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1 Chronicles 1:1–7

1 Chronicles

1 Chronicles 1:1–7

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 1:1–7 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:1–7 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In 1 and 2 Chronicles, the storyteller reminds the Israelites of the most important parts of their history. When the storyteller wrote this book, some Israelites were living in Jerusalem and the surrounding area, but other Israelites were still living a long distance away. All Israelites everywhere were living under the rule of foreign kings. The author of Chronicles begins the book with a long section to remind the Israelites of their ancestors from the first man, Adam, to their very important ancestor Abraham. In this story, the storyteller reminds the audience of the family line from Adam to Noah. Then the storyteller mentions some of the people groups that are descended from Noah's son Japheth.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how important is it for people to remember who their ancestors were? Why is it important to people to remember their ancestors? How do people remember their ancestors? Pause this audio here.

To the ancient Israelites, it was very important to remember who their ancestors were. First, a person's ancestry was what made that person an Israelite. Although a small number of foreign-born people joined the Israelite community, most Israelites were born into the community. Yahweh made great promises to Abraham that Yahweh would fulfill through Abraham's son, Isaac, Abraham's grandson, Jacob, and Jacob's descendants. For an Israelite, to know his or her ancestors was proof that those promises that Yahweh gave to Abraham applied to him or her. Furthermore, every Israelite was born into the tribe of his or her father and remained in that tribe for life. In ancient Israel, a person's tribe affected many aspects of how that person lived. This was especially true for the Levites, because their tribe was responsible for taking care of the temple.

Stop here and discuss this question: Tell a story about the ancestors of your people, especially any stories that include more than one generation of your ancestors. Pause this audio here.

The ancient Israelites were not supposed to worship or pray to their ancestors. Yahweh told the Israelites many times that ancestor worship was a sin against Yahweh. There were other reasons why ancestry was important to the Israelites. By beginning his book with our earliest human ancestors, the author of Chronicles shows that Yahweh's plan to save humanity from sin goes all the way back to the beginning of the human race. It also shows that, even though the Israelites are God's chosen people, all human beings are connected through common ancestors. The Israelites valued remembering the ancestry of the people groups around them, even though those people were sometimes the Israelites' enemies.

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In the first part of this story, the storyteller lists the male ancestors of all human beings. The story starts with the first man, Adam, then Adam's son Seth, then Seth's son Enosh, and so on, all the way to Noah. There are 10 generations from Adam to Noah. The storyteller assumed that the ancient Israelites who read and heard this list already knew who these men were and how they were related to each other, because people knew these men's stories from the book of Genesis. So the storyteller of Chronicles just wrote the list of names to remind the Israelites of the earliest ancestors of mankind. However, people in your culture may not know who these men are, and you will need to make it clear how the men are related to each other.

In some cultures, people think that their ancestors through their father are most important. In other cultures, people think that their ancestors through the mother are most important. And in other cultures, people think that their ancestors through the mother and father are equally important. The ancient Israelites thought that their ancestors through the father were most important. This is the reason why lists of ancestors in the Bible usually only list fathers and sons. These lists normally do not include the names of mothers unless there is something unusual or significant about the mother. In this story, the storyteller does not mention mothers at all.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, when you talk about family lines, do you talk about family lines through mothers, through fathers, or both? How do you feel about the fact that this list includes only fathers and sons? Pause this audio here.

In the second part of this story, the focus changes to name many people who descended from Noah. This scene begins a large section of the book that describes how, after the Great Flood, people began to spread out and live in different parts of the earth. These family lists are also a record of how all the different groups of people on earth are related to each other. First, the storyteller names Noah's three sons: Shem, Ham, and Japheth. Then the storyteller lists some of the descendants of Japheth. The storyteller will list the descendants of Ham and Shem later. The storyteller tells us the names of the sons of Japheth, then the storyteller names people groups who are descended from Japheth's grandsons. In this story, the storyteller uses the word "sons" to describe both the literal sons of Noah—Shem, Ham, and Japheth—and the storyteller uses the word "sons" to describe the groups of people who descended from Noah's son Japheth.

No one knows for certain exactly where all of these people groups lived. But Bible scholars have tried to show the approximate locations of the descendants of Shem, Ham, and Japheth on maps.

Stop here and look at a map of the descendants of Shem, Ham, and Japheth. Note where the descendants of Japheth lived in relation to Israel.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes. Each scene has a different focus.

In the first scene: The focus is on the list of descendants from Adam, the first man, down to Noah, the man who built the big boat before the Great Flood.

In the second scene: The focus is on the names of the people groups that descended from Noah's son Japheth.

The characters in this passage are:

- Adam, Seth, Enosh, Kenan, Mahalalel, Jared, Enoch, Methuselah, Lamech, Noah
- Shem, Ham, Japheth, Gomer, Magog, Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech, Tiras, Ashkenaz, Riphath, Togarmah, Elishah, Tarshish
- And the people of Kittim and Rodanim

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

At the beginning of a section like this, it might be helpful to tell your audience that they are about to hear a list of ancestors. You could use a phrase like "A list of descendants from Adam to Noah" or "The family line from

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Adam to Noah." We call a short sentence like this, which tells your audience what the next section is about, we call that a section heading. We do not find section headings in the Bible originally, but you may want to use one to help your audience understand what they are hearing.

Stop here and discuss whether or not you will use a section heading to introduce this list. If you decide to use one, discuss how you will say it. What would be most helpful for your audience? Pause this audio here.

The first scene focuses on the family line, or line of descent, from Adam to Noah. When the Israelites heard this list of names, the Israelites remembered that Yahweh told the first man to be fruitful and multiply, to fill the earth with descendants and rule over the earth. If you have already translated the book of Genesis, it will be helpful to go back and listen to a more detailed description of this family line in Genesis chapter five.

Stop here and have the group listen to Genesis chapter five if it is available in your language. Pay special attention to how you translated the names. Pause this audio here.

This same list of names occurs in reverse order at the end of the third chapter of the book of Luke. If you have already translated the book of Luke, you can go back and listen to how you translated these names in Luke.

Stop here and listen to the ancestry of Jesus in the second half of Luke chapter three. Pay special attention to how you translated the names starting from Noah and going back to Adam. Do the names match how you translated them in Genesis? Pause this audio here.

In 1 Chronicles, the list of fathers and sons from Adam to Noah is much shorter than the story in Genesis chapter five. In fact, the storyteller of Chronicles simply lists the names of each man one right after another! The storyteller assumed that his audience already knew that each man on the list was the father of the man whose name came next. However, audiences now probably will not know this information. This is why some translations say the relationship between each person. For example, you might say "Adam was the father of Seth, Seth was the father of Enosh, Enosh was the father of Kenan," and on down to Noah.

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: What is the most natural way in your language to present this list of names? How do you make it clear who is the father and who is the son? Does your language have special words to use in a list of ancestors? Will you use a list of names, or will you state the relationship between each person? Pause this audio here.

The second scene focuses on naming the descendants of Noah's son Japheth. Whenever storytellers list Noah's sons, they list them in this order: first Shem, then Ham, and Japheth is last. Ham was Noah's youngest son, while Bible scholars believe that Shem was Noah's firstborn son. It may seem strange that the storyteller of Chronicles starts with the younger sons of Noah and leaves Shem's family list until last. But there is a good reason for this: the Israelites are descended from Shem, and so the storyteller will spend the rest of the book talking about Shem's descendants. Therefore, the storyteller quickly lists the descendants of Japheth and Ham and leaves Shem for last.

In the Bible, storytellers use the word "sons" in different ways. Sometimes "sons" means the literal sons of one person. Other times, "sons" means descendants, which can mean children, grandchildren, great-grandchildren, and even more people over many generations. In this story, the storyteller probably uses the word "sons" in both ways.

Stop here and discuss this question: Does your language have a word that can mean both "son" and "descendant"? If not, what words will you use to show a difference between who is a son and who is a descendant in this story? Pause this audio here.

We also find this list of the descendants of Japheth in the book of Genesis. If you have already translated the book of Genesis, it may help to go back and listen to the list of the descendants of Japheth that you find at the beginning of Genesis chapter 10.

Stop here and listen to the first four verses of Genesis chapter 10. Pause this audio here.

You may notice that the list of the descendants of Japheth in 1 Chronicles chapter one is very similar to the list in Genesis chapter ten, verses two through four. Most of the names of both the sons or descendants of Japheth and the descendants of Gomer are the names of both the son and the people groups that descended from that

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son. The ancient Israelites would have recognized each of these names as the name of a group of people, rather than the name of one person.

Stop here and discuss this question: Does your language have a special way of showing that a name is the name of a group of people, rather than the name of an individual? In your language, how do you refer to a group of people to show that they are descended from a common ancestor? Pause this audio here.

In the next part of the story, the storyteller identifies some of the people groups that descended from Javan according to where they lived. For example, the word "Rodanim" means "the people who live in Rhodes," which is a large island off the coast of Greece. Because these terms refer to places that still exist today, some Bible translations choose to use the modern name of that place. For example, the name "Kittim" refers to the people who live on Cyprus, an island in the Mediterranean Sea that is not far from Israel. Some Bible translations say "the people of Cyprus" rather than "Kittim" because people nowadays can look at a map and find Cyprus and understand where these people lived, but the word "Kittim" probably means nothing to them.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you identify people according to where those people live? If you do not have a way to do this in your language, how can you show that these people groups take their names from the place where they live? Pause this audio here.

You might have noticed that the storyteller names people groups who are descended from Japheth's sons, Gomer and Javan. The storyteller does not name any people groups who are descendants of Japheth's other sons. Nobody knows for certain why the storyteller does not mention other descendants.

We hear many names in this story, and it might be difficult to remember them all in the correct order.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will remember all the names in the correct order. You might want to use objects or some other memory device to help you. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Adam, Seth, Enosh, Kenan, Mahalalel, Jared, Enoch, Methuselah, Lamech, Noah
- Shem, Ham, Japheth, Gomer, Magog, Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech, Tiras, Ashkenaz, Riphath, Togarmah, Elishah, Tarshish
- And the people of Kittim and Rodanim

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. That person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite listening to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you could also play the audio recording of the passage out loud again. While you do this, think about the purpose of the book of Chronicles.

Many years before, the ancestors of the Israelite people experienced terrible things. The Babylonians overthrew the Israelite king, murdered many of the Israelite people, destroyed Jerusalem, and destroyed the temple of Yahweh. The Babylonians forced the Israelite people to leave Israel and move to Babylon. After the Persians and the Medes came to power, they allowed the Israelites to go back to their country, but Israel was in terrible condition. It took years of hard work to build a second temple, which was smaller and not as beautiful as the temple that Solomon built. It took many more years of hard work to rebuild Jerusalem. Even after the Israelites rebuilt Jerusalem, the Israelites did not have their own king, but had to obey a foreign ruler.

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The storyteller of Chronicles wants to remind the Israelites that, in spite of all this, the Israelites are still Yahweh's chosen people. The storyteller plans to show the Israelites in his book that Yahweh has always been faithful to them and that all the promises Yahweh made to the Israelites' ancestors are still true. The storyteller hopes to increase the people's faith by showing them that, in spite of their troubles, they belong in the story of Yahweh's plan of redemption.

Pause this audio here and listen to the passage.

The group should listen to this passage a second time. At certain points, pause the recording and ask each person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and listen to the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Adam was the father of Seth, Seth was the father of Enosh, Enosh was the father of Kenan, Kenan was the father of Mahalalel, Mahalalel was the father of Jared, Jared was the father of Enoch, Enoch was the father of Methuselah, Methuselah was the father of Lamech, Lamech was the father of Noah.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I think it is really important that our people remember where we came from; or
- I feel in awe that we still know the names of the earliest humans; or
- I feel honored to be the one who is teaching our people these important truths; or
- I hope that my people remember the stories in Scripture about these men.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I feel proud that our people have saved this important history of the world; or
- I remember some of these names, but not all of them; or
- Some of these men died in the Great Flood, which means they were wicked people and God punished them; or
- This book must be very important if the storyteller begins with Adam; or
- Maybe God has not abandoned our people.

Continue reciting the names.

Noah had three sons: Shem, Ham, and Japheth. The descendants of Japheth were Gomer, Magog, Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech, and Tiras. The descendants of Gomer were the people of Ashkenaz, Riphath, and Togarmah. The descendants of Javan were the people of Elishah, Tarshish, Kittim, and Rodanim.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know some of these people groups, and I do not like them; or
- I wonder why these people went and lived where they did. These people must have been very brave; or
- I am in awe when I think of how God filled the earth with many different kinds of people.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I am thankful that God did not destroy everybody in the flood but allowed some people to live; or
- I wonder if these people remember God or know what he has done for them; or
- I am impressed that my people have recorded the origin of all the people groups on the earth; or
- It is important to remember this information.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

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In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In scene one of this story, the storyteller lists the family line from Adam to Noah. We hear 10 names in this list. If you have already translated the book of Genesis or the book of Luke, you have already decided how to translate each of these names.

Stop here and listen again to Genesis chapter five, or to the second half of Luke chapter three. Pay close attention to how you translated each name in this list. Did you translate the name according to its meaning, or did you translate it to sound similar to the original name? Do you like the decision you made for each name, or do you want to change it? Pause this audio here.

In the book of 1 Chronicles, the storyteller sometimes uses the word “sons” to mean the male children of a person, and sometimes to mean all the descendants of a person.

Stop here and decide how you will talk about **sons** in your translation when it means a male child and how you will talk about it when it means descendants. Will you use one word to mean both, or will you use two different words to describe whether the son is a male child or whether the sons are descendants of the person? The words “sons” and “descendants” are in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

If you decide to change any names, you must go back and change each occurrence of that name. If you need to know the meanings of each person’s name, here they are: the name **Adam** means “man,” “person,” or “mankind.” The name **Seth** means “given, placed, or set.” The name **Enosh** means “a man” or “a human being.” The name **Kenan** means “a room or a place to live.” The name **Mahalalel** means “the praise of God.” The name **Jared** means “descent” or “falling down.” The name **Enoch** means “initiated” or “dedicated” in the sense of someone who has been trained for something. The name **Methuselah** means “man of the dart” or “man of the spear” in the sense of someone who is able to throw a weapon. The meaning of the name **Lamech** is a bit uncertain. It might mean “a strong man” in the sense of a man who misuses his power. The name **Noah** means “rest, quiet, or peaceful.”

Stop here and discuss whether you want to make any changes to the names you are using in this section. Pause this audio here.

In scene two of this story, the storyteller lists Noah’s three sons: Shem, Ham, and Japheth. These names also have meaning. The name Shem probably means “fame” or “honor.” The name Ham means “hot” or “heat.” The name Japheth means “expansion” or “enlarged.”

Stop here and discuss whether you are happy with the way you translated the names of **Shem**, **Ham**, and **Japheth** or if you want to change them. Pause this audio here.

In the rest of scene two, the storyteller tells us the names of Japheth’s descendants. Most of the names in this list are probably the names of people groups. You can also find these names in Genesis chapter ten, verses one through four.

Stop here and listen again to Genesis chapter ten, verses one through four. Pay close attention to how you translated each name in this list. Can you tell that each name is the name of a people group? Do you like the decision you made for each name, or do you want to change it? Pause this audio here.

Some of the names on this list refer to the people who lived in certain places. Those places still exist today. We do not know where all of these places are, but for some of them, we do know for certain what they refer to. When it is possible to do so, some translation teams prefer to use the modern-day names of these places because they are more meaningful to their audience. Using modern place names reminds the audience that these stories are about real people and real places.

Another way you could do this is to say the original name of the people group and then say the modern name of the location where they lived, if you know the place. For example, when you list the descendants of Javan, you could say “the people of Elishah; the people of Tarshish, which is in Spain; the people of Kittim, which is the island of Cyprus; and the people of Rhodes, which is an island in Greece.” Your language may or may not have names for these places. If it does not, that is okay. You can choose to call the people of those lands according to the original name of the people group. If you decide to use the modern names of geographical places, you will need to know which people groups lived in which places.

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Stop here and look at a map that shows the locations of the descendants of Japheth. Then listen to the following description of where the people lived. Pause this audio here.

The sons of Japheth were Gomer, Magog, Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech, and Tiras. This is what we know about where these people lived: The people of **Gomer** probably lived somewhere around the Black Sea, in the countries that are now Russia and Turkey. Bible scholars do not agree on where the people of **Magog** lived, so it is probably better not to use a place name for this people group. In contrast, we know exactly where the people of **Madai** lived: they lived on the plateau south of the Caspian Sea, in the country people now call Iran. The people of Madai were the ancestors of the Medes, who founded the Persian Empire, and we hear people mention this name many times in the Bible. The people of **Javan** lived on the islands in the Ionian Sea, between Greece and Turkey, and in the coastlands around that sea. The storytellers in the books of Ezekiel and Isaiah mention the people of Javan three times. . The people of **Tubal** probably lived in central Turkey**.** The storytellers in the books of Ezekiel and Isaiah mention the people of Tubal six times. . The people of **Meshech** probably lived west of the people of Tubal, also in Turkey. The storytellers in Isaiah, Ezekiel and the book of Psalms mention the people of Mesech many times. Bible scholars do not agree on where the people of **Tiras** lived, so it is probably better not to use a place name for this people group.

Stop here and discuss how you want to translate the names of this group of the descendants of Japheth. Pause this audio here.

The descendants of Gomer were Ashkenaz, Riphath, and Togarmah. This is what we know about where they lived: The people of **Ashkenaz** probably lived north of the Caucasus mountains in Russia. These people later became known as the Scythians. The storyteller in the book of Jeremiah mentions the Scythians, or the people of Ashkenaz, and so does the storyteller of the New Testament book of Colossians. . Bible scholars do not agree on where the people of **Riphath** and **Togarmah** lived, so it is probably better not to use a place name for these people groups.

The descendants of Javan were the people of Elishah, Tarshish, Kittim, and Rodanim. This is what we know about where these people lived: Bible scholars also do not agree on where the people of **Elishah** lived, so it is probably better not to use a place name for this group of people. The people of **Tarshish** probably lived somewhere on the coast of Spain. The people of **Kittim** probably lived on the island of Cyprus. The storytellers in the Old Testament mention the people of Tarshish and Kittim many times. The people of **Rodanim** lived on the island of Rhodes, which is a large island in Greece, one of the closest Greek islands to Israel.

Stop here and discuss how you want to translate the names of the descendants of Gomer and Javan.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (775 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.0 MB)

1 Chronicles 1:8–16

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 1:8–16 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:8–16 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:8–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller of Chronicles listed the family line from Adam to Noah. Noah was the father of Shem, Ham, and Japheth. The storyteller told us the names of some people groups who descended from Japheth. In this passage, the storyteller will tell us the names of some descendants of Ham, Noah's youngest son.

Remember that it was important to the ancient Israelites to remember who their ancestors were. The Israelites did not worship their ancestors as some of the people groups around them did. Yahweh told the Israelites many times not to worship dead people because that was a sin against Yahweh. Rather, the Israelites remembered their ancestors because their family line connected them to the promises of Yahweh. Yahweh promised that he would send a savior to rescue all the descendants of Adam from their sins. Yahweh promised Noah that Yahweh would never again send a flood to destroy the entire earth. Yahweh told Noah and his children to be fruitful, multiply, and spread out over the entire earth. By remembering the descendants of Noah, the Israelites kept a record of how people did what Yahweh told them to do.

Just like in the previous passage, some of the names the storyteller lists here are the names of individual people, and some are the names of people groups. And just like in the previous passage, you might have a choice between referring to a people group according to the name of their ancestor or referring to the people group according to where they lived.

Stop here and remind each other of the decisions you made for how to translate the names of people groups in the previous passage. Do you still like the decisions you made? Why or why not? Pause this audio here.

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Just like in the previous passage, the word “sons” might refer to one person’s sons, or to many descendants of that person. In the previous passage, you discussed what words you will use to refer to a son and to descendants.

Stop here and remind each other of the decisions you made for how to translate “sons” and “descendants.” Do you still like the decisions you made? Why or why not? Pause this audio here.

This story focuses on the descendants of Ham, Noah’s youngest son. Some of the descendants of Ham went to live in new parts of the world after the Great Flood, but some of them lived in the area that would eventually become the land of Israel. No one knows for certain where all of these people groups lived. But Bible scholars have tried to show the approximate locations of these people groups on maps.

Stop here and look at a map of the descendants of Shem, Ham, and Japheth. Note where the descendants of Ham lived in relation to Israel. Pause this audio here.

Because Ham’s descendants lived so close to the Israelites or even lived within Israel’s territory, the Israelites communicated with Ham’s descendants more than they did with Japheth’s descendants. For this reason, you will hear some of these group names many times in the Bible. Groups like these include the Philistines, the Egyptians, and the Canaanites.

This story includes some information about an individual descendant of Ham, a warrior named Nimrod. You can hear more details of Nimrod’s life in Genesis chapter ten, verses eight through twelve. Here, the storyteller of Chronicles simply mentions that Nimrod was a mighty warrior.

Stop here and tell a story about someone who was a great hunter or warrior. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller mentions that Sidon was the firstborn son of Ham. This probably means that Sidon was both the name of an individual and a people group.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:8–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller names Ham’s four sons: Cush, Mizraim, Put, and Canaan.

In the second scene: The storyteller names Cush’s descendants, including Nimrod, a mighty warrior.

In the third scene: The storyteller names Mizraim’s descendants.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller names Canaan’s descendants.

The storyteller does not tell us anything about the descendants of Ham’s son, Put.

The characters in this passage are:

- Cush, Mizraim, Put, Canaan
- Seba, Havilah, Sabta, Raamah, Sabteca, Sheba, Dedan, Nimrod
- Mizraim’s descendants: the Ludites, Anamites, Lehabites, Naphtuhites, Pathrusites, Casluhites, the Philistines —who descended from the Casluhites—and the Caphtorites
- Sidon and his descendants: the Hittites, Jebusites, Amorites, Girgashites, Hivites, Arkites, Sinites, Arvadites, Zemarites, and Hamathites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage’s setting. You may want to have your map available so you can see where some of these people groups lived.

We hear the names of all these individuals and people groups in the tenth chapter of Genesis. If you have already translated the book of Genesis, it might be helpful to go back and listen to that chapter again to remind you of these people’s stories and the names you used for them.

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Stop here and listen to Genesis chapter ten, verses six through twenty. Pay attention to the names you used for all the people listed. Pause this audio here.

The first scene focuses on the sons of Ham. These sons' names were Cush, Mizraim, Put and Canaan. Sometimes people call Mizraim "Egypt." Sometimes people call Put "Libya." Canaan is the son of Ham whom his grandfather Noah cursed.

Stop here and listen again to Genesis chapter ten, verse six. Pay attention to the names you used for Ham's sons Cush, Mizraim, Put, and Canaan. Do you like the way you chose to translate them in Genesis? Why or why not? Pause this audio here.

The second scene focuses on the descendants of Ham's son Cush. In this context, the name Cush probably refers to both an individual and a geographical region. The region is located in Africa, south of the country of Egypt. The Bible mentions the region of Cush many times. Most of the descendants of Cush lived south of Israel.

Stop here and listen again to Genesis chapter ten, verses seven through eleven. Pay attention to how you translated each of the names. Do you like the way you chose to translate them in Genesis? Why or why not? Pause this audio here.

At this point in the story, the storyteller introduces a new way to describe relationships. Up to this point, the storyteller has introduced descendants by calling them "the sons of Ham" or "the sons of Cush." But beginning with Cush and Nimrod, instead of saying "Nimrod was the son of Cush," the storyteller says "Cush begot Nimrod" or "Cush became the father of Nimrod." The storyteller uses a special word that means "to father" or "to become the father of."

Stop here and discuss this question: What is the most natural way in your language to say that someone fathered a child or became the father of a child? Pause this audio here.

In the next two scenes, the storyteller does the same thing with people groups. The storyteller says, "This person was the father of..." and then names the groups. So in this story, the storyteller uses the word "father" in two ways. Sometimes it means the literal father of an individual, but sometimes it means "ancestor" or "founder." "Founder" is a word that means a person who started something, or in the case of a people group, the first person that we can identify as one of those people.

Stop here and discuss this question: What words does your language use to talk about your ancestors? How many of these words refer to more than one generation? Could you use any of these words to mean both "father" and "ancestor"? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller switches between explaining relationships by describing a group of people as "the sons of" someone, or saying that a man "begat" or "became the father" of a group of descendants. If it is natural and clear to do so in your language, your translation should reflect the way the storyteller describes the relationships. However, in some languages, this may be confusing, or it may not be acceptable at all.

Stop here and discuss this question: How clear and natural is it in your language to switch between these two different ways of describing relationships? How confusing do you think it might be to your audience? Would it be better to consistently describe the relationships in the same way, or is it acceptable to follow the way the storyteller does it? Pause this audio here.

The third scene focuses on the descendants of Ham's son Mizraim. People sometimes call Mizraim "Egypt." Most of these people groups lived in the northeastern part of Africa.

Stop here and listen again to Genesis chapter ten, verses thirteen and fourteen. Pay attention to the names you used for the descendants of Mizraim. Do you like the way you chose to translate these names in Genesis? Why or why not? Pause this audio here.

The fourth scene focuses on the descendants of Canaan, Ham's youngest son. The storyteller mentions that Sidon was the firstborn son of Ham. This probably means that Sidon was both the name of an individual and a people group.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does your language talk about the firstborn child, or the firstborn son? What special words could you use to refer to the firstborn child? Pause this audio here.

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Most of the people groups who descended from Canaan lived in the land that became Israel, as well as the lands that are now the countries of Lebanon, Syria, Jordan, and parts of Arabia.

Stop here and listen again to Genesis chapter ten, verses fifteen through nineteen. Pay attention to the names you used for the descendants of Canaan. Do you like the way you chose to translate them in Genesis? Why or why not? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller does not tell us the names of any of Put's descendants. Nobody knows why the storyteller does not mention Put's descendants.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:8–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Cush, Mizraim, Put, Canaan
- Seba, Havilah, Sabta, Raamah, Sabteca, Sheba, Dedan, Nimrod
- Mizraim's descendants: the Ludites, Anamites, Lehabites, Naphtuhites, Pathrusites, Casluhites, the Philistines —who descended from the Casluhites—and the Caphtorites
- Sidon and his descendants: the Hittites, Jebusites, Amorites, Girgashites, Hivites, Arkites, Sinites, Arvadites, Zemarites, and Hamathites

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If this section is too difficult to remember, you may listen to an audio recording again.

While you do this, think about the Israelites' experiences. The Israelites' ancestors communicated with many of these people groups. The Egyptians, who were Mizraim's descendants, enslaved the Israelites. When the Israelites left Egypt, they drove the Hittites, Jebusites, Amorites, Girgashites, and Hivites out of the Promised Land. At times, their ancestors had to fight with the Philistines, who were descendants of Mizraim, and the Assyrians, who were descendants of Nimrod. The Israelites' ancestors frequently sinned by worshipping Ashtoreth, the goddess of the Sidonians. Because of that sin, Yahweh punished the Israelites and allowed the Babylonians to overthrow their king and destroy their country.

When the ancient Israelites heard the names of these people groups, the Israelites probably thought about the history of their nation, both good and bad. The Israelites might have thought about how all these different people groups played a role in shaping not only the national history of Israel, but also the spiritual life of the people.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should listen to this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The descendants of Ham were Cush, Mizraim, Put, and Canaan. The descendants of Cush were Seba, Havilah, Sabta, Raamah and Sabteca. The descendants of Raamah were Sheba and Dedan. Cush was also the ancestor of Nimrod, who was the first heroic warrior on earth.

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Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that my people are listening to this after all the hard work I put into writing it down; or
- Nimrod’s descendants did terrible things to our people. I do not like Nimrod’s descendants; or
- I feel sad about all the conflict my people have had with these other groups of people.

Ask the people playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I wonder why some of these people moved so far away; or
- I recognize some of the names of these people, and I do not like them; or
- I hope I never have to see any of these people in my life; or
- This is so interesting. I forgot that all these people were related to each other!

Continue reciting the names.

Mizraim was the ancestor of the Ludites, Anamites, Lehabites, Naphtuhites, Pathrusites, Casluhites, from whom the Philistines came, and the Caphtorites.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel ashamed that our ancestors did not destroy all the Philistines and had to fight with them for hundreds of years; or
- I feel proud that our people have kept records about the ancestors of everyone in the world; or
- I feel sad about all the bad things that these other people have done to my people.

Ask the people playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I feel angry when I remember that the Egyptians from Mizraim enslaved our ancestors; or
- I am so glad that my people finally defeated the Philistines; or
- I have never met anyone from some of these groups. I wonder why they are so important.

Continue reciting the names.

Canaan’s firstborn son was Sidon, the ancestor of the Sidonians. Canaan was also the ancestor of the Hittites, Jebusites, Amorites, Girgashites, Hivites, Arkites, Sinites, Arvadites, Zemarites, and Hamathites.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I hope that my people will feel inspired when they hear this; or
- I want my people to understand how important this history is to us; or
- I hope that someday we will send all the foreigners out of our land again, like our ancestors did to the Canaanites.

Ask the people playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel proud when I think about how our ancestors sent away the Canaanites from the land; or
- I feel sad when I remember that our ancestors worshipped Canaanite gods; or
- I am glad that Yahweh completely destroyed some of these people groups.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:8–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Remember that sometimes **sons** in the original language refers to the male children of a parent, and sometimes it refers to a group of **descendants**. Translate sons, or descendants, in the same way you translated in the previous passage. In the previous passage, you may have chosen to use one word to mean both, or you may have

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two separate words for sons and descendants. For more information about sons and descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

The sons of Ham are Cush, Mizraim, Put, and Canaan. These names refer to both individual people and geographical locations.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the locations of Ham's descendants. Then listen to the rest of the audio, which explains the locations of these people groups. Pause this audio here.

Apart from Canaan, we do not know the meaning of these names, so it is probably best to translate these names to sound like the original names. The name Canaan means "conquered" or "humiliated."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the name **Canaan**. Will you translate it according to how it sounds, or will you translate it according to the meaning of the word? See the Master Glossary for more information on Canaan. Pause this audio here.

Cush refers to a part of Africa around the upper part of the Nile River in the modern-day countries of Sudan and Ethiopia. **Mizraim** refers to the lower part of the Nile River in modern-day Egypt. **Put** probably refers to an area west of Egypt in the modern-day country of Libya. And **Canaan** refers to the area on the eastern coast of the Mediterranean Sea that became the land of Israel.

Stop here and discuss how you translated these names. Do you like the way you already translated them in Genesis chapter ten, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

Bible scholars think that Seba, Havilah, Sabta, Raamah and Sabteca were all located around the southern part of the Red Sea, either in southern Arabia or northeastern Africa, but no one is certain about their exact location. **Sheba** refers to the land and the people in southern Arabia in the area of modern Yemen. **Dedan** is probably a town located at an oasis in northwestern Arabia. The name **Nimrod** refers to both a person and a geographical area. Nimrod was the ancestor of the Assyrian people, and the Bible calls Assyria "the land of Nimrod." The heart of Nimrod's territory was the area around the Tigris and Euphrates rivers in the modern-day country of Iraq.

Stop here and discuss how you translated these names. Do you like the way you already translated them in Genesis chapter ten, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

At this point in 1 Chronicles chapter one, the storyteller begins to use a new way to describe the relationships between individuals. Instead of saying "Nimrod was the son of Cush," he says "Cush became the father of Nimrod."

Stop here and discuss what word or phrase you will use to translate "**became the father of**." Pause this audio here.

Bible scholars do not agree on where the **Ludites** and **Anamites** lived. But most Bible scholars think that the **Lehabites** probably lived along the coast of North Africa, possibly west of the people of **Put**, in modern-day Libya. The **Naphtuhites** probably lived somewhere along the lower part of the Nile River in Egypt, possibly in the place where the Nile River reaches the coast. The **Pathrusites** probably lived in southern Egypt or northern Sudan. Bible scholars do not agree on where the **Casluhites** lived. But the location of the **Philistines** is very well known. The Philistines lived along the coast of the southeastern Mediterranean Sea in the area now known as Gaza. The **Caphtorites** probably lived on the island of Crete, which is a large island south of Greece.

Stop here and discuss how you translated these names. Do you like the way you already translated them in Genesis chapter ten, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

Now we come to the descendants of Canaan. First, the storyteller mentions **Sidon**, whom he calls the firstborn son of Canaan. The name Sidon means "to hunt," but Sidon was also a city and a region north of Israel on the coast of the Mediterranean Sea in the modern-day country of Lebanon. The Bible mentions Sidon many times as a city, a region, and a people group. The rest of the descendants of Canaan are people groups. If you have already translated Old Testament books such as Genesis, Exodus, Judges, Joshua, or 1 and 2 Samuel, then you have translated the terms Hittites, Jebusites, Amorites, Girgashites, and Hivites before. These are the people groups that Yahweh told the Israelites to send away from the land. We only hear about the Arkites, Sinites, Arvadites, Zemarites, and Hamathites here and in Genesis chapter ten.

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The **Hittites** lived in the hill country south of Jerusalem. The **Jebusites** lived in the hills around Jerusalem. In fact, the Canaanites called the city Jebus before the Israelites came in and called it Jerusalem. The **Amorites** lived on the east side of the Jordan River between Ammon and Moab. Bible scholars are not certain where the **Girgashites** lived, but they may have lived somewhere north of the **Amorites**. The **Hivites** probably lived in the central and northern regions of the land of Canaan.

Stop here and discuss how you translated these names. Do you like the way you already translated them in Genesis chapter ten, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

The **Arkites** probably lived in the coastal town of Irqata, about 150 kilometers north of Sidon. Bible scholars do not agree on where the **Sinites** lived. The **Arvadites** lived in the city of Arvad, located on a rocky island off the coast north of Irqata. The **Zemarites** probably lived somewhere near the coast in the modern-day country of Syria. The **Hamathites** also probably lived in the western part of Syria in a city called Hamath.

Stop here and discuss how you want to translate Arkites, Sinites, Arvadites, Zemarites, and Hamathites. Do you want to translate them so they sound similar to the original names? When it is possible, do you want to translate them according to the modern-day name of the location?

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (846 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.0 MB)

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Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 1:17–27 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:17–27 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:17–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller of Chronicles told us about the descendants of Ham, Noah's youngest son. In this passage, the storyteller tells us the names of the descendants of Shem, Noah's oldest son. This passage includes the family line from Shem to Abraham, the father, or very important ancestor, of the Israelite people. So the Israelites consider this line of descent the most important line of descent. The storyteller will spend the rest of the books of 1 and 2 Chronicles talking mostly about the descendants of Shem.

The descendants of Shem spread out around the Middle East and northeast of Africa. No one knows for certain exactly where all the descendants of Shem lived. But Bible scholars have tried to show the approximate locations of the descendants of Shem on maps.

Stop here and look at a map of the descendants of Shem. Note where these people lived in relation to Israel. Pause this audio here.

By now, you have probably noticed that the storyteller has repeated a few names in these lists of descendants. For example, Ham had a descendant named Sheba, and Shem also had a descendant named Sheba.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: in your culture, how often do you meet different people who have the same name? Describe the circumstances when it is acceptable or not acceptable for different people to have the same name. If it is not normal in your culture for different people to have the same name, how will you make it clear to your audience that these descendants with the same name are different people? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller names several descendants of Shem. Then the storyteller follows the line of descent from Shem through Arphaxad, Shelah, and Eber, to Eber's two sons, Peleg and Joktan. The Israelites are descended from Peleg. But before the storyteller tells us about the descendants of Peleg, he tells us about 13 people groups that descended from Peleg's brother Joktan.

Stop here and discuss this question: How is your people group related to other people groups who live nearby? What is the relationship like between the groups? Do you have a good relationship, or not? How important is it to remember the common ancestors that you have with other people groups? How do you talk about the other groups that you are related to? Pause this audio here.

At the end of this passage, the storyteller follows the line of descent from Shem to Abraham. There are 10 generations from Shem to Abraham. Remember that Abraham's original name was Abram, which means "mighty father," but Yahweh later gave him the name Abraham, which means "father of many." Yahweh gave this name as a sign of the promise that Abraham would be the ancestor of many descendants. So Abram and Abraham are two different names for the same person.

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Stop here and discuss this question: Talk about someone in your culture who you know by more than one name. How did that person get each of his or her names? Under what circumstances might a person become known by more than one name? If this is uncommon or unheard of in your culture, how can you make it clear to your audience that Abram and Abraham are the same person?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:17–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller focuses on naming some people groups who descended from Shem, but who were not ancestors of the Israelites.

In the second scene: The storyteller focuses on telling us the family line that descended from Shem to Abraham, the father of the Israelite nation.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elam, Asshur, Arphaxad, Lud, Aram, Uz, Hul, Gether, Meshech, Shelah, Eber, Peleg, Joktan, Almodad, Sheleph, Hazarmaveth, Jerah, Hadoram, Uzal, Diklah, Obal, Abimael, Sheba, Ophir, Havilah, Jobab
- And Shem, Arphaxad, Shelah, Eber, Peleg, Reu, Serug, Nahor, Terah, and Abram

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller focuses on naming some people groups who descended from Shem. We find most of these names in chapter 10 of the book of Genesis. If you have already translated Genesis, it would probably be helpful to go back and listen again to chapter 10 to remember how you translated these names.

Stop here and listen to chapter 10 of Genesis if it is available in your language. Pay attention to how you translated the names of the descendants of Shem. Pause this audio here.

If you were able to listen to Genesis chapter 10 in your language, you may have noticed a small difference in how the storytellers list the descendants of Shem. In 1 Chronicles chapter one, the storyteller says, "The descendants of Shem were Elam, Asshur, Arphaxad, Lud, Aram, Uz, Hul, Gether, and Meshech." Genesis chapter 10 says, "The sons of Shem were Elam, Asshur, Arphaxad, Lud, and Aram. The sons of Aram were Uz, Hul, Gether, and Meshech."

We can explain this difference by remembering the two different meanings of the term "sons of" in the original language of the Bible, Hebrew. Remember that in the Hebrew language, the word "son" can mean someone's male child, but it can also mean "descendants," which includes sons, grandsons, great-grandsons, and so on. In this case, the storyteller of Chronicles clearly uses the term "sons of" to mean "descendants" and not "children. To put it another way, all the names listed after Shem are his descendants, even if some of them are sons and some of them are grandsons. Therefore, we recommend that you use the term "descendants" in this section of the passage.

You might have also noticed that some translations include the information that Uz, Hul, Gether, and Meshech were the sons of Aram, and therefore the grandsons of Shem. Other translations just list all the names as the descendants of Shem. Either choice is acceptable.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Will you include the information that Uz, Hul, Gether, and Meshech were the sons of Aram, or will you call everyone in this list the descendants of Shem? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller once again switches between two different ways of describing relationships. Sometimes the storyteller says that a group of people were the sons of their father. Other times, the storyteller says that someone was the father of a group of people.

Stop here and remind each other of what you decided for the last story. How clear and natural is it in your language to switch between these two ways of describing relationships? Pause this audio here.

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The name Peleg sounds like the Hebrew word for “divided.” Most Bible scholars think that when the storyteller says, “in his days the earth was divided,” this means that Peleg lived at the time of the Tower of Babel, when human beings began to speak many different languages.

In this section, the storyteller begins to follow a certain pattern that he will sometimes repeat in upcoming sections. In the case of Joktan, he says “Joktan became the father of…” and then lists the names of Joktan’s descendants. The storyteller then finishes the section with a summary statement: “All these were the sons of Joktan.” In some languages, people will find it helpful to hear this summary statement. But in other languages, the repetition might sound strange and unnatural. If it is unnatural in your language to include the summary statement, you may choose to leave it out.

Stop here and discuss this question: Is it natural and clear in your language to include the summary statement that “all these were the sons of Joktan” here? Why or why not? Will you include it in your translation or leave it out? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller tells us the family line from Shem to Abraham. The storyteller repeats the names of Shem, Arphaxad, Shelah, Eber, and Peleg. Then the storyteller continues the genealogy to Abraham. This is the most important part of this section to the Israelites because all of these men are the Israelites’ ancestors. Once again, the storyteller of Chronicles assumes that his audience knows the relationships between Shem, Arphaxad, Shelah, and the rest of the people in this list, so he simply lists their names. Your audience will probably be less familiar with the relationships between these men, and it might be helpful to make the relationships clear. For example, you might say, “Shem was the father of Arphaxad, who was the father of Shelah, who was the father of Eber,” and continue in this way until you reach Abraham.

Stop here and discuss this question: What is the most natural way in your language to present this list of descendants? Will you explain the relationship between each man, or just use the list of names? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:17–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elam, Asshur, Arphaxad, Lud, Aram, Uz, Hul, Gether, Meshech, Shelah, Eber, Peleg, Joktan, Almodad, Sheleph, Hazarmaveth, Jerah, Hadoram, Uzal, Diklah, Obal, Abimael, Sheba, Ophir, Havilah, Jobab
- And Shem, Arphaxad, Shelah, Eber, Peleg, Reu, Serug, Nahor, Terah, and Abram

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group in your language. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you could also play the audio recording out loud.

As you do this, imagine you are an ancient Israelite who lives in Jerusalem and is listening to one of your leaders tell you the names of the descendants of Shem. This is an exciting portion of the chapter for you and the other Israelites because you are all descendants of Shem. The people in the line of descent from Shem are your ancestors, and the people groups the storyteller mentions here are more closely related to you than the people groups who the storyteller mentioned in earlier stories. You and the other Israelites know the history of your people’s interactions with the descendants of Aram and Asshur. You have heard of places called Sheba and Ophir. You have heard stories about Abram all your lives. To an Israelite, this is the most important part of the story so far.

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Pause this audio here and recite the passage.

The group should listen to this passage a second time. It is acceptable to listen to an audio recording of the passage if the many names are too difficult to remember at this point. At certain points in the passage, pause and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The descendants of Shem were Elam, Asshur, Arphaxad, Lud, Aram, Uz, Hul, Gether, and Meshech. Arphaxad was the father of Shelah, who was the father of Eber. Eber had two sons. One son's name was Peleg, because during his time, the people of the world were divided, or in different parts of the world. And the other son's name was Joktan.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of 1 Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am excited because we are finally getting to the best part; or
- I hope everyone is still listening; or
- I feel angry about the things that some of these people groups did to my people.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy to hear more about my ancestors; or
- I wonder what it was like when everyone suddenly started speaking different languages; or
- I wonder where all these people live and what they are doing now; or
- This is very important information. I need to memorize it!

Continue reciting the names.

The descendants of Joktan were the people of Almodad, Sheleph, Hazarmaveth, Jerah, Hadoram, Uzal, Diklah, Obal, Abimael, Sheba, Ophir, Havilah, and Jobab.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of 1 Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel privileged to be the one to tell my people these important things; or
- I want to memorize all these names; or
- I wonder why it was important to name some people's descendants but not other people's descendants..

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wish I knew more about all these groups of people; or
- I cannot remember all these names; or
- It is really interesting to hear about all these different people.

Continue reciting the names.

This is the family line from Shem to Abram: Shem was the father of Arphaxad, who was the father of Shelah, who was the father of Eber, who was the father of Peleg, who was the father of Reu, who was the father of Serug, who was the father of Nahor, who was the father of Terah, who was the father of Abram, who people came to know as Abraham.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of 1 Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am excited! This is the most important part; or
- It is so good that our ancestors thought to write down the names of fathers and sons; or

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- Now we are really getting to the good part of the story!

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy because I recognize these names; or
- I wonder if these people knew how important their family was; or
- I wish we knew more about what happened in each person's life; or
- Thank you, God, for preserving this information about our ancestors.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:17–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Stop here and look at the map that shows the location of the descendants of Shem. Keep this map visible for the rest of step five. Pause this audio here.

Remember that sometimes the word **sons** in the original language refers to the male children of a parent, and sometimes it refers to a group of **descendants**. Translate sons, or descendants, in the same way you have translated in the previous passages. In the previous passages, you may have chosen to use one word to mean both, or you may have used two separate words for sons and descendants. For more information about sons and descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

The descendants of Shem were Elam, Asshur, Arphaxad, Lud, Aram, Uz, Hul, Gether, and Meshech. The descendants of Elam lived in the fertile region to the east of the mouth of the Tigris River and north of the Persian Gulf, in modern-day Iran. The descendants of Asshur were the Assyrians, who lived along the Tigris River in central Iraq and later became a great empire. Bible scholars do not agree on exactly where the descendants of Arphaxad lived, but most think it was somewhere in the modern-day countries of Iraq or Iran. The descendants of Lud probably lived on the west coast of the modern-day country of Turkey. The descendants of Aram lived north of the land of Israel, and people called these descendants Arameans or Syrians. We hear about the descendants of Aram many times in the Bible, as they were one of Israel's closest neighbors. The descendants of Uz lived in northwest Arabia. Bible scholars do not agree on where the descendants of Hul, Gether, and Meshech lived. Bible scholars are unsure of the meaning of most of these names.

Stop here and listen again to the last part of Genesis chapter 10, which lists the descendants of **Shem**. Pay close attention to how you translated the names **Elam**, **Asshur**, **Arphaxad**, **Lud**, **Aram**, **Uz**, **Hul**, **Gether**, and **Meshech**. Did you translate the name to sound similar to the original name, or did you translate it according to where those people lived? Do you like the decision you made for each name, or do you want to change it? Pause this audio here.

Arphaxad was the father of Shelah. Use the same words or phrase for "became the father of" that you used in previous passages.

Shelah, **Eber**, **Peleg**, and **Joktan** are the names of individual people. Shelah was the father of Eber, and Eber was the father of Peleg and Joktan. But these individuals may also have given their names to the people groups who descended from them. The people who took the names of Eber and Peleg probably lived between the Tigris and Euphrates rivers, in modern-day Iraq. The people who took the name of Joktan lived south of them, in modern-day Saudi Arabia.

Stop here and look at the map that shows the location of the descendants of Shem. Look for the location of Eber, Peleg, and Joktan. Pause this audio here.

The names Shelah, Eber, Peleg and Joktan also have their own meanings. Shelah means "to send away or send out." Eber means "to cross over." Peleg means "to divide" or "divided," and Joktan means "he will be small."

Stop here and listen again to the last part of Genesis chapter 10. Pay close attention to how you translated the names of **Shelah**, **Eber**, **Peleg**, and **Joktan**. Did you translate the name to sound similar to the original name,

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according to the meaning of the name, or did you translate it according to where those people lived? Do you like the decision you made for each name, or do you want to change it? Pause this audio here.

We do not know the exact location of most of the descendants of Joktan. Some Bible scholars believe that **Ophir** was located in northeastern Africa in the modern-day countries of Djibouti or Somalia, but others think it may be located in India. Ophir was famous for its gold. The people of **Sheleph**, **Hazarmaveth**, **Hadoram**, **Uzal**, **Diklah**, **Obal**, **Sheba**, and **Jobab** probably lived somewhere in the southern part of Arabia along the coast, but no one agrees on exactly where each group lived. There was more than one people group and more than one location called **Havilah**, so it is probably best not to translate this name according to a modern place name. People do not agree on where the people of **Jerah** and **Abimael** lived.

Of the descendants of Joktan, we know the meaning of only a few of their names. Abimael means “father of Mael.” Havilah means “to spin, to circle” or it can also mean “round, circular.” Jobab means “to cry or to howl.”

Stop here and listen again to the latter part of Genesis chapter 10. Pay close attention to how you translated the names of Joktan’s descendants. Did you translate the name to sound similar to the original name, or did you translate it according to the meaning of the name? Do you like the decision you made for each name, or do you want to change it? Pause this audio here.

Shem was the father of Arphaxad, Arphaxad was the father of Shelah, Shelah was the father of Eber, Eber was the father of Peleg, Peleg was the father of Reu, Reu was the father of Serug, Serug was the father of Nahor, Nahor was the father of Terah, and Terah was the father of Abram, who became Abraham.

Most Bible scholars believe that the members of this family line lived in the area around the Tigris and Euphrates rivers, in modern-day central Iraq. While the meaning of the name Arphaxad is uncertain, Bible scholars know the meaning of many of the names on this list. We have already discussed the meanings of the names Shelah, Eber, and Peleg. The name Reu means “friend or companion.” The name Serug means “to weave together.” The name Nahor means “to snort or to snore.” The meaning of the name Terah is uncertain. The name Abram means “great father” or “mighty father,” while the name Abraham means “father of many.”

Stop here and listen again to the last part of Genesis chapter 10. Pay close attention to how you translated the names **Arphaxad**, **Shelah**, **Eber**, **Peleg**, **Reu**, **Serug**, **Nahor**, **Terah**, **Abram**, and **Abraham**. Did you translate the name to sound similar to the original name, or did you translate it according to the meaning of the name? Do you like the decision you made for each name, or do you want to change it?

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 1:17–27

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (884 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 1:28–33

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 1:28–33 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:28–33 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:28–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller of Chronicles told us about the line of descent from Shem to Abraham. In this passage, the storyteller begins a long section in which he tells us more about the people who descended from Abraham. The storyteller starts by telling us the names of the descendants of Abraham's firstborn son, Ishmael. Then the storyteller lists the descendants of Abraham through his concubine Keturah. The storyteller will list the names in Abraham's line of descent through Isaac later.

Stop here and tell a story about one of your ancestors who was famous or did something important. Why is it important to remember the story of this ancestor? How do you feel when you talk about this ancestor? How often do you talk about this ancestor? Pause this audio here.

Once again, the storyteller talks about the descendants of a person by first listing the descendants who are not the direct ancestors of the Israelites. The Israelites descended from Abraham through his second son, Isaac, who was born to Abraham's wife, Sarah. Although Ishmael was Abraham's firstborn son, Abraham was not married to Ishmael's mother, Hagar. Hagar was Sarah's servant. Although it was a socially acceptable practice at that time to father children in this way, Ishmael still did not have the same status as Sarah's son, Isaac.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, how important is it that a child is born to married parents? What are the advantages for a child who is born to married parents? What are the possible disadvantages or problems for a child who is born to unmarried parents? Pause this audio here.

The descendants of Ishmael lived in Arabia and the Sinai Peninsula between Egypt and Israel. Ishmael's descendants were nomadic people, which means that they did not always live in the same place. These people may have lived in different places at different times of the year. But Bible scholars show where they think these people lived on maps.

Stop here and look at a map of the descendants of Ishmael. Note where these people lived in relation to Israel. Pause this audio here.

You may have noticed that sometimes in these lists of descendants, the storyteller points out who is the firstborn in a list of sons. This was an important detail in the Israelites' culture.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, how important is it to be the firstborn child? What special privileges or responsibilities does a firstborn child have? Does it make a difference if the firstborn is a boy or a girl? Pause this audio here.

Keturah was Abraham's concubine. A concubine was like a wife or companion of a man who already had one wife. A concubine did not have the same rights as a man's first wife. The sons of Keturah were also not the direct ancestors of the Israelites. In spite of this, the storyteller of Chronicles thought it was important to record the names of Keturah's sons in his book. This is the first time that the storyteller of Chronicles thinks that the identity of a mother is important enough to mention. We do not know for certain why the storyteller chooses to mention Keturah's name here. One possibility is that, although Keturah was Abraham's concubine, Yahweh did not include her children in the agreement that Yahweh had made with Abraham. Perhaps the storyteller wanted to emphasize that Keturah's children did not receive the promises about possessing the land of Canaan, or any of the other promises that were for Isaac only.

We know where some of the descendants of Abraham through Keturah lived.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the location where some of Keturah's descendants lived.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:28–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller focuses on naming the descendants of Ishmael.

In the second scene: The storyteller focuses on naming the descendants of Abraham through Abraham's concubine Keturah.

The characters in this passage are:

- Isaac, Ishmael, Nebaioth, Kedar, Adbeel, Mibsam, Mishma, Dumah, Massa, Hadad, Tema, Jetur, Naphish, Kedemah
- And Keturah, Zimran, Jokshan, Medan, Midian, Ishbak, Shuah, Sheba, Dedan, Ephah, Epher, Hanoch, Abida, and Eldaah

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

If you have already translated the book of Genesis, then you have already translated all of these names. If the book of Genesis is available in your language, it would be helpful to go back and listen to the beginning section of Genesis chapter 25, which lists the descendants of Abraham through Keturah and through Ishmael.

Stop here and listen to Genesis chapter 25, up until the descendants of Ishmael. Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, the storyteller introduces this new section of the book by saying, "The sons of Abraham were Isaac and Ishmael." Isaac's mother was Sarah, Abraham's wife, while Ishmael's mother was Hagar, Sarah's servant. Although it was the Israelites' custom to list their children beginning with the oldest and continuing in order of age, the storyteller of Chronicles lists Abraham's younger son, Isaac, before Ishmael.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, what is the relationship like between older siblings and younger siblings? How much authority do older siblings have over younger siblings? Do older siblings or younger siblings have any special responsibilities or privileges? Pause this audio here.

There are several reasons why the storyteller of Chronicles might have put Isaac's name before Ishmael's name. First, Isaac was the ancestor of the Israelites, and therefore, Isaac was most important to the Israelites. So the storyteller of Chronicles just put Isaac's name first. It is possible that it could reflect the fact that Abraham was not married to Ishmael's mother, so even though Ishmael was older, Isaac had a higher status than Ishmael. It might also reflect the fact that Yahweh told Abraham that Yahweh would fulfill his promises to Abraham through Isaac and not through Ishmael.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, when you recite a list of family members, how do you decide the order in which you list your family members? What rules or customs determine how you list your family members? Do you always follow these rules? If not, under what circumstances might you choose not to follow the rules? Pause this audio here.

This introduction also does not mention the sons of Keturah. The storyteller waits to list these sons after he lists the descendants of Ishmael. The storyteller probably assumes that his audience knows that Abraham also had sons through Keturah, who became Abraham's concubine after Sarah died. A concubine is a woman who has a lower status than a wife, but is socially acceptable as a man's companion. People considered that the children of a concubine were legitimate children and had the same rights as the children of a wife. In the Ancient Near East, it was a very common practice for a man to have one or more concubines. In Genesis chapter 25, the storyteller calls Keturah Abraham's wife. The storyteller of Chronicles might call her Abraham's concubine here to show that Keturah did not have the same status as Sarah, the mother of Isaac, who inherited the promises from God.

Stop here and discuss these questions: What word or phrase could you use in your language to describe a concubine? Do you have a similar word or concept in your culture? If not, how do you feel about this category of wife? Pause this audio here.

You might find a small difference in the list of descendants of Keturah in Genesis compared to the list in 1 Chronicles. The passage in Genesis lists the descendants of Dedan, while the list in 1 Chronicles leaves those descendants out. Since we want our translation to accurately reflect what is in the original story, do not include the descendants of Dedan here.

The storyteller mentions that Nebaioth was Ishmael's firstborn son. In that time and place, the firstborn son had special privileges and special responsibilities. The firstborn son got twice as much inheritance as any other sons did. The firstborn often had more authority than other sons did.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your language, how do you talk about the firstborn child, or the firstborn son? Pause this audio here.

You may notice that the storyteller once again includes a summary statement at the end of the list of Ishmael's descendants and at the end of the list of Abraham's descendants through Keturah. The storyteller says, "These were the sons of Ishmael," and later says, "These were the descendants of Keturah." You previously talked about whether or not to include this kind of summary statement in your translation.

Stop here and remind each other of the decision you made about including summary statements for each section in your translation. Are you happy with the decision you made, or do you want to change it? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:28–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Isaac, Ishmael, Nebaioth, Kedar, Adbeel, Mibsam, Mishma, Dumah, Massa, Hadad, Tema, Jetur, Naphish, Kedemah
- And Keturah, Zimran, Jokshan, Medan, Midian, Ishbak, Shuah, Sheba, Dedan, Ephah, Epher, Hanoch, Abida, and Eldaah

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group in your language. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you could also play the audio recording out loud.

While you do this, imagine you are an ancient Israelite listening to this list of descendants. You have heard the stories about Abraham, Isaac, and Ishmael many times. You know that Yahweh made great promises to Abraham. Yahweh also told Abraham that Yahweh would fulfill those promises through Isaac, Abraham's son with Sarah. You know that Abraham and Sarah had to wait a very long time before Sarah became pregnant with Isaac, and that Abraham and Sarah's trust in God was weak. That is how Hagar gave birth to Ishmael. You know that after the birth of Isaac, Abraham sent his son Ishmael away. You know that Sarah died before Abraham died, and that Abraham grieved for Sarah. Then Abraham married Keturah and had more children. But Isaac remained the son that Yahweh had miraculously provided for Abraham.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should read this passage a second time. At certain points in the passage, stop reading and ask each person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The sons of Abraham were Isaac and Ishmael. These are their family records: the firstborn son of Ishmael was Nabaioth, then Kedar, Adbeel, Mibsam, Mishma, Dumah, Massa, Hadad, Tema, Jetur, Naphish, and Kedemah.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel excited that we are now talking about the descendants of Abraham; or
- I do not like the descendants of Ishmael; or
- It is important to remember the other descendants of our father Abraham.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- Those Ishmaelites have been a problem for our people; or
- That situation with Ishmael was sad. I feel bad for Ishmael and his mother; or
- I am excited. I want to know more about these people.

Continue reciting the names in the passage.

The sons of Keturah, Abraham's concubine, were Zimran, Jokshan, Medan, Midian, Ishbak, and Shuah. The sons of Jokshan were Sheba and Dedan. The sons of Midian were Ephah, Epher, Hanoch, Abidah, and Eldaah. All these were the descendants of Keturah.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- It is important to remember that these people are also descendants of Abraham; or
- I wonder what happened to all these people over the years; or
- I hope my audience is still listening to these long lists of names.

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Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I am relieved that I recognize some of these names; or
- I feel happy for Abraham that he was blessed with so many children; or
- It is important to remember who descended from which ancestors.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:28–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Remember that sometimes the word **sons** in the original language refers to the male children of a parent, and sometimes it refers to a group of **descendants**. Translate sons, or descendants, in the same way you have translated in the previous passages. In the previous passages, you may have chosen to use one word to mean both sons and descendants, or you may have two separate words for sons and descendants. For more information about sons and descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

To introduce the next section, the storyteller begins by saying, “The sons of Abraham were Isaac and Ishmael. These are their genealogies.” **Genealogy** is a special word that means “a record of ancestors and descendants.”

Stop here and discuss this question: Does your language have a special word or phrase for a list of ancestors and descendants? If so, can you use that word here? If not, how will you introduce this list of descendants? For more information on the word genealogy, see the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Be sure to translate the names **Abraham**, **Isaac**, and **Ishmael** in the same way that you have translated them in previous stories. Also see the Master Glossary for more information on Abraham.

Now we come to the lists of the descendants of Abraham. If you have already translated the book of Genesis, then you have already translated these names. It would be helpful to listen again to the section of the book of Genesis where you find this list of names.

Stop here and listen to the first section of Genesis chapter 25, which lists the descendants of Abraham. Pay attention to how you translated the names. Did you translate the names according to their meaning, according to where the people lived, or did you translate them to sound like the original name? Pause this audio here.

Next, the storyteller lists the descendants of Ishmael. Ishmael’s descendants lived in modern-day Saudi Arabia, and possibly in parts of Jordan and in the eastern part of Egypt, but it is hard to know for sure exactly where each group lived. So it is probably best not to use modern place names for the people groups who descended from Ishmael. We do know what some of these names mean. The name Ishmael means “God hears.” Nebaioth means “fruitfulness.” Kedar means “dark or dusky.” Adbeel means “disciplined of God.” Mibsam means “smells good.” We do not know the meanings of Mishma, Dumah, and Massa. Hadad means “fierce.” We do not know the meaning of Tema. Jetur probably means “surrounded or closed in.” Naphish means “refreshed.” Kedemah means “to come first, to be first.”

Stop here and listen again to Genesis chapter 25, specifically the part that lists **Ishmael**’s descendants. Pay attention to how you translated the names **Nebaioth**, **Kedar**, **Adbeel**, **Mibsam**, **Mishma**, **Dumah**, **Massa**, **Hadad**, **Tema**, **Jetur**, **Naphish**, and **Kedemah**. Are you happy with how you translated these names in Genesis, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller lists the sons of Abraham through Keturah. In this story, the storyteller calls Keturah Abraham’s concubine. A concubine is any woman who lives with a man and provides him with children, but who has an inferior status to that man’s primary wife. People consider that the children of a concubine are legitimate children and those children can inherit wealth and property from their father. In the case of Abraham, Sarah, and Keturah, Sarah was the primary wife. Even though Sarah died before Abraham married Keturah, the storyteller of Chronicles still refers to Keturah as a concubine and not as a wife.

Stop here and discuss what word you will use **concubine**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, be sure to use the same word here. Pause this audio here.

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Bible scholars believe that some of these people groups that descended from Abraham and Keturah probably lived in Arabia. But with the exception of the descendants of **Midian**, we do not know exactly where each of these groups lived. Midian is a region in the far northwest part of Arabia. The Midianites lived on both sides of the Gulf of Aqaba and were probably nomadic. We hear about the country of Midian and the Midianite people many times in the Bible.

The name Keturah means “perfumed”, as in “smelling good”, or possibly “frankincense,” which was a pleasant-smelling substance. Zimran means “musical.” Jokshan means “tricky or sneaky.” Medan means “arguing.” Midian means “argument.” Ishbak means “he will leave.” Shuah means “to think.” We are not certain what Sheba and Dedan mean. Ephah means “darkness.” Epher means “gazelle, or deer-like animal.” Hanoch means “introduced.” Abidah means “father of knowledge.” Eldaah means “God of knowledge.”

Stop here and listen again to the very beginning of Genesis chapter 25, which lists the descendants of Abraham through Keturah. Pay attention to how you translated the names **Keturah**, **Zimran**, **Jokshan**, **Medan**, **Midian**, **Ishbak**, **Shuah**, **Sheba**, **Dedan**, **Ephah**, **Epher**, **Hanoch**, **Abidah**, and **Eldaah**. Are you happy with how you translated these names in Genesis, or do you want to change them?

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 1:28–33

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (948 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 1:34–37

1 Chronicles 1:34–37

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 1:34–37 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:34–37 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:34–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller of Chronicles introduced us to the descendants of Abraham. The storyteller listed the descendants of Ishmael, Abraham's firstborn son, and the descendants of Abraham through his concubine Keturah. In this passage, the storyteller begins to list the descendants of Abraham through his son, Isaac. First, the storyteller lists Isaac's two sons, Esau and Israel, and then the storyteller lists some of Esau's descendants.

The storyteller follows the same pattern from previous passages by first listing the descendants of Esau, the son of Isaac, who was not the direct ancestor of the Israelites. Esau and Jacob were twins. Esau was born first, and Jacob was born second. Later, Yahweh gave Jacob the name Israel, so the name "Israel" in this passage refers to Jacob, Isaac's second son. The Israelites are descendants of Isaac through his son Jacob and received their name from "Israel," the name that Yahweh gave to Jacob. The storyteller of Chronicles often uses the name "Israel" when he talks about Jacob to remind the Israelites of this connection.

The descendants of Esau lived in a region called Edom. This area was south of the Dead Sea and southeast of Israel. Edom included territory in the far southeastern part of modern-day Israel, the south of modern-day Jordan, and the far northwest of modern-day Saudi Arabia.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the location of Edom and Israel. Pause this audio here.

The descendants of Esau were even more closely related to the Israelites than any other group we have discussed up to this point. Because Esau's descendants lived in the region called Edom, people sometimes called Esau's descendants the Edomites. The Israelites often came in contact with the Edomites, and the two groups often acted hostilely toward each other. Yahweh even told the Israelites, "You are not to hate an Edomite, for he is your brother," emphasizing the close relationship between the two groups.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Name some people groups that your group considers to be related to you. What is the relationship like between your group and the other groups? What are some reasons why you might feel close to or friendly with the other groups? What are some reasons why you might have conflict? Pause this audio here.

The descendants of Esau were all part of the people group that we know as the Edomites. Just like the Israelites, the Edomites had smaller subgroups that people sometimes called tribes. People usually named these groups after an ancestor.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Do you have tribes in your people group? If so, how do you know which tribe a person belongs to? How important is membership in a tribe? What is the relationship like between the tribes?

1 Chronicles 1:34–37

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:34–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller focuses on the family line from Abraham to Esau and Israel. Then the storyteller names the sons of Esau.

In the second scene: The storyteller lists some of the descendants of Esau's sons.

The characters in this passage are:

- Abraham, Isaac, Esau, Israel, Eliphaz, Reuel, Jeush, Jalam, and Korah
- Teman, Omar, Zepho, Gatam, Kenaz, Amalek, Timna
- And Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller tells us about the family line from Abraham to Esau and Israel. Then the storyteller tells us the names of Esau's sons. If you have already translated the book of Genesis, then you have already translated all of these names. It would probably be helpful to go back and listen to the part of Genesis that contains this part of the family line.

Stop here and listen to the first five verses of Genesis chapter 36, which list the sons that were born to Esau in the land of Canaan. Pause this audio here.

You probably noticed that the story in Genesis chapter 36 contains more details than the list of ancestors in 1 Chronicles chapter 1. For example, the storyteller of Chronicles leaves out the names of Esau's wives. The storyteller might have assumed that his audience already knew which of Esau's wives was the mother of which son. Or, the storyteller might have assumed that if his audience did not know, they could refer to Genesis chapter 36 and find out. Remember that the Israelites considered the family line of fathers and sons to be the most important detail of their family lines.

Because we can refer back to Genesis chapter 36, we know all of the names in this scene are names of individual men. The Bible has many stories about Abraham, Isaac, Esau, and Israel, that is, Jacob. We also know that Eliphaz, Reuel, Jeush, Jalam, and Korah were individual men. Therefore, in this scene, whenever the storyteller uses the word "father," it means a literal "father" rather than "ancestor." And when the storyteller uses the word "son," it means a literal "son" rather than "descendant."

Jacob and Israel are two different names for the same person. Throughout the Bible, the storytellers frequently call the descendants of Jacob by the name Israel, and sometimes call them Israelites. This can be confusing for listeners. It might not always be obvious when the name "Israel" refers to Jacob the individual, or to his descendants, the Israelites. Here, the storyteller is talking about Jacob the person and not about Jacob's descendants.

In scene two, the storyteller tells us the names of some descendants of Esau's sons, Eliphaz and Reuel. The storyteller does not tell us any names of descendants of Esau's sons Jeush, Jalam, and Korah.

In 1 Chronicles 1, the storyteller includes Timna in the list of descendants of Eliphaz. But Genesis 36 says that Timna was actually Eliphaz's concubine and the mother of Amalek. This difference is easy to explain if the storyteller of Chronicles assumed that his audience already knew who Timna was. In the original language, Hebrew, the name Timna is a name for a woman, so the storyteller probably assumed that his audience knew she was the mother of the person whose name came after hers.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your language, are there names that people use for males only? For females only? Is it possible for a name to be both a name for a male and a name for a female? Give some examples. Pause this audio here.

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Some translations of this passage include the information that Timna was not a descendant of Eliphaz, but rather that Timna was Eliphaz's concubine and was the mother of Amalek.

Stop here and discuss this question: Will you include the information that Timna was the mother of Amalek and not a descendant of Eliphaz? Why or why not? Pause this audio here.

The descendants of Esau were all part of one people group, the Edomites. Although the Edomites were closely related to the Israelites, they saw themselves as a separate, independent group. The Edomites had their own territory and their own leaders. Also, like the Israelites, the Edomites recognized that there were smaller groups within their own people group. These smaller groups were descended from the sons and grandsons of Esau. Some translations of the Bible refer to these smaller groups of people as tribes. The word "tribes" does not appear in the original language, but it is acceptable to use here if it helps to make the text more clear and natural. For example, some translations say something like, "Eliphaz became the ancestor of the following tribes."

Stop here and discuss these questions: What words does your language use to refer to smaller groups of people within the larger group? Which word might you use to translate the word tribe? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:34–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Abraham, Isaac, Esau, Israel, Eliphaz, Reuel, Jeush, Jalam, and Korah
- Teman, Omar, Zepho, Gatam, Kenaz, Amalek, Timna
- And Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group in your language. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you could also play the audio recording out loud.

While you do this, imagine you are an ancient Israelite listening to this list of descendants. You are familiar with the stories of Abraham, Isaac, Esau, and Jacob. You know that Esau sold his birthright to Jacob for a bowl of stew and was angry about it afterwards. You know that Esau was so angry that he planned to kill Jacob. You know that your ancestors had conflict with the descendants of Esau for a long time. You know that King David and King Solomon ruled over the Edomites for a time, but that later the Edomites rebelled and attacked Israel.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should read or recite this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask each person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" Each person should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Abraham's son Isaac had two sons, Esau and Jacob. Esau's sons were Eliphaz, Reuel, Jeush, Jalam, and Korah.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel honored to be the one who tells my people about these important parts of our history; or

- I feel sad that there has been so much conflict between our people and the descendants of Esau; or
- It is important to remember the other descendants of our father Isaac.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The peoplemight answer things like:

- I feel sad for Esau, who really suffered for his poor decisions; or
- I feel angry at the Edomites because they treated our people badly so many times; or
- I wish I knew more about the descendants of our brother Esau.

Continue reciting the list of names.

The sons of Eliphaz were Teman, Omar, Zephi, Gatam, Kenaz, and by Timna, Amalek. The sons of Reuel were Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel angry when I remember the Amalekites, who have been our enemies for a long time; or
- I hope our people do not continue to have conflict with the Edomites; or
- I wonder what happened to the descendants of Esau’s other three sons?

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I recognize some of these names, and I do not like them; or
- I wonder why the storyteller mentioned Timna but not any other wives or mothers; or
- I am afraid that the Edomites could still hurt our people.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:34–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Remember that sometimes the word **sons** in the original language refers to the male children of a parent, and sometimes it refers to a group of **descendants**. In this passage, all the names in scene one are names of individual sons. The names in the second scene are both the name of an individual son and of a tribe. Translate these types of sons and descendants in the same way you have in previous passages. For more information about sons and descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

In the first scene, the storyteller recounts the family line through **Abraham**, **Isaac**, **Esau**, and **Israel**. Then he lists Esau’s sons. Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob are called the patriarchs, or fathers, of Israel. Their names have important meaning. Abraham means “father of many.” Isaac means “laughter,” which reminds us that Isaac’s mother, Sarah, laughed when she first heard that she would have a son. Esau means “rough or rugged” in the sense of the opposite of smooth and even. Israel means “wrestles with God.” Be sure to translate Abraham, Isaac, Esau, and Israel the same way you have in previous passages. Look up Abraham and Israel in the Master Glossary for more information.

The storyteller begins this scene by using the special word **begot**, or “became the father of,” to say that Abraham was the father of Isaac. Be sure to translate this word in the same way that you have done in previous passages.

The sons of **Esau** were **Eliphaz**, **Reuel**, **Jeush**, **Jalam**, and **Korah**. The name Eliphaz means “God of gold.” The name Reuel means “friend of God.” The name Jeush means “too fast.” The name Jalam means “hidden.” The name Korah means “ice.”

Stop here and listen again to Genesis chapter thirty-six, the first five verses, if it is available in your language. Pay close attention to how you translated the names of Esau’s sons. Did you translate the names according to their meaning, or according to how they sound? Do you like the way you translated the names, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

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Eliphaz was the father of **Teman**, **Omar**, **Zephi**, **Gatam**, and **Kenaz**. Through his concubine **Timna**, **Eliphaz** also fathered **Amalek**. The name Teman means “south.” The name Omar means “talkative.” The name Zephi means “observant.” We do not know the meaning of the name **Gatam**. The name Kenaz means “hunter.” The name Timna means “restraint.” We do not know the meaning of the name Amalek.

Stop here and listen again to the middle part of Genesis chapter 36 if it is available in your language. Pay close attention to how you translated the names of the family of Eliphaz. Did you translate the names according to their meaning, or according to how they sound? Do you like the way you translated the names, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

Reuel became the father of **Nahath**, **Zerah**, **Shammah**, and **Mizzah**. The name Nahath means “to go down.” The name Zerah means “to appear.” The name Shammah means “desolation.” The name Mizzah means “to faint from fear.”

Stop here and listen again to Genesis chapter 36 if it is available in your language. Pay close attention to how you translated the names of the sons of Reuel. Did you translate the names according to their meaning, or according to how they sound? Do you like the way you translated the names, or do you want to change them?

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 1:34–37

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1014 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 1:38–42

1 Chronicles 1:38–42

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 1:38–42 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:38–42 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:38–42 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller of Chronicles told us about some of the descendants of Esau, who was Isaac's oldest son. In this passage, the storyteller tells us the names of some people who lived in Seir, which is another name for Edom. These are probably the groups of people who lived in Edom around the time that Esau's descendants settled there.

The land of Edom is south of the land of Israel.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the locations of Edom and Israel. Pause this audio here.

There are many mountains and valleys in the land of Edom. The name of one of those mountains was Mount Seir. Bible scholars are not sure exactly where Mount Seir was located. But over time, people began to call the entire area "the hill country of Seir" or just "Seir." So "Edom" and "Seir" are two different names for the same place.

Stop here and discuss this question: Tell a story about a place in your country that people call by more than one name. How did this place get each of its names? Pause this audio here.

Before the descendants of Esau lived in Seir, a group called the Horites lived there. Esau's descendants had to fight the Horites and drive them out in order to make a place for themselves to live. In the book of Genesis, the same group of people is called "the sons of Seir the Horite." So it seems that "the Horites" and "the sons of Seir" are two different names for the same group of people. Seir is probably the name of both the area of land people called Seir and the person from whom the sons of Seir descended.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Tell a story about a group of people in your country that you call by more than one name. How did this group get its different names? Or, if others call your group by more than one name, tell the story of how your group got those names. Pause this audio here.

You may find it surprising that the storyteller listed the descendants of Seir here. These people are not descendants of Abraham, and so to include them here might seem out of place. In the previous passage, the storyteller told us that Esau's son Eliphaz had a concubine named Timna, who was the mother of Eliphaz's son Amalek. In this passage, the storyteller tells us that Lotan, a son of Seir, had a sister named Timna. Some Bible scholars think that this was the same Timna. Remember, we previously talked about how the Israelites think that the family line through the father is most important, and that the Biblical storytellers usually do not mention mothers unless there is something unusual or significant about the mother. So if Esau's son Eliphaz married a Horite woman named Timna, this might explain why the storyteller of Chronicles mentioned her in two passages. If Timna's family was an important family, or if this was an important marriage, then it also might explain why the storyteller listed the descendants of Seir here.

1 Chronicles 1:38–42

In the Bible, marriages were not always just for romance or childbearing. Sometimes, a leader or a father might arrange a marriage in order to show that two different groups were making a political partnership with each other, or that two families were making peace with each other. This was especially true for kings, but it could be true for other people as well.

Stop here and discuss these questions: How often do families arrange marriages in your culture? For what reasons, other than romance or having children, might two families arrange a marriage? Do people ever arrange marriages to form an alliance between two families or two larger groups? Pause this audio here.

Some people might also find this passage confusing because there are several sets of people with the same name. For example, Seir named one of his sons Anah, and Zibeon also named one of his sons Anah.. Seir named another son Dishon, and Anah also named one of his sons Dishon..

Stop here and remind yourselves of the discussion you had earlier about identifying different people with the same name. In your culture, how often do you encounter different people who have the same name? How often do parents give their child the same name as a relative? How can you make it clear to your audience that there are different people with the same name in this story?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:38–42 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller lists the names of the sons of Seir.

In the second scene: The storyteller lists the names of the sons of Lotan, then mentions that Lotan's sister was Timna.

In the third scene: The storyteller lists the names of the sons of the remaining sons of Seir.

The characters in this passage are:

- Seir, Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah, Dishon, Ezer, Dishan
- Hori, Homam, Timna
- And Alvan, Manahath, Ebal, Shepho, Onam, Aiah, Anah, Dishon, Hemdan, Eshban, Ithran, Keran, Bilhan, Zaavan, Akan, Uz, and Aran

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

If you have already translated the book of Genesis, then you have already translated a story about the sons of Seir. This story is in the middle of Genesis chapter 36. If it is available in your language, it would be helpful and go back and listen to this part of Genesis to remind yourself of each of these names.

Stop here and listen to the middle part of Genesis chapter 36, which discusses the sons of Seir. Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, the storyteller of Chronicles lists the names of the sons of Seir. You probably noticed that in Genesis chapter 36, the storyteller tells us that Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah, Dishon, Ezer, and Dishan are chiefs of the Horites living in the land of Edom. The storyteller of Chronicles leaves out this detail and just tells us their names. The storyteller also leaves out Oholibamah, the daughter of Anah.

The storyteller of Chronicles has not mentioned Seir before in his book. The storyteller probably assumed that his audience knew who Seir was and why Seir's descendants were important. However, this will not be the case with many modern audiences. For this reason, some Bible translations choose to include a short statement to explain who the sons of Seir were. You may choose to do the same if you think it will help your audience understand this section. You may choose to say something like, "The original people of Edom were descended from the following sons of Seir."

Stop here and discuss whether or not you will include a short statement to explain who the descendants of Seir were. What are the advantages and disadvantages of doing so? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller tells us the names of the sons of Lotan. The storyteller also tells us that Lotan had a sister named Timna. Some Bible scholars think that this Timna is the same person who was the concubine of Eliphaz and the mother of Amalek. If this is true, then this is evidence that the descendants of Esau intermarried with the people who lived in the hill country of Seir.

In the third scene, the storyteller tells us the names of the rest of the grandsons of Seir.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:38–42 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Seir, Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah, Dishon, Ezer, Dishan
- Hori, Homam, Timna
- And Alvan, Manahath, Ebal, Shepho, Onam, Aiah, Anah, Dishon, Hemdan, Eshban, Ithran, Keran, Bilhan, Zaavan, Akan, Uz, and Aran

This section lists the original inhabitants of Edom. Esau's descendants drove the original inhabitants out of their land. The ancient Israelites knew what that felt like. The Israelites' ancestors had experienced the same thing. On the other hand, Esau's descendants were their brothers. The ancient Israelites had a stronger connection to Esau's descendants than they did to the original inhabitants of Edom. In spite of this, the Edomites had fought the Israelites many times during their history. The ancient Israelites might have had a lot of conflicting feelings about this story!

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should read or recite this passage a second time. At certain points, pause and ask each person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" Each person should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue to read or recite the passage.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The original people of Edom were the descendants of Seir: Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah, Dishon, Ezer, and Dishan.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel impatient to get through this section because these people are not descendants of Abraham; or
- It is important to remember the people that our brothers, the Edomites, had to fight in order to get their land; or
- This information is important but not very exciting.

Ask the person playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- These people are not descendants of Abraham, so why do we need to know this? or
- I am glad that the descendants of Esau defeated these people; or
- I feel sad when I remember all these people who Esau's descendants drove outof the land of Edom; or
- I wonder where Seir came from?

Continue reciting the list of names.

The sons of Lotan were Hori and Homam. Lotan's sister was Timna.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Timna must have been from an important family; or
- Lotan was honored that his sister Timna married Eliphaz; or
- Maybe if these people had defeated the Edomites, we would not have such problems with the Edomites now.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I wonder why Timna became the concubine of Eliphaz? or
- I do not like Timna because she was the mother of the Amalekites; or
- I do not care about these people.

Continue reciting the list of names.

The sons of Shobal were Alvan, Manahath, Ebal, Shepho, and Onam. The sons of Zibeon were Aiah and Anah. The son of Anah was Dishon. The sons of Dishon were Hemdan, Eshban, Ithran, and Keran. The sons of Ezer were Bilhan, Zaavan, and Akan. The sons of Dishan were Uz and Aran.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hope my audience is still listening; or
- I am glad that my people have recorded this important information; or
- It is good to remember that God calls our people to be a blessing to these other people.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I wish I knew more about these people; or
- It is sad that these people lost their land and their homes; or
- I wonder what happened to the descendants of these people.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:38–42 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

If you have already translated the book of Genesis, then you have already decided how to translate these names.

Stop here and listen to the middle part of Genesis chapter 36 that lists the descendants of Seir, if it is available in your language. Pause this audio here.

Remember that sometimes, the word **sons** in the original language refers to the male children of a parent, and sometimes it refers to a group of descendants. In this passage, sons refers to individual male children of a parent. Translate "sons" in the same way you have translated it in the previous passage. For more information about sons, refer to the Master Glossary.

The sons of **Seir** were **Lotan**, **Shobal**, **Zibeon**, **Anah**, **Dishon**, **Ezer**, and **Dishan**. The name Seir means "rough," as in "not smooth or soft." The name Lotan means "covering." The name Shobal means "overflowing." The name Zibeon means "striped." The name Anah probably means "an answer." The name Dishon probably means "one who leaps" or "antelope." The name Ezer means "treasure." The name Dishan probably means the same thing as Dishon, "antelope."

Stop here and listen again to the part of Genesis chapter 36 that lists the sons of Seir. Pay close attention to how you translated the names. Did you translate the names according to the meaning, or according to how they sounded? Do you like the way you translated these names, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

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The sons of Lotan were **Hori** and **Homam**. Lotan's sister was **Timna**. The name **Hori** means "burning anger." The name **Homam** means "destroying." The name **Timna** means "restraint."

Stop here and listen again to the part of Genesis chapter 36 that lists the sons of Lotan and Lotan's sister Timna. Pay close attention to how you translated the names. Did you translate the names according to the meaning, or according to how they sounded? Do you like the way you translated these names, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

The sons of Shobal were **Alvan**, **Manahath**, **Ebal**, **Shepho**, and **Onam**. The sons of Zibeon were **Aiah** and **Anah**. The son of Anah was **Dishon**. The name Alvan means "high or lofty." The name Manahath means "rest." The name Ebal means "bald or bare." The name Shepho means "a bare hill or plain." The name Onam means "strong." The name Aiah means "hawk or vulture." The name Anah means "an answer." The name Dishon probably means "one who leaps" or "antelope."

Stop here and listen again to the part of Genesis chapter 36 that lists the sons of Shobal, Zibeon, and Anah. Pay close attention to how you translated the names. Did you translate the names according to the meaning, or according to how they sounded? Do you like the way you translated these names, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

The sons of Dishon were **Hemdan**, **Eshban**, **Ithran**, **and Keran**. The sons of Ezer were **Bilhan**, **Zaavan**, and **Akan**. The sons of Dishan were **Uz** and **Aran**. The name Hemdan means "red." The name Eshban means "energetic." The name Ithran means "excellent." We are not certain what the name Keran means. The name Bilhan means "timid." The name Zaavan means "restless." The name Akan means "twisting." The name Uz means "to get advice." The name Aran means "to shout."

Stop here and listen again to the part of Genesis chapter 36 that lists the sons of Dishon, Ezer, and Dishan. Pay close attention to how you translated the names. Did you translate the names according to the meaning, or according to how they sounded? Do you like the way you translated these names, or do you want to change them?

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 1:38–42

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (889 KB)

- Setting the Stage (3.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 1:43–54

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 1:43–54 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:43–54 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:43–54 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller told us the names of some of the descendants of Seir the Horite. Those descendants were the original people who lived in Edom before Esau's descendants settled there. In this passage, the storyteller tells us about the kings who ruled in Edom after Esau's descendants settled there and before Israel had any kings. The storyteller also tells us the names of some tribal chiefs of the Edomites.

The land of Edom was south of Israel. The storyteller mentions several cities in this story, but apart from Bozrah, Bible scholars are not sure where any of these cities were. The city of Bozrah was so strongly connected with the land of Edom that sometimes in the Bible, Bozrah represents all of Edom.

Stop here and look at a map of Edom that shows the location of Israel and the location of the city of Bozrah. Pause this audio here.

The kings of Edom, who the storyteller listed here, are probably descendants of Esau. The storyteller tells us the name of each king, the name of that king's father, and where that king is from. In a few cases, we get a little extra information about each king. The storyteller makes it clear that the position of King of Edom did not pass from father to son, which is rather unusual for this area of the world. We do not know what the relationship of each king was to the king before him or the king after him.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, how do you choose your leaders? Do positions of leadership ever pass from one family member to another family member? Is your way of choosing leaders now different from how it was in the past? If so, talk about how your people used to choose their leaders. Pause this audio here.

In the last part of this passage, the storyteller of Chronicles gives us a list of names of Edomites. Some Bible scholars think these are the names of individual people who were chiefs of Edom. A chief is a person who is a leader in the community, but not the leader of the entire people group. Normally, the leader of an entire people group is called a king. A chief might be the leader of an extended family, the leader of a tribe, or the leader of the people in a certain geographical area, like a city. The people might choose a chief, or the position of chief might pass from one family member to another.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Talk about the different kinds of leaders that exist in your people group. Why does your group have these different kinds of leaders? What kind of authority does each kind of leader have? Which of these leaders might be similar to a chief? Pause this audio here.

Some Bible scholars do not agree that these are the names of individual people. Rather, those scholars think these might be the names of clans or tribes of Edomites. We know that the Israelites had tribes, such as the tribe of Judah. The Edomites might have had a similar system. A clan or tribe is a group of people that is larger than a family, but where the people still see themselves as related in some way.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, do you organize families into larger groups like clans or tribes? If so, how does each person know which clan or tribe he or she belongs to? How do you determine who the leader of the clan or tribe is? What are the reasons why your group organizes people into clans or tribes? Does each clan or tribe have any special jobs or responsibilities?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:43–54 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us the names of the eight Edomite kings. The storyteller also tells us the names of the fathers of most of the kings, as well as the city or region that the king came from.

In the second scene: The storyteller tells us the names of 11 chiefs or clans of Edom who descended from Esau.

The characters in this passage are:

- Bela, Beor, Jobab, Zerah, Husham, Hadad, Bedad, Samlah, Shaul, Baal-Hanan, Acbor, Hadad, Mehetabel, Matred, Me-Zahab
- And Timna, Alvah, Jetheth, Oholibamah, Elah, Pinon, Kenaz, Teman, Mibzar, Magdiel, and Iram

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

If you have already translated the book of Genesis, then you have already translated this story about the kings and chiefs of Edom. It would probably be helpful to listen again to that story to remind you how you translated the names in this story.

Stop here and listen again to the final part of Genesis chapter 36, which contains this story about the kings and chiefs of Edom, if it is available in your language. Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, the storyteller tells us the names of eight kings of Edom. The storyteller makes it clear that the kings are not fathers and sons. After each king dies, another man becomes king and rules in his place. This means that the next man took on all the activities and the authority that comes with being the king. It does not necessarily mean that each king lived in the same city as the previous kings, the way that all of the Israelite kings ruled in Jerusalem. Bible scholars do not agree on whether the Edomites had one capital city throughout the reigns of these eight kings, or if different kings ruled from different cities.

Stop here and discuss these questions: What is the most natural way in your language to say that one person took over the position of another person? How will you say that each Edomite king took over the position of king from the man who came before him? Pause this audio here.

In this story, the fourth king of Edom is named Hadad, and the eighth king of Edom is also named Hadad.

Stop here and remind yourselves of the discussion you had before about different people with the same name. How will you make it clear to your audience that there are two different men named Hadad in this story? Pause this audio here.

Most of the Edomite kings came from a different city or different region in Edom. For example, the first king, Bela, was from a city called Dinhabah, while the third king, Husham, was from a part of Edom called "the land of the Temanites." The storyteller tells us where each king of Edom is from except for Baal-Hanan.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your language, how do you describe where a person is from? Pause this audio here.

The fourth king of Edom was named Hadad. In this section, the storyteller tells us that Hadad defeated Midian in the country of Moab. Here, "Midian" probably refers to the army of the Midianite people, who were descendants of Abraham through his concubine Keturah. This may seem confusing because the territory of the Midianites was south of Edom, while the country of Moab was north of Edom. The people who lived in Moab were the descendants of Abraham's nephew Lot. So apparently around this time, the Edomites, Moabites, and Midianites were all fighting with each other in Moab's territory, and Hadad's army defeated the Midianites' army.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the nations of Moab, Edom, and Midian in relation to Israel. Pause this audio here.

The eighth king of Edom was also named Hadad. The storyteller of Chronicles gives us some information about Hadad's wife, Mehetabel. The storyteller tells us that Mehetabel is "the daughter of Matred, the daughter of Me-Zahab." It is not clear if this means that Matred and Me-Zahab are Mehetabel's mother and father, or if it means that Mehetabel's mother was Matred, and Me-Zahab was the mother or father of Matred. To put it another way, we know that Matred was one of Mehetabel's parents, but we do not know if Me-Zahab was Mehetabel's other parent or one of Mehetabel's grandparents. Bible scholars do not know if Matred is the name of a woman or a man, and we also do not know this for the name Me-Zahab.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Does your language have names that can be a name for both a male and a female? If so, give some examples. How could you translate the names Matred and Me-Zahab so that they could be the names of either a woman or a man? Pause this audio here.

It is unusual for a Biblical storyteller to describe someone the way they describe Mehetabel. Because it is so unusual, some Bible scholars think that perhaps Me-Zahab is not a person but rather a place, and that Mehetabel and/or Matred came from the place called Me-Zahab. This explanation would fit the pattern that the storyteller has used so far in this passage to name a king, that king's father, and the place he was from. Perhaps Mehetabel was from such an important family that the storyteller felt it was necessary to mention her name, her father's name and the place they came from.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your language, can the name of a place also be the name of a person? If so, give examples of places and people that share the same name. Pause this audio here.

Since we do not know if Matred and Me-Zahab are male or female, if Me-Zahab was Mehetabel's parent or grandparent, or if Me-Zahab was a person's name or a place name, you should keep these things uncertain in your translation. The best option would probably be to follow the original language as closely as possible to describe Mehetabel as "the daughter of Matred, the daughter of Mezehab."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the phrase "Mehetabel, the daughter of Matred, the daughter of Mezehab." Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller shifts his focus to naming the chiefs or clans of the Edomites. As we mentioned before, Bible scholars do not agree on whether these are the names of individuals who were chiefs of Edom, or if they are the names of clans of Edomites.

If these are the names of individual chiefs, then there are some interesting things to note. A chief is a leader of a smaller group of people in the community, such as an extended family or possibly people from a certain area. In the list of Edomite chiefs, there is a chief named Timna and a chief named Oholibamah. You may remember that Timna was the name of the wife of Eliphaz, and Oholibamah was the name of one of Esau's wives. Bible scholars do not know if the Timna and Oholibamah in this passage are men who had the same names as those women, or if Edomite society allowed women to be chiefs. In Bible times, it was unusual for women to have a position like a chief, but it was also not completely impossible.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, what positions of leadership do women have? Are there any positions of leadership that women are not allowed to have? Pause this audio here.

Bible scholars who believe that these are the names of Edomite chiefs do not agree on whether the chiefs of Edom led their groups at the same time that the king of Edom ruled the entire country, or if the kings of Edom were the leaders for a time and then chiefs replaced them. It is possible that the chiefs existed at the same time as a king and cooperated with the king to lead the nation. But it is also possible that kings ruled Edom first and that chiefs later replaced those kings.

In this scene, the word for "chief" or "clan" appears with the name of each chief. In some languages, this amount of repetition may be unnatural. If this is the case, you may choose to introduce the list of chiefs and then list the names, without repeating the word "chief" before each name.

Stop here and discuss this question: Will you include the word for "chief" or "clan" with each name on this list, or will you just list the names? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller of Chronicles repeats at the end of the passage that these were the chiefs of Edom. You may keep this repetition if it is natural in your language.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:43–54 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Bela, Beor, Jobab, Zerah, Husham, Hadad, Bedad, Samlah, Shaul, Baal-Hanan, Acbor, Hadad, Mehetabal, Matred, Me-Zahab
- And Timna, Alvah, Jetheth, Oholibamah, Elah, Pinon, Kenaz, Teman, Mibzar, Magdiel, and Iram

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group in your language. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you could also play the audio recording out loud.

While you do this, think about how the ancient Israelites might have felt while they listened to these lists of names. The kings and chiefs of Edom were these people's relatives, the descendants of Jacob's brother Esau. Because Esau sold his birthright to Jacob, there was bitterness and conflict between the two brothers and their descendants. Yet God blessed Esau with wealth, territory, and descendants—even descendants who became kings!

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should read or recite this passage a second time. At certain points in the passage, pause and ask each person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" Each person should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue reading or reciting the passage.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the passage and possible responses.

These are the kings who ruled in the land of Edom before any king ruled over the Israelites: Bela, the son of Beor, of the city of Dinhabah. When Bela died, Jobab, the son of Zerah, of Bozrah, ruled in his place. When Jobab died, Husham of the land of the Temanites ruled in his place. When Husham died, Hadad, the son of Bedad, who was from the city of Avith, ruled in his place. Hadad destroyed the Midianite army in the land of Moab.

1 Chronicles 1:43–54

Pause the reciting here. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I wish we knew the story of how Hadad defeated the Midianites; or
- Some of these kings of Edom treated our ancestors badly, so I do not like them; or
- It is important to remember the descendants of our brother Esau.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that Esau’s descendants had their own country and leaders; or
- I wish our relationship with the Edomites was better; or
- I do not like the Edomites.

Continue reciting the names.

After Hadad died, the rest of the Edomite kings were Samlah from Masrekah, Shaul from Rehoboth-on-the-river, Baal-Hanan the son of Acbor and Hadad from the city of Pai, whose wife’s name was Mehetabel. She was the daughter of Matred, the daughter of Me-Zahab.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I wonder how the Edomites decided who the next king would be; or
- I want my people to remember this important history; or
- No matter how we feel about the Edomites, we must remember that God told us to be a blessing to all people.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I really want to know more about these people; or
- I am angry at the Edomites for the way they treated our people; or
- I am sad when I think about how the Babylonians killed and overthrew the Edomites, just like they did to our ancestors.

Continue reciting the names.

Then Hadad died. The names of the clans of Edom were Timna, Alvah, Jetheth, Oholibamah, Elah, Pinon, Kenaz, Teman, Mibzar, Magdiel, and Iram.

Pause. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am curious about who these people were; or
- It is important to remember these people because they are our brothers; or
- I wish these people were not related to us.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel impatient to get past this and onto the information about our ancestors; or
- I do not think this information is important to know; or
- We should forgive the Edomites for the conflicts we have had with them.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 1:43–54 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

If you have already translated the book of Genesis, then you have already translated this story about the kings and chiefs of Edom.

1 Chronicles 1:43–54

Stop here and listen again to the final part of Genesis chapter 36, which contains this story about the kings and chiefs of Edom. Pause this audio here.

Throughout this passage, **son** means the individual male child of a person. Use the same word or phrase for son that you have used in previous passages, and see the Master Glossary for more information about son.

In this passage, the storyteller tells us about the **kings** who ruled Edom before there were any kings in Israel. A king is a ruler of a city or a territory.

Stop here and discuss what word you will use to translate the word "king." Look up king in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The first king of Edom was Bela son of Beor. Bela's city was called Dinhabah. A city is a large settlement that usually has a wall around it to protect the people.

Stop here and decide what word or phrase you will use for **city**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

When **Bela** died, **Jobab** son of **Zerah** from **Bozrah** became king. When Jobab died, **Husham** from the land of the **Temanites** became king. The name Bela means "destruction." The name Beor means "a light." We do not know what **Dinhabah**'s name means. The name Jobab means "to yell." The name Zerah means "to appear." The name Bozrah means "sheep pasture." The name Husham means "hurried." The name Teman means "south."

Stop here and listen again to the first part of this story in Genesis chapter 36. Pay close attention to how you translated the names. Did you translate the names according to the meaning, or according to how they sounded? Do you like the way you translated these names, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

When Husham died, **Hadad** son of **Bedad** from the city of **Avith** became king. Hadad was the one who destroyed the army of **Midian** in the land of **Moab**. We do not know what Hadad's name means. The name Bedad means "to divide." The name Avith means "ruin." Be sure to translate "Midian" and "Moab" the same way that you have translated them before.

Stop here and listen again to this part of the story in Genesis chapter 36. Pay close attention to how you translated the names. Did you translate the names according to the meaning, or according to how they sounded? Do you like the way you translated these names, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

When Hadad died, **Samlah** from **Masrekah** became king. When Samlah died, **Shaul** from **Rehoboth-on-the-river** became king. When Shaul died, **Baal-Hanan** son of **Acbor** became king. The name Samlah means "covering." The name Masrekah means "vineyard." The name Shaul is the same as the name of King Saul of Israel, which means "to ask." Be sure to translate this name the same way you have translated it before. The name Rehoboth means "broad places," and the city was probably next to a major river in the area. The name Baal-Hanan means "one who has grace." The name Acbor means "attacking."

Stop here and listen again to this part of the story in Genesis chapter 36. Pay close attention to how you translated the names. Did you translate the names according to the meaning, or according to how they sounded? Do you like the way you translated these names, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

When Baal-Hanan died, **Hadad** became king. Hadad's city was called **Pau**. Hadad's wife was named **Mehetabel**, the daughter of **Matred**, the daughter of **Me-Zahab**. We do not know what Hadad's name means. We do not know what Pau's name means. The name Mehetabel probably means "God made it better." The name Matred means "moving forward." The name Mezahab probably means "gold waters."

Stop here and listen again to this part of the story in Genesis chapter 36. Pay close attention to how you translated the names. Did you translate the names according to the meaning, or according to how they sounded? Do you like the way you translated these names, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

The chiefs of Edom were **Timna**, **Alvah**, **Jetheth**, **Oholibamah**, **Elah**, **Pinon**, **Kenaz**, **Teman**, **Mibzar**, **Magdiel**, and **Iram**. The name Timna means "restraint." The name Alvah means "immorality." We do not know what Jetheth's name means. The name Oholibamah means "a high tent." The name Elah means "a strong tree." The name Pinon

means “confusion.” The name Kenaz means “hunter.” The name Teman means “south.” The name Mibzar means “fortress.” The name Magdiel means “preciousness of God.” The name Iram means “related to a city.”

Stop here and listen again to this part of the story in Genesis chapter 36. Pay close attention to how you translated the names. Did you translate the names according to the meaning, or according to how they sounded? Do you like the way you translated these names, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

You will have to decide if you want to say that these are the names of chiefs of the Edomites or the names of clans of the Edomites. Either choice is acceptable. A clan is a group of related families within a people group. A chief is a leader of a clan or tribe.

Stop here and discuss whether you want to say that these are the names of chiefs or clans.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 1:43–54

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1008 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 2:1–8

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 2:1–8 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:1–8 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller told us the names of some of the leaders of the Edomites, who were descendants of Isaac's son Esau. In this passage, the storyteller begins a new section of the book in which he tells us about the sons of Isaac's son Jacob. Yahweh gave Jacob the name Israel.

In this section, the storyteller introduces a new pattern of giving us information. After the storyteller tells us the names of the twelve sons of Israel, he immediately tells us about the family of Israel's fourth son, Judah. To the storyteller of Chronicles, Judah's line of descent is the most important because Judah's line led to King David. Yahweh promised David that one of David's descendants would always sit on the throne of Israel. So many people think that David's family line is the most important family line of all the Israelites. The storyteller of Chronicles will spend most of the rest of the book talking about the actions of King David and his descendants.

You might notice that when we see a list of the 12 sons of Jacob in the Bible, the list is not always in the same order. Sometimes the storyteller lists the sons in the order of their birth. Other times, the storyteller lists them in groups of brothers born to the same mother, with the oldest brothers always listed first. Remember that Jacob had two wives and two concubines, and all four of them gave birth to Jacob's children. In this list, the storyteller names the first four sons of Jacob, who were born to Leah, in order of their birth. After that, the storyteller switches between birth order and grouping by mother a few times. Bible scholars do not know why the storyteller of Chronicles chose to list the sons of Jacob in this way.

In this passage, the storyteller of Chronicles assumes that his audience already knows the details of the story of Judah's family, so the storyteller quickly summarizes the most important points. Judah had three sons with his wife, who is called Bathshua in this story. Judah and Bathshua's sons were called Er, Onan, and Shelah. Judah's family was not perfect. Judah's oldest son, Er, was an evil man, so Yahweh killed Er.

Stop here and tell a story in your language about someone who did something bad and how someone in authority punished that person for that bad thing. Did that person get what he or she deserved? Why or why not? How do you feel about that person's punishment? Pause this audio here.

Later, Judah had sexual relations with Er's widow, Tamar, and she became pregnant. Tamar gave birth to Perez and Zerah. So Judah had a total of five sons. While this story about Judah and Tamar might sound strange and even disturbing to modern hearers, Bible scholars believe it may have been relatively normal in the surrounding Canaanite culture. Bible scholars have discovered legal documents from the Hittite culture that say that if a widow's brother-in-law was not available to produce a male son to inherit the property, the father-in-law was required to do so.

Stop here and discuss this question: How do you take care of widows in your culture? Who is responsible for the well-being of a widow after her husband dies? What kind of things might happen to a widow if no one takes care of her properly? What responsibilities does the husband's family have to the widow? What responsibilities does the widow have to her husband's family? How are these practices different from the other people around you? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller does not tell us if Judah had any daughters. Remember that to the Israelites, the family line through the father was most important. So a list of family members does not usually contain the names of women unless there is something significant or unusual about the woman. In this story, the storyteller probably

tells us the names of Bathshua and Tamar because the way that Tamar got pregnant with Judah's son Perez was unusual in Israelite culture. Importantly, the family line of Perez is the family line that led to King David.

In this passage, the storyteller also reminds us of the story of Achar, son of Carmi, who was a descendant of Judah's son Zerah. When the Israelites were fighting to conquer the Canaanites, Yahweh told them to kill everyone in Jericho except for Rahab and her family. Yahweh also told the Israelites to destroy everything they found except for valuable items that people made of gold, silver, bronze, and iron. Those valuable items were supposed to go into Yahweh's treasury. But Achar stole some goods from Jericho and hid them in his tent. This made Yahweh angry, and the Israelites lost a battle. When Joshua, the military commander, asked Yahweh why the Israelites lost the battle, Yahweh told Joshua that an Israelite had stolen goods from Jericho. Joshua found out that Achar was the one who stole the goods, and the Israelites killed Achar and his family. This is why Achar is called "a troubler of Israel," because Achar's selfish and greedy actions caused the Israelites to lose a battle.

Stop here and tell a story about someone who did something selfish, and how other people suffered because of that action. What did people think about the person who committed the selfish act? Did that person receive any punishment for what he or she did? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller also tells us about a son of Ethan named Azariah. Bible scholars do not know why the storyteller of Chronicles tells us about Azariah here. Although there are many people in the Bible with the name Azariah, none of them is the son of Ethan. The storyteller of Chronicles might have assumed that his audience knew the story of Azariah son of Ethan from another source, but we do not find that story in the Bible.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us the names of the 12 sons of Jacob.

In the second scene: The storyteller tells us the names of Judah's five sons, as well as the names of their mothers.

In the third scene: The storyteller tells us the names of some of the descendants of Judah's sons Perez and Zerah.

The characters in this passage are:

- Israel, Reuben, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Zebulun, Dan, Joseph, Benjamin, Naphtali, Gad, Asher
- Bathshua, Er, Onan, Shelah, Tamar, Perez, Zerah
- And Hezron, Hamul, Zimri, Ethan, Heman, Calcol, Darda, Achar, Carmi, and Azariah

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller lists the sons of Israel. In this case, the word "sons" means male "children" and not descendants. We know that Jacob, Reuben, Simeon, Levi, and all the rest are specific individuals. If you have already translated the book of Genesis, then you have already translated this list of the sons of Jacob. It would be helpful to go back and listen to that list to remind you of how you chose to translate all the names.

Stop here and listen to the final part of Genesis chapter 36, after the death of Rachel, which lists the sons of Jacob. Pay close attention to how you translated the sons' names. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller of Chronicles refers to Jacob by the name "Israel" in this part of the story. We have discussed before that although Israel is the name of an individual, it is also the name people use for all the descendants of Jacob, the Israelites. Sometimes this can confuse listeners. It might be more clear to refer to Jacob by the name his father gave him at birth when Jacob is a character in a story, like he is here.

Stop here and remind each other of your previous discussion about whether to call Jacob by the name Israel or the name Jacob. Pause this audio here.

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In scene two, the storyteller focuses on telling us about the family of Judah, Jacob's fourth son. If you have already translated the book of Genesis, then you have translated a much longer version of this story. It would be helpful to go back and listen to that version to remind you of how you chose to translate all the names.

Stop here and listen to Genesis chapter 38, if it is available in your language. Pay close attention to how you translated the names of Judah's sons, Judah's wife, and Tamar. Pause this audio here.

The story of Judah's family in 1 Chronicles is shorter than it is in Genesis. We hear little more than the names of Judah's sons and their mothers. Actually, Bible scholars do not agree about whether Judah's wife's name was Bathshua. In the original language, Bathshua means "daughter of Shua," and so it was actually a way of identifying her father, Shua. It is possible that people may have called her by that name, but we do not know for sure.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your language, do you have a way to name a person according to the name of that person's father or mother? If so, how do you feel about using that system to name people in this case? Pause this audio here.

Judah had three sons with his wife. Judah named these sons Er, Onan, and Shelah.

Stop here and discuss this question: What is the most natural way in your language to say that a woman gave birth to a man's child? Pause this audio here.

Judah's firstborn son, Er, married Tamar. But Er was evil in the sight of Yahweh. This means that Er did evil things and Yahweh saw that those things were evil. Some translations may explain this by saying that Er displeased Yahweh, Er disobeyed Yahweh and did what was evil, or Er was a wicked man. We do not know what Er did, but we do know that the evil things that Er did were so bad that Yahweh killed Er before Er had a chance to have children.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that Er was evil in the sight of Yahweh, or that Yahweh saw the evil things that Er did. Pause this audio here.

From the Genesis story, we know that Er and Onan, Judah's two oldest sons, died before they had any children. Tamar was supposed to marry Shelah, Judah's youngest son, but when Shelah was old enough to marry, Judah did not give him to Tamar. Because of this, Tamar tricked Judah into having sex with her, and Tamar became pregnant. This is how Perez and Zerah were born.

In the third scene, the storyteller focuses on telling us about some of the descendants of Judah's sons Perez and Zerah. First, the storyteller names the sons of Perez and Zerah. Then the storyteller reminds us of the story of Zerah's descendant Achar. If you have already translated the book of Joshua, then you have already translated the long version of this story. If the story is available in your language, it would be helpful to go back and listen to it to remind you of the story and how you translated the names of Achar, Carmi, Zimri, and Zerah.

Stop here and listen to Joshua chapter seven if it is available in your language. Pay attention to how you translated the names of Achar, Carmi, Zimri, and Zerah. Pause this audio here.

You will notice that in the passage in Joshua, the storyteller calls Achar "Achan." You may use the name Achan in this passage if it will make more sense to your audience. In this passage, the storyteller of Chronicles calls Achar "the troubler of Israel." This means that Achar's actions brought trouble on everyone in Israel at that time. Because Achar disobeyed Yahweh, some Israelite soldiers died, the Israelite army lost the first battle of Ai, and all the people were terrified. The storyteller of Chronicles assumed that his audience knew the story of Achar and knew exactly how Achar caused trouble for Israel. But this might not be true for modern audiences who listen to the story. Instead of giving Achar a title like "The Troubler of Israel," some translations choose to describe the effect that Achar's actions had on the Israelites. Those translations might say something like "Achar, who brought disaster on Israel" or "Achar, who brought doom on the people of Israel." This provides a little more context and might help people understand the verse more clearly.

Stop here and discuss whether you will use a title like "The Troubler of Israel" or whether you will use a phrase to describe how Achar's actions affected the Israelites. Pause this audio here.

When Achar took the items from Jericho, he disobeyed Yahweh. But the word in the original language has an even stronger meaning than "to disobey." This word can mean "to act unfaithfully or treacherously," "to betray,"

or “to violate an agreement.” The word definitely describes a person who chooses to do something that he has already agreed not to do. In some Bible passages, the storyteller uses this word to describe the situation when a married man or woman commits adultery. Just like a husband or wife who acts unfaithfully toward his or her marriage partner, Achar acted unfaithfully toward Yahweh. The idea is not just of a morally wrong action, but a personal betrayal.

Stop here and tell a story about someone who betrayed someone else and caused something bad to happen. Pay attention to the words you use to describe the betrayal. Which of these words might be best to use here? Pause this audio here.

In the original story in Joshua chapter seven, Yahweh told the Israelites to destroy everything in Jericho except for a list of items that the Israelites were supposed to save and put into Yahweh’s treasury. This list included items that people had made from silver, gold, bronze, and iron. The people called these things “devoted things,” “condemned things,” or “plunder that had been set apart for God.” The word for these items implies that the people could only use them to worship Yahweh. This is why they are called devoted things.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your language, how do you describe things that people put aside for one special use only? How do you describe things that people put aside for religious use only? Which of these words might be appropriate here? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Israel, Reuben, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Zebulun, Dan, Joseph, Benjamin, Naphtali, Gad, Asher
- Bathshua, Er, Onan, Shelah, Tamar, Perez, Zerah
- And Hezron, Hamul, Zimri, Ethan, Heman, Calcol, Darda, Achar, Carmi, and Azariah

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group in your language. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you could also play the audio recording out loud.

While you do this, think about how the ancient Israelites might have felt as they listened to these names and stories. It is likely that every single ancient Israelite knew the names of the sons of Jacob because they were also the names of the tribes of Israel. They were the names of the people who inherited the promises that Yahweh made to Abraham. Every single Israelite knew which tribe he or she belonged to and probably knew the names of all their ancestors, starting with the founder of the tribe. Furthermore, the ancestry of King David was very important because this family line fulfilled ancient prophecy. The descendants of David were not only the rulers of Israel but also the family line from which the Messiah would come. All the hope of Israel depended on this royal line of descent.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the passage, pause and ask each person, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue reading or reciting the passage.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

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The following is an example of the passage and possible responses.

The sons of Jacob were Reuben, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Zebulun, Dan, Joseph, Benjamin, Naphtali, Gad, and Asher.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so glad we are finally talking about our own people; or
- I feel proud to be a descendant of Jacob; or
- I feel sad when I remember all the struggle and pain our ancestors went through; or
- I wish our ancestors could have been completely unified. Then our fate might have turned out differently.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I am happy that I know all of these names; or
- I feel proud when I hear my tribe's name here; or
- This reminds me of someone from another tribe, and I do not like that person.

Continue reading or reciting the passage.

Judah had three sons with his wife Bathshua, a Canaanite woman. Those sons were named Er, Onan, and Shelah. Er displeased Yahweh, so Yahweh put him to death. Then Tamar, the widow of Er, Judah's daughter-in-law, gave birth to Judah's sons Perez and Zerah. So Judah had a total of five sons.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wonder what Er did that was so bad that Yahweh decided to kill him; or
- It is important for our people to know the lineage of King David; or
- I feel proud that I am teaching our people these important things about our history.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I wonder why Judah's son Er was such a terrible man; or
- I am disturbed by the fact that Judah got his daughter-in-law pregnant; or
- I wonder why Yahweh picked the tribe of Judah for the king to come from. The people of Judah are not very good people.

Continue reading or reciting the passage.

Perez had two sons named Hezron and Hamul. Perez's brother Zerah had five sons: Zimri, Ethan, Heman, Calcol, and Darda. One of Zerah's descendants was Achar son of Carmi. Achar brought disaster on the people of Israel by keeping plunder that Israel had devoted to Yahweh. Ethan had one son, Azariah.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wonder why Achar thought he could get away with stealing the devoted things; or
- I hope my audience will remember all these names; or
- I am glad that my people have recorded these important aspects of our history.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I wish Achar had not done what he did; or
- I wonder who Ethan's son Azariah was and what he did; or
- I feel excited that we are getting closer to talking about King David.

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Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Israel had 12 sons: **Reuben**, **Simeon**, **Levi**, **Judah**, **Issachar**, **Zebulun**, **Dan**, **Joseph**, **Benjamin**, **Naphtali**, **Gad**, and **Asher**. The name Israel means "struggles with God." The name Reuben means "a son." The name Simeon means "heard." The name Levi means "attached." The name Judah means "celebrate or praise." The name Issachar means "reward." The name Zebulun means "place to live." The name Dan means "to judge." The name Joseph means "may he add." The name Benjamin means "son of the right hand." The name Naphtali means "my wrestling." The name Gad means "luck." The name Asher means "happy."

Stop here and listen to the final part of Genesis chapter 36, after Rachel's death, which lists the sons of Jacob. Pay close attention to how you translated the sons' names. Did you translate the names according to their meaning, or according to how they sound? Do you like the way you translated them, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

Judah's wife is called **Bathshua**. This name means "daughter of **Shua**." The name Shua means either "freedom" or "wealth." Bathshua was a **Canaanite**. Be sure to translate Canaanite the same way that you have in previous passages. See Canaan in the Master Glossary for more information on Canaanite.

Judah's sons with Bathshua were named **Er**, **Onan**, and **Shelah**. The name Er means "watchful." The name Onan means "strong." The name Shelah means "request."

Judah's oldest son, Er, was **evil**, so **Yahweh** killed Er. Be sure to translate evil the same way that you have in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information on evil.

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the word "evil." Pause this audio here.

Yahweh is God's personal name. Be sure to translate Yahweh the same way you have in previous books of the Bible.

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the name "Yahweh." See the Master Glossary for more information on Yahweh, and translate this name in the same way you have in previous books of the Bible. Pause this audio here.

Judah had two more sons with his daughter-in-law, **Tamar**. The names of their sons were **Perez** and **Zerah**. The name Tamar means "palm tree." The name Perez means "to break through." The name Zerah means "brightness."

Stop here and listen to Genesis chapter 38. Pay close attention to how you translated the names of Judah's family members. Did you translate the names according to their meaning, or according to how they sound? Do you like the way you translated them, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **daughter-in-law**. A daughter-in-law is the wife of a person's son. Pause this audio here.

The sons of **Perez** were **Hezron** and **Hamul**. The name Hezron means "courtyard." The name Hamul means "to have compassion on someone."

Stop here and listen to the middle of Genesis chapter 46, which lists the sons of Perez. Pay close attention to how you translated the names of Hezron and Hamul. Did you translate the names according to their meaning, or according to how they sound? Do you like the way you translated them, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

The sons of **Zerah** were **Zimri**, **Ethan**, **Heman**, **Calcol**, and **Darda**. The name Zimri means "musical or melodic." The name Ethan means "permanent or enduring." The name Heman means "faithful." The name Calcol means "nourishment." We do not know what Darda's name means. **Achar** son of **Carmi** was a descendant of Zimri. The name Achar means "trouble." The name Carmi means "gardener."

Stop here and listen to the beginning of Joshua chapter seven if you have it in your language. Pay close attention to how you translated the names Achan, Carmi, Zimri and Zerah. Did you translate them according to their meaning, or according to how they sound? Do you like the way you translated them, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

Achar brought disaster on the Israelites by transgressing in the matter of the devoted things.

When someone transgresses, they act unfaithfully to betray someone, to disobey an order, or to break an agreement. If you have already translated this word in a previous book of the Bible, be sure to use the same word here as you did previously.

Stop here and decide how you will translate the word **transgress**. Pause this audio here.

Devoted things are objects that people set aside for a specific purpose, usually for a religious purpose. In the story of Achar the "Troubler of Israel," people were supposed to put the devoted things into Yahweh's treasury.

Stop here and decide how you will translate **devoted things**. Pause this audio here.

Ethan's son was named Azariah. The name Azariah means "Yahweh has helped."

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (849 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.4 MB)

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Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 2 Chronicles 6:1–11 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 2 Chronicles 6:1–11 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 2 Chronicles 6:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, Yahweh saw all that King Solomon and the people of Israel were doing. When the priests placed the Ark of the Covenant in the Most Holy Place, Yahweh responded by filling the Temple with a thick cloud. In this passage, King Solomon speaks to Yahweh in a prayer and then addresses the people of Israel in response to Yahweh's presence in the Temple. Stop here and review the photo of King Solomon's Temple. Pause this audio here.

This passage is almost exactly the same as 1 Kings 8:12–21 that you may have translated previously.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: If you have already translated 1 Kings 8:12–21, listen to your translation of that passage. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon begins his prayer by acknowledging words that Yahweh has spoken previously. In the book of Leviticus, Yahweh spoke to Moses and told Moses not to allow his brother Aaron to go into the Most Holy Place. Yahweh also said that Yahweh would dwell in a dark cloud in the Holy Place over the Ark of the Covenant. This was a sign that Yahweh was pleased and was present in the Tabernacle. When Yahweh shows up in a dark and thick cloud this time, Yahweh is doing the same thing as He did in the time of Moses. King Solomon acknowledges this, and King Solomon tells Yahweh that King Solomon has built a magnificent Temple for Yahweh to dwell in forever. While King Solomon says he built it, King Solomon represents all of the people who helped build the Temple, as King Solomon did not build it by himself. Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember that the people of Israel likely knew the story of Moses and Yahweh's presence in the Tabernacle. How do you think they felt when they saw this happen? How would you feel if you saw this with your own eyes instead of only hearing about it? Pause this audio here.

After King Solomon prays to and acknowledges Yahweh, King Solmon then turns away from the Temple and faces the people of Israel. The storyteller uses the word 'assembly' to describe the people. The use of assembly most likely means that King Solomon is standing before all of the tribes of people of Israel and not just the priests and Levites. King Solomon then blesses the people. Again, King Solomon does the same act that Moses did at the Tabernacle. King Solomon sees all that has happened, and King Solomon honors Yahweh and then speaks Yahweh's blessings over the people of Israel. Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about the most important or famous person in your country or beyond. This could be a king or leader. How would you feel if this person acknowledged you and spoke kind words to you? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon begins his prayer and blessing by praising the Lord, the God of Israel. In this case, the Lord and God are the same person, and King Solomon is praising Yahweh. King Solomon gives a specific reason for offering these praises. King Solomon says that Yahweh has fulfilled Yahweh's promises through Yahweh's hands. The storyteller is not saying that Yahweh's actual hands built the Temple. But, the storyteller is likely saying that Yahweh made it possible through Yahweh's power and strength for King Solomon and the people to complete

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the Temple. The storyteller also says that the promise that Yahweh fulfilled through the Temple completion is exactly what Yahweh told King Solomon's father, King David, that Yahweh would do. King Solomon likely wants to remind the people of Yahweh's faithfulness and trustworthiness. Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you use imagery to describe something? For example, King Solomon talks about the 'hand of Yahweh' in this passage, but King Solomon doesn't mean Yahweh's actual hand. How do you use imagery in your culture? Pause this audio here.

In the next section, King Solomon speaks words that Yahweh has already spoken. These words are not King Solomon's interpretation of Yahweh's words. King Solomon is quoting Yahweh exactly by saying the following words:

"Since the day I brought my people Israel out of Egypt, I have not chosen a city in any tribe of Israel to have a Temple built so that my name might be there, nor have I chosen anyone to be ruler over my people Israel. But, now I have chosen Jerusalem for my name to be there, and I have chosen David to rule my people Israel." Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Refer back to the 1 Kings 8:12–21 translation. What is different about this section? In your culture, how often do people tell stories that still tell the same story with minor differences? Pause this audio here.

In this part of the passage, King Solomon likely shares what Yahweh said to King David, because these words help explain why King David did not build the Temple sooner. Yahweh wanted King David to rule over the people of Israel, but Yahweh did not give King David permission or instructions for building a Temple. Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Imagine that you are King David. How would you feel if you were king and you wanted to build a Temple, but Yahweh would not let you? Describe your feelings and thoughts. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon then explains that his father, King David, 'had it in his heart' to build a Temple for Yahweh. In the Hebrew language, the heart usually means the same as the mind. King David wanted to build a Temple, but this was likely more of a thought than an emotional response. King David desired to build the Temple to honor Yahweh's name. Again, King Solomon says, "Lord, God of Israel", and King Solomon is using two names to describe Yahweh.

King Solomon returns to quoting Yahweh when he says Yahweh's words:

"You did well to have it in your heart to build a temple for my Name. Nevertheless, you are not the one to build the temple, but your son, your own flesh and blood—he is the one who will build the temple for my Name."

In this part of the passage, King Solomon reminds the people of Israel why King Solomon has built the Temple. Yahweh did not let King David build the Temple, even though Yahweh loved King David and King David wanted to build the Temple to honor Yahweh's name. However, Yahweh did have a plan. Yahweh told King David that King David's son, King Solomon would build the Temple. Yahweh makes sure that King David understands the word 'son' when he says that David's 'flesh and blood' would be the one to build the Temple. By sharing Yahweh's words, King Solomon reminds the people of Israel that Yahweh is faithful and is in control of all things, including time. Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Imagine a time where you thought someone would choose you for a special role. Imagine that the person chooses someone else. Share with the group how you would feel? Pause this audio here.

After King Solomon reminds the people of what Yahweh said, King Solomon then confirms that what Yahweh said has happened. Yahweh has kept all of Yahweh's promises, and King Solomon wants the people to see this. King Solomon then lists specific promises, including that King Solomon has become king after his father, King David, and King Solomon sits on the throne and rules over the people of Israel. King Solomon also lists that he has built the Temple for Yahweh. Again, King Solomon says that he has built the Temple for the "Lord, God of Israel". It is important to remember that King Solomon is not saying that he built the Temple by himself. This means that King Solomon commissioned people to build the Temple and watched over the process.

Stop here and look at a picture of a throne. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Why do you think King Solomon repeats Yahweh's promises? What are some reasons why it's helpful to repeat stories or phrases? Pause this audio here.

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King Solomon finishes this prayer and blessing by explaining that King Solomon has built a place within the Temple for the Ark of the Covenant. It is important to remember that the Ark of the Covenant was where Yahweh rested. When Yahweh rested on the ark, Israel experienced victory in battles. It is also good to remember the previous passage where Yahweh's presence filled the Temple after the priests placed the Ark of the Covenant in the Temple. King Solomon also acknowledges the covenant in the Ark. The covenant refers to the stone tablets in the Ark of the Covenant that act as a reminder of Yahweh's covenant with the people of Israel after Yahweh led the people of Israel out of Egypt. King Solomon reminded the people of Israel of all the promises Yahweh made to their ancestors and showed the people of Israel that Yahweh is keeping these promises at this moment. Stop here and look at a picture of the Ark of the Covenant. Pause this audio here. Stop here and look at a picture of the stone tablets. Pause this audio here. Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you pass information down through generations so that people will know what happened during their ancestors' lives? How do you keep a record of all that has happened? Pause this audio here.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 2 Chronicles 6:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has **2** scenes.

In the first scene: King Solomon faces the Temple and speaks to Yahweh.

In the second scene: King Solomon turns around and blesses the people of Israel.

The characters in this passage are:

- Storyteller
- King Solomon
- Yahweh
- People of Israel
- King David
- People of Israel's Ancestors

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this entire passage, King Solomon is the only one who speaks. King Solomon speaks first to Yahweh and then to the people of Israel.

In the first scene, King Solomon faces the Temple and speaks to Yahweh. King Solomon reminds Yahweh, and anyone listening, that Yahweh previously said that he would live in a dark cloud. King Solomon is referring to another point in time when Yahweh spoke to Moses. King Solomon then offers the new Temple to Yahweh so that Yahweh can have a place to dwell in forever. The storyteller shows that King Solomon acknowledges Yahweh's previous words and offers a new idea to Yahweh instead.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how will you translate this part so that people will understand that King Solomon's words are repeated words from earlier passages? Decide how you will make sure to keep words and stories consistent throughout different books. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, King Solomon turns his attention to the people of Israel. The storyteller says that the people are standing as an assembly or group, so King Solomon is likely talking to people who are actively listening to him. The storyteller says that King Solomon blessed the people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what type or types of blessings do people speak over people? Think of examples of how people might offer words to people for comfort or to remind them of how they are blessed. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon changes back and forth in this section between the present day of the passage and a previous time when Yahweh spoke. King Solomon starts by praising the "Lord, the God of Israel" for helping King Solomon fulfill

what Yahweh told King David that King Solomon would do. It is important to notice the small difference here from the parallel passage in 1 Kings 8:12–21. King Solomon says here that Yahweh's hands fulfilled Yahweh's promises.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When you tell a story in your language and culture, how do you make it clear when you are changing between present day and past experiences? What words would you use to help make a person aware of the time changes? Also, how will you translate hands versus hand? Does this make a difference in your language? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon then references what Yahweh said to King David. After the people of Israel left Egypt, Yahweh did not give a specific place for anyone to build a Temple and Yahweh had not chosen anyone to rule. However, eventually Yahweh did choose Jerusalem as the place where people would honor His name. Yahweh also blessed King David and chose King David to rule over the people of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how can you explain the imagery here when Yahweh says He chose Jerusalem for His name? How can you show this? Pause this audio here.

This part of this passage also differs slightly from the passage in 1 Kings 8:12–21. King Solomon then tells the people that King Solomon's father, King David, wanted to build a Temple for Yahweh. Then, King Solomon goes back to Yahweh's words that Yahweh spoke to King David. Yahweh told King David that Yahweh was pleased that King David wanted to build a Temple for Yahweh. However, Yahweh tells King David that King David will not be the one that builds the Temple. Instead, Yahweh chose King Solomon, King David's own 'flesh and blood', to build the Temple for Yahweh. In this case, flesh and blood means King David's son, not King David's own skin and blood.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how can you translate phrases like 'flesh and blood' so that people can understand the meaning of the imagery without picturing the words literally? Pause this audio here.

King Solomon finishes this prayer of blessing by making it clear to the people that Yahweh has answered and fulfilled the promises that Yahweh made to King David. King Solomon now sits on Israel's throne and rules over the people of Israel. King Solomon has also built the Temple for Yahweh and has placed the Ark of the Covenant in the Temple. King Solomon also reminds the people that the covenant is in the Ark of the Covenant. The covenant refers to the tablets which represent the covenant that Yahweh made with Moses and the people of Israel when Yahweh freed the people of Israel from Egypt. Again, pay close attention to this part of the passage, as it is slightly different to the parallel passage in 1 Kings 8:12–21. Stop here and look at a picture of a throne. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a picture of the Ark of the Covenant. Pause this audio here. Stop here and look at a picture of the stone tablets. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 2 Chronicles 6:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has **2** scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Storyteller
- King Solomon
- Yahweh
- People of Israel
- King David
- People of Israel's Ancestors

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

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First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The storyteller should read the drama.

After King Solomon built a Temple for Yahweh, King Solomon faced the Temple and spoke to Yahweh. King Solomon said that in a previous time, Yahweh said he would dwell in a dark cloud. But, King Solomon then says that King Solomon has built a Temple for Yahweh to dwell in forever. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing **King Solomon**, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- "I hope Yahweh approves of this Temple!"; or
- "Look at how much better this Temple is than a cloud!"; or
- "I feel proud of what I have accomplished.".

After King Solomon spoke to Yahweh, King Solomon turned around and faced all of the people of Israel that were standing in front of him. King Solomon blessed the people. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the **people of Israel** , "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- "I must be quiet and listen to King Solomon!"; or
- "I'm excited to hear what King Solomon is going to say to us!"; or
- "Look at this beautiful Temple!".

Continue the drama.

King Solomon praises Yahweh by saying, "Praise be to the Lord, the God of Israel!" King Solomon then tells the people why he is praising Yahweh. King Solomon praises Yahweh because Yahweh has fulfilled the promise that Yahweh made to King David.

Pause this drama. Ask the person playing the **Yahweh**, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- "I remember exactly what King Solomon is saying!"; or
- "I love when King Solomon honors me!"; or
- "It makes me happy when King Solomon sees what I have done for him!".

King Solomon speaks about what Yahweh did by reminding the people of Israel of the time that Yahweh led the people of Israel out of Egypt. After the people left Egypt, Yahweh did not choose a place anywhere in Israel for anyone to build a Temple, and Yahweh did not choose anyone to rule over the people of Israel. However, Yahweh eventually chose Jerusalem as the place where people would honor His name, and Yahweh chose King Solomon's father, King David, to rule the people of Israel.

Pause this drama. Ask the person playing **King Solomon**, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- "I want the people to see Yahweh's faithfulness!"; or
- "I am in awe of all Yahweh has done!"; or
- "I wonder why Yahweh chose me!".

King Solomon then tells the people of Israel that his father, King David, wanted to build a Temple for Yahweh. King Solomon then tells the people of Israel what Yahweh said to King David. Yahweh told King David that King

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David was right to have a desire to build the Temple for Yahweh. But, Yahweh then tells King David that King David cannot be the person to build the Temple. Instead, Yahweh says that King Solomon will build the Temple.

Pause this drama. Ask the person playing **King David**, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- "I wish I could build the Temple!"; or
- "I am thankful that my son will get to build the Temple"; or
- "I am sad that I will not get to see the Temple".

King Solomon then finishes his blessing by declaring that Yahweh has fulfilled the promises that Yahweh made to King David and by listing the promises. King Solomon now sits on the throne of Israel and has built the Temple for Yahweh. King Solomon placed the Ark of the Covenant in the Temple with the stone tablets in the Ark to represent the covenant that Yahweh made when Yahweh led the people of Israel out of Egypt.

Pause this drama. Ask the person playing **the people of Israel**, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- "Wow! Look at all Yahweh has done!"; or
- "I feel like I can trust Yahweh when He speaks!"; or
- "I am glad that Yahweh approves of our king!".

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 2 Chronicles 6:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

After Yahweh's presence fills the **Temple**, **King Solomon** faces the **Temple** and speaks to Yahweh. **King Solomon** says that Yahweh previously said that He would **dwell** in a dark **cloud**. **King Solomon** says that he has built a **magnificent Temple** for Yahweh where Yahweh can **dwell** forever. Use the same word or phrase for **Temple** and **cloud** as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **dwell**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

After King Solomon speaks to Yahweh, King Solomon turns around and faces the **assembly** of Israel. **Assembly** likely means the people of Israel all together. King Solomon praises the Lord, the God of Israel and tells the people of Israel that Yahweh has fulfilled with His **hands** what Yahweh told King Solomon's **father**, **King David** with His **mouth**. Use the same word or phrase for **father** and **assembly** as you used in previous passages.

King Solomon then tells the people of Israel what Yahweh previously said to King David. Yahweh told King David that Yahweh had not **chosen** any city in any **tribe** of Israel for anyone to build a Temple and no one to rule over Israel. However, Yahweh did eventually **choose** for King David to rule over the people of Israel and for Jerusalem to be the place where people would honor Yahweh's name .

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **tribe** and **chosen**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon tells the people of Israel that King David wanted to build the Temple, and Yahweh approved of King David's desire to build the Temple. However, Yahweh told King David that King David could not build the Temple. Instead, Yahweh said that King David's son, King David's own **flesh and blood**, would build the Temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **flesh and blood**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King Solomon then assures the people of Israel that Yahweh has kept His **promises**! King Solomon lists the promises by saying that King Solomon is seated on the throne after he **succeeded** King David. King Solomon also confirms that he has built the Temple like Yahweh promised. Finally, King Solomon reminds the people of Israel

that King Solomon placed the **Ark of the Covenant** in the Temple. The **Ark of the Covenant** contains the **stone tablets** inside the **Ark** representing the **covenant** Yahweh made with the people's **ancestors** when Yahweh led the people of Israel's **ancestors** out of Egypt. Use the same words or phrases for **promises**, **Ark of the Covenant**, stone **tablets**, **covenant** and **ancestors** as you used in previous passages.

Media Requests:

1. King Solomon's Temple: photo or illustration of King Solomon's Temple. This should be a wide shot that shows all of the areas that were included in the Temple complex.

King Solomon's Temple Example

1. Ark of the Covenant: photo or illustration of the Ark of the Covenant that the priests carried to the Temple. (We have this image in the works already)
2. Tablets in the Ark of the Covenant: photo of what the stone tablets would have looked like that Moses put into the ark. (We have this image already)
3. Throne: photo of a throne that a king would sit on as he ruled over a kingdom. (We have this image already)

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step. Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage. Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene. Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (915 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 2:18–24

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 2:18–24 and put it in your hearts.

1 Chronicles 2:18–24

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:18–24 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:18–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller of Chronicles told us about the line of descent from Hezron to Jesse. Then the storyteller told us about Jesse's seven sons, two daughters, and some of Jesse's grandchildren. In this passage, the storyteller tells us about some other descendants of Hezron. Some of these descendants of Hezron might have lived and ruled in the land of Canaan while the rest of the Israelites were living in Egypt.

This passage has two statements that are very hard to understand in the original language. Bible scholars do not agree on how to translate these statements. The first statement in this passage is one of them. When you listened to three different versions of this passage, you might have heard some different translations of this statement.

We know for sure that Hezron had a son named Caleb. He is not the same Caleb who went with Joshua to spy on the Promised Land. Most translations agree that Caleb's wife was named Azubah. Some Bible scholars think that Jerioth was a second wife or a concubine of Caleb. It is possible that Caleb's wife, Azubah, could not have children, and so Azubah gave her servant, Jerioth, to Caleb to have children for Azubah, just like Sarah gave her servant Hagar to Abraham to have children.

Stop here and discuss these questions: How common is it in your culture for a man to have more than one wife? If it is not common now, was it common in the past? What do most people think about a man having more than one wife? Pause this audio here.

Other Bible scholars think that perhaps Jerioth was just another name for Azubah. Most translations identify Jesher, Shobab, and Ardon as sons of Caleb and Azubah. A third possibility is that Jerioth was the daughter of Caleb and Azubah and that Jesher, Shobab, and Ardon were the sons of Jerioth.

After Azubah died, Caleb married a woman named Ephrath, who was the mother of Caleb's son Hur. Hur was the ancestor of Uri, and Uri was the ancestor of Bezalel. Bezalel was famous because Bezalel lived during the 40 years the Israelites wandered in the wilderness after they left Egypt. Bezalel was a skilled artist. Yahweh chose Bezalel and Oholiab to make the Tent of Meeting and all of the objects that would go inside it, including the covenant box.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Tell a story in your language about a person from your people group who was or is a good artist. What has this person done or made that your people especially admire? How do people remember or honor this person? Pause this audio here.

The tabernacle, or Tent of Meeting, and the ark of the covenant were very important to the Israelites. For hundreds of years, the Tent of Meeting was the central location where the Israelites were supposed to worship Yahweh. Yahweh himself was present in the Tent of Meeting. The Israelites also kept the ark of the covenant in the Tent of Meeting. The ark of the covenant contained the Ten Commandments and other important objects. The Israelites considered the ark of the covenant to be an earthly representation of Yahweh's throne, which symbolized Yahweh's power and authority. Bezalel, a descendant of Hezron, was the chief artist in charge of making these items, as well as many more items inside the Tent of Meeting. This was a position of great honor.

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In the book of Genesis, Moses tells us that Hezron moved from Canaan to Egypt with his father Perez, his grandfather Judah, and his great-grandfather Jacob. The Israelites stayed in Egypt for 430 years, and the Egyptians eventually forced the Israelites to be slaves. But this passage tells us that some of Hezron's descendants went back to Canaan for a while. Hezron's descendant Jair ruled 23 towns in a land called Gilead.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the location of Egypt, Canaan, Gilead, Geshur, and Aram, including the towns of Jair and Kenath. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller of Chronicles tells us that Hezron married a woman who was the daughter of Makir and the sister of a man named Gilead. Bible scholars are not sure if this means that Hezron left Egypt to marry the daughter of Makir and then raised his family in Gilead, or if Hezron married the daughter of Makir in Egypt and then their descendants went back to Gilead later. What is certain is that Hezron's descendant Jair became a leader of 23 cities in Gilead.

But the descendants of Hezron lost control of this territory in Canaan. The people of Geshur and the people of Aram came and took the territory away from Hezron's descendants. The land of Geshur was northeast of Israel, and the land of Aram was north of Israel.

The last statement of this passage is very hard to understand in the original language. When you listened to three different versions of this passage, you might have heard some different translations of this sentence. Some Bible scholars think this sentence means that Caleb's wife Ephrath was originally married to Hezron, Caleb's father. When Hezron died, Ephrath did not have any children by him, so Caleb married her in order to give her children. In this understanding, Ephrath is the mother of Ashhur.

Another possible understanding is that Hezron's wife was named Abijah and that Hezron died while Abijah was pregnant with his child. Then Abijah gave birth to Ashhur, who was the ancestor of Tekoa. In this understanding, Ephrathah is the name of a place.

Tekoa is both the name of a person and the name of a town in Israel. The town is located about sixteen kilometers south of Jerusalem and about eight kilometers south of Bethlehem. Tekoa was the hometown of an Israelite prophet named Amos.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the location of Tekoa.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:18–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller focuses on telling us about some descendants of Caleb, the son of Hezron.

In the second scene: The storyteller focuses on telling us about the family line of Hezron, Segub, and Jair.

In the third scene: The storyteller tells us about Hezron, Ashhur, and Tekoa.

The characters in this passage are:

- Caleb, Hezron, Azubah, Jerioth, Jesher, Shobab, Ardon, Ephrath, Hur, Uri, and Bezalel
- Makir, Gilead, the daughter of Makir, Segub, Jair, the people of Geshur, the people of Aram
- And Abijah, Ashhur, and Tekoa

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller tells us about the family of Caleb, son of Hezron. Bible scholars are certain that Azubah was Caleb's wife, but they do not agree on who Jerioth was. Most translations of this sentence say that Caleb also had children with Jerioth, which means that she was probably a second wife or concubine. But some

translations say that Jerioth was the daughter of Caleb and Azubah. We recommend that you translate this part of the passage to match the Bible translation that your local churches use.

After Azubah died, Caleb married another woman called Ephrath. Ephrath's son was named Hur. Hur was the ancestor of Uri, who was the ancestor of Bezalel. When the storyteller describes the relationship of Hur, Uri, and Bezalel, he uses the special word "begot" that can mean "to be the father of" or "to be the ancestor of." Your translation should reflect the fact that this word can mean "father of" or "ancestor of."

Stop here and remember the discussion you had previously about the different words you could use for "father" and "ancestor." Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, we find out about more descendants of Hezron. When Hezron was 60 years old, he married a woman who was the daughter of Makir. The storyteller says that Hezron "went in to" or "lay with" the daughter of Makir, which means that Hezron had sexual relations with her.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How would you say that a man had sexual relations with his wife, in a way that is appropriate to say in a group of both men and women? Pause this audio here.

Most Bible scholars think that Makir was the son of Manasseh, one of the sons of Joseph. Makir also had a son named Gilead. So Hezron married the sister of Gilead. The region people called Gilead was east of the Jordan River and of the Sea of Galilee. People may have named this region after Gilead, the son of Makir.

Stop here and look again at the map that shows the location of the land of Egypt, Canaan, Gilead, Geshur, and Aram. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller does not tell us the name of Hezron's wife. The important information is that she gave birth to Segub, and Segub was the ancestor of Jair, the leader of 23 towns in Gilead. We do not know how long Jair controlled this territory. We only know that the people of Geshur and the people of Aram, who lived north of the region of Gilead, took this territory away from Jair. We do not know what happened to Jair and his descendants after they lost their territory.

The storyteller of Chronicles finishes this scene by saying, "All of these were the descendants of Makir, the father of Gilead." This is unusual for Hebrew because these people were actually the descendants of Makir's daughter, and not of his son Gilead. The ancient Israelites considered descent through the father to be most important. But it is possible that, because Jair, the descendant of Makir's daughter, ruled 23 towns, the other descendants of Makir wanted to claim Jair as one of their own. In this case, it is best to use the more general term for "descendants" rather than "sons" to show the fact that this line of descent includes a woman.

Stop here and decide which word you will use for "descendants" to reflect the fact that this line of descent goes through a woman. Pause this audio here.

Scene three is the hardest of all the scenes in this passage to understand. Depending on how you translate from the original language, the characters and their relationships change. We recommend that you translate this section with the following meaning: "Soon after Hezron died in the town of Caleb Ephrathah, Hezron's wife Abijah gave birth to a son named Ashhur. And Ashhur became the father of Tekoa."

According to this understanding of the story, Hezron had another wife named Abijah. When Hezron died in a town called Caleb Ephrathah, Abijah was pregnant with Hezron's child. No one knows where the town of Caleb Ephrathah was located. After a little while, Abijah gave birth to a son called Ashhur.

Bible scholars are unsure if the final part of this verse means that Ashhur was the ancestor of a person called Tekoa, who founded a town named after himself, or if it means that Ashhur was the founder of the town of Tekoa. Remember that the word "father of" can mean a person's father, but it can also mean "founder of." In this case, it would mean that Ashhur was the first person to move his family to the place that became the town of Tekoa.

Stop here and remember the discussion you had before about words that can mean "father of" and "founder of." Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

1 Chronicles 2:18–24

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:18–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Caleb, Hezron, Azubah, Jerioth, Jesher, Shobab, Ardon, Ephrath, Hur, Uri, and Bezalel
- Makir, Gilead, the daughter of Makir, Segub, Jair, the people of Geshur, the people of Aram
- And Abijah, Ashhur, and Tekoa

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group in your language. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you could also play the audio recording out loud.

While you do this, think about how the ancient Israelites might have felt as they listened to these names. Bezalel had an important and honorable role in the religious history of Israel. Bezalel was the chief artist in charge of making the tabernacle, or Tent of Meeting, and all the objects that the people kept inside it. People used these objects to worship Yahweh. The objects included altars, gold lampstands, bowls, incense, and the clothes for the priests. People eventually moved these objects into the temple and used them for hundreds of years.

Hezron's descendant Jair ruled 23 towns in the land of Gilead for a period of time, but he eventually lost that territory. This might have reminded the ancient Israelites of how their ancestors eventually lost control of the land of Israel. That was a terrible time for the Israelite community. Many people died in battle, and the Israelites' enemies forced many of them to live in a foreign land. Although the ancient Israelites who listened to this story were living in the land of Israel, they still faced many difficulties. These Israelites were probably familiar with the town of Tekoa, which was near Jerusalem. Some of the ancient Israelites who listened to this passage might even have been in the town of Tekoa! It might have comforted and encouraged these people to know the ancestry of the Israelite who founded that town.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should read or recite this passage a second time. At certain points in the reading, pause and ask each person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" Each person should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the reading or reciting the passage.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the passage and possible responses.

Hezron's son Caleb had sons with his wife Azubah and with Jerioth. Her sons were called Jesher, Shobab, and Ardon. After Azubah died, Caleb married Ephrath, and they had a son named Hur. Hur was the ancestor of Uri, who was the ancestor of Bezalel.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am impressed that the tribe of Judah produced so many important Israelites; or
- I wish that we still had all the original items in the temple; or
- I am amazed that Bezalel had enough skill to make all those items for the Tent of Meeting.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that we no longer have the original items that Bezalel made for the Tent of Meeting; or

- What an honor for Bezalel to be in charge of making all the items people used to worship Yahweh! or
- I wish I knew more about these people. These people's lives must have been very interesting.

Continue reciting the passage.

When Hezron was 60 years old, he married Gilead's sister, the daughter of Makir. They had a son named Segub. Segub was the ancestor of Jair, who ruled 23 towns in the land of Gilead. But the Geshurites and the Arameans captured the towns of Jair and also took the town of Kenath and its 60 surrounding villages. All these were the descendants of Makir, the father of Gilead.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wonder why the descendants of Makir went back to Gilead and conquered that territory; or
- I am sad that our people have had to fight so hard just to survive; or
- I think it is unusual that the storyteller calls these folks the descendants of Makir.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I do not like the Geshurites and Arameans because they have been such a problem for our people; or
- The tribe of Judah is strong. Many rulers came from that tribe; or
- I feel sad that Jair lost control of his territory, and I wonder what happened to Jair and his descendants.

Continue reciting the passage.

After Hezron died in Caleb Ephrathah, Hezron's wife Abijah gave birth to a son named Ashhur. And Ashhur was the father of Tekoa.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am proud that someone from our people founded the town of Tekoa; or
- The prophet Amos came from Tekoa, so Tekoa must be a good town; or
- I feel sad for Abijah that her husband died before their son was born.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I have been to Tekoa, and I am glad that I know who founded it; or
- I feel sad for Ashhur that he never knew his father; or
- I am happy for Abijah that she was able to have a son and a famous descendant.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:18–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The word **sons** in this passage refers to the male children of a parent. Translate sons when it means male children in the same way you have translated it in the previous passage. For more information about sons, refer to the Master Glossary.

Caleb had sons by his wife, **Azubah**, and also by a woman named **Jerioth**. The sons were called **Jesher**, **Shobab**, and **Ardon**. The name Caleb means "faithful." The name Azubah means "strength." The name Jerioth means "curtains." The name Jesher means "right, pleasant, or prosperous." The name Shobab means "a heathen." The name Ardon means "roaming."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate these names. Pause this audio here.

After Azubah died, Caleb married **Ephrath**. Caleb and Ephrath's son was named **Hur**. Hur was the ancestor of **Uri**, and Uri was the ancestor of **Bezalel**. The name Ephrath means "fruitful." The name Hur means "white." The

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name Uri means “fiery.” The name Bezalel means “the shadow of God.” If you have already translated the book of Exodus, then you have already translated these names.

Stop here and listen again to the first few verses of Exodus chapter 31. Pay close attention to how you translated the names Hur, Uri, and Bezalel. Did you translate these names according to their meaning, or according to how they sound? Do you like the way you translated them, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

When Hezron was 60 years old, he married the daughter of Makir. Makir was the father of Gilead. Hezron’s wife gave birth to Segub. Segub was the ancestor of Jair, who controlled 23 cities in the land of Gilead. But the people of Geshur and the people of Aram came and captured the territory of Jair as well as the territory of Kenath and all 60 of the towns that surrounded Kenath. These were the **descendants** of Makir, the father of Gilead. Use the same words for descendants as you have used in previous passages. Remember that descendants are sons and daughters who descended from one person. For more information about descendants, refer to the Master Glossary, and use the same word for descendants as you have used previously.

In the Bible, a city was a large settlement surrounded by a wall. The wall protected the people who lived inside the city. Often, there were smaller settlements called villages near a city. The villages might not have walls around them.

Stop here and remember previous conversations you have had about how to translate the words **city** and **village**. Be sure to translate these words the same way you did in previous books of the Bible. Pause this audio here.

The name **Hezron** means “courtyard.” The name **Makir** means “salesman.” The name **Gilead** means “rocky.” The name **Segub** means “exalted.” The name **Jair** means “someone who brings light.” The name **Geshur** means “bridge.” The name **Aram** means “highland.” The name **Kenath** means “a possession.”

Stop here and decide how you want to translate these names. Pause this audio here.

After Hezron died in the town of **Caleb Ephrathah**, Hezron’s wife Abijah gave birth to his son **Ashhur**. Ashhur was the father of **Tekoa**. The name Caleb Ephrathah is a combination of the names **Caleb** and **Ephrath**, which mean “faithful” and “fruitful.” The name Ashhur probably means “black.” The name Tekoa means “place where you set up a tent.”

Stop here and decide how you want to translate these names.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 2:18–24

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (862 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 2:25–33

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 2:25–33 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:25–33 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:25–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller of Chronicles told us about some descendants of Hezron, the grandson of Judah. The storyteller also told us about the descendants of Caleb, who was one of Hezron's sons. In this passage, the storyteller tells us about the descendants of Jerahmeel, who was the firstborn son of Hezron.

Bible scholars know very little information about the people the storyteller mentions in this passage. The storyteller of Chronicles might have assumed that his audience already knew some information about the descendants of Jerahmeel. Jerahmeel was a member of the tribe of Judah, which was an important tribe of the Israelites. Jerahmeel's descendants made up a clan or smaller group of related individuals within the tribe of Judah. Members of a clan like the Jerahmeelites would see themselves as related to other clans in the tribe of Judah, but more closely related to other people in the clan of Jerahmeel.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your people group, how do you decide who is a close relative and who is a distant relative? What kind of groupings of related individuals do you use? Do you have groups like clans and tribes? How closely related does another person have to be in order for you to consider that person family? Pause this audio here.

When the Israelites left Egypt and went into the Promised Land, the descendants of Jerahmeel received land in the territory that Yahweh gave to the tribe of Judah. During the time of King David, the descendants of Jerahmeel lived in the southern part of Judah, south of a town people called Beersheba. People call this part of Israel the Negev wilderness. The Negev is a very dry area of Israel.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel that shows the location of the territory of the Jerahmeelites. Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 2:25–33

Many of the ancient Israelites who went into exile in Babylon and later returned to Israel were from the tribe of Judah. It is possible that the original audience who listened to the book of Chronicles understood the importance of the descendants of Jerahmeel. Some of those people were probably descendants of Jerahmeel themselves. The people would probably feel very honored that their ancestors were included in the Book of Chronicles.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Tell some stories about famous people from your people group that you think everyone already knows. Does everyone on your team actually know these stories? Does everyone know the same version of the stories, or are there different versions? Pause this audio here.

King David was a descendant of Judah through Ram, the brother of Jerahmeel. The ancient Israelites might have considered the Jerahmeelites to be close relatives of David's family. This is another possible reason why the storyteller of Chronicles takes the time to tell us about the descendants of Jerahmeel. Bible scholars do not know what the relationship was like between the descendants of Jerahmeel and other clans of the tribe of Judah.

Stop here and discuss these questions: How important are family relationships in your culture? Discuss the good things that can happen because of good family connections. Also, discuss the bad things that can happen because of bad family connections. Pause this audio here.

Jerahmeel, son of Hezron, had six sons. Five of those sons were from one wife, and one son was born to Jerahmeel's other wife, Atarah. The storyteller chooses to tell us about the descendants of Jerahmeel's son Ram, who was the firstborn, and about the descendants of Jerahmeel's son Onam. The storyteller does not tell us anything about the descendants of Jerahmeel's other four sons.

Although the storyteller of Chronicles tells us the names of Ram's sons, he does not give us any more information about those sons' descendants. The storyteller uses the rest of this passage to talk about the descendants of Onam. Specifically, the storyteller names six generations of descendants from Onam. This suggests that the storyteller thinks the line of descent through Onam is the most important information in this passage.

Ahlai is the descendant of Sheshan, son of Ishi. In the next passage, we will find out that Ahlai is Sheshan's daughter. Sheshan had no sons, so this is a valid reason for including his daughter Ahlai in this list of descendants.

In the next passage, the storyteller will tell us about the descendants of Sheshan through his daughter Ahlai.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:25–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller lists the sons of Jerahmeel.

In the second scene: The storyteller names the grandsons of Jerahmeel through his firstborn son Ram and his son Onam.

In the third scene: The storyteller follows the family line of Jerahmeel's son Onam through Shammai.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller follows the family line of Onam through Jada, the brother of Shammai.

The characters in this passage are:

- Hezron, Jerahmeel, Ram, Bunah, Oren, Ozem, Ahijah, Atarah, Onam
- Maaz, Jamin, Eker
- Shammai, Jada, Nadab, Abishur, Abihail, Ahban, Molid, Seled, Appaim, Ishi, Sheshan, Ahlai
- And Jether, Jonathan, Peleth, and Zaza

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller lists the sons of Jerahmeel. The storyteller reminds us that Jerahmeel was the firstborn son of Hezron. The storyteller also tells us that Ram was the firstborn son of Jerahmeel. This might confuse some audiences because Jerahmeel also had a brother named Ram.

Stop here and remember the discussion you had about multiple people in a family with the same name. If this is something unusual in your culture, how will you make it clear to your audience that Jerahmeel's brother Ram and Jerahmeel's son Ram are two different people? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller does not tell us the name of the mother of Jerahmeel's sons Ram, Bunah, Oren, Ozem, and Ahijah. The storyteller does tell us the name of Jerahmeel's other wife, Atarah, who was the mother of Onam. This might be because, for most of the rest of the passage, the storyteller will talk about the descendants of Onam. Apparently, it was important to the storyteller of Chronicles to make it clear that Onam had a different mother from the rest of Jerahmeel's sons.

In the second scene, the storyteller of Chronicles tells us the names of Jerahmeel's grandsons through Ram and Onam. The storyteller does not tell us the names of any descendants of Bunah, Oren, Ozem, or Ahijah.

In the third scene, the storyteller tells us more about the family line of Shammai, the grandson of Hezron, through Onam. First, the storyteller recites the list of ancestors from Shammai through his son Abishur to his grandsons Ahban and Molid. The storyteller also includes the name of Abishur's wife, Abihail.

Next, the storyteller traces a line of descent from Shammai through his son Nadab. This list of ancestors contains several generations. Through Nadab, his son Appaim, his grandson Ishi, and great-grandson Sheshan, we get to Ahlai, the daughter of Sheshan.

The storyteller tells us that two people in this list of ancestors, Seled and Jether, died without children. You might have heard two different ways to say this when you listened to different translations of the Bible. Some translations say that these men died without children, but other translations say that the men died without having sons. Because people in the Israelite culture considered descent through the father to be most important, children were usually born into their father's tribe. Therefore, a man had to father sons in order to continue his family line. A man's daughter's children belonged to the daughter's husband's family line. Therefore, in the Israelite culture, for a man to die with no sons was kind of the same as if the man died with no children at all. However, it is also important to remember that the original Hebrew word for "sons" can also be understood to mean "descendants," which would include both male descendants and female descendants. So it is possible that this means that both Seled and Jether died with no children at all, either male or female.

Stop here and discuss whether you will translate these sentences to say that each person died without sons or that each person died without children. Pause this audio here.

Ahlai is the daughter of Sheshan, son of Ishi. In the next passage, the storyteller will tell us that Sheshan had no sons, only daughters. In the original language, the storyteller of Chronicles uses the word that people usually translate as "sons of" or "descendants of" to describe the relationship between Sheshan and Ahlai. In many languages, it will be unnatural to say that Ahlai was the son of Sheshan when it soon becomes clear that Ahlai was Sheshan's daughter. It is acceptable in this scene to say that Ahlai was a descendant of Sheshan, or to say that Sheshan was the father of Ahlai.

Stop here and discuss how you will describe the relationship between Sheshan and Ahlai in your language. Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller traces the descendants of Jada, the brother of Shammai. Once again, Bible scholars do not know why the storyteller mentions these members of the tribe of Judah. This scene ends with a summary statement that says, "These were the sons of Jerahmeel." In this case, the word "sons" clearly means "descendants," since the storyteller has talked about a total of eight generations.

Stop here and discuss how you will translate this summary statement. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:25–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Hezron, Jerahmeel, Ram, Bunah, Oren, Ozem, Ahijah, Atarah, Onam
- Maaz, Jamin, Eker
- Shammai, Jada, Nadab, Abishur, Abihail, Ahban, Molid, Seled, Appaim, Ishi, Sheshan, Ahlai
- And Jether, Jonathan, Peleth, and Zaza

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group in your language. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite listening to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you could also play the audio recording out loud.

As you do this, imagine you are an ancient Israelite who lives in Jerusalem and is listening to one of your leaders tell you the names of the descendants of Jerahmeel. Perhaps you are a descendant of Jerahmeel, and you feel honored to hear your leader read the names of your ancestors out loud. You might hope that your ancestors had faith that their family line would survive. You might think of the sadness your ancestors felt when enemies forcibly removed your ancestors from their homes and sent them to Babylon. Or you might think about the joy your ancestors felt when other people allowed your ancestors to return and rebuild Jerusalem. You might think of your family's ancient territory, the towns and farms left behind in the Negev wilderness in the south of Judah, and wish that you could take control of it again. Or, you might be from another Israelite tribe. Maybe your ancestors did not get along with the ancestors of the Jerahmeelites. Maybe you know some descendants of Jerahmeel, and you do not like those people. Or, maybe you see yourself and the descendants of Jerahmeel as brothers, who all work toward the same goal and serve the same God.

Pause this audio here and recite the passage.

The group should listen to this passage a second time. You might decide to listen to an audio recording of the passage if the many names are too difficult to remember at this point. At certain points in the passage, pause and ask each person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" Each person should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the passage.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the passage and possible responses.

The sons of Jerahmeel, the firstborn son of Hezron, were named Ram, Bunah, Oren, Ozem, and Ahijah. Jerahmeel had another wife named Atarah, and she was the mother of Onam.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- It is important to remember all the ancestors of our people; or
- God blessed Jerahmeel with six sons; or
- The tribe of Judah had many important people.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I am excited to hear more about our ancestors; or
- It makes me proud to hear the names of my ancestors read aloud; or
- I wonder what Jerahmeel's other wife was called?

Continue reading or reciting the passage.

1 Chronicles 2:25–33

The sons of Ram, the firstborn of Jerahmeel, were Maaz, Jamin, and Eker. The sons of Onam were Shammai and Jada.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wonder why Jerahmeel gave his firstborn son the same name as his brother; or
- These people all probably lived in Egypt; or
- I hope my people feel honored when they remember their ancestors.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I wonder why the storyteller does not tell us anything about Jerahmeel's other sons; or
- I know some descendants of Jerahmeel, and I do not like those people; or
- Why do we have to talk so much about the tribe of Judah?

Continue reading or reciting the passage.

Shammai had two sons named Nadab and Abishur. Abishur's wife was named Abihail, and she was the mother of Ahban and Molid. Nadab had two sons named Seled and Appaim. Seled died without any sons. Appaim had a son named Ishi, who was the father of Sheshan. And Sheshan was the father of Ahlai.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hope my people will remember this important information about our ancestors; or
- I wonder what life was like for these people who lived so long ago; or
- I feel honored to remember these people.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I wonder what happened to Seled, and why he died without any sons; or
- I wonder why the storyteller tells us the name of Abishur's wife. Was Abishur's wife an important person at that time? or
- It is important to remember the names of our ancestors. I hope I can remember all this!

Continue reading or reciting the passage.

Shammai's brother Jada had two sons, Jether and Jonathan. Jether died without having any sons. Jonathan had two sons named Peleth and Zaza. All these people were the descendants of Jerahmeel.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wish we knew more about these Israelites; or
- I feel honored to teach our people this important history; or
- I am excited to share more information about the tribe of Judah!

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I wonder why this branch of Jerahmeel's family was so important; or
- I feel confused why the storyteller is telling us about so many random people of Judah; or
- I wish I did not have to listen to all this information about the Jerahmeelites.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:25–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Remember that sometimes the word **sons** in the original language refers to the male children of a parent, and sometimes it refers to a group of **descendants**. Translate sons, or descendants, in the same way you have translated in the previous passage. For more information about sons and descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

The sons of Jerahmeel, the firstborn son of Hezron, were Ram, Bunah, Oren, Ozem, and Ahijah. Jerahmeel had another wife named Atarah. Atarah was the mother of Onam.

You have already translated the names **Hezron**, **Jerahmeel**, and **Ram**. Be sure to translate these names the same way that you did in previous passages in Chronicles. You have also already translated the term "**firstborn**," so be sure to translate it the same way you did in previous passages.

The name **Bunah** means "wisdom." The name **Oren** means "pine tree." The name **Ozem** means "strong." The name **Ahijah** means "brother of Yahweh." The name **Atarah** means "crown." The name **Onam** also means "strong."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the names of the sons of Jerahmeel. Pause this audio here.

The sons of Ram, who was Jerahmeel's firstborn son, were **Maaz**, **Jamin**, and **Eker**. The sons of Onam were called **Shammai** and **Jada**. The name Maaz could mean "vigor" or "anger." The name Jamin means "right hand" or "authority, power." The name Eker means "barren" or "weak." The name Shammai means "They have heard my name." The name Jada means "wise."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the names of the sons of Ram and Onam. Pause this audio here.

Shammai's sons were called **Nadab** and **Abishur**. **Abishur**'s wife was called **Abihail**. Abihail was the mother of Abishur's sons **Ahban** and **Molid**. The name Nadab means "generous." The name Abishur means "my father is a wall" or "my father is a bull," both of which refer to strength and protection. The name Abihail means "my father is strong." The name Ahban means "intelligent." The name Molid means "birthplace" or "generation."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the names of these descendants of Shammai. Pause this audio here.

The sons of Nadab were called **Seled** and **Appaim**. Seled died without children. Appaim had a son named **Ishi**, who was the father of **Sheshan**. And Sheshan was the father of **Ahlai**. The name Seled means "rock." The name Appaim means "nostrils." The name Ishi means "salvation." The name Sheshan could mean "joy, rejoicing." The name Ahlai means "desire."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the names of these descendants of Nadab. Pause this audio here.

The sons of Jada, Shammai's brother, were **Jether** and **Jonathan**. Jether died without children. Jonathan's sons were named **Peleth** and **Zaza**. These were the descendants of Jerahmeel. The name Jether means "excellence." The name Jonathan means "Yahweh has given." The name Peleth means "speed." The name Zaza can mean "light."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the names of these descendants of Jada.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 2:25–33

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (945 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 2:34–41

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 2:34–41 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:34–41 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:34–41 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller of Chronicles told us about the descendants of Jerahmeel, son of Hezron. In this passage, the storyteller continues to tell us about the list of ancestors from Jerahmeel's descendant Sheshan to a man named Elishama.

Although the passage does not say so, many Bible scholars assume that the Sheshan the storyteller mentions in this passage is the same Sheshan from the previous passage, Sheshan who was the son of Ishi and the father of Ahlai. Many Bible scholars also assume that Ahlai was the daughter that Sheshan gave in marriage to Jarha. That means that Sheshan and his descendants are members of the tribe of Judah and descendants of Jerahmeel.

At the very beginning of the passage, the storyteller tells us that Sheshan had no sons, but he did have daughters. In ancient Israelite culture, this was a difficult situation for Sheshan. Previously, we discussed how in Israelite culture, a child was born into his or her father's tribe. That means that normally, the children of Sheshan's

daughters would not belong to Sheshan's tribe, but to their father's tribe. You have already seen how almost all the names in the genealogies of the Book of Chronicles are the names of men. Without male descendants to carry on the family line, Sheshan's family line would cease to exist.

But a man who only had daughters also faced other disadvantages. In the Israelite culture, a man would normally pass his property and wealth to his sons. If a man only had daughters, then there was no one to inherit that man's property. This was a huge problem for an ancient Israelite because Israelites often connected wealth to the land. It was very important to the Israelites to maintain their family and tribal possession of the land.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, what kind of inheritance rights do daughters have? Are there any rights or privileges that sons have but daughters do not have? If men and women in your culture have equal rights of inheritance now, was there ever a time in the past when this was not the case? If a husband and wife do not have children who are able to inherit their wealth or property, what happens to their wealth or property? Pause this audio here.

Sheshan had an Egyptian servant named Jarha. Bible scholars disagree on whether Jarha was a paid servant that Sheshan employed, or if Jarha was actually a slave, who was not free to come and go as he liked. When you listened to different translations of this passage, you may have heard some translations call Jarha a servant, and other translations call Jarha a slave.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, how common is it for a person to have servants? How common is it for a person to have slaves? If these things are not common now, was there a time in the past when these things were common? What do people in your culture think about slavery? Pause this audio here.

Whether Jarha was a servant or a slave, Sheshan gave one of his daughters in marriage to Jarha, and everyone considered their children to be Sheshan's descendants. This is similar to how Abraham took Sarah's Egyptian slave Hagar as a concubine in order to father children. People thought this was an acceptable solution to a serious problem. People considered Abraham and Hagar's son Ishmael a legitimate descendant of Abraham. In the case of Sheshan's daughter and Jarha, this solution probably only worked because Jarha was Egyptian and not a member of any tribe of Israel. It probably did not matter to Jarha which Israelite tribe his children belonged to. Whether Jarha was a servant or a slave, this arranged marriage would most likely give Jarha's children a better future because those children would inherit Sheshan's property.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, how common is it for parents to arrange the marriages of their children? If it is not common now, was it common in the past? Do parents do this for both sons and daughters? When parents arrange a marriage, what details should they consider when they choose a bride or groom? Pause this audio here.

The ancient Israelites probably considered this an emergency solution to a serious problem. This solution does not follow normal inheritance practices, but it was a way to make sure Sheshan's grandchildren could inherit his property.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Think of some circumstances where, in your culture, it is socially acceptable to make an exception to the rules. What is the normal rule in this situation? What is the exception to this rule? Under what circumstances is it okay to break the rule? Why is it acceptable to make an exception to this rule? Pause this audio here.

The rest of this passage focuses on the list of ancestors from Attai to Elishama. This is actually one of the longest genealogies in the Bible. Because of this, Bible scholars believe that Elishama must have been an important person. Unfortunately, nobody knows for sure who Elishama was or why he was important. It seems that once again, the storyteller of Chronicles assumed that his audience knew who Elishama was and why Elishama was important. But modern audiences do not know why Elishama was important.

Stop here and tell a story about someone from your people group whom everyone respected and honored. What did this person do to cause others to respect and admire him or her so much? When you talk about this person, what kind of words do you use to describe him or her? What kind of qualities did he or she have?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:34–41 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller explains how Sheshan arranged the marriage of his daughter to his Egyptian servant, Jarha, so that Sheshan's family line could continue.

In the second scene: The storyteller focuses on telling his audience the list of ancestors from Sheshan's grandson Attai to Elishama. There are 13 generations in this scene.

The characters in this passage are:

- Sheshan, Jarha, Attai, and Sheshan's daughter
- And Nathan, Zabad, Ephlal, Obed, Jehu, Azariah, Helez, Eleasah, Sismai, Shallum, Jekamiah, and Elishama

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller explains how Sheshan's family line continued through his daughter's marriage to Jarha, an Egyptian servant. Sheshan had no sons, and this meant that Sheshan's family line would end with Sheshan. This meant that Sheshan had to find an unusual way to make sure that Sheshan had descendants to inherit his property.

Most Bible translations say that Sheshan gave his daughter in marriage to Jarha. This simply means that Sheshan made the arrangements for his daughter to marry Jarha. In ancient Israelite culture, parents usually arranged marriages for their children. Parents might have considered their children's feelings in the matter, but the parents usually made the final decision about who their children married. We do not know how Sheshan's daughter and Jarha felt about this matter. Jarha and Sheshan's daughter might have been happy about the marriage, or they might have been unhappy about it. Jarha and Sheshan's daughter may have felt they were simply doing their duty.

Stop here and discuss this question: What is the most natural way in your language to say that Sheshan arranged for his daughter to marry Jarha? Pause this audio here.

Most Bible scholars assume that Ahlai was Sheshan's daughter who married Jarha. But since the storyteller of Chronicles does not include this information here, it is better to simply say, "Sheshan gave his daughter to Jarha to be Jarha's wife" or "Sheshan gave one of his daughters in marriage to Jarha."

In the second scene, the storyteller uses a specific way to describe the list of ancestors from Attai to Elishama. The storyteller tells us that each man was the father of the man whose name comes after.

Stop here and remember the conversation you had previously about the most natural way to express this kind of list of ancestors in your language. Pause this audio here.

You might notice that some of the names in this section are common Israelite names. For example, we hear of other characters in the Bible with the names Nathan, Obed, Jehu, Shallum, and Azariah.

Stop here and discuss this question: If it is unusual or forbidden in your culture for two different people to have the same name, how will you make it clear to your audience that these Israelites with the same name are different people? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:34–41 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

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The characters in this passage are:

- Sheshan, Jarha, Attai, and Sheshan's daughter
- And Nathan, Zabad, Ephlal, Obed, Jehu, Azariah, Helez, Eleasah, Sismai, Shallum, Jekamiah, and Elishama

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group in your language. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite listening to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you could also play the audio recording out loud.

As you do this, imagine you are an ancient Israelite who lives in Jerusalem. For the sake of this exercise, imagine that you are a member of the tribe of Judah and part of the clan of Jerahmeel. Imagine that Elishama was your ancestor, and that everyone respected and honored Elishama. You know that you are listening to Elishama's genealogy. You probably feel honored and proud that your ancestor has been included in the Book of Chronicles. The other people around you know that Elishama was an honorable and important man, and they know that you are Elishama's descendant.

Pause this audio here and recite the passage.

The group should read or recite this passage a second time. At certain points in the passage, ask each person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" Each person should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue to read or recite the passage.

Pause this audio here and recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of possible responses.

Sheshan had no sons, only daughters. Sheshan also had an Egyptian servant named Jarha. Sheshan arranged for his daughter to marry Jarha, and they had a son named Attai.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel bad for Sheshan that he had no sons; or
- Sheshan figured out a very clever solution to his problem; or
- It is a good thing that Sheshan's family line was able to continue so that Elishama could be born.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I feel honored that these stories about my ancestors made it into this book! or
- I am thankful that our ancestor Sheshan found a way to continue our family line; or
- I wonder how Sheshan's daughter and Jarha felt about their arranged marriage?

Continue reading or reciting the passage.

Attai became the father of Nathan. Nathan became the father of Zabad. Zabad became the father of Ephlal. Ephlal became the father of Obed. Obed became the father of Jehu. Jehu became the father of Azariah. Azariah became the father of Helez. Helez became the father of Eleasah. Eleasah became the father of Sismai. Sismai became the father of Shallum. Shallum became the father of Jekamiah. Jekamiah became the father of Elishama.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel honored to teach our people these important parts of our history; or
- It is important to remember the family line of Elishama because he was an important man; or
- I am impressed that so many good people came from the tribe of Judah.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- It is exciting to hear someone read about the family line of Elishama from this book; or
- I feel proud to be a descendant of Elishama; or
- I am grateful that the storyteller thought our family history was important enough to include in his book.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:34–41 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Remember that sometimes the word **sons** in the original language refers to the male children of a parent. In this passage, Sheshan had no sons, only daughters. “Sons” in this case refers to the male children of parents. For more information about sons, refer to the Master Glossary.

Sheshan did not have any sons, but he had daughters. Sheshan had an Egyptian servant named Jarha. A servant is a person who does work for someone else. Some translations of the Bible call Jarha a slave. A slave also does work for someone else, but is not free to leave and find another job. People consider a slave the property of the person he or she works for.

Stop here and discuss as a group whether you will call Jarha a **servant** or a **slave**, if you have different words for the different types of servants. Look up servant in the Master Glossary for more information. Once you decide which word to use, if you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used before. Pause this audio here.

Sheshan gave his daughter to Jarha to be Jarha’s wife, and she had a son named Attai. We do not know what Jarha’s name means. The name Attai means “good timing.”

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the names **Jarha** and **Attai**. Will you translate these names according to the meaning, or will you translate them to sound the same as the original names? Pause this audio here.

For the rest of the passage, the storyteller uses a special word that means “**to become the father of**” or “**to become the ancestor of**.”

Stop here and remember the decision you made about how to translate this special word or phrase. Be sure to translate it the same way that you have before. Pause this audio here.

Attai was the father of **Nathan**, who was the father of **Zabad**. Zabad was the father of **Ephlal**, who was the father of **Obed**. Obed was the father of **Jehu**, who was the father of **Azariah**. The name Nathan means “gift.” The name Zabad means “giver.” The name Ephlal means “God has judged.” The name Obed means “worshipper.” The name Jehu means “Yahweh is God.” The name Azariah means “Yahweh has helped.”

Stop here and discuss how you will translate these names. Pause this audio here.

Azariah was the father of **Helez**, who was the father of **Eleasah**. Eleasah was the father of **Sismai**, who was the father of **Shallum**. Shallum was the father of **Jekamiah**, who was the father of **Elishama**. The name Helez means “strong” or “freedom.” The name Eleasah means “God has made.” The name Sismai means “my protector.” The name Shallum probably means “reward.” The name Jekamiah means “Yahweh will rise” or “Yahweh will establish.” The name Elishama means “God hears.”

Stop here and discuss how you will translate these names.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 2:34–41

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (960 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 2:42–50a

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 2:42–50a and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:42–50a three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:42–50a in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller of Chronicles told us about many generations of descendants of Jerahmeel, the oldest son of Hezron of the tribe of Judah. In this passage, the storyteller returns to tell us about the descendants of Caleb, the brother of Jerahmeel.

Caleb and Jerahmeel were sons of Hezron. Hezron had five sons in total. Jerahmeel was the oldest. Hezron's other sons were Ram, Caleb, Segub, and Ashhur. Ram was the ancestor of King David. The storyteller of Chronicles previously told us about some of Caleb's descendants, but apparently, the storyteller did not finish telling us

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about all of Caleb's descendants. In the next two passages, the storyteller will finish his list of the descendants of Caleb. Bible scholars do not know why the storyteller split his account of Caleb's descendants into two parts.

Caleb had many wives and concubines. In previous passages, the storyteller told us that Caleb had a wife named Azubah and possibly a wife or concubine named Jerioth. After Azubah died, Caleb took a wife named Ephrathah. In this passage, the storyteller does not tell us the name of the woman who was the mother of Caleb's firstborn son. But the storyteller does tell us that Caleb had two more concubines named Ephah and Maacah.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, how common is it for a man to have more than one wife at the same time? If it is not common now, was it common in the past? What do people in your culture think about a man having more than one wife? If a man has more than one wife, do people consider some wives to have a different status than the others? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller suddenly introduces a person named Jahdai with no connection to any other person in this list. Bible scholars do not agree on who Jahdai was or how Jahdai is connected to the descendants of Caleb. Bible scholars do not even agree on whether Jahdai was a man or a woman. It is possible that Jahdai was another wife or concubine of Caleb, and that Regem, Jotham, Geshan, Pelet, Ephah, and Shaaph were Caleb's sons with Jahdai. It is also possible that Jahdai was another name for one of the male descendants of Caleb. Unfortunately, it is impossible to know for sure.

In this passage, the storyteller repeats some names. We hear about two different people named Shaaph and two different people named Gazez. Caleb had a concubine named Ephah, but another male descendant of Caleb is also called Ephah.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Say some names in your language that can be a name for both a man and a woman. If your language does not have names that can be the name for both a man and a woman, how can you make it clear to your audience that names in the Bible, like "Ephah," can be the name of both a man and a woman? Pause this audio here.

We also hear several names in this passage that occur in other parts of the Bible for different people.

Stop here and discuss these questions: How confusing will it be for your listeners to hear names in this passage that are the same names for other famous people in the Bible? If necessary, discuss how you will make it clear to your audience that the people the storyteller mentions here are different from those other famous people in the Bible with the same names. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller mentions "Shaaph, the father of Madmannah." Bible scholars know that Madmannah is the name of a town in the southern part of Judah. Because of this, some translations say that Shaaph was the founder of the town of Madmannah. Some Bible scholars also believe that Macbenah and Gibea are the names of towns. Since people sometimes name towns in the Bible after people, it is possible that these are the names for both a person and a town.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Talk about some cities, towns, or settlements in your area that someone has named after a person. Why did people name these places after that person? Talk about other locations in your area, such as mountains, rivers, forests, or valleys, that people have named after a person. Why have people named those locations after that person? Pause this audio here.

One purpose of these family lists in the Book of Chronicles was to remind the Israelites of how their family groups began. To the Israelites, their beginnings not only included families and tribes, but also land and towns. Each Israelite tribe received territory in Israel, and each clan also received a portion of land. The leaders of those clans divided up their territory and gave it to families. Those families worked hard to farm the land, build towns, and defend their land when enemies threatened it. Each tribe, clan, and family not only had family connections but also strong connections to their territory.

Stop here and discuss these questions: Have each person in the group say what town or region they come from. How long has your family lived in that area? Does your family own land in that area? How do your people determine who the land belongs to? Are there any cities, towns, or land features in the area that have the same name as one of your ancestors? How important is it to your people that you live in the same area where your ancestors lived? Why is it important?

1 Chronicles 2:42–50a

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:42–50a in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us about Caleb's descendants through his firstborn son, Mesha.

In the second scene: The storyteller tells us about Caleb's descendants through a concubine named Ephah.

In the third scene: The storyteller tells us about the descendants of a person called Jahdai.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller tells us about Caleb's descendants through a concubine named Maacah.

The characters in this passage are:

- Caleb, Mesha, Ziph, Mareshah, Hebron, Korah, Tappuah, Rekem, Shema, Raham, Jorkeam, Shammai, Maon, Beth Zur
- Ephah, Haran, Moza, Gazez, and another man named Gazez
- Jahdai, Regem, Jotham, Geshan, Pelet, Ephah, Shaaph
- And Maacah, Sheber, Tirhanah, Shaaph, Madmannah, Sheva, Macbenah, Gibea, and Acsah

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, at the very beginning, the storyteller does not follow the usual pattern to describe relationships between people. This makes it very difficult to understand some of the relationships. Because of this, you might have heard a few different ways to translate this verse when you listened to three different versions of this story. What is clear is that Caleb's firstborn son was named Mesha, and that Mesha was the father of Ziph. It is also clear that Mareshah was the father of Hebron. What is not clear is the relationship between Caleb, Mesha, and Mareshah. The storyteller uses the word "son" for all of these relationships.

Stop here and gather five objects to represent Caleb, Mesha, Ziph, Mareshah, and Hebron. You will use these objects to visualize possible relationships between these five men. Pause this audio here.

Some Bible scholars think that Ziph was the father of Mareshah, so that this list of ancestors shows five generations of men.

Stop here and arrange the five objects in such a way that they show that Caleb was the father of Mesha, Mesha was the father of Ziph, Ziph was the father of Mareshah, and Mareshah was the father of Hebron. If anyone has a device that can take pictures, you might want to take a picture of this arrangement. Or you could draw the arrangement. Pause this audio here.

Other Bible scholars think that Mesha and Mareshah were brothers. In this understanding, Caleb was the father of Mesha and Mareshah. Mesha was the father of Ziph, and Mareshah was the father of Hebron, which means that Caleb was the grandfather of both Ziph and Hebron.

Stop here and rearrange the objects to show that Caleb was the father of Mesha and Mareshah, Mesha was the father of Ziph, and Mareshah was the father of Hebron. Make sure everyone understands the changes. If anyone has a device that can take pictures, you might want to take a picture of this arrangement. Or you could draw the arrangement. Pause this audio here.

Some Bible scholars think that Mesha and Mareshah are two names for the same person. So, according to this understanding, Caleb was the father of Mesha, and Ziph and Hebron were Mesha's sons.

Stop here and rearrange the objects so that Mesha and Mareshah are the same person, and that Caleb is the father of Mesha and Mesha is the father of Ziph and Hebron. Make sure everyone understands the changes. Take a picture or draw this arrangement. Pause this audio here.

Some Bible translations intentionally leave the relationship between Mareshah and the other men unclear. For example, these translations might say something like, "The descendants of Caleb, the brother of Jerahmeel,

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included Mesha, the firstborn son, who became the father of Ziph. Caleb's descendants also included the sons of Mareshah, the father of Hebron." This option makes it clear that all these men were descendants of Caleb, but does not try to explain the relationship between Mareshah and Caleb.

Stop here and rearrange the objects so that Caleb is the father of Mesha and the grandfather of Ziph, and so that Mareshah is the father of Hebron, but the relationship between Mareshah and the others is undefined. Make sure everyone understands the changes. Take a photo or draw this arrangement. Pause this audio here.

It is good practice that if the meaning of a Biblical passage is unclear in the original language, it should be equally unclear in your translation. For this reason, we recommend that you choose to leave the relationship between Mareshah and the other men in this section unclear. However, if you wish to choose one of the other options, that is acceptable.

Stop here and discuss how you will translate this part of the passage. Pause this audio here.

Some of the names in this scene are also the names of towns. Hebron is a town located about 32 kilometers southwest of Jerusalem, and Ziph is a town near Hebron. Tappuah is the name of a town in the western foothills of Judah. Jorkeam may be the name of a village. Beth Zur is a town in the southern part of Judah. People established Hebron before the time of Abraham. It is possible that people named the other towns after these descendants of Caleb, but Bible scholars do not know this for certain. For this reason, we recommend that you do not use the word "founder" in this scene.

In the second scene, the storyteller tells us about the descendants of Caleb through his concubine named Ephah. In this scene, the storyteller describes the relationships between people in yet another way. The storyteller tells us that Ephah gave birth to, or became the mother of, Caleb's sons.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your language, what are some common ways to say that a woman gave birth to a child, or became a mother to her child? Pause this audio here.

This scene contains a statement that might make people feel very uncomfortable. The statement has to do with sex between very close relatives.

Stop here and discuss this topic: For a possibly uncomfortable discussion about sex between close relatives, would it be better to split men and women into two groups and have separate discussions? Pause this audio here.

In this scene, the storyteller tells us, "Caleb's concubine Ephah gave birth to Haran, Moza, and Gazez. Haran was the father of Gazez." There are two ways to interpret this statement. One is that Caleb was the father of Haran, Moza, and Gazez, and that Haran later had a son named Gazez. In this understanding, Haran gave his son the same name as his brother. In the Israelite culture, it was acceptable for a person to give a child the same name as a living relative, so this is a very good possible explanation.

Another interpretation could be that Haran had a sexual relationship with his own mother, Ephah, so that he was both the father and the brother of Gazez. This kind of relationship between a mother and son was strictly forbidden in Israel. Therefore, Bible scholars do not believe that Haran had this kind of relationship with his mother. Some translations say something like, "Haran also had a son named Gazez," in order to be very clear that there are two different people named Gazez in this family.

Stop here and discuss these questions: How likely do you think it is that your audience might misunderstand this verse to mean that Haran had a son with his own mother? Do you feel it is necessary to make it clear that there are two different people named Gazez in this family? If so, how will you make it clear that Haran had a brother named Gazez and also a son named Gazez? Pause this audio here.

We are now done discussing this topic. If you split into groups of men and women for this discussion, you may return to a large group now.

Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller tells us about the sons of Jahdai. Bible scholars do not know if Jahdai was a male descendant of Caleb, or if Jahdai was a woman and the mother of these six sons of Caleb. Since the storyteller lists these sons of Jahdai between the sons of Caleb's concubine Ephah and Caleb's concubine Maacah, it is

possible that Jahdai was another concubine. But since the original language does not say this, you should leave the relationship of Jahdai to Caleb unclear.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller tells us about Caleb's descendants through a concubine named Maacah. Maacah had four sons named Sheber, Tirhanah, Shaaph, and Sheva. Madmannah, Macbenah, and Gibea may have been the names of people, but they also might have been the names of towns. In the Book of Chronicles, the storyteller uses the word "father" to not only mean "male parent" or "ancestor" but also "founder." A founder is a person who starts something new, such as the first person to move his family to a new location and start a town. A founder could also be the first king in a dynasty of kings, the original owner of a company, the first person to start a new religious movement, or a person to start a new school.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your language, how do you describe someone who was the founder of a city or settlement? What other special words might you use for the first person to do something? Pause this audio here.

Some translations say that Shaaph was the founder of Madmannah, and Sheva was the founder of Macbenah and Gibea. But it is also acceptable to say that Shaaph was the father of Madmannah, and Sheva was the father of Macbenah and Gibea.

Stop here and discuss how you will translate this: Will you say "father" or "founder"? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us here that Caleb had a daughter named Acsah. The storyteller does not tell us the name of Acsah's mother. We do not know any more information about Acsah or why the storyteller mentioned Acsah here.

At the end of this passage, the storyteller tells us that all these people were descendants of Caleb. This sounds like a summary statement. However, in the next passage, the storyteller will continue to talk about more descendants of Caleb. For this reason, some Bible scholars think that this sentence is supposed to go with the next passage in 1 Chronicles chapter 2. Instead of translating this sentence as a summary statement, such as "These were all descendants of Caleb," these scholars translate the sentence as an introduction to the next passage and say something like, "The following people were also descendants of Caleb." You are free to make whatever choice is the most clear and natural in your language.

Stop here and discuss whether you will translate this sentence as a summary of this passage or as an introduction to the next passage. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:42–50a in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Caleb, Mesha, Ziph, Mareshah, Hebron, Korah, Tappuah, Rekem, Shema, Raham, Jorkeam, Shammai, Maon, Beth Zur
- Ephah, Haran, Moza, Gazez, and another man named Gazez
- Jahdai, Regem, Jotham, Geshan, Pelet, Ephah, Shaaph
- And Maacah, Sheber, Tirhanah, Shaaph, Madmannah, Sheva, Macbenah, Gibea, and Acsah

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group in your language. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite listening to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you could also play the audio recording out loud.

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As you do this, imagine you are an ancient Israelite who lives in Jerusalem. Imagine that you are a descendant of Caleb, and that you feel honored to hear someone read the names of your ancestors aloud. You might feel grateful that the storyteller of the Book of Chronicles wrote this information down and included your ancestors in it. You might also feel grateful that the storyteller listed the names of your ancestors who founded cities in the land of Judah. These words remind you that your family has been very attached to the land for hundreds of years. Your ancestors worked hard to start cities, farm the land, raise children, and fight battles for survival all over the land of Judah. You might really want to go and see towns like Tappuah, Madmannah, and Beth Zur for yourself. Perhaps one of your own ancestors was the founder of a town. When you think about how many generations of your ancestors were born, lived, and died in this land, you realize even more how important the land is to your people.

Pause this audio here and recite the passage.

The group should read or recite this passage a second time. At certain points in the passage, pause and ask each person, “What are you feeling or thinking?” Each person should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue reading or reciting the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The descendants of Caleb, the brother of Jerahmeel, included Mesha, his firstborn, who became the father of Ziph. Caleb’s descendants also included the sons of Mareshah, the father of Hebron. The sons of Hebron were Korah, Tappuah, Rekem, and Shema. Shema was the father of Raham, who was the father of Jorkeam. Rekem was the father of Shammai, who was the father of Maon. And Maon was the father of Beth Zur.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- It is important for our people to know about these members of the tribe of Judah; or
- We should all keep in mind who founded our cities and towns; or
- I feel proud that the tribe of Judah is so important in Israel.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” They might answer things like:

- I feel humbled to think about how hard my ancestors worked to settle this land; or
- I am glad that I know the origins of the people who founded the towns of Judah; or
- When I hear this, it makes me feel proud to be a member of the tribe of Judah!

Continue reading or reciting the passage.

Caleb’s concubine Ephah gave birth to Haran, Moza, and Gazez. And Haran also had a son named Gazez. The sons of Jahdai were Regem, Jotham, Geshan, Pelet, Ephah, and Shaaph.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Caleb was a very blessed man who had a lot of children! or
- I hope that when people hear this, it helps our people realize that we are all one people.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” They might answer things like:

- Caleb had a lot of concubines and a lot of children. I wonder how Caleb provided for all of these people; or
- I wonder why Haran gave his son the same name as his brother; or
- I feel honored that the names of my ancestors are in this book; or

Continue reading or reciting the passage.

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Another one of Caleb's concubines, Maacah, gave birth to Sheber and Tirhanah. Maacah also gave birth to Shaaph, the founder of Madmannah, and Sheva, the founder of Macbenah and Gibea. Caleb also had a daughter named Acsah. These were all descendants of Caleb.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- No wonder the descendants of Caleb founded so many towns. There were so many descendants! or
- The descendants of Caleb must have been very capable to have founded so many towns; or
- It is important for our people to know who founded the towns of Judah.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" They might answer things like:

- It is very important for our people to remember who settled the land; or
- I wonder what it was like for all of Caleb's children to have so many brothers and sisters! or
- I want to go visit the towns that my ancestors founded.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:42–50a in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The storyteller talks about the **sons**, or **descendants**, of Caleb. Use the same word or phrase for sons as you used in previous passages when it means descendants, or all the sons and grandsons and the continuing children of someone. Sometimes the storyteller talks about individual sons of a father, and at that time, you can use the word you have chosen for a male child of a father. For more information, refer to "sons" and "descendants" in the Master Glossary.

Caleb was a brother of Jerahmeel. **Mesha**, Caleb's firstborn son, was the father of **Ziph**, and Caleb's son **Mareshah** was the father of **Hebron**. The sons of **Hebron** were **Korah**, **Tappuah, Rekem**, and **Shema**. Be sure to translate the names Caleb and Jerahmeel the same way that you did in previous passages. The name Mesha means "safety." The name Ziph means "flowing." The name Mareshah means "place at the top." The name Hebron means "friendship." The name Korah means "smooth." The name Tappuah means "apple tree." The name Rekem means "multi-colored." The name Shema means "a sound."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the names of these descendants of Caleb. Will you translate the names according to their meaning, or will you translate them to sound the same as the original names? Pause this audio here.

Shema was the father of **Raham**, who was the father of **Jorkeam**. Rekem was the father of **Shammai**, who was the father of **Maon**. Maon was the father of **Beth Zur**. The name **Raham** means "to have mercy." The name **Jorkeam** probably means "the people are green" in the sense that "the people are growing or spreading." The name **Shammai** means "my name has been heard." The name **Maon** means "place to live." The name **Beth Zur** means "house of rock."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the names of these descendants of Caleb. Pause this audio here.

Ephah, Caleb's **concubine**, was the mother of **Haran**, **Moza**, and **Gazez**. Haran also had a son named Gazez. Be sure to translate concubine the same way that you have in previous passages. The name Ephah means "dark." The name Haran means "dry." The name Moza could mean "to go out." The name Gazez means "one who shears sheep."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate these names. Pause this audio here.

The sons of **Jahdai** were called **Regem**, **Jotham**, **Geshan**, **Pelet**, **Ephah**, and **Shaaph**. The name Jahdai probably means "Yahweh leads." The name Regem means "pile of stones." The name Jotham means "Yahweh is perfect." The name Geshan means "strong." The name Pelet means "escape." The name Ephah means "darkness." The name Shaaph might mean "to desire."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate these names. Pause this audio here.

Maacah, Caleb's concubine, was the mother of **Sheber** and **Tirhanah**. Maacah was also the mother of **Shaaph**, the father of **Madmannah**, and of **Sheba**, the father of **Macbenah** and **Gibea**. The name Maacah means "to press down." The name Sheber means "hope." We are not certain what the name Tirhanah means, but it might mean "kindness." The name Shaaph might mean "to desire." The name Madmannah means "manure pit." The name Sheba means "false." The name Macbenah means "a belt or a cloak." The name Gibea means "hill."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate these names. Pause this audio here.

Caleb also had a daughter named **Acsah**. The name Acsah means "anklet," which is a piece of jewelry that people wore on their ankle.

Stop here and look at a picture of an anklet. Discuss these questions: In your culture, what do you call a chain or piece of jewelry that someone wears around the ankle? Could you use this word as a name for Caleb's daughter? If not, how will you translate the name of Caleb's daughter?

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 2:42–50a

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (942 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (8.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 2:50b–55

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 2:50b-55 and put it in your hearts.

1 Chronicles 2:50b–55

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:50b-55 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:50b-55 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller of the Book of Chronicles continued to tell us about the descendants of Caleb. In this passage, the storyteller focuses on telling us about the descendants of Caleb's son Hur. Hur was the oldest son of Caleb's wife Ephrathah. Caleb married Ephrathah after his wife Azubah died, so Hur was not Caleb's firstborn son.

In this passage, the storyteller uses the word "father" not only to describe relationships between people but also to describe people who founded cities. Because of this, when you listened to different translations of this passage, you might have heard the speaker say "Shobal was the father of Kiriath Jearim" or "Shobal was the founder of Kiriath Jearim." Both of these ways of saying it mean the same thing: Shobal was the Israelite who started living in Kiriath Jearim.

Several of Hur's descendants founded important towns in the territory of the tribe of Judah. Hur's son Shobal founded Kiriath Jearim, his son Salma founded Bethlehem, and his son Hareph founded the town of Beth Gader. Bible scholars know where Kiriath Jearim and Bethlehem were located, but they do not know where Beth Gader was located.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel. Look for the towns of Kiriath Jearim and Bethlehem. You might want to continue to look at this map during the discussion. Pause this audio here.

Kiriath Jearim is about 13 kilometers northwest of Jerusalem. This town once belonged to the Gibeonites, one of the Canaanite tribes. However, the Israelites eventually went and lived in this town. Bethlehem is located about 10 kilometers south of Jerusalem. Bethlehem was the hometown of King David. Bible scholars do not know anything about the town of Beth Gader. No one mentions this town anywhere else in the Bible. The storyteller of Chronicles might have assumed that his audience knew why Beth Gader was important, but modern audiences do not.

The descendants of Shobal lived in and around Kiriath Jearim. Shobal's descendants divided themselves into clans, or smaller groups of families. The storyteller of Chronicles tells us that these clans were known as the Ithrites, the Puthites, the Shumathites, and the Mishraites.

Apparently, the descendants of Shobal grew to large enough numbers that they needed to start new towns. Some of the descendants of Shobal lived in two towns that people called Zorah and Eshtaol. These two towns were right next to each other, just a few kilometers west of Kiriath Jearim.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the location of Kiriath Jearim, Zorah, and Eshtaol. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, we hear some information that is difficult to understand in the original language. Whenever this is the case, you might hear different explanations when you listen to different translations of the Bible. You might even hear some different versions of names. All this means is that Bible scholars are not sure what the storyteller meant to say in the original language.

1 Chronicles 2:50b–55

For example, Bible scholars are not sure if the name “Haroeh” refers to a person, a clan, or a town. It is the same for the name “Manahath.” The storyteller of Chronicles probably assumed that his audience knew what these names refer to, but Bible scholars now do not know for sure.

Salma was the founder of Bethlehem. Salma’s descendants lived in that town and the surrounding area. Some of Salma’s descendants lived in a town people called Netophah, which is located eight kilometers southeast of Bethlehem.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the location of Bethlehem and Netophah. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller of Chronicles tells us that the descendants of Salma include “Atroth Beth Joab” and half the Manahathites. Bible scholars are not sure if the words “Atroth Beth Joab” refer to a person, a clan, or a place. Bible scholars also do not know if the Manahathites were a clan or the people who lived in a town.

In this passage, the storyteller tells us that some of the descendants of Salma were scribes. Scribes were important and respected people in Israelite culture. People hired a scribe because the scribe was able to read and write. A scribe’s most important job was to make perfect copies of the Old Testament books. But Israelite scribes probably did other jobs too. Scribes might have copied other written documents, taught the Old Testament to the Israelites, worked in the temple or the house of the king, and even served as elders, judges, or advisers. In this passage, the storyteller of Chronicles tells us that there were entire families who had members working as scribes.

Stop here and discuss these questions: In your culture, how do you describe a person who is able to read and write? How common is it in your culture that a person is able to read and write? What jobs require someone to be able to read and write? What jobs can you think of in which a person does things similar to what a scribe does? Pause this audio here.

The families of scribes lived in a town called Jabez. Bible scholars do not agree on where the town of Jabez was located. Some scholars think Jabez was probably close to Bethlehem.

The last section of this passage is very difficult to understand in the original language. Bible scholars do not agree on what the word “Kenites” means here, who Hammath was, or what “house of Rechab” means. You might have heard different translations of this verse when you listened to different translations of the Bible.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:50b-55 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller lists the sons of Hur and the names of the towns the sons founded.

In the second scene: The storyteller lists the names of the clans descended from Shobal, as well as the names of some towns where the clans lived.

In the third scene: The storyteller lists names of the clans descended from Salma.

The storyteller does not list any descendants of Hareph.

The characters in this passage are:

- Hur, Caleb, Ephrathah, Shobal, Salma, Hareph
- The people of Haroeh and Manahath; the Ithrites, Puthites, Shumathites, Mishraites, Zorathites, Eshtaolites
- And the people of Netophath, Atroth Beth Joab, Manahath, the Zorites, Tirathites, Shimeathites, Sucathites, Kenites, Recabites, and Hammath

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage’s setting:

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In the first scene, the storyteller lists three sons of Hur named Shobal, Salma, and Hareph. Each son founded a town. Shobal was the founder of Kiriath Jearim, Salma was the founder of Bethlehem, and Hareph was the founder of Beth Gader.

Stop here and look again at the map that shows the locations of Kiriath Jearim and Bethlehem. Keep looking at the map during this discussion. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and decide how you will translate that each of these sons was the father of a town or the founder of the town. Pause this audio here.

If you have translated the book of Joshua, you might remember that Kiriath Jearim belonged to the Gibeonites, who were a Canaanite tribe. The Gibeonites tricked the Israelites so that the Israelites agreed not to kill the Gibeonites. As part of this agreement, the Gibeonites became the slaves of the Israelites. This means that other people had already built the city of Kiriath Jearim before the Israelites moved there. When the storyteller of Chronicles says that Shobal was the founder of Kiriath Jearim, this probably means that Shobal was the leader of the first group of Israelites to start living in that town. The Israelites might have lived alongside the Gibeonites, or it is possible that the Israelites lived in their own section of the town. But the storyteller gives Shobal the credit for being the first person to start an Israelite settlement in Kiriath Jearim. Kiriath Jearim became an important town in Judah. Before King David built the temple, people kept the ark of the covenant in Kiriath Jearim for about 20 years.

Bethlehem was a small but very important town in Israel. Rachel, one of the four wives of Jacob, was buried in Bethlehem. Bethlehem was also the hometown of King David. It is likely that the original audience of the Book of Chronicles would have heard the prophecy about Bethlehem that Yahweh gave to the prophet Micah. The words of the prophecy are, “Yahweh says, ‘Bethlehem Ephrathah, you are one of the smallest towns of Judah, but out of you I will bring a ruler for Israel, whose family line goes back to ancient times.’” Micah probably lived in the eighth century B.C., about 250 years after King David was alive, so this prophecy does not refer to David or to Solomon. It refers to a ruler who had not yet been born when the storyteller of Chronicles wrote his book.

In the second scene, some names refer to clans, while other terms refer to people who came from a town.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your language, how do you refer to someone who comes from a particular town? Pause this audio here.

The first statement in this scene is difficult to understand in the original language. It clearly says that Shobal had descendants, but the words that follow are not typical names. The word “Haroeh” means “the prophet.” Bible scholars do not know if this is a person’s name, a title for a person, or the name of a place. Most translations of the Bible translate this word in a way so that it sounds like the original word, but some translations say “the people of Haroeh.”

The next group of people in this list of descendants is “half the Manahathites.” Bible scholars do not agree on what “half the Manahathites” means. Scholars do not even agree on what the correct pronunciation of the word “Manahathites” should be. Some Bible scholars think Manahath was a town, and for this reason, you might have heard some Bible translations say “half of the people who lived in Manahath.”

Fortunately, the rest of this scene is easier to understand. Most Bible scholars think that the words Ithrites, Puthites, Shumathites, and Mishraites refer to people who were descended from ancestors named Jether, Puth, Shuma, and Mishra. These four clans, or family groups, probably lived in Kiriath Jearim. In contrast, the words Zorathites and Eshtaolites refer to people who lived in the towns called Zorah and Eshtaol.

Stop here and remember what you previously discussed. How did you decide to refer to a group of people who are descended from a particular ancestor? What is the best way in your language to refer to the descendants of Jether, Puth, Shuma, and Mishra? How did you decide to refer to a group of people who live in a specific town? What is the best way in your language to refer to the people who lived in the towns of Zorah and Eshtaol? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller tells us about the descendants of Salma. Many of these people lived in Bethlehem or the area surrounding Bethlehem. Netophah was a town eight kilometers from Bethlehem.

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The words “Atroth Beth Joab” mean “Crown of the House of Joab.” Bible scholars do not know if this is the name of a person, a title for a person, or the name of a town. For this reason, most Bible translations translate this phrase to sound like it does in the original language.

Stop here and discuss the best way to say “Atroth Beth Joab” in your language. Pause this audio here.

The next group of people in this list of descendants of Salma is “half of the Manahathites.” Bible scholars do not agree on what this means. Some scholars think that Manahath was a town. These scholars interpret this entire passage to mean that half of the people who lived in Manahath were descendants of Shobal and that the other half were descendants of Salma. For this reason, some translations of this verse say “the other half of the Manahathites” or that these descendants of Salma were one of two clans that lived in the town of Manahath.

The Zorites are the next group in this list of descendants. Bible scholars are not sure if this refers to a clan of descendants of Salma, to the name of a town, or both.

Fortunately, it is clear that the next group of descendants, the scribes who are descended from Salma, consist of three clans: the Tirathites, Shimeathites and Sucathites. A scribe was a person who could read and write. In Israel, a scribe’s most important job was to make perfect copies of the Old Testament, especially the first five books, which they sometimes called the Books of Moses or the Book of the Law. Because the scribes spent so much of their time reading and writing the Old Testament, they understood it very well, and so scribes were also religious teachers.

Stop here and discuss what the best way is to refer to the Tirathites, Shimeathites, and Sucathites in your language. Pause this audio here.

The last section of this passage is very hard to understand in the original language. We suggest you use this statement as a model for translation: “These were the Kenites who were descendants of Hammath, the founder of the city of Beth Recab.”

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:50b-55 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Hur, Caleb, Ephrathah, Shobal, Salma, Hareph
- The people of Haroeh and Manahath; the Ithrites, Puthites, Shumathites, Mishraites, Zorathites, Eshtaolites
- And the people of Netophath, Atroth Beth Joab, Manahath, the Zorites, Tirathites, Shimeathites, Sucathites, Kenites, Recabites, and Hammath

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group in your language. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite listening to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you could also play the audio recording out loud.

While you do this, think about how the ancient Israelites might have felt as they listened to these lists of names. Imagine that you are an ancient Israelite and a member of the tribe of Judah. You live in a village close to Jerusalem. Your family has worked very hard to make a living in your village. Your people live in some of the towns the storyteller mentions in this passage, but foreigners control some of these towns, and your people cannot live in them. This section of the Book of Chronicles reminds you of your people’s important ancestors. It reminds you that your ancestors did important things in this land. When you hear about the town of Bethlehem, you remember King David and his son, Solomon, who became Israel’s two greatest kings. You know about Micah’s

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prophecy of a future ruler who will come from Bethlehem, and you wonder if that promised ruler will become the ruler during your lifetime, or maybe during the lifetime of your children. When you hear about the scribes who were descendants of Salma, you feel grateful for them because they worked hard to write down Micah's prophecy and teach it to all of your people. Because of this, your people can have hope that a better future is coming and that all your hard work to survive is worth it.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should read or recite this passage a second time. At certain points, pause and ask each person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" Each person should answer what they would be feeling or thinking. Then continue reading or reciting the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the passage and possible responses.

The descendants of Hur, the firstborn of Caleb's wife Ephrathah, were Shobal, the founder of Kiriath Jearim; Salma, the founder of Bethlehem; and Hareph, the founder of Beth Gader.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am impressed that Hur was the ancestor of so many important Israelites; or
- I feel proud that our people established these cities; or
- I feel ashamed that our people have not regained all of our territory.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- It is important to remember who founded the town of Bethlehem, the hometown of King David; or
- I wish our people were as strong now as they were back then; or
- I am so glad that we are learning this important history about our people.

Continue reading or reciting the passage.

Shobal, the founder of Kiriath Jearim, was the ancestor of Haroeh, half of the Manahathites, and of the following clans of Kiriath Jearim: the Ithrites, Puthites, Shumathites, and Mishraites. The people of the towns of Zorah and Eshtaol were members of these clans.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel sad when I think about how people killed our ancestors and drove them out of their towns; or
- I hope that one day our people will be able to take back all of our lost territory; or
- I feel honored to teach our people this important information about our ancestors.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I know some people from these clans, and I do not like those people; or
- I wonder if our people will ever grow large and strong again; or
- I want to honor my ancestors by remembering how they founded the towns and cities around here.

Continue reading or reciting the passage.

The descendants of Salma, the founder of Bethlehem, were the Netophathites, Atroth Beth Joab, half the Manahathites, the Zorites, and the clans of scribes who lived in the town of Jabez. These were the Kenites who were descendants of Hammath, the founder of the city of Beth-Recab.

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Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I wonder what it was like to grow up in Bethlehem, the hometown of King David! or
- I am glad that the scribes worked so hard to make copies of God’s law and God’s prophecies so we could hear them today; or
- I hope my people realize how important this information is.

Ask the people playing the ancient Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I remember that Salma was the ancestor of King David; or
- I am impressed that Salma’s descendants were not only the kings of Judah but also scribes too; or
- I wish Yahweh would hurry up and send a ruler to free us from the power of these foreigners!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 2:50b-55 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Remember that sometimes the word **sons** in the original language refers to the male children of a parent, and sometimes it refers to a group of **descendants**. In this passage, the “sons of Hur” refers to Hur’s male children. However, throughout the rest of the passage, the same word refers to the descendants. Translate sons, or descendants, in the same way you have translated in previous passages, based on your choices there. For more information about sons and descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

Remember that sometimes “father” in this passage may mean the founder of a town. Remember how you decided to translate “father” when it means “founder of a town,” and translate it here in the same way that you did before.

Stop here and, if needed, remind each other how you would like to translate “father” when it means “founder of a town.” Pause this audio here.

Hur was the oldest son of **Caleb**’s wife **Ephrathah**. Hur’s son Shobal founded the town of Kiriath Jearim, his son Salma founded the town of Bethlehem, and his son Hareph founded the town of Beth Gader. Be sure to translate the personal names Caleb, Ephrathah, Hur, and Salma the same way you did in previous passages. If you have already translated books that contain the names of the towns Kiriath Jearim and Bethlehem, be sure to also translate those names the same way you did in previous passages.

The name **Shobal** means “overflowing.” The name **Hareph** means “harvest.” The name **Beth Gader** means “house of the wall.”

Stop here and discuss how you will translate these names. Pause this audio here.

Shobal, the founder of Kiriath Jearim, was the ancestor of the people of Haroeh, of half the inhabitants of Manahath, and of the following clans of people who lived in Kiriath Jearim: the Ithrites, Puthites, Shumathites, and Mishraites. The people who lived in Zorah and Eshtaol were members of these clans. A clan is a group of related families that is smaller than a tribe.

Stop here and remind each other of the previous discussion you had about groups of related families. Decide what word is best to translate the word **clan**. Pause this audio here.

The name **Haroeh** means “the prophet.” The name **Manahath** probably means “resting place.” The word **Ithrites** means “people of Jether.” The name **Jether** means “excellence.” The word **Puthites** means “people of Puth.” The name **Puth** means “hinge.” The word **Shumathites** means “people of Shuma.” The name **Shuma** means “highly exalted.” The word **Mishraites** means “people of Mishra.” The name **Mishra** means “to stretch out.” We are not sure what the name **Zorah** means. The name **Eshtaol** might mean “to ask.”

Stop here and discuss how you will translate these names. Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 2:50b–55

The descendants of **Salma**, the founder of **Bethlehem**, were the **Netophathites**, **Atroth Beth Joab**, half the **Manahathites**, the **Zorites**, and the clans of scribes who lived in the town of Jabez: the **Tirathites**, the **Shimeathites**, and the **Sucathites.** These were the **Kenites** who were descendants of **Hammath**, the founder of the city of **Beth-Recab**. The name Netophah means "to drip." Distilling is part of the process for making alcoholic drinks. The name Manahath has a similar meaning to the word "to rest." The word Zorite means "people of Zorah." The name Zorah might mean "wasp."

Stop here and discuss how you will translate these names. Pause this audio here.

A scribe was someone who was an expert in copying and writing documents. In Israel, a scribe's most important job was to study and copy the Old Testament. For this reason, the scribes were often religious leaders. But a scribe might also do other kinds of work that required the ability to read and write. If you have already translated the book of Matthew, Mark, or Luke into your language, then you have already translated the word for scribe. It might be helpful to go back and listen to a part of one of those books to remind yourselves how you translated this word. If you have it in your language, go back and listen to Matthew chapter 2, Mark chapter 7, or Luke chapter 15. You can find the word scribe near the beginning of each of these chapters.

Stop here and listen to your translation of one of these passages from the New Testament.

Look up scribe or "teacher of the law" in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. If not, decide what word you will use for **scribe**. Pause this audio here.

The word **Tirathite** means "people of Tirath." The name **Tirath** means "gate." The word **Shimeathite** means "people of **Shimea**." The name Shimea means "he who hears" or "announcement." The word **Sucathite** means "people of **Sucath**." The name Sucath might mean "something with branches." The word **Kenite** means "people of **Cain**." The name Cain means "to get something." The name **Hammath** means "hot springs." The name **Beth-Racab** means "house of the rider," as in a person who rides on a horse.

Stop here and discuss how you will translate these names.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 2:50b–55

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (956 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 3:1–9

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 3:1–9 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:1–9 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, you heard more of a list of the family line of Judah. The list included ancestors of David.

This passage gives a list of David's children, including David's wives, his sons, and one of his daughters. This information is important to the people of Israel because God had promised David that one of his descendants, or a member of David's family, would rule over Israel forever. This passage lists all of David's sons who could have been king after David.

The list has two groups. The first group contains David's wives and the sons they had while David reigned from Hebron. David ruled over Judah from Hebron for 7.5 years. The second group contains the sons David had while he ruled from Jerusalem. This group also contains one more wife and a daughter. After Hebron, David ruled from Jerusalem for 33 years.

Stop here and look at a map that includes the city of Hebron and the city of Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

The first group of David's wives and their sons shows a pattern. The list tells the order in which the sons were born, the name of each son, and the name of each son's mother. For David's first three sons, the list also includes the birthplace of each son's mother. This list probably has the first son born to each of David's wives while they lived in Hebron, but it does not include all of David's sons born in Hebron. This list may have helped people understand which of David's sons might become king when David died. This list is very similar to a list you can find in a previous passage in 2 Samuel.

David's first son was Amnon. Amnon's mother was named Ahinoam. Ahinoam was from Jezreel. Jezreel was a valley south of Galilee and north of the hill country of Ephraim. As David's first son, Amnon could have been the next king of Israel after David, but you may remember that Amnon's brother Absalom sent servants to murder Amnon before Amnon could be king.

1 Chronicles 3:1–9

David's second son was named Daniel, but in a previous passage, people called this son Chileab. This son may have had two names. This son's mother was named Abigail. Abigail was from the city of Carmel, which was south of the city of Hebron. The Bible does not tell us anything else about Daniel. David's third son was named Absalom. Absalom's mother was named Maacah. Maacah was the daughter of Talmai, who was the king of Geshur. Geshur was a small kingdom in Syria located northeast of the Sea of Galilee between Bashan and Hermon. This is not the same Geshur that David and his soldiers raided in a previous story. David may have married Maacah to make the region of Geshur his ally. We do not know anything else about Maacah, but we do know that Absalom tried to become the next king after David. However, you may remember that someone killed Absalom before he could take David's place as king permanently.

Stop here and look at a map as a group: Locate Hebron, Jezreel, Carmel, and Geshur. Pause this audio here.

David's fourth son was named Adonijah. Adonijah's mother was named Haggith. The Bible does not tell us anything else about Haggith. In another book of the Bible, we learn the story about Adonijah's attempt to become king after David. Adonijah does not succeed. David's fifth son was named Shephatiah. Shephatiah's mother was named Abital. The Bible only tells us that Shephatiah fights as a warrior alongside his father, David. The Bible does not tell us anything else about Abital. David's sixth son was named Ithream. Ithream's mother was named Eglah, and she was another one of David's wives. The Bible does not tell us anything else about Ithream or Eglah. David had these six sons with his wives while he ruled from Hebron for 7.5 years.

Then, David moved to the city of Jerusalem. David ruled from Jerusalem for 33 years. Now the passage gives a second group of David's children who were born while David ruled from Jerusalem. This group does not list sons and mothers in the same pattern as the first group. In this group, we know the mother of four of the sons. We know David had nine more sons as well, but we do not know the mother of each of those sons.

David's wives gave birth to the following children in Jerusalem. Bathsheba had Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, and Solomon. People also call Bathsheba by the name of Bathshua, and her father was Ammiel. You will remember the story about David and Bathsheba from a previous passage. The Bible calls Shammua by the name of Shimea in other places. The Bible does not tell us anything else about Shammua or Shobab. However, Luke, who wrote the book of Luke in the New Testament, lists Nathan as an ancestor of Jesus. Solomon was Bathsheba's second son with David.

David also had other children while he ruled from Jerusalem. These children were Ibhar, Elishua, Eliphelet, Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia, Elishama, Eliada, and Eliphelet. In other lists of David's children, some of these names are slightly different. We do not know exactly why or how this happened. David had these nine sons while he lived and ruled from the city of Jerusalem. The sons the storyteller listed in this passage are David's sons with his primary wives. However, David also had children with David's concubines. A concubine is a secondary wife who has less value than a primary wife.

The last child of David in this passage is Tamar, David's daughter and the sister of David's sons. You will remember Tamar's story from a previous story. Most of the time, people do not include daughters in a list of descendants, but the storyteller probably mentions Tamar because the Bible tells Tamar's story, and that story impacts who could become the next king after David.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: David had sons with his wives while he ruled from the city of Hebron for 7.5 years.

In the second scene: After David ruled from Hebron, he ruled from the city of Jerusalem for 33 years. David had more children while he lived in Jerusalem. David also had children with his concubines while he lived in Jerusalem.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- David's sons born in Hebron: Amnon, Daniel, Absalom, Adonijah, Shephatiah, Ithream
- David's wives: Ahinoam, Abigail, Maacah, Haggith, Abital, Eglah
- David's sons born in Jerusalem: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon, Ibhar, Elishua, Eliphelet, Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia, Elishama, Eliada, Eliphelet
- Bathsheba
- And Tamar

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, we hear a list of David's wives and the firstborn sons they had in Hebron. This list gives information about who was in David's family and how David's family continued to grow stronger.

David had sons with his wives while David ruled from the city of Hebron. The list shows a pattern that lists the birth order of David's son, the son's name, and the mother's name. For David's first three wives, the list gives some more information about the mother.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you make lists of people in your culture? Tell an example of a list of people, and pay attention to how you make that list. Do you use a certain order or pattern? Pause this audio here.

David's first son was named Amnon. Amnon's mother was Ahinoam, and she was from the valley of Jezreel. David married Ahinoam before he moved to Hebron, but Ahinoam did not have her son Amnon until they lived in Hebron.

Stop here and look at a map that includes Hebron, Jezreel, Carmel, Geshur, and Jerusalem. Keep the map out to remind you as you hear about David's other wives. Pause this audio here.

David's second son was named Daniel. Daniel's mother was Abigail. Abigail was from the town of Carmel. Because we do not hear about Daniel later when the other sons are trying to become king after David, Daniel probably died at a young age. In other parts of the Bible, lists of David's sons call Daniel by the name of Chileab. Therefore, Daniel may have two names.

David's third son was named Absalom. Absalom's mother was Maacah. Maacah was the daughter of King Talmai of Geshur.

David's fourth son was named Adonijah. Adonijah's mother was Haggith. David's fifth son was named Shephatiah. Shephatiah's mother was Abital. David's sixth son was named Ithream. Ithream's mother was Eglah, and Eglah was another one of David's wives.

David and his wives had these six sons while they all lived in the city of Hebron. David ruled from Hebron for 7.5 years.

Stop here as a group and listen to the passages from 2 Samuel 3:2–5 that contain the same list of David's wives and children in Hebron. Listen to how you translated the previous list to make sure you translate the names the same way. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, after David reigned from Hebron, David and his family moved to Jerusalem. David ruled from the city of Jerusalem for 33 years. David's wives had children while they all lived in Jerusalem.

David's wife Bathsheba had four children: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, and Solomon. Bathsheba was the daughter of a man named Ammiel. Solomon was actually David and Bathsheba's second son. Here, Solomon is probably listed last either because he followed David as the next king of Israel or because his place in the list of David's children puts Solomon in the center of the list. The name at the center of the list has the same number of names before it and after it. In this culture, the name at the center of the list was the most important name.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How do you talk about important descendants in your culture? Give an example of a list of descendants, and pay attention to the people you emphasize. How do you know which descendants are important? Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 3:1–9

David had nine more sons while he lived in Jerusalem. These sons were Ibhar, Elishua, Eliphelet, Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia, Elishama, Eliada, and another Eliphelet. David had these nine sons in Jerusalem. The Bible does not tell us which of David's wives had each of these sons, but we do know that David's primary wives had these sons.

David had other children with his concubines. A concubine was a legitimate secondary wife who had a lower status than David's primary wives. David's sons from his concubines would not have been able to be king after David.

This list of David's family ends with Tamar, David's daughter and the sister of David's sons. Most of the time, lists of descendants only include sons, but the storyteller may list Tamar here because her story is important in David's family.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- David's sons born in Hebron: Amnon, Daniel, Absalom, Adonijah, Shephatiah, Ithream
- David's wives: Ahinoam, Abigail, Maacah, Haggith, Abital, Eglah
- David's sons born in Jerusalem: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon, Ibhar, Elishua, Eliphelet, Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia, Elishama, Eliada, Eliphelet
- Bathsheba
- And Tamar

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If this section is too difficult to remember, you may listen to an audio recording again.

While you do this, think about how the Israelites may have felt as they heard this list. King David was a very important part of the Israelites' history. God promised David that someone from David's family line would rule over Israel forever. Each name in David's family line reminded the Israelites that God would be faithful to keep God's promises. The Israelites also remembered the stories about David's sons. The Israelites knew how God remained faithful even when David's sons were not faithful to God.

When they heard the names of these people, the ancient Israelites probably thought about the promises God kept. The Israelites might have thought about how David's sons impacted the community of Israel and the spiritual life of the nation.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should recite this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask, "What are you feeling or thinking?" about a particular character. Then answer what that character would be feeling or thinking. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

1 Chronicles 3:1–9

This passage gives a list of some of David's children. David had six sons with his wives while he ruled from the city of Hebron. David's first son was Absalom, whose mother was Ahinoam. Ahinoam was from the valley of Jezreel. David's second son was named Daniel, and Daniel's mother was Abigail. Abigail was from the city of Carmel. David's third son was Absalom, whose mother was Maacah. Maacah was from Geshur, and her father was King Talmai of Geshur.

Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that Yahweh gave me so many sons to strengthen my family; or
- I feel hopeful that my strong family will help me rule over all of Israel.

Continue reciting the names.

David's fourth son was Adonijah. Adonijah's mother was Haggith. David's fifth son was Shephatiah, whose mother was Abital. David's sixth son was Ithream, and Ithream's mother was Eglah, who was another one of David's wives.

David and his wives had these sons while they lived in Hebron.

Pause the reciting. Ask the people playing David's sons born in Hebron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are proud to be sons of King David; or
- We are hopeful that one of us will be king after our father David.

Continue reciting the names.

After David lived in Hebron, David and his family moved to Jerusalem. David ruled from Jerusalem for 33 years. David's wives had more children in Jerusalem. David's wife Bathsheba had four sons named Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, and Solomon. Bathsheba's father was Ammiel. David's other wives had nine other sons in Jerusalem named Ibhar, Elishua, Eliphelet, Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia, Elishama, Eliada, and Eliphelet. These were David's sons by David's wives. David also had children with his concubines. David's sons had a sister named Tamar.

Pause the reciting. Ask the people playing David's sons born in Jerusalem, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are confident in our status as David's sons; or
- We are proud to be a part of the line of David.

Ask the people playing David's wives, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We celebrate the many sons we have given David; or
- We trust David to provide for our children.

Ask the person playing Bathsheba, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy that my son Solomon will be the next king; or
- I know my sons are important to David's family because God will use these sons to keep his promise to David.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

David had **sons** with his wives while he ruled from the city of Hebron. David was the second king of Israel. In this passage, a son is the male child of his parents. Use the same word or phrase for son as you used in previous passages. For more information on David and son, refer to the Master Glossary.

David's **firstborn son** was Amnon, whose mother was Ahinoam from Jezreel. The firstborn son was the first male child born to his parents. Use the same word or phrase for "firstborn son" as you used in previous passages.

1 Chronicles 3:1–9

David's second son was Daniel, whose mother was Abigail from Carmel. David's third son was Absalom, whose mother was Maacah. Maacah's father was **King** Talmai of Geshur. A king is someone who rules over a city or a territory. Look up king in the Master Glossary for more information.

David's fourth son was Adonijah, whose mother was Haggith. David's fifth son was Shephatiah, whose mother was Abital, and David's sixth son was Ithream, whose mother was Eglah, another one of David's wives.

Stop here and discuss how you translated the names of **Amnon**, **Absalom**, and **Adonijah**. Do you like the way you translated the names from 2 Samuel 3:2–5, or do you want to change them? Pause this audio here.

These were the sons David had while he lived in Hebron for 7.5 years. Then, David ruled from **Jerusalem** for 33 years. King David established the city of Jerusalem as the capital of Israel. For more information on Jerusalem, refer to the Master Glossary.

In Jerusalem, David's wives had more children. Bathsheba had Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, and Solomon. David's other wives had Ibhar, Elishua, Eliphelet, Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia, Elishama, Eliada, and Eliphelet. These nine were David's sons with his wives.

Stop here and discuss how you translated the names **Bathsheba** and **Solomon**. Pause this audio here.

David also had children with his **concubines**. A concubine was a legitimate wife who had a lower status than David's other wives. Use the same word or phrase for concubine as you used in previous passages.

David's sons also had a sister named Tamar.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 3:1–9

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (434 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.7 MB)

- Filling the Gaps (1.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (661 KB)

1 Chronicles 3:10–16

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 3:10–16 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:10–16 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, you heard a list of David's sons and David's wives. David had six sons while David ruled from the city of Hebron for 7.5 years. David had nine sons and his daughter Tamar while David ruled as king from the city of Jerusalem for 33 years.

In this passage, the storyteller gives a list of David's descendants through the line of David's son Solomon. After David died, Solomon reigned as king over Israel and Judah. This passage tells the line of Solomon's descendants who reigned over Judah for about 300 years. The list begins with Solomon and his son Rehoboam and ends with Zedekiah, who ruled over Judah during the time when another country, Babylon, forced the people of Judah to leave the land of Israel and to move to Babylon. This passage only tells the men who succeeded or became king after the previous king died. It does not list every descendant of King Solomon.

Stop here and look at a map that includes the northern kingdom of Israel and the southern kingdom of Judah. Locate the country of Babylon. Pause this audio here.

This list shows a pattern. The storyteller begins by naming King Solomon and Solomon's son, Rehoboam. The storyteller then tells the name of Rehoboam's son, Abijah, followed by the phrase, "his son." The storyteller lists 14 generations of fathers and sons in this way. The storyteller then tells the four sons of Josiah. The storyteller ends by listing the men who succeeded Jehoiakim, one of Josiah's sons, as king.

Solomon's son Rehoboam became king after Solomon died. However, Rehoboam became king over only Judah, the southern part of Israel. After Solomon died, the country of Israel broke into two parts. The northern part of the country contained 10 of the tribes of Israel, and they had their own king. The southern part of Israel contained two of the tribes of Israel, and their king was Rehoboam.

Rehoboam's successor, or the next man who became king, was Rehoboam's son Abijah. In another book of the Bible, Abijah, the king of Judah, fights against the king of Israel. Abijah asks Yahweh to help him, and Yahweh helps Abijah win the battle against the king of Israel. Abijah had a son named Asa. Asa reminded the people of Judah to come back and to worship Yahweh instead of worshiping other gods. Asa had a son named Jehoshaphat. Jehoshaphat loved and worshiped Yahweh and led the people to worship Yahweh as well.

Jehoshaphat had a son named Jehoram. In some places in the Bible, people call this son Joram. Jehoram did not worship Yahweh and did not lead the people of Judah to worship Yahweh. Jehoram had a son named Ahaziah. Ahaziah was Jehoram's youngest son, and Ahaziah became king because people had killed all of Jehoram's other sons. Ahaziah also did not worship Yahweh, and people killed Ahaziah. Ahaziah had a son named Joash. Joash

1 Chronicles 3:10–16

became king when he was seven years old and led the people of Judah to worship Yahweh, but later Joash stopped worshiping Yahweh.

Joash had a son named Amaziah. Amaziah worshiped Yahweh for a few years but later stopped. Amaziah had a son named Azariah. In other places in the Bible, people call this son Uzziah. This son may have had two names, or there may be two ways to spell his name. Uzziah worshiped Yahweh but did not always obey Yahweh. Uzziah had a son named Jotham. Jotham worshiped Yahweh. Jotham had a son named Ahaz. Ahaz did not worship Yahweh and led the people of Judah to worship idols. Ahaz had a son named Hezekiah. Hezekiah worshiped Yahweh and led the people of Judah to worship Yahweh. Hezekiah reminded the people to obey Yahweh's commands. Hezekiah had a son named Manasseh. Manasseh did not worship Yahweh at first, but later he turned back to Yahweh and led the people of Judah to worship Yahweh again. Manasseh had a son named Amon. Amon did not worship Yahweh. Amon had a son named Josiah. Josiah became king when he was eight years old and worshiped Yahweh. Josiah led the people of Judah to obey Yahweh's laws. Josiah died in a battle against Egypt.

After Josiah, the pattern of the list changes. Only four more kings reign over Judah after Josiah dies. The storyteller lists four sons of Josiah in their birth order. Josiah had a son named Johanan first. Josiah's second-born son was Jehoiakim. Josiah had his son Zedekiah third, and Josiah had his son Shallum fourth.

We do not know anything else about Johanan, and he never became king. Johanan may have died at a young age. After Josiah died, the people chose Shallum, Josiah's youngest son, to be king. People also called Shallum by the name Jehoahaz in other places in the Bible. However, because Israel had lost a battle to the country of Egypt, the king of Egypt made Jehoiakim king over Judah instead of Jehoiakim's brother, Shallum. Jehoiakim's original name was Eliakim, but the king of Egypt changed his name to Jehoiakim. We do not know if Jehoiakim died or if the king of Babylon took him as a prisoner, but we do know that Jehoiakim stopped being king of Judah.

Jehoiakim had a son named Jehoiachin. People also call this son Jeconiah or Coniah in other places in the Bible. Jehoiachin ruled over Judah as king for only three months before the ruler of Babylon made Jehoiachin go to Babylon as a prisoner. The last king to rule over Judah in the land before the people had to go to Babylon was Zedekiah. Because several kings ruled over Judah in a short time, we are not certain about Zedekiah's father. King Josiah had a son named Zedekiah, but he is probably not the king the storyteller listed here. The Zedekiah who became king is probably either Jehoiakim's son or Jehoiachin's son. This Zedekiah ruled Judah when the people from Babylon conquered Judah and took the people away from their land and to the land of Babylon.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Solomon had 14 descendants who succeeded him as king over Judah. Each king succeeded his father as king.

In the second scene: Josiah had four sons whom the storyteller listed in birth order. Josiah's son Jehoiakim had two men who succeeded him as king.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Solomon's descendants: Rehoboam, Abijah, Asa, Jehoshaphat, Jehoram, Ahaziah, Joash, Amaziah, Azariah, Jotham, Ahaz, Hezekiah, Manasseh, Amon
- Josiah
- Josiah's four sons: Johanan, Jehoiakim, Zedekiah, and Shallum
- And the kings who followed Jehoiakim: Jehoiachin and Zedekiah

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

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In scene one, Solomon had a son named Rehoboam. When Solomon died, the nation of Israel split into two kingdoms, one in the north and one in the south. People called the northern kingdom Israel, and it had 10 of the original tribes of Israel. People called the southern kingdom Judah, and it had two of the original tribes of Israel. The tribe of Judah was part of the kingdom of Judah. Yahweh had promised that someone from King David's family, who was from the tribe of Judah, would reign as king forever. So, the kings of Judah were part of Yahweh's promise to King David.

The passage lists 14 generations that followed Rehoboam, Solomon's son. Although the storyteller never calls these men a "king," the storyteller is giving the name of each son who became king when his father died. The passage moves in a pattern when it gives the name of a king and the phrase, "his son." This means that each name is the son of the previous name.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Give an example of a list of rulers from your country. Notice how you make the list. Is the list in the order that the people ruled? Is there a specific phrase you use to talk about how each ruler follows, one after the other? Pause this audio here.

Rehoboam had a son named Abijah. Abijah had a son named Asa. Asa had a son named Jehoshaphat. Jehoshaphat had a son named Jehoram. Jehoram had a son named Ahaziah. Ahaziah had a son named Joash. Joash had a son named Amaziah. Amaziah had a son named Azariah. Azariah had a son named Jotham. Jotham had a son named Ahaz. Ahaz had a son named Hezekiah. Hezekiah had a son named Manasseh. Manasseh had a son named Amon. Amon had a son named Josiah.

Even though each of these kings probably had other sons and daughters, this passage only gives the names of each man who became king after his father.

In the second scene, we no longer see the earlier pattern that listed sons who ruled over Judah. The pattern probably changes because, after Josiah, the pattern of who becomes the next king changes. Josiah had four sons, and the passage lists these sons in the order that they were born. Josiah had Johanan first, Jehoiakim second, Zedekiah third, and Shallum fourth. The passage probably lists all of Josiah's sons because more than one of his sons became king after Josiah.

Josiah's first son, Johanan, did not become king, and we do not know anything else about Johanan. When Josiah died, people chose Shallum, Josiah's youngest son, to be the next king. However, Josiah died in a battle against the country of Egypt. The king of Egypt decided he wanted a different king over Judah. The king of Egypt decided that Josiah's second-born son, Jehoiakim, should be Josiah's successor.

After Jehoiakim, only two men ruled over Judah before the Babylonians took all the people as prisoners to Babylon. Jehoiakim had a son named Jehoiachin, and Jehoiachin ruled over Judah for only three months before the king of Babylon took him as a prisoner. After Jehoiachin, a man named Zedekiah ruled Judah until the Babylonians destroyed the country of Judah. Zedekiah was probably either Jehoiakim's son or Jehoiachin's son.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you help people to understand the change in the pattern of who became the next king? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Solomon
- Solomon's descendants: Rehoboam, Abijah, Asa, Jehoshaphat, Jehoram, Ahaziah, Joash, Amaziah, Azariah, Jotham, Ahaz, Hezekiah, Manasseh, Amon
- Josiah

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- Josiah's four sons: Johanan, Jehoiakim, Zedekiah, and Shallum
- And the kings who followed Jehoiakim: Jehoiachin and Zedekiah

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Solomon had a son named Rehoboam, who had Abijah his son, who had Asa his son, who had Jehoshaphat his son, who had Jehoram his son, who had Ahaziah his son, who had Joash his son, who had Amaziah his son, who had Uzziah his son, who had Jotham his son, who had Ahaz his son, who had Hezekiah his son, who had Manasseh his son, who had Amon his son, who had Josiah his son. Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I rejoice that God gave me so many descendants to rule over Judah; or
- I am content to see that God kept his promise to keep someone from the line of my father David on the throne.

Ask the person playing Solomon's descendants, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We feel happy that God allowed us to be part of his promise to King David; or
- We are surprised that God not only used kings who worshiped God but also kings who worshiped idols as part of God's plan for God's people.

Continue to recite the passage. Josiah had four sons, whom the storyteller listed in the order that they were born. Josiah had Johanan first, Jehoiakim second, Zedekiah third, and Shallum fourth. Jehoiakim had a son named Jehoiachin. When the king of Babylon took Jehoiachin to be a prisoner in Babylon, Zedekiah became king. Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing Josiah's sons and Jehoiakim's successors, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- Even though we got to be part of Judah's royal family, we are sad that we could not keep Babylon from conquering our country; or
- We are glad that God preserved the line of David through our family.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Solomon had a **son** named **Rehoboam**. Rehoboam's name means "the number of people increased." Rehoboam had a son named **Abijah**, whose name means "Yahweh is my father." Abijah had a son named **Asa**, who had a son named **Jehoshaphat**, who had a son named **Jehoram**, whose name means "Yahweh is exalted." Jehoram had a son named **Ahaziah**, who had a son named **Joash**, who had a son named **Amaziah**, who had a son named **Azariah**, who had a son named **Jotham**, who had a son named **Ahaz**, who had a son named **Hezekiah**, who had a son named **Manasseh**, who had a son named **Amon**, who had a son named **Josiah**. In this passage, a son is a male child of his parents. Use the same word or phrase for son as you used in previous passages. For more information on son, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and listen to the way you have translated each name. If you have already translated these names in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase as you used before. Pause this audio here.

Josiah had four sons, whom the storyteller listed in their birth order. Josiah had Johanan first, Jehoiakim second, Zedekiah third, and Shallum fourth.

Jehoiakim had two successors, or men who followed him as king. Jehoiakim had a son named Jehoiachin. After Jehoiachin, Zedekiah became king over Judah. Remember that the storyteller does not use the word for "king" in this passage.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 3:10–16

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (489 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (1.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (991 KB)
- Speaking the Word (684 KB)

1 Chronicles 3:17–24

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 3:17–24 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:17–24 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

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1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:17–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, you heard a list of the descendants of King Solomon. These descendants include the men who ruled over Judah from the time of Solomon until the Babylonians conquered Judah and took many of the people of Judah to be prisoners in Babylon. The last king to rule over Judah before the people went to Babylon was Zedekiah.

This passage provides a list of the family line of Jehoiachin, who was king over Judah after his father Jehoiakim and right before Zedekiah. People also call Jehoiachin by the names Jeconiah or Coniah in other parts of the Bible. Jehoiachin ruled over Judah for three months until the Babylonians took him to Babylon as a prisoner. Jehoiachin had sons in Babylon who continued the line of King David's family. When the people recognized the descendants of King David, it reminded the people of Israel to trust God's promises to King David.

Jehoiachin had seven sons. Jehoiachin had Shealtiel, Malkiram, Pedaiah, Shenazzar, Jekamiah, Hoshama, and Nedabiah. The Bible does not tell us much about these sons.

Pedaiah had two sons, Zerubbabel and Shimei. However, other stories in the Bible call Zerubbabel's father Shealtiel, not Pedaiah. This may be because of cultural laws around marriage. If a woman's husband died before that man had a son, the husband's brother was supposed to marry the woman whose husband died. When that man and woman had their first son, that son would count as the son of the man who died. At the same time, if a man only had a daughter before he died, that daughter would marry a man who would keep the family line. Either of these could explain why we hear about different fathers of Zerubbabel. Or, the different fathers of Zerubbabel could be a mistake, or there could be more than one man named Zerubbabel. We do not know for certain which explanation is true, but other parts of the Bible talk about how Zerubbabel helped the people of Israel to begin rebuilding the city of Jerusalem and God's temple in the city. We also know that Zerubbabel is in the family line of King David and was a legitimate ruler over Israel. We do not know anything else about Shimei.

Stop here and look at a map as a group that includes Jerusalem and Babylon. Pause this audio here.

Zerubbabel had two sons, Meshullam and Hananiah. Zerubbabel also had a daughter, Shelomith. The passage then lists five other sons named Hashubah, Ohel, Berekiah, Hasadiah, and Jushab-Hesed. We do not know for certain which man had these five sons. They are probably sons of Meshullam, but they may have been Zerubbabel's sons born from a second wife. Or, Zerubbabel may have had Meshullam, Hananiah, and Shelomith in Babylon, and Zerubbabel may have had the other five sons when he returned to the land of Israel. These five sons also have names with important meanings that reminded the people of God's promises. The five sons are Hashubah, which means "Yahweh has considered," Ohel, which means "Yahweh's tent," Berekiah, which means "Yahweh blesses," Hasadiah, which means "Yahweh has had covenant love," and Jushab-Hesed, which means "covenant love returns." Yahweh had promised that, after the people of Israel had spent time in Babylon, they would return to the land Yahweh promised. The names of these sons reminded the people of Israel that Yahweh blesses and loves Yahweh's people.

Hananiah had at least two sons, Pelatiah and Jeshiah. Then the passage talks about the sons of Rephaiah, Arnan, Obadiah, and Shecaniah. We do not know exactly who these people are. These people may be descendants of Hananiah, but they may also be Jeshiah's sons or descendants who lived around the same time as Hananiah. The storyteller is unclear on the relationship between these descendants. We only know that these sons belong to the family line of David.

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Shecaniah had six descendants named Shemaiah, Hattush, Igal, Bariah, Neariah, and Shaphat. These six descendants may all be Shecaniah's sons. Or, the six descendants may be Shecaniah's son Shemaiah and Shemaiah's five sons.

Neariah had three sons named Elioenai, Hizkiah, and Azrikam. Elioenai had seven sons named Hodaviah, Eliashib, Pelaiah, Akkub, Johanan, Delaiah, and Anani.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:17–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has one scene.

In the first scene: Jehoiachin was king over Judah before the Babylonians took him away as a prisoner. Jehoiachin had seven descendants. Jehoiachin's son Pedaiah had two sons. Pedaiah's son Zerubbabel had eight descendants. Zerubbabel's son Hananiah had six descendants. Hananiah's descendant Shecaniah had six descendants. Shecaniah's descendant Neariah had three sons. Neariah's son Elioenai had seven sons.

The characters in this passage are:

- Jehoiachin
- Shealtiel, ^ ^Malkiram, Pedaiah, Shenazzar, Jekamiah, Hoshama, Nedabiah
- Zerubbabel, Shimei
- Meshullam, Hananiah, Shelomith
- Hashubah, Ohel, Berekiah, Hasadiah, Jushab-Hesed
- Pelatiah, Jeshaiah
- sons of Rephaiah, of Arnan, of Obadiah, and of Shecaniah
- Shemaiah
- Hattush, Igal, Bariah, Neariah, and Shaphat
- Elioenai, Hizkiah, Azrikam
- And Hodaviah, Eliashib, Pelaiah, Akkub, Johanan, Delaiah, Anani

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Jehoiachin was king over Judah for three months before the Babylonians took him back to Babylon as a captive or prisoner. Sometimes, people take captives during battle and take those captives back to their home country. While Jehoiachin lived in Babylon, Jehoiachin had children. This passage provides a list of the family line that began with Jehoiachin. The passage lists mostly male descendants. These descendants come from the family line of David, but not every descendant the storyteller lists became a ruler over Israel. The Bible is not completely clear in this list about who was the father and who was the son. In some places, the passage talks about sons, and in some places, the passage talks about descendants, which can include grandsons and all future children in the family line. But we know every name on the list comes from the family line of King David.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell about a person's family line. How do you describe each generation's relationship to the previous generation? Pause this audio here.

Jehoiachin had Shealtiel, Malkiram, Pedaiah, Shenazzar, Jekamiah, Hoshama, and Nedabiah. Jehoiachin's son Pedaiah had two sons, Zerubbabel and Shimei. In other places in the Bible, Zerubbabel's father is Shealtiel. It is possible that Zerubbabel's birth father is Shealtiel, but because of cultural laws, people understood that Zerubbabel came from Pedaiah's family line. Zerubbabel had Meshullam, Hananiah, and a daughter named Shelomith. The passage lists five more descendants of Zerubbabel named Hashubah, Ohel, Berekiah, Hasadiah, and Jushab-Hesed. These men are probably Zerubbabel's grandsons, and their father was probably Meshullam.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Because we are not certain who their father is, how will you talk about these five men? Pause this audio here.

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Zerubbabel's son Hananiah had descendants named Pelatiah, Jeshaiah, Rephaiah, Arnan, Obadiah, and Shecaniah. We are not sure about the fathers of these men.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you help people understand that these are descendants, but we are not sure who is the son of whom? Pause this audio here.

Shecaniah had six descendants named Shemaiah, Hattush, Igal, Bariah, Neariah, and Shaphat. He had a total of six descendants. Neariah had three sons named Elioenai, Hizkiah, and Azrikam. He had a total of three sons. Elioenai had seven sons named Hodaviah, Eliashib, Pelaiah, Akkub, Johanan, Delaiah, and Anani. He had a total of seven sons. These last three groups of descendants show a pattern. The storyteller lists a man and his sons or descendants and then tells the total number of sons that man had.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you list groups like this? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:17–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has one scene.

The characters in this passage are:

- Jehoiachin
- Shealtiel, Malkiram, Pedaiah, Shenazzar, Jekamiah, Hoshama, Nedabiah
- Zerubbabel, Shimei
- Meshullam, Hananiah, Shelomith
- Hashubah, Ohel, Berekiah, Hasadiah, Jushab-Hesed
- Pelatiah, Jeshaiah
- sons of Rephaiah, of Arnan, of Obadiah, and of Shecaniah
- Shemaiah
- Hattush, Igal, Bariah, Neariah, and Shaphat
- Elioenai, Hizkiah, Azrikam
- And Hodaviah, Eliashib, Pelaiah, Akkub, Johanan, Delaiah, Anani

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If this section is too difficult to remember, you may listen to an audio recording again.

While you do this, think about the people of Israel. The descendants in this list represent the family line that includes King David. Yahweh had promised King David that someone from his family line would rule over Israel forever. Each time the Israelites heard this list of descendants, the people would remember that Yahweh is faithful to keep Yahweh's promises. Even when the people of Israel went to Babylon as prisoners, Yahweh kept Yahweh's promise to preserve the family line of King David. When the people returned to the land of Israel, the family line of David continued.

When they heard the names of these people, the Israelites probably celebrated Yahweh's faithfulness. The Israelites may have looked forward to the Messiah that Yahweh promised.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

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The group should recite this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask, "What are you feeling or thinking?" about a particular character. Answer what that character might be feeling or thinking. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Jehoiachin was a prisoner in Babylon. Jehoiachin had sons in Babylon named Shealtiel, Malkiram, Pedaiah, Shenazzar, Jekamiah, Hoshama, and Nedabiah. Pedaiah had sons named Zerubbabel and Shimei. Zerubbabel had sons named Meshullam and Hananiah, and he had a daughter named Shelomith. Then the passage lists five more sons. These sons' names are Hashubah, Ohel, Berekiah, Hasadiah, and Jushab-Hesed. Pause. Ask the person playing Zerubbabel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I rejoice that I have descendants who can remind the people of Israel that God is faithful; or
- I am proud to be from the family line of King David.

Continue reciting. Hananiah had Pelatiah and Jeshaiah. Then the storyteller mentions the sons of Rephaiah, of Arnan, of Obadiah, and of Shecaniah. Shecaniah had six descendants, including his son Shemaiah and Shemaiah's sons Hattush, Igal, Bariah, Neariah, and Shaphat. Neariah had three sons named Elioenai, Hizkiah, and Azrikam. Elioenai had seven sons named Hodaviah, Eliashib, Pelaiah, Akkub, Johanan, Delaiah, and Anani. Pause. Ask the person playing Jehoiachin, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that God preserved my family line even though I was a prisoner in Babylon; or
- I am sad that the people of Israel have been away from the land for so long, and I want them to remember that God promised that we would return to the land God gave us.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 3:17–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Jehoiachin was a prisoner in Babylon. Jehoiachin had **descendants** while he lived in Babylon. A person's descendants are his children, grandchildren, and all future children from the same family line. In this passage, however, the storyteller uses the word **sons** instead of the word descendants. In Hebrew, a son can be the male child of his parents, or a son can be a descendant. In this passage, the storyteller uses the word sons, but some translations use the word "descendants" in some places because the list includes people who are not direct sons. For more information on descendants and son, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words for sons when it means the male child of a parent, and for descendants when it means all future children from the same family line.

Jehoiachin had sons named Shealtiel, Malkiram, Pedaiah, Shenazzar, Jekamiah, Hoshama, and Nedabiah. Pedaiah had Zerubbabel and Shimei. Zerubbabel had Meshullam, Hananiah, and a daughter named Shelomith. Zerubbabel's name means "offspring of Babylon." Meshullam's name means "restored," Hananiah means "Yahweh is merciful," and Shelomith means "peace." Then there were five descendants named Hashubah, Ohel, Berekiah, Hasadiah, and Jushab-Hesed. We call these men descendants because we are not sure how they are related.

Hananiah's descendants are Pelatiah and Jeshaiah, and the sons of Rephaiah, of Arnan, of Obadiah, and of Shecaniah. Shecaniah had six descendants, including his son Shemaiah and his grandsons Hattush, Igal, Bariah, Neariah, and Shaphat. Neariah had three sons named Elioenai, Hizkiah, and Azrikam. Elioenai had seven sons named Hodaviah, Eliashib, Pelaiah, Akkub, Johanan, Delaiah, and Anani.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 3:17–24

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (475 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (691 KB)

1 Chronicles 4:1–10

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 4:1–10 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:1–10 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, you heard a list of the descendants of Jehoiachin, who ruled over Judah right before the Babylonians took the people of Judah to Babylon as prisoners. Jehoiachin's family line came from King David, and the Israelites remembered that God had promised that someone from this family line would rule over Israel forever. God kept this promise even after the people of Israel returned from Babylon to the land God had given them.

1 Chronicles 4:1–10

In this passage, we hear a list of more of the family line of Judah. Judah was one of the sons of Israel. The storyteller uses the word “sons” here to describe a relationship between family members. You will remember that in Hebrew, the word “sons” can describe the direct sons of a father or a person’s descendants. A person’s descendants may be that person’s children, grandchildren, and all future generations. Some translations use the word “descendants” instead of the word “sons” to talk about relatives who are not direct sons.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Remind each other of how you describe relationships between fathers, sons, and grandsons in your culture. Pause this audio here.

You will remember from a previous passage that we heard a list of Judah’s sons and some of those sons’ descendants that led to King David. The storyteller then talked about David’s sons and the generations that followed David’s sons. In this passage, the storyteller begins with one of Judah’s sons and lists more descendants of Judah.

We are not certain how all of the people in this passage may be related to each other. Most of the people in this part of Judah’s family line do not appear in any other places in the Bible.

Judah had some descendants named Perez, Hezron, Carmi, Hur, and Shobal. This list does not contain every one of Judah’s descendants. Perez is Judah’s son. Hezron is Perez’s son. The name “Carmi” may be a mistake, and this person’s name may be Caleb. Carmi may be either Hezron’s son or Perez’s brother. Carmi had a son named Hur, and Hur had a son named Shobal.

Shobal had a son named Reaiah, and Reaiah had a son named Jahath. Jahath had two sons named Ahumai and Lahad. The descendants of Ahumai and Lahad came from the city of Zorah. This city was in the Sorek Valley, about two kilometers north of Beth Shemesh. Zorah may have been important because people continued to live there after the Israelites returned from Babylon.

Stop here and look at a map as a group: Find the cities of Zorah and Beth Shemesh. Pause this audio here.

The sons of Etam were Jezreel, Ishma, and Idbash, and they had a sister named Hazzelelponi. We know that Etam was also the name of a city about 3.5 kilometers southwest of Bethlehem. So “sons of Etam” may mean that these men established this city. The storyteller then tells us that Penuel was the father of the city of Gedor, and Ezer was the father of the city of Hushah. Again, the storyteller probably means that Penuel was the founder of Gedor because he started the city of Gedor, and Ezer was the founder of Hushah. Gedor was a city in the hill country of Judah, located about 12.5 kilometers north of Hebron. Hushah was a city located only a few kilometers away from Bethlehem. These men were Hur’s descendants. Hur fathered or started the city of Bethlehem, which people also called Ephrathah after Hur’s mother’s name. Hur’s father was Caleb, and Hur’s mother was Ephrathah. Hur was Caleb’s and Ephrathah’s oldest son.

Stop here and look at a map as a group. Find the towns of Etam, Gedor, Hushah, and Bethlehem. Pause this audio here.

Ashhur was the father of Tekoa, a town about 8 kilometers south of Bethlehem or 16 kilometers south of Jerusalem. Amos the prophet came from the city of Tekoa. Ashhur may actually be another name for Hur, but Ashhur may also have been Hur’s younger brother. Ashhur had two wives, called Helah and Naarah.

Ashhur’s wife Naarah had four sons with Ashhur named Ahuzzam, Hepher, Temeni, and Haahashtari. We do not know anything else about Ahuzzam or Hepher. However, the names Temeni, which means “man of the south,” and Haashashtari may actually refer to family groups instead of individual people. Ashhur’s other wife, Helah, had sons named Zereth, Zohar, and Ethnan.

Koz was the father of Anub and Hazzobebah. We are not sure who Koz’s father may be. Koz may have been the son of Ashhur and Helah. Koz was the father of the family group of Aharhel, who was the son of Harum. We only know that Aharhel is a descendant of Judah, but we do not know how he may be connected to any other of Judah’s descendants. Harum was not Koz’s son but was probably an important descendant of Koz.

We also hear about a man whom people called Jabez. Jabez was a great man, and people respected and honored Jabez more than they honored Jabez’s brothers. We do not know exactly who Jabez’s brothers may have been, but Jabez may have been the brother of Koz. Jabez’s mother said that his birth had caused her to feel much pain. Therefore, she named him Jabez, which sounds like a Hebrew word that means “pain.” One day, Jabez prayed

1 Chronicles 4:1–10

to the God of Israel and begged God to bless Jabez and give him a bigger piece of land than he had. Jabez also asked God to be with Jabez, to protect him, and to keep him safe. Jabez did not want any harm or pain to come to Jabez. And God gave Jabez what Jabez had asked for.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Judah had descendants named Perez, Hezron, Carmi, Hur, and Shobal. Shobal's son Reaiah had Jahath, and Jahath had Ahumai and Lahad, who were people from the town of Zorah. Jezreel, Ishma, and Idbash were sons of the city of Etam with their sister Hazzelelponi. Penuel was the father of the town of Gedor, and Ezer was the father of the town of Hushah. These men were descendants of Hur, Ephrathah and Caleb's oldest son. Ashhur was the father of Tekoa and had two wives. Ashhur's wife Naarah had Ahuzzam, Hepher, Temeni, and Haahashtari. Ashhur's wife Helah had Zereth, Zohar, and Ethnan.

In the second scene: Koz became the father of Anub and Hazzobebah, and Koz's descendants were the families of Aharhel, the son of Harum.

In the third scene: There was a man named Jabez who had more honor than his brothers. His mother named him Jabez because she felt much pain when she gave birth to Jabez. Jabez prayed and asked God to bless Jabez, to give him more land, and to protect him from harm. And God answered Jabez's prayer.

The characters in this passage are:

- Judah
- Perez, Hezron, Carmi, Hur, Shobal
- Reaiah
- Jahath
- Ahumai and Lahad
- Jezreel, Ishma, Idbash
- Hazzelelponi
- Penuel
- Ezer
- Hur
- Ashhur
- Naarah
- Ahuzzam, Hepher, Temeni, Haahashtari
- Helah
- Zereth, Zohar, Ethnan
- Koz
- Anub and Hazzobebah
- Families of Aharhel, son of Harum
- Jabez
- And God

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In scene one, Judah has several descendants. Judah has a son named Perez, who has a son named Hezron, who may have had a son named Carmi or Caleb. Carmi could also be the brother of Perez. Carmi has a son named Hur, who has a son named Shobal. Shobal's son Reaiah has a son named Jahath, and Jahath has sons named Ahumai and Lahad. Jahath's sons lived in the city of Zorah.

Jezreel, Ishma, and Idbash were the sons of Etam, and they had a sister named Hazzelelponi. However, Etam is not a person. Etam is a city. These men started the city of Etam, so they are called Etam's sons. In the same way,

1 Chronicles 4:1–10

Penuel was the father of the city of Gedor, and Ezer was the father of the city of Hushah. These men were the founders of the cities of Gedor and Hushah, so they are called the fathers of those cities. These men were Hur's descendants. Hur was the oldest son of Ephrathah and Caleb. Hur was the father of the city of Bethlehem.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How do you talk about the people who establish or lead a town in your culture? Pause this audio here.

Ashhur, who was the father of the city of Tekoa, had two wives. Ashur and his wife Naarah had Ahuzzam, Hepher, Temeni, and Haahashtari. Ashur and his wife Helah had Zereth, Zohar, and Ethnan.

In scene two, Koz had two sons named Anub and Hazzobebah. Koz also had descendants in the family group of Aharhel, Harum's son.

In scene three, we hear about a man named Jabez who had more honor and respect than his brothers. Jabez's mother named him Jabez because she felt much pain when she gave birth to him. Jabez prayed to the God of Israel and said, "Oh that you would bless me and give me more land! Let your hand, or power, be with me! Please be with me in all I do and protect me from harm and pain." And God answered Jabez's prayer.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How do you describe men whom other people greatly honor in your culture? How do you use specific words or phrases to help your audience understand the importance of an honorable man's life? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Judah
- Perez, Hezron, Carmi, Hur, Shobal
- Reaiah
- Jahath
- Ahumai and Lahad
- Jezreel, Ishma, Idbash
- Hazzelelponi
- Penuel
- Ezer
- Hur
- Ashhur
- Naarah
- Ahuzzam, Hepher, Temeni, Haahashtari
- Helah
- Zereth, Zohar, Ethnan
- Koz
- Anub and Hazzobebah
- Families of Aharhel, son of Harum
- Jabez
- And God

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite listening to the passage.

1 Chronicles 4:1–10

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If this section is too difficult to remember, you may listen to an audio recording again.

While you do this, think about the Israelites. When the Israelites heard this list of names, they would remember God's faithfulness to keep God's promises. The Israelites may have thought about how God kept different groups of Israelite people safe throughout numerous generations.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should recite this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask one of the characters, "What are you feeling or thinking?" Then the person playing that character should answer what that character would be feeling or thinking. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Judah had descendants named Perez, Hezron, Carmi, Hur, and Shobal. Shobal had a son named Reaiah, who had a son named Jahath. Jahath had two sons named Ahumai and Lahad, whose families lived in the city of Zorah. Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy to see how God has preserved so many of Judah's descendants; or
- I am proud that my people lived in the land God promised to the Israelites.

Continue to recite the passage. Jezreel, Ishma, and Idbash were the sons of the city of Etam. These men had a sister named Hazzelelponi. Penuel was the father of the city of Gedor, and Ezer was the father of the city of Hushah. These men were Hur's descendants. Hur was the oldest son of Ephrathah and Caleb. Hur was also the father of Bethlehem. Pause the reciting. Ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We praise God for God's faithfulness to preserve our people in the land God promised us, even after we returned from Babylon; or
- We hope that our people will survive for many generations to see God fulfill his promise to keep a descendant from Judah as our ruler forever.

Continue to recite the passage. Ashur was the father of Tekoa, and Ashhur had two wives. Ashhur's wife Naarah had Ahuzzam, Hepher, Temeni, and Haahashtari. Ashhur's other wife, Helah, had Zereth, Zohar, and Ethnan.

Koz had two sons named Anub and Hazzobebah. Koz's other descendants came from the family groups of Aharhel, son of Harum.

There was a man named Jabez whom everyone honored and respected more than they respected Jabez's brothers. Jabez's mother named him Jabez because she felt much pain when she gave birth to him. Jabez prayed to the God of Israel and said, "Oh that you would bless me and give me more land! Please be with me in all I do and protect me from harm and pain." And God answered Jabez's prayers. Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel confident that God hears the prayers of my people because God heard Jabez and answered his prayers; or
- I feel grateful for how God has kept the Israelites in the land God promised them.

Ask the person playing God, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy to answer the prayers of my people; or
- Even after the difficulties my people Israel experienced in Babylon, some of them still worship me and pray to me, and I feel proud of them.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 4:1–10

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Judah had **descendants** named Perez, Hezron, Carmi, Hur, and Shobal. These are not all Judah's direct **sons**, but in this passage, the word "sons" can also mean "descendants." A son is usually the male child of his parents. A descendant is a person's children, grandchildren, and all future generations along that family line. For more information on son and descendant, refer to the Master Glossary, and use the words for these ideas in the same way you have in previous passages.

Shobal became the father of Reaiah, who became the father of Jahath, who became the father of Ahumai and Lahath. These men came from the city of Zorah. They formed large family groups, called **clans**. Use the same word or phrase for clans as you have used in previous passages.

Jezreel, Ishma, and Idbash were the **sons** of the **city** of Etam, along with their sister Hazzelelponi. Penuel was the **father**, or founder, of the city of Gedor, and Ezer was the father of the city of Hushah. Ezer's name means "help." Ashhur was the father of the city of Tekoa. Usually, to be a son or father of someone describes the relationship between a father and a son. Here, the storyteller means that these people started or came from a specific city. Use the same word or phrase for "fathers" who started or founded a city as you have used in previous passages. Use the same word or phrase for "sons" or men who came from a certain city as you have used in previous passages. If you need to state that each of these place names was a city so that your audience will understand that these are not people's names, you may do so. Use the same word or phrase for city that you have used in previous passages.

Ashur had two wives named Naarah and Helah. Naarah had Ahuzzam, Hepher, Temeni, and Haahashtari. Helah had Zereth, Zohar, and Ethnan.

Koz became the father of his sons Anub and Hazzobebah. Koz also had descendants from the families of Aharhel, who was the son of Harum.

There was a man named Jabez whom people honored and respected more than they respected Jabez's brothers. Jabez's mother named him Jabez because she felt so much pain when she gave birth to him. Jabez prayed to the God of **Israel**, and God answered his prayers. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you have previously, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word you have used for the general name for **God** in previous books of the Bible. For more information about God, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Jabez asks God to have his "hand" on him. When the storyteller of Chronicles talks about someone's hand, he is talking about their power. Jabez is asking God for God's power or God's presence to be with him.

Stop here and, as a group, discuss how you will talk about God's hand or God's presence being with Jabez.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 4:1–10

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (474 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (709 KB)

1 Chronicles 4:11–20

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 4:11–20 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:11–20 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:11–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, you heard a list of more sons, or descendants, of Judah. Some of those descendants settled towns in the land of Judah. The list ended with Jabez, who prayed to the God of Israel, and God answered Jabez's prayers.

In this passage, you will hear more lists of the family line of Judah. This list begins with Kelub. We do not know exactly who Kelub's father was, although some people think Kelub is Caleb, the son of Hezron, who appeared in an earlier list of Judah's descendants. People may also call Kelub by the names Caleb or Chelubai. Kelub was Shuhah's brother, and Kelub was the father of a son named Mehir. Mehir was the father of Eshton. The Bible does not tell us anything else about Shuhah or Mehir.

Eshton was the father of three sons named Beth Rapha, Paseah, and Tehinnah. Tehinnah was the father or founder of the city of Ir Nahash, which means that Tehinnah settled the city of Nahash. The descendants of these men lived in the city of Recah. We are not sure where the cities of Nahash and Recah may have been located, but they were probably in the territory of Judah.

Kenaz had sons, or descendants, named Othniel and Seraiah. The descendants of Kenaz, known as the Kenizzites, became a tribe in southern Israel that eventually joined the southern kingdom of Judah. Othniel was probably

1 Chronicles 4:11–20

a brother or nephew of Caleb, the son of Jephunneh. This is probably a different man from the Kelub or Caleb mentioned earlier in the passage. You will remember from a previous passage that Caleb, the son of Jephunneh, was a former Israelite spy, and he helped Joshua and the Israelites conquer the land God promised to give them.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about two different people who had the same name but who did very different things. Pause this audio here.

Othniel conquered the city of Debir when the Israelites took the land God had promised them. As a reward, Caleb allowed Othniel to marry Caleb's daughter, Acsah. Othniel became Israel's first judge in the time before kings ruled over Israel. Othniel had sons named Hathath and Meonothai, and Meonothai was the father of a son named Ophrah. Kenaz's son Seraiah was the father of Joab.

Stop here and look at a map as a group that contains Israel, Judah, the territory of the Kenizzites, and the city of Debir. Pause this audio here.

Joab was the father or founder of a place called Ge Harashim, which means "valley of the craftsmen." That place was called the valley of the craftsmen because the people who lived there were skilled in making things. This valley was probably northwest of Jerusalem, but we are not sure where it was located.

Caleb was the son of Jephunneh, and Caleb had sons named Iru, Elah, and Naam. Elah had a son named Kenaz. We are not sure if this Kenaz is the same as the Kenaz the storyteller mentioned before, who had sons named Othniel and Seraiah.

In the rest of the list, the Bible does not tell us anything else about these people, and we are not sure how each person may be related to the rest of the family line. We only know that these descendants came from the family line of Judah, one of Israel's sons.

Jehallelel had sons named Ziph, Ziphah, Tiria, and Asarel. Ziph may have been a grandson of Caleb. The Bible does not tell us how Jehallelel and his sons may be related to anyone else in this list of descendants.

Ezrah had sons named Jether, Mered, Epher, and Jalon. Mered married a woman named Bithiah from Egypt. Bithiah was a daughter of the Pharaoh, or the king of Egypt. Mered and Bithiah had children named Miriam, Shammai, and Ishbah. Ishbah was the father of Eshtemoa. We are not sure if this means Ishbah was the father of a person named Eshtemoa or if Ishbah was the founder of a town called Eshtemoa, which was south of Hebron. Mered also married an Israelite woman from the tribe of Judah, and they had three sons. Their son Jered was the father or founder of Gedor, their son Heber was the father of the town of Soco, and their son Jekuthiel was the father of the town of Zanoah. Gedor, Soco, and Zanoah were towns located in Judah, but we are not sure exactly where they were.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about some of the towns or places in your area. How do people name those places? Pause this audio here.

Hodiah married Naham's sister. Their descendants were the fathers of Keilah and Eshtemoa. Keilah's descendants were a clan or family group called the Garmites, and Eshtemoa's descendants were a clan or family group called the Maacathites. The storyteller is not very clear about these clans and the towns in which they lived.

Shimon had sons named Amnon, Rinnah, Ben-Hanan, and Tilon. Ishi had sons named Zoheth and Ben-Zoheth. The Bible does not give us any more information on any of these people.

Stop here and discuss as a group: We do not know much about many of the people the storyteller listed in this passage. How do you talk about people in your culture when you do not know many details about them?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:11–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has 2 scenes.

1 Chronicles 4:11–20

In the first scene: This list contains more members of the family of Judah. The list begins with Shuhah's brother Kelub and provides several generations of names down to Kenaz.

In the second scene: The list continues with Jehallelel and provides the names of more descendants and towns those men founded. This passage ends with Zoheth and Ben-Zoheth.

The characters in this passage are:

- Shuhah
- Kelub
- Mehir
- Eshton
- Beth Rapha, Paseah, and Tehinnah
- Kenaz
- Othniel and Seraiah
- Hathath and Meonothai
- Ophrah
- Joab
- Jephunneh
- Caleb
- Iru, Elah, and Naam
- Kenaz
- Jehallelel
- Ziph, Ziphah, Tiria, and Asarel
- Ezrah
- Jether, Mered, Epher, and Jalon
- Bithiah
- Miriam, Shammai, and Ishbah
- A woman from the tribe of Judah
- Jered, Heber, and Jekuthiel
- Hodiah
- Naham's sister
- Keilah and Eshtemoa
- Shimon
- Amnon, Rinnah, Ben-Hanan, and Tilon
- Ishi
- And Zoheth and Ben-Zoheth

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In scene one, Shuhah's brother Kelub was the father of Mehir. Mehir was the father of Eshton. Eshton was the father of Beth Rapha, Paseah, and Tehinnah. Tehinnah was the father or founder of the city of Nahash. The descendants of these men lived in a place called Recah. Although Nahash and Recah are probably cities, the storyteller does not say that they are. You may need to state that these are names of cities.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In the previous passage, you heard that sometimes the word "father" describes a relationship between a man and his son. In other places, "father" means the man who founded or settled a particular city. Remind each other how you translated the two different meanings of this word in your language so that you can use the same words or phrases again to be consistent. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will show that Nahash and Recah are not the names of people, but the names of cities. Pause this audio here.

Kenaz had sons named Othniel and Seraiah. Othniel's sons were Hathath and Meonothai, who was the father of Ophrah. Seraiah was the father of Joab, who was the father or founder of Ge Harashim, the valley of craftsmen. People called this place the "valley of the craftsmen" because the people who lived there were good at making things.

1 Chronicles 4:11–20

Stop here and discuss as a group: In the previous script, you discussed how people name places in your area. What will you call this valley of craftsmen? Pause this audio here.

Caleb was the son of Jephunneh, and Caleb's sons were Iru, Elah, and Naam. Elah's son was Kenaz.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In some places in this passage, the storyteller emphasizes who the father of someone is. In other places, the storyteller emphasizes who the sons of someone are. In your culture, is it more important to talk about fathers or sons? Is there a difference in the way you will talk about someone's father or someone's sons? Pause this audio here.

In scene two, Jehallelel had sons named Ziph, Ziphah, Tiria, and Asarel.

Ezrah had sons named Jether, Mered, Epher, and Jalon. Mered had two wives. One of Mered's wives was named Bithiah, and she was the daughter of the Pharaoh or king of Egypt. Bithiah and Mered had children named Miriam, Shammai, and Ishbah, who was the father of a person called Eshtemoa or the founder of a city called Eshtemoa. Mered's other wife was an Israelite from the tribe of Judah. She and Mered had sons named Jered, Heber, and Jekuthiel. Jered was the father or founder of the city of Gedor. Heber was the father or founder of the city of Soco, and Jekuthiel was the father or founder of the city of Zanoah.

Hodiah's wife was Naham's sister. Hodiah and his wife had two sons. One son was the father of Keilah, who came from the family group of the Garmites. The other son was the father of Eshtemoa, who came from the family group of the Maacathites.

Shimon had sons named Amnon, Rinnah, Ben-Hanan, and Tilon.

Ishi had sons or descendants named Zoheth and Ben-Zoheth.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:11–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Shuhah
- Kelub
- Mehir
- Eshton
- Beth Rapha, Paseah, and Tehinnah
- Kenaz
- Othniel and Seraiah
- Hathath and Meonothai
- Ophrah
- Joab
- Jephunneh
- Caleb
- Iru, Elah, and Naam
- Kenaz
- Jehallelel
- Ziph, Ziphah, Tiria, and Asarel
- Ezrah
- Jether, Mered, Epher, and Jalon
- Bithiah
- Miriam, Shammai, and Ishbah
- A woman from the tribe of Judah

1 Chronicles 4:11–20

- Jered, Heber, and Jekuthiel
- Hodiah
- Naham's sister
- Keilah and Eshtemoa
- Shimon
- Amnon, Rinnah, Ben-Hanan, and Tilon
- Ishi
- And Zoheth and Ben-Zoheth

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person who plays the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If this section is too difficult to remember, you may listen to an audio recording again.

While you do this, think about the Israelites. When they heard this list of names, the Israelites would remember God's faithfulness to keep God's promises. The Israelites may have thought about how God kept different groups of Israelite people safe through several generations. The Israelites also may have thought about how God abundantly blessed them with many children.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should recite this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask one of the characters, "What are you feeling or thinking?" Then the person playing that character should answer what that character would be feeling or thinking. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Kelub, Shuhah's brother, was the father of Mehir, who was the father of Eshton, who was the father of Beth Rapha, Paseah, and Tehinnah. Tehinnah was the father, or founder, of the city of Ir Nahash. These men's descendants lived in the city of Recah.

Kenaz had sons named Othniel and Seraiah. Othniel's sons were Hathath and Meonothai. Meonothai was the father of Ophrah. Seraiah was the father or founder of the place called Ge Harashim, which means valley of craftsmen. People called this place the valley of craftsmen because the people who lived there were skilled in making things. Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the storyteller of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am proud to know more of the descendants of the tribe of Judah; or
- I celebrate what the Lord has done through the generations.

Continue to recite the passage. Caleb was the son of Jephunneh, and Caleb had sons named Iru, Elah, and Naam. Elah had a son named Kenaz. Jehallelel had sons named Ziph, Ziphah, Tiria, and Asarel. Ezrah had sons named Jether, Mered, Epher, and Jalon.

Mered had two wives. One wife was named Bithiah, and she was the daughter of the pharaoh or king of Egypt. Mered and his wife Bithiah had children named Miriam, Shammai, and Ishbah, who was either the father of a man called Eshtemoa or the founder of the town of Eshtemoa. Mered and his other wife, an Israelite from Judah, had sons named Jered, the father or founder of the town of Gedor; Heber, the father or founder of the town of Soco; and Jekuthiel, the father or founder of the town of Zanoah.

Naham's sister was Hodiah's wife, and they had sons named Keilah, who was from the Garmite family group, and Eshtemoa, who was from the family group of the Maacathites.

1 Chronicles 4:11–20

Shimon's sons were Amnon, Rinnah, Ben-Hanan, and Tilon. Ishi's descendants were Zoheth and Ben-Zoheth. Pause the reciting. Ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are amazed at how God has worked to provide for us and to keep us safe from the time we entered the land; or
- We are grateful that God has blessed us with so many descendants; or
- We look forward to what God will do for us while we wait for the ruler God promised to give us.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:11–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Kelub, Shuhah's brother, was the **father** of Mehir, who was the father of Eshton, who was the father of Beth Rapha, Paseah, and Tehinnah. Tehinnah was the father, or **founder**, of the city of Ir Nahash. Use the same word for father or founder as you used in previous passages.

The **descendants** of these men lived in the city of Recah. A person's descendants are his children, grandchildren, and all future generations from the same family line. In some places in this passage, the word sons can also mean descendants. Use the same word or phrase for descendants as you used in previous passages. For more information on descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

Kenaz had **sons** named Othniel and Seraiah. Othniel's sons were Hathath and Meonothai. The word son can mean the male child of his parents, or it can mean all of a person's descendants over generations. In this part of the passage, the word means the male child of his parents. Use the same word or phrase for sons as you used in previous passages. For more information on sons, refer to the Master Glossary.

Meonothai was the father of Ophrah. Seraiah was the father or founder of the place called Ge Harashim, which means "valley of the craftsmen." People called this place the valley of the craftsmen because the people who lived there were skilled in making things.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word you will use for **craftsmen**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the word or phrase that you used there. Pause this audio here.

Caleb was the son of Jephunneh, and Caleb had sons named Iru, Elah, and Naam. Elah had a son named Kenaz. Jehallelel had sons named Ziph, Ziphah, Tiria, and Asarel. Ezrah had sons named Jether, Mered, Epher, and Jalon.

Remember that Ir Nahash, Recah, Eshtemoa, Gedor, Soco, and Zanoah are cities, and Ge Harashim is the "valley of the craftsmen." You may need to state that these are cities and a valley so that your audience will not think that these are people's names. If you use the word for city, use the same word that you have used in previous passages for city.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will show that these are place names. Pause this audio here.

Mered had two wives. One wife was named Bithiah, and she was the daughter of the pharaoh. Pharaoh is the title for the king in the country of Egypt.

Stop here and discuss what word or phrase you will use for **pharaoh**. Use the same word or phrase for pharaoh as you used in previous passages. For more information on pharaoh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 4:11–20

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (474 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (690 KB)

1 Chronicles 4:21–23

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 4:21–23 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:21–23 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:21–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller gave a list of more descendants of Judah, who was one of Israel's sons. The Bible talks about many of those descendants only in that passage.

In this passage, the storyteller gives a list of the descendants of Shelah, who was one of Judah's sons. Shelah's mother was a Canaanite woman, the daughter of Shua. Shelah named one of his sons Er. Shelah may have chosen this name to honor Er, one of Judah's other sons. Shelah's son Er was the father or founder of the town of Lecah. Another of Shelah's sons was named Laadah, and he founded, or was the father of, the town of Mareshah. We

1 Chronicles 4:21–23

are not sure of the exact locations of any of the towns the storyteller mentioned in this passage, except for the town of Mareshah. We do know that these towns were probably located in the southern part of Israel, in the territory that became the southern kingdom of Judah.

Stop here and look at a map as a group. Look at the territory of the southern kingdom of Judah. Find the location of the town of Mareshah. Pause this audio here.

Shelah had more descendants, who included the families or clans who worked with linen. Linen is a white cloth material that people weave from the fibers of the flax plant. Linen is a strong material that helps people stay cool when they wear it. We are not certain if Ashbea is a place or a person. It could be that the linen workers lived in a town called Beth Ashbea, or it may be that these people came from the house or family of a person named Ashbea.

Stop here and look at a picture of linen or fine white cloth as a group. Pause this audio here.

Shelah had more descendants who included Jokim, the men of the town of Cozeba, and Joash and Saraph. These men probably lived before the Babylonian exile. These men probably went to Moab to take wives. It is unclear what these men did next. Most scholars believe that these men then returned to Bethlehem, but this could also mean that these men went to rule over Moab before they returned to Bethlehem. Moab was a country east of Judah, on the other side of the Dead Sea. The people who lived in Moab were not part of God's people. Bethlehem was a small city in Israel.

Stop here and look at a map as a group. Find the country of Moab and the city of Bethlehem. Pause this audio here.

The people in these lists come from ancient times, probably before the Babylonian people took the people of Judah as prisoners to the city of Babylon. People probably thought these lists were old before the storyteller of Chronicles wrote the book.

These people were potters, or people who made pots and jars out of clay. We are not sure if all of Shelah's descendants made pots or if only some of them became potters. These potters lived at Netaim and Gederah, which means "plants and hedges." However, these are two cities in southern Judah. These people probably lived on land that one of the kings provided. The king probably gave the potters the materials they needed to make jars and pots for the king, so these people worked for the king.

Stop here and look at a picture of a pot as a group. Why do you think making pots for the king might be an important job?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:21–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has one scene.

In the first scene: One of Judah's sons is named Shelah, and Shelah had several descendants. These descendants probably lived before the Babylonian exile.

The characters in this passage are:

- Judah
- Shelah
- Er
- Laadah
- Families of linen workers at Beth Ashbea
- Jokim
- Men of Cozeba
- Joash

1 Chronicles 4:21–23

- Saraph
- And the king

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Shelah was one of Judah's sons. Shelah had a son named Er, who founded or was the father of the city of Lecah. Another of Shelah's sons was Laadah, who founded or was the father of the city of Mareshah. Shelah also had descendants who formed the clans or family groups of the people who wove linen cloth at Beth Ashbea. Beth Ashbea may be the name of a place or the name of a person's household.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Some of these descendants formed clans or family groups, and they all had similar jobs. How do you talk about family groups who people know for the kind of work that they do in your culture? Pause this audio here.

Shelah had more descendants: Jokim, the men who lived in the city of Cozeba, and Joash and Saraph. These descendants went to the country of Moab to get wives before they returned to Bethlehem. The storyteller now gives us the extra information that the records of these descendants are very old. People probably created these records before the people of Babylon took the Israelites as prisoners.

Stop here and discuss as a group: The storyteller of Chronicles gives some extra information when he tells us about these "ancient" records. What is the best natural way for you to include this extra information from the storyteller in this passage? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Do you keep very old records of people in your culture? How do you normally communicate lists or stories of your ancestors? Pause this audio here.

Some of these people worked as potters where they lived in the towns of Netaim and Gederah. These potters created pots and jars for a king. We do not know exactly when these people lived in these towns or which king they served.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:21–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has one scene.

The characters in this passage are:

- Judah
- Shelah
- Er
- Laadah
- Families of linen workers at Beth Ashbea
- Jokim
- Men of Cozeba
- Joash
- Saraph
- And the king

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the author of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person who plays the author should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If this section is too difficult to remember, you may listen to an audio recording again.

1 Chronicles 4:21–23

While you do this, think about the Israelites. When the Israelites heard this list of names, they would remember God's faithfulness to keep God's promises. The Israelites may have thought about how God kept different groups of Israelite people safe through several generations.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should recite this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask one of the characters, "What are you feeling or thinking?" Then the person playing that character should answer what that character would be feeling or thinking. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Shelah was one of Judah's sons. Shelah had sons named Er, who founded Lecah, and Laadah, who founded Mareshah. Shelah also had descendants in the clans or family groups who wove linen cloth at Beth Ashbea. Pause the reciting. Ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We celebrate our clans who were successful in weaving linen; or
- We feel sad that some of the important places where our descendants lived no longer exist.

Continue to recite the passage. More of Shelah's descendants are Jokim, the men from the town of Cozeba, and Joash and Saraph. These men went to Moab to find wives to marry, and then they returned to the city of Bethlehem. These records are very old. Pause the reciting. Ask the person playing the author of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am surprised that some of the people looked for wives in Moab instead of in Israel; or
- I am happy to know that God continues to use the Israelites through the generations.

Continue to recite the passage. These descendants were potters who made pots and jars. These descendants lived in the towns of Netaim and Gederah, and they worked for the king. Pause the reciting. Ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are happy to know that our ancestors did good work weaving linen cloth and making pots; or
- We feel surprise and comfort when we hear the lists of people that God preserved for us to remember.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:21–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Shelah was the **son** of Judah. A son is the male child of his parents, and Shelah was the male child of his father, Judah. Sometimes in this passage, "sons" means the same thing as **descendants**. A person's descendants include their children, grandchildren, and anyone else in the direct family line. Use the same word for son and descendants as you used in previous passages. For more information on son and descendant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Shelah had sons named Er, who founded the city of Lecah, and Laadah, who founded the city of Mareshah. Shelah also had sons or descendants in the clans or family groups who wove linen cloth in the city of Beth Ashbea. Linen is a fine, white cloth that people weave from the flax plant. You may need to state that Lecah, Laadah, Mareshah, and Beth Ashbea are cities. Use the same word for clans or family groups, and cities, as you have used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **linen**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Other sons of Shelah include Jokim, the men of the city of Cozeba, and Joash and Saraph. These men went to the country of **Moab** to find wives before they returned to the city of **Bethlehem**. Moab was a country to the east of Judah. The people who lived in Moab were not part of God's people, the Israelites. Bethlehem was a small village

in Israel. Use the same words or phrases for Moab and Bethlehem as you used in previous passages. For more information on Bethlehem, refer to the Master Glossary.

These records, or lists of descendants, are from ancient or very old times. Some of these descendants were potters who lived in the cities of Netaim and Gederah and worked for the **king**. A potter was a person who made clay pots and jars. A king is a ruler of a city or country. Use the same word for king as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss what word or phrase you will use for **potter**. Look at a picture of a pot as a group. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 4:21–23

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (442 KB)
- Setting the Stage (1.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (1.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (1.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (638 KB)

1 Chronicles 4:24–43

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 4:24–43 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:24–43 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1 Chronicles 4:24–43

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:24–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The previous passage talks about the descendants of Judah's son Shelah.

In this story, the storyteller now tells the history of the tribe of Simeon. The storyteller talks about the family history of some of Simeon's descendants, where they lived, and the lands their leaders conquered. You will remember that the storyteller of Chronicles tells the story to the Israelites who recently came from the place where the conquering nation had taken them as captives. These Israelites, from the southern kingdom of Judah, were in that foreign land for 70 years. Some Israelites return home to their own land. Simeon's land no longer exists separately because it becomes part of Judah's land. The storyteller likely reminds the descendants of Simeon of the special agreement that Yahweh made with the people of Israel. Yahweh gave the Israelites land and promised to bless them if they obeyed him. The storyteller probably wants to give the people of Israel hope that Yahweh still remembers his promises to his people.

Simeon is Jacob's second son and Abraham's great-grandson. The storyteller says Simeon has five sons: Nemuel, Jamin, Jarib, Zerah, and Shaul. Three other Bible passages also list Simeon's descendants, but those passages differ in the number and names of Simeon's sons. This account does not mention Simeon's third son, Ohad. We do not know why, but maybe Ohad's descendants died out and could not form a family clan.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you decide what really happened if there are different versions of the same story? Talk about why there might be different versions of a family history in your culture. Pause this audio here.

Simeon's sons started families, or clans, that became part of the tribe of Simeon. We do not know much about Simeon's sons, except for Shaul. You might remember that Shaul's mother was a Canaanite woman, which made Shaul different from his brothers. Now, the storyteller focuses on Shaul's descendants. In the book of Chronicles, when the storyteller lists several brothers, the lists often follow the family line of the youngest brother on the list. Shaul was the father of Shallum. Shallum was the father of Mibsam. Mibsam was the father of Mishma. This family list shows three generations.

Mishma's descendants were Hammuel, Zaccur, and Shimei. This likely means that Mishma was the father of Hammuel, Hammuel was the father of Zaccur, and Zaccur was the father of Shimei. This family list shows three generations. The Bible does not tell us much about these men.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What rules does your culture have for how to share family history? How do you choose which descendants to include and which ones to leave out? What are the rules about including women in the family history? Pause this audio here.

This story ends this part of Simeon's family history with Shimei, who had 16 sons and 6 daughters. Shimei's relatives did not have many children, so the tribe of Simeon did not grow as much as the tribe of Judah. Yahweh gave the tribe of Simeon a small area of land inside Judah's land. By the time the storyteller tells this story, the tribe of Simeon is no longer separate. It has become part of the tribe of Judah.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map. Locate the territory of the tribe of Simeon. Pause this audio here.

In the second part of the story, the storyteller lists the cities where the descendants of Simeon lived. These cities are in the southern part of Judah's territory because that is where the tribe of Simeon's land was. The first of the cities of the tribe of Simeon was Beersheba, which people knew as the most southern city of Israel. All the cities and villages that the story mentions from now on are near Beersheba. The other cities are: Moladah, Hazar Shual, Bilhah, Ezem, Tolad, Bethuel, Hormah, Ziklag, Beth Marcaboth, Hazar Susim, Beth Biri, and Shaaraim.

The families from the tribe of Simeon owned these cities before David became king of Israel. The following settlements surrounded these cities: Etam, Ain, Rimmon, Token, and Ashan, five towns or villages in all. There were other settlements around the same cities, and they went as far as the city of Baalath. These settlements belonged to the clans of Simeon. The people from the tribe of Simeon wrote down the names of their ancestors. Even though they were a small tribe and lived among the tribe of Judah, the Simeonites kept their own genealogy, or family list.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map. Locate the cities and settlements in the territory of the tribe of Simeon. Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller tells us about another part of the history of the tribe of Simeon, when some leaders of clans or family groups conquer more land. These people may have been officers in the tribal military units. These people's names were Meshobab, Jamlech, and Joshah, whose father was Amaziah. Other leaders were Joel and Jehu, whose father was Joshibiah. Joshibiah's father was Seraiah. Seraiah's father was Asiel. These leaders also included Elioenai, Jaakobah, Jeshohaiah, Asaiah, Adiel, Jesimiel, and Benaiah. The leaders also included Ziza, whose father was Shiphi. Shiphi's father was Allon. Allon was the son of Jedaiah. Jedaiah was the son of Shimri. Shimri was the son of Shemaiah. We do not know much about these leaders. The fact that Ziza's family history goes back five generations means that Ziza may have been from an important family. The clans or families of these 13 leaders grew very large.

These leaders went to the region of the city of Gedor, in the eastern part of the valley, where the city was. We do not know exactly where Gedor was. The city might have been called Gerar. The leaders went here to find land for their flocks to eat grass. Flocks include groups of smaller animals like sheep and goats. The leaders found good land with plenty of grass in a wide, quiet, and peaceful open area. Before the leaders of the families of the tribe of Simeon got there, some of Noah's son Ham's descendants lived in the land. These people might have been Egyptians, Cushites, or Canaanites. These people were peaceful shepherds who lived in tents.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story from the history of your people group about a time when the leaders wanted more land. What did the leaders want the land for, and what did they do to get the land? Pause this audio here.

The Simeonite leaders whom we have just heard about came to Gedor when Hezekiah was king of Judah. Hezekiah was king of Judah about 700 years before Jesus' birth. This means these leaders lived many years after the first generations of Simeon's descendants we heard about earlier. The leaders attacked the descendants of Ham and destroyed the tents where they lived. The leaders also attacked the Meunites, a people group who lived there too. The leaders of Simeon's clans completely destroyed both the Hamites and the Meunites, and these people are completely gone now. Yahweh had told the Israelites to destroy the original people who lived in the land he gave the Israelites to live in. Afterward, the leaders from the tribe of Simeon took over the land and settled there because it had good pasture for their flocks.

Some of the descendants of Simeon went on a second battle to take land. Pelatiah, Neariah, Rephaiah, and Uzziel, the sons of Ishi who were military leaders, took 500 fighting men and went east to attack the Edomite people who lived near Mount Seir in Edom. Mount Seir was a mountainous area in Edom next to the southeastern border with the tribe of Judah. The Simeonites killed the Amalekites who had stayed in Edom since earlier battles. The Amalekites were the descendants of Amalek, a grandson of Esau. The Amalekites had lived with the Edomites since Saul first chased them there, and David also chased them there later. The Simeonites took the land and still lived there until the storyteller wrote this story.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map. Locate the territory of Mount Seir in Edom.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:24–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

1 Chronicles 4:24–43

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us about the family history of some of Simeon's descendants.

- **In the first part of scene one:** The storyteller lists Simeon's sons.
- **In the second part of scene one:** The storyteller lists the descendants of Shaul, Simeon's youngest son.
- **In the third part of scene one:** The storyteller lists the descendants of Mishma, Shaul's youngest descendant.
- **In the fourth part of scene one:** The storyteller lists the descendants of Shimei, Mishma's youngest descendant.

In the second scene: The storyteller lists the cities and settlements where the descendants of Simeon lived.

In the third scene: The storyteller talks about the lands that the leaders of the tribe of Simeon conquered.

- **In the first part of scene three:** The storyteller lists the names of leaders of some other descendants of Simeon. These people live in the time of King Hezekiah, several hundred years after the other descendants of Simeon.
- **In the second part of scene three:** The leaders travel to the region of the city of Gedor to look for land for their sheep to eat grass. The leaders find good land there and destroy the people groups who live there—the descendants of Noah's son Ham and the Meunites. The leaders take over the land and settle there.
- **In the third part of scene three:** Some of Simeon's descendants, four military leaders who are sons of Ishi, take 500 fighting men and go on a second battle to take land. They go to the region of Mount Seir in Edom and defeat the remaining Amalekites who live there. The Simeonites settle in the land.

The characters in this passage are:

- Simeon
- Simeon's sons: Nemuel, Jamin, Jarib, Zerah, and Shaul
- Shaul's descendants: Shallum, Mibsam, and Mishma
- Mishma's descendants: Hammuel, Zaccur, and Shimei
- Shimei's 16 sons and 6 daughters
- Shimei's brothers
- Shimei's brothers' children
- Thirteen leaders of family groups from the tribe of Simeon:
- Meshobab
- Jamlech
- Joshah, son of Amaziah
- Joel
- Jehu, son of Joshibiah, whose father was Seraiah, whose father was Asiel
- Elioenai
- Jaakobah
- Jeshohaiah
- Asaiah
- Adiel
- Jesimiel
- Benaiah
- Ziza, son of Shiphi, whose father was Allon, whose father was Jedaiah, whose father was Shimri, whose father was Shemaiah
- The families of the 13 princes or important leaders from the tribe of Simeon
- King Hezekiah
- Descendants of Noah's son Ham who live in the region of Gedor
- The Meunites who live in the region of Gedor
- Other leaders from the tribe of Simeon who were Ishi's sons:
- Pelatiah
- Neariah
- Rephaiah
- Uzziel
- Five hundred fighting men from the tribe of Simeon
- And the Amalekites who live in the region of Mount Seir

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This family history begins about 1,900 years before Jesus came to Earth and covers about 1,000 years.

Scene one tells the family history of some of Simeon's descendants.

Jacob's second son, Simeon, has five sons: Nemuel, Jamin, Jarib, Zerah, and Shaul. Three other Bible passages—Genesis 46:10, Exodus 6:15, and Numbers 26:12–13—also list Simeon's descendants, but they differ in the number and names of Simeon's sons.

Stop here. If you have already translated Simeon's family history in other books of the Bible, listen to the stories together as a team. Pay close attention to the names. If a person's name is a little different in the stories, you can either change it to match the other stories or keep the name from this story. Talk together about what you will do and why. Pause this audio here.

Now, the story focuses on Shaul's descendants. In the book of Chronicles, when the story lists several brothers, it then often follows the family line of the youngest brother on the list. Shaul was the father of Shallum. Shallum was the father of Mibsam. Mibsam was the father of Mishma. This family list shows three generations.

Mishma's descendants were Hammuel, Zaccur, and Shimei. This likely means that Mishma was the father of Hammuel, Hammuel was the father of Zaccur, and Zaccur was the father of Shimei. This family list shows three generations. The Bible does not tell us much about these men.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about the way you will translate this family history when the exact relationship between a person and their descendants is not clear. Pause this audio here.

This story ends this part of Simeon's family history with Shimei, who had 16 sons and 6 daughters. However, Shimei's brothers did not have many children. Therefore, the number of people in the tribe of Simeon did not grow larger like the number of people in the tribe of Judah did. The word "brothers" refers here to Shimei's other relatives rather than Shimei's brothers from the same father. The phrase "men of Judah" refers to the whole tribe of Judah and not just to its male members.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map. Locate the territory of the tribe of Simeon. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words do you use in your language to refer to relatives in general? What words do you use to talk about the people who are part of your family? Pause this audio here.

Scene two tells about the places where Simeon's descendants lived.

The story lists the cities where the descendants of Simeon lived. These cities are in the southern part of Judah's territory because that is where the tribe of Simeon's land was. Joshua 19:2–8 also lists the cities that the tribe of Simeon received.

Stop here. If you have already translated Joshua 19:2–8, listen to the story together as a team. Pay close attention to the city names and how you translated them in the story in Joshua. If you see a small difference in a city's name between the stories, you can either change the name to match the other name or keep the name from this story. Talk together about what you will do and why. Pause this audio here.

The first of the cities of the tribe of Simeon was Beersheba, which people knew as the most southern city of Israel. All the cities and villages that the story mentions from now on were near Beersheba.

The other cities are: Moladah, Hazar Shual, Bilhah, Ezem, Tolad, Bethuel, Hormah, Ziklag, Beth Marcaboth, Hazar Susim, Beth Biri, and Shaaraim. The families from the tribe of Simeon owned these cities before David became king of Israel. The following settlements surrounded these cities: Etam, Ain, Rimmon, Token, and Ashan, five towns or villages in all. There were other settlements around the same cities, and they went as far as the city of Baalath. These settlements belonged to the clans of Simeon. The people from the tribe of Simeon wrote down the names of their ancestors in their own genealogy, or family list.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map. Locate the cities, villages, and settlements in the territory of the tribe of Simeon. Pause this audio here.

Scene three tells about the lands that the leaders of the tribe of Simeon conquered.

Now the storyteller tells us another part of the history of the tribe of Simeon and lists the names of the princes, or leaders, who are part of it: Meshobab, Jamlech, and Joshah, whose father was Amaziah. Other leaders were Joel and Jehu, whose father was Joshibiah. Joshibiah's father was Seraiah. Seraiah's father was Asiel. These leaders also included Elioenai, Jaakobah, Jeshohaiah, Asaiah, Adiel, Jesimiel, and Benaiah. The leaders also included Ziza, whose father was Shiphi. Shiphi's father was Allon. Allon was the son of Jedaiah. Jedaiah was the son of Shimri. Shimri was the son of Shemaiah. The storyteller says that "the princes' fathers' houses increased greatly." This means that the clans or families of these 13 leaders grew very large, so that there were many people in the families.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you talk about the way a family grows large, like the princes' fathers' house that "grew large?" Pause this audio here.

The leaders traveled to the entrance of the city of Gedor, in the eastern part of the valley, where the city was. We do not know exactly where Gedor was, but it was in the eastern part of the valley. You may remember that "east" is the direction from which the sun comes up. The city might have been called Gerar. The word which people translated from the original language as "entrance" means that the leaders went in the direction of Gedor, and very close to it. The leaders went here to find land for their flocks to eat grass. The leaders found good land with plenty of grass in a wide, quiet, and peaceful open area where the descendants of Noah's son Ham lived in tents.

The men whose names the storyteller just listed came to Gedor when Hezekiah was king of Judah. Hezekiah was king of Judah about 700 years before Jesus' birth. This means these leaders lived many years after the first generations of Simeon's descendants we heard about earlier. The leaders attacked the descendants of Ham and destroyed their tents or dwellings. The leaders also attacked the Meunites, a people group who lived there too. The leaders of Simeon's clans completely destroyed both the Hamites and the Meunites, and there is no trace of these people today. The phrase "completely destroy" in the original language means to set people apart for Yahweh. The Israelites did this by killing the Hamites and the Meunites to show that they honoured Yahweh. Afterward, the leaders from the tribe of Simeon took over the land and settled there because it had good pasture for their flocks.

Some of the descendants of Simeon went on a second battle to take land. Pelatiah, Neariah, Rephaiah, and Uzziel were the sons of Ishi. These men were military leaders who took 500 fighting men and went east to attack the Edomite people who lived near Mount Seir in Edom. Mount Seir was a mountainous area in Edom next to the southeastern border with the tribe of Judah. The Simeonites killed the Amalekites who had stayed in Edom since earlier battles. The Simeonites took the land and still live there to this day. "This day" refers to the time when the storyteller was telling the story.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map. Locate the territory of Mount Seir in Edom. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:24–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Simeon
- Simeon's sons: Nemuel, Jamin, Jarib, Zerah, and Shaul
- Shaul's descendants: Shallum, Mibsam, and Mishma
- Mishma's descendants: Hammuel, Zaccur, and Shimei
- Shimei's 16 sons and 6 daughters
- Shimei's brothers
- Shimei's brothers' children
- Thirteen princes or leaders of family groups from the tribe of Simeon:
- Meshobaab

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- Jamlech
- Joshah, son of Amaziah
- Joel
- Jehu, son of Joshibiah, whose father was Seraiah, whose father was Asiel
- Elioenai
- Jaakobah
- Jeshohaiah
- Asaiah
- Adiel
- Jesimiel
- Benaiah
- Ziza, son of Shiphi, whose father was Allon, whose father was Jedaiah, whose father was Shimri, whose father was Shemaiah
- The families of the 13 princes or important leaders from the tribe of Simeon
- King Hezekiah
- Descendants of Noah's son Ham who live in the region of Gedor
- The Meunites who live in the region of Gedor
- Other leaders from the tribe of Simeon who were Ishi's sons:
- Pelatiah
- Neariah
- Rephaiah
- Uzziel
- Five hundred fighting men from the tribe of Simeon
- And the Amalekites who live in the region of Mount Seir

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Simeon, the son of Jacob, has five sons: Nemuel, Jamin, Jarib, Zerah, and Shaul.

Shaul was the father of Shallum. Shallum was the father of Mibsam. Mibsam was the father of Mishma.

Mishma's descendants were Hammuel, Zaccur, and Shimei.

Shimei had 16 sons and 6 daughters. However, Shimei's relatives did not have many children. Therefore, the tribe of Simeon did not multiply like the men of Judah.

The descendants of Simeon lived in the following cities: Beersheba, Moladah, Hazar Shual, Bilhah, Ezem, Tolad, Bethuel, Hormah, Ziklag, Beth Marcaboth, Hazar Susim, Beth Biri, and Shaaraim. The families from the tribe of Simeon owned these cities before David became king of Israel. The following villages surrounded these cities: Etam, Ain, Rimmon, Token, and Ashan, five towns or villages in all. There were other settlements around the same cities, and they went as far as the city of Baalath. These settlements belonged to the clans of Simeon. The people from the tribe of Simeon wrote down the names of their ancestors in their own family list.

Now the storyteller tells us about 13 princes or leaders from the tribe of Simeon: Meshobab, Jamlech, and Joshah, whose father was Amaziah. Other leaders were Joel and Jehu, whose father was Joshibiah. Joshibiah's father was Seraiah. Seraiah's father was Asiel. These leaders also included Elioenai, Jaakobah, Jeshohaiah, Asaiah, Adiel,

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Jesimiel, and Benaiah. The leaders also included Ziza, whose father was Shiphi. Shiphi's father was Allon. Allon was the son of Jedaiah. Jedaiah was the son of Shimri. Shimri was the son of Shemaiah. The families of these 13 leaders grew very large.

The leaders traveled to the entrance of the city of Gedor, in the eastern part of the valley, where the city was. The leaders went here to find land for their flocks to eat grass. The leaders found good land with plenty of grass in a wide, quiet, and peaceful open area where the descendants of Noah's son Ham lived in tents. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Simeonite leaders, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are grateful to Yahweh that our clans have grown; or
- Because we have more flocks now, we need to look for more land to feed our sheep; or
- We are happy that Yahweh has led us to the land near Gedor. This land has plenty of grass and is peaceful.

Continue the drama. The princes, or leaders, came to Gedor when Hezekiah was king of Judah. The leaders attacked the descendants of Ham and destroyed their tents. The leaders also attacked the Meunites, a people group who lived there too. The leaders of Simeon's clans completely destroyed both the Hamites and the Meunites, and there is no trace of them today. Afterward, the leaders from the tribe of Simeon took over the land and settled there because it had good pasture for their flocks. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Simeonite leaders, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We have to completely destroy the people who live in this land; or
- We want to obey Yahweh, who said that we cannot spare anyone in the land we are to possess;
- We trust Yahweh. We will not live in the same land as the descendants of Ham or the Meunites, or we will become like them and start to worship idols.

[!end] Continue the drama.

Some of the descendants of Simeon went on a second battle to take land. Pelatiah, Neariah, Rephaiah, and Uzziel, the sons of Ishi and military leaders, took 500 fighting men and went east to attack the Edomite people who lived near Mount Seir in Edom. The Simeonites killed the Amalekites who had stayed in Edom since earlier battles. The Simeonites took the land and still live there to this day. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Amalekites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are so scared. The Israelites have attacked us! The Israelites want our land! or
- The Israelite God is really powerful. What will happen to us now? or
- We must run away, or the Israelites will kill us!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 4:24–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Simeon has five **sons**: Nemuel, Jamin, Jarib, Zerah, and Shaul. The word son can mean either a biological male child of his parents or a **descendant**, which is any person from all future generations from the same family line. Here, "the sons of Simeon" refers to the biological male children of Simeon. However, the "sons of Mishma" include grandsons and great-grandsons, so you may want to say that these are the "descendants of Mishma" if you are using a different word for descendants. The number of people from the tribe of Simeon did not become as large as the number of people from the tribe of **Judah**. Use the same words or phrases for Judah, son, and descendants as you used in previous passages. For more information on Judah, son, or descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

The storyteller talks about cities and their surrounding villages. Cities usually had walls around them for protection. Smaller villages surrounded the cities and probably did not have walls around them. Use the same words or phrases for cities and villages as you used in previous passages. The storyteller summarizes by saying

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that “these were their settlements.” A settlement is a more general term for a place where many homes are together.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **cities**, **villages**, and **settlements** in this passage. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The people from the tribe of Simeon wrote down the names of their ancestors in their own **genealogy**, or family list. Use the same word or phrase for genealogy as you used in previous passages. For more information on genealogy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Now the storyteller tells us about another part of the history of the tribe of Simeon, when some **princes** or leaders of **clans**, or family groups, conquer more land. These leaders’ names were Meshobab, Jamlech, Joshah, Joel, and Jehu. These leaders also included Elioenai, Jaakobah, Jeshohaiah, Asaiah, Adiel, Jesimiel, Benaiah, and Ziza. The clans or families of these 13 leaders grew very large. Use the same word or phrase for prince or leader as you used in previous passages. Use the same word or phrase for clan or family group as you used in previous passages.

The men whose names the storyteller just listed came to Gedor, in the east part of the valley, when Hezekiah was **king** of Judah. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **east**. Pause this audio here.

The Simeonite leaders attacked the descendants of Ham and destroyed their homes. Here, the homes were tents. People make tents from heavy cloth or animal skins. Tents are easy to pack up and move quickly.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **home** or **tent**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 4:24–43

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (874 KB)

- Setting the Stage (6.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (8.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.0 MB)

1 Chronicles 5:1–10

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 5:1–10 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:1–10 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The previous story told us about the tribe of Simeon. That story described the family history of some of Simeon's descendants, the places where they lived, and the lands their leaders conquered.

This story is the first of three stories about the tribes that once lived east of the Jordan River: the tribe of Reuben, the tribe of Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh. This story focuses on the tribe of Reuben and tells us about some of Reuben's descendants and where those people lived. You will remember that the storyteller tells the story to Israelites who recently came from the place where the conquering nation had taken them as captives. The Israelites were in that place for 70 years. Some Israelites returned home to their land, but the descendants of the tribe of Reuben did not return to their own land. Instead, they settled west of the Jordan River. The storyteller likely reminds Reuben's descendants of the special agreement that Yahweh made with the people of Israel. Yahweh gave the Israelites land and promised to bless them if they obeyed Yahweh. The storyteller probably wants to give the people of Israel hope that Yahweh still remembers his promises to his people.

The storyteller is about to list the sons of Reuben, but pauses to explain Reuben's situation. Reuben was Israel's firstborn son. Israel is the name that Yahweh gave to Jacob, Abraham's grandson. Usually, the firstborn son gets special rights and privileges that other sons do not have. In some cultures, the firstborn even inherits everything and leads the family. These rights and privileges are called the birthright. But Reuben slept with Bilhah, one of Israel's concubines. Because of this, Reuben lost his special birthright and his right to lead the family. Israel took away Reuben's birthright and gave it to the two sons of Israel's son Joseph: Manasseh and Ephraim. You will remember that Israel gave a blessing, or prophecy, to Joseph and his sons just before Israel died.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about special rights which the firstborn son or daughter receives in your culture. Tell a story about how a firstborn or special child in your culture lost their special rights. Pause this audio here.

Even though Israel gave the birthright to Joseph's sons, people did not list Joseph as the firstborn in the family records. This happened because Joseph was not born first. The storyteller also explains that even though Judah was powerful among his brothers, Judah did not have the rights of the firstborn, but Joseph did. You will remember

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that Jacob had also blessed Judah's descendants before he died, and God made that promise come true in many ways. Under Moses, the tribe of Judah grew strong, and God made Judah the first tribe to take the land of Canaan after Joshua's death. Here, the storyteller tells us that God chose a leader, or prince, from Judah's family to rule Israel. In the original language, the word for "leader" here means a ruler whom God chose. We know this leader was King David. Even though Judah became the strongest tribe, they did not have the birthright. Joseph's sons, Ephraim and Manasseh, kept the special right of the firstborn.

The sons of Reuben, the firstborn son of Israel, or Jacob, were: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi. These sons became leaders of major family groups within the tribe of Reuben. You may remember that the descendants of Pallu—Eliab and his sons Dathan and Abiram—rebelled against Moses and Aaron. The Bible does not give us any information about the others.

The storyteller tells us about Joel's family history. Joel came from one of Reuben's sons, but we do not know which son or when. Joel had a son named Shemaiah. Shemaiah had a son named Gog. Gog had a son named Shimei. Shimei had a son named Micah. Micah had a son named Reaiah. Reaiah had a son named Baal. The scriptures do not tell us anything more about these men. The name Baal means "lord" or "master" and was also a title for a Canaanite false god. This shows that the culture of the nations that lived near the Reubenites influenced what the Reubenites named their children. Baal had a son named Beerah. Then Tiglath-Pileser, king of a big kingdom called Assyria, captured Beerah and took him into exile, or to live in Assyria. Beerah was a leader or a prince of a family in the tribe of Reuben. Tiglath-Pileser ruled Assyria for 18 years, around 700 years before Jesus.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map and locate Israel and Assyria. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time in your people's history when enemies captured and took someone away. Talk about what happened. Pause this audio here.

When people wrote down their genealogies, or family histories, and listed each clan, or family group, they recorded that Beerah's relatives included Jeiel, who was their leader.

People also listed Zechariah and Bela. Bela's father was Azaz, Azaz's father was Shema, and Shema's father was Joel. This Joel might be the same one the storyteller mentioned before. All of Beerah's relatives in the list came from either Joel or his brothers. This family group lived east of the Jordan River in an area that stretched from the strong city of Aroer in the south up to Nebo and the city of Baal Meon in the north of the land of the tribe of Reuben. The name Nebo refers to either a mountain called Mount Nebo or a city called Nebo located near the mountain.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map and locate Aroer city, Mount Nebo, Nebo city, and Baal Meon in the land of the tribe of Reuben. Pause this audio here.

While the Reubenites lived in Gilead, their livestock grew in number, so they had very many animals. Livestock refers to the animals the Reubenites kept: cows, sheep, horses, camels, and donkeys. Gilead was a small area on the eastern side of the Jordan River, about 40 kilometers wide. Since the Reubenites had many animals to feed, they needed more land. So, the Reubenites settled farther east of Gilead, all the way to the edge of the wilderness. The wilderness stretched from there to the Euphrates River.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of livestock: cows, sheep, horses, camels, and donkeys. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map and locate the area to the east of Gilead where the Reubenites settled. Pause this audio here.

Back during King Saul's reign, about 300 years before King Tiglath-Pileser ruled Assyria, the tribe of Reuben attacked the Hagrite people who lived in tents east of the Jordan River. The Reubenites won the battle and defeated the Hagrites. Afterward, the Reubenites took over the Hagrites' land and lived there, which was east of Gilead.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

1 Chronicles 5:1–10

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has six scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller explains that Reuben, Israel's firstborn son, lost his birthright because he slept with Israel's concubine. Israel then gave the birthright to Joseph's sons. However, people did not list Joseph as the firstborn in the family records because Joseph was not born first. Although Judah was powerful among his brothers, Judah did not have the rights of the firstborn, but Joseph did.

In the second scene: The storyteller lists the sons of Reuben.

In the third scene: The storyteller tells a family history of Joel, who was a descendant of one of the sons of Reuben. We learn that Tiglath-Pileser, king of Assyria, captured Beerah, one of Joel's descendants and a leader in the tribe of Reuben, and took him to live in Assyria.

In the fourth scene: We learn about the family history of Beerah, which people wrote down in a record. This family history records some family members all the way back to Beerah's ancestor, Joel. This family group lived east of the Jordan River in an area that stretched from the strong city of Aroer in the south up to Nebo and the city of Baal Meon in the north of the land of the tribe of Reuben.

In the fifth scene: While the people from the tribe of Reuben lived in Gilead, their livestock increased in number, so they had very many animals. So, they settled farther east of Gilead, all the way to the edge of the wilderness. The wilderness stretched from there to the Euphrates River.

In the sixth scene: The storyteller takes us back to Saul's reign when the tribe of Reuben attacked the Hagrite people who lived in tents east of the Jordan River. The Reubenites won the battle and defeated the Hagrites. Afterward, the Reubenites took over the Hagrites' land, which was east of Gilead.

The characters in this passage are:

- Reuben
- Israel, or Jacob
- Joseph
- Joseph's sons, Ephraim and Manasseh, but the storyteller does not mention their names
- Judah
- Reuben's sons: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi
- Joel's descendants: Shemaiah, Gog, Shimei, Micah, Reaiah, Baal, and Beerah
- Tiglath-Pileser
- The tribe of Reuben, or the Reubenites
- Beerah's ancestors, including Jeiel, Zechariah, Bela, Azaz, Shema, and Joel
- King Saul
- And the Hagrites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This story talks about the family history of the tribe of Reuben, some of Reuben's descendants, and where those people lived. The story begins about 1,900 years before Jesus comes to earth and covers over 1,000 years.

The storyteller is about to list the sons of Reuben, but pauses to explain Reuben's situation. Reuben was Israel's firstborn son. Usually, the firstborn son gets special rights and privileges that other sons do not have. People call these rights and privileges the "birthright." But Reuben slept with Bilhah, one of Israel's concubines. The storyteller uses special language to describe this act. The storyteller says that Reuben dishonoured or defiled his father's marriage bed. When Reuben slept with Bilhah, Reuben made the bed unclean. Because of this, Reuben lost his special birthright. Israel then took away Reuben's birthright and gave it to the two sons of Israel's son Joseph: Manasseh and Ephraim.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do people in your language call it when someone does something very shameful and sleeps with another person's husband or wife? How do you talk about the way that person dishonours the husband and wife's marriage or marriage bed? Pause this audio here.

Even though Jacob gave the birthright to Joseph's sons, people did not list Joseph as the firstborn in the family records. This happened because even though Joseph had the birthright, Joseph was not born first. The storyteller also explains that Judah did not have the birthright, even though the tribe of Judah became the most powerful and took the lead among the tribes of Israel. Here, the storyteller tells us that a leader from Judah's family became whom God chose to rule Israel. In the original language, the word for "leader" here means a ruler whom God chose. Even though Judah became the strongest tribe, Joseph's sons, Ephraim and Manasseh, kept the special right of the firstborn.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about different words that you use for a "leader" in your language. How do the words differ in meaning? How will you say that God chose this leader? Pause this audio here.

The sons of Reuben, the firstborn son of Israel, were: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi. These sons became heads of major family groups within the tribe of Reuben. Three other Bible passages—Genesis 46:9, Exodus 6:14, and Numbers 26:5–6—also list Reuben's sons.

Stop here. If you have already translated Reuben's family history in other Bible books, listen to the stories together as a team. Pay close attention to the names and how you translated them. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us about Joel's family history. Joel came from one of Reuben's sons, but we do not know which son or when. Joel had a son named Shemaiah. Shemaiah had a son named Gog. Gog had a son named Shimei. Shimei had a son named Micah. Micah had a son named Reaiah. Reaiah had a son named Baal. Baal had a son named Beerah. Then Tiglath-Pileser, king of Assyria, captured Beerah and took him into exile, or to live in Assyria. Beerah was a leader, or a prince of a family, in the tribe of Reuben. Tiglath-Pileser ruled Assyria for 18 years, around 700 years before Jesus.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map and locate Israel and Assyria at the time of Tiglath-Pileser. Pause this audio here.

When people wrote down their genealogies, or family histories, and listed each clan, or family group, they recorded that Beerah's relatives included Jeiel, who was their leader.

People also listed Zechariah and Bela. Bela's father was Azaz, Azaz's father was Shema, and Shema's father was Joel. This Joel might be the same one the storyteller mentioned before. All Beerah's relatives in the list came from either the first Joel or his brothers. This family group lived east of the Jordan River in an area that stretched from the strong city of Aroer in the south up to Nebo and the city of Baal Meon in the north of the land of the tribe of Reuben. The name Nebo refers to either a mountain called Mount Nebo or a city called Nebo located near the mountain.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map and locate Aroer city, Mount Nebo, Nebo city, and Baal Meon in the land of the tribe of Reuben. Pause this audio here.

While the Reubenites lived in Gilead, their livestock grew in number very much. Gilead was a small area on the eastern side of the Jordan River, about 40 kilometers wide. Since the Reubenites needed more land because they had so much livestock, they settled farther east of Gilead, all the way to the edge of the wilderness. The wilderness stretched from there to the Euphrates River.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map and locate the area to the east of Gilead where the Reubenites settled. Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller takes us back to the time of the reign of King Saul. Saul was king over Israel for about 40 years and likely reigned 900 years after Reuben's sons were born and 300 years before Tiglath-Pileser took Beerah into captivity. During Saul's reign, the tribe of Reuben attacked the Hagrite people who lived in tents east of the Jordan River. The Hagrites fell into the Reubenites' hand, which means that the Reubenites won the battle and defeated the Hagrites. Afterward, the Reubenites took over the Hagrites' land and lived there, which was east of Gilead.

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Stop here and discuss as a group: How do you tell a story when the events happened a long time ago, but you need to share those events out of order? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text
Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has six scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Reuben
- Israel, or Jacob
- Joseph
- Joseph's sons, Ephraim and Manasseh, but the storyteller does not mention their names
- Judah
- Reuben's sons: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi
- Joel's descendants: Shemaiah, Gog, Shimei, Micah, Reaiah, Baal, and Beerah
- Tiglath-Pileser
- The tribe of Reuben, or the Reubenites
- Beerah's ancestors, including Jeiel, Zechariah, Bela, Azaz, Shema, and Joel
- King Saul
- And the Hagrites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Reuben was Israel's firstborn son. Usually, the firstborn son gets special rights and privileges that other sons do not have, which people call the birthright. But Reuben slept with Bilhah, one of Israel's concubines. Because of this, Reuben lost his special birthright and his right to lead the family. Israel took away Reuben's birthright and gave it to the two sons of Israel's son Joseph: Manasseh and Ephraim. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Reuben, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel upset that I foolishly slept with Bilhah and lost my birthright; or
- I feel ashamed that I defiled my father's bed and embarrassed my father in this way; or
- I feel angry with myself because I lost the special position in the family that Yahweh wanted me to have.

Continue the drama. Even though Israel gave the birthright to Joseph's sons, people did not list Joseph as the firstborn in the family records. This happened because Joseph was not born first. The tribe of Judah became the most powerful and took the lead among the tribes of Israel. God chose a leader from Judah's family to rule Israel. Even though Judah became the strongest tribe, they did not have the birthright. Joseph's sons, Ephraim and Manasseh, kept the special right of the firstborn.

The sons of Reuben, the firstborn son of Israel, or Jacob, were: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi.

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The storyteller tells us about the family history of Joel, one of Reuben's descendants. Joel had a son named Shemaiah. Shemaiah had a son named Gog. Gog had a son named Shimei. Shimei had a son named Micah. Micah had a son named Reaiah. Reaiah had a son named Baal. Baal had a son named Beerah. Then Tiglath-Pileser, king of Assyria, captured Beerah and took him to live in Assyria. Beerah was a leader or a prince of a family in the tribe of Reuben. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Reubenites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are happy that Yahweh blessed our tribe with many relatives; or
- We are very sad that Tiglath-Pileser captured our leader Beerah; or
- We are heartbroken because Yahweh has sent the Assyrian king to judge us for our sins.

Continue the drama. When people wrote down their family stories one by one, they recorded Beerah's relatives. People included Jeiel, who served as their leader. People also listed Zechariah and Bela. Bela's father was Azaz, Azaz's father was Shema, and Shema's father was Joel. This family group lived east of the Jordan River in an area that stretched from the strong city of Aroer in the south up to Mount Nebo or the city of Nebo and the city of Baal Meon in the north of the land of the tribe of Reuben.

While the Reubenites lived in Gilead, their livestock grew in number, so they had very many animals. So, the Reubenites settled farther east of Gilead, all the way to the edge of the wilderness. The wilderness stretched from there to the Euphrates River. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Reubenites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We feel happy because Yahweh has blessed us with a lot of livestock; or
- We are grateful for the land east of Gilead, as we can take it and move there so our animals have grass to eat; or
- We want to praise Yahweh because he is faithful. Yahweh provided us with the land when we needed it.

Continue the drama. Back during King Saul's reign, the tribe of Reuben attacked the Hagrite people who lived in tents east of the Jordan River. The Reubenites won the battle and defeated the Hagrites. Afterward, the Reubenites took over the Hagrites' land and lived there, which was east of Gilead.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Reuben was **Israel**'s firstborn son. But Reuben had sex with one of his father's concubines, and this dishonoured Reuben's father. So Reuben's father, Israel, gave Reuben's birthright to his other son, Joseph, and to Joseph's sons. Use the same word for Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Birthright refers to the special privileges and inheritance that the father gives to his firstborn son in a family. In some cultures, the firstborn son even inherits everything and leads the family.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **birthright**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Judah was powerful among his brothers, and God chose a leader from Judah's family to rule Israel. However, Judah did not have the rights of the firstborn, but Joseph did. In the original language, the word for "leader" here means a ruler whom God chose. For more information about Judah, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **leader** here. Many translations use the same word for leader here as they do in other places. However, you may have a word that means a leader whom someone has especially chosen to be in a high position. Pause this audio here.

The **sons** of Reuben, the firstborn son of Israel, or Jacob, were: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Karmi. Here, sons refers to the biological male children of Reuben. However, the word son can mean **descendant** when it is at the beginning of a list of sons. Use the same word or phrase for son or descendant as you used in previous passages. For more information on son or descendant, refer to the Master Glossary.

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Then Tiglath-Pileser, **king** of a big kingdom called Assyria, captured Beerah and took him into exile, or to live in Assyria. Use the same word for king as you have previously, and refer to king in the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for when a ruler captures people and takes them away to a different place, into **exile**. If you have already translated this idea in another book of the Bible, use the same words or phrases that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Beerah was a leader, or a prince of a family, in the tribe of Reuben. The word leader here means a **clan leader** or **chief**. Use the same word or phrase for clan leader or chief as you used in previous passages.

When people wrote down their **genealogies**, or family histories, and listed each **clan**, they recorded that Beerah's kinsmen, or relatives, included Jeiel, who was their leader. Use the same word or phrase for clan, or family group, as you used in previous passages. Use the same word or phrase for genealogy as you have previously, and for more information on genealogy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Jeiel was a **leader** also. Here, the word leader means chief, or head of a group of men. Use the same word or phrase for leader of a group of men as you used in previous passages.

While the Reubenites lived in Gilead, their livestock grew in number until they had very many animals. Livestock refers to the animals the Reubenites kept: cows, sheep, horses, camels, and donkeys.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of livestock: cows, sheep, horses, camels, and donkeys. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **livestock**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Since the Reubenites needed more land because they had so much livestock, the Reubenites settled farther east of Gilead, all the way to the edge of the wilderness. The wilderness stretched from there to the Euphrates River.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wilderness**. The wilderness is an area of land where very few people live and where not much grows. Use the same word or phrase for wilderness as you used in previous books of the Bible. For more information on wilderness, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The Reubenites defeated the Hagrites with their "**hand**." You will remember that "hand" symbolizes someone's power. The Reubenites were powerful and defeated the Hagrites.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about the Reubenites defeating the Hagrites with their power.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 5:1–10

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (769 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.0 MB)

1 Chronicles 5:11–17

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 5:11–17 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:11–17 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:11–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, the storyteller talked about the family history of the tribe of Reuben, who some of Reuben's descendants were, and where those people lived.

This story tells us the family history of the tribe of Gad, who lived next to the tribe of Reuben. The storyteller tells us who some of the descendants were and where those people lived.

Before enemies conquered the people of Israel, the descendants of Gad lived in Bashan, which was north of the tribe of Reuben. Bashan was a fertile plain east of the Sea of Galilee. Mount Hermon marked Bashan's northern border, and the Yarmuk River marked its southern border. King Og ruled Bashan before, and he controlled 60 walled cities. Moses and the Israelites conquered Bashan, and Yahweh gave it to the half-tribe of Manasseh. At first, the tribe of Gad lived south of Bashan, mostly in Gilead, but their land stretched close to Bashan and may have included parts of it. The storyteller is likely talking about a later time when Gad's descendants spread into Bashan, but we do not know how far north. The tribe of Gad's land reached all the way to the town of Salecah in the southeast.

Stop here and locate the region of Bashan on the map. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller talks about some of Gad's descendants. These descendants are not Gad's sons because other stories that list Gad's sons do not mention these men. These men must have descended from Gad's sons, but we do not know their full family histories, and no other Bible stories mention them. Joel was the leader of the

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main clan, or family group, and Shapham led the second clan. Janai and Shaphat were the leaders of other clans in the Bashan region. It is also possible that Joel led the tribe of Gad, Shapham was second in command, and Janai and Shaphat followed them. These men's exact roles and relationships are unclear.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about some family descendants whose names you know, but you do not know how exactly those people are related. Pause this audio here.

The four men were the relatives of leaders of seven other fathers' houses, or clans of the Reubenites: Michael, Meshullam, Sheba, Jorai, Jacan, Zia, and Eber. These seven men were all descendants of Abihail, son of Huri. Huri was the son of Jaroah, and Jaroah was the son of Gilead. Gilead was the son of Michael. Michael was the son of Jeshishai. Jeshishai was the son of Jahdo, and Jahdo was the son of Buz.

Ahi was another descendant of Gad. Ahi was the son of Abdiel, and Abdiel was the son of Guni. Ahi was the leader of the Gadite family clans that the storyteller mentioned before: the clans of Joel, Shapham, Janai, Shaphat, and their seven relatives, the other clan leaders. The Gadite people lived in the Gilead region, the Bashan region, and the nearby villages. The Gilead region was south of Bashan and stretched between the Yarmuk River in the north and the Arnon River in the south. The Gadites also lived in a place called Sharon, which was near Gilead and Bashan, but we do not know exactly where. Sharon had many grassy fields where cattle, sheep, and goats could feed. The land belonged to the Gadites all the way to the borders of Sharon.

Stop here and locate the region of Gilead and Bashan on the map. Pause this audio here.

The descendants of Gad wrote down the names of all the people the storyteller mentioned in a family record. The people did this during the reign of Jotham, king of Judah, and during the reign of Jeroboam, king of Israel. King Jotham ruled Judah, and King Jeroboam ruled Israel, around 750 years before Jesus. Since these two kings did not rule at exactly the same time, people likely wrote two separate family records for the tribe of Gad during their reigns. You will remember that Judah here refers to the southern kingdom and Israel to the northern kingdom. The kingdom of Israel split into Israel and Judah after King Solomon, son of King David, died. This event happened around 930 B.C. This event was part of God's judgment because Solomon and the people had turned away from God. The split was permanent, and the two kingdoms stayed separate until foreign nations conquered both.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:11–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us that the descendants of Gad lived in the Bashan region. The descendants' land reached as far as the town of Salecah in the southeast.

In the second scene: The storyteller talks about four of Gad's descendants: Joel probably led the main clan, and Shaphan probably led the second clan. Janai and Shaphat were probably the leaders of other clans in the Bashan region.

In the third scene: The storyteller tells us about seven clan leaders who were relatives of the four leaders he has just mentioned. These leaders are Michael, Meshullam, Sheba, Jorai, Jacan, Zia, and Eber. We also learn about these leaders' family history.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller introduces Ahi and some of his family history. Ahi was the leader of all the Gadite family clans that the storyteller told us about in this story. The Gadite people lived in the Gilead region, the Bashan region, and the nearby villages. The Gadite people also lived in a place called Sharon.

In the fifth scene: The descendants of Gad wrote down the names of all the people the storyteller mentioned in this story in a family record. The descendants did this during the reign of Jotham, king of Judah, and during the reign of Jeroboam, king of Israel.

The characters in this passage are:

- Descendants of Gad
- Joel
- Shapham
- Janai
- Shaphat
- Michael
- Meshullam
- Sheba
- Jorai
- Jacan
- Zia
- Eber
- Abihail
- Huri
- Jaroah
- Gilead
- Michael
- Jeshishai
- Jahdo
- Buz
- Ahi
- Abdiel
- And Guni

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The descendants of Gad lived in the region of Bashan, north of the tribe of Reuben. Even though the storyteller says the "sons" of Gad, we know that he is referring to a wider group of Gad's relatives.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What do you say in your language when you talk about different types of descendants? What words do you use for sons and daughters, and what words do you use for more distant relatives? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller shows that the tribes of Gad and Reuben had a close relationship when he mentions that they lived next to each other. The tribe of Gad lived in the Bashan region. The Bashan region was east of the Sea of Galilee. Mount Hermon marked its northern border, and the Yarmuk River marked its southern border. At first, the tribe of Gad lived south of Bashan, mostly in Gilead, but their land stretched close to Bashan and may have included parts of it. The storyteller is probably talking about a later time when Gad's descendants moved into Bashan, but we do not know how far north they went. The tribe of Gad's land reached all the way to the town of Salecah in the southeast.

Stop here and locate the region of Bashan on the map. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you say in your language to show that two people groups that live near each other have a close relationship? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller talks about some of Gad's descendants. These descendants are not Gad's sons, but they must have descended from Gad's sons. Joel was the leader of the main clan, and Shapham led the second clan. Janai and Shaphat were the leaders of other clans in the Bashan region. However, Joel and Shapham might have been the two most important leaders of the same clan. It is also possible that Joel led the tribe of Gad, Shapham was second in command, and Janai and Shaphat followed them. These men's exact roles and relationships are unclear.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you talk about Joel, Shapham, Janai, and Shaphat since their roles and relationships in this story are not very clear? Pause this audio here.

The four men were the relatives of leaders of seven other fathers' houses, or clans of the Reubenites: Michael, Meshullam, Sheba, Jorai, Jacan, Zia, and Eber. These seven men were all descendants of Abihail, son of Huri. Huri

was the son of Jaroah, and Jaroah was the son of Gilead. Gilead was the son of Michael. Michael was the son of Jeshishai. Jeshishai was the son of Jahdo, and Jahdo was the son of Buz.

The storyteller now introduces Ahi, who was the son of Abdiel, and Abdiel was the son of Guni. Ahi was the leader of the Gadite family clans that the storyteller mentioned before: the clans of Joel, Shapham, Janai, Shaphat, and their seven relatives, the other clan leaders. The Gadite people lived in the Gilead region, the Bashan region, and the nearby villages. The Gilead region was south of Bashan and stretched between the Yarmuk River in the north and the Arnon River in the south. The Gadites also lived in a place called Sharon. Sharon had many grassy fields where cattle, sheep, and goats could feed. The land belonged to the Gadites all the way to the borders of Sharon.

Stop here and locate the region of Gilead and Bashan on the map. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and, as a group, do the following: Find objects like sticks or pebbles that will represent all the descendants of Gad the storyteller spoke about in this story. Arrange the objects in groups to show the relationships that the various people had with each other. Talk about how you will show distant relatives, fathers and sons, and leaders. Pause this audio here.

The descendants of Gad wrote down the names of all the people the storyteller mentioned in a family record. The people did this during the reign of Jotham, king of Judah, and during the reign of Jeroboam, king of Israel. King Jotham ruled Judah, and King Jeroboam ruled Israel, around 750 years before Jesus. Since these two kings did not rule at exactly the same time, people likely wrote two separate family records for the tribe of Gad during their reigns.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:11–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Descendants of Gad
- Joel
- Shapham
- Janai
- Shaphat
- Michael
- Meshullam
- Sheba
- Jorai
- Jacan
- Zia
- Eber
- Abihail
- Huri
- Jaroah
- Gilead
- Michael
- Jeshishai
- Jahdo
- Buz
- Ahi
- Abdiel
- And Guni

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The descendants of Gad lived in the region of Bashan, north of the tribe of Reuben. The tribe of Gad's land reached all the way to the town of Salecah in the southeast. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing descendants of Gad, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We feel blessed that Yahweh has given us land next to the tribe of Reuben. We have a good relationship with them; or
- We are grateful that Yahweh gave us more land as our tribe and our herds and flocks increased. We used to be mostly in Gilead, but now we are also in Bashan; or
- We praise Yahweh for his faithfulness to us.

Continue the drama. Gad's descendant Joel led the main clan, and Shapham led the second clan. Janai and Shaphat were the leaders of other clans in the Bashan region.

The four men were the relatives of leaders of seven other clans of the Reubenites: Michael, Meshullam, Sheba, Jorai, Jakan, Zia, and Eber. These seven men were all descendants of Abihail, son of Huri. Huri was the son of Jaroah, and Jaroah was the son of Gilead. Gilead was the son of Michael. Michael was the son of Jeshishai. Jeshishai was the son of Jahdo, and Jahdo was the son of Buz.

Ahi was another descendant of Gad. Ahi was the son of Abdiel, and Abdiel was the son of Guni. Ahi was the leader of the Gadite family clans of Joel, Shapham, Janai, Shaphat, and their seven relatives, the other clan leaders. The Gadite people lived in the Gilead region, the Bashan region, and the nearby villages. The Gadites also lived in a place called Sharon. The land belonged to the Gadites all the way to the borders. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ahi, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh has given me a big blessing and a big task to lead the many clans of Gad; or
- Praise Yahweh for providing all the land we need to feed our herds and flocks, which Yahweh blessed us with.

Continue the drama. The descendants of Gad wrote down the names of all the people the storyteller mentioned in a family record. The descendants did this during the reign of Jotham, king of Judah, and during the reign of Jeroboam, king of Israel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the descendants of Gad, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are so glad that we have good family records and that we know who our ancestors were; or
- We are grateful that our ancestors knew the importance of family records and that they wrote family lists down twice, during the reign of Jotham, king of Judah, and during the reign of Jeroboam, king of Israel; or
- We are glad our ancestors obeyed Yahweh. Yahweh told Moses to keep a family record so we know which tribe we are from.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:11–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The sons, or descendants, of Gad lived in Bashan, which was north of the tribe of Reuben.

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Here, the word “sons” refers to the **descendants** of Gad. A descendant is any person from all future generations from the same family line. Use the same word or phrase for descendant as you used in previous passages. For more information on descendant, refer to the Master Glossary.

The storyteller talks about some of Gad’s descendants. These people are not Gad’s sons, but they must have descended from Gad’s sons. Joel was the **leader** of the main clan, and Shapham led the second clan. Here, the word leader means **chief**, or head of a group of men. Use the word or phrase for leader, or chief, as you used in previous passages.

The four men were the relatives of leaders of seven other fathers’ households, or clans of the Reubenites: Michael, Meshullam, Sheba, Jorai, Jakan, Zia, and Eber. Use the same word or phrase for clans as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **households**. “Fathers’ households,” or “houses,” refers to everyone who lives in a family home. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about household. Pause this audio here.

Ahi was another descendant of Gad. Ahi was the **son** of Abdiel, and Abdiel was the son of Guni.

Here, son refers to a biological male child. Use the same word or phrase for son as you used in previous passages. For more information on son, refer to the Master Glossary.

The descendants of Gad lived in Bashan and its outlying **villages**, and in the pasturelands of Sharon. Pasturelands were open land where cattle and sheep could eat grass. Use the same word for village, or small town that probably did not have a wall around it, as you have used previously.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **pasturelands**. Pause this audio here.

The descendants of Gad wrote down the names of all the people the storyteller mentioned in a **genealogy**, or family record. The descendants did this during the reign of Jotham, king of Judah, and during the reign of Jeroboam, king of Israel. Use the same word or phrase for genealogy as you used in previous passages. For more information on genealogy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same word or phrase for **king**, **Judah**, and Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, Judah, and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 5:11–17

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (847 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 5:18–26

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 5:18–26 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:18–26 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:18–26 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, we learned about the family history of the tribe of Gad, who some of Gad's descendants were, and where those people lived.

This story shows some of the history of the two-and-a-half Israelite tribes—Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh—who lived east of the Jordan River. The events in this story happened around 800 years before Christ was born. About 400 years before Jesus came, the storyteller shared this story with the Israelites who had recently come back to Israel after an enemy government held them captive for 70 years. Some Israelites return to their land, but the people of the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh do not. Although these tribes are still in exile, the storyteller likely wants to give the people of Israel hope. The storyteller wants to remind the people that Yahweh's promises still matter. The storyteller shows that Yahweh blesses people who want to follow him and punishes those who disobey his commands.

The tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh had a large army of 44,760 strong and brave men. The soldiers carried shields, swords, and bows. These men were skilled fighters and ready for war. The word for shield in the original language refers to a small, round shield that soldiers held in one hand at arm's length to protect their upper body and head. The storyteller uses a general word for a sword, which does not say whether the sword was long or short. The Israelites mostly used straight, double-edged iron swords about 45 to 60 centimetres long, or shorter dagger-like swords that people used as a backup weapon.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a typical Israelite sword, shield, and bow. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about the army in your people group. Who are the soldiers, how old are they, are they men or women, and what skills do they have? Are these people professional fighters or trained civilians? What weapons do these people use when they go to war? Pause this audio here.

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The people in the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh started a war against the Hagrites, and the people in Jetur, Naphish, and Nodab. The Hagrites were a group of people who lived in tents in the deserts east of the Jordan River. The Hagrites were enemies of Israel, and you may remember that the tribe of Reuben fought against them during the reign of King Saul. This story takes place about 300 years after the reign of King Saul, when the two-and-a-half tribes of Israel attacked the Hagrites and the other desert tribes that were the allies of the Hagrites. We do not know anything else about these other tribes.

God helped the soldiers from the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh fight against the Hagrites and the people in Jetur, Naphish, and Nodab. The war was probably very serious because both sides were fighting for the land. The people in the two-and-a-half Israelite tribes mainly raised cattle, and the enemy tribes on their eastern border were also shepherds. People disagreed about the pastureland, so they began to fight and destroy each other. God made the two-and-a-half Israelite tribes defeat the Hagrites and their allies. The Israelites won because they cried out or prayed to God during the battle or war. God answered their prayers because the people trusted God.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Why does your people group have battles with other people groups? Talk about a situation where the soldiers from your people group fought against another people group and their allies and won. Talk about why you think your people's soldiers won the war or battle. Pause this audio here.

The soldiers of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh captured the possessions of the Hagrites and their allies. The people took 50,000 camels, 250,000 sheep, and 2,000 donkeys. The people also took 100,000 people captive, including men, women, and children. Many Hagrite soldiers died in the war because God was fighting against them. The people of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh took over the land of the Hagrites. The people lived there until the time of exile, or captivity, when the Assyrians took the Israelite people away as captives to the land of Assyria.

Stop here and look at pictures of camels, sheep, and donkeys. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map and locate Israel, with the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh, and Assyria. Pause this audio here.

There were very many people in the half-tribe of Manasseh. These people lived in the land of Bashan, which was a fertile region east of the Jordan River. Yahweh gave most of the region to the half-tribe of Manasseh, but the tribe of Gad also lived in part of it. Manasseh's land reached as far north as the mountain Baal Hermon, which people also call Senir or Mount Hermon.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map and locate the land of the half-tribe of Manasseh. Pause this audio here.

The following men in the half-tribe of Manasseh were the leaders in their clans. These men's names were Epher, Ishi, Eliel, Azriel, Jeremiah, Hodaviah, and Jahdiel. These men were all very good soldiers and well-known heads of their clans. We do not know anything more about these men.

However, the people of the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh sinned against the God of their ancestors. These people did not worship the God of their ancestors. Instead, they worshipped the gods of the people who had lived in the land before, whom God had destroyed.

So, the God of Israel made King Pul of Assyria, also known as Tiglath-Pileser, invade the land of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh. God caused King Pul to feel strong emotions or ideas that led him to attack Israel. King Pul took people from the two-and-a-half Israelite tribes as captives. This was part of God's plan to punish Israel because they had turned away from God. The Assyrians exiled the Israelites to places east and north of the Assyrian capital, Nineveh. The Assyrians took the people to the region of Halah town, the Habor River, which flowed into the large Euphrates River, the region of Hara, and the Gozan River. The people stayed there until "this day," which means that the people in the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh stayed in exile, unlike some of the rest of the Israelites who came back.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map and find Assyria and the places where King Pul of Assyria took the Israelites as prisoners.

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Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:18–26 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has six scenes.

In the first scene: We learn that the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh had a large army of 44,760 strong and brave men. The soldiers carried shields, swords, and bows.

In the second scene: The people in the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh started a war against the Hagrites and the people in Jetur, Naphish, and Nodab. God helped the Israelite soldiers to defeat the enemy nations because they prayed to God and trusted him.

In the third scene: The soldiers of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh captured the possessions of the Hagrites and of their allies. The soldiers took 50,000 camels, 250,000 sheep, and 2,000 donkeys. They also took 100,000 people captive. The people in the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and half of Manasseh took the land from the Hagrites and lived there. The people stayed in that land until the Assyrians came and took them away as captives to Assyria.

In the fourth scene: We learn that the people of the half-tribe of Manasseh lived in Bashan, and the storyteller tells us the names of some of their clan leaders who were all outstanding soldiers and well-known.

In the fifth scene: The people of the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh sinned against the God of their ancestors. The people did not worship their ancestors' God. Instead, they worshipped the gods of the people who lived in the land and whom God had destroyed.

In the sixth scene: Because the two-and-a-half tribes were unfaithful to God, he made King Pul of Assyria, also called Tiglath-Pileser, invade their land. King Pul took them away as captives to places in Assyria. The people stayed there until the storyteller told this story.

The characters in this passage are:

- The Reubenites
- The Gadites
- The half-tribe of Manasseh
- Brave soldiers from the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh
- Enemy nations: the Hagrites and the people in Jetur, Naphish, and Nodab
- God
- 100,000 people from the enemy nations whom the Israelite soldiers took captive
- Heads of clans in the half-tribe of Manasseh: Epher, Ishi, Eliel, Azriel, Jeremiah, Hodaviah, and Jahdiel
- And Pul King of Assyria, also known as Tiglath-Pileser

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

There are three storylines in this story:

- First, the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh go to war against the Hagrites and their allies.
- Second, we hear about some of the family history of the half-tribe of Manasseh.
- Third, the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh are not faithful to God, and the Assyrian King Pul captures the tribes and takes them into exile.

The tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh had a large army of 44,760 strong and brave men. The soldiers carried shields and swords, and drew bows, which means that they were shooting arrows. These soldiers were skilled fighters, ready for war.

The word for shield in the original language refers to a small, round shield that soldiers held in one hand at arm's length to protect their upper body and head. The soldiers held a sword or another weapon in their other hand. People made shields out of wood or metal, and sometimes people covered wooden shields with leather. The

storyteller uses a general word for a sword that does not say whether the sword was long or short. The Israelites mostly used iron swords, which were either straight, double-edged swords about 45 to 60 centimeters long or shorter dagger-like swords that people used as a backup weapon. The Israelites also probably carried spears and slings as part of their weapons.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a typical Israelite sword, shield, and bow, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and, as a group, talk about the words or phrases in your language for different types of shields, swords, and bows. Pause this audio here.

The tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh started a war against the Hagrites and the people in Jetur, Naphish, and Nodab. God helped the soldiers of the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh to fight the Hagrites and the people in Jetur, Naphish, and Nodab. God delivered the Hagrites and their allies into the hands of the Israelite tribes, or into their power. In the original language, the word “allies” means all who were with the Hagrites. The people from the two-and-a-half tribes won because they cried out or prayed to God during the war. God answered the people’s prayers because they trusted God.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about other people groups who are with you, or who are your allies, in your culture? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you say in your language to show that people cried out or called out to God for help? What do you say to show that God caused the Israelite tribes to win the battle or war? Pause this audio here.

The soldiers of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh captured the livestock of the Hagrites and of their allies. The word “livestock” in the original language refers generally to possessions and can include fields, animals, and prisoners of war. The Israelite soldiers took 50,000 camels, 250,000 sheep, and 2,000 donkeys. The Israelites also took 100,000 people captive, including men, women, and children. The people of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh took over the land of the Hagrites. The people lived there until the time of exile, when the Assyrians took the people away as captives to the land of Assyria.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What word will you use for “livestock” that shows it includes more than just animals, which the Israelite tribes took? Pause this audio here.

There were very many people in the half-tribe of Manasseh. The people lived in the land of Bashan, which was a fertile region east of the Jordan River. Manasseh’s land reached as far north as the mountain Baal Hermon, which people also call Senir or Mount Hermon.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map and locate the land of the half-tribe of Manasseh. Pause this audio here.

The following men of the half-tribe of Manasseh were the leaders in their clans. These men’s names were Epher, Ishi, Eliel, Azriel, Jeremiah, Hodaviah, and Jahdiel. These men were all outstanding soldiers and well-known heads of their clans.

The storyteller shows that the three tribes—Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh—stopped being faithful to God. The storyteller does not say it directly, but he means all three tribes, not just the half-tribe of Manasseh. Now, the storyteller focuses on how all of them turned away from the God of Israel. However, the people of the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh sinned against the God of their ancestors. The word “sinned” here means to act treacherously or to be unfaithful. Whenever we hear the phrase “God of their ancestors,” it refers to Yahweh, the God who chose Israel to be his special people. The two-and-a-half tribes did not worship Yahweh. Instead, they worshipped the gods of the people who had lived in the land before, whom God had destroyed. The original language uses special language to show that these tribes of Israel were like a prostitute in how they were unfaithful to Yahweh. A prostitute is a person who has sexual relations outside of marriage in order to gain money.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How are you going to say that the two-and-a-half tribes sinned against Yahweh? What words or phrases are you going to use to show that these tribes were unfaithful like a prostitute? Pause this audio here.

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The storyteller now points out that what happens next is a result of the Israelites' sin against God. So, the God of Israel stirred up the spirit of King Pul of Assyria, also known as Tiglath-Pileser, to invade the land of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh. The human spirit is an invisible part of a person that God speaks to in order to influence what a person does. When God stirred up the spirit of King Pul, God made King Pul want to act. King Pul took the people away as captives. The Assyrians exiled the two-and-a-half Israelite tribes to places east and north of the Assyrian capital, Nineveh. The Assyrians took the people to the region of Halah town, the Habor River, which flowed into the large Euphrates River, the region of Hara, and the Gozan River. The people stayed there until "this day," which means the time when the storyteller told the story.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map and find Assyria and the places where King Pul of Assyria took the Israelites as prisoners. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:18–26 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has six scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The Reubenites
- The Gadites
- The half-tribe of Manasseh
- Brave soldiers from the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh
- Enemy nations: the Hagrites and the people in Jetur, Naphish, and Nodab
- God
- 100,000 people from the enemy nations whom the Israelite soldiers took captive
- Heads of clans in the half-tribe of Manasseh: Epher, Ishi, Eliel, Azriel, Jeremiah, Hodaviah, and Jahdiel
- And Pul King of Assyria, also known as Tiglath-Pileser

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh had a large army of 44,760 strong and brave men. The soldiers carried shields, swords, and bows and were skilled fighters, ready for war.

The tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh started a war against the Hagrites and the people in Jetur, Naphish, and Nodab. God helped the soldiers from the Israelite tribes fight against the enemy nations, and God made the Israelite tribes defeat the Hagrites and their allies. The Israelites won because they prayed to God during the war. God answered their prayers because they trusted God.

The soldiers of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh captured the possessions of the Hagrites and their allies. They took 50,000 camels, 250,000 sheep, and 2,000 donkeys. They also took 100,000 people captive. Many Hagrite soldiers died in the war because God was fighting against them. The people of Reuben, Gad, and the half-

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tribe of Manasseh took over the land of the Hagrites. The people lived there until the time of exile, when the Assyrians took them away as captives to the land of Assyria. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing soldiers from the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We feel grateful! Praise be to Yahweh, for he heard our prayers! Yahweh went before us and helped us win the war against the Hagrites and the people of Jetur, Naphish, and Nodab; or
- We feel so happy that we are now safe from these enemy nations! And we are happy with all their livestock we got! or
- We feel pleased that we can now use their land to feed our many animals!

Continue the drama. There were very many people in the half-tribe of Manasseh. The people lived in the land of Bashan, which was a fertile region east of the Jordan River. Manasseh's land reached as far north as the mountain Baal Hermon, which people also call Senir or Mount Hermon.

The following men from the half-tribe of Manasseh were the leaders in their clans. These men's names were Epher, Ishi, Eliel, Azriel, Jeremiah, Hodaviah, and Jahdiel. They were all outstanding soldiers and well-known heads of their clans.

However, the people of the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh sinned against the God of their ancestors. The people did not worship him. Instead, the people worshipped the gods of the people who lived in the land. These were the nations that God had destroyed.

So, the God of Israel made King Pul of Assyria, also known as Tiglath-Pileser, invade the land of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh. King Pul took the people away as captives. The Assyrians took the people to the region of Halah town, the Habor River, which flowed into the large Euphrates River, the region of Hara, and the Gozan River. The people stayed there until the time when the storyteller told the story. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing people from the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We feel free! Surely we do not have to obey only Yahweh. Surely it is fine to have wives from the land we conquered. Maybe they will want to follow Yahweh, but surely we can follow their gods too; or
- We are scared! The Assyrians have invaded our land! Is Yahweh punishing us? or
- We regret abandoning Yahweh. Yahweh blessed us when we followed his laws. Now it is too late, and the Assyrians have taken us into captivity! We must live in their land and obey their laws!

Ask the person playing God, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I cry for my people, Israel. I love the Israelites so much, but they are unfaithful to me and are going after worthless idols; or
- My heart is broken. I thought Israel would call me "Father" and not turn away from following me; or
- I am so sad. I raised Israel as my children and brought them up, but they have rebelled against me. I will discipline the Israelites and send them into exile, so they recognise their own wickedness and repent and turn to me.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 5:18–26 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The soldiers carried shields and swords, and drew bows.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a typical Israelite sword, shield, and bow, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **shield**, **sword**, and **bow**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

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God helped the soldiers of the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh to fight the Hagrites and the people in Jetur, Naphish, and Nodab. God delivered the Hagrites and their allies **into the hands** of the Israelite tribes. This means that God gave the Israelites power over the Hagrites. Use the same phrase for "delivered into the hands of Israelites" as you used in previous passages.

The people from the two-and-a-half tribes won because they cried out or prayed to God during the war. God answered their urgent cry for help because they trusted God.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **cry for help** to God, or **pray** to God. Look up pray in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated "cry for help" to mean prayer in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller lists the leaders, or chiefs of the **households** of these tribes, who were fighting men and famous. Use the same word or phrase for households, or father's houses, that you have used in previous passages. Household is in the Master Glossary.

However, the people of the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh were unfaithful to the God of their ancestors. The people sinned—they did not worship him. Instead, they worshipped the gods of the people who had lived in the land before, whom God had destroyed. These gods were false gods, not the one true creator God.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **gods**. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

So, the **God** of **Israel** stirred up the spirit of King Pul of Assyria, also known as Tiglath-Pileser, to invade the land of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh. The human spirit is the invisible part of a person that God speaks to in order to influence what that person does. When God stirred up the spirit of King Pul, God made King Pul want to act. Use the same word or phrase for God and Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on God and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **spirit**. Look up spirit in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Use the same word or phrase for **king** as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 5:18–26

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (821 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 6:1–15

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 6:1–15 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:1–15 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, the storyteller told us some of the history of the two-and-a-half Israelite tribes—Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh. People from these tribes won a battle against the Hagrites and their allies because the Israelites prayed to God for help. But later, the people from the two-and-a-half Israelite tribes sinned when they worshipped other gods instead of the true God. So God punished the people by sending the king of Assyria, who took them away as captives.

Next, the storyteller shares several stories from the family history of the tribe of Levi. The Levites lived all over Israel and helped the Israelites worship Yahweh wherever they were, no matter what happened in Israel's history. The family history of the tribe of Levi is the second longest in 1 Chronicles. The tribe of Levi is one of only two tribes that the storyteller follows right to the time of the exile. This shows how important the Levites were in the story of Israel. The storyteller puts the tribe of Levi in the centre of all the 12 tribes' family histories. You will remember from the book of Numbers that when the Israelites camped in the wilderness, the Levites stayed at the centre, close to the tabernacle or the special tent where Yahweh's presence was. All the other tribes camped around the Levites. This showed that worshiping Yahweh was the most important part of Israel's life.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When you tell a story about different family clans or groups in a family history, how do you make one clan stand out above others because of the important things they do? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller is telling the story to the Israelites who returned to their land after 70 years in captivity in Babylon. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that the most important thing they can do is to worship Yahweh.

1 Chronicles 6:1–15

In this story, the storyteller tells us the family history of the family line of the high priests. The high priest served as Israel's most important spiritual leader and helped the people stay close to Yahweh. The high priest offered sacrifices to Yahweh for the people's sins, took care of the tabernacle or temple, led worship, and taught the people Yahweh's laws and how to obey those laws. The high priest also prayed for the Israelites and asked Yahweh to bless and protect them. The storyteller lists the high priests first to show how important worship was for Yahweh's people.

Levi was the third son of Jacob and the great-grandson of Abraham. Levi was the father of Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Now the family list focuses on the descendants of Kohath from whom the high priests came. Kohath was the father of Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. Amram had two sons, Aaron and Moses, and a daughter, Miriam. While Aaron, Moses, and Miriam were from the family of Levi, only the direct descendants of Aaron served as high priests. You might remember that after the Israelites left Egypt, Yahweh gave Moses instructions for the priesthood on Mount Sinai. Yahweh chose Aaron to be the first high priest and Aaron's sons to be priests.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When you tell a story about a family history, how do you decide which people to include? Tell a story about a particular time in your family's history. Explain why you have included some people and not others. Pause this audio here.

Aaron was the father of Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar. You will remember that Yahweh killed Aaron's oldest sons, Nadab and Abihu, because they disobeyed Yahweh. Therefore, after Aaron's death, Yahweh chose Aaron's third son, Eleazar, to be high priest. Eleazar helped Joshua to divide the Promised Land among the tribes of Israel. Eleazar was the father of Phinehas. You will remember that people knew Phinehas had zeal for Yahweh. Phinehas killed an Israelite man who sinned with a Midianite woman, and this action caused Yahweh to stop a plague that Yahweh had sent on Israel as judgment. Because of what Phinehas did, Yahweh promised Phinehas that his family would always serve as priests.

Phinehas was the father of Abishua, who became the high priest after Phinehas. Abishua was the father of Bukki, who passed the high priestly line to his son Uzzi. Uzzi then served as high priest, likely during the time when judges ruled the nation of Israel. Uzzi was the father of Zerahiah, who continued the high priestly line, and Zerahiah was the father of Meraioth. We do not know much about Zerahiah and Meraioth.

Meraioth was the father of Amariah, and Amariah was the father of Ahitub. Ahitub was the father of Zadok, who was the high priest during the reigns of King David and King Solomon. Zadok was the father of Ahimaaz, who helped King David during David's son Absalom's rebellion. Ahimaaz was the father of Azariah, and Azariah the father of Johanan. Johanan was the father of Azariah, who served as a high priest in the house or temple that Solomon built in Jerusalem. The temple is the place where the Israelites worshiped Yahweh. He is likely the same Azariah who opposed King Uzziah when King Uzziah wrongly tried to burn incense in the temple. Azariah was the father of Amariah, and Amariah was the father of Ahitub. Ahitub was the father of another Zadok, and Zadok was the father of Shallum. Shallum was the father of Hilkiah. Hilkiah found the scroll of Yahweh's law during the reign of Josiah, the king of Judah. Hilkiah helped King Josiah lead Israel to obey Yahweh's law again and restore worship. Hilkiah was the father of Azariah, and Azariah was the father of Seraiah, the last high priest before the Babylonian exile. Seraiah was the father of Jehozadak. At that time, Yahweh caused King Nebuchadnezzar to come and conquer the people of the kingdom of Judah and its capital city, Jerusalem. Nebuchadnezzar took the people away as captives to Babylon. Jehozadak, the last high priest in this story, was one of those captives.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map. Locate the two kingdoms of Israel and Judah and the kingdom of Babylon. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Some Bible stories, like this one, are family lists with mostly names. As you hear some of the history about the people on this list, why do you think the storyteller chose these names for the list? What is the storyteller trying to help the audience understand? Pause this audio here.

This family history is the longest list of high priests in the Old Testament. This history covers over 800 years, from about 1,400 years before Jesus to 600 years before Jesus. The storyteller names 23 generations of high priests from Aaron's family through Aaron's third son, Eleazar. This shows that the high priestly family line continued unbroken. But the list is not complete and does not include every high priest in Israel's history.

Some of these high priests in the list also seem to have lived at a different time than when other Bible stories talk about them. We do not know exactly why this happened.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller follows the family line of Aaron, the first high priest, all the way back to Levi, who was Abraham's grandson. The storyteller lists the high priests of Israel from Aaron's time to the time when Israel was taking the land of Canaan.

In the second scene: The storyteller lists high priests of Israel from the time of the Judges to the time of King David and King Solomon.

In the third scene: The storyteller lists high priests of the Israelites from the time when Yahweh divided the kingdom of Israel into Israel and Judah until the time of the Babylonian exile.

The characters in this passage are:

- Levi and his sons: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari
- Kohath's sons: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel
- Amram's children: Aaron, Moses, and Miriam
- Aaron's sons: Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar
- And Eleazar's descendants: Phinehas, Abishua, Bukki, Uzzi, Zerahiah, Meraioth, Amariah, Ahitub, Zadok, Ahimaaz, Azariah, Johanan, Azariah, Amariah, another Ahitub, Zadok, Shallum, Hilkiah, Azariah, Seriah, and Jehozadak
- Yahweh
- And Nebuchadnezzar

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this story, the storyteller shares the family history of the high priests. The storyteller shows that the high priest's family line began with Levi, who was Abraham's great-grandson.

The storyteller lists the names of all the high priests in one long list, so it may help to divide the names into important time periods.

In scene one, the storyteller follows the family line of Aaron, the first high priest, all the way back to Levi, who was Abraham's great-grandson. The storyteller lists the high priests of Israel from Aaron's time to the time when Israel was taking the land of Canaan.

Levi had three sons: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. The word sons in this part of the story means that these three men were Levi's biological sons.

Kohath had four sons: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel.

Amram had two sons, Aaron and Moses, and a daughter called Miriam.

Aaron was the first high priest. Aaron had four sons: Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.

Eleazar became high priest after Aaron died. After this, the storyteller only names the son of each high priest who became high priest after his father died. When the storyteller says that Eleazar fathered Phinehas or became the father of Phinehas, it means that Eleazar's son Phinehas became high priest after Eleazar died.

Exodus 6:16–26 also lists some of Levi's descendants.

Stop here. If you have already translated Levi's family history in Exodus, listen to the story together as a team. Pay close attention to the names and how you translated them in the other story. Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 6:1–15

In scene two, the storyteller begins the second group of high priests in Israel with Abishua, the son of Phinehas, when the Judges ruled Israel. From this name on, the list follows the same structure and shows how each high priest was the son of the one before him. This group also includes Abishua's descendants: Bukki, Uzzi, Zerahiah, Meraioth, Amariah, and Ahitub. The last high priest in this group is Ahitub's son Zadok, who served during the time of King David and King Solomon.

In scene three, the storyteller begins the third group of high priests in Israel with Zadok's son Ahimaaz, who lived when Yahweh divided Israel into two kingdoms, Israel and Judah. This group also includes Ahimaaz's descendants: Azariah, Johanan, Azariah, Amariah, Ahitub, Zadok, Shallum, Hilkiah, Azariah, and Seraiah. The group ends with Seraiah's son Jehozadak, when Yahweh allowed Nebuchadnezzar to take Jehozadak and the people of the kingdom of Judah, including those in its capital city Jerusalem, as captives to Babylon. The storyteller says that Yahweh sent the people into exile by the hand, or power, of Nebuchadnezzar.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the map. Locate the two kingdoms of Israel and Judah and the kingdom of Babylon. Pause this audio here.

You will notice that there are several high priests in the family list who had the same name, but were different people.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Levi and his sons: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari
- Kohath's sons: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel
- Amram's children: Aaron, Moses, and Miriam
- Aaron's sons: Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar
- And Eleazar's descendants: Phinehas, Abishua, Bukki, Uzzi, Zerahiah, Meraioth, Amariah, Ahitub, Zadok, Ahimaaz, Azariah, Johanan, Azariah, Amariah, Ahitub, Zadok, Shallum, Hilkiah, Azariah, Seriah, and Jehozadak.
- Yahweh
- And Nebuchadnezzar

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite listening to the passage.

First, the person playing the author should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If this section is too difficult to remember, you may listen to an audio recording again.

While you do this, think about the role of the high priests in the life of the Israelites. Think how the high priests' service to Yahweh affected the Israelites individually and as a nation over the years. High priests helped the Israelites by leading the people in worship and offering sacrifices to Yahweh. The high priests taught the people Yahweh's laws and prayed for them. As a nation, the Israelites depended on the high priests to keep the people close to Yahweh and guide them to follow Yahweh's commands.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should listen to this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Levi had three sons: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Kohath had four sons: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. Amram had two sons, Aaron and Moses, and a daughter called Miriam. Aaron was the first high priest. Aaron had four sons: Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar. Eleazar was the father of Phinehas. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the storyteller of 1 Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am amazed! Yahweh has had such a clear plan for how the people of Israel would know and worship him; or
- Yahweh chose the descendants of Aaron, who were from the tribe of Levi, to be high priests and teach the people how to worship Yahweh; or
- Yahweh loves the people of Israel so much that he forgave them their sins when the priests offered sacrifices.

Continue the drama. The storyteller begins the second group of high priests in Israel with Abishua, the son of Phinehas. This group also includes Abishua's descendants: Bukki, Uzzi, Zerahiah, Meraioth, Amariah, and Ahitub. The last high priest in this group is Ahitub's son Zadok. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We praise Yahweh for the high priests who serve him. We are grateful that the high priests do not have their own land, but live among us all throughout Israel; or
- The high priests teach us how to worship Yahweh and how to be right with Yahweh. The high priests pray for our nation, too; or
- The high priests help our kings to lead our nation. The high priests use the ephod to ask Yahweh what to do.

Continue the drama. The storyteller begins the third group of high priests in Israel with Ahimaaz. This group also includes Ahimaaz's descendants: Azariah, Johanan, Azariah, Amariah, Ahitub, Zadok, Shallum, Hilkiah, Azariah, and Seraiah. The group ends with Jehozadak when Nebuchadnezzar took him and the people of the kingdom of Judah, including those in its capital Jerusalem, as captives to Babylon. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh has used the high priests and prophets to tell us to repent of our sin for so many years; or
- We are sorry that we did not obey Yahweh and that we worshipped other gods instead; or
- We are so sad, because Yahweh punished us for disobeying him. Yahweh sent the Assyrians and then the Babylonians to conquer our kingdom and take us into captivity.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Stop here. If you have already translated Levi's family history in Exodus 6:16–26, listen to the story together as a team. Pay close attention to the names and how you translated them in the other story. Pause this audio here.

The **sons** of Levi were Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Throughout this passage, the word sons refers to biological male children of the father. Use the same word or phrase for son as you used in previous passages. For more information on son, refer to the Master Glossary.

Azariah served as a high priest in the house or temple that Solomon built in Jerusalem. Priests were people who worked in the temple of God in Jerusalem. God had appointed priests to be in between God and the people. Priests made it possible for people to come before God and to have a good relationship with God. The priests did this by offering sacrifices on behalf of the people and by teaching people how to live.

The temple is the place where the Israelites worshiped God. Another name for the temple is the house of God.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **priest** and **temple**. Look up priest and temple in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh sent the people of **Judah** and Jerusalem into exile **by the hand of Nebuchadnezzar**. Use the same word for Yahweh and Judah as you have used previously, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information. Use

the same phrase for “by the hand of Nebuchadnezzar” as you have used previously to show that someone did something using their strength.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 6:1–15

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (451 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (982 KB)
- Speaking the Word (635 KB)

1 Chronicles 6:16–30

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 6:16–30 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:16–30 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:16–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, the storyteller started to tell us the family history of the tribe of Levi. The storyteller began with the family line of the high priests, who all descended from Levi's great-grandson Aaron.

In this story, the storyteller continues with the family history of the tribe of Levi. We learn about three clans of Levi's descendants who were not high priests but carried out important duties at the tent of meeting, or tabernacle.

Levi was the third son of Jacob and the great-grandson of Abraham. Levi had three sons: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Each of Levi's sons also had sons. Gershon was the father of two sons, Libni and Shimei. Kohath was the father of four sons, Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. Merari was the father of two sons, Mahli and Mushi. The sons of Levi were the ancestors of the Levite clans or family groups. The storyteller introduces the Levite clans next.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: The storyteller begins by reminding us that the families in this story all came from Levi. Levi was one of the sons of Israel, or Jacob. Yahweh gave clans in Levi's large family different jobs. Who can you think of in your family who is really important or who started your family line? Tell a story of your family by starting with that person, just like the storyteller started with Levi. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller begins with the clan of Gershon, Levi's firstborn son. The storyteller lists a number of generations of the descendants of Gershon's firstborn son, Libni. Libni's son was Jehath. Jehath's son was Zimmah. Zimmah's son was Joah. Joah's son was Iddo, and Iddo's son was Zerah. Zerah was the father of Jeatherai.

You will remember that Yahweh gave each Levite clan an important job. As the Israelites travelled from place to place on their way to the Promised Land, the Levite clans took care of and carried parts of the tent of meeting, or tabernacle. The Israelites set up the tent of meeting in the centre of the Israelite camp, and this tent was very important for the Israelites because it was the place where people met with Yahweh. The Israelites worshipped Yahweh at the tent of meeting and brought their sacrifices there. Yahweh also spoke to Moses in the tent of meeting. And once a year, on the Day of Atonement, the high priest went into the tent of meeting to offer a special sacrifice to ask Yahweh to cover over the people's sins and to restore Yahweh's relationship with the people.

Yahweh gave the Gershonite clan, including the family line of Gershon's second son Shimei, the responsibility to care for and carry all the coverings of the tent, the curtains that were at the entrance to the tent and courtyard, and the curtains that formed a fence around the courtyard.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Yahweh gave each Levite clan its own special job to help with the spiritual life of Israel. Talk about different members of your family and the different responsibilities they have. Who is responsible for the spiritual life of your family? Who looks after elderly relatives? Who looks after family records? Who looks after family property? Who assigns these different tasks to various family members? What roles do members of your family have traditionally? What customs do you still follow today? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller now talks about the family history of the Kohathites, who were descendants of Levi's second son, Kohath. The storyteller lists many generations of Kohath's descendants. The storyteller begins the Kohathite family history with Kohath's son Amminadab, whose son was Korah. No other story in the Bible refers to Amminadab as Kohath's son, and we know from Exodus 6:21 that Korah was the son of Kohath's second son, Izhar. It is possible that Amminadab is another name for Izhar or that a scribe, or the person who wrote down a copy of this story, made an error. You will remember that Korah, along with other leaders of Israel, rebelled against Moses and Aaron. Yahweh punished these men by killing them and their families, but Korah's children did not die. Korah was the father of Assir, and Assir's son was Elkanah, the father of Ebiasaph. The storyteller in Exodus 6:24 lists Assir, Elkanah, and Ebiasath as three sons of Korah. This is a different family relationship from what the storyteller says here. Ebiasath was the father of another Assir. Assir was the father of Tahath. Tahath was the father of Uriel. Uriel was the father of Uzziah. Uzziah was the father of Shaul.

1 Chronicles 6:16–30

Elkanah, who was likely the son of Shaul, was the father of Amasai and Ahimoth. Ahimoth was the father of another Elkanah, who was the father of Zophai. Zophai was the father of Nahath, and Nahath was the father of Eliab. Eliab was the father of Jeroham, and Jeroham was the father of another Elkanah. You will remember from 1 Samuel chapter 1 that Elkanah and his ancestors, including Zophai, or Zuph, lived in the hill country of Ephraim. We know from 1 Samuel chapter 1 that Elkanah was the father of Samuel, who was a prophet and a judge over Israel, and who also carried out priestly duties. Samuel helped lead the people of Israel, taught them to follow God, and helped choose their first two kings, Saul and David. Samuel was honest, brave, and trusted Yahweh in everything. Samuel was the father of Joel and Abijah. When Samuel grew old, Samuel made his sons judges to help lead the people of Israel, just like Samuel had done. But Samuel's sons did not follow Samuel's example and were unfair and took bribes. Instead of helping people, Samuel's sons used their power the wrong way.

In the previous story, the storyteller told us about the Kohathite family line, who descended from Kohath's son Amram and who were high priests. The Kohathites in this story, who descended from Kohath's son Izhar, here called Amminadab, also had an important job. These Kohathites were responsible for caring for and carrying the most sacred or holy objects within the tent of meeting, or tabernacle. These items included the ark of the covenant, the showbread table, the golden lampstand, and the altars. The Kohathites also took care of and carried the utensils the priests used to serve in the tent of meeting and the curtain at the entrance to the Most Holy Place.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: As you have just heard, there are names like Elkanah that appear again and again in the family line. Talk about the different traditions people follow to give names to children in your culture. Discuss your own family histories and talk about names that repeat over time. Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller talks about the family history of Merari, Levi's third son. Merari had two sons, but the storyteller only follows the family line of Merari's firstborn son, Mahli, and lists several generations of Mahli's descendants. Mahli was the father of Libni. Libni was the father of Shimei. Shimei was the father of Uzzah. Uzzah's son was Shimea. Shimea's son was Haggiah. Haggiah's son was Asaiah.

The Merarites had an important job to take care of and move the parts that held up the tent of meeting. The Merarites were in charge of the framework, the pillars, and the boards that made up the tent. The Merarites also took care of the courtyard. Whenever the Israelites set up camp or traveled, the Merarites made sure that people built the tent of meeting correctly and stayed strong during the journey. This was very important to keep the tent in good shape as the people moved through the wilderness.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:16–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller lists the sons and grandsons of Levi.

In the second scene: The storyteller lists some of the descendants of Levi's firstborn son, Gershon.

In the third scene: The storyteller lists some of the descendants of Levi's second son, Kohath.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller lists some of the descendants of Levi's third son, Merari.

The characters in this passage are:

- Levi
- Levi's three sons: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari
- Gershon's sons: Libni and Shimei
- Kohath's sons: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel
- Merari's sons: Mahli and Mushi
- Gershon's descendants: Libni, Jahath, Zimmah, Joah, Iddo, Zerah, and Jeatherai

- Kohath's descendants: Amminadab, which is possibly another name for Kohath's second son Izhar, Korah, Assir, Elkanah, Ebiasaph, Assir, Tahath, Uriel, Uzziah, Shaul, Amasai, Ahimoth, Elkanah, Zophai, Nahath, Eliab, Jeroham, Elkanah, Samuel, Joel, and Abijah
- And Merari's descendants: Mahli, Libni, Shimei, Uzzah, Shimea, Haggiah, and Asaiah

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this story, the storyteller continues with the family history of the tribe of Levi. We learn about three clans of Levi's descendants who carried out important duties at the tent of meeting, or the tabernacle.

First, the storyteller shows that the clans started from Levi, Abraham's great-grandson.

Levi had three sons: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Each of Levi's sons also had sons. Gershon was the father of two sons, Libni and Shimei. Kohath was the father of four sons: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. Merari was the father of two sons: Mahli and Mushi. The word son here means a biological male child.

Stop here and start to make a family tree of Levi's descendants. Gather lots of pebbles to represent people and sticks to make connections between people that the pebbles represent. Start by putting down on the ground the pebble for Levi. Then put down three pebbles below the "Levi" pebble to represent Levi's three sons: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Join the "son" pebbles to the "Levi" pebble with three sticks. Then put down pebbles to represent Levi's grandsons and join them to the correct "father" pebbles. Continue to put down pebbles as you hear the names of the other descendants of Levi. Pause this audio here.

Exodus 6:16–26 also lists some of Levi's descendants.

Stop here. If you have already translated Levi's family history in Exodus, listen to the story together as a team. Pay close attention to the names. Make sure you use the same names for the same people. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller begins with the clan of Gershon, Levi's firstborn son. The storyteller lists a number of generations of the descendants of Gershon's firstborn son, Libni. From this point on, the list follows the same structure and shows how each man was the son of the one before him. Jahath was Libni's son, Zimmah was Jahath's son, and Joah was Zimmah's son. Iddo was Joah's son, Zerah was Iddo's son, and Jeatherai was Zerah's son.

The storyteller now lists many generations of Kohath's descendants. The storyteller introduces the list by saying, "The sons of Kohath." Please note that the word "son" has two meanings. Here, the word "sons" means descendants. But from this point on, the word "son" means biological male child. The storyteller begins the Kohathite family history with Kohath's son Amminadab, whose son was Korah. No other story in the Bible refers to Amminadab as Kohath's son, and we know from Exodus 6:21 that Korah was the son of Kohath's second son, Izhar. It is possible that Amminadab is another name for Izhar or that a scribe, or the person who wrote down a copy of this story, made an error. Korah was the father of Assir, and Assir's son was Elkanah, and Elkanah's son was Ebiasaph. The storyteller in Exodus 6:24 lists Assir, Elkanah, and Ebiasaph as three sons of Korah. This is a different family relationship from what the storyteller says here. Assir was Ebiasaph's son, Tahath was Assir's son, and Uriel was Tahath's son. Uzziah was Uriel's son, and Shaul was Uzziah's son.

Elkanah, who was likely the son of Shaul, had two sons: Amasai and Ahimoth. There are several different Elkanahs in this passage, and here the storyteller tells us the descendants of Elkanah, who is likely the son of Shaul. Ahimoth was the father of another Elkanah, who was the father of Zophai. Zophai's son was Nahath, and Nahath's son was Eliab. Eliab's son was Jeroham, and Jeroham's son was another Elkanah. Even though this story does not say so, we know from 1 Samuel chapter 1 that this Elkanah was the father of Samuel. Samuel was the father of Joel and Abijah. The storyteller takes a little break in the structure to tell us which of Samuel's sons is firstborn.

Now the storyteller talks about the family history of Merari, Levi's third son. The storyteller tells us about several generations from Merari's first son, Mahli. The storyteller introduces the list by saying, "The sons of Merari." Here, the word "sons" means descendants. But from this point on, the word "son" means biological male child. Mahli was the father of Libni. Libni was the father of Shimei. Shimei's son was Uzzah. Uzzah's son was another Shimea. Shimea's son was Haggiah. Haggiah's son was Asaiah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: The storyteller is using the family lists of the Levite clans to tell a story about each clan. What story or important point is the storyteller telling in this passage through the different family lists of the Gershonites, the Kohathites, and the Merarites? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:16–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Levi
- Levi's three sons: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari
- Gershon's sons: Libni and Shimei
- Kohath's sons: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel
- Merari's sons: Mahli and Mushi
- Gershon's descendants: Libni, Jahath, Zimmah, Joah, Iddo, Zerah, and Jeatherai
- Kohath's descendants: Amminadab, which is possibly another name for Kohath's second son Izhar, Korah, Assir, Elkanah, Ebiasaph, Assir, Tahath, Uriel, Uzziah, Shaul, Amasai, Ahimoth, Elkanah, Zophai, Nahath, Eliab, Jeroham, Elkanah, Samuel, Joel, and Abijah
- And Merari's descendants: Mahli, Libni, Shimei, Uzzah, Shimea, Haggiah, and Asaiah

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person playing the author should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If this section is too difficult to remember, you may listen to an audio recording again.

While you do this, think about the story that the storyteller is telling through each family line. Yahweh gave each Levite clan an important job. As the Israelites travelled from place to place on their way to the Promised Land, the Levite clans took care of and carried parts of the tent of meeting, or tabernacle. The tent of meeting was set up in the centre of the Israelite camp and was very important for the Israelites because it was the place where people met with Yahweh. The Israelites worshipped Yahweh at the tent of meeting and brought their sacrifices there. Yahweh also spoke to Moses in the tent of meeting. And once a year, on the Day of Atonement, the high priest went into the tent of meeting to offer a special sacrifice to ask Yahweh to forgive the people's sins.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should listen to this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Levi had three sons: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Each of Levi's sons also had sons. Gershon was the father of two sons: Libni and Shimei. Kohath was the father of four sons: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. Merari was the father of two sons: Mahli and Mushi. The word son here means a biological male child. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the storyteller of 1 Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am grateful that Yahweh had such a clear plan of who should help the people of Israel to stay close to him. Yahweh chose the Levites to do that job; or
- I am in awe! Yahweh gave me very clear instructions about how to tell the story about each Levite family line. Yahweh had a reason why he wanted the Israelites to know who was in each clan; or

- Each time I have told the story about the clans from the tribe of Levi, Yahweh has told me to make it clear that Levi was at the beginning of this important Israelite clan or tribe.

Continue the drama. Gershon was the father of Libni. Libni's son was Jahath. Jahath's son was Zimmah. Zimmah's son was Joah. Joah's son was Iddo, and Iddo's son was Zerah. Zerah was the father of Jeatherai.

Kohath was the father of Amminadab, whose son was Korah. Korah was the father of Assir, and Assir's son was Elkanah, the father of Ebiasaph. Ebiasaph was the father of Assir. Assir was the father of Tahath. Tahath was the father of Uriel. Uriel was the father of Uzziah. Uzziah was the father of Shaul. Elkanah was the father of Amasai and Ahimoth. Ahimoth was the father of Elkanah, who was the father of Zophai. Zophai was the father of Nahath, and Nahath was the father of Eliab. Eliab was the father of Jeroham, and Jeroham was the father of Elkanah. According to 1 Samuel chapter 1, Elkanah was the father of Samuel, and Samuel was the father of Joel and Abijah.

Merari was the father of Mahli, and Mahli was the father of Libni. Libni was the father of Shimei, and Shimei was the father of Uzzah. Uzzah's son was another Shimea. Shimea's son was Haggiah, and Haggiah's son was Asaiah. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are curious why Yahweh is reminding us about these clans of Levi. The storyteller mentions some names and not others; or
- We are grateful to Yahweh for the Gershonites, the Kohathites, and the Merarites. Yahweh gave each Levite clan a specific job, and they cared for the tent of meeting before Solomon built the temple; or
- We are grateful that the Levites helped us to stay close to Yahweh and worship him.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:16–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Stop here. If you have already translated Levi's family history in Exodus 6:16–26, listen to the story together as a team. Pay close attention to the names. Make sure you use the same names for the same people. Pause this audio here.

When the storyteller lists the **sons** of Levi, he is referring to Levi's biological sons.

However, when the storyteller begins a list by saying "the sons of Kohath, the sons of Elkanah, or the sons of Merari," the storyteller is probably saying that he is about to list several of the **descendants** of Kohath, Elkanah, or Merari, and probably not just their biological sons.

Use the same word or phrase for son or descendant as you used in previous passages. For more information on sons and descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

The storyteller says that these are the **clans**, or family groups, of the Levites according to their fathers. Use the same word or phrase for clan or family group as you used in previous passages. Levites are people who belong to the tribe of Levi, one of the 12 tribes of Israel.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Levites**. Look up Levites in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The phrase "according to their fathers" means that the storyteller listed the Levite clans according to their fathers' **households**, or families. Use the same word or phrase for households as you have in previous passages. "Household" is in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 6:16–30

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (462 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (658 KB)

1 Chronicles 6:31–48

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 6:31–48 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:31–48 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:31–48 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 6:31–48

In the last story, the storyteller talked about three family groups from Levi's tribe who had important jobs to look after and carry different parts of the tent of meeting. The storyteller listed the descendants of Gershon's firstborn son, Libni, the descendants of Kohath's son, Amminadab, and the descendants of Merari's firstborn son, Mahli.

In this story, the storyteller tells us about the men from the tribe of Levi whom King David put in charge of the music at the house of Yahweh, or the tabernacle. David chose these men when he and the Levites brought the ark of the covenant to the tabernacle in Jerusalem. The ark was a special wooden box that held the tablets with God's commandments, a jar of manna, and Aaron's staff that had budded. The ark reminded the Israelites that God was with the Israelites and had promised to take care of them if they obeyed God. After the Philistines stole the ark of the covenant and then gave it back, the ark stayed in the homes of Israelites for over 20 years and not in the tent of meeting. David brought the ark to Jerusalem, the royal city, to honor God, show that God was the true King, and make Jerusalem the place where everyone could worship together.

The musicians served by making music at the tabernacle, or the tent of meeting. Later, King Solomon, King David's son, built the house of Yahweh, or the temple, in Jerusalem, which was a permanent building where Yahweh met with his people. The musicians continued to worship Yahweh with music and songs in the temple. The musicians did all their musical duties according to the instructions Yahweh had given them through David.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the pictures of the tabernacle, or tent of meeting and the temple. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What role does music play in the religions of your people group? Who is in charge of the music, and what are their responsibilities? Who creates the music? What instruments do the musicians use? Pause this audio here.

These men and their sons were in charge of the music to worship Yahweh. The storyteller lists three main families of Levites that David appointed to organize music at the tent of meeting and who continued their work in the temple when Solomon built it. They were the family of Heman, who descended from Levi's son Kohath, the family of Asaph, who descended from Levi's son Gershon, and the family of Ethan, also called Jeduthun in other passages, who descended from Levi's son Merari.

In the clan of the Kohathites was a man named Heman who was the head musician. Heman was the son of Joel. Joel was the son of Samuel. Samuel was the son of Elkanah. Elkanah was the son of Jeroham. Jeroham was the son of Eliel. Eliel was the son of Toah. Toah was the son of Zuph, whom the storyteller also called Zophai in the previous story. Zuph was the son of Elkanah. Elkanah was the son of Mahath. Mahath was the son of Amasai. Amasai was the son of another Elkanah. Elkanah was the son of Joel. Joel was the son of Azariah. Azariah was the son of Zephaniah. Zephaniah was the son of Tahath. Tahath was the son of Assir. Assir was the son of Ebiasaph. Ebiasaph was the son of Korah. Korah was the son of Izhar. Izhar was the son of Kohath. Kohath was the son of Levi. Levi was one of the 12 sons of Israel, whom people also called Jacob.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In the last story, the storyteller started the family list with the oldest person, Levi, and ended with his youngest descendant. But in this new story, the storyteller does the opposite. The storyteller starts with the youngest family member and ends with Israel, the oldest ancestor. How do people in your culture talk about their families? Do people start with the oldest people in the family or the youngest? Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller talks about the descendants of Levi's son Gershon. Heman's helper was Asaph from the clan of Gershon. Asaph stood on Heman's right side during worship at the tabernacle and worked with him. The right side in those days was a place of honour, strength, or support. So, when Asaph stood on Heman's right side, it showed that Asaph had an important role and worked closely with Heman, the main music leader. Asaph was the son of Berekiah. Berekiah was the son of Shimea. Shimea was the son of Michael. Michael was the son of Baaseiah. Baaseiah was the son of Malkijah. Malkijah was the son of Ethni. Ethni was the son of Zerah. Zerah was the son of Adaiah. Adaiah was the son of Ethan. Ethan was the son of Zimmah. Zimmah was the son of Shimei. Shimei was the son of Jahath. Jahath was the son of Gershon. Gershon was the son of Levi.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Asaph stood on Heman's right side in a place of importance and honour. In your culture, where do the most important musicians stand in a group? Where do the leaders stand? Where do the other musicians stand? Pause this audio here.

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Now the storyteller talks about the descendants of Levi's son Merari, who were serving on Heman's left side. Ethan, from the clan of Merari, was Heman and Asaph's helper, and Ethan was leading the men from his clan who served in worship. Ethan was the son of Kishi. Kishi was the son of Abdi. Abdi was the son of Malluch. Malluch was the son of Hashabiah. Hashabiah was the son of Amaziah. Amaziah was the son of Hilkiah. Hilkiah was the son of Amzi. Amzi was the son of Bani. Bani was the son of Shemer. Shemer was the son of Mahli. Mahli was the son of Mushi. Mushi was the son of Merari. In the previous story, Mahli and Mushi are brothers. It is possible that Mushi named one of his sons after his brothers. Merari was the son of Levi.

There were other descendants of Levi from Levi's sons Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. These descendants had other duties in the tabernacle, or the house of God.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:31–48 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us that this story is about men from the tribe of Levi whom King David chose to be in charge of the music at the house of Yahweh, or the tabernacle, when David and the Levites brought the ark of the covenant to the tent of meeting in Jerusalem. The men continued with their duties as musicians in the temple that King Solomon later built in Jerusalem.

In the second scene: The storyteller lists family members of the family of Heman, the head musician, who came from the family group of Kohath, Levi's middle son.

In the third scene: The storyteller lists family members of the family of Asaph, Heman's assistant, who came from the family group of Gershon, Levi's firstborn son.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller lists family members of the family of Ethan, Heman's other assistant, who came from the family group of Merari, Levi's youngest son.

In the fifth scene: The storyteller tells us that there were other descendants of Levi from Levi's sons Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. These descendants had other duties in the tabernacle, or the house of God.

The characters in this passage are:

- King David
- King Solomon
- The family group of Heman, the lead musician from the clan of Kohath: Heman, Joel, Samuel, Elkanah, Jeroham, Eliel, Toah, Zuph, Elkanah, Mahath, Amasai, Elkanah, Joel, Azariah, Zephaniah, Tahath, Assir, Ebiasaph, Korah, Izhar, Kohath, Levi, and Israel
- The family group of Heman's assistant Asaph, who came from the clan of Gershon: Asaph, Berekiah, Shimea, Michael, Baaseiah, Malkijah, Ethni, Zerah, Adaiah, Ethan, Zimmah, Shimei, Jahath, Gershon, and Levi
- The family group of Heman's other assistant, Ethan, who came from the clan of Merari: Ethan, Kishi, Abdi, Malluch, Hashabiah, Amaziah, Hilkiah, Amzi, Bani, Shemer, Mahli, Mushi, Merari, and Levi (Levi appears three times in this list of characters as all three family groups descended from him)
- And other descendants of Levi from his sons Gershon, Kohath, and Merari, who had other duties in the tabernacle

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller tells us who this story is about—men from the tribe of Levi whom King David chose to be in charge of the music at the house of Yahweh, or the tabernacle. This happened when King David and the Levites brought the ark of the covenant to the tabernacle in Jerusalem. The men worshipped Yahweh with music and songs at the tabernacle, or tent of meeting, in Jerusalem until King Solomon built the house of Yahweh, or the temple. The musicians stood in front of the tabernacle, likely near the entrance to the holy place, but outside the tent itself. The musicians sang and played instruments like harps, lyres, cymbals, and trumpets. The musicians praised

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Yahweh, gave thanks, and helped the Israelites worship. The musicians did this every day and during special times. In the temple, the musicians stood in the courtyard, just east of the altar and in front of the holy place. The men performed their service according to their order, which means that they did all their musical duties according to the instructions Yahweh had given them through David.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the pictures of the tabernacle, or tent of meeting and the temple, if needed. Locate the position where the musicians likely stood. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you say in your language when you are doing something according to specific instructions someone gave you? How will you say that the men performed their service according to their order? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller in the previous story, 1 Chronicles 6:16–30, already talked about some of Levi's family. The storyteller mentions some of those same people again in this story.

Stop here. Listen to the previous story together as a team. Pay close attention to the names. Make sure you use the same names for the same people. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and make a family tree for Heman, Asaph, and Ethan's families as you listen to the next part of this passage! Use pebbles to show each person, and sticks to show who is whose father. Start with a pebble for Heman, then add pebbles going up to show Heman's father, grandfather, and other ancestors. At the very top, put a pebble for Israel, or Jacob. Do the same for Asaph and Ethan, who worked with Heman. Connect all the son pebbles with the father pebbles above to show the family link. The three family groups should meet at Levi's pebble, just below Israel's, because Levi was the tribe leader from whom the three families descended. Pause this audio here.

These men and their sons organized the music to worship Yahweh. The storyteller lists family members of the family of Heman, the head musician. Heman came from the sons, or descendants of Kohath. Heman was the son of Joel. Please note that the word "son" has two meanings. The storyteller first says, "sons of the Kohathites," which means descendants. But when the storyteller talks about Heman being the son of Joel, he means a biological male child. From this point on, the list follows the same structure and shows how each man was the son of the one before him. Joel was the son of Samuel. Samuel was the son of Elkanah. Elkanah was the son of Jeroham. Jeroham was the son of Eliel. Eliel was the son of Toah. Toah was the son of Zuph, whom the storyteller also called Zophai in the previous story. Zuph was the son of Elkanah. Elkanah was the son of Mahath. Mahath was the son of Amasai. Amasai was the son of Elkanah. Elkanah was the son of Joel. Joel was the son of Azariah. Azariah was the son of Zephaniah. Zephaniah was the son of Tahath. Tahath was the son of Assir. Assir was the son of Ebiasaph. Ebiasaph was the son of Korah. Korah was the son of Izhar. Izhar was the son of Kohath. Kohath was the son of Levi. Levi was one of the 12 sons of Israel, whom people also called Jacob. All the family lists in this story start with the most recent family member and end with Israel, the oldest ancestor. This family list begins with Heman.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remind each other of the words you use in your language for "son" and "descendant." If you use the same word for both, how do you help people know if you mean a son or a descendant? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller lists family members of the family of Asaph, Heman's assistant, who came from the family group of Gershon. Asaph stood on Heman's right side during worship at the tabernacle and worked with him. Asaph was the son of Berekiah. Berekiah was the son of Shimea. Shimea was the son of Michael. Michael was the son of Baaseiah. Baaseiah was the son of Malkijah. Malkijah was the son of Ethni. Ethni was the son of Zerah. Zerah was the son of Adaiah. Adaiah was the son of Ethan. Ethan was the son of Zimmah. Zimmah was the son of Shimei. Shimei was the son of Jahath. Jahath was the son of Gershon. Gershon was the son of Levi.

The storyteller lists family members of the family of Ethan, Heman's other assistant, who came from the family group of Merari. Ethan and his family members stood on the left side of Heman and Asaph when they served as musicians during worship. The storyteller refers to the Merarites as the brothers or relatives of Heman and Asaph. Here, the word brothers means relatives. Ethan was the son of Kishi. Kishi was the son of Abdi. Abdi was the son of Malluch. Malluch was the son of Hashabiah. Hashabiah was the son of Amaziah. Amaziah was the son

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of Hilkiah. Hilkiah was the son of Amzi. Amzi was the son of Bani. Bani was the son of Shemer. Shemer was the son of Mahli. Mahli was the son of Mushi. Mushi was the son of Merari. Merari was the son of Levi.

There were other descendants of Levi from his sons Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. These descendants had other duties in the tabernacle, or the house of God.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:31–48 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King David
- King Solomon
- The family group of Heman, the lead musician from the clan of Kohath: Heman, Joel, Samuel, Elkanah, Jeroham, Eliel, Toah, Zuph, Elkanah, Mahath, Amasai, Elkanah, Joel, Azariah, Zephaniah, Tahath, Assir, Ebiasaph, Korah, Izhar, Kohath, Levi, and Israel
- The family group of Heman's assistant Asaph, who came from the clan of Gershon: Asaph, Berekiah, Shimea, Michael, Baaseiah, Malkijah, Ethni, Zerah, Adaiah, Ethan, Zimmah, Shimei, Jahath, Gershon, and Levi
- The family group of Heman's other assistant, Ethan, who came from the clan of Merari: Ethan, Kishi, Abdi, Malluk, Hashabiah, Amaziah, Hilkiah, Amzi, Bani, Shemer, Mahli, Mushi, Merari, and Levi (Levi appears three times in this list of characters as all three family groups descended from him)
- And other descendants of Levi from his sons Gershon, Kohath, and Merari, who had other duties in the tabernacle

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite listening to the passage.

First, the person playing the author should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If this section is too difficult to remember, you may listen to an audio recording again.

While you do this, think about the story that the storyteller is telling through each family line. Yahweh gave each Levite clan an important job. In this story, the storyteller tells us about the descendants of Levi whom King David chose to work as musicians at the tabernacle, or tent of meeting, in Jerusalem and later in the temple. These people sang and played instruments like harps, lyres, cymbals, and trumpets. These people praised Yahweh, gave thanks, and helped the Israelites worship.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should listen to this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

This story is about men from the tribe of Levi whom King David chose to lead the music at the house of Yahweh, or the tabernacle. This happened when King David and the Levites brought the ark of the covenant to the tabernacle in Jerusalem. The men worshipped Yahweh with music and songs at the tabernacle, or tent of meeting, until King Solomon built a temple. The men performed all their musical duties according to the instructions Yahweh had given them through David. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

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- We are so grateful for the musicians who lead us to worship Yahweh at the tabernacle; or
- We are happy that we can praise Yahweh with our singing when the musicians are playing; or
- We are happy because we now have musicians who teach us to thank Yahweh with songs for taking care of us and leading us.

Continue the drama. These men and their sons organized the music to worship Yahweh. The storyteller lists family members of the family of Heman, the head musician. Heman came from the sons, or descendants of Kohath. Heman was the son of Joel. Now the storyteller lists all the other ancestors of Heman, all the way to Kohath, Levi, and Israel.

The storyteller lists family members of the family of Asaph, Heman's assistant, who came from the family group of Gershon. Asaph stood on Heman's right side during worship at the tabernacle and worked with Heman. Asaph was the son of Berekiah. Now the storyteller lists all the other ancestors of Asaph, all the way to Gershon and Levi.

The storyteller lists family members of the family of Ethan, Heman's other assistant, who came from the family group of Merari. Ethan and his family members stood on the left side of Heman and Asaph when they served as musicians during worship. Ethan was the son of Kishi. Now the storyteller lists all the other ancestors of Ethan, all the way to Merari and Levi. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are grateful that Yahweh gave different roles to different Levites. All of these men help us to obey Yahweh and worship him; or
- Yahweh even gave different roles to different musicians. Yahweh chose Heman to lead the musicians. Asaph was Heman's main assistant, and Ethan was helping Heman and Asaph; or
- We are happy that Yahweh has a plan. Everyone knows their job, and they can do it well according to Yahweh's rules.

Continue the drama. There were other descendants of Levi from his sons Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. These descendants had other duties in the tabernacle, or the house of God.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:31–48 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

This story is about men from the tribe of Levi whom King David chose to be in charge of the music at the house of Yahweh, or the tabernacle. This happened when King David and the Levites brought the ark of the covenant to the tabernacle in Jerusalem. The men worshipped Yahweh with music and songs at the tabernacle, or tent of meeting, until King Solomon built a temple.

The house of Yahweh or the house of God is a way to talk about the place on earth where God lived among his people. Although God does not need to live in a house, God told the Israelites that he would live among the Israelites and meet with them in the special portable tent they prepared for God. The Israelites called this tent the tabernacle, or tent of meeting. Later, when the Israelites settled in the Promised Land, God gave the people instructions for building a more permanent house for him—the temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **house of Yahweh**, **tabernacle**, **tent of meeting**, and **temple**. Look up house of God, tabernacle, and temple in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh is God's personal name, and the storyteller uses this name throughout this passage. Use the same word for Yahweh that you have used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

The ark was a special wooden box that held the tablets with God's commandments, a jar of manna, and Aaron's staff that had budded. The ark reminded the Israelites that God was with them and had promised to take care of them if they obeyed God.

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Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **ark** or **ark of the covenant**. Look up ark of the covenant in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The musicians did their duty according to Yahweh's **ordinances**, or rules.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for Yahweh's special rules about work in the tabernacle. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

These are the men who served and their **sons**. Of the sons of the Kohathites: Heman the singer, the son of Joel, son of Samuel, son of Elkanah, and so on. The word "son" has two meanings. The storyteller first says, "sons of the Kohathites." Here, "sons" means **descendants**. But in the lists where the storyteller talks about someone being someone's son, he means they are a biological male child. For example, Heman is a biological male child of Joel. Use the same word or phrase for son and descendants as you used in previous passages. For more information on son and descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Merarites are the brothers, or relatives, of Heman and Asaph. Here, brothers refers to a wider group of relatives who are all descended from one common ancestor. They are not brothers from the same mother and father.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about the Merarites being relatives of Heman and Asaph.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (469 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (636 KB)

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Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 6:49–53 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:49–53 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:49–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, we learned about the men from the tribe of Levi whom King David picked to be in charge of the music in the tabernacle and later, the temple. David chose these men when David and the Levites brought the ark of the covenant to Jerusalem. The main music leader was Heman. Heman's helper was Asaph. Another man named Ethan and his family also helped with the music.

In this story, the storyteller talks again about the family line of Aaron, the great-grandson of Levi.

Yahweh allowed only Aaron and Aaron's descendants to serve as priests for Yahweh. The priests brought sacrifices, or offerings, to the altar of burnt offering. The priests also received other offerings or gifts from the people. The altar of burnt offering was a big, square box that people made of wood and covered with bronze. It stood outside in the courtyard of the tabernacle, and later it stood in the courtyard of the temple. The people brought animals like bulls, goats, sheep, or birds. The priests killed the animals and burned them on the altar. This showed that the people were sorry for their sins. The smoke that rose up was like a gift to Yahweh. The priests also burned incense on the altar of incense. The altar of incense was a small table that people made of wood and covered with gold. This altar stood inside the holy place, near the curtain that separated it from the Most Holy Place, both in the tabernacle and later in the temple. Every morning and evening, the priests burned incense, or a special mix of spices, on this altar. The sweet smell showed that the people's prayers were going up to God.

Stop here and look at a picture of the altar of burnt offering and the incense altar as a group. Pause this audio here.

Only the descendants of Aaron did the work in the Most Holy Place. The Most Holy Place was the special room inside the tabernacle or temple where Yahweh's presence was. Only the high priest could go in, and only once a year, on the Day of Atonement. Aaron and his descendants made atonement for the sins of Israel, or the people of Israel. They did this by offering sacrifices to Yahweh to cover over people's sins and restore their broken relationship with Yahweh. An animal had to die in the place of the people so Yahweh could forgive the people's sins. Then the people would not have to die; the people could continue to live. Every year, on the Day of Atonement, the high priest made a special sacrifice for all the people of Israel. This offering covered everyone's sins for the year. During the year, if someone wanted to bring a sacrifice for a specific reason, such as a thanksgiving offering or a peace offering, the priests would offer that individual's sacrifice too. Aaron and his descendants followed the rules for offering sacrifices that Yahweh gave through his special servant, Moses.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about how people choose religious leaders in your people group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the most important job that religious leaders do? What are the most important religious ceremonies or rituals in your people group? How do these ceremonies help the people? Pause this audio here.

Here is the family line of Aaron, the great-grandson of Levi. Aaron's son was Eleazar. Eleazar's son was Phinehas. Phinehas's son was Abishua. Abishua's son was Bukki. Bukki's son was Uzzi. Uzzi's son was Zerahiah. Zerahiah's son was Meraioth. Meraioth's son was Amariah. Amariah's son was Ahitub. Ahitub's son was Zadok. Zadok's son was Ahimaaz. The high priests came only from Aaron's family line. The storyteller shows this by listing the names one after the other. The family list finishes with Zadok and his son Ahimaaz. Zadok was a very important priest. Because Zadok was faithful to Yahweh, King David, and King Solomon, Yahweh promised that Zadok's family would continue to serve as priests, especially as high priests. That made Zadok's family very special among the Levites. After the Babylonian exile, all high priests came from Zadok's family line. This shows that one of Aaron's direct descendants was always a high priest throughout all of Israel's history.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about how your people group tells family histories. Who keeps records of family history in your group, and why do they do it? Who uses these family histories, and what do they use them for? How important is it for a normal family to keep their family history?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:49–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us that Yahweh only allowed Aaron and his descendants to serve as priests for Yahweh. The priests brought sacrifices, or offerings, to the altar of burnt offering and incense to burn on the altar of incense. Only Aaron's descendants did the work in the Most Holy Place. Aaron and his descendants made atonement for the sins of the Israelites. They followed the rules Yahweh gave through his special servant, Moses.

In the second scene: The storyteller lists the high priests in the family line of Aaron. The list begins with Aaron and finishes with Zadok's son Ahimaaz.

The characters in this passage are:

- Aaron
- Aaron's descendants who were high priests: Eleazar, Phinehas, Abishua, Bukki, Uzzi, Zerehiah, Meraioth, Amariah, Ahitub, Zadok, and Ahimaaz
- And the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller tells us that Yahweh only allowed Aaron and his sons to serve as priests for Yahweh. Here, the word "sons" means descendants and refers both to priests and high priests. Aaron and his descendants made offerings on the altar of burnt offering and on the altar of incense. The phrase for "made offerings" in the original language means "to let a sacrifice go up in smoke." This phrase can refer to when people burn animal or grain offerings, or when people burn incense. The word for "altar" comes from the word for "to slaughter" in the original language because the priests used the altar to make burnt offerings, or sacrifices of animals, to God.

The storyteller tells us that only Aaron and his descendants did the work in the Most Holy Place. Aaron and his descendants made atonement for the sins of Israel, or the people of Israel. When a priest makes atonement, he causes Yahweh to cover over sin. Yahweh restores Yahweh's relationship with people who have broken the relationship because those people sinned or because they were impure. Aaron and his descendants atoned for the sin of the Israelites by making offerings and sacrifices. The priests offered sacrifices for individual people in Israel who brought a sacrifice. The high priests offered a sacrifice for the sin of the whole nation of Israel on the Day of Atonement. Aaron and his descendants followed the rules Yahweh gave through his special servant, Moses.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Some words or phrases in the Bible, like “make an offering,” “altar,” or “make atonement,” carry rich meanings in the original language. These meanings point to actions, symbols, or beliefs that are very important for understanding the story. How do you translate such words in your language so that people understand both what happened and why it mattered to the Israelites and to God? If you have already translated Leviticus, remind each other of how you talked about atonement and offerings in Leviticus. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller now lists the names of the high priests from Aaron’s family line. The storyteller lists the same names in 1 Chronicles 6:3–8.

Stop here. Listen to 1 Chronicles 6:3–8 together as a team. Pay close attention to the names. Make sure you use the same names for the same people. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and make a family line of the high priests who descended from Aaron. Use pebbles to show each person, and sticks to show who is whose father. Start with a pebble for Aaron, then add pebbles going down to show Aaron’s son Eleazar, Aaron’s grandson Phinehas, and Aaron’s other descendants. At the other end from Aaron, put the pebble for Zadok’s son Ahimaaz, the last high priest in this list. Then connect all the son pebbles to the father pebbles to show a family link. Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller lists Aaron’s descendants who were high priests. The storyteller begins by saying, “These are Aaron’s sons.” The word “sons” here means descendants, as only Eleazar was Aaron’s biological son. However, after this point, throughout this list, the word “son” means a biological male child and shows that each man was the son of the man before him.

Eleazar’s son was Phinehas. Phinehas’s son was Abishua. Abishua’s son was Bukki. Bukki’s son was Uzzi. Uzzi’s son was Zerahiah. Zerahiah’s son was Meraioth. Meraioth’s son was Amariah. Amariah’s son was Ahitub. Ahitub’s son was Zadok. Zadok’s son was Ahimaaz.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:49–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Aaron
- Aaron’s descendants who were high priests: Eleazar, Phinehas, Abishua, Bukki, Uzzi, Zerehiah, Meraioth, Amariah, Ahitub, Zadok, and Ahimaaz
- And the Israelites

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. He or she will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite listening to the passage and the roles of Aaron and his descendants.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If this section is too difficult to remember, you may listen to an audio recording again.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should listen to this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh only allowed Aaron and Aaron's descendants to serve as priests for Yahweh. These men made offerings on the altar of burnt offering and on the altar of incense. Only Aaron's descendants did the work in the Most Holy Place. These men made atonement for the sins of the Israelites. Aaron's descendants followed the rules Yahweh gave through his special servant, Moses.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron and his descendants, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are so grateful to Yahweh that we can be priests! Only we can make sacrifices to Yahweh on behalf of the Israelites so Yahweh can forgive their sins! or
- We are happy that we can burn incense to Yahweh on the table of incense, so that Yahweh knows the Israelites are praying to him; or
- We are grateful that we can follow the rules Yahweh gave to Moses. This way, we can be sure we worship Yahweh the correct way.

Continue the drama.

Here is the family line of Aaron. Aaron's son was Eleazar. Eleazar's son was Phinehas. Phinehas's son was Abishua. Abishua's son was Bukki. Bukki's son was Uzzi. Uzzi's son was Zerahiah. Zerahiah's son was Meraioth. Meraioth's son was Amariah. Amariah's son was Ahitub. Ahitub's son was Zadok. Zadok's son was Ahimaaz.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We trust Yahweh because he always has a plan. Yahweh said that only the descendants of Aaron can be high priests; or
- Each new high priest must be a descendant of Aaron. The new high priest will have to prove that he descended from Aaron; or
- We now understand why the Levites keep detailed family records!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:49–53 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Aaron and his **sons**, or **descendants**, made offerings on the altar of burnt offering and on the altar of incense. In this passage, the storyteller uses the same word for "son" and for "descendant." Here, the storyteller is saying that Aaron and his descendants, or all of his male sons and sons of sons, made offerings. In all the other cases in this passage except here, the word "son" means a direct biological son. Although in the original language people used the same word to mean both "son" and "descendant," you may decide to use two different words depending on whether the storyteller means that the person is a biological direct son, or whether the person is a grandchild or great-grandchild. Use the same words or phrases for son and descendant as you used in previous passages. For more information on son or descendant, refer to the Master Glossary.

An offering is a gift or sacrifice that a person offers in a ritual to God, usually in the temple or on a special altar. People can make offerings for many reasons, including to give thanks, to be purified, or to ask forgiveness for sin. The phrase for "made offerings" in the original language means "to let a sacrifice go up in smoke." This phrase can refer to how a person burns an animal or vegetable offering or burns incense.

Stop here and discuss as a group what phrase you will use for "**make an offering**." Look up offering in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this idea in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

An altar is a place where people make offerings or sacrifices to God. The word for "altar" comes from the word for "to slaughter" in the original language because the priests used the altar to make burnt offerings, or sacrifices, to God. An altar is like a table or a platform that people make of earth or large stones. People placed gifts for God on this table. Often, this meant that people then burned the gift. The gift could be an animal, food items, or sweet-smelling spices.

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Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **altar**. Look up altar in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The altar of burnt offering was a big, square box that people made of wood and covered with bronze. It stood outside in the courtyard of the tabernacle, and later in the courtyard of the temple. The people brought animals like bulls, goats, sheep, or birds. The priests killed the animals and burned them on the altar. This showed that the people were sorry for their sins. The smoke that rose up was like a gift to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **altar of burnt offering**. Refer to the Master Glossary for burnt offering for more information. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The altar of incense was a small table that people made of wood and covered with gold. This altar stood inside the Holy Place, near the curtain that separated it from the Most Holy Place. Every morning and evening, the priests burned incense, or a special mix of spices, on this altar. The sweet smell showed that the people's prayers were going up to God.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **altar of incense**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Only the descendants of Aaron did the work in the Most Holy Place. The Most Holy Place was the special room inside the tabernacle or temple where Yahweh's presence was. Only the high priest could go in, and only once a year, on the Day of Atonement.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Most Holy Place**. Look up "Most Holy Place" in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Aaron and his descendants made atonement for the sins of Israel. Atonement is the action someone does to cover over sin and reconcile or restore a relationship with God after people break that relationship because they sin or become impure.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **atonement**. Look up atonement in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Israel here means the people of or the nation of Israel. Use the same word or phrase as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Aaron and his descendants followed the rules Yahweh gave through his special **servant**, Moses.

A servant is a person who does work for someone else. Servants may work in the house or in the fields of their master. Servants usually have a low position in the community. Look up servant in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same word that you have used in previous passages.

Stop here. You have already translated the names of the high priests listed here in 1 Chronicles 6:3–8. Listen to the story in 1 Chronicles 6:3–8 together as a team. Pay close attention to the names and how you translated them. Pause this audio here.

[These are the sons of Aaron: Aaron's son was Eleazar.]{.mark} Eleazar's son was Phinehas. Phinehas's son was Abishua. Abishua's son was Bukki. Bukki's son was Uzzi. Uzzi's son was Zerahiah. Zerahiah's son was Meraioth. Meraioth's son was Amariah. Amariah's son was Ahitub. Ahitub's son was Zadok. Zadok's son was Ahimaaz. When the storyteller first talks about the sons of Aaron at the beginning of this passage, the word "sons" means "descendants." However, from this point on in the list, the word "son" means a biological male child and shows that each man was the son of the man before him.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 6:49–53

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (439 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (1.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (704 KB)

1 Chronicles 6:54–81

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 6:54–81 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:54–81 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:54–81 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, the storyteller told us about Aaron and his sons, who Yahweh chose to serve as priests. These men offered sacrifices to atone for the sins of the people of Israel and took care of the holy things in the temple. The storyteller also listed some of the high priests in Aaron's family line, from Aaron to Zadok.

In this story, the storyteller tells us about the cities that the Israelites gave the Levites, just as Yahweh told the Israelites through Moses. The Levites did not get one big piece of land like the other tribes. Instead, Yahweh chose the Levites to help people worship him, so the Levites lived in many cities across Israel to teach and serve all the tribes. The storyteller first lists the cities the Israelites gave to Aaron's descendants, the priests. Then the storyteller lists the cities the Israelites gave to the other Levites from the families of Kohath, Gershon, and Merari.

This list of cities is a lot like the list in Joshua 21, but there are some differences. The storyteller of Joshua 21 tells the story just after the tribes enter the Promised Land, about 1,400 years before Jesus was born. The storyteller shows that Yahweh keeps his promise to the Levites. The storyteller also shows that the Israelites obey Yahweh by giving the Levites cities, just like God tells them to do through Moses.

But the storyteller in 1 Chronicles tells the story almost 1,000 years later. The 1 Chronicles storyteller speaks to the Israelites who come back to their land after 70 years in exile in Babylon. Through this story, Yahweh reminds his people that they still belong to Yahweh. Yahweh also shows that the Levites are important to help the people worship and obey Yahweh.

Stop here. If you have already translated Joshua 21, listen to it now as a group. Pause this audio here.

This is a record of the settlements and territory that Aaron's descendants in the clan of Kohath received. A settlement is a general word that can mean a larger city or a smaller village. Because the first lot was for them, Aaron's descendants, the priests, got the first share of the settlements the Israelites gave to the Levites. People threw lots, which were pieces of wood or stone, to learn what Yahweh wanted the people to do.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a photo of lots. Pause this audio here.

Aaron's family received the Hebron city and the pasturelands around it in the tribe of Judah's territory. The pasturelands were open fields near Hebron where the Levites let their animals eat grass. But Caleb, the son of Jephunneh, received the fields and villages near Hebron. The fields were large farming areas farther from the city, and the villages were small settlements around the city. Caleb was a Kenizzite. It is not clear whether Caleb was born an Israelite or not. But it is clear that people accepted Caleb as a man of the tribe of Judah. Yahweh accepted Caleb as one of Yahweh's own people. Yahweh gave Caleb land around Hebron as Caleb's inheritance.

The people from the tribe of Judah gave Hebron city to the descendants of Aaron. Hebron was a city of refuge, where someone who accidentally killed a person could run to be safe. Remember, there are six cities of refuge spread throughout the land of Israel. Hebron is probably the first city on the list because it is an important city as a city of refuge. The people from Judah also gave the descendants of Aaron these cities with pastureland around them: Libnah, Jattir, Eshtemoa, Hilen, Debir, Ashan, Juttah, and Beth Shemesh.

The family of Aaron also got cities from the people of the tribe of Benjamin. Aaron's family received Gibeon, Geba, Alemeth, and Anathoth, along with the pasturelands around them. So, Aaron's family got 13 cities in total.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find the cities that the Israelites gave to Aaron's descendants, the priests. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and, as a group, talk about religious leaders in your people group. Where do those people live? Do those people all stay in one area, or do they live across the land? Who gives those people places to live? Has this changed over time? Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller tells us which tribes of Israel gave cities to the other Levite families. The other families from the Kohath clan who were not part of Aaron's family got 10 cities by lot from the western half of the tribe of Manasseh, west of the Jordan River. The tribes of Issachar, Asher, Naphtali, and the eastern side of the tribe of Manasseh in the area of Bashan gave 13 cities to the descendants of Levi's son Gershon. The tribes of Reuben, Gad, and Zebulun gave 12 cities to the family of Levi's son Merari.

Now the storyteller gives a summary of the story so far. In this way, the people of Israel gave the Levites cities to live in with pastureland around them for their animals. The tribes of Judah, Simeon, and Benjamin gave Aaron's

descendants the cities that the storyteller just listed. The Israelites cast lots to decide which cities Yahweh wanted them to give to Aaron's family.

Now the storyteller tells us about the cities that the other Levites got from the people of Israel.

This is a record of the cities and land the Israelites gave to the rest of the clan of Kohath, Levi's second son. The tribe of Ephraim gave the remaining Kohathites, who were not Aaron's descendants, some cities from their territory. The Ephraimites gave the Kohathites the city of Shechem and the pastureland in the hill country of Ephraim. Shechem was a city of refuge where someone who accidentally killed a person could run to be safe. The people of Ephraim also gave the Kohathites the following cities with pastureland: Gezer, Jokmeam, Beth Horon, Aijalon, and Gath Rimmon.

The Kohathites who were not from Aaron's family also got cities and land from the people of the western half of the tribe of Manasseh. These Kohathites received land west of the Jordan River. These Kohathites got the cities of Aner and Bileam, along with the pastureland around them.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find the cities that the Israelites gave to the Kohath family that did not come from Aaron's family. Pause this audio here.

This is a list of the cities and land the Israelites gave to the descendants of Gershon, Levi's firstborn son. The Israelites threw lots to find out which cities Yahweh wanted the Gershonites to have. The people from the eastern half of the tribe of Manasseh, who lived in the hills of Bashan east of the Jordan River, gave the descendants of Gershon the cities of Golan and Ashtaroth with the pastureland around those cities. The people from the tribe of Issachar gave the Gershonites the cities of Kedesh, Daberath, Ramoth, and Anem, along with their pasturelands. The people from the tribe of Asher gave them the cities of Mashal, Abdon, Hukok, and Rehob, with the pastureland around each one. The people from the tribe of Naphtali gave the Gershonites these cities with pastureland: Kedesh in the region of Galilee, Hammon, and Kiriathaim.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find cities that the people of Israel gave to the descendants of the tribe of Gershon. Pause this audio here.

The rest of the tribe of Levi were the descendants of Merari, who was Levi's youngest son. Here is a list of cities and land the Israelites gave to the Merarites by throwing lots to know what Yahweh wanted. The people from the tribe of Zebulun gave the Merarites the following cities, each with surrounding pastureland: Jokneam, Kartah, Rimmono, and Tabor. From the land of the tribe of Reuben, the Merarites received cities east of Jericho city. This land was on the east side of the Jordan River. The Merarites got the city of Bezer in the wilderness with the pastureland around it. Wilderness, or desert, is a lonely, empty place where almost nothing grows and there is very little water. Bezer was a city of refuge where someone who accidentally killed a person could run to be safe. The Merarites also received the cities of Jahzah, Kedemoth, and Mephaath, each with the pastureland around it. The people from the tribe of Gad gave the clans of Merari these cities with the pastureland around them: Ramoth in the region of Gilead, Mahanaim, Heshbon, and Jazer.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find cities that the people of Israel gave to the descendants of the tribe of Merari.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:54–81 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has six scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller lists the cities that the descendants of Aaron received from the people of the tribes of Judah and Benjamin.

In the second scene: The storyteller tells us which Israelite tribes gave cities to the rest of the Levites.

In the third scene: The storyteller gives a summary of the story so far. The people of Israel gave the Levites cities to live in with pastureland for their animals. The tribes of Judah, Simeon, and Benjamin gave cities to Aaron's family. By throwing lots, the people decided which cities God wanted them to give.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller lists the cities that the rest of the clan of Kohath, Levi's second son, received from the people of the tribes of Ephraim and the half-tribe of West Manasseh.

In the fifth scene: The storyteller lists the cities that the descendants of Gershon, Levi's firstborn, received from the people of the half-tribe of East Manasseh and the tribes of Issachar, Asher, and Naphtali.

In the sixth scene: The storyteller lists the cities that the descendants of Merari, Levi's youngest son, received from the people of the tribes of Zebulun, Reuben, and Gad.

The characters in this passage are:

- Descendants of Aaron, the priests
- Leaders of Israel
- Tribe of Judah
- Caleb, son of Jephunneh
- Tribe of Benjamin
- The rest of the Kohathites, or the descendants of Levi's son Kohath, who did not descend from Aaron
- Half-tribe of West Manasseh
- The Gershonites, or descendants of Levi's son Gershon
- Tribe of Issachar
- Tribe of Asher
- Tribe of Naphtali
- Half-tribe of East Manasseh
- The Merarites, or descendants of Levi's son Merari
- Tribe of Reuben
- Tribe of Gad
- Tribe of Zebulun
- Tribe of Simeon
- And tribe of Ephraim

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller begins by listing the settlements and land that the sons or descendants of Aaron received. Aaron was from the Kohathite clan. The storyteller says, "These are their dwelling places according to their settlements within their borders." The "dwelling places" here means "settlements," not "houses." Settlements were communities where people lived. Some settlements were cities that had walls around them for protection. Some settlements may have been small villages that did not have walls around them. "Within their borders" means that all the settlements the Israelites gave to the Levites were within the borders of Israel. Aaron's descendants lived in those cities along with people from the Israelite tribe that owned the land. Because the first lot was for them, Aaron's descendants, the priests, got the first share of the cities the Israelites gave to the Levites. People threw lots, which were pieces of wood or stone, to learn what Yahweh wanted them to do. People marked these objects with different colours, symbols, or names and put them in a bag. Then a person shook the bag until one of the objects fell out.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a photo of lots, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Aaron's family received Hebron city and the pasturelands around it in the tribe of Judah's territory. The pasturelands were open fields near Hebron where the Levites let their animals eat grass. Now the storyteller mentions Caleb, the son of Jephunneh, who received the fields and villages near Hebron. The fields were large farming areas farther from the city. Caleb was not one of Aaron's descendants. It is not clear whether Caleb was born into the tribe of Judah. Some people think Caleb was a Kenizzite who joined the tribe of Judah and trusted Yahweh. The storyteller mentions Caleb here because Yahweh also gave Caleb land around Hebron.

Stop here and discuss as a group the difference between pasturelands and fields. What word are you going to use for each to clearly show the difference? Pause this audio here.

This list of cities that the Israelites gave to the Levites is a lot like the list in Joshua 21, but has some differences.

Stop here. If you have already translated Joshua 21, listen to this story together as a team. Watch how the story is put together. In Joshua 21, the storyteller organizes the cities by the tribes that gave them. In this story, the writer organizes the cities by the Levite families who received them. Listen closely to the city names and check how you translated them in the other story. Note that this story lists fewer cities than Joshua 21. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller now lists all the cities the people of the tribe of Judah gave to the descendants of Aaron. The storyteller begins saying, “To the sons of Aaron they gave the cities of refuge.” The storyteller then lists eight cities, and the first one is Hebron. Please note that only Hebron is a city of refuge where someone who accidentally killed a person could run to be safe. We do not know why the storyteller talks as if he were listing more than one safe city.

The people from the tribe of Judah gave the descendants of Aaron some more cities. These cities had pastureland, or fields for animals, around them. The cities were: Libnah, Jattir, Eshtemoa, Hilen, Debir, Ashan, Juttah, and Beth Shemesh. The storyteller says that most cities came “with pastureland,” but does not mention pastureland after Jattir city. We know from Joshua chapter 21 that Jattir also had pastureland around it.

Aaron’s family also got cities from the tribe of Benjamin. The people received Gibeon, Geba, Alemeth, and Anathoth, along with the grazing land around them. Alemeth is called Almon in the list of Aaronite cities in Joshua 21. In total, Aaron’s family got 13 cities. Some old copies of this story do not mention Juttah from the land of Judah or Gibeon from the land of Benjamin, so some Bible translations leave them out. But Joshua 21 lists both cities.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find the cities that the Israelites gave to Aaron’s descendants, the priests. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In Joshua 21, the writer lists the cities by the tribes that gave them. But in this story, the writer lists the cities by the Levite families who received them. How will you organise the list of cities in this passage? Practice listing the cities in the way you will organise them. Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller tells us which tribes of Israel gave cities to the other Levite families. The other families from the Kohath clan got 10 cities by lot from the western side of the tribe of Manasseh, west of the Jordan River. The tribes of Issachar, Asher, Naphtali, and the eastern side of the tribe of Manasseh in the area of Bashan, east of the Jordan River, gave 13 towns to the descendants of Levi’s son Gershon. The tribes of Reuben, Gad, and Zebulun gave 12 towns to the family of Levi’s son Merari.

Now the storyteller gives a summary of the story so far. In this way, the people of Israel gave the Levites towns to live in with fields around them for their animals. The tribes of Judah, Simeon, and Benjamin gave Aaron’s descendants the cities listed here. The Israelites cast lots to decide which cities Yahweh wanted them to give to Aaron’s family.

Now the storyteller tells us about the cities that the other Levites got from the people of Israel.

The storyteller now lists the names of the cities that the tribe of Ephraim gave to the Kohathites who did not come from Aaron’s family. The storyteller starts by saying, “They gave them the cities of refuge.” Then the storyteller lists seven cities, and the first one is Shechem, which was a city of refuge where someone who accidentally killed a person could run to be safe. But Shechem is the only city of refuge in that list. We do not know why the storyteller talks as if he were listing more than one safe city. The Kohathites received Shechem and the pastureland around it in the hill country of Ephraim. The Kohathites also received these cities with pastureland: Gezer, Jokmeam, Beth Horon, Aijalon, and Gath Rimmon. In Joshua 21, Jokmeam is called Kibzaim.

The Kohathites who were not from Aaron’s family also got cities and land from the people of the western half of the tribe of Manasseh. These people’s land was west of the Jordan River. The Kohathites received the cities of Aner and Bileam, along with the pastureland around them.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find the cities that the Israelites gave to the Kohath family that did not come from Aaron’s family. Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 6:54–81

This is a record of the cities and land the Israelites gave to the descendants of Gershon, Levi's son. The people from the eastern half of the tribe of Manasseh, who lived in the hills of Bashan east of the Jordan River, gave them the cities of Golan and Ashtaroth with the pastureland around them. The people from the tribe of Issachar gave the Gershonites the cities of Kedesh, Daberath, Ramoth, and Anem, along with their pastureland. In Joshua 21, Kedesh is called Kishion, and Ramoth is called Jarmuth. The people from the tribe of Asher gave them the cities of Mashal, Abdon, Hukok, and Rehob, with the pastureland around each one. In Joshua 21, Mashal is called Mishal, and instead of Hukok, the storyteller mentions Hilkath, but it is possible that Hukok and Hilkath are two different cities. The people from the tribe of Naphtali gave the Gershonites these cities, each with pastureland: Kedesh in the region of Galilee, Hammon, and Kiriathaim. In Joshua 21, Hammon is called Hammoth Dor.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find cities that the people of Israel gave to the descendants of the tribe of Gershon. Pause this audio here.

The rest of the tribe of Levi were the descendants of Merari, who was Levi's son. Here is a list of cities and land that the Israelites gave to the Merarites. The people from the tribe of Zebulun gave the Merarites the following cities and the pastureland that surrounded those cities: Jokneam, Kartah, Rimmono, and Tabor. From the land of the tribe of Reuben, the Merarites received cities east of Jericho city. This land was on the east side of the Jordan River. The Merarites received the city of Bezer in the wilderness with the pastureland around it. The Merarites also received the cities of Jahzah, Kedemoth, and Mephaath, each with the pastureland around it. The city of Jahzar is also called Jahaz in other books of the Bible. The people from the tribe of Gad gave the Merarites these cities with the pastureland around them: Ramoth in the region of Gilead, Mahanaim, Heshbon, and Jazer.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find cities that the people of Israel gave to the descendants of the tribe of Merari. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:54–81 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has six scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Descendants of Aaron, the priests
- Leaders of Israel
- Tribe of Judah
- Caleb, son of Jephunneh
- Tribe of Benjamin
- The rest of the Kohathites, or the descendants of Levi's son Kohath, who did not descend from Aaron
- Half-tribe of West Manasseh
- The Gershonites, or descendants of Levi's son Gershon
- Tribe of Issachar
- Tribe of Asher
- Tribe of Naphtali
- Half-tribe of East Manasseh
- The Merarites, or descendants of Levi's son Merari
- Tribe of Reuben
- Tribe of Gad
- Tribe of Zebulun
- Tribe of Simeon
- And tribe of Ephraim

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

1 Chronicles 6:54–81

For this step, you will choose one person to play the part of the storyteller of Chronicles. The person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group. Everyone else in the group will play the role of ancient Israelites from the tribes of Israel who gave cities to the Levites. They will be listening to the passage.

First, the person playing the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If this section is too difficult to remember, you may listen to an audio recording again.

While you do this, notice how the storyteller shows that the Levites are very important. Yahweh chose all the Levites to help Yahweh's people worship and obey him. Each group in the tribe of Levi had special jobs from Yahweh. Aaron's family were the priests. Aaron's family had the most holy jobs, like offering sacrifices. That is why Aaron's family's lot fell first, and why the storyteller lists Aaron's family first. Instead of organizing the cities by the tribes that gave them, the storyteller organizes the cities by the Levite families who received them.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage.

The group should listen to this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

This is a record of the settlements and territory that those in the clan of Kohath, who descended from Aaron, received. Because the first lot was for them, Aaron's descendants, the priests, got the first share of the settlements the Israelites gave to the Levites.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh honoured Aaron's family, the priests, by giving them their cities first; or
- All the Levite families are important to Yahweh, but the priests have the most holy jobs; or
- We praise Yahweh for the priests because the priests make sacrifices to Yahweh for us.

Continue the drama.

Aaron's family received Hebron city and the pasturelands around it in the tribe of Judah's territory. But Caleb, the son of Jephunneh, received the fields and villages near Hebron.

The people from the tribe of Judah gave Hebron city to the descendants of Aaron. Hebron was a city of refuge, where someone who accidentally killed a person could run to be safe. The people from Judah also gave the descendants of Aaron these cities with the pastureland around the cities: Libnah, Jattir, Eshtemoa, Hilen, Debir, Ashan, Juttah, and Beth Shemesh.

The family of Aaron also received cities from the people of the tribe of Benjamin. They received Gibeon, Geba, Alemeth, and Anathoth, along with the grazing land around those cities. So, Aaron's family received 13 cities in total.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We thank Yahweh for all the Levites because they help us obey Yahweh; or
- The Levites who are not priests have important jobs too. These people take care of the temple, guard it, teach God's law, and show us how to worship Yahweh; or
- The Levites work hard. Even though they live in many cities, the Levites still travel to Jerusalem to do their jobs at the temple.

Continue the drama.

1 Chronicles 6:54–81

Now the storyteller tells us which tribes of Israel gave towns to the other Levite families. The other families from the Kohath clan who were not in Aaron's family received 10 cities by lot from the western half of the tribe of Manasseh. The tribes of Issachar, Asher, Naphtali, and the eastern half of the tribe of Manasseh in the area of Bashan gave 13 towns to the descendants of Levi's son Gershon. The tribes of Reuben, Gad, and Zebulun gave 12 towns to the family of Levi's son Merari.

Now the storyteller gives a summary of the story so far. In this way, the people of Israel gave the Levites towns to live in with pastureland around them for their animals. The tribes of Judah, Simeon, and Benjamin gave Aaron's descendants the cities that the storyteller just listed. The Israelites cast lots to decide which cities Yahweh wanted them to give to Aaron's family.

This is a record of the cities and land the Israelites gave to the rest of the clan of Kohath, Levi's second son. The tribe of Ephraim gave the remaining Kohathites, who were not Aaron's descendants, some cities from their territory. The Ephraimites gave the Kohathites the city of Shechem and the pastureland in the hill country of Ephraim. Shechem was a city of refuge where someone who accidentally killed a person could run to be safe. The people of Ephraim also gave the Kohathites the following cities, each with pastureland: Gezer, Jokmeam, Beth Horon, Aijalon, and Gath Rimmon.

The Kohathites who were not from Aaron's family also received cities and land from the people of the western half of the tribe of Manasseh. The Kohathites received the cities of Aner and Bileam, along with the pastureland around them.

This is a list of the cities and land the Israelites gave to the descendants of Gershon, Levi's second son. The Israelites threw lots to find out which cities Yahweh wanted the Gershonites to have. The people from the eastern half of the tribe of Manasseh, who lived in the hills of Bashan east of the Jordan River, gave the descendants of Gershon the cities of Golan and Ashtaroth with the pastureland around them. The people from the tribe of Issachar gave the Gershonites the cities of Kedesh, Daberath, Ramoth, and Anem, along with the pastureland. The people from the tribe of Asher gave them the cities of Mashal, Abdon, Hukok, and Rehob, with the pastureland around each one. The people from the tribe of Naphtali gave the Gershonites these cities with their pastureland: Kedesh in the region of Galilee, Hammon, and Kiriathaim.

The rest of the tribe of Levi were the descendants of Merari, who was Levi's youngest son. Here is a list of cities and land the Israelites gave to the Merarites by throwing lots to know what Yahweh wanted. The people from the tribe of Zebulun gave the Merarites the following cities with their surrounding pastureland: Jokneam, Kartah, Rimmono, and Tabor. From the land of the tribe of Reuben, the Merarites received cities east of Jericho city. This land was on the east side of the Jordan River. The Merarites received the city of Bezer in the wilderness with the pastureland around it. Bezer was a city of refuge where someone who accidentally killed a person could run to be safe. The Merarites also received the cities of Jahzah, Kedemoth, and Mephaath, each with the pastureland around it. The people from the tribe of Gad gave the clans of Merari these cities with the pastureland around them: Ramoth in the region of Gilead, Mahanaim, Heshbon, and Jazer.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are grateful that the people in every tribe obeyed Yahweh and gave cities to each Levite family in their land; or
- We are glad that the Levites live in cities all over Israel, so they can teach everyone how to obey Yahweh; or
- We are happy that, now that we are back from Babylon, the priests help us by making sacrifices for our sins, and the other Levites teach us how to love Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 6:54–81 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The storyteller begins by saying that these are Aaron's descendants' dwelling places according to their settlements within their borders, or within the borders of Israel: to the sons of Aaron of the clans of Kohathites, for

theirs was the first lot. Dwelling places and settlements mean very similar things. The storyteller is saying that he is going to list the places where the descendants of Aaron lived. Most of these cities had walls around them to protect the people who lived there.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will introduce that “These are the places where the descendants of Aaron live within the borders of Israel.” Pause this audio here.

The word **sons** here means **descendants**. Use the same word or phrase for descendants as you used in previous passages. For more information on descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same word or phrase for **clans** as you used in previous passages.

People threw lots, which were pieces of wood or stone, to learn what Yahweh wanted them to do. People marked these objects with different colours, symbols, or names and put them in a bag. Then a person shook the bag until one of the objects fell out.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a photo of lots, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **lots** or **throwing lots**. If you have already translated this word or phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The people from the tribe of Judah gave Hebron city to the descendants of Aaron. Hebron was a city of refuge. A city of refuge was a city where someone who accidentally killed a person could run to be safe. There were six cities of refuge spread throughout the land of Israel.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **city of refuge**. If you have already translated this word or phrase in Joshua 20:1–9, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Caleb received the fields and villages around Hebron. A village is a smaller settlement and may or may not have a wall around it. Use the same word for villages or small settlements as you have used in previous passages. Use the same words for fields here, and pasturelands in the rest of the passage, as you have used in previous passages.

The other families from the Kohath clan received 10 **cities** by lot from the western side of the tribe of Manasseh, west of the Jordan River. Use the same word or phrase for city as you used in previous passages.

The Merarites, who were **Levites**, received the city of Bezer in the wilderness with the pastureland around it. Use the same word for Levites that you have used previously, and remember that Levites is in the Master Glossary.

A wilderness or desert is a lonely, empty place without water. There are almost no trees or bushes growing in the wilderness. The ground is dry and rocky, and there are wild animals roaming around.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wilderness**. Look up wilderness in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 6:54–81

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (439 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (608 KB)

1 Chronicles 7:1–5

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 7:1–5 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:1–5 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This part of 1 Chronicles continues the family history of the 12 tribes of Israel. Now the history turns to the tribes that live in the northern part of the land of Israel. This list focuses on the family history of Issachar and the tribe of Issachar. You will remember that family histories do not usually tell all the names of the family members. Family histories include the names of famous members of the family. And most of the time, family histories record the names of the leaders or heads of the family. This way, the people of each tribe can easily trace their ancestors and their place in the family history.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In this family history, the narrator lists Issachar's four sons in the order that they were born. When you list people in your family history, how do you list them? Try listing the children of one of your ancestors. Notice what order you list those people. Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 7:1–5

Issachar is the fifth son of Jacob with Jacob's wife Leah. Remember that Yahweh gave Jacob the name Israel, which is how the people of Israel received their name. Later in the history of the people of Israel, the tribe of Issachar, along with the tribes of Naphtali, Manasseh, Ephraim, and Asher, lived in the northern part of the land Yahweh gave to the tribes of Israel.

Stop here and look at a map of northern Israel. As a group, show where the other tribes of Israel settled in the past. Pause this audio here.

We will learn later in 1 Chronicles that while David ruled over Israel, David conducted a census of all the fighting men in Israel. The storyteller may have used the census as the source to write Issachar's family history. Perhaps David ordered his commanders to count David's troops. This might explain why Isaachar's family history is like a military list. This list gives the impression that the tribe of Issachar is a family of brave warriors.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: The scene presents the sons of Issachar.

In the second scene: The scene presents the sons of Tola, the oldest son of Issachar. These people are the grandsons of Issachar.

In the third scene: The scene presents Izrahiah as the only son of Uzzi. Izrahiah is the great-grandson of Issachar.

In the fourth scene: The scene presents the sons of Izrahiah. These people are the great-great-grandsons of Issachar.

In the fifth scene: The storyteller finishes the family history of Issachar.

The characters in this passage are:

- The sons of Issachar: Tola, Puah, Jashub, and Shimron
- The sons of Tola: Uzzi, Rephaiah, Jeriel, Jahmai, Ibsam, and Samuel
- The son of Uzzi: Izrahiah
- The sons of Izrahiah: Michael, Obadiah, Joel, and Isshiah
- Wives and children of the sons of Izrahiah
- All the fighting men of the tribe of Issachar

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller presents the names of Issachar's sons. The storyteller specifically mentions the number four to affirm that indeed Issachar has four sons. These sons were Tola, Puah, Jashub, and Shimron. Even though the storyteller only mentioned the names and did not include details as to the birth order of the sons of Issachar, we can say that the order of the names probably starts from the eldest or firstborn son down to the youngest son.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how would you affirm in a natural way that Issachar did indeed have four sons? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller presents the names of Tola's sons. Tola is the firstborn son of Issachar. The sons of Tola were Uzzi, Rephaiah, Jeriel, Jahmai, Ibsam, and Samuel. Again, the order starts from the eldest or the firstborn son down to the youngest. Although this time, the storyteller does not confirm the number of Tola's sons, the storyteller mentions other information about Tola's sons. The storyteller describes these men as the heads or leaders of their ancestral families. The storyteller also mentions that when David was the king of Israel, David listed a total of 22,600 descendants of Tola as mighty warriors.

1 Chronicles 7:1–5

The third scene is shorter than the previous scene. The storyteller only introduces Izrahiah as the son of Uzzi. In the next scene, the storyteller introduces the sons of Izrahiah. Perhaps the purpose of this short scene is to connect the next generation with the family history of Issachar.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller presents the names of the sons of Izrahiah. The sons of Izrahiah were Michael, Obadiah, Joel, and Isshiah. Again, the storyteller arranges the names according to the order of their birth from the eldest to the youngest. These sons, together with Izrahiah, were the five chiefs or leaders of their clans or large family groups. Also, along with their families and clans, these chiefs had 36,000 mighty warriors under them. These chiefs had many wives and sons, which made them have large numbers of warriors.

In the fifth scene, the storyteller finishes the family history of Issachar. The storyteller mentions that Issachar's genealogy lists 87,000 mighty warriors from all of the descendants of Issachar. These warriors may have served the king of Israel during their time.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it. The group can draw a family tree of Issachar or use rocks and sticks to make a model of the family on the ground.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The sons of Issachar: Tola, Puah, Jashub, and Shimron
- The sons of Tola: Uzzi, Rephaiah, Jeriel, Jahmai, Ibsam, and Samuel
- The son of Uzzi: Izrahiah
- The sons of Izrahiah: Michael, Obadiah, Joel, and Isshiah
- Wives and children of the sons of Izrahiah
- All the fighting men of the tribe of Issachar

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller introduces Issachar. Since Issachar was the head of the family, the person who plays the character of Issachar may have to appear older than the rest of the characters. Then the storyteller will call the names of the sons of Issachar from the eldest to the youngest. The storyteller will call Tola, Puah, Jashub, and then Shimron one by one. These people will stand in front of Issachar. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Issachar, "What are you feeling or thinking as the head of your family or clan?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel honored; or
- I wonder if I will be able to lead my family according to the ways of Yahweh.

Then ask the people who are playing the sons of Issachar, "What are you feeling or thinking as the sons of Issachar?" The people who are playing the sons of Issachar might answer things like:

1 Chronicles 7:1–5

- I think Yahweh wants us to honor our father by living in a way where we obey Yahweh's commands.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, the storyteller introduces the sons of Tola. The storyteller will call the names of the sons of Tola from the eldest to the youngest. The storyteller will call Uzzi, Rephaiah, Jeriel, Jahmai, Ibsam, and then Samuel. These men will stand in front of Tola. But this time, the sons of Tola will pose like mighty warriors. The storyteller will comment that during the time of David as king of Israel, there were 22,600 mighty warriors from the family of Tola alone. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Tola, "What are you feeling or thinking as the head of your clan, which serves as warriors for the king of Israel?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel proud being a father of warriors who serve the king of Israel; or
- I feel afraid for the safety of my sons who serve as warriors. My sons might get injured or lose their lives in times of war.

Then ask the people who are playing the sons of Tola, "What are you feeling or thinking as the sons of Tola?" The people who are playing the sons of Tola might answer things like:

- I think Yahweh wants us to honor our father by living in a way where we obey Yahweh's commands; or
- I feel committed to serve the king of Israel loyally and bravely.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, the storyteller introduces Izrahiah, who is the son of Uzzi. The storyteller will call Izrahiah and let Izrahiah stand in front of Uzzi.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller introduces the sons of Izrahiah. The storyteller will call the names of the sons of Izrahiah again, from the eldest to the youngest. The storyteller will call Michael, Obadiah, Joel, and then Isshiah. These men will stand in front of Izrahiah but will move beside Izrahiah, because these men were considered chiefs or leaders of their clans along with Izrahiah. The storyteller will also call more people to act as wives and sons of these five chiefs. All the men from the family of Izrahiah, Michael, Obadiah, Joel, and Isshiah will pose like mighty warriors. Because these five chiefs had many wives and children, there were 36,000 mighty warriors who came from the family of Izrahiah and the sons of Izrahiah. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Izrahiah, "What are you feeling or thinking as the head of a large clan?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel thankful that Yahweh blessed me with a large family; or
- I feel worried that I may not be able to lead these people in the ways of Yahweh.

Then ask the people who are playing Izrahiah and the sons of Izrahiah, "What are you feeling or thinking about having warriors as family members?" The people might answer things like:

- We will feel proud that we have family members who are warriors; or
- I feel afraid for the safety of my family members who serve as warriors. My family might get injured or lose their lives in times of war.

Continue the drama. In the fifth scene, the storyteller highlights that there were 87,000 mighty warriors listed in the genealogy records of the family of Issachar. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Issachar, "What are you feeling or thinking after you heard your family history?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel impressed with my family history. We have so many mighty warriors!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The passage presents the family history of Issachar by immediately introducing the **sons** of Issachar in the first scene. The storyteller refers to these men as sons of Issachar. Although the original language uses a word that means sons, the word can also mean anyone who is descended from that person. In this case, the sons in this passage were most likely really sons of their fathers. Use the same word or phrase for sons that you used in the previous passages to mean sons. For more information on sons, refer to the Master Glossary.

1 Chronicles 7:1–5

The second scene of the passage presents the sons of Tola. The sons of Tola were Uzzi, Rephaiah, Jeriel, Jahmai, Ibsam, and Samuel. These sons were the **leaders** or chiefs of their own families or "**father's households**." Remember that a chief leads a group of people. Use the same word or phrase for leaders and "father's households" that you used in the previous passages. "Households" is in the Master Glossary.

This scene also mentions that the descendants of Tola were mighty **warriors**, or **fighting men**, during the reign of David. There were 22,600 warriors from the descendants of Tola. Use the same word or phrase for warriors or fighting men as you used in previous passages.

The fourth scene presents the sons of Izrahiah. Izrahiah had four sons. The storyteller mentions that five of these sons were leaders, or chiefs. This includes Izrahiah as a chief, or head of a father's household, too. Use the same words or phrases for heads or chiefs of fathers' households as you used previously in this passage and in previous passages.

The final scene is the conclusion of the passage. But the emphasis of this scene is on the total number of warriors from the tribe of Issachar. The scene mentions that 87,000 warriors belonged to all of the large family groups, or clans, of the tribe of Issachar. Use the same word for clans, or large family groups, that you have used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 7:1–5

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (2.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.4 MB)

1 Chronicles 7:6–13

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 7:6–13 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:6–13 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:6–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This list continues the family history of the tribes of Israel. You will remember that family histories do not usually tell all the names of the family members. Family histories may include the names of famous members of the family. And most of the time, family histories record the names of the leaders or heads of the family. This way, the people in a tribe can easily trace their ancestors and their place in the family history.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: If you have not done this before, remind each other of how you list important names in a family's history in your culture. Pause this audio here.

This list presents the family history of the tribe of Benjamin. Writers of family histories or genealogies often follow the birth order when they tell the names of the family members. But in this section, the writer did not follow the birth order when he told the family history. Benjamin is the youngest son of Jacob, whom people also called Israel, and of Jacob's wife Rachel. The storyteller of the book of Chronicles presents the family history of Issachar in the previous section. But the storyteller inserts the family history of Benjamin before the storyteller presents the family history of Naphtali in the next section.

At least two significant events in the history of Israel involved the tribe of Benjamin. The first king of Israel came from the tribe of Benjamin. Yahweh chose Saul to be the king of Israel when the people asked for a king. But surprisingly, the storyteller did not mention Saul in this list.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you tell the family history of your leaders? Pause this audio here.

The other event that involved the tribe of Benjamin happened when the united kingdom of Israel divided into two factions: the northern kingdom of Israel and the southern kingdom of Judah. The northern kingdom included the tribes Reuben, Simeon, Dan, Naphtali, Gad, Issachar, Asher, Zebulun, Ephraim, and Manasseh. The tribe of Benjamin stayed with the southern kingdom of Judah.

Towards the end of this section, the storyteller includes the family history of Naphtali. The summary of Naphtali's family is the shortest of all the Israelite tribes. Naphtali is the son of Jacob, whom people also called Israel, with Jacob's concubine Bilhah. When Rachel, who was Jacob's wife, could not conceive a child, Rachel gave Bilhah to Jacob to have children with. Naphtali and Dan are the two sons of Jacob and Bilhah.

We will see a more complete family history of Benjamin in future passages of 1 Chronicles.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:6–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 7:6–13

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller introduces the sons of Benjamin.

In the second scene: The storyteller introduces the descendants of Bela.

In the third scene: The storyteller introduces the descendants of Beker.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller introduces the descendants of Jediael.

In the fifth scene: The storyteller introduces the descendants of Naphtali.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller of Chronicles
- Benjamin
- Sons of Benjamin: Bela, Beker, Jediael
- Sons of Bela: Ezbon, Uzzi, Uzziel, Jerimoth, Iri
- 22,034 fighting men from the descendants of Bela
- Sons of Beker: Zemirah, Joash, Eliezer, Elioenai, Omri, Jeremoth, Abijah, Anathoth, Alemeth
- 20,200 fighting men from the descendants of Beker
- Son of Jediael: Bilhan
- Sons of Bilhan: Jeush, Benjamin, Ehud, Kenaanah, Zethan, Tarshish, Ahishahar
- 17,200 fighting men from the descendants of Jediael
- Ir
- Sons of Ir: Shuppim, Huppim
- Aher
- Son of Aher: Hushim
- Naphtali
- Bilhah, the mother of Naphtali
- Sons of Naphtali: Jahziel, Guni, Jezer, Shillem

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller suddenly lists the three sons of Benjamin without any other introduction. Benjamin was the youngest son of Jacob, or Israel. The sons of Benjamin are Bela, Beker, and Jediael. This list followed the birth order of the sons. Bela was the eldest, followed by Beker, and then Jediael was the youngest.

In the second scene, the storyteller introduces the sons of Bela. Bela was the eldest son of Benjamin. Bela had five sons. These sons were Ezbon, Uzzi, Uzziel, Jerimoth, and Iri. The storyteller mentioned that these sons were mighty warriors or soldiers. These sons were also the heads of their families. This means that these sons were the leaders of their clans. To be the leader of the clan means that these people are responsible for the welfare and protection of the members of the clan. The genealogy, or family history, recorded 22,034 warriors under their clans. The exact number of warriors may have come from the census during David's time as king of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question. In your culture, what are the responsibilities of the heads or leaders of your clan? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller introduced the sons of Beker. Beker is the second son of Benjamin. The sons of Beker were Zemirah, Joash, Eliezer, Elioenai, Omri, Jeremoth, Abijah, Anathoth, and Alemeth. The storyteller emphasized that all of these names were indeed the sons of Beker. The storyteller did this by stating that they were the sons of Beker at the beginning of the list of names and stating it again at the end of the list of names.

Stop here and discuss this question: How will you make it clear that these sons were the sons of Beker? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller also mentioned that the family record included 20,200 mighty warriors or soldiers under the heads of their clans. This gives the impression that the family of Beker is a family of warriors.

1 Chronicles 7:6–13

In the fourth scene, the storyteller introduced Jediael's son Bilhan. Then the storyteller immediately presented Bilhan's sons. The sons of Bilhan were Jeush, Benjamin, Ehud, Kenaanah, Zethan, Tarshish, and Ahishahar. Bilhan is the only son of Jediael listed here. Perhaps this is the reason why the storyteller considered the sons of Bilhan as the sons of Jediael, too. The narrator listed them as sons of Jediael, even though it includes not only the sons but also the grandsons of Jediael. The word for sons in this list can also mean descendants.

Stop here and discuss this question: How will you make it clear that these sons were the descendants of Jediael? Pause this audio here.

These sons were also listed as mighty warriors. There were 17,200 warriors listed under their clans who served in the army.

Towards the end of the fourth scene, the storyteller introduces Shuppim and Huppim as sons of Ir, and Hushim as the son of Aher. These people are probably descendants of Jediael. Shuppim, Huppim, and Hushim are the names of the sons, but some English translations use Shuppites, Huppites, and Hushites, which may refer to a group of people. We are not sure if these names refer to individual people or to groups of people. You may choose to follow the Bible translation of your area when you name these people.

In the fifth scene, the storyteller introduces the sons of Naphtali. You will remember that Naphtali is a son of Jacob and a woman named Bilhah. The sons of Naphtali were Jahziel, Guni, and Jesher. The storyteller finishes by reminding us that all these men were also the descendants of Bilhah.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:6–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller of Chronicles
- Benjamin
- Sons of Benjamin: Bela, Beker, Jediael
- Sons of Bela: Ezbon, Uzzi, Uzziel, Jerimoth, Iri
- 22,034 fighting men from the descendants of Bela
- Sons of Beker: Zemirah, Joash, Eliezer, Elioenai, Omri, Jeremoth, Abijah, Anathoth, Alemeth
- 20,200 fighting men from the descendants of Beker
- Son of Jediael: Bilhan
- Sons of Bilhan: Jeush, Benjamin, Ehud, Kenaanah, Zethan, Tarshish, Ahishahar
- 17,200 fighting men from the descendants of Jediael
- Ir
- Sons of Ir: Shuppim, Huppim
- Aher
- Son of Aher: Hushim
- Naphtali
- Bilhah, the mother of Naphtali
- Sons of Naphtali: Jahziel, Guni, Jezer, Shillem

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

1 Chronicles 7:6–13

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller calls Benjamin and lets him stand at the center. Then the storyteller calls the three sons of Benjamin from the eldest to the youngest. The storyteller will call Bela, Beker, and Jediael. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Benjamin, "What are you feeling or thinking as the head of your family or clan?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel honored and thankful. God had blessed me with a family; or
- I feel anxious. I hope I will be able to lead my family and clan according to the ways of Yahweh.

Then ask the people who are playing Bela, Beker, and Jediael, "What are you feeling or thinking as the sons of Benjamin?" The people who are playing the sons of Benjamin might answer things like:

- We think Yahweh wants us to honor our father by living in a way where we obey Yahweh's commands.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, the storyteller calls Bela and lets him stand at the center. Then the storyteller calls the sons of Bela and lets them stand in front of Bela. The storyteller calls the sons of Bela in this order: Ezbon, Uzzi, Uzziel, Jerimoth, and Iri. The storyteller also mentions that these sons were mighty warriors who served the kingdom. These sons are also leaders of their clans. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Bela, "What are you feeling or thinking about as the head of your family or clan who serves as warriors or soldiers for the kingdom of Israel?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel proud that I am a father of warriors who serve the kingdom of Israel; or
- I feel afraid for the safety of my sons who serve as warriors. My sons might get injured or lose their lives in times of war.

Then ask the people who are playing the sons of Bela, "What are you feeling or thinking as you serve the kingdom of Israel as warriors or soldiers? And what are you feeling or thinking about your responsibility to lead your clans?" The person might answer things like:

- I think Yahweh wants us to honor and serve as warriors for the sake of the kingdom of Israel, or
- I feel that we are privileged to lead our clans.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, the storyteller calls Beker and lets him stand at the center. Then the storyteller calls the sons of Beker and lets them stand in front of Beker. The storyteller calls the sons of Beker in this order: Zemirah, Joash, Eliezer, Elioenai, Omri, Jeremoth, Abijah, Anathoth, and Alemeth. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Beker, "What are you feeling or thinking about as the head of your family or clan who serves as warriors or soldiers for the kingdom of Israel?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel proud that I am a father of warriors who serve the kingdom of Israel; or,
- I feel afraid for the safety of my sons who serve as warriors. My sons might get injured or lose their lives in times of war.

Then ask the people who are playing the sons of Beker, "What are you feeling or thinking as you serve the kingdom of Israel as warriors or soldiers? And what are you feeling or thinking about your responsibility to lead your clans?" The people might answer things like:

- I think Yahweh wants us to honor and serve as warriors for the sake of the kingdom of Israel, or
- I feel that we are privileged to lead our clans. Not all will have the opportunity to serve in such a capacity.

[!end] Continue the drama.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller calls Jediael and lets him stand at the center. Then the storyteller calls Jediael's son, Bilhan, and lets Bilhan stand at the center. Then the storyteller immediately calls Bilhan's sons and

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lets them stand in front of Bilhan. The storyteller calls the sons of Bilhan in this order: Jeush, Benjamin, Ehud, Kenaanah, Zethan, Tarshish, and Ahishahar. Then the storyteller says that all of these sons are sons of Jediael. The storyteller also mentions that the family of Jediael is a family of warriors or soldiers who serve the kingdom.

The storyteller then calls Ir together with Ir's sons Shuppim and Huppim. Then the storyteller calls Aher together with Aher's son Hushim. People believe that these men were descendants of Jediael. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jediael, "What are you feeling or thinking about having only one child?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel thankful to Yahweh for blessing me, even if it is only one child; or
- I feel sad because I do not have many children.

Then ask the person who is playing Bilhan, "What are you feeling or thinking about being the only child?" The person might answer things like:

- I think I have the responsibility to take care of my father and our family when my father grows old; or
- I feel sad that I do not have other siblings.

Then ask the people who are playing the sons of Bilhan, "What are you feeling or thinking about being a family that serves the kingdom?" The people might answer things like:

- We need to be responsible and live in the right way so that our family will have a good reputation; or
- It is a privilege to serve the kingdom.

Then ask the people who are playing the other descendants of Jediael, "What are you feeling or thinking about being part of this family?" The people might answer things like:

- We need to be responsible and live in the right way so that our family will have a good reputation; or
- It is a privilege to serve the kingdom.

Continue the drama. In the fourth scene, the storyteller calls Naphtali and lets him stand at the center. Then the storyteller calls the sons of Naphtali. The storyteller calls the sons of Naphtali in this order: Jahziel, Guni, and Jesher. The storyteller also calls Bilhah and introduces her as the ancestor of the tribe of Naphtali. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Naphtali, "What are you feeling or thinking about as one of the heads of the 12 tribes of Israel?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel thankful to Yahweh for using me to fulfill Yahweh's promise to our ancestor Abraham; or
- I feel I have the responsibility to live out the faith of our ancestor Abraham.

Then ask the people who are playing the sons of Naphtali, "What are you feeling or thinking about as the sons of Naphtali?" The people might answer things like:

- We think we have the responsibility to take care of our family and live out our faith in Yahweh.

Then ask the person who is playing Bilhah, "What are you feeling or thinking about as a part of the family history of Israel?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel very honored to be part of the family.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:6–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The passage presents the family history of Benjamin by immediately introducing the **sons** of Benjamin in the first scene. The storyteller refers to them as sons of Benjamin. Although the original language uses a word that means sons, that word can also mean anyone who is descended from the person. In this case, the sons in this passage were most likely really sons of Benjamin. Later in this passage, the storyteller talks about the sons of Jediael to refer to Bilhan and Bilhan's sons. It is also possible that Shuppim, Huppim, and Hushim were actually groups of people rather than individuals. In these cases, the word for sons refers to **descendants**. Use the same

word or phrase for sons and descendants that you have been using in the previous passages to mean sons. For more information on sons and descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

In the second scene, the passage presents the sons of Bela. The sons of Bela were Ezbon, Uzzi, Uzziel, Jerimoth, and Iri. These men were **leaders**, or **chiefs**, of their father's **households**. Use the same word or phrase for leaders, or chiefs, and fathers' households that you have been using in the previous passages. Use these same words throughout this passage as well. Household is in the Master Glossary.

The **genealogy** of the sons of Bela lists 22,034 **warriors**, or **fighting men**, from the descendants of Bela. Use the same words or phrases for warrior or fighting men, and for genealogy, as you used in previous passages, and throughout this passage as well. Genealogy is in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 7:6–13

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (3.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (8.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Chronicles 7:14–19

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 7:14–19 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:14–19 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

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Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:14–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This list continues the family history of the tribes of Israel. You will remember that family histories do not usually tell all the names of the family members. Family histories may include the names of famous members of the family. And most of the time, family histories record the names of the leaders or heads of the family. This way, the people in a tribe can easily trace their ancestors and their place in the family history.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: If you have not done this before, remind each other of how you list important names in a family's history in your culture. Pause this audio here.

In this section, the storyteller presents the family history of the tribe of Manasseh. The 12 sons of Jacob, who people also knew as Israel, became the heads of the 12 tribes of Israel. But people recognized Manasseh and Ephraim as part of the 12 tribes, even though they were the grandchildren of Jacob. Manasseh and Ephraim were the sons of Joseph. Joseph was the son of Jacob with Jacob's wife Rachel. Jacob honored the request of Joseph to Jacob to claim Manasseh and Ephraim as Jacob's own sons. Even though Joseph's brothers betrayed Joseph, Joseph saved Jacob and Jacob's family during a severe famine.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you usually honor or show appreciation to a person who did a good thing for you? Pause this audio here.

When the Israelites were about to cross the Jordan River to conquer the Promised Land, half of the tribe of Manasseh, along with the tribes of Reuben and Gad, asked Moses at that time to let them have the land on the east side of the Jordan River. This is because these tribes had a large number of farm animals, and the area across the Jordan had good pastureland that the people could use for farm animals.

Then the other half of the tribe of Manasseh settled on the west side of the Jordan River.

Stop here and look at a map as a group. Find the place where the tribe of Manasseh settled near the Jordan River after the Israelites conquered the Promised Land. Pause this audio here.

This time, the storyteller presented this family history in a different way from the family histories in the previous sections. The family history of Manasseh does not have details that describe military involvement or details about the heads of their clans. The storyteller presented the descendants of Manasseh in an interesting way. The storyteller emphasized certain characters from the family history of Manasseh.

For example, after the storyteller mentioned Manasseh, the storyteller introduced Asriel, who was Manasseh's son with Manasseh's concubine. This concubine was from the territory of Aram, or Syria.

Another example was when the storyteller gave more emphasis to the descendants of Makir. The storyteller repeated Makir's name four times in this family history. The storyteller also described Zelophehad as the person "who had daughters." Zelophehad, who was a descendant of Makir, did not have sons but only five daughters. You will remember the story about Zelophehad's daughters in the book of Numbers. After Zelophehad died, his five daughters asked Moses for Zelophehad's portion of land.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you usually pass properties or inheritance to the next generation? Pause this audio here.

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Then, finally, the storyteller also emphasized the family history of Gilead. The storyteller repeats Gilead's name twice.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you show emphasis on a person when you are telling a family history?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:14–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller presents Manasseh and the descendants of Manasseh.

In the second scene: The storyteller presents Makir and the descendants of Makir.

In the third scene: The storyteller presents Hammoleketh and the children of Hammoleketh.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller presents Shemida and the sons of Shemida.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller, who presents the family history of Manasseh
- Manasseh
- Aramean concubine of Manasseh
- Descendants of Manasseh: Asriel, Makir
- Makir's wife
- Maacah
- Sons of Makir: Gilead, Peresh, Sheresh
- Zelophehad
- Sons of Sheresh: Ulam, Rakem
- Son of Ulam: Bedan
- Hammoleketh, the sister of Gilead
- Sons of Hammoleketh: Ishhod, Abiezer, Mahlah
- Shemida
- And the sons of Shemida: Ahian, Shechem, Likhi, Aniam

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller presents the descendants of Manasseh. The storyteller introduces Asriel as the son of Manasseh with Manasseh's concubine, who came from Aram, which we know today as Syria. We do not know the name of that concubine. Then this concubine gave birth to Makir, who became the father of Gilead.

In the second scene, Makir probably took Maacah as his wife from the family of Huppim and Shuppim. Many scholars believe that Maacah is a sister of Huppim and Shuppim, rather than Makir's sister, but we are not sure. It seems that Zelophehad was another descendant of Makir, but we are not sure exactly how Zelophehad is related to Makir.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you say that you are not sure how a particular person is part of the family? Pause this audio here.

Zelophehad had no sons. Zelophedad only had five daughters.

Then the storyteller goes back to presenting the family of Makir. This time, the storyteller clearly mentions a woman named Maacah as the wife of Makir. Maacah gave birth to a son for Makir. Maacah named the son "Peresh." Peresh had a brother named Sheresh. The sons of Sheresh were Ulam and Rekem. And the son of Ulam was Bedan.

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Finally, the storyteller concludes this scene when he emphasizes that these people were indeed the sons or descendants of Gilead, who is the son of Makir, who is the son of Manasseh. It is possible that the storyteller wants to emphasize that the people he has just listed are all related to Gilead.

In the third scene, the storyteller introduces Hammoleketh. Many scholars believe that Hammoleketh is the sister of Gilead. Then the storyteller presents the children of Hammoleketh. The children of Hammoleketh were Ishhod, Abiezer, and Mahlah.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller ends the presentation of the family history of Manasseh. The storyteller introduces Shemida and the sons of Shemida. The sons of Shemida were Ahian, Shechem, Likhi, and Aniam. Shemida may be a son of Gilead, but we are not sure how Shemida is connected to the family.

We are not sure about many of the relationships in this passage, so you may choose to follow the most recent and well-known Bible translation of your area when you make decisions about how family members are related to each other in this passage.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:14–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller, who presents the family history of Manasseh
- Manasseh
- Aramean concubine of Manasseh
- Descendants of Manasseh: Asriel, Makir
- Makir's wife
- Maacah
- Sons of Makir: Gilead, Peresh, Sheresh
- Zelophehad
- Sons of Sheresh: Ulam, Rakem
- Son of Ulam: Bedan
- Hammoleketh, the sister of Gilead
- Sons of Hammoleketh: Ishhod, Abiezer, Mahlah
- Shemida
- And the sons of Shemida: Ahian, Shechem, Likhi, Aniam

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller introduces and calls Manasseh to the front. Then the storyteller introduces Manasseh's concubine. The storyteller mentions that the concubine came from the land of Aram and that she

was an Aramean. The storyteller lets the concubine stand beside Manasseh. Then the storyteller mentions that Manasseh's concubine gave birth to Manasseh's sons. The sons of Manasseh and Manasseh's concubine were Asriel and Makir. After that, the storyteller calls Asriel and Makir and lets them stand in front of Manasseh and Manasseh's concubine. Then the storyteller presents Makir as the father of Gilead. Gilead is the firstborn son of Makir. The storyteller will call Gilead and let him stand in front of Makir. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Manasseh, "What are you feeling or thinking about as part of the 12 tribes of Israel and being the head of your family or clan?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel honored to be recognized as part of the 12 tribes of Israel. I feel I have the responsibility to lead my family and clan to obey the laws of Yahweh; or
- I feel worried about whether I will be able to fulfill my role as the father of my clan faithfully.

Then ask the person playing Manasseh's concubine, "What are you feeling or thinking about living with a person whose culture is different from yours?" The person might answer things like:

- I think this will be hard for me, since I need to learn and live the new culture; or
- I feel happy because these people accept me in the family even though my culture is different.

Then ask the people who are playing the sons of Manasseh, "What are you feeling or thinking about the fact that your father and mother came from different cultures?" The people might answer things like:

- I think it is the will of Yahweh to love and accept people, even if the people have different cultures; or
- I think it will promote peace and understanding.

Then ask the people who are playing Asriel and Makir, who were the sons of Manasseh, "What are you feeling or thinking about the fact that your father and mother came from different cultures?" The people might answer things like:

- I think it is the will of Yahweh to love and accept people, even if the people have different cultures; or
- I think it will promote peace and understanding.

Now ask the person playing Gilead, "What are you feeling or thinking about being included in the genealogy or family history of your family?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel honored to be included in our family history.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, the storyteller talks more about Makir and Makir's family line. The storyteller calls Makir again and lets Makir stand in the center. Then the storyteller calls Maacah with her brothers Huppim and Shuppim. Maacah, Huppim, and Shuppim will stand at the left side of Makir. Then the storyteller calls Makir and Maacah to the center. The storyteller will tell that Makir took Maacah to be his wife. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Makir and Maacah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We feel very happy and honored because people have recognized us; or
- I think I have the responsibility to lead my family to obey the laws of Yahweh and to keep the honor that people have given me.

Continue the drama. Then the storyteller suddenly introduces Zelophehad. The storyteller mentions that Zelophehad is a descendant of Makir and that Zelophehad did not have sons, only five daughters. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Zelophehad, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel very thankful. Yahweh has blessed me with daughters; or
- I feel sad. If only Yahweh would bless me with sons, too. How will my inheritance pass down to my family?

Continue the drama. After that, the storyteller continues to present the family line of Makir. The storyteller says that Maacah, who was the wife of Makir, gave birth to a son. The storyteller calls Peresh, who was the son of Maacah and Makir. The storyteller lets Peresh stand in front of Maacah and Makir. Then the storyteller mentions that Peresh had a brother named Sheresh. The storyteller lets Sheresh stand beside Peresh. Then the storyteller presents the sons of Sheresh, who were Ulam and Rekem. The storyteller lets these sons stand in front of Sheresh. Then the storyteller calls Bedan and introduces Bedan as the son of Ulam. The storyteller lets Bedan stand in front of Ulam. The storyteller then finishes this scene when he says that these people were the

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descendants of Gilead. Gilead was the son of Makir, and Makir was the son of Manasseh. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Makir and Maacah, "What were you feeling or thinking when you had your children?" The people might answer things like:

- We think we are to live our lives and lead our family according to the commands of Yahweh; or
- We feel worried about whether we will be able to fulfill our roles as parents according to the commands of Yahweh.

Ask the people playing Peresh and Sheresh, "What are you feeling or thinking as the children of Makir and Maacah?" The people might answer things like:

- We think we are to honor our parents by living according to the commands of Yahweh; or
- We feel responsible to help our children live their lives in the right way.

Ask the people playing Ulam and Rekem, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We think we have the responsibility to teach the laws of Yahweh to the next generation; or
- Yahweh chose us as a people, and we feel very happy to be part of Yahweh's own people.

Ask the person playing Bedan, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I think I have the responsibility to pass the family's legacy to the next generation; or
- I feel afraid because I do not know if I can fulfill my role to lead my family according to the commands of Yahweh.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, the storyteller introduces Hammoleketh and lets Hammoleketh stand in the center. Many scholars believe that Hammoleketh is the sister of Gilead. Then the storyteller will introduce the children of Hammoleketh. The children of Hammoleketh were Ishdod, Abiezer, and Mahlah. The storyteller lets the children of Hammoleketh stand in front of Hammoleketh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Hammoleketh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy and honored to be included in our family history; or
- I feel worried about whether I can live up to the expectations of my family.

Ask the people playing Ishdod, Abiezer, and Mahlah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We think we have the responsibility to teach the laws of Yahweh to the next generation; or
- Yahweh chose us as a people, and we feel very happy.

Continue the drama. In the fourth scene, the storyteller introduces Shemida and lets Shemida stand in front. Shemida was a descendant of Gilead. Then the storyteller will call the sons of Shemida. The sons of Shemida were Ahian, Shechem, Likhi, and Aniam. The storyteller lets the sons of Shemida stand in front of Shemida. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Shemida, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel the responsibility to continue the traditions and practices of my family; or
- I feel worried that I may fail my family.

Ask the people playing Ahian, Shechem, Likhi, and Aniam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We think we have the responsibility to preserve our tradition and connect it to the next generation; or
- We feel very happy that we have the opportunity to make things better as we lead the next generation.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:14–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

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The first scene introduced Manasseh along with his Aramean concubine and their sons. **Aram** was a place in the northeast outside of Israel. Today, Aram is called Syria. Use the same word for Aram here as you have used in previous passages.

Although the storyteller uses the word **son** in this passage, son can also mean a **descendant**, or the grandsons and great-grandsons of a father. In this passage, the word for sons means descendant when the storyteller lists the "sons, or descendants" of Manasseh. Asriel, Zelophehad, and the "sons of Gilead" are all also probably descendants rather than the direct son of someone. Use the same word or phrase for sons or descendants that you have been using in the previous passages. For more information on sons and descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same word or phrase for **concubine**, or wife of lower status, as you used in previous passages.

Maacah was the sister of Huppim and Shuppim. Other translations understand these two names as groups of people, which they call Huppites and Shuppites. You can choose to use the names Huppim and Shuppim, or you can address them as people of Huppites and Shuppites.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 7:14–19

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (972 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (8.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Chronicles 7:20–29

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 7:20–29 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:20–29 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:20–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Ephraim and Manasseh were the two sons of Joseph. Ephraim was the youngest son. We remember that Joseph asked Jacob, who people also called Israel, to bless Manasseh and Ephraim as Israel's own sons. That is why Manasseh and Ephraim were included in the 12 tribes of Israel.

In this section, the storyteller presents the descendants of Ephraim. But sadly, the people from the city of Gath killed two of Ephraim's descendants. These descendants were Ezer and Elead. This happened because Ezer and Elead raided some people in the area of Gath and attempted to take those people's farm animals. We do not know when this event happened, as Ephraim was born in Egypt. Ezer and Elead are probably two of Ephraim's descendants, not direct sons.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your culture, how do you comfort each other when a close family member dies? Pause this audio here.

People who lived in these times raised farm animals, fished, and planted crops. Since a large portion of the land of Israel was dry, mountainous, and rocky, the best way for the Israelites to provide for their families was to raise farm animals. Most of the time, when a tribe or a family had a lot of farm animals, people in the community considered that family wealthy. Sometimes, people from other tribes would talk about these wealthy families. Then bands of raiders or thieves would hear about this wealth and come to rob the families of their possessions and animals. Sometimes the raiders also took people captive. That is why the tribes trained their own fighting men to protect their people and property.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you preserve or protect your possessions from bad people? Pause this audio here.

We also remember that in those times, people often gave names for special reasons. The parents gave names to remember significant events or experiences. In this case, Ephraim gave his son the name Beriah to remember that their family had lost these two sons. The name Beriah sounds like the Hebrew word for "disaster," or "tragedy."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you usually name your children? How do you remember important events or experiences in your family history? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller adds another interesting detail here. As you may remember, men were more important in family histories than women in this culture. That is why we hear more names of men than women in this genealogy. But the storyteller of Chronicles mentions a woman in the genealogy of Ephraim's tribes. The storyteller includes the name of Sheerah, who was the daughter of Ephraim, maybe because Sheerah founded the cities of Lower and Upper Beth Horon, and Uzzen Sheerah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you talk about a woman who has done something important? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller also presents Joshua as a descendant of Ephraim. We remember that Yahweh chose Joshua, who was Moses' assistant, to continue the work of Moses. Joshua led the people of Israel to conquer the Promised Land.

Finally, the storyteller presents the geographical location where the tribe of Ephraim settled in the Promised Land. The territory of the tribe of Ephraim includes two significant places in the history of Israel. These places were Bethel and Shechem. Bethel is the place where Jacob saw, in a dream, angels going up to heaven and coming down. More significant events happened in Shechem. The Israelites renewed the covenant in Shechem during the time of Joshua. This is also the place where the Israelites buried Joseph, who was the father of Manasseh and Ephraim. These lands are near the lands of Manasseh. In this way, the storyteller shows the close connection of Ephraim with Manasseh as the sons of Joseph.

Stop here and look at a map of ancient Israel as a group. Locate the territory of Ephraim and Manasseh, as well as the cities of Lower and Upper Beth Horon, Uzzen Sheerah, Bethel, Naaran, Gezer, Shechem, Beth Shan, Taanach, Megiddo, and Dor.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:20–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller presents Ephraim and the descendants of Ephraim.

In the second scene: The storyteller presents the death of two of Ephraim's descendants.

In the third scene: The storyteller presents Ephraim's other descendants.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller presents the territory and cities of the tribe of Ephraim.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller, who presents the family history of Ephraim
- Ephraim
- Wife of Ephraim
- Descendants of Ephraim: Shuthelah, Bered, Tahath, Eleadah, another Tahath, Zabad, another Shuthelah, Ezer, Elead, Beriah, Rephah, Resheph, Telah, Tahan, Ladan, Ammihud, Elishama, Nun, Joshua, and his daughter Sheerah
- Ephraim's relatives
- And the men of Gath

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller introduces the descendants of Ephraim. When the storyteller introduces the eldest son of Ephraim, who was Shuthelah, the storyteller also introduces the descendants of Shuthelah. The son of Shuthelah was Bered. Then Bered's son was Tahath. Tahath's son was Eleadah. Eleadah's son's name was also Tahath. Tahath's son was Zabad. And Zabad's son was also Shuthelah. Then the storyteller introduces the other two sons of Ephraim, who were Ezer and Elead.

In the second scene, the storyteller tells the tragedy that the family of Ephraim experienced. Sadly, the people who were born in the city of Gath killed Ezer and Elead because Ezer and Elead tried to take those people's livestock, or farm animals. Ephraim mourned his sons' death for many days. Ephraim's relatives also came to Ephraim to comfort Ephraim. This may seem confusing because we know that Ephraim was born and died in Egypt. Perhaps Ephraim's sons, Ezer and Elead, left Egypt to raid the people of Gath, or perhaps Ephraim and his relatives refer to the descendants of Ephraim as a group. You should translate this section just as it is.

In the third scene, the storyteller mentions that Ephraim and Ephraim's wife had sexual relations again and had a new son. The storyteller uses the phrase "went in to his wife" to mean that they had sexual relations. Ephraim's wife "conceived" and had a son.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your language, how do you translate that a married couple had sexual relations in an appropriate or respectful way? How do you translate in an appropriate way that a woman is pregnant and has had a son? Pause this audio here.

Ephraim named this son Beriah so that people could remember the tragedy that Ephraim's family experienced. The name Beriah means "disaster," or "tragedy."

Then the storyteller continues to present the descendants of Ephraim. Ephraim had a daughter named Sheerah. Sheerah built the towns of Lower and Upper Beth Horon and also Uzzen Sheerah. Then the storyteller mentions Rephah. We are not sure whether Rephah is Beriah's son or Ephraim's son. Rephah's son was Resheph. Resheph's son was Telah. Telah's son was Tahan. Tahan's son was Nun. And Nun's son was Joshua.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you translate this statement about Rephah to show that we are not sure whose son Rephah is? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller gives the territorial boundaries of the land that Joshua gave to Ephraim. The boundaries where the tribe of Ephraim settled included the cities of Bethel, Naaran, and Gezer, and the villages that surrounded these cities. Naaran was in the eastern part of the territory, and Gezer was in the western part of the territory. You will remember that the direction of "east" is the direction from which the sun rises. "West" is the direction to which the sun sets.

The tribe also settled in the cities and villages of Shechem as far as Ayyah. The tribe also reached the borders of the people, or sons, of Manasseh and extended to the cities and villages of Beth Shan, Taanach, Megiddo, and Dor. This is where the tribe of Ephraim settled.

The storyteller reminds us that Ephraim was the son of Joseph, who was the son of Jacob, or Israel.

Stop here and look at a map of ancient Israel as a group again and trace the area where the tribe of Ephraim lived. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:20–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller, who presents the family history of Ephraim
- Ephraim
- Wife of Ephraim
- Descendants of Ephraim: Shuthelah, Bered, Tahath, Eleadah, another Tahath, Zabad, another Shuthelah, Ezer, Elead, Beriah, Rephah, Resheph, Telah, Tahan, Ladan, Ammihud, Elishama, Nun, Joshua, and his daughter Sheerah
- Ephraim's relatives
- And the men of Gath

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller calls the descendants of Ephraim. The storyteller calls the eldest son of Ephraim, who was Shuthelah. Shuthelah will stand in front of Ephraim. Then the storyteller calls the descendants of Shuthelah, starting with Bered, who was the son of Shuthelah. Bered will stand in front of Shuthelah. Then the storyteller calls Tahath, who was the son of Bered. Tahath will stand in front of Bered. Then the storyteller calls Eleadah, who was the son of Tahath. Eleadah will stand in front of Tahath. Then the storyteller calls another man named Tahath. This Tahath is the son of Eleadah. Tahath will stand in front of Eleadah. Then the storyteller calls Zabad, who was the son of Tahath. Zabad will stand in front of Tahath. Then the storyteller calls Shuthelah, who was the son of Zabad. Shuthelah will stand in front of Zabad. After the descendants of Shuthelah form a line, the storyteller calls Ezer and Elead, who were the other two sons of Ephraim. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Shuthelah, Bered, Tahath, Eleadah, Tahath, Zabad, Shuthelah, Ezer, and Elead, “What are you feeling or thinking being part of the tribe of Ephraim?” These persons might answer things like:

- We feel blessed because we are part of the chosen people of Yahweh; or
- We feel insecure because our great ancestor Ephraim was not a direct son of Israel.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, the storyteller tells the tragedy that the family of Ephraim experienced. Ezer and Elead went to Gath to steal the livestock, or farm animals, from the people of Gath. But the men of Gath fought back and killed Ezer and Elead. Ephraim mourned for many days because of his sons’ death. Ephraim’s relatives comforted Ephraim. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Ezer and Elead, “What were you thinking when you came and tried to take the farm animals of the people of Gath?” The people who are playing Ezer and Elead might answer things like:

- We thought we needed to prove ourselves to the family by bringing them farm animals; or
- We felt no fear in doing this.

Ask the people playing the men of Gath, “What were you feeling or thinking when Ezer and Elead tried to take your farm animals?” The people who are playing the men of Gath might answer things like:

- We felt very afraid. These people are members of Yahweh’s people. We cannot stop them; or
- We thought we needed to protect our people and our properties.

Ask the person playing Ephraim, “What were you feeling or thinking when you found out that your sons Ezer and Elead were dead?” The person who is playing Ephraim might answer things like:

- I feel very sad because of this tragedy; or
- I think that Yahweh let this happen.

Ask the people playing the relatives of Ephraim, “What were you feeling or thinking when you came to be with Ephraim?” The people who are playing relatives of Ephraim might answer things like:

- We feel very sad about the tragedy that happened to Ephraim’s family; or
- We think we need to console and encourage Ephraim.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, the storyteller mentions that Ephraim and Ephraim’s wife had a new son. Ephraim named this son Beriah as a reminder of the tragedy that their family experienced. Then the storyteller continues to present the descendants of Ephraim. The storyteller calls Sheerah, the daughter of Ephraim. The storyteller mentions that Sheerah built the towns of Lower and Upper Beth Horon and also Uzzen Sheerah. Then the storyteller continues to present the other descendants of Ephraim. The storyteller calls Rephah. Then the storyteller calls Rephah’s son who was Resheph. Resheph will stand in front of Rephah. Then the storyteller calls Resheph’s son who was Telah. Telah will stand in front of Resheph. Then the storyteller calls Telah’s son who was Tahan. Tahan will stand in front of Telah. Then the storyteller calls Tahan’s son who was Ladan. Ladan will stand in front of Tahan. Then the storyteller calls Ammihud who was the son of Ladan. Ammihud will stand in front of Ladan. Then the storyteller calls Elishama who was the son of Ammihud. Elishama will stand in front of

Ammihud. Then the storyteller calls Nun who was the son of Elishama. Nun will stand in front of Elishama. And then the storyteller calls Nun's son who was Joshua. Joshua will stand in front of Nun. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ephraim, "What were you thinking or feeling when you found out that your wife conceived and gave birth to a son for you?" The person playing Ephraim might answer things like:

- I feel like Yahweh is faithful, because Yahweh blessed me with a son; or
- I still feel grief because I lost my children.

Ask the person playing Beriah, "What were you feeling or thinking when you found out that your father Ephraim named you from the tragedy that happened to the family?" The person who is playing Beriah might answer things like:

- I feel the sadness that my father Ephraim feels; or
- I think it is unfair to me to be identified with the tragedy that happened to my family.

Ask the people playing Beriah, Sheerah, Rephah, Resheph, Telah, Tahan, Ladan, Ammihud, Elishama, Nun, and Joshua, "What are you feeling or thinking as part of the tribe of Ephraim after the family experienced a great tragedy?" These people might answer things like:

- We feel sad because of what our family has experienced; or
- We think we have the chance to make things right and prove ourselves worthy to be called people of Yahweh.

Continue the drama. In the fourth scene, the storyteller gives the territorial boundaries of the land that the tribe of Ephraim received. The territory includes the area of Bethel, East Naaran, West Gezer, Shechem, Ayyah, and the area near the border of the territory of the tribe of Manasseh, Beth Shan, Taanach, Megiddo, and Dor. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ephraim, "What were you thinking or feeling when you found out that you received these areas as your territory?" The person playing Ephraim might answer things like:

- I feel very happy. Yahweh has blessed me with such wide territory; or
- I think I need to be faithful to Yahweh because of Yahweh's kindness.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:20–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Scene one introduced the sons of Ephraim. Although the original language uses a word that means sons, in this passage, the word "sons" or "descendants" means anyone who is descended from Ephraim. This passage also ends with a summary statement that all of the names the storyteller listed are the "sons," or "**descendants**," of Joseph, son of **Israel**. Use the same words or phrases for descendants and Israel that you used in the previous passages. For more information on descendant and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Scene two showed how the two children of Ephraim died. The men of Gath killed Ezer and Elead because they came to Gath to get the people's **livestock**, or farm animals. These animals can be cows, sheep, and goats. Use the same word for livestock as you have used in previous passages.

The brothers of Ephraim came to comfort Ephraim. The storyteller says "brothers" to mean Ephraim's **family members**, which can include anyone who is related to Ephraim. Use the same words for family members or relatives as you used in the previous passages.

In scene three, Beriah is born as the son of Ephraim. Here and for the rest of the passage, the storyteller uses **son** to mean a male child of his father. Use the same word or phrase for son as you have in previous passages. Remember that son is in the Master Glossary.

Ephraim names his son Beriah because **disaster** or **tragedy** had come to his house. A disaster or tragedy is something very sad and very bad that causes people sadness or pain.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for disaster or tragedy. Pause this audio here.

In scene four, the storyteller listed the areas where the tribe of Ephraim lived. In this scene, the storyteller talks about the **settlements** and then mentions the names of **cities**. The word for settlements is a general word for places where people live. These cities, like Bethel, probably had walls around them for protection. Also, each city probably had **villages** around it that were small settlements without walls. Use the same general word or phrase for settlement that you used in the previous passages. Also, use the same words for cities and small villages that surround larger cities that you used in the previous passages.

Some of the cities are in the eastern part of the territory, and some of the cities are in the western part of the territory. Use the same words for east and west as you have used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 7:20–29

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (869 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (7.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Chronicles 7:30–40

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 7:30–40 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:30–40 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1 Chronicles 7:30–40

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:30–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This section presents a simple family history of the tribe of Asher. The first part of this family history introduces Asher. Then we hear a list of Asher's descendants, and finally, the family history ends with a summary and comments about the tribe of Asher. The list of names in the family history is a bit longer than the previous histories. The family history also shows that the information is from a military census because it includes information about the number of fighting men.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you usually take a military census in your culture? Pause this audio here.

Asher is the eighth son of Jacob, or Israel. The mother of Asher was Zilpah. Zilpah was the personal maid of Leah, who was the first wife of Jacob. Gad and Asher were the two sons of Zilpah and Jacob. The storyteller presents Asher's family history that includes heads of families, honorable men, brave warriors, and outstanding leaders. The storyteller also mentions that the people listed 26,000 warriors in their family history.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you describe a family or a clan that people know have brave warriors? Pause this audio here.

After the people of Israel conquered the Promised Land, the tribe of Asher settled in the northern part of Canaan, which covers the mountain range of Carmel. That part of the region was an ideal place for people to let their animals graze. That location was also an ideal place for people to trade or sell things. Traders passed through that region in those times. Perhaps this fulfilled Jacob's blessing to Asher, when Jacob said in the past that Asher's food would be abundant and would be the food of kings and princes.

Stop here and look at a map of Canaan as a group and locate the portion of the land Joshua gave to the tribe of Asher.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:30–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has seven scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller introduces Asher and the sons of Asher.

In the second scene: The storyteller presents the descendants of Asher through Beriah.

In the third scene: The storyteller presents more descendants of Asher through Heber.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller presents more descendants of Asher through Helem.

In the fifth scene: The storyteller presents more descendants of Asher through Jether.

In the sixth scene: The storyteller presents more descendants of Asher through Ulla.

In the seventh scene: The storyteller finishes the family history of Asher.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller, who presents the family history of Asher
- Asher
- Sons of Asher: Imnah, Ishvah, Ishvi, Beriah, and Serah, their sister
- Sons of Beriah: Heber, Malkiel
- Son of Malkiel: Birzaith
- Sons of Heber: Japhlet, Shomer, Hotham, and Shua, their sister
- Sons of Japhlet: Pasach, Bimhal, Ashvath
- Sons of Shomer: Ahi, Rohgah, Hubbah, Aram
- Helem
- Sons of Helem: Zophah, Imna, Shelesh, Amal
- Sons of Zophah: Suah, Harnepher, Shual, Beri, Imrah, Bezer, Hod, Shamma, Shilshah, Ithran, Beera
- Sons of Jether: Jephunneh, Pispah, Ara
- And the sons of Ulla: Arah, Hanniel, Rizia

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller introduces Asher and the sons of Asher. The sons of Asher were Imnah, Ishvah, Ishvi, and Beriah. Asher also had a daughter named Serah.

In the second scene, the storyteller continues the family history of Asher through Asher's son Beriah. The sons of Beriah were Heber and Malkiel. Malkiel had a son named Birzaith.

In the third scene, the storyteller continues the family history of Asher through Beriah's son, Heber. The sons of Heber were Japhlet, Shomer, and Hotham. Heber also had a daughter. Heber's daughter's name was Shua. Then the storyteller presents the sons of Japhlet. The sons of Japhlet were Pasach, Bimhal, and Ashvath. The storyteller gives a summary statement here that he has finished listing the sons of Japhlet. This is a way to help the listener organize the names in their mind.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your language, what kinds of things do you say in a long list of names to help the listener organize the list in their minds? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller presents the sons of Shomer. The sons of Shomer were Ahi, Rohgah, Hubbah, and Aram.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller continues the family history of Asher through Helem. Helem may be the son of Heber, and also perhaps the brother of Shomer. Some scholars think that Shomer and Helem are the same people as Heber's sons Shomer and Hotham, who we heard about earlier in the list, but we are not sure about this. You may want to consider using the common translation in your area. The sons of Helem were Zophah, Imna, Shelesh, and Amal. Then the storyteller presents the sons of Zophah. The sons of Zophah were Suah, Harnepher, Shual, Beri, Imrah, Bezer, Hod, Shamma, Shilshah, Ithran, and Beera.

In the fifth scene, the storyteller presents more descendants of Asher through Jether. We are not sure how Jether is related to Asher's other descendants. The sons of Jether were Jephunneh, Pispah, and Ara.

In the sixth scene, the storyteller presents more descendants of Asher through Ulla. We are not sure how Ulla is related to Asher's other descendants. The sons of Ulla were Arah, Hanniel, and Rizia.

In the seventh scene, the storyteller finishes the family history of the tribe of Asher. The storyteller also comments on the tribe of Asher's reputation. According to the storyteller, these men were the leaders of their father's households, good fighting men, and chiefs of the princes, or very good leaders. Finally, the storyteller mentions that the people listed 26,000 fighting men from the tribe of Asher. These details give the impression that the people of Israel respect the tribe of Asher.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:30–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

1 Chronicles 7:30–40

This passage has seven scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller, who presents the family history of Asher
- Asher
- Sons of Asher: Imnah, Ishvah, Ishvi, Beriah, and Serah, their sister
- Sons of Beriah: Heber, Malkiel
- Son of Malkiel: Birzaith
- Sons of Heber: Japhlet, Shomer, Hotham, and Shua, their sister
- Sons of Japhlet: Pasach, Bimhal, Ashvath
- Sons of Shomer: Ahi, Rohgah, Hubbah, Aram
- Helem
- Sons of Helem: Zophah, Imna, Shelesh, Amal
- Sons of Zophah: Suah, Harnepher, Shual, Beri, Imrah, Bezer, Hod, Shamma, Shilshah, Ithran, Beera
- Sons of Jether: Jephunneh, Pispah, Ara
- And the sons of Ulla: Arah, Hanniel, Rizia

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller introduces Asher. Then the storyteller calls the sons of Asher and lets them stand in front of Asher. The sons of Asher were Imnah, Ishvah, Ishvi, and Beriah. The storyteller also calls Serah, the daughter of Asher. Serah will join her brothers. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Asher, “What are you feeling or thinking as the head of one of the 12 tribes of Israel?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel honored that Yahweh chose me to represent him to my family; or
- I think the father or head of a tribe faces many challenges.

Ask the people playing the sons of Asher, “What are you feeling or thinking as the sons of Asher?” The people might answer things like:

- We think we have the responsibility to take care of our tribe; or
- We think the father or head of a tribe faces many challenges.

Ask the person playing Serah, “What are you feeling or thinking as the only daughter in the family?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel insecure because I am the only daughter; or
- I think I can prove that I can be the person Yahweh wants me to be.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, the storyteller presents the family line of Beriah. The storyteller calls on Heber and Malkiel and lets them stand in front of Beriah. Malkiel had a son named Birzaith. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Beriah, “What are you feeling or thinking now that your family has multiplied?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel grateful to Yahweh because Yahweh blessed me with children and grandchildren; or
- I think my role is to pass the traditions of my ancestors to the younger generation.

Ask the people playing the sons and descendants of Beriah, “What are you feeling or thinking as the sons and descendants of Beriah?” The people might answer things like:

- We are thankful to Yahweh for fulfilling the blessing of Jacob to our great-grandfather Asher; or
- We think we need to do many things to sustain our growing families.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, the storyteller continues the family history of Asher through Beriah’s son Heber. The sons of Heber were Japhlet, Shomer, and Hotham. Heber also had a daughter named Shua. Then the storyteller presents the sons of Japhlet. The sons of Japhlet were Pasach, Bimhal, and Ashvath. These are the sons of Japhlet. The storyteller presents the sons of Shomer. The sons of Shomer were Ahi, Rohgah, Hubbah, and Aram. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Shomer and Helem, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We feel honored because people included our names in the list; or

Continue the drama. In the fourth scene, the storyteller continues the family history of Asher through Helem. The sons of Helem were Zophah, Imna, Shelesh, and Amal. Then the storyteller presents the sons of Zophah. The sons of Zophah were Suah, Harnepher, Shual, Beri, Imrah, Bezer, Hod, Shamma, Shilshah, Ithran, and Beera. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Helem and Zophah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We feel thankful to our family members because we cannot lead our families without them; or
- We feel grateful to Yahweh because of his grace and faithfulness.

Continue the drama. In the fifth scene, the storyteller presents more descendants of Asher through Jether. The sons of Jether were Jephunneh, Pispah, and Ara.

In the sixth scene, the storyteller presents more descendants of Asher through Ulla. The sons of Ulla were Arah, Hanniel, and Rizia.

In the seventh scene, the storyteller says that these men were the leaders of their father’s households, good fighting men, and chiefs of the princes, or very good leaders. There were 26,000 men from the tribe of Asher who were listed as fighting men. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Asher again, “What are you feeling or thinking when you hear the comments of other people about your family?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel very proud of my family and descendants; or
- I feel grateful to Yahweh for his faithfulness.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 7:30–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

This family history mentions Asher’s **sons** and descendants. Although the original language uses a word that means sons, that word can also mean anyone who is descended from the person. We are not sure if these names are sons or descendants, so it may be best to use the word for sons in this passage. Use the same word or phrase for sons that you have been using in the previous passages. For more information on sons refer to the Master Glossary.

The last scene mentions that the men listed in the **genealogy** were **leaders** or chiefs of their fathers’ **households**. This means that people consider these men to be the leaders of the clans under the tribe of Asher. Use the same word or phrase for leaders, household, and genealogy as you used in previous passages. For more information about genealogy and household, refer to the Master Glossary.

The last scene also mentions that the men listed in the genealogy were famous, or well-chosen fighting men. These men from the tribe of Asher were of higher rank than that of common fighting men. We can consider these fighting men as elite fighting men.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group. In your language, how do you describe soldiers who are more skilled than normal soldiers? Pause this audio here.

Finally, the last scene mentions that some of these men were also the chiefs, or "leaders of the princes." This means that some members of the tribe of Asher have the responsibility to lead the leaders of the tribe of Asher. In other words, these men were leaders of leaders.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you describe persons who lead other leaders?

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 7:30–40

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (842 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (6.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.4 MB)

1 Chronicles 8:1–16

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 8:1–16 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:1–16 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 8:1–16

5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:1–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The previous passages are the introduction to the book of 1 Chronicles. Remember that in each passage so far in 1 Chronicles, the storyteller listed the names of important descendants of the tribes of the people of Israel. We have already seen names of people from most of the tribes of Israel. The previous passage listed names of people from the tribe of Asher. Now, this passage continues the introduction to the book of 1 Chronicles when it gives the descendants, or sons, of the tribe of Benjamin. We already saw one list that was a summary of the descendants of Benjamin in a previous passage, and now this passage has the full family history of the descendants of Benjamin.

This part of the introduction to the book of 1 Chronicles is different from the other parts of the introduction about the other tribes of Israel. This might be because the tribe of Benjamin was an important tribe that stayed with the tribe of Judah when the nation of Israel split into the northern kingdom and the southern kingdom. Or it might be because the first king of Israel, King Saul, was from the tribe of Benjamin.

This passage is the first part of a three-part story about the descendants of Benjamin. This passage and the following passages do not have a complete list of all of the descendants of Benjamin. Also, it is not always clear how people are related to each other in these passages.

In the first part of the passage, the storyteller lists the names of the sons of Benjamin. This passage says Benjamin has five sons. The firstborn son of Benjamin is Bela, and then the other sons in order of their birth are Ashbel, Aharah, Nohah, and Rapha. In an earlier passage in 1 Chronicles, the storyteller says that Benjamin has three sons, and other parts of the Old Testament say that Benjamin has as many as nine sons. This passage might have a different number of sons of Benjamin because it only includes the sons of Benjamin who started important families in the tribe of Benjamin. You will remember that the word “son” can also mean a descendant, like a grandson or a great-grandson. The names of the sons of Benjamin in this passage might also be different from the names of the sons of Benjamin in other parts of the Old Testament because different people write the names differently.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: List your sons and grandsons or the sons and grandsons of someone you know. How do you talk about sons? How do you talk about grandsons? Pause this audio here.

Next, the storyteller tells the sons of Bela, who was the firstborn son of Benjamin. Bela has nine sons: Addar, Gera, Abihud, Abishua, Naaman, Ahoah, Gera, Shephuphan, and Huram. Two sons of Bela are both named Gera, which might be because one is a grandson of Bela instead of a son. Also, Naaman is the grandson of Benjamin in this passage, but the storyteller of Genesis says Naaman is the son of Benjamin. Some people think Bela only has one son named Addar, and that Gera is the father of Ehud. These people think that the rest of the sons in this part of the passage are also the sons of Gera, the father of Ehud.

In the next part of the passage, the storyteller lists the sons of Ehud. Ehud has three sons, or descendants, named Naaman, Ahijah, and Gera. These sons of Ehud are the heads, or leaders of their families in Geba. Later, these families had to move to Manahath. Geba was a city of refuge in the land of the tribe of Benjamin. A city of refuge is a place where people can go if they kill someone accidentally. Manahath was a nearby city.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the city of Geba and the city of Manahath as a group. Pause this audio here.

It is also hard to know who brought the families from Geba to Manahath. It is possible that Gera, one of the sons of Ehud, is the one who led the families or forced the families to move. Gera, the son of Ehud, also has two sons named Uzzah and Ahihud.

Next, the storyteller gives information about a man named Shaharaim. Shaharaim has two wives named Hushim and Baara. Shaharaim has two sons with his wife Hushim, and these sons are named Abitub and Elpaal. We also

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see that sometime later, Shaharaim divorces his two wives, Hushim and Baara. In the original language, it says that Shaharaim sends these wives away from him.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does someone get divorced in your community? Pause this audio here.

Sometime after Shaharaim divorces his first two wives, Shaharaim has seven more sons with a new wife named Hodesh. These sons are Jobab, Zibia, Mesha, Malcam, Jeuz, Sakia, and Mirmah. The sons of Shaharaim all become heads, or leaders, of their families. At some point, Shaharaim moves to the land of Moab, which people also call the plains or fields of Moab.

Stop here and look at a map that shows the land of Moab as a group. Pause this audio here.

The following section of the passage is about the sons of Elpaal, who was one of the sons of Shaharaim. Elpaal has three sons: Eber, Misham, and Shemed. Shemed is probably the one who builds the cities of Ono and Lod. Shemed also builds the villages around Ono and Lod. It is possible that Shemed rebuilds these cities because Ono and Lod both were already cities during the time of Elpaal and his sons.

Stop here and look at a map that includes Ono and Lod. Pause this audio here.

Next, we hear information about Beriah and Shema. Beriah and Shema are the leaders of the families who live in Aijalon, a city near Jerusalem. The leaders of families who lived in Aijalon chased out the people of Gath from the city of Gath. We do not know why the leaders of families forced the people of Gath to leave. Some people think that the other sons of Elpaal are also leaders of families who chased out the people of Gath. Gath could be the Philistine city, or a different city that people also called Gittaim.

Stop here and look at a map that includes the cities of Aijalon and Gath as a group. Pause this audio here.

It is also unclear how Ahio, Shashak, and Jeremoth are related to the other people in this passage. Most people think that Ahio, Shashak, and Jeremoth are also sons of Beriah. Other people think that Ahio, Shashak, and Jeremoth could be other sons of Elpaal from earlier in the passage. In the final part of this passage, Beriah has six sons named Zebadiah, Arad, Eder, Michael, Ishpah, and Joha.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:1–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: Benjamin has five sons. The firstborn son of Benjamin is Bela. Bela has nine sons.

In the second scene: Ehud has three sons. The sons of Ehud and their families move from Geba to Manahath.

In the third scene: Shaharaim has two sons with his wife, Hushim. Shaharaim divorces his first two wives, Hushim and Baraa. Shaharaim marries another wife, and Shaharaim has seven more sons.

In the fourth scene: Elpaal has five sons. These sons are the leaders of the families that live in Aijalon. The sons of Elpaal chase out the people of Gath.

In the fifth scene: Beriah has nine sons.

The characters in this passage are:

- Benjamin
- Benjamin's firstborn son, Bela
- Benjamin's other sons, Ashbel, Aharah, Nohah, and Rapha
- Bela's sons, Addar, Gera, Abihud, Abishua, Naaman, Ahoah, Gera, Shephuphan, and Huram
- Ehud
- Ehud's sons, Naaman, Ahijah, and Gera

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- Uzza and Ahihud
- Families of people who live in Geba
- Shaharaim
- Shaharaim's wives, Hushim and Baara
- Shaharaim's wife, Hodesh
- Shaharaim's sons Jobab, Zibia, Mesha, Malcam, Jeuz, Sakia, and Mirmah, whom Shaharaim had with his wife, Hodesh
- Shaharaim's sons Abitub and Elpaal, whom Shaharaim had with his wife, Hushim
- Elpaal's sons, Eber, Misham, Shemed, Beriah, and Shema
- Families of people who lived in Aijalon
- People who lived in Gath
- And Beriah's sons, Ahio, Shashak, Jeremoth, Zebadiah, Arad, Eder, Michael, Ishpah, and Joha

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that this passage continues the introduction to the book of 1 Chronicles. Also, we already heard a passage earlier in the book of 1 Chronicles about the sons of Benjamin. This passage and the following two passages have more information about the sons, or descendants, of the tribe of Benjamin. Remember that it is not always clear how the people in this passage are related to one another.

In the first scene, Benjamin has five sons. Remember that Bela is Benjamin's firstborn son. Benjamin's other sons are Ashbel, Aharah, Nohah, and Rapha. The storyteller lists the sons in the order of their birth. In the original language, the storyteller says that "Benjamin caused to give birth to the sons." This means Benjamin is the father of the sons.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate Benjamin's five sons in this passage? Here are some translation options:

- Bela was Benjamin's first son. Ashbel was Benjamin's second son. Aharah was Benjamin's third son. Nohah was Benjamin's fourth son. And Rapha was Benjamin's fifth son; or
- Benjamin had five sons. In order of birth, Benjamin's sons were Bela, Ashbel, Aharah, Nohah, and Rapha.

Pause this audio here.

In the next part of the first scene, the storyteller tells us the sons of Bela. Sons can mean actual sons or descendants. It is possible that the people in this scene are not all the actual sons of Bela, so descendants may be a better way to translate "sons" here. Remember that Bela has two sons who are both named Gera. It might be helpful to say "another son named Gera" to show there are two different sons of Bela, both named Gera.

Remember that some people think that Bela only has one son, Addar, and that "Gera Abihud" means "Gera, the father of Ehud" in the original language. The storyteller in the book of Judges says that Gera the Benjamite was the father of Ehud the judge. However, it is probably best to translate this to show that Bela has nine sons.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this part about the sons of Bela? How many sons of Bela will you include in your translation? Will you choose to include two sons of Bela, both named Gera, or will you translate Gera as the father of Ehud? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Ehud has three sons. The sons of Ehud are leaders of their father's households, or families, and they move from Geba to Manahath. It is difficult to understand why the families moved to Manahath, and whether the families chose to leave or if someone else forced them to leave. Remember that Geba was a city of refuge in the land of the tribe of Benjamin. Manahath was a city 5 kilometers southwest of Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a map that includes the city of Geba and the city of Manahath again as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

Remember that it is also difficult to know who brought the families from Geba to Manahath. Remember that Gera, a son of Ehud, might have moved the families, or someone else might have moved the families. It is possible that in the original language, the word for "he took them into exile" actually is a name, "Heglam." Some people think that this helps the translation because it shows that this is a different Gera than Gera, the son of Ehud, from earlier in the passage. This Gera is named Gera, or Heglam.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this part of the passage about the sons of Ehud and who moved the families from Geba to Manahath? In some way, Gera forced the sons of Ehud to move. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Shaharaim has several sons. We are uncertain what a lot of things mean in this part of the passage. For example, it is not clear how Shaharaim is related to the other descendants of Benjamin in this passage. It is possible that Shaharaim's family is one of the families that moved from Geba to Manahath.

Remember that Shaharaim has three wives and many sons. Shaharaim has two sons with his wife Hushim. Later, Shaharaim divorces Hushim and Baara. In the original language, the storyteller says that Shaharaim "sends away" his two wives. In the law of Moses, this is how a person declared that he divorced his wife.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about someone you know who divorced their wife. How will you translate this part of the passage where Shaharaim divorces his two wives? Pause this audio here.

Shaharaim has seven more sons with his wife, Hodesh. Shaharaim moves to Moab. It is not clear if Shaharaim lives in Moab while he is married to his first two wives, or if Shaharaim divorces his first two wives before he marries his third wife, Hodesh.

Stop here and look at a map of the land of Moab again as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate the third scene? You could choose to include the information about Shaharaim's first wives and two sons with his wife Hushim, and then talk about his move to Moab, how he divorces two of his wives, and how he has two other sons with his third wife, Hodesh. Remember that it is not clear when Shaharaim moved to Moab, when Shaharaim got married to each wife, or when he divorced his first two wives. Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller lists the sons of Elpaal, who is the son of Shaharaim. Remember that Shemed is probably the one who builds the cities of Ono and Lod and their surrounding villages. In the original language, the passage says the villages around Lod are "the daughters of Lod." This is special language to show that the large, fortified city is like a mother, and the smaller villages are like daughters who rely on the bigger city for resources and protection. Lod was about 18 kilometers southeast of Joppa, and Ono was 11 kilometers southeast of Joppa. Ono and Lod are both between the Judean hill country to the east and the coastal plain to the west.

Stop here and look at a map that includes Ono and Lod. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the part that Shemed built Ono and Lod and the villages that surrounded those cities? Pause this audio here.

In the next part of the fourth scene, Beriah and Shema are leaders of families who lived in Aijalon, a city northwest of Jerusalem on the border of the land of Ephraim. It is unclear if Beriah and Shema are also sons of Elpaal, or if Beriah and Shema are not related at all to the previous people in this passage.

Remember that the leaders of the families in Aijalon chased out the people of Gath. Remember that it is not clear if only Beriah and Shema are the leaders of families in this part of the passage, or if the other three sons of Elpaal are also leaders of families in Aijalon. It is also not clear if the other sons of Elpaal also chased out the people of Gath. Aijalon was 20 kilometers northwest of Jerusalem on the border with the land of Ephraim. Aijalon was originally a part of the land of the tribe of Dan. Remember that Gath might be the Philistine city of Gath, or it might be a different city that people called Gittaim.

Stop here and look at a map that includes the cities of Aijalon and Gath again as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this part of the passage about Beriah and Shema? Will you say clearly that Beriah and Shema are also sons of Elpaal? How will you talk about who are the leaders of the families in Aijalon who chased out the people of Gath? Pause this audio here.

In the fifth scene, Beriah has many sons. Most people think that Beriah has nine sons, including Ahio, Shashak, and Jeremoth. However, some people think Beriah only has six sons, and that Ahio, Shashak, and Jeremoth are not sons of Beriah. In the original language, "Ahio" can mean "his brothers." This could change the translation

1 Chronicles 8:1–16

to mean "his brothers Shashak and Jeremoth," which would imply that Shashak and Jeremoth are brothers of Beriah and Shema, and sons of Elpaal.

In the final part of the scene, the storyteller lists the other six sons of Beriah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this part of the passage about Ahio, Shashak, and Jeremoth and the sons of Beriah? Here are some translation ideas:

- The sons of Beriah were Ahio, Shashak, Jeremoth, Zebadiah, Arad, Eder, Michael, Ishpah, and Joha; or
- Shashak and Jeremoth were brothers of Beriah and Shema. The sons of Beriah were Zebadiah, Arad, Eder, Michael, Ishpah, and Joha.

Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:1–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Benjamin
- Benjamin's firstborn son, Bela
- Benjamin's other sons, Ashbel, Aharah, Nohah, and Rapha
- Bela's sons, Addar, Gera, Abihud, Abishua, Naaman, Ahoah, Gera, Shephuphan, and Huram
- Ehud
- Ehud's sons, Naaman, Ahijah, and Gera
- Uzza and Ahihud
- Families of people who live in Geba
- Shaharaim
- Shaharaim's wives, Hushim and Baraa
- Shaharaim's wife, Hodesh
- Shaharaim's sons Jobab, Zibia, Mesha, Malcam, Jeuz, Sakia, and Mirmah, whom Shaharaim had with his wife, Hodesh
- Shaharaim's sons Abitub and Elpaal, whom Shaharaim had with his wife, Hushim
- Elpaal's sons, Eber, Misham, Shemed, Beriah, and Shema
- Families of people who lived in Aijalon
- People who lived in Gath
- And Beriah's sons, Ahio, Shashak, Jeremoth, Zebadiah, Arad, Eder, Michael, Ishpah, and Joha

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you act out the relationships in this passage between fathers, sons, and grandsons? Work together to find a way to show the relationships. Pause this audio here.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

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The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Benjamin has five sons. Benjamin's first son is Bela, his second son is Ashbel, his third son is Aharah, his fourth son is Nohah, and his fifth son is Rapha. Benjamin's son, Bela, has nine sons. Bela's sons are Addar, Gera, Abihud, Abishua, Naaman, Ahoah, Gera, Shephuphan, and Huram. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Benjamin, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am very happy to have so many sons and grandsons; or
- Yahweh blessed me when he gave me so many sons and grandsons; or
- I hope that my sons and grandsons also have many children.

Continue the drama. Ehud has three sons named Naaman, Ahijah, and Gera. These sons of Ehud are leaders of the families in the town of Geba. Later, someone forced the families to move from the town of Geba to the town of Manahath. Gera, the son of Ehud, led the families to Manahath. Gera had two sons named Uzza and Ahihud. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Naaman, Ahijah, and Gera, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are not happy that we had to leave Geba and move to Manahath; or
- We are glad that we could stay with our families, even though we had to leave our town of Geba and move to the town of Manahath; or
- We hope that we do not have to move again to another town.

Continue the drama. Shaharaim has two wives named Hushim and Baara. Shaharaim and Hushim have two sons together named Abitub and Elpaal. Shaharaim divorces his wives, Hushim and Baara. Shaharaim has more sons with a new wife, Hodesh, while Shaharaim lives in the land of Moab. The names of Shaharaim's sons with his wife Hodesh are Jobab, Zibia, Mesha, Malcam, Jeuz, Sakia, and Mirmah. Shaharaim's sons are all leaders of their families. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Shaharaim's wives, Hushim and Baara, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We do not understand why Shaharaim divorced us; or
- We hope that Shaharaim will still help us because now we have no one to take care of us; or
- We are jealous of Shaharaim's new wife, Hodesh, and Shaharaim's other seven sons with his new wife.

Continue the drama. Elpaal has five sons. The names of Elpaal's sons are Eber, Misham, Shemed, Beriah, and Shema. Shemed builds the cities of Lod and Ono, and the villages that surround those cities. The sons of Elpaal are all leaders of the families who live in Aijalon. The sons of Elpaal also chase out the people of Gath from the city of Gath. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elpaal, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am proud that I have five sons; or
- I am glad that even though my father, Shaharaim, divorced my mother, Hushim, I can still have a large and important family; or
- My sons did many good and important things. My son Shemed built up the cities of Lod and Ono, and the surrounding villages. My sons also chased out the people of Gath. I am proud of my sons.

Continue the drama. Beriah has nine sons. The names of Beriah's sons are Ahio, Shashak, Jeremoth, Zebadiah, Arad, Eder, Michael, Ishpah, and Joha. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Beriah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am very happy that I have nine sons; or
- I am proud that we chased out the people of Gath; or
- I am glad that I am a leader of my family.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:1–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

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Benjamin is the youngest son of the 12 sons of Israel. The 12 sons of Israel became the leaders of the 12 tribes of Israel, and each tribe had many descendants. Translate Benjamin the same as you have in previous passages.

The storyteller in this passage lists the **sons**, or descendants of Benjamin. Sometimes "son" can mean an actual son, and sometimes it can mean a descendant. Most of the time, "sons" in this passage means the male children of his parents. Translate son the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on son, refer to the Master Glossary.

The sons of Ehud were the leaders or chiefs of their fathers' families, or **households**. This means the sons of Ehud were leaders of the groups of their families. A household includes all the people who live in the house, and the head is the leader of the household. Other ways to translate this could be clan leaders, family leaders, heads of families, or leaders of the clans. Translate "heads or leaders of their father's households" in the same way you have in previous passages. For more information on household, refer to the Master Glossary.

Shaharaim had seven sons in **Moab** with his wife Hodesh. Moab is east of the Dead Sea. Translate Moab the same as you have in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a map of the land of Moab again as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

Shemed, one of the sons of Elpaal, built the **cities** of Ono and Lod. Shemed also built the **villages** around Ono and Lod. Villages are smaller than cities and do not have walls around them like cities. Translate city and village the same as you have in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 8:1–16

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (999 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (11.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (6.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.0 MB)

- Speaking the Word (1.4 MB)

1 Chronicles 8:17–28

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 8:17–28 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:17–28 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:17–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This passage is a part of the introduction to the book of 1 Chronicles. Remember that the previous passage was the first part of a three-part passage about the descendants of the tribe of Benjamin. Now, in this passage, we learn the names of the family leaders of the tribe of Benjamin who lived in Jerusalem. We learn the names of the sons of Elpaal, the sons of Shimei, the sons of Shashak, and the sons of Jeroham.

This passage does not include a lot of details about these descendants of Benjamin. We know these descendants were family leaders and that they all lived in Jerusalem. These leaders' families also probably lived in Jerusalem with them.

Remember that the previous passage and this current passage do not have a complete list of all the descendants of Benjamin. Also, it is not always clear if the people in this passage are the same people who are in previous passages, even if they share the same name as a person in a previous passage.

In each part of this passage, the storyteller lists the sons of an important leader in the tribe of Benjamin. In the first part of the passage, the storyteller says that Elpaal's sons are Zebadiah, Meshullam, Hizki, Heber, Ishmerai, Izliah, and Jobab. In the original language, we hear the names of the sons first, and then the name of their father, Elpaal.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell the names of the sons of a man you know. Pay attention to see if you say the names of the sons first, or if you say the father's name first. Pause this audio here.

It is not clear if this Elpaal is the same Elpaal that we heard about in the previous passage. Elpaal in the previous passage was the son of Shaharaim and his wife, Hushim. If this is the same Elpaal, then now we hear the names of seven more sons of the same person.

In the next part, the storyteller lists the sons of Shimei. Shimei has nine sons named Jakim, Zicri, Zabdi, Elienai, Zillethai, Eliel, Adaiah, Beraiah, and Shimrath. Shimei is likely the same person as Shema in the previous passage. Shema was the son of Elpaal from the previous passage. Also, Elienai is another way to say the name Elioenai.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about people in your community who have the same name or a similar name. Why do people have the same names or similar names? Is it common for a family to use the same name again in the same family for another descendant? Who decides how to spell or say a person's name? Pause this audio here.

Next, the storyteller lists the 11 sons of Shashak. Remember that we heard about Shashak in a previous passage. Some people think that Shashak is a son of Beriah, who is a son of Elpaal. Others think that Shashak is a son of

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Elpaal. The 11 sons of Shashak are Ishpan, Eber, Eliel, Abdon, Zicri, Hanan, Hananiah, Elam, Anthothijah, Iphdeiah, and Penuel.

Jeroham has six sons. Jeroham's six sons are Shamsherai, Sheharіah, Athaliah, Jaareshiah, Elijah, and Zicri. Jeroham is most likely a different way to write the name Jeremoth. Remember that Jeremoth is a son of Beriah from the previous passage.

In the final part of this passage, the storyteller says that the people in this passage were the leaders of the families. This probably means these men led entire clans, or family groups.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about the leaders of your families, family groups, and clans. Who is your leader? How did that person become your leader? Pause this audio here.

These people were also leaders according to their genealogy, or the lists of their ancestors. During this time, people wrote down the names of their ancestors so they could remember the names.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you remember the names of your ancestors? Pause this audio here.

Finally, the passage says that these people lived in Jerusalem. This most likely means that all of the people in this passage lived in Jerusalem, including all the leaders, their sons, and all of their families. Jerusalem was the capital city of Israel. Some people think this means that other descendants of Benjamin also lived in Jerusalem, including descendants of Benjamin from the previous passage.

Stop here and look at a map that includes all of Israel and the city of Jerusalem as a group.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:17–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: Elpaal has seven sons.

In the second scene: Shimei has nine sons.

In the third scene: Shashak has 11 sons.

In the fourth scene: Jeroham has six sons.

In the fifth scene: These are all the family leaders in the records of their ancestors. All these people lived in Jerusalem.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elpaal and his seven sons, Zebadiah, Meshullam, Hizki, Heber, Ishmerai, Izliah, and Jobab
- Shimei and his nine sons, Jakim, Zicri, Zabdi, Elienai, Zillethai, Eliel, Adaiah, Beraiah, and Shimrath
- Shashak and his 11 sons, Ishpan, Eber, Eliel, Abdon, Zicri, Hanan, Hananiah, Elam, Anthothijah, Iphdeiah, and Penuel
- And Jeroham and his six sons, Shamsherai, Sheharіah, Athaliah, Jaareshiah, Elijah, and Zicri

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that this passage is the second part of a three-part passage about the descendants of the tribe of Benjamin. Remember also that the previous passage ended with information about the sons of Elpaal and the sons of Beriah.

As the first scene begins, we learn about more sons of Elpaal. Remember, this might be the same Elpaal that was in the previous passage, or it might be a different person with the same name, Elpaal.

We hear a list of names at the beginning of each of the four scenes. Then at the end of each scene, the storyteller says that these people were the sons of Elpaal, the sons of Shimei, the sons of Shashak, or the sons of Jeroham. It might be easier to understand in your language if you put the name of the father at the beginning of each scene instead. For example, in the first scene, you could translate it two different ways:

- Elpaal had seven sons named Zebadiah, Meshullam, Hizki, Heber, Ishmerai, Izliah, and Jobab; or
- Zebadiah, Meshullam, Hizki, Heber, Ishmerai, Izliah, and Jobab were the sons of Elpaal.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember the discussion from the previous step about how you say the names of a father and his sons. How will you translate the first scene about the sons of Elpaal? Is it more natural in your language to say first, “Elpaal had seven sons,” or to say the names of the seven sons first? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Shimei has nine sons. Remember that it is possible that Shimei is the same person as Shema in the previous passage.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this scene about the sons of Shimei? Decide as a group if you want to say the names of the sons of Shimei first, or if you want to say first, “Shimei had nine sons,” and then give the names of the nine sons. Be sure to do this in the same way that you chose to do it in the previous discussion about the sons of Elpaal. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Shashak has 11 sons. Remember that Shashak was in a previous passage. Some people think that Shashak was the son of Beriah, who was the son of Elpaal. Other people think that Shashak was a son of Elpaal. Again, your translation team should choose to translate this scene in the same way that you translated the first two scenes. You can choose to first say “Shashak had 11 sons,” and then name the 11 sons, or you can say the names of the sons and then say, “These were Shashak’s sons.”

In the fourth scene, Jeroham has six sons. Jeroham is most likely the same person as Jeremoth from a previous passage. Jeremoth is the son of Beriah. Again, be sure to translate this scene in the same way that you translated the first three scenes.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Would it be helpful to include that Jeroham is the same person as Jeremoth, and that Jeremoth is the son of Beriah? Pause this audio here.

In the final scene, we hear a summary of this passage. Most people think this summary is only about the people in this current passage, but other people think that this summary includes some of the descendants of Benjamin from the previous passage.

This summary has three important parts. First, the summary says that these people were the leaders of their families. In the original language, it says they were heads of fathers’ houses. This means these men were leaders of their families or clans. This means these men were leaders of more than just their family, who lived in the same house. Instead, these men led entire clans, or family groups.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember how you have translated “leader of families” in previous passages. Think about how “leaders of families” compares with similar groups in your culture. Pause this audio here.

Second, the summary says that the people were leaders according to the lists of their ancestors. The lists of ancestors were the lists of the people in the tribe of Benjamin. Sometimes people call a list of ancestors a genealogy or a record of the ancestors. In the original language, it says “according to their generations.” Generations are the fathers and ancestors of the people in this passage. Remember how you have translated “according to the lists of their ancestors” in previous passages.

Finally, these leaders lived in Jerusalem. Remember that this most likely means the leaders and all of their families and family groups also lived in Jerusalem. Remember, some people think that other descendants of Benjamin from the previous passage also lived in Jerusalem, but it is not clear. Even if some of the descendants of Benjamin from the previous passage did live in Jerusalem, some of these descendants of Benjamin did not live in Jerusalem. Remember that in a previous passage, some of the descendants of Benjamin lived in other places like Geba, Aijalon, Ono, and Lod.

Stop here and look at a map of Jerusalem again as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:17–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Elpaal and his seven sons, Zebadiah, Meshullam, Hizki, Heber, Ishmerai, Izliah, and Jobab
- Shimei and his nine sons, Jakim, Zicri, Zabdi, Elienai, Zillethai, Eliel, Adaiah, Beraiah, and Shimrath
- Shashak and his 11 sons, Ishpan, Eber, Eliel, Abdon, Zicri, Hanan, Hananiah, Elam, Anthothijah, Iphdeiah, and Penuel
- And Jeroham and his six sons, Shamsherai, Sheharіah, Athaliah, Jaareshiah, Elijah, and Zicri

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Elpaal has seven sons named Zebadiah, Meshullam, Hizki, Heber, Ishmerai, Izliah, and Jobab. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elpaal, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that I have seven sons; or
- I am proud of all of my sons.

Continue the drama. Shimei has nine sons named Jakim, Zikri, Zabdi, Elienai, Zillethai, Eliel, Adaiah, Beraiah, and Shimrath. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Shimei, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am proud of my large family; or
- I am glad that I am the son of Elpaal, who was the son of Shaharaim and his wife Hushim; or
- I am glad that I am a leader in the tribe of Benjamin.

Continue the drama. Shashak has 11 sons named Ishpan, Eber, Eliel, Abdon, Zicri, Hanan, Hananiah, Elam, Anthothijah, Iphdeiah, and Penuel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Shashak, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that I have more sons than any of the other people in the tribe of Benjamin; or
- I am proud that I have 11 sons; or
- I am honored that I am a leader in the tribe of Benjamin.

Continue the drama. Jeroham has six sons named Shamsherai, Sheharіah, Athaliah, Jaareshiah, Elijah, and Zicri. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeroham, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that I have six sons; or
- I am proud to be a leader in the tribe of Benjamin; or
- I am glad that my father was Beriah.

Continue the drama. These people were all leaders of their families, according to the lists of their ancestors. These leaders and their families all lived in Jerusalem. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Elpaal, Shimei, Shashak, and Jeroham, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are honored that we are leaders of the clans and families in the tribe of Benjamin; or
- We are happy that we can live in Jerusalem, the capital city of Israel; or
- We are proud of our role as leaders of the tribe of Benjamin in the people of Israel.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:17–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, we see the **sons** of some important leaders of the tribe of Benjamin. Sons can sometimes mean descendants, but in this passage they probably mean the male child of their parents. Translate sons as you have in previous passages. See sons in the Master Glossary.

All of these people were the leaders or chiefs of their fathers' families, or **households**. This means these people were leaders of the groups of their families. A household includes all the people who live in the house, and the head is the leader of the household. In this case, these men were leaders of large groups of families, not just those people who lived in their house. Other ways to translate this could be clan leaders, family leaders, heads of families, or leaders of the clans. Translate heads of families in the same way as you have in previous passages. For more information on household, refer to the Master Glossary.

These men were leaders according to their generations. This means these leaders are in the list of names that belong to the same ancestor. We call a list of generations a genealogy.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate "leaders according to their **generations**?" You can just say that the **genealogy** of their tribe listed these men as leaders of their father's households. Use the same word for leaders, or chiefs, as you have used previously. For more information, refer to genealogy and generation in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

These leaders all lived in **Jerusalem**. Jerusalem is the most important city of the Jewish people. Translate Jerusalem the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on Jerusalem, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (965 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 8:29–40

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 8:29–40 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:29–40 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:29–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This passage is a part of the introduction to the book of 1 Chronicles. Remember that the previous passages were the first two parts of a three-part story about descendants in the tribe of Benjamin. The storyteller in the previous passage listed all the leaders of the families who lived in Jerusalem. Now, in this passage, we learn about some other descendants of the tribe of Benjamin. These descendants of Benjamin all lived in Gibeon and Jerusalem. This passage also includes the ancestors and descendants of Saul, the first king of Israel.

In this passage, the storyteller lists 15 generations of the genealogy of Saul. This passage is very similar to another passage later in 1 Chronicles that also describes the genealogy of Saul. Some of the names in this passage are spelled differently than in other passages of the Old Testament, even though it is the same person here and in the other passages. The current passage also includes names that we do not find in any other passages of the Old Testament.

The storyteller begins with Jeiel, the father of the city of Gibeon. Some translations do not have the name Jeiel. Instead, these translations say “the father of Gibeon” but do not say the person’s name. We know from a later passage in 1 Chronicles that Jeiel was the father of Gibeon. Gibeon is the name of a city, and not the name of a person. “Father of Gibeon” probably means that this person started the city of Gibeon, or that this person was the leader of Gibeon. Remember that Gibeon was an important city in the land of the tribe of Benjamin.

Stop here and look at a map that includes the city of Gibeon as a group. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about someone in your community who started a town, village, or city. Describe how this person started the town, village, or city. Pause this audio here.

Jeiel lives in the city of Gibeon, and Jeiel's wife's name is Maacah. This passage says that Jeiel has eight sons, but we know from other passages that Jeiel has 10 sons, and the storyteller does not list two of the sons in this passage. Jeiel's firstborn or eldest son is Abdon. The other sons in this passage are Zur, Kish, Baal, Nadab, Gedor, Ahio, and Zeker. From the later passage in 1 Chronicles, we know that Ner is also a son of Jeiel. Some translations include Ner in this current passage.

Jeiel's son Zeker is called Zechariah in the passage later in 1 Chronicles. Also, this current passage says that Mikloth is the father of Shimeah, and it is not clear here that Mikloth is also a son of Jeiel. However, the later passage in 1 Chronicles does include Mikloth as the 10th son of Jeiel. Shimeah is also called Shimeam in the later passage in 1 Chronicles.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Ask each person on your team the different ways they might say their names. Pause this audio here.

The next part of the passage is difficult to understand. It is difficult to know who lived near their relatives in Jerusalem, and who these relatives were. Some people think that these words in the passage mean that some of the people of the tribe of Benjamin moved from Gibeon to Jerusalem. Others think that this passage says that Jeiel and his wife lived in Gibeon, and all of Jeiel's sons lived in Jerusalem. Finally, other people think that maybe only Mikloth and Shimeah lived in Jerusalem. If it is Mikloth and Shimeah who live in Jerusalem, that means that, unlike their brothers, Mikloth and Shimeah lived in Jerusalem with other people from the tribe of Benjamin, and not with their own brothers. Remember that the other sons of Jeiel probably lived in Gibeon.

Stop here and look at a map of Jerusalem as a group. Pause this audio here.

Most of the rest of this passage is about the descendants of Ner, one of the 10 sons of Jeiel. The storyteller does not talk about any descendants from the other sons of Jeiel, besides Mikloth's son, Shimeah.

Ner is the father of Kish, and Kish is the father of Saul, the first king of Israel. It is surprising that the storyteller says Ner is the father of Kish, because in another part of the Old Testament, the storyteller says that Abiel is the father of Kish. Some translations include here that Saul was the king.

Saul has four sons: Jonathan, Malki-Shua, Abinadab, and Esh-Baal. In another part of the Old Testament, the storyteller says Saul only has three sons: Jonathan, Malki-Shua, and Esh-Baal. This passage is difficult to understand because we learn here that Saul has four sons and many descendants, but in the passage later in 1 Chronicles, we learn that all of Saul's family died with Saul. It is possible that not all of Saul's family died with Saul, because here we see that Saul had many descendants.

In other parts of the Old Testament, sometimes Saul's son Esh-Baal has the name Ish-Bosheth, and sometimes Jonathan's son Merib-Baal has the name Mephibosheth. It is possible that people in Israel changed these names because it was shameful to have a son with the same name as the Canaanite god, Baal. The new names end with Bosheth, which means "shame" in the original language.

Jonathan's son Merib-Baal is the father of Micah. Micah has four sons, Pithon, Melech, Tarea, and Ahaz. Micah's son Ahaz is the father of Jehoaddah. Again, Jehoaddah is called Jadah in the later passage in 1 Chronicles. Jehoaddah and Jadah are the same person.

Jehoaddah has three sons named Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri. Zimri is the father of Moza, and Moza is the father of Binea. Most people think that the correct translation of the next part of this passage is that Binea is the father of Raphah, Raphah is the father of Eleasah, and Eleasah is the father of Azel. But some people think that Binea, Raphah, Eleasah, and Azel are all sons of Moza because it says, "Raphah his son," and this could mean Moza is the father of Raphah.

Azel has six sons named Azrikam, Bokeru, Ishmael, Sheariah, Obadiah, and Hanan. "Bokeru" is very similar to the word for "firstborn" in the original language, so some people think this means that Azrikam is Azel's firstborn son. If a translation says "Azrikam the firstborn," then there is one son's name missing from the six sons of Azel in this passage.

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Eshek has three sons named Ulam, Jeush, and Eliphelet. It is most likely that Eshek is the brother of Azel here. However, it is also possible that Eshek is not the brother of Azel. Eshek might be another descendant of Benjamin who is related to Benjamin in a different way.

The first son of Eshek is Ulam. The second and third sons of Eshek are Jeush and Eliphelet. Ulam's sons were brave warriors who could handle the bow. A bow is a weapon that warriors use to shoot arrows at their enemies.

Stop here and look at a picture of a bow and arrows as a group. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about the brave warriors and mighty men in your community. Pause this audio here.

The sons of Ulam had 150 sons and grandsons. This part of the passage might be from a list of military men who fought for the tribe of Benjamin.

In the final part of this passage, the storyteller says that all these were the descendants of Benjamin. It is most likely that this is a final summary of the entire three-part story about the descendants of the tribe of Benjamin.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:29–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has six scenes.

In the first scene: Jeiel has 10 sons. One of Jeiel's sons is Ner. These people all live near their relatives in Jerusalem.

In the second scene: Saul's grandfather is Ner, and Saul's father is Kish. Saul has four sons.

In the third scene: Saul's son Jonathan has a son named Merib-Baal. Merib-Baal's son is Micah, and Micah has four sons. One of Micah's sons is Ahaz.

In the fourth scene: Ahaz's son is Jehoaddah. Jehoaddah has three sons, including one son named Zimri. Zimri is the father of Moza. Moza is the father of Binea, Binea is the father of Raphah, Raphah is the father of Eleasah, Eleasah is the father of Azel.

In the fifth scene: Azel has six sons. Eshek has three sons. One of Eshek's sons is Ulam. The sons of Ulam were brave warriors who used the bow.

In the sixth scene: All of these were descendants of the tribe of Benjamin.

The characters in this passage are:

- Jeiel
- Jeiel's wife, Maacah
- Jeiel's 10 sons, Abdon, Zur, Kish, Baal, Ner, Nadab, Gedor, Ahio, Zeker, and Mikloth
- Shimeah, the son of Mikloth
- Kish, the son of Ner
- Saul, the son of Kish
- Saul's four sons, Jonathan, Malki-Shua, Abinadab, and Esh-Baal
- Merib-Baal, the son of Jonathan
- Micah, the son of Merib-Baal
- Micah's four sons, Pithon, Melech, Tarea, and Ahaz
- Jehoaddah, the son of Ahaz
- Jehoaddah's three sons, Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri
- Moza, the son of Zimri
- Binea, the son of Moza
- Raphah, the son of Binea

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- Eleasah, the son of Raphah
- Azel, the son of Eleasah
- Azel's six sons, Azrikam, Bokeru, Ishmael, Shearіah, Obadiah, and Hanan
- Eshek, the brother of Azel
- Eshek's three sons, Ulam, Jeush, and Eliphelet
- And 150 sons and grandsons of Ulam

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that this is the third and final passage in a three-part story about the descendants of the tribe of Benjamin. In this passage, we see descendants of Benjamin who lived in Gibeon and Jerusalem. Gibeon and Jerusalem are both important cities for the genealogy or family history of Saul, the first king of Israel.

In the first scene, Jeiel is the father of Gibeon, and Jeiel lives in the city of Gibeon. Remember that some translations do not have the name Jeiel. Instead, those translations say "the father of Gibeon." Remember that Gibeon is a city, and not a person. Also, remember that "father of Gibeon" probably means that Jeiel started the city of Gibeon. Gibeon is a city about 10 kilometers northwest of Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a map of the city of Gibeon again as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the first part of this passage? Some examples include:

- Jeiel was the founder of the city of Gibeon. Jeiel also lived in the city of Gibeon; or
- The person who started the city of Gibeon also lived in the city of Gibeon.

Pause this audio here.

Jeiel also has a wife. Jeiel's wife's name is Maacah. It is likely that Maacah also lives in the city of Gibeon with her husband, Jeiel. Your team may choose to translate this part of the passage to say that Jeiel and his wife lived in Gibeon.

In the next part of this scene, the storyteller lists the names of Jeiel's sons. The firstborn son of Jeiel is Abdon. Remember that in this current passage, there are only eight names of Jeiel's sons. These eight sons are: Zur, Kish, Baal, Nadab, Gedor, Ahio, and Zeker. However, we know from the later passage in 1 Chronicles that Jeiel has two other sons named Ner and Mikloth. Some translations choose to include the names Ner and Mikloth in this current passage. Your team can decide if you want to include Ner after Baal and before Nadab, and if you want to include Mikloth as the final son of Jeiel. Ner is in the next scene of the passage, so it might be helpful to include Ner here as well so that people remember that Ner is one of the sons of Jeiel. Mikloth is the father of Shimeah in this passage, but it is not clear here that Mikloth is a son of Jeiel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How many sons of Jeiel will you include in this passage? Will you include Ner and Mikloth as sons of Jeiel in this passage? Pause this audio here.

Also, in the later passage in 1 Chronicles, Zeker is called Zechariah and Shimeah is called Shimeam. Zeker is the same person as Zechariah, and Shimeah is the same person as Shimeam. It is a different way to say the same name. It would be best to say these names the same in both places of 1 Chronicles.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you say the names Zecher and Shimeah in this passage? Pause this audio here.

In the final part of this scene, we learn that "they lived near their relatives in Jerusalem." Remember that it is hard to know who lived near their relatives in Jerusalem, and who the relatives were. In the original language it says they lived both "with their relatives" and "opposite their relatives." Many people think "with their relatives" and "opposite their relatives" are two ways to describe the same idea. The word "opposite" can also mean "unlike." Here are some translations you can choose for this part of this passage:

- Some of the people of the tribe of Benjamin moved from Gibeon to Jerusalem. These people who moved to Jerusalem lived near, or alongside, their relatives; or
- Jeiel and his family lived in Gibeon, and all of Jeiel's sons lived in Jerusalem near their other relatives; or

- Unlike their brothers, Mikloth and his son Shimeah lived in Jerusalem. The rest of the sons of Jeiel lived in Gibeon. Mikloth and Shimeah lived alongside other people from the tribe of Benjamin.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the final part of this scene about people who lived near their relatives in Jerusalem? Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and look at a map of Jerusalem again as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Ner is the father of Kish. Kish is the father of Saul, the first king of Israel. This part about Saul and his ancestors and descendants is probably the most important part of this passage. Remember that Ner is one of Jeiel's sons. Some translations choose to say that Saul is the son of Kish and the grandson of Ner so that the focus is on Saul. Most people that heard 1 Chronicles when it was written already knew that Saul was the first king of Israel, but it might be helpful to add "King" Saul here to remind listeners that Saul was the first king of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will your translation team talk about Saul in this passage? Some translations include:

- King Saul was the son of Kish, and the grandson of Ner; or
- Ner was the father of Kish. Kish was the father of King Saul; or
- Ner was Kish's father, and Kish was Saul's father.

Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Saul has four sons. Saul's sons are Jonathan, Malki-Shua, Abinadab, and Esh-Baal. Remember that in the later passage in 1 Chronicles, Saul has only three sons. Also, Esh-Baal is the same person as Ish-Bosheth from another part of the Old Testament. In the original language, "bosheth" means shame, and people who wrote 1 Chronicles probably changed the name from Baal to Bosheth because Baal was a Canaanite god.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the name Esh-Baal in this passage? You can choose to translate it as Ish-Bosheth instead, you could choose to include both names as ways to say this son's name, or you could choose to explain what the name means. Pause this audio here.

Saul's son Jonathan has a son named Merib-Baal. Merib-Baal is the same person as Mephibosheth. In other parts of the Old Testament, people call Jonathan's son Mephibosheth.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Will you translate Jonathan's son's name as Merib-Baal here, or as Mephibosheth? Pause this audio here.

Merib-Baal has a son named Micah. Micah has four sons named Pithon, Melech, Tarea, and Ahaz. In the later passage of 1 Chronicles, Tarea is called Tahrea. Your team should decide how you want to say Tarea's name. It would be best to say the name the same way in both places in 1 Chronicles.

In the fourth scene, we learn about the descendants of Ahaz, who is the son of Micah. Ahaz is the father of Jehoaddah. In the later passage of 1 Chronicles, Jehoaddah is called Jadah. Your team should decide how you want to say Jehoaddah's name. It would be best to say the name the same way in both places in 1 Chronicles.

Jehoaddah has three sons. These sons' names are Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri. Zimri has a son named Moza. Moza has a son named Binea. Binea is the father of Raphah, Raphah is the father of Eleasah, and Eleasah is the father of Azel. In the later passage of 1 Chronicles, Raphah is called Rephaiah. Your team should decide how you want to say Raphah's name. It would be best to say the name the same way in both places in 1 Chronicles.

In the fifth scene, Azel has six sons named Azrikam, Bokeru, Ishmael, Sheariah, Obadiah, and Hanan. Remember that the word "Bokeru" in the original language normally means "firstborn" instead of the name of a person. It is possible that some people made Bokeru a name so that there would be six sons of Azel. The storyteller repeats again that all of these were the sons of Azel. Your translation team can decide if you want to repeat this again or not.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will your translation team translate the names of Azel's sons? Will you repeat that "all of these were the sons of Azel?" Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 8:29–40

Azel has a brother named Eshek. Translations say “his brother” and not “Azel’s brother,” so some people think that Eshek is not the brother of Azel, but someone else’s brother. Eshek has three sons named Ulam, Jeush, and Eliphelet. Ulam is the first son, Jeush is the second son, and Eliphelet is the third son.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Ask someone from your translation team to tell you about their sons in the order that the sons were born. Pay attention to how you talk about the order of sons in your language. How will you translate the three sons of Azel in this passage? Pause this audio here.

Ulam’s sons were brave warriors who could handle the bow, or who knew how to shoot arrows from a bow with great skill. Remember a bow is a weapon that people used to shoot arrows at their enemies. Some translations say that the sons of Ulam were brave warriors or mighty bowmen. The sons of Ulam had 150 sons and grandsons.

Stop here and look at a picture of a bow and arrows as a group. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember the discussion from the previous script about brave warriors and mighty men in your community. How will you translate this part of the passage about Ulam’s sons who were mighty bowmen? Pause this audio here.

In the final scene, we hear a summary for the entire three-part passage about the descendants of the tribe of Benjamin. All of these people were descendants of Benjamin.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:29–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has six scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Jeiel
- Jeiel’s wife, Maacah
- Jeiel’s 10 sons, Abdon, Zur, Kish, Baal, Ner, Nadab, Gedor, Ahio, Zeker, and Mikloth
- Shimeah, the son of Mikloth
- Kish, the son of Ner
- Saul, the son of Kish
- Saul’s four sons, Jonathan, Malki-Shua, Abinadab, and Esh-Baal
- Merib-Baal, the son of Jonathan
- Micah, the son of Merib-Baal
- Micah’s four sons, Pithon, Melech, Tarea, and Ahaz
- Jehoaddah, the son of Ahaz
- Jehoaddah’s three sons, Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri
- Moza, the son of Zimri
- Binea, the son of Moza
- Raphah, the son of Binea
- Eleasah, the son of Raphah
- Azel, the son of Eleasah
- Azel’s six sons, Azrikam, Bokeru, Ishmael, Sheariah, Obadiah, and Hanan
- Eshek, the brother of Azel
- Eshek’s three sons, Ulam, Jeush, and Eliphelet
- And 150 sons and grandsons of Ulam

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Jeiel started the city of Gibeon. Jeiel lived in Gibeon, and Jeiel's wife was named Maacah. Jeiel's firstborn son was Abdon. Jeiel's other sons were Zur, Kish, Baal, Ner, Nadab, Gedor, Ahio, Zeker, and Mikloth. Mikloth was the father of Shimeah. Unlike their brothers, Mikloth and Shimeah lived in Jerusalem near their other relatives. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeiel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that I have so many sons. Yahweh blessed me with these children; or
- I worked hard to start the city of Gibeon, and I am proud of the city that I built; or
- I am glad that Gibeon is such an important city in Israel.

Continue the drama. Ner was the father of Kish. Kish was the father of King Saul. Saul was the father of Jonathan, Malki-Shua, Abinadab, and Esh-Baal. Jonathan was the father of Merib-Baal, and Merib-Baal was the father of Micah. Micah was the father of Pithon, Melech, Tarea, and Ahaz. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Saul, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am proud to be the first king of Israel; or
- I named my youngest son Esh-Baal because my wife likes the Canaanite god, Baal; or
- I am proud of my oldest son, Jonathan.

Continue the drama. Ahaz was the father of Jehoaddah, and Jehoaddah was the father of Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri. Zimri has a son named Moza. Moza has a son named Binea. Binea is the father of Raphah, Raphah is the father of Eleasah, and Eleasah is the father of Azel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ahaz, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that I am a descendant of Benjamin; or
- I am also glad that I am a descendant of Saul, the first king of Israel; or
- I am proud that I have so many descendants.

Continue the drama. Azel had six sons. Azrikam was Azel's firstborn son. Azel's other sons were Bokeru, Ishmael, Shearіah, Obadiah, and Hanan. These were all the sons of Azel. Azel's brother, Eshek, had three sons. Eshek's first son was Ulam, his second son was Jeush, and his third son was Eliphelet. The sons of Ulam were mighty warriors who were good at using a bow. The sons of Ulam had 150 sons and grandsons. All of these were the descendants of Benjamin. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the sons and grandsons of Ulam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are proud to be mighty warriors to protect our people; or
- We work hard to be excellent at shooting a bow; or
- We are proud that we are descendants of Saul, the first king of Israel.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 8:29–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Jeiel founded, or started, the city of Gibeon. Gibeon was one of the cities where Levites could live in the land of the tribe of Benjamin.

One of Jeiel's 10 sons was Mikloth. Mikloth and his son, Shimeah, lived near their other relatives or family members in **Jerusalem**. Use the same word for relatives and for Jerusalem as you used in previous passages. For more information on Jerusalem, refer to the Master Glossary.

Saul was the son of Kish and the grandson of Ner. Ner was one of Jeiel's sons. Saul was the first king of Israel. Use the same word for Saul as you used in previous passages.

All of these people were descendants of **Benjamin**. The tribe of Benjamin was one of the 12 tribes of Israel. Use the same word or phrase for Benjamin as you used in previous passages.

The sons of Ulam were good at shooting arrows with their **bows**. Use the same words and phrases for bows and arrows as you used in previous passages.

In this passage, "**sons**" means descendants. Use the same word for son as you have in previous passages. For more information on sons, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 8:29–40

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (898 KB)
- Setting the Stage (7.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (12.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Chronicles 9:1–9

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 9:1–9 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:1–9 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 9:1–9

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller finished a three-part story about descendants in the tribe of Benjamin. The final part of the three-part story included descendants of Benjamin who lived in Gibeon and Jerusalem. The storyteller also included descendants of Saul, the first king of Israel. Now, the storyteller starts to list the Israelites who returned to live in Jerusalem after their time of captivity, or exile, in Babylon. People from the tribes of Judah, Benjamin, Ephraim, and Manasseh, as well as priests, Levites, and temple servants, all returned to Jerusalem. In this passage, the storyteller lists the leaders of the families from the tribes of Judah and Benjamin who return to Jerusalem. This passage is the first part of a four-part story about the first Israelites who return to Jerusalem.

Some translations include the first part of this passage with the previous passage because the two together form a summary of the genealogies, or family records, for all of the previous passages in the book of 1 Chronicles. The storyteller says that people listed or wrote down the history of the kings of Israel in a book. Those people also wrote down the official family records of all of the Israelites in the same book of the kings of Israel. When the storyteller talks about the official family records of "all of Israel," he is including both the northern and southern kingdoms of Israel. The storyteller might say "all Israel" because the storyteller hoped that Israel would be a united kingdom someday.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does your family remember the history of your family? Pause this audio here.

In the next part of the passage, the storyteller talks about the time when the Babylonians captured the people of Judah and forced them to go to Babylon. Babylon was the capital city of the country of Babylonia, and the Babylonians were enemies of the Israelites. The people of Judah are the people in the southern kingdom of Israel that included the tribes of Judah and Benjamin. Yahweh allowed the Babylonians to capture the people of Judah because the people of Judah were unfaithful to Yahweh. To be unfaithful means to rebel or sin against Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss a time when your people group or another people group had to leave your home. Why did you leave? How did you come back home if you were ever able to return home? Pause this audio here.

The exiled Israelites were in captivity for 70 years. Now, the first exiled Israelites come back from Babylon to their villages in Israel again. The Israelite exiles live on the land that their ancestors owned in the past. The storyteller says that some Israelites, as well as some religious people, come back to Jerusalem. These religious people include priests, Levites, and temple servants. Priests, Levites, and temple servants were all people who worked in the temple of Yahweh. In the following passages, the storyteller will list the names of the priests, Levites, and temple servants who returned to Jerusalem.

The rest of this passage is about the other Israelites who come back to Jerusalem from their captivity in Babylon. These Israelites are not Levites, and they do not work in the temple of Yahweh. This passage is only about people who return to live in Jerusalem, and it is not about people who return to live outside of Jerusalem. This passage is similar to a list of names in the book of Nehemiah. Nehemiah also lists the people who return to Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a map of Jerusalem, Babylon, Israel, and Judah as a group. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that some people from the tribes of Judah, Benjamin, Ephraim, and Manasseh return to live in Jerusalem. We know from the book of Nehemiah that only about one family out of every 10 families goes back

to live in Jerusalem. The tribes of Judah and Benjamin formed the southern kingdom of Judah, and the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh were the two most important tribes in the northern kingdom of Israel.

In the rest of these lists about people who come back to Jerusalem after the exile to Babylon, we see no more information about families from the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh. This might be because these lists only include the leaders of larger families who returned to Jerusalem. It is likely that only single families and individuals from the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh returned to Jerusalem, and not any leaders of large families from the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh. For the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh, Jerusalem was not the home of their ancestors, and that might be why not a lot of families from the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh come back to Jerusalem.

The storyteller lists people from the tribe of Judah who return to Jerusalem. You will remember that Judah had three sons named Perez, Shelah, and Zerah. First, the storyteller talks about descendants of Perez, the son of Judah. Uthai is probably the leader of this group of people because the storyteller says Uthai's name first. Uthai is the son of Ammihud. Ammihud is the son of Omri. Omri is the son of Imri. Imri is the son of Bani. Bani is a son, or descendant, of Perez. These people are all descendants of Judah's son Perez.

Next, the storyteller talks about the descendants of Shelah, the son of Judah. Most people think that the Shilonites are the same as the Shelanites, or the descendants of Shelah. Asaiah is the firstborn, or eldest, son of Shelah. Asaiah is probably the leader of the Shilonites.

Finally, the storyteller lists the sons, or descendants, of Zerah, another son of Judah. Jeuel is probably the leader of the Zerahites. The total number of people from the tribe of Judah who move back to Jerusalem is 690. This is not the total number of families from the tribe of Judah who move back to Jerusalem from Babylon. This number is different from the number in the lists in Nehemiah, probably because Nehemiah did not count people at the same time as the storyteller here in 1 Chronicles counts people.

In the final part of this passage, the storyteller lists people from the tribe of Benjamin who return to Jerusalem. Remember that not all of the people of the tribe of Benjamin return to Jerusalem. The storyteller gives the names of four leaders of families in the tribe of Benjamin who return to Jerusalem. These four leaders of families are Sallu, Ibneiah, Elah, and Meshullam.

The storyteller lists some of the ancestors of these four important leaders of the tribe of Benjamin who return to Jerusalem. Sallu is the son of Meshullam. Meshullam is the son of Hodaviah. Hodaviah is the son of Hassenuah. Ibneiah is the son of Jeroham. Elah is the son of Uzzi. Uzzi is the son of Micri. Meshullam is the son of Shephatiah. Shephatiah is the son of Reuel. Reuel is the son of Ibnijah.

This list of descendants of the tribe of Benjamin who return to Jerusalem is similar to the list in the book of Nehemiah. Sallu and Ibneiah are both in the list in the book of Nehemiah, but Elah and Meshullam are not in the list in the book of Nehemiah.

The total number of people from the tribe of Benjamin who move back to Jerusalem from captivity in Babylon is 956. This is not the number of families, but the number of individual people. However, each of the men whom the storyteller lists by name for the tribe of Benjamin is a leader of the house of their father. A house of their father is all of the people who live in the same household together, and other closely related family members. The head of the household is the leader of the people in the household.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller says that someone had written down all of the names of the people of Israel in the genealogies of the history of the kings of Israel.

In the second scene: The people of Judah go to Babylon because the people of Judah are unfaithful to Yahweh.

1 Chronicles 9:1–9

In the third scene: The people of Judah return to Jerusalem to live in their own villages. The people who return include Israelites, priests, Levites, and temple servants. People from the tribes of Judah, Benjamin, Ephraim, and Manasseh return to Jerusalem.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller lists the descendants of the tribe of Judah who return to Jerusalem. The family leaders are descendants of Judah's three sons named Perez, Shelah, and Zerah.

In the fifth scene: The storyteller lists four important descendants of the tribe of Benjamin who return to Jerusalem: Sallu, Ibneiah, Elah, and Meshullam.

The characters in this passage are:

- People of Israel
- People of Judah
- Some Israelites who return to Jerusalem
- Priests
- Levites
- Temple servants
- Three sons of Judah: Perez, Shelah, and Zerah
- Uthai, a descendant of Perez
- Asaiah and his sons, a descendant of Shelah
- Jeuel, a descendant of Zerah
- 690 people from the tribe of Judah
- Sallu
- Ibneiah
- Elah
- Meshullam
- And 956 people from the tribe of Benjamin

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that this passage comes after a three-part story about the descendants of the tribe of Benjamin. In the previous passage, the storyteller listed descendants of Benjamin who lived in Gibeon and Jerusalem. Now, the storyteller begins a final summary of all of the genealogies, or family histories, in the book of 1 Chronicles so far. The storyteller also lists the Israelites who return to Israel after their captivity in Babylon. Remember that this passage is the first part in a four-part story about all the first Israelites, priests, Levites, and temple servants who returned to Jerusalem after their captivity in Babylon.

The first scene is the end of the previous passages in the book of 1 Chronicles about the family history of many different tribes of Israel. Remember that some translations include this first scene with the previous passage. "All Israel" does not mean that these genealogies included every person in Israel. "All Israel" probably means these genealogies included both the northern and southern kingdoms of Israel.

The "book of the kings of Israel" means the history of the kings of Israel. This history of the kings of Israel included the official family records for the tribes of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate "book of the kings of Israel"? How will you show that people also wrote, or listed, the names of the people of Israel in this book of the kings of Israel? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the Babylonians take the people of Judah to Babylon. Remember that Babylon is the capital city of the country of Babylonia, and the Babylonians are the enemies of the people of Judah. Babylon is in the present-day country of Iraq. It is important to remember that the Babylonians take the people of Judah to Babylon. However, the reason that the people of Judah go to Babylon is because the people of Judah were unfaithful to Yahweh. It might be better to include this reason first—that the people of Judah were unfaithful to Yahweh—so Yahweh allowed the Babylonians to take the people of Judah to Babylon.

Stop here and look at a map of Babylon and Israel as a group. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you show that the Israelites went to Babylon because the Israelites were unfaithful to Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

The Israelites went to Babylonia a long time before the other scenes in this passage happen, but the storyteller has this scene here to describe what happens after the time of captivity in Babylon. Some people think that the first scene in this passage happens before the action in the second scene. If this is true, it would mean that scribes wrote down all the genealogies of the people of Israel before the people of Israel went to Babylon. However, it is not clear whether the first scene happened before the second scene. It is possible that the storyteller starts a new idea in the second scene when he talks about the exile to Babylon. Then, the storyteller lists the first Israelites who come back from Babylon to Jerusalem in the following scenes.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In the first scene of this passage, the storyteller makes a summary statement about how someone wrote down all of the genealogies of Israel in a book about the kings of Israel. We do not know when this happened. However, in the second scene, the people from the tribe of Judah were unfaithful to Yahweh, so the Babylonians captured the Israelites and took the Israelites to Babylon. How will you show that the second scene starts a new topic? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the Israelites return from their exile in Babylon to their homes in Israel. These homes are the villages, property, and land that the ancestors of the Israelites owned in the past. Remember that most of the Israelites who returned to Israel probably were not born in Israel, and they probably never lived in Israel before this time.

The storyteller says that some Israelites return to Israel, and some Israelites who are religious workers for the people of Israel also return. These religious people include priests, Levites, and temple servants. Remember that the storyteller lists the names of the priests, Levites, and temple servants who return to Israel in the following passages.

Israelites from the tribes of Judah, Benjamin, Ephraim, and Manasseh return to Jerusalem. Remember that these Israelites are not religious workers. Also, remember that not all of the people in the tribes of Judah, Benjamin, Ephraim, and Manasseh return to Jerusalem. Remember that we see no more information about people from the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh in the lists of people who return to Jerusalem. It is possible that the storyteller wants to show that Israel should be unified as one kingdom, and that is why the storyteller includes tribes from both the northern and southern kingdoms of the divided kingdom of Israel.

Stop here and look again at a map of Jerusalem, Babylon, Israel, and Judah as a group. Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller lists the leaders from the tribe of Judah who return to Jerusalem. Remember that Judah's three sons are Perez, Shelah, and Zerah. The storyteller lists three important leaders—Uthai, Asaiah, and Jeuel—who are each descendants of one of Judah's three sons. At the end of the fourth scene, the storyteller says that 690 people from the tribe of Judah come back to live in Jerusalem. Some translations include this information at the beginning of this scene so that it is clearer that all of the people in this scene are from the tribe of Judah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate this scene so that it is clear that all of these people are from the tribe of Judah? Pause this audio here.

The first leader from the tribe of Judah is Uthai, who is a descendant of Perez. Uthai is probably the leader of his people. Uthai's father is Ammihud, Ammihud's father is Omri, Omri's father is Imri, Imri's father is Bani, and Bani's father is Perez.

The next important person from the tribe of Judah is Asaiah. The storyteller says that Asaiah is the firstborn, or eldest, son of Shelah. This probably just means that Asaiah is the leader in the clan of people who descended from Shelah. Asaiah is also probably the leader of his people. Remember that Shelah is one of the other sons of Judah. The Shilonites are probably a different way to say the Shelanites, who are the people descended from Shelah.

Finally, the third important person in the tribe of Judah is Jeuel. Jeuel is probably the leader of the Zerahites. Remember that Zerah is another son of Judah.

In the fifth scene, the storyteller lists four important leaders from the tribe of Benjamin who return to Jerusalem. These four leaders are Sallu, Ibneiah, Elah, and Meshullam. It might be helpful to clearly say at the start of the fifth scene that all of these people are from the tribe of Benjamin and that these people also returned to Jerusalem. The storyteller also lists some of the ancestors of each of these leaders of the tribe of Benjamin.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How can you show that the four main leaders in the tribe of Benjamin who return to Jerusalem are Sallu, Ibneiah, Elah, and Meshullam? Pause this audio here.

At the end of the fifth scene, the storyteller says that 956 people from the tribe of Benjamin move back to live in Jerusalem. The storyteller also says that each of the men whose names he said was a head, or leader, of the house of that man's father.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- People of Israel
- People of Judah
- Some Israelites who return to Jerusalem
- Priests
- Levites
- Temple servants
- Three sons of Judah: Perez, Shelah, and Zerah
- Uthai, a descendant of Perez
- Asaiah, a descendant of Shelah
- Jeuel, a descendant of Zerah
- 690 people from the tribe of Judah
- Sallu
- Ibneiah
- Elah
- Meshullam
- And 956 people from the tribe of Benjamin

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

People listed the names of all the people of Israel in the official family records. People wrote that information in a book called the History of the Kings of Israel. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are honored that we are all in the official family records in the book of the kings of Israel; or
- We are glad that we are a part of the people of Israel; or
- We feel important because our names are in the genealogies in the book of the kings of Israel.

Continue the drama. The enemies of the people of Judah captured the people of Judah. The enemies of the people of Judah took the people of Judah to Babylon. Yahweh allowed this to happen because the people of Judah were not faithful to Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the people of Judah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We do not understand why Yahweh let our enemies capture us and take us to Babylon; or
- We are very sorry that we were unfaithful to Yahweh and that we sinned against Yahweh; or
- We hope that Yahweh rescues us and forgives us from our sin against Yahweh.

Continue the drama. After a long time, the first people came back from their captivity in Babylon to live in Jerusalem on their own land and in their own villages. The first people who came back were some Israelites, as well as some priests, Levites, and temple servants. The Israelites who came back to live in Jerusalem were from the tribes of Judah, Benjamin, Ephraim, and Manasseh. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Israelites, priests, Levites, and temple servants who are the first to return to Jerusalem, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We hope that we can live on our own land again and in our own villages again; or
- We are happy to be back in our land now! or
- We are very sorry that our ancestors sinned against Yahweh. We want to follow Yahweh so that we never need to leave our land again; or
- We are honored that we are the people who get to come back to Israel first.

Continue the drama. Some of the Israelites who came back were from the tribe of Judah. The total number of people who returned to Jerusalem from the tribe of Judah was 690 people. The people from the tribe of Judah were all descendants of Judah's three sons: Perez, Shelah, and Zerah. Perez's descendant Uthai returned to Jerusalem. Uthai was the son of Ammihud, Ammihud was the son of Omri, Omri was the son of Imri, Imri was the son of Bani, Bani was the son of Perez, and Perez was the son of Judah. Shelah's descendant Asaiah and Asaiah's sons also returned to Jerusalem. Asaiah was the oldest son of Shelah. Asaiah was one of the Shilonites. Zerah's descendant Jeuel also returned to Jerusalem. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Uthai, Asaiah, and Jeuel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are ready to be back in our land of Israel again; or
- We are glad to be leaders of our family groups as we come back to our land; or
- We are proud that we are descendants of Perez, Shelah, and Zerah, who are all sons of Judah; or
- We are nervous that we are the leaders of this small group of people who came back to Israel. We hope that no one attacks us or tries to stop us from living in our land again.

Continue the drama. Other Israelites who came back to Jerusalem were from the tribe of Benjamin. The total number of people from the tribe of Benjamin who came back was 956 people. Sallu, the son of Meshullam, was the first leader of the tribe of Benjamin. Meshullam was the son of Hodaviah, and Hodaviah was the son of Hassenuah. The next leader of the tribe of Benjamin was Ibneiah, the son of Jeroham. The third leader of the tribe of Benjamin was Elah, the son of Uzzi. Uzzi was the son of Micri. The final leader of the tribe of Benjamin was Meshullam, the son of Shephatiah. Shephatiah was the son of Reuel, and Reuel was the son of Ibnijah. All these men were leaders of the houses of their fathers. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Sallu, Ibneiah, Elah, and Meshullam, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are honored to lead our people of the tribe of Benjamin as we come back to our land in Jerusalem; or
- We hope that we can protect our people and live peacefully in our land now; or
- We want to follow Yahweh and be faithful to Yahweh so that we do not have to go back to Babylon again.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 9:1–9

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

People wrote down the names of all Israel in the genealogies that they included in the history of Israel's kings. People wrote this history in the books of the kings of Israel. People wrote information, names, and histories on paper or stone tablets. During the time of Israel, people wrote on paper, and then they glued the paper together and wound it around two sticks. People called this a scroll, or a book. To read the scroll, people unrolled the scroll. People rolled the scroll around the two sticks when they were not reading the scroll.

Stop here and look at a picture of a scroll as a group. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the idea of a **book** in this passage? Pause this audio here.

Israel means the people of Israel. **Genealogies** are lists of names of people who belong to the same ancestor. The **kings** of Israel are the kings who ruled in the land of Israel. Some of the kings ruled in the northern kingdom, which people also called Israel, and some of the kings of Israel ruled in the southern kingdom of Judah. Here, the history of the kings of Israel probably means both the northern and southern kingdoms. Translate Israel, genealogies, and kings the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on Israel, genealogies, and kings, refer to the Master Glossary.

The enemies of the people of **Judah** take the people of Judah captive to **Babylon**. The people of Judah are the people in the southern kingdom of Israel. The tribe of Judah was the largest tribe in the southern kingdom. Babylon is the capital city of the country of Babylonia. Translate Judah the same as you have in previous passages. Translate Babylon or Babylonia in the same way as you have in other parts of the Old Testament. For more information on Judah, refer to Judah in the Master Glossary.

The people of Judah went to Babylon because the people of Judah were **unfaithful** to Yahweh. Unfaithfulness means the people of Judah are not faithful, that the people have sinned and rebelled against Yahweh. Translate unfaithfulness the same as you have in previous passages.

Some **Israelites**, **priests**, **Levites**, and temple servants were the first people to return to their own **cities** and land in Israel. Israelites are the people of Israel. Priests are from the tribe of Levi and the family of Aaron. Priests offer sacrifices in the temple, or house, of Yahweh. Levites are other people who work in the temple of Yahweh who are from the tribe of Levi, but they are not priests. Temple servants are other people who work in the temple of Yahweh. Translate Israelites, priests, cities, and Levites the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on Israelites, priests, and Levites, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate **temple servants**? If you choose to call these people "temple servants," refer to temple and servant in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

People from the tribes of **Judah**, **Benjamin**, **Ephraim**, and **Manasseh** all return to **Jerusalem**.

Judah, Benjamin, Ephraim, and Manasseh are four of the 12 tribes of Israel. Jerusalem is the most important city in Israel. Use the same words for Judah, Benjamin, Ephraim, Manasseh, and Jerusalem as you used in previous passages. For more information on Jerusalem, refer to the Master Glossary.

The storyteller lists people from the tribe of Judah who return to Jerusalem. The storyteller says these people are **sons of sons** of Judah. Sons can sometimes mean descendants. So "sons of sons" is another way to talk about several generations of descendants. See sons, descendants, and generations in the Master Glossary to decide how you will translate sons in this passage.

The storyteller also lists people from the tribe of Benjamin who return to Jerusalem. All of these people were the **leaders of their fathers' families**, or households. A household includes all the people who live in a house, and the head is the leader of the household. But people could also use the word household, or house, to mean a large group of people who did not live in the same house, but who were part of a larger group. So we know that these men were leaders of the groups of their families. Other ways to translate this could be clan leaders, family leaders, heads of families, or leaders of the clans. Translate heads of families in the same way as you have in previous passages. For more information on household, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word
Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 9:1–9

Audio Content
- Hear and Heart (839 KB)
- Setting the Stage (7.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (9.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (6.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.4 MB)

1 Chronicles 9:10–16

Hear and Heart
In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 9:10–16 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:10–16 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage
Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

1 Chronicles 9:10–16

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller started to list the first people who came back to Jerusalem after their time of captivity, or exile, in Babylon. The storyteller listed the names of people from the tribes of Judah and Benjamin who came back to live in Jerusalem. Now, the storyteller lists the priests and the Levites who returned to live in Jerusalem. This passage is the second part of a four-part story about the first Israelites who return to Jerusalem.

It is important that religious leaders are among the first people to come back to Jerusalem after the time of captivity in Babylon. Priests and Levites are both from the tribe of Levi. Priests are a certain kind of Levites who serve Yahweh in special ways. Priests are descendants of Aaron. Levites are not descendants of Aaron, but they serve Yahweh in other ways.

In the book of Nehemiah, we hear similar lists of priests and Levites who return to Jerusalem after they were captive in Babylon, but the lists do have some differences. We also know from the book of Nehemiah that these priests and Levites come back to serve in the temple, or house, of Yahweh, which the Israelites rebuild in Jerusalem. Remember that the enemies of the Israelites destroyed the first temple.

First, the storyteller lists the priests who return to the city of Jerusalem. Priests were people who worked in the temple of Yahweh. Priests also offered sacrifices to Yahweh. The six priests in this passage are Jedaiah, Jehoiarib, Jakin, Azariah, Adaiah, and Maasai. These are not all of the same priests that Nehemiah lists in the book of Nehemiah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Describe the religious leaders in your community. What do your religious leaders do? Pause this audio here.

The first three priests are Jedaiah, Jehoiarib, and Jakin. We know from a later passage in 1 Chronicles that people divided the priests by lots. Jedaiah received the second lot, Jehoiarib received the first lot, and Jakin received the 21st lot. These lots told priests their assignments in the house of Yahweh.

Another priest who returns to Jerusalem is Azariah, the son of Hilkiah. Hilkiah was the son of Meshullam. Meshullam was the son of Zadok. Zadok was the son of Meraioth. Meraioth was the son of Ahitub. It is likely that the storyteller does not list all of Azariah's genealogy in this passage. In the book of Nehemiah, Azariah is called Seraiah.

It is difficult to know who the chief official, or high priest, was in charge of the house of Yahweh. Some translations say that Azariah was the high priest, but other translations say that Ahitub was the high priest. A high priest was the most important priest in the house of Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about the most important religious leader in your community. How is your most important religious leader different from the other religious leaders in your community? Pause this audio here.

The final two priests in this passage are Adaiah and Maasai. Adaiah was the son of Jeroham, Jeroham was the son of Pashhur, and Pashhur was the son of Malkijah. Maasai was the son of Adiel. Adiel was the son of Jahzerah. Jahzerah was the son of Meshullam. Mehsullam was the son of Meshillemith. Meshillemith was the son of Immer. Maasai is called Amashai in the book of Nehemiah, and Maasai's ancestors are also a little different in the book of Nehemiah.

There were 1,760 priests who returned to live in Jerusalem. These priests were all leaders of their families. This is a different number of priests than the number of priests in the book of Nehemiah. The book of Nehemiah lists the total number of priests as 1,192. It is possible that the storyteller of 1 Chronicles gives a more up-to-date list and includes more priests because now there are more priests than when Nehemiah wrote the book of Nehemiah.

The priests were all capable men. The priests were also skilled in their work in the house, or temple, of Yahweh. The men were qualified in their work. In the original language, capable men can also mean important men.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about the religious leaders in your community again. What skills do these religious leaders have? What do these leaders need to know how to do? Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 9:10–16

Next, the storyteller lists the Levites who return to the city of Jerusalem. Levites help the priests with work in the temple of Yahweh. The book of Nehemiah has a very similar list of Levites who return to Jerusalem. In the book of Nehemiah, Nehemiah says that 284 Levites return to Jerusalem. The storyteller in this passage does not say the total number of Levites who return to Jerusalem.

The storyteller gives us the names of seven of the Levites who return to Jerusalem. It is likely that many of these Levites were musicians in the temple of Yahweh. The Levites are Shemaiah, Bakbakkar, Heresh, Galal, Mattaniah, Obadiah, and Berekiah. The storyteller includes information about the ancestors of Shemaiah, Mattaniah, and Obadiah, who are from three important families in the tribe of Levi. Shemaiah was a descendant of Merari. Merari was one of the three sons of Levi. Mattaniah was a descendant of Asaph. Obadiah was a descendant of Jeduthun. The storyteller does not give any information about the families of Bakbakkar, Heresh, or Galal in this passage.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people become religious leaders in your community? Does the role of religious leader pass down from father to son, like in this passage, or does it happen in a different way? Pause this audio here.

The final Levite in this passage is Berekiah, the son of Asa. Asa was the son of Elkanah. Some people think that Obadiah and Berekiah live in the villages of Netophah. But, it is most likely that of these men, only Elkanah and his family lived in the villages of Netophah with the Netophathites. The Netophathites were descendants of Caleb, who was a descendant of Judah. Netophah was in the hill country of Judah near the village of Bethlehem. Remember that villages are smaller settlements without walls, and hills are raised areas of land.

Stop here and look at a map of the location of Netophah and a picture of hill country as a group.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller lists six priests who return to Jerusalem.

In the second scene: The storyteller lists seven Levites who return to Jerusalem.

The characters in this passage are:

- The priests Jedaiah, Jehoiarib, and Jakin
- The high priest, Azariah
- The priests Adaiah and Maasai
- 1,760 priests who return to Jerusalem
- The Levite Shemaiah from the clan of Merari
- The Levites Bakbakkar, Heresh, and Galal
- The Levite Mattaniah, a descendant of Asaph
- The Levite Obadiah
- And the Levite Berekiah

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in the previous passage, the storyteller said that some Israelites, priests, Levites, and temple servants were the first people to return to Jerusalem after their captivity in Babylon. The storyteller also listed the people from the tribes of Judah and Benjamin who returned to Jerusalem. Now, we learn the names of the priests and Levites who returned to Jerusalem. Remember that this passage is the second part in a four-part story about the first Israelites who return to Jerusalem. The final two parts of this story will be about the temple servants who return to Jerusalem.

As the first scene begins, it is important to remember that this passage continues to tell the story from the previous passage. Many translations begin this passage with "of the priests" or "from the priests," but it may

be helpful to remind listeners that these priests are in the group of people who returned first to Jerusalem from their captivity in Babylon. The second scene begins in a similar way as the storyteller tells about the Levites who returned to Jerusalem.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to begin the first and second scenes in this passage so that listeners remember these priests and Levites are people who returned to live in Jerusalem? Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, the storyteller lists six priests who return to Jerusalem. These priests are heads of families, and this list only includes the names of the heads of families. There were many more than six priests who returned to Jerusalem. Some translations include the names of all six of these priests at the beginning of the scene so that no one will be confused about who the priests are who return to Jerusalem and who are the ancestors of these priests. Some people also include here the general information about the priests that is at the end of the scene. Here is one way to translate the beginning of the first scene: "The priests Jedaiah, Jehoiarib, Jakin, Azariah, Adaiah, and Maasai all returned to live in Jerusalem. These priests were all leaders of their families. These priests were all capable men who were skilled in their work in the house of Yahweh."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate the beginning of this scene? Should you include all the names at the beginning of the scene? Should you also include the information about these men's skills and duties here, or at the end of this scene? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller does not give any additional information about the families of Jedaiah, Jehoiarib, and Jakin. Azariah also returns. Remember that some people think that Azariah is the high priest, while other people think that Ahitub was the high priest because Ahitub is at the end of the list of names of the ancestors of Azariah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Would it be better to clearly state that Azariah was the high priest, or to make it possible for people to understand it was either Azariah or Ahitub? For example:

- Azariah son of Hilkiah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the son of Meraioth, the son of Ahitub. Azariah was the official in charge of the house of God; or
- Azariah son of Hilkiah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the son of Meraioth, the son of Ahitub, who was the official in charge of the house of God.

Pause this audio here.

The final two priests in this scene are Adaiah and Maasai. The storyteller tells us three generations of Adaiah's ancestors and five generations of Maasai's ancestors.

At the end of the first scene, the storyteller says that 1,760 priests returned to live in Jerusalem. These priests were all leaders of their families. Remember, the priests are all capable men who are skilled at the work they do in the temple of Yahweh. Some translation teams may want to include this information at the beginning of this scene instead of at the end of this scene.

In the second scene, the storyteller lists seven Levites who return to the city of Jerusalem. The Levites are Shemaiah, Bakbakkar, Heresh, Galal, Mattaniah, Obadiah, and Berekiah. Remember that three of the Levites in this passage are from important families in the tribe of Levi. Shemaiah is a descendant of Merari, Mattaniah is a descendant of Asaph, and Obadiah is a descendant of Jeduthun.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Would it be helpful here to include the information that a Merarite is a descendant of Merari, one of the three sons of Levi? Pause this audio here.

Berekiah, the son of Asa, also returns to Jerusalem. Asa was the son of Elkanah. Remember that it is most likely that Elkanah lived in the villages of Netophah. Remember, Berekiah lived in Jerusalem. The villages of Netophah were in the hill country of Judah, about eight kilometers southeast of Bethlehem.

Stop here and look at a map of the location of Netophah and a picture of hill country again, as a group, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

1 Chronicles 9:10–16

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The priests Jedaiah, Jehoiarib, and Jakin
- The high priest, Azariah
- The priests Adaiah and Maasai
- 1,760 priests who return to Jerusalem
- The Levite Shemaiah from the clan of Merari
- The Levites Bakbakkar, Heresh, and Galal
- The Levite Mattaniah, a descendant of Asaph
- The Levite Obadiah
- And the Levite Berekiah

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

These priests also returned to Jerusalem. The priests were Jedaiah, Jehoiarib, Jakin, Azariah, Adaiah, and Maasai. The priests were all leaders of their families. These priests were capable men who were skilled in their work in the temple of Yahweh. Azariah was the high priest in charge of the temple of Yahweh. Azariah was the son of Hilkiah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the son of Meraioth, the son of Ahitub. Adaiah was the son of Jeroham, the son of Pashhur, the son of Malkijah. Maasai was the son of Adiel, the son of Jahzerah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Meshillemith, the son of Immer. There were 1,760 priests who returned to Jerusalem. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Jedaiah, Jehoiarib, Jakin, Azariah, Adaiah, and Maasai, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We are honored that we are priests in the temple of Yahweh; or
- We are glad to be back in the land of Israel so we can worship Yahweh in this new temple; or
- We are confident in our skills as we serve Yahweh in Yahweh’s temple.

Continue the drama. These Levites also returned to Jerusalem. The Levites who returned were Shemaiah, Bakbakkar, Heresh, Galal, Mattaniah, Obadiah, and Berekiah. Shemaiah was the son of Hasshub, the son of Azrikam, the son of Hashabiah, who was a descendant of Merari. Merari was one of the sons of Levi. Mattaniah was the son of Mica, the son of Zicri, the son of Asaph. Obadiah was the son of Shemaiah, the son of Galal, the son of Jeduthun. Berekiah was the son of Asa, the son of Elkanah, who lived in the villages of the Netophathites. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Shemaiah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am glad to return to the land of Israel to serve in the temple of Yahweh; or
- I am proud to be a descendant of Merari, one of the sons of Levi; or
- I am ready to do anything I can to serve in the temple of Yahweh.

Also, ask the person playing Berekiah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- My ancestor was Elkanah, who lived in the villages of the Netophathites. I am proud that I am a part of the family of Elkanah; or
- I am ready to serve Yahweh in Yahweh’s temple; or
- I am proud to be a Levite who serves Yahweh in Yahweh’s temple.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The **priests** returned to Jerusalem. Priests were from the tribe of Levi and the family of Aaron. Priests offered sacrifices in the temple, or house, of Yahweh. Translate priests the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on priests, refer to the Master Glossary.

Azariah was probably the **high priest** in charge of the **house of God**. The high priest was the most important priest. The high priest offered the sacrifice for the people on the Day of Atonement, and the high priest was the only priest Yahweh allowed to go into the Most Holy Place of the temple. Although we know this means high priest, you should probably translate this part of the passage as “the leader of the house of God.” The house of God means the temple of God. Translate “house of God” the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on high priest, house of God, and God, refer to the Master Glossary.

The storyteller lists the ancestors of the priests who return to Jerusalem. For example, the storyteller says that Adaiah was the **son** of Jeroham, the son of Pashhur, the son of Malkijah. Sons can sometimes mean descendants. In this passage, son usually means a father-and-son relationship, although sometimes the storyteller does not list all of the generations in a family, and therefore “sons” may mean “descendants, or grandsons.” Translate sons in the same way you have in previous passages. See sons and descendants in the Master Glossary.

The priests were the heads of their fathers’ families, or **households**. This means the priests were leaders of the groups of their families. A household includes all the people who live in the house, and the head is the leader of the household. Other ways to translate this could be clan leaders, family leaders, heads of families, or leaders of the clans. Translate leaders of families, or fathers’ households, in the same way as you have in previous passages. For more information on household, refer to the Master Glossary.

Levites were other people from the tribe of Levi who worked in the temple of Yahweh, but they were not priests. Levi was also the name of one of the 12 tribes of Israel. Remember that Levi had three sons: Kohath, Gershon, and Merari. One of Kohath’s grandsons was Aaron, who became the first priest for the people of Israel. Male descendants of Aaron were responsible for serving Yahweh as priests for Israel. The descendants of Gershon and Merari did other work in the temple of Yahweh. Translate Levites in the same way as you have in previous passages. For more information on Levites, refer to the Master Glossary.

Berekiah was the son of Asa, who was the son of Elkanah. Elkanah lived in the villages of the Netophathites. Villages are small towns with no walls around them. Translate villages the same as you have in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 9:10–16

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (908 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Chronicles 9:17–27

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 9:17–27 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:17–27 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:17–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller continues the list of the people who return to Jerusalem after their exile to Babylon. The storyteller already listed people from the tribes of Judah and Benjamin, the priests, and the Levites who came back. Now, in this passage, the storyteller lists the gatekeepers who come back. The storyteller also tells what the gatekeepers do in the house of God. The gatekeepers protected the tent of Yahweh during the time of Moses, they protected the temple of Yahweh during the time of the kings of Israel, and now the gatekeepers protect the new temple in the time after the exile. This is the third part in a four-part story about the people who returned to Jerusalem.

In the past, the Israelites worshipped Yahweh in a tabernacle, or the Tent of Meeting. The Israelites could pick up this tent and move it from place to place. Later, King David's son Solomon built the temple of Yahweh. Enemies of

1 Chronicles 9:17–27

the Israelites destroyed this first temple, and the enemies took the Israelites to Babylon. In this passage, some of the Israelites and some of the religious leaders have returned to Jerusalem, and the Israelites have rebuilt the temple. There is now a new, second temple. Both of these temples and the tabernacle shared the same basic structure, and there were gatekeepers for each of them.

We hear a similar passage in the book of Nehemiah about the gatekeepers who come back to Jerusalem after the exile. Some of the names of the gatekeepers are different in that passage. Some people think that the gatekeepers that the storyteller lists here are family names of the ancestors of the gatekeepers, and not the names of the actual gatekeepers who came back to Jerusalem.

There were four main gatekeepers. The gatekeepers were the temple guards at the gates, or entrances, of the temple. We know from later in this passage that the temple had one gate on each of the four sides of the temple. The gatekeepers defended the temple from any person or any animal who might try to come into the temple without permission. It was important to keep the temple spiritually clean according to the law of Moses. It was a big responsibility to protect the temple of Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What places in your community have guards or gates? What do the guards or gates protect? Who are the guards? How do the guards protect the entrances to these places? Pause this audio here.

The names of the gatekeepers were Shallum, Akkub, Talmon, Ahiman, and their relatives. These gatekeepers were all Levites, which means that these men were all from the tribe of Levi. The chief gatekeeper, or the leader of the gatekeepers, was Shallum. Shallum guarded the King's Gate, which was the gate on the eastern side of the temple that the king usually used to enter the temple. Some people think that Akkub, Talmon, Ahiman, and their relatives also guarded the King's Gate with Shallum.

A long time ago, King David appointed either Shallum or Shallum's ancestors to guard the gates of the Tent of Meeting. We know that the first gatekeepers were gatekeepers of the Tent of Meeting, which people also called the tabernacle. Later, when Solomon built the temple, the gatekeepers did the same jobs at the temple. The tabernacle and the temple are both the house of God. In some places in this passage, the storyteller calls the temple "the house of God." The Israelites sometimes continued to call the temple "the Tent of Meeting" or "the house of God." In this passage, the storyteller says that the descendants of Shallum still guard the gates of the temple.

It is difficult to know where the King's Gate and the camp of the Levites are, and whether the storyteller is talking about gatekeepers at the time when he wrote this passage, or gatekeepers during the time of Moses. Some people think that the gatekeepers in this passage guard the King's Gate, and the ancestors of those gatekeepers guarded the camp of the Levites during the time of Moses. Other people think that the gatekeepers in this passage guarded the King's Gate in the past, but now the same gatekeepers guard the camp of the Levites, which is where the Levites now live near the temple.

Shallum and his family guarded the thresholds, or entrances, to the house of God. This is probably the same Shallum who was the chief gatekeeper of the temple, but some people think this was a different person named Shallum. Shallum was the son of Kore, the son of Ebiasaph, the son of Korah, and Shallum's relatives were from the Korahite family. Korah was from the tribe of Levi, just like Aaron and the high priests.

A threshold is usually a large stone block as wide as a door frame. A threshold is the bottom of a door frame. Shallum and his family stood in front of each threshold, or entrance, to the tent to protect and guard the tent. In this passage, tent means the temple. Shallum's ancestors also guarded the entrance to the dwelling, or house, of Yahweh. In the past, Yahweh's house was a tabernacle. During the time that the storyteller writes this passage, Yahweh's house is a temple.

Stop here and look at a picture of a threshold as a group. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Describe the threshold or entrance into your home or another tent, building, or place that you know. How do you make sure that no one comes into the house, tent, building, or place without permission? Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 9:17–27

Another gatekeeper in the past was Phinehas, the son of Eleazar. Phinehas was the leader of the gatekeepers when the people of Israel went across the Jordan River into the land of Canaan. Phinehas' father, Eleazar, was the high priest at that time. Yahweh was with Phinehas. Some people translate this part of the passage as a prayer that Yahweh may be with Phinehas, but most people say that Yahweh was with Phinehas.

Another gatekeeper in the past was Zechariah, the son of Meshelemiah. Zechariah guarded the entrance to the tent of Yahweh's presence. Here, the tent of Yahweh's presence means the temple of Yahweh. We will see later in the book of 1 Chronicles that Zechariah was the firstborn, or oldest, son of Meshelemiah, and that Zechariah guarded the north side of the temple of Yahweh. It is not clear why the storyteller includes Zechariah here in this list of gatekeepers. Maybe Zechariah was a leader of the gatekeepers during Zechariah's life.

When the storyteller wrote this passage, there were 212 present-day guards at the entrances and gates of the temple. This included Shallum and all the temple guards in this passage so far. The number of gatekeepers is different here than in the book of Nehemiah. Some people think that the storyteller of the book of 1 Chronicles counted the gatekeepers at a different time or in a different way than the storyteller of the book of Nehemiah counted the gatekeepers.

The gatekeepers lived in the villages of their ancestors. The gatekeepers' ancestors lived in these villages since the time of Joshua. The people listed the gatekeepers in the genealogies, or family records, in the villages where the gatekeepers lived.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Where did your ancestors live? What are the villages, towns, or cities of your ancestors? How do you keep the records or the history of your families? Pause this audio here.

In the past, King David and the seer, or prophet, Samuel gave the gatekeepers from the past their jobs to guard the gates of the temple of Yahweh. A seer is a prophet, or a person who sees things from Yahweh that other people do not see. We know that Samuel already died before David was the king, but Samuel did prepare the way for David to be king. David organized the worship in the Tent of Meeting, or house of Yahweh, including choosing the guards of the house of Yahweh during David's time. It was important to choose faithful men to be the gatekeepers because this was a permanent official duty to guard and protect Yahweh's house.

The gatekeepers that David and Samuel chose, and the gatekeepers' sons, or descendants, were in charge of the house of Yahweh, which people called the tent. In this passage, the tent probably means the temple. It is also possible that the storyteller could mean both the tent and the temple since the gatekeepers guarded both the tent and the temple.

The gatekeepers were on all four sides of the temple because there were four gates of the temple. The gates were on the east, west, north, and south sides of the temple. The sun rises in the east, and the sun sets in the west. It is likely that the four gatekeepers at the beginning of this passage each guarded one of the four gates of the temple.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about different directions in your language? Pause this audio here.

At certain times, relatives of the four main gatekeepers came from their villages to help guard the temple for seven days at a time. The chief gatekeepers probably lived in Jerusalem, and their relatives lived in villages outside of Jerusalem.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about something that you do regularly, or at certain times during the year. Make sure you choose something you do regularly and not something that you only do occasionally. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller reminds us that the four main gatekeepers were Levites, or from the tribe of Levi. These main gatekeepers were responsible for each of their four gates. These men were permanently on duty and were trustworthy. The men were also responsible to guard the storerooms and treasuries of the temple of Yahweh. The treasuries probably had supplies in them. Some people think that all of the gatekeepers or all of the Levites were responsible for the storerooms and treasuries of the temple, but it is probably best to say that the four main gatekeepers were responsible for the storerooms and the treasuries of the temple.

The main gatekeepers stayed near the temple at night. This might mean that the gatekeepers lived near the temple, or it might mean that the gatekeepers stayed up all night to protect the temple. The gatekeepers needed to be near the temple so that they could guard the temple and open the gates each morning. This might mean the gatekeepers unlocked the gates with a key or that the gatekeepers opened the gates. A key is a tool that people use to open a lock on a door or gate. People make keys out of wood or metal. The lock and key protect what is inside a door or a gate.

Stop here and look at a picture of a key as a group. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about the discussion from earlier in this step about places that people guard in your community. How long does one guard stay at the same place to guard the entrance to that place? How often do other people come to relieve this guard? If the guards sleep during their time on duty, where do the guards sleep?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:17–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller lists the gatekeepers who returned for the temple of Yahweh. The storyteller also lists some of the gatekeepers who guarded the temple many years ago.

In the second scene: The storyteller tells the duties of the gatekeepers for the temple of Yahweh.

The characters in this passage are:

- Shallum, the chief gatekeeper and his family
- Shallum's father, Kore, Kore's father, Ebiasaph, and Ebiasaph's father, Korah
- Akkub, Talmon, Ahiman, and their brothers
- Phinehas, son of Eleazar
- Yahweh
- Zechariah, son of Meshelemiah
- 212 gatekeepers
- David
- Samuel
- Four chief gatekeepers
- And relatives of the four chief gatekeepers

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that the storyteller continues to list the people who come back to Jerusalem after the exile. In the previous passage, the storyteller listed the priests and the Levites who came back. Now, the storyteller lists the gatekeepers. Remember that gatekeepers are also Levites, but gatekeepers take care of the temple in different ways than the other Levites. Remember also that the gatekeepers have taken care of the tent of Yahweh, or the temple of Yahweh, since the time of Moses. Remember that this is the third part in a four-part story.

In the first scene, it might be helpful to say the gatekeepers returned to live in Jerusalem after the exile. Remember that gatekeepers guard the entrances, or gates, of the temple. You could also translate gatekeepers as guards, temple guards, or security guards.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember your discussion in the previous step about guards in your community. How will you translate gatekeepers in this passage? Pause this audio here.

The chief gatekeeper was Shallum. The other gatekeepers were Akkub, Talmon, Ahiman, and their relatives. It might be better to say that Shallum was the main gatekeeper before you list the other gatekeepers. Shallum guarded the King's Gate on the east side of the temple.

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Remember that some translations say these gatekeepers not only guard the camp where the Levites currently live, but they also used to guard the King's Gate. Remember also that other people believe the storyteller of 1 Chronicles means these gatekeepers guarded the King's Gate at the time when the storyteller wrote this, but that different gatekeepers guarded the camp of the Levites in the time of Moses.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Use objects, like rocks, to show the temple with four gates and the camp of the Levites. Use other objects, like sticks, to show the gatekeepers. Show the different ways to translate this part of the passage. How will your translation team translate this part of the passage? Pause this audio here.

Shallum and his relatives guarded the thresholds, or entrances, to the temple. Remember that in this passage, the storyteller uses the words tent and temple to both mean "temple." Remember that we learn later in this passage that the temple had four entrances, one on each side of the temple. Remember that Shallum is probably the same person who is the chief gatekeeper earlier in this passage. Remember that Shallum is from the Korahite family, which is an important family in the Kohathite clan in the tribe of Levi. In the past, Shallum's ancestors also guarded the entrance to the house of Yahweh, which they called the tabernacle in the past.

Stop here and look at a picture of a threshold as a group. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate threshold or entrance in this passage? Pause this audio here.

The rest of the first scene describes two other gatekeepers of the temple of Yahweh who were gatekeepers many years before. These gatekeepers are Phinehas, son of Eleazar, and Zechariah, the son of Meshelemiah. Phinehas was a leader of the gatekeepers during his time, and Yahweh was with Phinehas. Other ways to translate "Yahweh was with Phinehas" are "Yahweh's presence was with Phinehas" or "Yahweh helped Phinehas."

Zechariah, the son of Meshelemiah, also guarded the entrance to the Tent of Meeting. Remember that the storyteller sometimes calls the temple "the Tent of Meeting" in this passage.

In the second scene, the storyteller gives information about the duties of the gatekeepers of the temple of Yahweh. First, the storyteller says there were 212 gatekeepers when the storyteller wrote the book of 1 Chronicles. Remember, the numbers in 1 Chronicles are not exactly the same as the numbers of gatekeepers in the book of Nehemiah.

Next, the storyteller tells where the gatekeepers lived. The gatekeepers lived in the villages of their ancestors, and the people wrote down the genealogies, or family records, of the places where the gatekeepers lived.

The storyteller also says that David and the seer, or prophet, Samuel appointed these trustworthy gatekeepers to these important positions to guard the temple of Yahweh. Remember that Samuel was a prophet during the time of David, and Samuel received messages from Yahweh that other people did not hear.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you show that the gatekeepers had an important role that required David and Samuel to trust them? How will you translate "seer," or "prophet"? Some different ways to translate this part of the passage are:

- David and the seer, Samuel, made the important jobs of gatekeepers. The job of gatekeeper was a position of trust; or
- King David and the prophet Samuel wanted faithful men to be gatekeepers; or
- King David and Samuel, the prophet of Yahweh, trusted these men. So, David and Samuel chose the first men to do the important work to guard the gates of the temple.

Pause this audio here.

The gatekeepers that David and Samuel chose had children. The sons, or descendants, of these gatekeepers became the new gatekeepers of the tent of Yahweh. Remember that the tent of Yahweh probably means the temple in this passage.

Next, the storyteller says the gatekeepers guarded all four sides of the temple. There was a gate on each of the four sides of the temple at the east, west, north, and south. Remember, the sun rises in the east, and the sun

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sets in the west. When you face the sun as it rises in the east, the north is on the left hand and the south on the right hand.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember your discussion in the previous step about different directions in your language. How will you translate the four sides of the temple? Pause this audio here.

The four chief gatekeepers guarded the gates, but sometimes relatives of the chief gatekeepers came to relieve the chief gatekeepers. The chief gatekeepers probably lived in Jerusalem so they could always be near the temple, and the relatives of the chief gatekeepers lived in villages outside of Jerusalem. The relatives came at certain times to help, and these relatives stayed to guard the gates of the temple for seven days at a time.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember your discussion from the previous step about something that you do regularly. How will you translate this part of the passage that the relatives of the main gatekeepers came "from time to time" to relieve the main gatekeepers in their duties to guard the temple? Pause this audio here.

The four chief gatekeepers were all Levites, and these men had a permanent responsibility to guard the temple. The gatekeepers also guarded the storerooms and treasuries of the temple. These gatekeepers stayed near the temple at night, which might mean they stood and guarded the gates all night long, or it could mean they slept in rooms near the temple so they could get up easily to unlock the gates in the morning.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember your discussion from the previous step about how long guards stay in the same place to guard that place, and when or if guards sleep during their time on guard duty. How will you say that the gatekeepers stayed around the temple all night long? Here are some translation options:

- The gatekeepers stood as guards near the gates of the temple all night; or
- The gatekeepers slept in rooms near the gates of the temple at night; or
- The gatekeepers stayed near the gates at night.

Notice that the final translation option might mean that the gatekeepers guarded the gates at night, or it might mean that the gatekeepers slept somewhere near the gates at night. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:17–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Shallum, the chief gatekeeper
- Shallum's father, Kore, Kore's father, Ebiasaph, and Ebiasaph's father, Korah
- Akkub, Talmon, Ahiman, and their brothers
- Phinehas, son of Eleazar
- Yahweh
- Zechariah, son of Meshelemiah
- 212 gatekeepers
- David
- Samuel
- Four chief gatekeepers
- And relatives of the four chief gatekeepers

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

1 Chronicles 9:17–27

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The gatekeepers returned to live in Jerusalem after the exile. The chief gatekeeper was Shallum. Shallum guarded the King's Gate on the east side of the temple until this day. Other gatekeepers were Akkub, Talmon, Ahiman, and their brothers. These men were all Levites. Shallum was the son of Kore, the son of Ebiasaph, the son of Korah, and Shallum was from the family of the Korahites. Shallum guarded the entrances to the temple in the same way that Shallum's ancestors also guarded Yahweh's Tent of Meeting in the past. Pause the drama. Ask the person who plays Shallum, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- It is an honor to be the chief gatekeeper of the temple of Yahweh; or
- I am glad that I can guard the temple of Yahweh, just as my ancestors guarded the tent of Yahweh during the time of Moses; or
- I am proud that I am from the same clan of Kohathites as Aaron and the high priests.

Continue the drama. Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, was the chief gatekeeper in the past. Yahweh's presence was with Phinehas. Zechariah, the son of Meshelemiah, was also a gatekeeper at the entrance of the tent of Yahweh in the past. Pause the drama. Ask the person who plays Phinehas, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that I was the chief gatekeeper when the people of Israel crossed over the Jordan River into the land of Canaan; or
- I am encouraged that I did my work well because Yahweh was with me; or
- I hope that future gatekeepers will also work hard to protect the tent of Yahweh.

Continue the drama. There were 212 gatekeepers of the entrances to the temple. The people wrote down the names of the gatekeepers in the villages of the ancestors of the gatekeepers. In the past, King David and Samuel, the prophet of Yahweh, trusted these men. So, David and Samuel chose these men to do the important work to guard the gates of the temple. These gatekeepers and their sons, or descendants, continued to guard the gates of the house of Yahweh, the temple. Pause the drama. Ask the people who play David and the prophet Samuel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- It was important for us to choose trustworthy men to guard the temple of Yahweh. That is why we chose these trustworthy men to become the gatekeepers; or
- The gatekeepers have an important responsibility to guard the temple, and I hope these men will do a good job with their important work; or
- We know that the descendants of these gatekeepers will continue to guard the temple of Yahweh. We hope the future generations of gatekeepers will also do their work well.

Continue the drama. The gatekeepers guarded all four sides of the temple on the east, west, north, and south. Relatives of the chief gatekeepers came from their villages to relieve the chief gatekeepers at certain times. These relatives guarded the gates for seven days at a time. The chief gatekeepers had a permanent responsibility to guard the gates. The chief gatekeepers also guarded the storerooms and the supply rooms of the temple of Yahweh. The chief gatekeepers stayed near the gates of the temple at night so they could guard the gates of the temple. Every morning, the chief gatekeepers opened the gates of the temple. Pause the drama. Ask the people who play the chief gatekeepers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- This is a big responsibility to guard the temple of Yahweh; or

- We will not let anyone or anything into the temple of Yahweh that should not be there. We will also faithfully protect the storerooms and supply rooms of the temple of Yahweh; or
- We are glad that our relatives sometimes come to give us relief from our work as guards. We need a break from this important work as we guard the temple; or
- We hope that our relatives from the villages will also do a good job when they guard the temple.

Also, ask the people who play the relatives of the chief gatekeepers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are honored that we can also have a turn to guard the temple of Yahweh; or
- We are glad that we do not need to stay here permanently, and that we can return to our homes in the villages after our seven days of guard duty; or
- We respect our relatives, the main gatekeepers, for doing this work. This is a big responsibility! or
- We are ready to protect the temple of Yahweh so that no person or animal enters the temple who should not be there.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:17–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The gatekeepers were Shallum, Akkub, Talmon, Ahiman, and their brothers. Gatekeepers guarded the gates to the temple of Yahweh. People also called the gates the entrances or the thresholds of the temple. Sometimes people also called the temple of Yahweh the house of Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate **gatekeepers** in this passage? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, "**tent**," "Tent of Meeting," and "**temple**" all mean the house of Yahweh. Over the years, the Israelites sometimes exchanged the names of the temple and the Tent of Meeting. Translate temple and tent of Yahweh the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on temple, tabernacle, and house of God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Shallum was the chief, or main gatekeeper, during the time that the storyteller wrote this passage. Translate chief or leader in the same way as you have in previous passages. Shallum guarded the King's Gate on the east side of the temple. The King's Gate was the gate where the **king** entered the temple. A king is a person who rules over a city or a territory. Translate king the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

Shallum and the other gatekeepers were Levites, or from the camp of the Levites. The Levites are descendants of the tribe of Levi, one of the 12 tribes of Israel. Translate **sons of Levi** the same as you have in previous passages. Sons of Levi means Levites. For more information on "sons of Levi," refer to Levites in the Master Glossary.

Phinehas was another chief gatekeeper. **Yahweh** was with Phinehas. Yahweh is God's personal name. Translate Yahweh the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Also, translate "**house of God**" the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

The people listed the gatekeepers in the **genealogies** of each of their **villages**. Genealogies are lists of names of people who belong to the same ancestor. Villages are smaller than cities and do not have walls around them. Translate genealogies and villages the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on genealogy, refer to the Master Glossary.

David and the prophet **Samuel** put these gatekeepers in their positions of trust. David was the second king of Israel. Samuel was the prophet who anointed David as the next king of Israel after King Saul. Prophets, or seers, receive messages from Yahweh. Translate David and Samuel the same as you have in previous passages. For more information on David and prophet, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate **seers** in this passage? Pause this audio here.

The gatekeepers and their sons, or descendants, guarded the gates of the house of Yahweh on the **east**, **west**, **north**, and **south** sides. Remember that the east side of a building is the side from which the sun rises. Translate the directions for east, west, north, and south in the same way as you have previously.

In this passage, **sons** usually means descendants. Translate "sons" in the same way as you have in previous passages when it means descendants. See descendants in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 9:17–27

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (911 KB)
- Setting the Stage (8.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (9.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (6.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.4 MB)

1 Chronicles 9:28–34

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 9:28–34 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:28–34 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:28–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller continues the list of the people who return to Jerusalem after their exile to Babylon. The storyteller already listed people from the tribes of Judah and Benjamin, the priests, the Levites, and the gatekeepers who came back. Now, in this passage, the storyteller describes the duties of other Levites in the temple. This is the fourth part in a four-part story about the people who returned to Jerusalem.

Some people think that in this passage, the storyteller continues to talk about the Levites who were gatekeepers in the previous passage. This would mean that gatekeepers from the previous passage have other duties besides their duties as gatekeepers. Other people think that in this passage, the storyteller now describes the duties of other Levites who are not gatekeepers in the house of Yahweh.

These Levites had some important duties in the house of Yahweh. These people took care of the utensils of service, which were probably the valuable silver and gold dishes, cups, and tools that the priests used in the house of Yahweh. When the priests needed these articles, people brought the cups, tools, and dishes out of the treasure room in the temple so that the priests could use these articles in the worship service. These Levites in this passage carefully counted the articles every time people brought the articles out of the treasure room. Then, after the worship service was finished, people brought the articles back to the treasure room. Again, these Levites counted the articles when the people brought the articles back to the room. These Levites counted the articles before and after people used the articles to make sure that none of the valuable articles got lost.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you take care of valuable things in your home or your community? How do you make sure that no one loses these valuable things, or that no one steals these valuable things? Pause this audio here.

People put other Levites in charge of the equipment, or the furniture and other holy utensils for the sanctuary. In the original language, furniture is the same word as the utensils of service that the Levites took care of in the previous part of this passage. Here, furniture probably means other items that the Levites took care of. Holy utensils were things like buckets and shovels, which priests used in the temple. People kept this sacred or holy equipment in the inner rooms of the house of Yahweh.

These same Levites were also in charge of the flour, the wine, the oil, the incense, and the spices. To make flour, people ground the inner kernels of wheat into a powder. Then people used the flour to make grain offerings and other food offerings in the temple. Wine is grape juice that people have fermented. People used wine to make drink offerings. People crushed olives to make oil. People used olive oil to make food offerings. People mixed spices to make incense, which is a sweet-smelling smoke, or sometimes people mixed the spices together with oil to make anointing oil for priests. The spices included myrrh, cinnamon, cane, and cassia. Only priests could mix the spices.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: People used flour, wine, oil, and spices in the temple of Yahweh. What are some common foods that you use to help you worship your gods in your culture? Pause this audio here.

Mattithiah was the Levite who baked the bread for the temple. Mattithiah probably cooked this bread in a pan, and people used this bread to make offerings to Yahweh. Mattithiah was the firstborn son of Shallum the Korahite. This may be the same Shallum we heard about in a previous passage, who was the chief gatekeeper of the temple. It was Mattithiah's permanent responsibility to bake the offering bread. In the original language, this is the same word that described the permanent responsibility of the gatekeepers in a previous passage. Mattithiah was a reliable or faithful worker. People trusted Mattithiah with this role.

1 Chronicles 9:28–34

Some of the Kohathites also had an important role. The Kohathites were from the clan of Kohath, one of the sons of Levi. Some people think the Kohathites were responsible for preparing the bread and also putting 12 loaves of bread in two rows on the golden table in the Holy Place every Sabbath. In the original language, people call this bread "the bread of the row." We know from the book of Exodus that there were always 12 loaves of bread on the table in the Holy Place. The Holy Place is a part of the temple where only priests can go. The priests were also the only ones who could eat the bread on the table in the Holy Place.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of what the bread on the table might have looked like. Pause this audio here.

It is also possible that the Kohathites only made the bread, and someone else set the bread on the table in the Holy Place. Or maybe the Kohathites only set the bread on the table. Some people think the Kohathites both made the bread and set the bread on the table. The Sabbath is the seventh day of the week, which is Saturday for people today. The Sabbath is a day of rest for the people of Israel. The people of Israel also worshipped Yahweh on the Sabbath every week.

The musicians were heads of fathers' houses, or leaders of their families. These musicians were also all Levites. The musicians lived in rooms in the temple area. The musicians did not have other work to do in the temple because the musicians needed to be ready to perform at any time in a worship service to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a job in your community where a person is always on duty, and someone could call this person to come work at any time. Pause this audio here.

All of the Levite men in the past few passages were heads of fathers' houses, or leaders of their families. These men all had work to do in the temple of Yahweh. People listed these men's names in the records of their ancestors. The storyteller says that these people all lived in Jerusalem, but we know from previous passages that some of these people actually lived in the villages around Jerusalem.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:28–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Some of the Levites had the job to count the tools that people used in the temple. Other Levites were responsible for the furniture, other holy utensils of the sanctuary, flour, wine, oil, incense, and spices. Certain priests mixed the spices.

In the second scene: Mattithiah made the offering bread. Some Kohathites prepared the bread for the holy table every Sabbath.

In the third scene: Some of the Levites were musicians and lived in rooms in the temple area.

In the fourth scene: These men were all leaders of Levite families and lived in Jerusalem.

The characters in this passage are:

- Levites who were in charge of the articles in the temple
- Levites who were in charge of the furniture, other articles, flour, wine, oil, and spices
- Priests who mixed the spices
- Mattithiah
- Some Kohathites who put bread on the table
- Levites who were musicians
- And all the Levites who were heads of their families

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that this is the fourth part in a four-part story about the people who returned to Jerusalem after their exile to Babylon. In the previous passage, the storyteller described the duties of the temple gatekeepers.

This passage is the final passage in a long section of the book of 1 Chronicles. This section started at the beginning of chapter one, where it described the ancestors of the Israelites from among all the nations from the very beginning. Now, this section ends in a similar way when it describes the Israelites who came back to Jerusalem from among the nations where the Israelites were in exile.

In the first scene, remember it is not clear whether the storyteller is describing additional duties of the Levite gatekeepers of the temple or if the storyteller is now describing the duties of a different group of Levites within the temple. In the original language, the storyteller says “some of them,” which could mean some of the Levite gatekeepers or some of the other Levites who were not also gatekeepers.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate “some of them” in this passage? If possible, choose to translate “some of them” so that people could understand “them” to refer to either the gatekeepers or to some of the other Levites. Pause this audio here.

The Levites in this passage had important work. First, the storyteller says that the people were in charge of the articles of the temple. Remember that these articles were probably the gold and silver dishes and other things that the priests used in the temple. Next, the storyteller gives more specific information about how these Levites took care of the articles of the temple. Remember that every time people took the articles out, these Levites counted the articles. And every time people put the articles back, these Levites counted the articles again. Remember that the Levites probably counted the articles to make sure no one stole or lost these things.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate “articles” in this passage? Other ways to translate this could be utensils, tools, or dishes. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Describe a common job in your community. First, give an overall description of the job. Then, tell more specific details about the job. How will you translate this part of the first scene that tells the general work of these Levites to take care of the utensils of service, and then the specific details about how the Levites did this work? Pause this audio here.

In the next part of the first scene, the storyteller describes the role of other Levites who took care of the furniture, other holy utensils in the sanctuary, flour, wine, oil, incense, and spices. In the original language, the storyteller does not say who put these Levites in charge of these things. In your language, it may be better to translate this as, “Someone assigned these Levites” or “Someone gave these Levites the duty to take care of these things.”

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this part of the passage about the Levites who were in charge of the furniture, other holy utensils in the sanctuary, flour, wine, oil, incense, and spices? Pause this audio here.

So far in this passage, Levites are in charge of all of the articles, tools, and food in the temple. But in the final part of the first scene, we see that only priests could mix the spices. Remember that not all Levites are priests. Levites are all descendants of Levi, but priests are a special group of Levites who are the sons, or descendants, of Aaron, who was also a descendant of Levi. In the original language, the storyteller says that “the sons of the priests” can mix the spices. “Sons of the priests” is another way to say “priests.”

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about two different kinds of jobs in your community, where one job is a job that many people could do, and another job is a job that only certain, special people can do. Pay attention to how you show a difference or contrast between the two jobs. How will you show the difference between the work of the Levites and the work of the priests who mix the spices? Pause this audio here.

The second scene is about the special offering bread in the temple. First, we learn the name of the man who made this bread. We also learn this man’s tribe, his father’s name, his clan, and his birth order. The man’s name was Mattithiah, and he was a Levite. Mattithiah was the firstborn son of Shallum, of the Korahite clan. Then, we learn about Mattithiah’s job. Mattithiah had the permanent job to bake the offering bread. Mattithiah was trustworthy and reliable, and that is why Mattithiah had this important job to bake the bread for the offerings. The original language does not say offerings, but we know that the priests used this bread for offerings to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Describe an important person in your community. Include information about the person's father, birth order, tribe, job, and anything else that is important to know. What is the best way to introduce Mattithiah in this scene? For example, would it be best to say Mattithiah's name, his father's name, his birth order, clan name, tribe name, or his important job first? What should come next? Also, how can you show that Mattithiah's job was his permanent responsibility? Pause this audio here.

Some of the Kohathites had the responsibility for the bread that people placed on the table every Sabbath and that stayed there throughout the week. Remember that Kohathites are from the clan of Kohath, one of the sons of Levi. Remember that we do not know if these Kohathites only baked this bread, or if they only set it out on the table, or if the Kohathites both baked the bread and set it out on the table. Remember, the bread is sometimes called "showbread" because people set this bread out in two rows on the table. Some other ways to translate this bread are the "bread of the Presence," "showbread," or "bread that people dedicate to Yahweh."

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of what the bread on the table might have looked like. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the bread that the Kohathites prepared every Sabbath? How will you show that the Kohathites were responsible for this special bread? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller describes the musicians in the temple. Some people think there should be a list of names here because it says "now these are" in the original language. However, there is no list of names here.

The musicians were all heads of fathers' houses. This means the musicians were all leaders of their families. The musicians were also all Levites. The musicians lived in rooms in the temple area because the musicians were on duty all the time. These rooms were probably along the outer walls of the temple. The musicians needed to be ready to play music at any time of the day or night.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about your discussion from the previous step about jobs where people are on duty for a certain period of time. What is the best way to translate the idea in this passage that the musicians needed to be available for their work at any time of the day or night? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller gives a summary of all of the men in the last few passages. All of these men were heads of fathers' houses, or leaders of their families. People listed these men's names in their family records. The storyteller says that all these people lived in Jerusalem, but we know that some of these people actually lived in the villages outside of Jerusalem.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:28–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Levites who were in charge of the articles in the temple
- Levites who were in charge of the furniture, other articles, flour, wine, oil, and spices
- Priests who mixed the spices
- Mattithiah
- Some Kohathites who put bread on the table
- Levites who were musicians
- And all the Levites who were heads of their families

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Some of the Levites took care of the utensils and articles that people used for worship in the temple. These Levites counted the articles when people took the articles out, and the Levites counted the articles again when people brought the articles back in. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Levites who were in charge of the articles of the temple, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We are proud to have this important job to take care of the articles of the temple; or
- We want to be very careful to count all of the articles correctly because we do not want anything to get lost in the temple of Yahweh; or
- We always feel relieved when we finish counting the articles people bring back from the temple and see that nothing is missing.

Continue the drama. Other people took care of the equipment and other articles in the temple. This included flour, wine, olive oil, incense, and spices. Some priests mixed the spices. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Levites who were in charge of the furniture, other articles, flour, wine, oil, and spices, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- Our role is important because we prepare the equipment and food that people use to worship Yahweh; or
- We want to do our work very carefully so that everything is prepared correctly for the worship service to Yahweh; or
- We are glad that we are not responsible for mixing the spices. It is difficult to mix the spices correctly, and it is better that the priests mix the spices.

Continue the drama. Mattithiah was a Levite. Mattithiah was the first son of Shallum, who was from the Korahite clan. Mattithiah was in charge of making the bread for the offerings in the temple. Some men from the clan of the Kohathites were in charge of preparing the bread that someone set out on the table in the Holy Place every Sabbath. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Mattithiah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel that my job to prepare the bread for the offerings is very important; or
- I do my job to prepare the bread as worship for Yahweh; or
- I am proud that I am from the clan of the Korahites and the tribe of Levites.

Also, ask the people playing the Kohathites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- Our job to prepare the bread of the Presence is a way for us to serve Yahweh; or
- Every time we go into the Holy Place to arrange the bread of the Presence, we feel that we are in Yahweh’s presence; or
- We are thankful for this opportunity to serve Yahweh by preparing the bread every Sabbath to put on the table in the Holy Place.

Continue the drama. The musicians were family leaders in the tribe of the Levites. The musicians stayed in rooms in the temple, and the musicians were ready to play music day and night. Because the musicians were always on duty, the musicians did not have other work to do in the temple besides their work as musicians. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Levites who were musicians, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We are honored to serve as musicians in the temple of Yahweh; or
- We are always ready to play music to help in the worship service to Yahweh; or
- We are relieved that we do not have other work to do in the temple of Yahweh except to play music for the worship of Yahweh.

Continue the drama. These were all of the family leaders of the Levites. People listed all of these Levites in their family records. These men lived in Jerusalem. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Levites who were heads of their families, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We are proud to serve Yahweh in the temple; or
- We hope that we will live a long time and continue to serve Yahweh for all our lives; or
- We want our families to continue to serve Yahweh as we do now.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:28–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Some of the Levites were in charge of the articles of service in the temple. Other Levites were in charge of other articles of service, and over other special articles. You can translate the name of these articles as "holy articles," or "articles of the sanctuary," or holy place. Something that is holy is something that people set apart as special for Yahweh. The holy articles are the special tools and vessels that people used in the holy parts of the tabernacle. Sometimes people call the whole tabernacle the "sanctuary" or holy place, and sometimes people call the special rooms in the tabernacle where only the priests could go "the sanctuary." The tabernacle was a tent that people could move. The tabernacle was where the Israelites worshiped Yahweh. When the Israelites built the temple, it also had a holy place where only priests could enter.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate these special articles? Will you call them **holy articles**, or **articles of the sanctuary**? Refer to the Master Glossary for more information on sanctuary and holy. Pause this audio here.

The Levites in charge of the other articles of service were also in charge of the **flour**, **wine**, **olive oil**, **incense**, and **spices**. People used the flour to make offering bread. Wine was fermented grape juice. Oil is often a symbol of the Holy Spirit. People burned incense in the temple to make a good smell for Yahweh. Spices are a symbol of the prayers that the Israelites offered to Yahweh. Translate flour, wine, olive oil, incense, and spices the same as you have in other parts of the Old Testament. For more information on wine, refer to the Master Glossary.

Sons of the **priests** were responsible to mix the spices for the temple. In this passage, sons probably means the descendants of the priests who also served as priests. Priests served Yahweh in the temple, and priests were descendants of Aaron. Translate sons and priest the same as you have in previous passages. For information on priests, refer to the Master Glossary. For more information on sons when it refers to all descendants, refer to descendants in the Master Glossary.

Mattithiah was the person who made the offering bread for the temple. Mattithiah was a Levite. **Levites** were people from the tribe of Levi who worked in the temple but were not priests. Translate Levites in the same way as you have in previous passages. For more information on Levites, refer to the Master Glossary.

Mattithiah made the bread for the grain offerings. Even though the word "offering" is not in the original language, it may be helpful to refer to offering and grain offering in the Master Glossary to remember how and why the Israelites made offerings to Yahweh.

Some of the Kohathites prepared the bread that the people put on the table in the Holy Place in the temple every Sabbath. People call this special bread the bread of the Presence, because it is in the holy place of the tabernacle where Yahweh's presence lives. The Sabbath is the seventh day of the week for the Israelites, and it is a day of rest. Translate Sabbath the same as you have in other parts of the Old Testament. For information on Sabbath and bread of the Presence, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate **Sabbath** and **bread of the Presence** in this passage? Pause this audio here.

The musicians stayed in rooms at the **temple**. Use the same word for temple as you have used previously, and refer to temple in the Master Glossary for more information.

All of these people were the **leaders** of their **fathers' families** or **households**. A household includes all the people who live in a house. But people could also use the word household, or house, to mean a large group of people who did not live in the same house, but who were part of a larger group. So, we know that these men were leaders of the groups of their families. Other ways to translate this could be clan leaders, family leaders, heads of families, or leaders of the clans. Translate leaders of families in the same way as you have in previous passages. For more information on household, refer to the Master Glossary.

These men were leaders according to their **generations**. This means these leaders are in the list of names that belong to the same ancestor. People call this list a **genealogy**, so you may say that these men were leaders in their genealogy. A generation is a group of people who live at the same time and who belong to the same age group. Translate generation, or genealogy, in the same way as you have in previous passages. For more information about listing generations of people, refer to genealogy and generation in the Master Glossary.

All of these men lived in **Jerusalem**. Jerusalem is the most important city in Israel. Use the same word for Jerusalem as you have in previous passages. For more information on Jerusalem, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 9:28–34

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (897 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (9.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.0 MB)

- Speaking the Word (805 KB)

1 Chronicles 9:35–44

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 9:35–44 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:35–44 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:35–44 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller finished a four-part story that listed the people who returned to Jerusalem after their exile to Babylon. Now, in this passage, the storyteller repeats the genealogy of Saul, the first king of Israel. The storyteller repeats Saul's family here because the following story is about Saul's death.

In this passage, the storyteller lists the genealogy, or ancestors and descendants, of Saul. This passage is very similar to another passage earlier in 1 Chronicles, where the storyteller also listed the family of Saul. Here, some of the names seem different when people see them written, but they are the same names.

This passage begins with Jeiel, the father of Gibeon. Gibeon is the name of a city, and not the name of a person. "Father of Gibeon" probably means that Jeiel started the city of Gibeon, or that Jeiel was the leader of Gibeon. Remember that Gibeon was an important city in the land of the tribe of Benjamin.

Stop here and look at a map that includes the city of Gibeon as a group. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk again about someone in your community who started a town, village, or city. Describe how this person started the town, village, or city. Pause this audio here.

Jeiel lives in the city of Gibeon, and Jeiel's wife's name is Maacah. Jeiel has 10 sons. Remember that in the previous passage in 1 Chronicles about Saul's family, the storyteller listed only eight of Jeiel's sons. But now we hear the names of all 10 of Jeiel's sons. These names include Ner and Mikloth, who are not in the previous passage. Jeiel's firstborn or eldest son is Abdon. Jeiel's other sons are Zur, Kish, Baal, Ner, Nadab, Gedor, Ahio, Zechariah, and Mikloth. The storyteller lists these sons in the order in which the sons were born. In the previous passage of 1 Chronicles about Saul's family, the storyteller called Zechariah "Zecher." Mikloth is the father of Shimeam, whom the storyteller called "Shimeah" in the previous passage about Saul's family.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember the conversation from the previous passage about Saul's family and how people on your translation team might say the names of your team members in different ways. Talk about other names that you know that people might say in different ways. Pause this audio here.

In this next part of the passage, the storyteller gives the same information we heard in the previous passage about Saul's family. However, this part of the passage is difficult to understand because we are not sure which people the storyteller is saying lived near their relatives in Jerusalem, or who those relatives were. Some people think that these words in the passage mean that some of the people of the tribe of Benjamin moved from Gibeon to Jerusalem. Other people think that this passage says that Jeiel and his wife lived in Gibeon, and all of Jeiel's sons lived in Jerusalem. Finally, other people think that maybe only Mikloth and Shimeam lived in Jerusalem. If it is Mikloth and Shimeam who live in Jerusalem, that means that, unlike their brothers, Mikloth and Shimeam

lived in Jerusalem with other people from the tribe of Benjamin, and not with their own brothers. Remember that the other sons of Jeiel probably lived in the city of Gibeon.

Stop here and look at a map that includes Jerusalem and Gibeon as a group. Pause this audio here.

Most of the rest of this passage is about the descendants of Ner, one of the 10 sons of Jeiel. The storyteller does not talk about any descendants from the other sons of Jeiel, besides Mikloth's son, Shimeam.

Ner is the father of Kish, and Kish is the father of Saul, the first king of Israel. It is surprising that the storyteller says Ner is the father of Kish, because another passage in the Old Testament says that Abiel is the father of Kish.

Saul has four sons: Jonathan, Malki-Shua, Abinadab, and Esh-Baal. In the following passage about Saul's death, the storyteller only lists three of Saul's sons: Jonathan, Malki-Shua, and Esh-Baal. This passage is difficult to understand because we learn here and in the previous passage that Saul has four sons and many descendants, but in the passage that follows this one, the storyteller says that all of Saul's family died with Saul. We are not sure why the storyteller says that all of Saul's family died with Saul, because we see here that Saul had many descendants.

In other parts of the Old Testament, sometimes Saul's son Esh-Baal has the name Ish-Bosheth, and sometimes Jonathan's son Merib-Baal has the name Mephibosheth. It is possible that people in Israel changed these names because it was shameful to have a son with the same name as the Canaanite god, Baal. The new names end with Bosheth, which means "shame" in the original language.

Jonathan's son Merib-Baal is the father of Micah. Micah's sons are Pithon, Melech, and Tahrea. In the previous passage in 1 Chronicles about Saul's family, the storyteller called Tahrea "Tarea," and here the storyteller says that Micah has a fourth son named Ahaz. In this current passage, the storyteller does not include the name Ahaz in the list of Micah's sons, but it is likely that Micah did have four sons because the next name in the list is Ahaz. Ahaz is the father of Jadah. The storyteller calls Jadah "Jehoaddah" in the earlier passage in 1 Chronicles. Jehoaddah and Jadah are the same person.

Jadah has three sons whose names are Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri. Zimri is the father of Moza, and Moza is the father of Binea. Most people think that the correct translation of the next part of this passage is that Binea is the father of Rephaiah, Rephaiah is the father of Eleasah, and Eleasah is the father of Azel. But some people think that Binea, Rephaiah, Eleasah, and Azel are all sons of Moza because it says, "Rephaiah his son," and this could mean Moza is the father of Rephaiah. In the previous passage of 1 Chronicles about Saul's family, the storyteller calls Rephaiah "Raphah."

Azel has six sons whose names are Azrikam, Bokeru, Ishmael, Shearіah, Obadiah, and Hanan. In the original language, "Bokeru" is very similar to the word for "firstborn", so some people think this means that Azrikam is Azel's firstborn son. If a translation says "Azrikam the firstborn," then there is one son's name missing from the six sons of Azel in this passage. The storyteller repeats the information again that "these were the sons of Azel."

In the earlier passage in 1 Chronicles, the storyteller also includes the names of Eshek's sons and grandsons. In this passage, we do not hear any information about Eshek or Eshek's family.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:35–44 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: Jeiel has 10 sons. One of Jeiel's sons is Ner. These people all live near their relatives in Jerusalem.

In the second scene: Saul's grandfather is Ner, and Saul's father is Kish. Saul has four sons.

In the third scene: Saul's son Jonathan has a son named Merib-Baal. Merib-Baal's son is Micah, and Micah has four sons. One of Micah's sons is Ahaz.

1 Chronicles 9:35–44

In the fourth scene: Ahaz's son is Jadah. Jadah has three sons, including one son named Zimri. Zimri is the father of Moza, Moza is the father of Binea, Binea is the father of Rephaiah, Rephaiah is the father of Eleasah, and Eleasah is the father of Azel.

In the fifth scene: Azel has six sons.

The characters in this passage are:

- Jeiel
- Jeiel's 10 sons: Abdon, Zur, Kish, Baal, Ner, Nadab, Gedor, Ahio, Zechariah, and Mikloth
- Mikloth's son Shimeam
- Kish, the son of Ner
- Saul, the son of Kish
- Saul's four sons: Jonathan, Malki-Shua, Abinadab, and Esh-Baal
- Merib-Baal, the son of Jonathan
- Micah, the son of Merib-Baal
- Micah's four sons: Pithon, Melech, Tahrea, and Ahaz
- Jadah, the son of Ahaz
- Jadah's three sons: Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri
- Moza, the son of Zimri
- Binea, the son of Moza
- Rephaiah, the son of Binea
- Eleasah, the son of Rephaiah
- Azel, the son of Eleasah
- And Azel's six sons: Azrikam, Bokeru, Ishmael, Sheariah, Obadiah, and Hanan

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in the previous four passages, the storyteller told about the exiles who returned to Jerusalem. Before those four passages, the storyteller listed the ancestors and descendants of Saul. Now, the storyteller repeats the list of the ancestors and descendants of Saul. The storyteller wants listeners to remember the family of Saul, the first king of Israel, before the storyteller talks about Saul's death in the next passage.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story that includes important information at the beginning about one of the main characters of the story. Then, include a few other important stories or ideas. Then, return to the first main character. How do you reintroduce the main character and that person's part in the story? Pause this audio here.

This passage is very similar to the previous passage in 1 Chronicles about Saul's family. To help you remember the way you translated parts of the previous passage about Saul's family, listen to the previous passage again.

Stop here and listen to your translation of 1 Chronicles 8:29–40 in your own language. Listen to this previous passage about Saul's family again while you work on this step to help you remember how you translated certain parts of the passage. Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, Jeiel is the father of Gibeon, and Jeiel lives in the city of Gibeon. Remember that Gibeon is a city, and not a person. Also, remember that "father of Gibeon" probably means that Jeiel started the city of Gibeon. Be sure to translate "father of Gibeon" the same way as you did in the previous passage of 1 Chronicles about Saul's family. Gibeon is a city about 10 kilometers northwest of Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a map of the city of Gibeon again as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

Jeiel also has a wife. Jeiel's wife's name is Maacah. It is likely that Maacah also lives in the city of Gibeon with her husband, Jeiel. Your team may choose to translate this part of the passage to say that Jeiel and his wife lived in Gibeon. Make sure to check how you translated this part of the passage in the previous passage about Saul's family, and translate it the same way here.

Remember that Jeiel has 10 sons. Remember that here, the storyteller lists both Ner and Mikloth as sons of Jeiel. Also, remember that in the previous passage, the storyteller calls Zechariah "Zecher" and Shimeam "Shimeah."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Decide if you want to translate the names Zechariah and Shimeam the same way as you did in the previous passage in 1 Chronicles about Saul's family, or if you want to translate the names as Zechariah and Shimeam here. How will you show that Zechariah is the same person as Zecher and Shimeam is the same person as Shimeah? Pause this audio here.

In the final part of this scene, we learn that "they lived near their relatives in Jerusalem." Remember that it is hard to know who lived near their relatives in Jerusalem, and who the relatives were. In the original language, the storyteller says they lived both "with their relatives" and "opposite their relatives." Many people think "with their relatives" and "opposite their relatives" are two ways to describe the same idea. The word "opposite" can also mean "unlike." Here are some translations you can choose for this part of this passage:

- Some of the people of the tribe of Benjamin moved from Gibeon to Jerusalem. These people who moved to Jerusalem lived near, or alongside, their relatives; or
- Jeiel and his family lived in Gibeon, and all of Jeiel's sons lived in Jerusalem near their other relatives; or
- Unlike their brothers, Mikloth and his son Shimeam lived in Jerusalem. The rest of the sons of Jeiel lived in Gibeon. Mikloth and Shimeam lived alongside other people from the tribe of Benjamin.

Pay attention to how you translated this part of the passage in the previous passage in 1 Chronicles about Saul's family. Be sure to translate it in the same way in this current passage.

Stop here and look at a map of Jerusalem again as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Ner is the father of Kish. Kish is the father of Saul, the first king of Israel. This part about Saul and his ancestors and descendants is probably the most important part of this passage. Remember that Ner is one of Jeiel's sons.

Saul has four sons. Saul's sons are Jonathan, Malki-Shua, Abinadab, and Esh-Baal. Remember that in the passage after this current passage, the storyteller only lists three of Saul's sons. Also, Esh-Baal is the same person as Ish-Bosheth from another part of the Old Testament. In the original language, "bosheth" means shame, and people who wrote 1 Chronicles probably changed the name from Baal to Bosheth because Baal was a Canaanite god. Decide if you want to translate the name Esh-Baal the same way as you did in the previous passage about Saul's family, or if you want to translate Esh-Baal as Ish-Bosheth.

In the third scene, Saul's son Jonathan has a son whose name is Merib-Baal. Merib-Baal is the same person as Mephibosheth. Other parts of the Old Testament call Jonathan's son "Mephibosheth." Again, decide as a group how you want to translate the name Merib-Baal in this passage.

Merib-Baal has a son named Micah. Micah has three sons whose names are Pithon, Melech, and Tahrea. In the earlier passage of 1 Chronicles about Saul's family, the storyteller calls Tahrea "Tarea." Decide how you want to translate Tahrea in this passage.

In the previous passage about Saul's family, the storyteller says that Micah has a fourth son whose name is Ahaz. Remember that the name Ahaz is not in the original language, but we know from the previous passage about Saul's family that Micah also had a son named Ahaz. It is probably best to include the name Ahaz in this current passage about the family of Saul.

In the fourth scene, we learn about the descendants of Ahaz. Ahaz is the father of Jadah. Remember that the storyteller calls Jadah "Jehoaddah" in the previous passage about Saul's family. Decide how you want to translate Jadah in this passage.

Jadah has three sons whose names are Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri. Zimri has a son whose name is Moza. Moza has a son named Binea. Binea is the father of Rephaiah. Rephaiah is the father of Eleasah. And Eleasah is the father of Azel. Remember that in the earlier passage of 1 Chronicles about Saul's family, the storyteller calls Rephaiah "Raphah." Your team should decide how you want to translate Rephaiah's name in this passage.

In the fifth scene, Azel has six sons named Azrikam, Bokeru, Ishmael, Sheariah, Obadiah, and Hanan. Remember that the word "Bokeru" in the original language normally means "firstborn" instead of the name of a person. Be sure to translate the names of Azel's sons the same as you did in the previous passage of 1 Chronicles about Saul's family.

The storyteller repeats again that all of these men were the sons of Azel.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:35–44 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Jeiel
- Jeiel's 10 sons: Abdon, Zur, Kish, Baal, Ner, Nadab, Gedor, Ahio, Zechariah, and Mikloth
- Mikloth's son Shimeam
- Kish, the son of Ner
- Saul, the son of Kish
- Saul's four sons: Jonathan, Malki-Shua, Abinadab, and Esh-Baal
- Merib-Baal, the son of Jonathan
- Micah, the son of Merib-Baal
- Micah's four sons: Pithon, Melech, Tahrea, and Ahaz
- Jadah, the son of Ahaz
- Jadah's three sons: Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri
- Moza, the son of Zimri
- Binea, the son of Moza
- Rephaiah, the son of Binea
- Eleasah, the son of Rephaiah
- Azel, the son of Eleasah
- And Azel's six sons: Azrikam, Bokeru, Ishmael, Shearіah, Obadiah, and Hanan

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Jeiel started the city of Gibeon. Jeiel lived in Gibeon, and Jeiel's wife's name was Maacah. Jeiel's firstborn son was Abdon. Jeiel's other sons were Zur, Kish, Baal, Ner, Nadab, Gedor, Ahio, Zechariah, and Mikloth. Mikloth was the father of Shimeam. Unlike their brothers, Mikloth and Shimeam lived in Jerusalem near their other relatives. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jeiel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that I have so many sons. Yahweh blessed me with these children; or
- I worked hard to start the city of Gibeon, and I am proud of the city that I built; or
- I am glad that Gibeon is such an important city in Israel.

Continue the drama. Ner was the father of Kish. Kish was the father of King Saul. Saul was the father of Jonathan, Malki-Shua, Abinadab, and Esh-Baal. Jonathan was the father of Merib-Baal, and Merib-Baal was the father of Micah. Micah was the father of Pithon, Melech, Tahrea, and Ahaz. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Saul, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am proud to be the first king of Israel; or
- I named my youngest son Esh-Baal because my wife likes the Canaanite god, Baal; or
- I am proud of my oldest son, Jonathan.

Also, ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We wonder why the storyteller wants to tell us about Saul again. We already heard all of Saul's ancestors and descendants in an earlier story; or
- We wonder why King Saul named his youngest son Esh-Baal, and why Jonathan named his son Merib-Baal. Those do not seem like good names for the son and grandson of the king of Israel because Baal is a false god; or
- We know that Saul did not have a good end to his life. We wonder if the storyteller will describe Saul's death next.

Continue the drama. Ahaz was the father of Jadah, and Jadah was the father of Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri. Zimri has a son named Moza. Moza has a son named Binea. Binea is the father of Rephaiah, Rephaiah is the father of Eleasah, and Eleasah is the father of Azel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ahaz, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that I am a descendant of Benjamin; or
- I am also glad that I am a descendant of Saul, the first king of Israel; or
- I am proud that I have so many descendants.

Continue the drama. Azel had six sons. Azrikam was Azel's firstborn son. Azel's other sons were Bokeru, Ishmael, Sheariah, Obadiah, and Hanan. These were all of Azel's sons. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Azel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that I have six sons; or
- I am proud that I am a descendant of Saul, the first king of Israel; or
- I am happy that I am a descendant of Benjamin in the tribe of Benjamin.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 9:35–44 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Jeiel founded, or started, the city of Gibeon. Gibeon was one of the cities in the land of the tribe of Benjamin where Levites could also live.

One of Jeiel's 10 sons was Mikloth. Mikloth and his son, Shimeam, lived near their other **relatives**, or family members, in **Jerusalem**. "Relatives" is a general term for any type of family member, even people who are distant family members. Jerusalem is the most important city in Israel. Use the same words for relatives and for Jerusalem as you used in previous passages. For more information on Jerusalem, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this passage, we learn the names of the ancestors and descendants of Saul. Sometimes, "**sons**" means descendants, but here it means the son of a father. Use the same word for son as you have in previous passages. For more information on sons, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 9:35–44

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (929 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (8.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (918 KB)
- Speaking the Word (1012 KB)

1 Chronicles 10:1–14

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 10:1–14 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 10:1–14 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 10:1–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, we heard King Saul's family history. The storyteller started with Saul's great-grandfather Jeiel and ended with his descendant Moza, who came from the family line of Saul's son Jonathan. Saul's family history connects Israel's past with Saul and the time when David began to rule over Israel.

Now, in this story, the storyteller begins a new section of 1 Chronicles. The storyteller describes the last battle between King Saul and the Philistines to show how Saul's rule over Israel ended. The storyteller bases the story on the battle that the storyteller in 1 Samuel 31 describes, but some details are different.

Stop here. If you have already translated 1 Samuel 31, listen to the recording now as a team. Pause this audio here.

The Philistines fight against the Israelites on Mount Gilboa in the Valley of Jezreel. The Philistines kill many Israelite soldiers, and the Israelite army starts to lose the battle. The Israelites must retreat. The Israelites, including King Saul and his sons, run away quickly to save their lives. But the Philistines catch up to Saul and his sons and kill three of Saul's sons: Jonathan, Abinadab, and Malki-Shua. We know that Saul has another son, Ish-Bosheth, who survives, but we do not know if Ish-Bosheth was in the battle. The word "kill" here means to use a weapon, like a sword or spear, to strike someone and cause that person to die.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and locate Mount Gilboa, where the Israelites and Philistines fought this battle. Pause this audio here.

The Philistines fight fiercely against Saul. After they kill Saul's sons, the Philistines get close to where Saul is. The Philistines attack hard and fight the men who are still with Saul, including Saul's bodyguard. Then the arrows that the enemies' archers shoot from their bows hit Saul. The arrows wound Saul very badly. Saul's wounds are so bad that he is about to die, and Saul has no chance to escape.

Stop here and look as a group at a picture of the bow and arrows. Pause this audio here.

Then Saul asks his armor-bearer to pull out his sword and kill Saul by stabbing him. An armor-bearer is a young man who helps an older soldier or leader by carrying extra weapons and equipment. Saul wants his armor-bearer to kill Saul because Saul is afraid the Philistines will kill Saul slowly and painfully. Saul thinks it would be more shameful and painful if the Philistines killed Saul. Saul also worries that the Philistines will mock Saul and hurt him for their own entertainment. Saul calls the Philistines "uncircumcised fellows," a negative term the Israelites used. The Israelites circumcised all Israelite male children as a sign of their special agreement with God, and the Israelites looked down on uncircumcised men. The armor-bearer refuses to kill Saul because he is afraid to harm the king of Israel, whom God appointed. Since Saul's armor-bearer will not kill Saul, Saul pulls out his own sword and kills himself by falling on the sword's point.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about times in your people's history when a leader ended their own life because an enemy hurt them or because their own army was losing a fight. Pause this audio here.

When Saul's armour-bearer sees that Saul is dead—either because he sees Saul kill himself or because he sees Saul's dead body—the armor-bearer throws himself on the point of his own sword and kills himself. The armour-bearer dies with Saul. This means the armor-bearer dies at about the same time, in the same place, and in the same way as Saul.

In that way, Saul and three of Saul's sons die. The men die on the same day along with "all of Saul's house." The phrase "all of Saul's house" means Saul's extended family and anyone who could become king after Saul. Saul and these people all die in the same battle on the same day.

The storyteller pauses the story about the battle between Israel and the Philistines to explain what happens after the Philistines win. When the Israelite people who live in the Jezreel Valley realise that the Israelite army ran away and that Saul and three of Saul's sons have died, the people run away from their cities quickly to live somewhere else. These people do not destroy their homes or buildings. The people just abandon the buildings. Then the Philistine soldiers and their families move into the empty cities, live there, and take control of the area.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Israel and locate the area from where the Israelites ran away and where the Philistines took over. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller now goes back to the story of the battle. The day after the fight, the Philistine soldiers go back to Mount Gilboa to take valuable things from the dead Israelite soldiers. The Philistines "strip the slain." This means the Philistines take weapons and armour from the Israelite soldiers whom they killed with swords. While they do this, the Philistines find Saul and his three sons lying dead.

The Philistine soldiers take off Saul's armour and cut Saul's head off. Saul's "armour" also refers to Saul's weapons. So the Philistines remove Saul's military clothes and the weapons Saul had carried, like his sword, shield, and spear. After this, the Philistines send men all over the land of Philistia to announce the good news that Saul is dead and that the Philistines won the battle. These men possibly carry Saul's weapons and armour as proof of victory. The Philistine messengers announce the good news of the victory to their idols and their people. An

idol is an object that people make to represent the god they worship. The Philistine men also tell the news to the Philistine people, possibly in public places like markets or smaller worship areas. People spread this news quickly from person to person and from town to town throughout the land of Philistia.

Stop here and look as a group at pictures of Saul's armour and weapons. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group how people in your community used to spread important news, whether good or bad, that affected the whole nation. Then, discuss how people spread important news now. Pause this audio here.

The Philistines put Saul's armour and weapons in a temple of one of their gods. A temple was a building where people showed statues or pictures of their god and prayed to those images. The Philistines hang Saul's head in the temple of Dagon, another one of their false gods. The Philistines probably stick Saul's head on a pole or attach it to a wall inside Dagon's temple. The Philistines want to honour Dagon as the god who helped them win against Saul and Israel. This is the Philistines' way of saying that their god is stronger than the God of Israel. When the Philistines show Saul's armour, weapons, and head in their gods' temples, the Philistines embarrass Israel and insult the God of Israel. When the Philistines do not bury Saul's body, the Philistines shame Saul and the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What do people in your people group do to show gratitude to false gods after a war victory? Pause this audio here.

When the people in Jabesh Gilead hear that the Philistines insulted Saul's dead body, the brave warriors from Jabesh Gilead decide to act. The warriors leave their city and go to get the bodies of Saul and Saul's sons. Jabesh is in Gilead, on the east side of the Jordan River, about 34–40 kilometers from Mount Gilboa. The story does not say exactly where the Philistine temples are, but they are probably near Mount Gilboa, where people fought the battle. The people of Jabesh, who are Israelites, feel grateful to Saul because Saul saved them from the Ammonites in the past.

The brave warriors bring back Saul's dead body and the bodies of Saul's sons to Jabesh. The warriors bury the bones of Saul and Saul's three sons under an oak tree that many people probably knew well in Jabesh. The warriors do this to honour Saul and his sons. Then the people of Jabesh fast, or stop eating, for seven days to show their sadness and to honour Saul after his death.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Israel and locate the city of Jabesh in Gilead. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of an oak tree. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are the burial customs in your people group? What do people do to honour a dead person? Talk about the burial of a special person in your people group who people honoured after their death. What did the person do to earn the honour? How did people honour that person? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller explains what happened in the story. Saul died because he was not faithful or obedient to Yahweh and did not follow Yahweh's commands. The storyteller might mean that Saul did not usually follow Yahweh's commands, or the storyteller might mean that Saul did not obey Yahweh when the prophet Samuel told Saul something Yahweh said to do. One time, Saul even asked a woman who talked to spirits of dead people for advice, even though Yahweh told the Israelites not to do that. Since Saul did not ask Yahweh for help, Yahweh punished Saul. Yahweh killed Saul, took the kingdom away from Saul, and gave the kingdom to David, the son of Jesse.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 10:1–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has eight scenes.

1 Chronicles 10:1–14

In the first scene: The Philistines fight the Israelites on Mount Gilboa and kill many Israelite soldiers. The Israelites, including King Saul and three of Saul's sons, run away quickly. The Philistines catch up to them and kill Saul's sons.

In the second scene: The Philistines fight fiercely against Saul and get close to where Saul is. Then the archers' arrows hit Saul and wound him very badly. Saul asks his armor-bearer to kill Saul, but the armor-bearer refuses because he is scared. Saul kills himself by falling on the point of his sword. When Saul's armor-bearer sees this, the armor-bearer throws himself on the point of his own sword and kills himself.

In the third scene: The storyteller summarises what happened that day. Saul and three of Saul's sons die. They die on the same day along with all of Saul's extended family.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller pauses the story about the battle between Israel and the Philistines to tell what happens after the Philistines won. The Israelite people who live in the Jezreel Valley realise that the Israelite army fled or ran away and that Saul and three of Saul's sons died. The Israelites flee or run away from their cities to live somewhere else. Then the Philistine soldiers and their families come into the empty cities and live there.

In the fifth scene: The storyteller returns to the story of the battle. The day after the fight, the Philistine soldiers go back to Mount Gilboa to take valuable things like weapons and armour from the dead Israelite soldiers. The Philistines find Saul and his three sons lying dead, and the Philistines remove Saul's military clothes and the weapons he carried and cut off his head. The Philistines send men all over the land of Philistia to announce the good news that Saul is dead and that the Philistines won the battle with their gods and their people.

In the sixth scene: The Philistines put Saul's armour and weapons in a temple of one of their gods. The Philistines fasten Saul's head in the temple of Dagon, another one of their false gods.

In the seventh scene: When the people in the city of Jabesh Gilead hear the news about how the Philistines insulted Saul's dead body, all the brave warriors from Jabesh Gilead leave their city and go to get the bodies of Saul and his sons. The warriors take Saul's dead body and the bodies of his sons and carry them back to Jabesh. Afterwards, the warriors bury the bones of Saul and his three sons under a large tree. The people of Jabesh fast, or stop eating, for seven days.

In the eighth scene: Now the storyteller explains what happened in the story. Saul died because he was not faithful or obedient to Yahweh and did not follow Yahweh's commands. Since Saul did not ask Yahweh for help, but asked for help from a woman who speaks to spirits of dead people, Yahweh punished Saul by killing him. Yahweh took the kingdom away from Saul and gave it to David, the son of Jesse.

The characters in this passage are:

- Philistine army
- Israelite army
- King Saul
- Three of Saul's sons: Jonathan, Abinadab, and Malki-Shua
- Philistine archers
- Saul's armor-bearer
- Saul's extended family, who died with Saul
- Israelites, or Israelite people who lived on the other side of the Jezreel Valley and beyond the Jordan River, who ran away from their homes
- Philistines, or Philistine people
- Israelite people who lived in the city of Jabesh in the region of Gilead
- And brave Israelite warriors from the city of Jabesh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller now uses language that introduces a new event. The Philistines fight the Israelites on Mount Gilboa in the Valley of Jezreel. The Philistines kill many Israelite soldiers. The Israelites, including King Saul and his sons, run away quickly to save their lives. But the Philistines catch up to Saul and his sons and kill three

of Saul's sons: Jonathan, Abinadab, and Malki-Shua. Here, the storyteller repeats the word "Philistines" several times to stress that it was the Philistines who killed the Israelites.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and locate Mount Gilboa, where the Israelites and Philistines fought this battle. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are the natural ways in your language to stress that it was the Philistines who killed the Israelites? Pause this audio here.

The Philistines fight fiercely against Saul. The Philistines get close to where Saul is. The Philistines attack hard and fight the men who are still with Saul, including Saul's armor-bearer. Then the archers shoot their arrows, and they hit Saul. The arrows wound Saul very badly. Saul is in severe pain from the arrows, and Saul cannot move easily.

Stop here and look as a group at a picture of the bow and arrows. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and talk as a group about how you will say that the enemy archers shoot their arrows and that the arrows hit Saul. Pause this audio here.

Then Saul asks his armor-bearer to pull out his sword and kill Saul by stabbing him. Saul wants his armor-bearer to kill Saul because Saul is afraid the Philistines will kill Saul slowly and painfully. Saul also worries that the Philistines will mock Saul and hurt him for their own entertainment. Saul calls the Philistines "uncircumcised fellows," a negative term the Israelites used. The armor-bearer is very scared and refuses to kill Saul. Since Saul's armor-bearer will not kill him, Saul pulls out his own sword and kills himself by falling on the sword's point.

Stop here and talk as a group about negative words or nicknames that people in your community use to describe people from enemy nations or people groups. Pause this audio here.

When Saul's armour-bearer sees that Saul is dead, the armor-bearer throws himself on the point of his own sword and kills himself. This means that the armour-bearer pushes himself onto the point of his own sword to make it go into his body and end his life. The armour-bearer dies at about the same time, in the same place, and in the same way as Saul.

Stop here and, as a group, discuss how you will describe how Saul's armour-bearer throws himself or pushes himself onto the point of his own sword. Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller summarises what happened that day. Saul, three of Saul's sons, and all of Saul's extended family die in battle on the same day.

The storyteller pauses the story about the battle between Israel and the Philistines to tell what happens after the Philistines win. When the Israelite people who live in the Jezreel Valley realise that the Israelite army ran away and that Saul and three of Saul's sons have died, the people run away from their cities quickly to live somewhere else. The storyteller says that the people "run away" twice in this story to show that the Israelite army runs away quickly, and the Israelite people also run away in a similar way. Then the Philistine soldiers and their families come into the empty cities, live there, and take control of the area.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a map of Israel and locate the area from where the Israelites ran away and where the Philistines took over. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller now goes back to the story of the battle. The day after the fight, the Philistine soldiers go back to Mount Gilboa to take valuable things like weapons and armour from the dead Israelite soldiers. While the Philistines do this, the Philistines find Saul and his three sons lying dead.

The Philistine soldiers take off Saul's armour and cut off Saul's head. Saul's "armour" also refers to Saul's weapons. So the Philistines remove Saul's military clothes and the weapons Saul carried, like his sword, shield, and spear. After this, the Philistines send men all over the land of Philistia to tell the good news that Saul is dead and that the Philistines won the battle. These men announce the good news in the temples of their idols and to the Philistine people, possibly in public places like markets or smaller worship areas.

Stop here and look, as a group, at pictures of Saul's armour and weapons. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words you have in your language for armour and weapons. What do soldiers in your people group wear for battle? Pause this audio here.

The Philistines put Saul's armour and weapons in a temple of one of their gods. The Philistines fasten Saul's head in the temple of Dagon, another one of their false gods. When the Philistines fasten Saul's head, they probably drive something through it, like a tent peg, and then drive that tent peg into a pole or wall inside Dagon's temple. The story does not mention the location of either temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group which word or phrase you will use to say that the Philistines fastened Saul's head in the temple. Talk about different words that you have in your language that mean to fasten or to attach. Pause this audio here.

But when the people in Jabesh Gilead hear that the Philistines insulted Saul's dead body, the brave warriors from Jabesh Gilead take action. The warriors leave their city and travel to get the bodies of Saul and his sons. Jabesh is in Gilead, on the east side of the Jordan River, about 34–40 kilometers from Mount Gilboa, near where the Philistine temples probably were. The warriors bring Saul's dead body and his sons' bodies back to Jabesh. Then the warriors bury the bones of Saul and Saul's three sons under an oak tree that was likely famous in Jabesh. After that, the people of Jabesh fast, or stop eating, for seven days to mourn the deaths of Saul and his sons.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: The "brave warriors" were the "most courageous warriors" in the army. What words do you have in your language to describe someone like that? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: The storyteller calls the city of Jabesh "Jabesh Gilead" in this story to show that it was Jabesh in the region of Gilead. If your country has cities or towns with the same name but in different regions, how do you tell them apart? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of an oak tree. Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller makes it clear to us that he is going to explain what happened in the story. Saul died because he did not trust Yahweh and did not keep the word of Yahweh, which means that Saul did not obey Yahweh. The storyteller reminds us that Saul even asked a woman who talked to spirits of dead people for advice, even though Yahweh told the Israelites not to do that. Since Saul did not ask Yahweh for help, Yahweh punished Saul. Yahweh killed Saul, took the kingdom away from Saul, and gave the kingdom to David, the son of Jesse.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What will you say to show that now the storyteller is explaining what happened in the story? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 10:1–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has eight scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Philistine army
- Israelite army
- King Saul
- Three of Saul's sons: Jonathan, Abinadab, and Malki-Shua
- Philistine archers
- Saul's armor-bearer
- Saul's extended family, who died with Saul
- Israelites, or Israelite people who lived on the other side of the Jezreel Valley and beyond the Jordan River, who fled their homes
- Philistines, or Philistine people
- Israelite people who lived in the city of Jabesh in the region of Gilead

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- And brave Israelite warriors from the city of Jabesh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The Philistines fight the Israelites on Mount Gilboa in the Valley of Jezreel. The Philistines kill many Israelite soldiers. The Israelites, including King Saul and his sons, run away quickly to save their lives. But the Philistines catch up to Saul and his sons and kill three of Saul's sons: Jonathan, Abinadab, and Malki-Shua. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Philistines, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are so happy that we are winning against the Israelites at last; or
- We are grateful to our gods who are helping us; or
- We are so happy that we killed Saul's three sons. Now we need to kill Saul.

Continue the drama. The Philistines fight fiercely against Saul. The Philistines get close to where Saul is. The Philistines attack hard and fight the men who are still with Saul, including Saul's bodyguard. Then the archers' arrows find their target, Saul, and hit him. The arrows wound Saul very badly.

Then Saul asks his armor-bearer to pull out his sword and kill Saul by stabbing him. Saul wants his armor-bearer to kill Saul because Saul is afraid the Philistines will kill Saul slowly and painfully. The armor-bearer is very scared and refuses to kill Saul. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Saul, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am desperate. My sons are dead and now I am badly wounded; or
- I am afraid that the Philistines will treat me badly; or
- My only hope is to die quickly.

Continue the drama. Since Saul's armor-bearer will not kill him, Saul pulls out his own sword and kills himself by falling on the sword's point. When Saul's armour-bearer sees that Saul is dead, the armor-bearer throws himself on the point of his own sword and kills himself. Saul, three of his sons, and all of Saul's extended family die in battle on the same day. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Saul's armor-bearer, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am scared. King Saul asked me to kill him, but I am here to save Saul's life; or
- I failed at my job. King Saul killed himself; or
- My only hope is to die quickly.

Continue the drama. When the Israelite people who live in the Jezreel Valley realise that the Israelite army ran away and that Saul and three of Saul's sons have died, the people run away from their cities quickly to live somewhere else. Then the Philistine soldiers and their families come into the empty cities and live there. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites on the other side of Jezreel Valley and those who live beyond the Jordan River, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are scared because Saul's army has fled, and King Saul is dead; or
- We are really worried! Who is going to protect us from the Philistines now? The Philistines will kill us; or
- We must run away as soon as we can. Yahweh will provide another place for us to live.

Continue the drama. The day after the fight, the Philistine soldiers go back to Mount Gilboa to take valuable things like weapons and armour from the dead Israelite soldiers. While the Philistines do this, the Philistines find Saul and his three sons lying dead.

The Philistine soldiers take off Saul's armour and cut off Saul's head. The Philistines remove Saul's military clothes and the weapons he carried. After this, the Philistines send men all over the land of Philistia to share the good news that Saul is dead and that the Philistines won the battle.

The Philistines put Saul's armour and weapons in a temple of one of their gods. The Philistines fasten Saul's head in the temple of Dagon, another one of their false gods.

When the people in the city of Jabesh Gilead hear the news about how the Philistines insulted Saul's dead body, all the brave warriors from Jabesh Gilead leave their city and go to get the bodies of Saul and his sons. The warriors take Saul's dead body and the bodies of his sons and carry them back to Jabesh. Afterwards, the warriors bury the bones of Saul and his three sons under a large tree. The people of Jabesh fast, or stop eating, for seven days. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of the city of Jabesh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are so sad and angry that the Philistines killed Saul and treated his dead body so disrespectfully; or
- Saul was kind to us and saved us from the Ammonites. We will now get Saul's body and bring it back to our city and bury it in an honourable way; or
- We are so happy that we were able to rescue the bodies of Saul and his sons. We will honour these men by burying their bones under the oak tree and we will fast for seven days.

Continue the drama. The storyteller explains what happened in the story. Saul died because he did not trust and obey Yahweh and did not follow Yahweh's commands. Since Saul did not ask Yahweh for help, but instead asked a woman who speaks to spirits of dead people, Yahweh punished Saul by killing him. Yahweh took the kingdom away from Saul, and gave it to David, the son of Jesse.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 10:1–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The Philistines fight against Israel on Mount Gilboa, and the men of **Israel** run away from the Philistines. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Philistines fight fiercely against Saul. Then the **archers**' arrows find their

target, Saul, and hit him. Use the same word or phrase for archer as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look, as a group, at a picture of the bow and arrows. Pause this audio here.

Then Saul asks his armor-bearer to pull out his **sword** and kill Saul by stabbing him, so that the uncircumcised fellows do not kill Saul slowly and painfully. Use the same word or phrase for sword as you used in previous passages.

Circumcision is the Jewish custom where people cut off the loose skin at the end of a boy's penis. People would perform circumcision when a baby boy was eight days old. The circumcision was a sign that God included the person in the covenant that God had made with Abraham.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **circumcised** and **uncircumcised**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. For more information on circumcision, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Saul and his entire house died. This means that the members of Saul's **household** died. In Israel, a person's household included the children and servants and all the people who lived in the house. Use the same word for household that you have used in previous passages, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information about household.

The Philistines send men all over the land of Philistia to tell the good news that Saul is dead and that the Philistines have won the battle. These men announce the good news to their idols and to the Philistine people. An idol is an object that people make in order to worship a god. The object reminds the people of some characteristics of this god. People make an object or an image of a god and worship that object as if it were that god. God forbade the Israelites in his commandments to ever make such an idol, or image, or to worship anything else besides God himself.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **idol** and **false god**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. For more information on idol and gods, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The Philistines put Saul's armour and weapons in a temple of one of their gods. The Philistines also fasten Saul's head in the house, or temple, of Dagon, another one of their false gods. A temple is a place where people worship their gods. Sometimes people call this a "house" for their god. This temple, or house, was not for Yahweh, but for false gods.

Saul died because he did not trust Yahweh and did not keep the word or commands of Yahweh.

This means that Saul did not obey Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**word of Yahweh**." If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same phrase that you have used there. For more information on Word and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (773 KB)
- Setting the Stage (7.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (9.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.3 MB)

- Filling the Gaps (2.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 11:1–9

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 11:1–9 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:1–9 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller begins the story of David, King of Israel. In the previous story, the storyteller told us about Saul's death and that Saul was unfaithful to Yahweh. Yahweh allowed the Philistines to kill Saul and gave Israel to David. Now the storyteller wants to tell us about David, a king who was faithful to Yahweh. This passage tells the same story as in 2 Samuel 5:1–16, but with some differences.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: If you have already translated 2 Samuel 5:1–16, listen to your translation of that passage. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller starts by telling us about the time when David became king of all Israel. The storyteller tells us that all Israel went to David at the city of Hebron. Some people from every tribe of Israel gathered together and went to David to make David king.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Talk about a time when your people all wanted the same thing and went to the leaders to make sure it happened. Pause this audio here.

The people who spoke to David reminded David that they were closely related to David by saying they were David's bone and flesh. The people had the same ancestors as David. The people reminded David of times in the past, while Saul was still king, when David led the men of Israel into battle and then back to their homes. The people reminded David of the words that Yahweh, David's God, said to David. David's God is Yahweh, the same God that the people from all Israel follow. At some time, before David became king, Yahweh told David that David would shepherd the people of Israel and be the ruler of the people of Israel. A shepherd protects and guides sheep or goats. Israelites kept sheep and goats for meat and wool. David would do the work of a shepherd to protect and guide the people of Israel, just like a shepherd protects and guides sheep or goats.

Stop here and look at a picture of a group of sheep with a shepherd. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also said that David would be a ruler or a prince one day. David would be the person that Yahweh chose or appointed to lead the people of Israel.

Then the storyteller tells us more about the meeting at Hebron. The people who came to David were the elders of the tribes of Israel, or the male leaders of clans or families in the tribes of Israel. When the elders gathered with King David in the city of Hebron, David made a covenant with the elders. A covenant is an agreement between two people or groups of people where both make strong promises to do or not do certain things. We do not know what David or the elders promised to each other in Hebron. David made the covenant before Yahweh. In

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other words, Yahweh knew the promises that David made to the elders. The ark of the covenant represented Yahweh's presence. Often, when the storyteller tells us that the people did something before Yahweh, it means that the ark was there. However, we do not know if the ark of the covenant was present at Hebron or somewhere else. Even so, Yahweh knew what promises David made to the elders. The elders of Israel anointed David king of Israel. The elders made David king and placed special oil on David's head. David was Yahweh's chosen king of Israel. The storyteller tells us that Yahweh fulfilled the promise that Yahweh had spoken through Samuel to make David king.

The storyteller tells us that David and all the Israelites went to Jerusalem to attack Jerusalem. This is different from the passage in 2 Samuel where another storyteller said that the king and his men went to Jerusalem. In this passage, the storyteller does not mean that everybody in Israel went to Jerusalem, but that all of Israel supported David as David and his men went to Jerusalem. The storyteller wants to show us that Israel is now united with David. People also knew Jerusalem as Jebus.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel that shows the cities of Hebron and Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

The Jebusites, the people who lived in Jebus, said to David that the Israelites would not get into the city to conquer it. The Jebusites did not talk directly to David but gave a message that someone else reported to David. The Jebusites were confident that the Israelites could not conquer their fortress, or stronghold, which people also called Zion. Even though the Jebusites were confident and the fortress of Zion was strong, David captured the fortress of Zion. The storyteller tells us that later people began to call it the City of David, which was the name of the place at the time of the storyteller.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Talk about a place that had one name but now has a different name. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us more about how David conquered the fortress. The storyteller gives us more information in this story than the storyteller in 2 Samuel did. In this story, David said that David would make the first person to attack the Jebusites the chief and commander of the Israelite army. A chief and a commander are the same thing. This is the most important person in a group of people, or the most important leader of the army. Joab, the son of Zeruiah, was the first to attack the Jebusites. Zeruiah was David's sister. It is unusual for a storyteller to identify a person in the Bible as the son of their mother rather than the son of their father. Because Joab attacked the Jebusites, David made Joab the most important leader of David's army.

The storyteller tells us some of the things that David did while David was king. Sometime after the battle for Jerusalem, David lived in the stronghold, the fortress in Jerusalem. Because David lived in the stronghold, people named it the City of David. The City of David was one part of Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a map of Jerusalem at the time David became king. Pause this audio here.

David ordered people to build the city around the City of David. The people built the city from the Millo, where the land was filled in, probably like a terrace. The people built around and on all sides of the City of David inward towards the wall around the fortress.

Stop here and look at a picture of terraces on the side of a hill. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Get a bowl and place it upside down on the ground. Take a long strip of paper or a long, wide leaf and make it into a ring that fits around the bowl. Put the ring around the bowl with the fine edge touching the ground and a space between the ring and the bowl. Now, use earth to fill the space between the slope of the bowl and the ring of paper or leaf and press it down until you make a flat, level surface between the slope of the bowl and the straight edge of the ring. The filled area with a flat level surface is like the Millo or terraces at Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us that Joab repaired the rest of the city.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Talk about a place where some people lived, but then those people left that place, and other people came and lived there instead. Talk about what people needed to do to be able to live in the place after the first people left the place empty. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Place a big stone on the flat base of your bowl to represent the City of David. Place small stones on the flat level surface between the slope of the bowl and the straight edge of the

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ring to represent the houses David built outside the fortress. Place more small stones outside the ring of paper or leaf to represent the buildings Joab repaired. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us that David became greater or more powerful over the time of David's reign because Yahweh was with David. The storyteller gives Yahweh an additional name, "the God of hosts" or "God almighty." God of hosts means the ruler of all heavenly beings. God Almighty means the all-powerful ruler of the armies of Israel.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: People from all of Israel met with David at the city of Hebron. The people told David all the reasons why David should be king of Israel. The elders of Israel met with David, and David made a covenant with them. The elders anointed David king of Israel. This fulfilled the prophecy that Yahweh gave to Samuel.

In the second scene: David went with people from all the tribes of Israel to Jerusalem to attack the Jebusites, and the Jebusites said that David would never conquer the fortress.

In the third scene: David conquered the fortress of Zion, which people later called the City of David.

In the fourth scene: David told the Israelites that the person who attacked the Jebusites first would become the commander of the Israelite army. Joab was first to attack the Jebusites, and David made Joab commander of the army.

In the fifth scene: During David's reign, David moved into the stronghold, the City of David, and built more buildings in the city on the land inside the terraces up to the wall of the fortress. Joab repaired the rest of Jerusalem. David became more powerful because Yahweh, God Almighty, was with David.

The characters in this passage are:

- People from all the tribes of Israel
- David
- Yahweh
- Elders from the tribes of Israel
- Fighting men from all the tribes of Israel
- Jebusites
- And Joab, son of Zeruiah

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this passage, the storyteller tells us about two important events when David became king and began to reign over Israel. Then the storyteller gives an overview of David's work in Jerusalem. Some time after Saul and the rest of Saul's family died, people from all the tribes of Israel went to David at the city of Hebron. The storyteller does not mean everybody in Israel went to Hebron, but some people from every tribe of Israel gathered together and went to David to make David king. When the people went to see David, the people gave all their reasons why they now wanted David to be king over all of Israel. The people talked about events from the past, when David led the Israelite army for Saul and when Yahweh gave a prophecy to David. Both of these events happened many years before David and the people from Israel met in Hebron. In the prophecy from Yahweh, when David was younger, Yahweh said David would become a shepherd and ruler of the Israelite people. The storyteller reminds us later that Yahweh gave this prophecy to the Israelites through Samuel.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Talk about a time when a friend or someone in your family talked about what you would be when you were older or grown up. Pay attention to how you talk about a conversation from your past when people talked to each other or you about your future or who you are now. Pause this audio here.

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When the people from all the tribes of Israel gathered in Hebron, it was the elders who spoke with David. David made a covenant with the elders, and Yahweh witnessed the covenant. Then the elders anointed David king over all the tribes of Israel. This fulfilled Yahweh's promise to David through Samuel. Yahweh gave the prophecy to Samuel many years earlier, when David was younger.

After the elders anointed David king of all Israel, David decided to go to Jerusalem, which people also knew as Jebus, to attack and conquer Jerusalem. The Jebusites felt confident that David could not conquer the stronghold of Zion. But David did conquer the stronghold. Now the storyteller gives us extra information. The storyteller says that Zion is what we call the City of David today. We know that at some point, people began to call Zion the City of David because David lived there. At the time the storyteller lived, people still called the fortress the City of David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you say to show that something happened even when you did not think it would happen, or you did something to stop it from happening? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us how Joab became the commander of the Israelite army. Before David and the Israelites conquered the fortress, David promised to give the job of the most important leader to the first person to attack the Jebusites. Joab was the first person to attack, and so he became the most important commander of the army.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call the person who is the most important leader of your army or fighting people? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller now tells us about what David did in Jerusalem while David was king. David moved his home from Hebron to the fortress, and people began to call the fortress the City of David. During David's reign in Jerusalem, David built up the city around the fortress. David did not build the buildings himself but directed other people to build what David wanted. David got people to build more buildings around the fortress from the edge of the Millo, the filled terrace area, to the wall of the fortress. Also, during David's reign in Jerusalem, Joab repaired other parts of the city of Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a map of Jerusalem at the time David became king, if needed. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller uses a word that means to make alive. We do not know if Joab brought the rest of the city to life by looking after the people or by making the buildings better. The storyteller uses the same word that Nehemiah used to tell the story of how the Israelites rebuilt Jerusalem when the Israelites returned from Babylon.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remind each other of the stories you told about how people came back to live in places that were empty and what they did to make the homes good to live in. How will you translate this idea of what Joab did to repair the city? Pause this audio here.

While David was king, David became greater and more powerful because Yahweh, God Almighty, was with David. David did not become larger or stronger in his body, but David had more political and military power. "God Almighty," or the "God of the Hosts," or of all the heavenly beings, was a special name the Israelites gave to Yahweh when the Israelites talked about how Yahweh has power over everything on earth and in heaven.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- People from all the tribes of Israel
- David
- Yahweh
- Elders from the tribes of Israel
- Fighting men from all the tribes of Israel

1 Chronicles 11:1–9

- Jebusites
- And Joab, son of Zeruiah.

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

People from all of Israel met with David at the city of Hebron. The people told David all the reasons why David should be king of Israel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people from all the tribes of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We want you to be our king; or
- We feel confident that Yahweh wants you to be king of Israel; or
- We want to do what Yahweh wants us to do.

Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We are family. We should be one nation together; or
- I did lead all the tribes when I was younger; or
- This is what Yahweh said I would be. I feel honoured to look after my people.

Continue the drama. The elders of Israel met with David, and David made a covenant with them. The elders anointed David king of Israel, and that fulfilled the prophecy that Yahweh gave to Samuel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the elders from all the tribes of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- David will look after us and make us a great nation; or
- We will make David our king; or
- We feel happy to have a king to rule all the tribes in Israel.

Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- The tribes will follow me; or
- This is what Samuel prophesied about when Yahweh’s spirit was on Samuel; or
- Now I am king, and I will be everything that Yahweh promised me.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Samuel said my promises to David a long time ago; or
- I am happy when I hear the covenant David makes with his people, the Israelites; or
- I said David would be king. Here he is!

Continue the drama. David went with people from all the tribes of Israel to Jerusalem to attack the Jebusites, and the Jebusites said that David would never conquer the fortress. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I need a home in the middle of Israel; or
- It is time the Jebusites gave up their fortress; or
- I feel strong when all the tribes of Israel follow me.

Ask the person playing the fighting men from all the tribes of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

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- We will follow David to a great victory; or
- The fortress is big and strong on the hill, but we will conquer it.

Ask the person playing the Jebusites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The Israelites will never break our fortress and make us leave; or
- We feel safe in our fortress.

Continue the drama. David conquered the fortress of Zion, which people later called the City of David. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The Jebusites were wrong; or
- We have conquered the fortress and will take it for us to live in; or
- This fortress will be my home, and I will make it mine.

Continue the drama. David tells the Israelites that the person who attacks the Jebusites first will become the commander of the Israelite army. Joab was first to attack the Jebusites, and David made Joab commander of the army. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want the person who leads my army to be brave and the best fighter; or
- I wonder who will win? or
- Joab is brave and strong. Joab will lead my army for me.

Ask the person playing the fighting men from all the tribes of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- David will make sure that our commander is brave and strong; or
- We wonder who will be first to attack the Jebusites; or
- Joab will lead us well.

Ask the person playing Joab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want to be the commander of the Israelite army; or
- I am first! David will make me the most important leader of the army.

Continue the drama. During David's reign, David moved into the fortress, the City of David, and built more buildings in the city on the land inside the terraces up to the wall of the fortress. Joab repaired the rest of Jerusalem. David became more powerful because Yahweh, God Almighty, was with David. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I will make the fortress my home, and I will call it the City of David; or
- I will make the city bigger and have enough homes and buildings for my people around my fortress; or
- Yahweh is blessing me and making me a strong and powerful king.

Ask the person playing Joab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I will look after the city of Jerusalem and build homes for our people; or
- We will bring Jerusalem to life with lots of people in the city and places for the people to live in; or
- Yahweh is making David into a strong and powerful king of Israel.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- David is being a good king, and David is obedient to me; or
- I am blessing David and making David a powerful king of Israel.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

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Some people, the leaders, from all the tribes of Israel, met with David at Hebron. For more information on Israel and Hebron, refer to the Master Glossary. The people said they were David's bone and flesh, which means that the people were closely related to David.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **bone and flesh**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The people from all the tribes reminded David what **Yahweh**, David's **God**, had said to David. Yahweh is God's personal name. In this passage, God is called Yahweh. Be sure to translate Yahweh and God in the same way as you have in previous passages, and remember that Yahweh and God are in the Master Glossary.

David led Israel's soldiers out to battle and back home when Saul was **king** of Israel. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

The leaders of the tribes reminded David that Yahweh said David would shepherd Yahweh's people. A shepherd is a person who takes care of sheep and goats, and so David would take care of Yahweh's people in the same way that a shepherd takes care of animals.

Stop here and look at a picture of a group of sheep with a shepherd if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **shepherd**. Look up shepherd in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also said David would be ruler or prince over Israel. This kind of ruler is one that someone in authority appoints. Yahweh is appointing David to rule.

Stop here and review what word or phrase you used for this type of **ruler** in 1 Chronicles 5:2. Use the same word or phrase for this type of ruler that you used there. Pause this audio here.

The elders or leaders of the tribes of Israel went to King David at Hebron.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **elders**. Look up elder in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King David made a covenant with the elders at Hebron. A covenant is a solemn promise between two people or groups of people that the people cannot break.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **covenant**. Look up covenant in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David made the covenant with the elders before Yahweh. In other words, Yahweh witnessed the covenant agreement.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **before Yahweh**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The elders anointed David as king, or poured special oil on David and made David king.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **anointed**. Look up anoint in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David and all the Israelites went to **Jerusalem**. For more information on Jerusalem, refer to the Master Glossary. The Jebusites said that David would not get into the fortress, or stronghold.

Even though the Jebusites thought David could not get into the fortress, David captured the fortress of Zion. There are two kinds of safe places like this in the Bible. One kind of fortress or stronghold is one that people made with bricks or stone and high walls. Another kind of stronghold is one that is a natural strong cave or safe

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place. The fortress, or stronghold, in this story is a safe place that people built. People usually built this kind of fortress with thick walls around it and often on top of a hill.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for fortress, or **stronghold**, and **Zion**. Look up stronghold and Zion in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David said that the person who led and was first to attack the Jebusites would be the **chief** and commander, the most important leader of the Israelite army. Use the same word or phrase for chief as you used in previous passages. A commander was a military leader who carried a staff to show he was a leader.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for chief **commander**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David lived in the fortress and called it the City of David. David built the **city** around the fortress from the Millo or terraces towards the fortress. The city was a large settlement with a wall around it. Use the same word or phrase for city as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of terraces on the side of a hill, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Millo**, or **terraces**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David became more powerful because Yahweh Almighty, the Yahweh of “Hosts” or all heavenly beings, was with David. You can translate this name to mean almighty or all-powerful.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Yahweh Almighty**, or **Yahweh of Hosts**. Look up “Yahweh of Hosts” in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this title in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (988 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 11:10–19

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 11:10–19 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:10–19 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:10–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, the storyteller gave a summary of how David defeated the city of Jerusalem with the help of his soldier Joab. David then made Joab commander of the whole Israelite army. Now, the storyteller will tell us about David's mighty men.

The storyteller says he will name the chiefs of David's mighty men, or the most elite group of David's soldiers. David specially chose and trained the mighty men, and these men took orders directly from David. These famous warriors gave David strong support in the kingdom, which means these men were very loyal to David as their king. David became king, or ruler of Israel, through the word of Yahweh, or just as Yahweh promised.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Who are the elite or greatest fighters in your culture? Why are these people so well-known? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller then begins to give an account of, or name, David's mighty men. The mighty men supported David from the time when Saul was king to David's own reign as king. Some of the mighty men began to follow David while he was on the run from Saul. After David was king, the men helped David to defeat his enemies and unify the tribes of Israel. David's mighty men consisted of two groups: the top military officers whom David called "The Three," and the next level of important soldiers whom people called "The Thirty." Jashobeam, who was a Hacmonite, probably from a place called Hacmoni, was chief, or the highest leader, of the group of three. Jashobeam was best known for the time when he defeated 300 men during one battle using only his spear. A spear is a type of weapon with a wooden staff and a sharp metallic end that soldiers used to stab people.

Stop here and look at a picture of a spear as a group. Pause this audio here.

The second man the storyteller lists as part of the three mighty men is Eleazar. Eleazar was a descendant of Dodai the Ahohite, probably from the clan, or family, of Ahoah. Eleazar stood with David at Pas Dammim to

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fight against the Philistines. Pas Dammim was most likely an area located to the west of Bethlehem toward the Philistine coast. The storyteller tells us that Eleazar stood with David to defend a field of barley from a group of Philistine soldiers after the rest of the Israelite soldiers ran away. Eleazer stayed with David, defended the field, and won a great victory with the help of Yahweh. Barley is a grain that people use to make bread and porridge. Barley can grow in places with little water and poor soil where wheat cannot grow, so barley was a very important grain in Israel.

Stop here and look at pictures of barley and a barley field as a group. Pause this audio here.

Although we know from 2 Samuel 23 that Shammah was the other soldier who was a part of The Three, the storyteller does not mention him in this passage. Because of the similarities between the stories of how Shammah defended a field of lentils with David and this story of how Eleazar defended a field of barley with David, it is likely that the story of how Eleazar defended the field may originally have been the story about Shammah.

The storyteller now changes to tell a different story. Three of David's mighty men go to "the rock" to visit David at the cave of Adullam. It is unclear whether these are the same three leaders as before or different mighty men. The rock most likely refers to a large rock that provided protection near the cave. The cave itself was probably a limestone cave, about 20 kilometers or 12 miles southwest of Bethlehem, the city where David was born. This cave and rock together created a stronghold, or a place where the natural areas of the land can protect people from enemies or danger.

Stop here and look at a picture of a limestone cave as a group. Discuss what a stronghold would look like in your culture and how it is the same or different from where David hid. Pause this audio here.

The Philistines were camped in the Valley of Rephaim, which was a wide valley southwest of Jerusalem on the border between Judah and the northern tribes. While David was staying in his stronghold, or cave, which was well-protected, the Philistines had a garrison, or a group of soldiers, who were staying in and had control of Bethlehem.

Stop here and look at a map of Adullam, the Valley of Rephaim, and Bethlehem as a group. Pause this audio here.

While David was in the cave, David wished that he could have a drink of water from a well by the gate of the city of Bethlehem. A well is a hole in the ground where people can find water naturally. When the three men heard that David wanted a drink of water, the men traveled to Bethlehem, broke through the Philistine soldiers staying there, and brought water from the well back to David. The soldiers showed their complete loyalty to David by going to so much trouble to get the water.

Even though David really wanted to drink the water his soldiers brought him, David poured the water on the ground. When an Israelite person poured water on the ground, it was like they were giving a drink offering to worship and honor Yahweh. David emphasizes that only Yahweh is fit to receive such a costly offering since David's soldiers risked their lives for David.

And so, these were some of the great acts of David's mighty men.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:10–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us about the three chiefs of David's mighty men who were loyal and supported David as their king.

In the second scene: Jashobeam fights with his spear and defeats 300 men during one battle.

In the third scene: Eleazar and David defend a barley field from the Philistines in Pas Dammim. Even when all the other Israelite soldiers run away, Eleazar continues to fight until Yahweh gives him a great victory.

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In the fourth scene: Three mighty men visit David in the cave of Adullam. David says he longs for a drink from a well in Bethlehem, even though the Philistines currently control the city of Bethlehem. The three men break through the Philistine soldiers and draw water from the Bethlehem well. The men bring the water back to David. David pours the water on the ground as an offering to Yahweh and says he cannot drink the water because the cost of the men's lives was too high.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- David
- Jashobeam
- The 300 enemies whom Jashobeam killed with a spear
- Eleazar
- The three mighty men who visited David
- And Philistine soldiers whom David's men defeated

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller begins by telling us that he will introduce a group of soldiers who were very loyal to David and gave David great support as their king. The storyteller says that not just the soldiers, but all of Israel, or the nation of Yahweh's chosen people, supported David as their king.

The phrase "according to the word of Yahweh" means that David was king and had the support of the people, just as Yahweh promised.

Then the storyteller lists David's mighty men, beginning with a group of elite soldiers called "The Three."

The storyteller describes the next events as separate and as having happened at different times and locations. These are events that have already happened. The mighty men helped David defeat his enemies early in his reign as king after David brought the tribes of Israel together.

Jashobeam is the chief of the three mighty soldiers, and Jashobeam was most famous for killing 300 soldiers at one time with his spear. The phrase "at one time" does not mean at the same moment, but during the same battle. It is important to note that the number of soldiers is different from the similar story in 2 Samuel 23, which says there were 800 soldiers.

The next person the storyteller talks about is Eleazar. When the storyteller says, "and next to him was Eleazar," the storyteller does not mean that Eleazar was physically standing beside Jashobeam, but rather that Eleazar was the next person the storyteller was going to talk about.

The storyteller tells about a time when Eleazar stood with David in a place called Pas Dammim. After all of the Israelite soldiers ran away, Eleazar stayed with David and defended a field of barley from a group of Philistine soldiers until Yahweh gave him a great victory. It is important to remember that barley was a grain that people used to make bread and porridge, which made barley a valuable crop during this time.

Stop here and look at pictures of barley and a barley field as a group. Pause this audio here.

It is important to note that the storyteller does not name the third man, Shammah, who was a part of this elite group of three soldiers.

The storyteller then tells about when three of David's mighty men visited David at the rock near the cave of Adullam. "The rock" most likely refers to a large rock that provided protection near the cave. The storyteller does not tell us if these are the same men he named earlier in the passage.

The storyteller says David was in David's stronghold. A stronghold was a high place that was well-protected, so this most likely refers to the cave of Adullam.

Stop here and look at a picture of a natural stronghold as a group. Discuss with your group how you will describe a place like this in your language. Pause this audio here.

The Philistines had a garrison, or a group of soldiers, in control of Bethlehem. This means the Philistine soldiers stayed in and had control of the city of Bethlehem. The three men visit David and hear David say, "Oh, that

someone would give me water to drink from the well of Bethlehem that is by the gate!" It is important to remember that David was not asking for someone to get water from the well, but David was saying that he wanted that water even though that was not possible at that time.

Stop here and discuss as a group: David spoke of something he desired, but David did not think it was possible for anyone to do. How will you translate this into your language? Pause this audio here.

The three soldiers decided to get the water for David. The men walked the 12 miles, or 19 kilometers, from the cave to Bethlehem, broke through the Philistine soldiers who were stationed at Bethlehem, drew water from the well, and brought it to David. The phrase "break through" means the mighty men were able to get past the camp of Philistine soldiers and reach the well. The mighty men may have fought the soldiers, but it seems most likely that the men snuck past the soldiers at night.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you translate the action of breaking through the soldiers in your language? Pause this audio here.

It is important to remember that the well or cistern was a place where people could find water that collected naturally.

The soldiers arrived back at the cave with the water for David. When David received the water, even though he really wanted it, David poured the water out on the ground as an offering to Yahweh. David responded by saying, "God forbid that I should drink this." David said this to emphasize that he could never drink the water that the men brought to David.

When David asked, "Shall I drink the blood of the men who went at the risk of their lives?" David was not actually asking if he should drink the blood of his soldiers. Instead, David said this to show he felt unworthy that his soldiers should risk their lives to give David what he wanted. Only Yahweh was worthy of the men risking their lives.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story of a time when someone did not accept what a person gave them because that person did not feel worthy. Pay attention to what words you use so that you can accurately translate how David responded to his loyal soldiers. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller clearly finishes this part of the story of David's mighty men by stating, "These are the kinds of things that the three mighty men did." The storyteller is not telling every story about what the mighty men did, but just giving some examples of what the men did.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:10–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- David
- Jashobeam
- The 300 enemies whom Jashobeam killed with a spear
- Eleazar
- The three mighty men who visited David
- And Philistine soldiers whom David's men defeated

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Act out how the storyteller tells us about David's three mighty men who were loyal and supported David as their king so that David's kingdom would be strong.

The audience would have known this group of soldiers well. One way to show this is by having the actors for the mighty men follow David wherever he goes. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh showed great favor to me when Yahweh gave me so many loyal soldiers; or
- I feel honored to be the king of Yahweh's people; or
- I am thankful that my soldiers have helped me defeat my enemies and that these men are loyal to me when I need them most.

Ask the person playing the three men, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel loyal. I will follow David wherever he goes; or
- It is clear that God is on David's side; or
- I would gladly give my life in battle for David.

Continue the drama. Act out how Jashobeam fights soldiers with his spear. Jashobeam defeats 300 men during one battle.

Next, act out how Eleazar defends a barley field from the Philistines in Pas Dammim. Even when all of the other Israelite soldiers run away, Eleazar continues to fight until Yahweh gives him a great victory. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite soldiers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am impressed by Eleazar's skill and bravery! or
- It is clear that Yahweh used Eleazar to give us victory; or
- I am ashamed that I ran away. I should have trusted Yahweh and stayed with Eleazar.

Continue the drama. Act out how three of the mighty men visit David in the cave of Adullam. David says he longs for a drink from a well in Bethlehem, even though the Philistines currently control the city. The three men walk to Bethlehem, break through the Philistine soldiers, and draw water from the well. The three mighty men bring the water back to David. David pours the water on the ground as an offering to Yahweh and says he cannot drink the water because the cost of the men's lives was too high. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the three mighty men, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am impressed by David's great love for Yahweh; or
- I am surprised. I was sure David would love to drink the water from his hometown; or
- I am humbled and reminded that my greatest desire should be Yahweh.

Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am humbled that my men are so loyal to me; or
- I am worried that my men could have died just because I wanted a drink of water! or
- I hope my soldiers know to honor Yahweh more than me.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:10–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The storyteller begins this section by describing David's mighty men. These mighty men refer to a group of soldiers whom David had specially chosen and trained well. The mighty men were very strong. The men reported directly to the king and did special assignments for him.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **mighty men**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says the mighty men gave David strong support in his **kingdom**, with all of **Israel**, to make David **king**. Israel was the nation of Yahweh's chosen people, the descendants of Jacob, whom Yahweh named "Israel." David was the king, or ruler, of Israel. David's kingdom refers to the territory of Israel. The loyalty and support of David's mighty men helped David defeat his enemies to become king. Use the same words or phrases for king, kingdom, and Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, kingdom, or Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

David became king and had the support of his soldiers and people according to the word of Yahweh, or just as Yahweh promised. The "**word** of Yahweh" refers to everything Yahweh tells people. Yahweh specially chose David when David was a young man to become the next king of Israel. Yahweh completed that promise. Use the same word or phrase for "word of Yahweh" as you used in previous passages. For more information on "word of Yahweh," refer to the Master Glossary.

Jashobeam, the chief of the mighty men, fights with his spear and defeats 300 men during one battle. Jashobeam was the chief, or leader, of the mighty men, and Jashobeam reported directly to the king.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **chief**, or **leader**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

A **spear** refers to a weapon that has a wooden shaft and a metallic, sharp end that people used to stab other people. Be sure to use the same word or phrase for spear that you have used in previous passages.

Eleazar defended a field of barley from the Philistines who were attacking them, even after the rest of the Israelite soldiers ran away. **Yahweh** gave Eleazar a great victory over the Philistines. Yahweh is the personal name of the God of Israel. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Three of the mighty men visited David when he was staying in the stronghold, or, in this case, the cave of Adullam. Here, stronghold refers to a high-up and well-protected area, which was a cave near Adullam. This type of stronghold was natural, which means that people did not make this stronghold like they made the fortress or stronghold at the City of David.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for a natural **stronghold**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. For more information on stronghold, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

When David's soldiers brought him the water from Bethlehem, David asked, "Should I drink the **blood** of the men who went at the risk of their lives?" Here, blood does not refer to actual blood, but it is special language that refers to the soldiers' lives. Use the same word or phrase for blood as you used in previous passages. For more information on blood, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 11:10–19

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (732 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.0 MB)

1 Chronicles 11:20–25

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 11:20–25 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:20–25 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:20–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The storyteller continues to remember David's mighty men. As you remember, David especially chose and trained these soldiers, and they reported directly to the king. David's mighty men consisted of two groups: the top military officers whom David called "The Three," and the next level of important soldiers whom people called "The Thirty." Now, the storyteller tells some stories about men from "The Thirty."

First, the storyteller tells about Abishai, who was the brother of Joab. As you remember, both Joab and Abishai were David's nephews. Abishai and Joab were famous among the people as skilled fighters. We know from

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previous passages that Joab was the commander of the Israelite army, but here, besides being the brother of Abishai, the storyteller does not mention Joab as part of David's mighty men.

One reason people knew Abishai was that Abishai killed 300 men during one battle using just his spear. As you remember, a spear was a weapon with a wooden shaft and a sharp metallic end that people used to stab enemies.

Stop here and look at a picture of a spear as a group. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says Abishai was the commander, or leader, of The Three. However, because the words for "The Three" and "The Thirty" are very similar in the original language, it is hard to know what Abishai's position was among "The Thirty." It is clear that people considered Abishai the most famous among the mighty men, and that the other men regarded Abishai as a leader. The people honored Abishai more than "The Three," though people did not consider him to be one of the three main leaders of the mighty men.

Next, the storyteller tells about Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada, who came from the city of Kabzeel. Kabzeel was in the southern part of the territory of Judah. Benaiah was a very brave man who did many brave things. One thing people remembered Benaiah for was that he killed two ariels, or champion fighters, in Moab. Scholars translate "ariel" as "lion of God," and think this means they were champion fighters in Moab. It may be easier to say he killed the two best fighters in the land of Moab.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story of a champion fighter who people celebrated in your culture. What kinds of brave actions make someone famous where you live? Pause this audio here.

Another one of Benaiah's brave acts was when he killed a lion in a pit or deep well. It was very cold, and snow, or cold white flakes of frozen water, had fallen from the sky like rain. Most likely, the snow made the lion go closer to the town in search of food. Since lions are large, dangerous hunters with sharp teeth and claws, it was very impressive that Benaiah could kill such an animal.

Stop here and look at a picture of some snow and a lion as a group. Pause this audio here.

Benaiah was also famous for killing a very large Egyptian man who was 5 cubits tall. This would have been around 7.5 feet or 2.5 meters tall.

Stop here and, as a group, stretch your arms as high as you can. Now imagine if you added another arm's length on top of that. That is how tall the Egyptian man was! Pause this audio here.

The Egyptian had a spear the size of a weaver's beam. When a person was weaving cloth, they would tie a set of threads to a large wooden stick while they wove another set of threads between them. People called this large stick a weaver's beam. The storyteller makes this comparison to say that the spear was thicker and longer than a normal spear.

Stop here and look at a picture of a weaver's beam as well as a wooden staff as a group. Pause this audio here.

While the Egyptian man used a spear, Benaiah fought him with only a club or a heavy wooden staff. While fighting the man, Benaiah managed to take the Egyptian's spear away from him and kill the Egyptian with the Egyptian's own weapon. Actions such as these won Benaiah a name. This means these acts made Benaiah famous, and people knew Benaiah just as well as they knew "The Three." The storyteller once again emphasizes that although people considered Benaiah to be famous among "The Thirty" mighty men, Benaiah was not a part of "The Three."

The storyteller says that David put Benaiah in charge of David's bodyguard. David's bodyguard was most likely a special group of soldiers who personally guarded King David.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:20–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

1 Chronicles 11:20–25

In the first scene: Abishai fights against and kills 300 men in one battle using only his spear. People see Abishai as a leader amongst the 30 mighty men.

In the second scene: Benaiah does several amazing things in sequence. First, Benaiah fights and kills two great fighters from Moab. Then Benaiah finds a lion caught in a pit in the snow. Benaiah kills the lion. Finally, Benaiah fights against a strong, tall Egyptian man with a large spear. Benaiah fights the Egyptian with only a staff. During the fight, Benaiah takes the spear from the Egyptian man and kills him with his own weapon. These actions make Benaiah as famous as the three mighty men.

In the third scene: All of the 30 mighty men cheer for Benaiah, and David makes Benaiah the leader of David's bodyguard.

The characters in this passage are:

- King David
- Abishai
- Benaiah
- The Three
- The 30 Mighty Men
- 300 enemies
- Two Moab fighters
- Lion
- The great Egyptian man

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

It is important to remember that the storyteller is telling about events from the past. These are battles that have already happened.

The storyteller tells about Abishai. The original language makes it clear that this is a new part of the story about David's mighty men. Abishai was Joab's brother, which means Abishai was David's nephew.

The storyteller describes Abishai as chief of the 30 mighty men, but it is possible that Abishai was chief of "The Three." It is difficult to know which group the storyteller is referring to because the words for the two groups are so similar in the original language. It is hard to know exactly how to translate Abishai's rank. It is clear that people considered Abishai the most famous among the 30 mighty men and that the other men regarded Abishai as a leader. Abishai was most likely not a part of the separate group of the three mighty men.

Abishai killed 300 men at one time with his spear. It is important to remember that Abishai did not kill all 300 men at the same time but during the same battle.

Abishai wins or makes a name for himself because he defeats the men. When someone wins a name, that person becomes famous because of what they do. People respected Abishai even more than they respected the three chief mighty men, but Abishai was not one of "The Three" chief mighty men.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate the concept of winning a name for yourself. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller then begins to tell about Benaiah and his different heroic and brave actions. Benaiah was the son of Jehoiada and was from Kabzeel, a city in the territory of the tribe of Judah.

The storyteller describes Benaiah as a valiant, or brave man. First, Benaiah fought against and killed the two ariels of Moab. Scholars translate "ariel" as "lion of God," and think this means they were champion fighters in Moab. It may be easier to say that Benaiah killed the two best fighters in the land of Moab. The Moabites were enemies of the Israelites.

Next, Benaiah finds a lion in a well near a village in the snow. Benaiah fights the lion and kills it.

Finally, Benaiah fights against an Egyptian man, or a man from Egypt, who is 5 cubits tall. A cubit is around 50 centimeters, so this means the man was 7.5 feet or 2.5 meters tall. The Egyptian had a spear as large as a weaver's beam, which was another way to say it was very large.

Stop here and look at a picture of a weaver's beam as a group. Compare how people weave thread in your culture to how the storyteller describes weaving here. Think about how you will translate the spear's comparison to a weaver's beam to mean that the spear was very long. Pause this audio here.

Benaiah only has a wooden staff, but he manages to take the spear from the Egyptian man and kill the Egyptian with the Egyptian's own weapon. It is important to remember that the spear was a better weapon, but Benaiah still managed to win the fight.

Stop here and look at a picture of a spear and a picture of a wooden staff as a group. Pause this audio here.

The 30 mighty men congratulate, or honor, Benaiah, but Benaiah is not part of the separate group of three elite fighters. David sets Benaiah over, or puts him in charge of, David's bodyguard, or the group of men who protect David.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:20–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King David
- Abishai
- Benaiah
- The Three
- The 30 Mighty Men
- 300 enemies
- Two Moab fighters
- Lion
- The great Egyptian man

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Act out how the storyteller tells about David's mighty men. The storyteller tells how Abishai fought against and killed 300 men in one battle using only his spear. The 30 mighty men see Abishai as their leader. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Abishai, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy to defend my uncle. I would do anything for David; or
- I am thankful to Yahweh for the victory that Yahweh gave me; or
- I see how the men look at me. I want to lead the men well.

Continue the drama. Act out how Benaiah does several amazing things. First, Benaiah fights and kills two great fighters from Moab. Then Benaiah finds a lion caught in a pit in the snow. Benaiah kills the lion.

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Act out how Benaiah fights against an Egyptian man who is a lot taller than Benaiah. The Egyptian man has a very large spear, but Benaiah fights the Egyptian with only a staff. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Egyptian, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel amused. This man is small and only has a staff. This fight will be easy; or
- I feel insulted. I cannot believe David thinks that one man can defeat me; or
- I feel concerned. This man seems too confident. I have heard stories of David's men who fight with the power of their God.

Continue the drama. Act out how Benaiah fights the Egyptian, takes the man's spear, and kills the Egyptian with the Egyptian's own weapon. Act out how all of the 30 mighty men honor Benaiah. David makes Benaiah the commander of David's bodyguard. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Benaiah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am honored to be in charge of keeping David safe; or
- I am determined to do everything I can to keep David safe; or
- I am eager to be in David's presence more often. I have much to learn from David.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:20–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Abishai was **chief** of "The Three." As you remember, David split his mighty men into two groups: the top military officers whom David called "The Three," and the next level of important soldiers whom David called "The Thirty." So Abishai was either chief or leader of the group of three elite soldiers or chief of the whole group of 30 mighty men. Be sure to use the same words or phrases for chief, "The Three," and "The Thirty" as you used in previous passages.

Abishai killed 300 men at one time with a **spear**. Be sure to use the same word for spear that you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a spear as a group. Pause this audio here.

Abishai also becomes the commander of the mighty men, which means Abishai was their military leader. Use the same word or phrase for military commander or leader as you have previously.

Benaiah killed a lion in a snowy pit. Snow is frozen water that looks like cold white flakes and falls from the sky like rain.

Stop here and look at a picture of snow as a group. Discuss what word you will use for **snow**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

A **lion** is a large, dangerous hunter with sharp teeth and claws. Be sure to use the same word for lion that you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a lion as a group. Pause this audio here.

Benaiah also struck down, or killed, two great fighters from Moab and a large Egyptian man who was 5 cubits tall. A cubit is a way to measure how long something is. One cubit is about as long as a man's arm from his elbow to his fingertips, which is about 50 centimeters. This means the Egyptian man was 7.5 feet or 2.5 meters tall.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **cubit**. Look up cubit in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David put Benaiah in charge of David's bodyguard. A bodyguard refers to a group of soldiers who personally protected King David. Be sure to use the same word or phrase for bodyguard that you have used in previous books.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **bodyguard**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 11:20–25

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (741 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 11:26–47

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 11:26–47 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:26–47 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

1 Chronicles 11:26–47

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:26–47 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The storyteller continues to tell us about David's mighty men. As you remember, David's mighty men consisted of two groups: the top military officers whom David called "The Three," and the next level of important soldiers whom people called "The Thirty." Now, the storyteller names these mighty men.

It is important to note that the names of the mighty men who were part of "The Thirty" changed during the time that King David ruled the kingdom of Israel. The names changed because, as men died, David needed to replace those men. There were even mighty men, such as Asahel, who were a part of this group before David was king.

In the list, the storyteller names each man and then describes each man by his ancestors, where he is from, or both. These are the names of David's mighty men:

- Asahel, the brother of Joab

As you remember, Abner killed Asahel after Asahel refused to stop chasing and attacking Abner.

- Elhanan, son of Dodo from Bethlehem

You will remember that Bethlehem was a city located in the hill country of Judah. Bethlehem was also the hometown of David.

- Shammoth, the Harorite

This means that Shammoth was most likely from Harod, which was a city in the Jezreel Valley.

- Helez, the Pelonite

The Pelonites were the people group or clan that Helez belonged to.

- Ira, the son of Ikkesh from Tekoa

Tekoa was a town 16 kilometers, or 10 miles, south of Jerusalem.

- Abiezer, from Anathoth
- Sibbecai the Hushathite

Sibbecai was famous because he killed the giant Saph. Sibbecai was a Hushathite, which means he was from the town of Hushah in Judah.

- Ilai, the Ahohite, from the place called Ahoah
- Maharai, the Netophathite
- Heled, the son of Baanah the Netophathite

Both Maharai and Heled were Netophathites, which means they were from Netophah, a city close to Bethlehem.

- Ithai, son of Ribai from Gibeah in Benjamin

Gibeah was a city in the territory of Benjamin near the border of Judah.

- Benaiah, the Pirathonite

Pirathonite means a person from the city of Pirathon, which was located in the territory of Ephraim.

- Hurai, from the brooks of Gaash

The brooks of Gaash refer to a body of water that flows continuously. These brooks were located at the base of Mount Gaash, southwest of Shechem.

- Abiel, the Arbathite from the place called Arbah, or Arbah's clan
- Azmaveth, the Barhumite

Azmaveth was from the city called Bahurim.

- Eliahba, the Shaalbonite

The Shaalbonites were a people group who lived in the city of Shaalbim, which was located in the territory of Dan.

- The sons of Hashem, the Gizonite from a place called Gizon
- Jonathan, the son of Shagee the Hararite
- Ahiam, the son of Sacar the Hararite

The Hararites were the people group that Jonathan and Ahiam belonged to, from the place called Harar.

- Eliphal, the son of Ur
- Hepher, the Mekerathite

The Mekerathites were the people group that Hepher belonged to, probably from Mekera.

- Ahijah, the Pelonite

The Pelonites were the people group Ahijah belonged to, probably from a place called Pelon.

- Hezro, the Carmelite

Carmelite refers to someone who is from the city of Carmel, which was located in the territory of Judah.

- Naarai, the son of Ezbai
- Joel, the brother of Nathan
- Mibhar, the son of Hagri
- Zelek, the Ammonite

Zelek was from Ammon, or a non-Israelite territory between the Jabbok River in the north and the Arnon River in the south, and from the Jordan River in the west to the eastern desert region.

- Naharai, the Beerothite, the armor-bearer of Joab son of Zeruiah

Beeroth was originally a Gibeonite city, or a foreign city, that Joshua assigned to the territory of Benjamin. Naharai was an armor-bearer, which means he carried extra weapons for Joab, who was the commander of the Israelite army. As you remember, Zeruiah was the sister of David.

- Ira, the Ithrite
- Gareb, the Ithrite

Ira and Gareb were Ithrites and from the city of Jattir. This was a city located in the territory of Judah.

- Uriah, the Hittite

The Hittites were the people group that Uriah was from. As you remember, Uriah was the husband of Bathsheeba and a soldier of David. Uriah died in battle after David ordered Joab to put Uriah where the battle was worst.

It is important to notice that, unlike the similar list of mighty men in 2 Samuel 23, here the storyteller continues to list 16 extra heroes. These men's names were:

- Zabad, the son of Ahlai
- Adina, the son of Shiza the Reubenite, a chief of the Reubenites, and thirty with him.

This means Adina's father, Shiza, was the chief of the Reubenites, including thirty men who followed his command.

- Hanan, the son of Maacah
- Joshaphat, the Mithnite

Joshaphat was from the city of Mithna.

- Uzzia, the Ashterathite

An Ashterathite was a person from the town of Ashtaroth in the region of Bashan.

- Shama and Jeiel, the sons of Hotham the Aroerite

Hotham was from the town of Aroer.

- Jediael, the son of Shimri
- Joha, the brother of Jediael, who was a Tizite

Joha belonged to the Tizite people group.

- Eliel the Mahavite

Eliel belonged to the Mahavite people group.

- Jeribai and Joshaviah, the sons of Elnaam
- Ithmah, the Moabite

Ithmah was from the region of Moab.

- Eliel
- Obed
- Jaasiel the Mezobaite

Jaasiel was from the town of Zobah.

In this list, the storyteller names 32 different men who were a part of "The Thirty," since the sons of Hashen probably refers to at least two men. As you may have noticed, not all of David's mighty men were Israelites. David included many foreigners, whom David most likely added to the group when he was running away from Saul before David became king.

As we can see by the number of men on the list, the storyteller emphasizes how many good relationships David had throughout his lifetime and how loyal those soldiers were to David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people remember lists of names in your culture? When have you heard a list of names similar to this before? Who is in that list? What format is that list in? Why do people make these kinds of lists? What are ways you can remember this list of names? Try to remember a list of names of famous people and tell the list to each other.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:26–47 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has one scene.

In the first scene: The storyteller tells us the names of David's mighty men. The storyteller lists 47 men in total.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller
- And the 47 mighty men

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

It is important to remember that David's mighty men consisted of two groups: the top military officers whom David called "The Three," and the next level of important soldiers whom people called "The Thirty."

It is important to remember that the group called "The Thirty" does not refer to an exact number because the number of men changed throughout David's lifetime.

This list of David's mighty men is different at times from the 2 Samuel list of mighty men. Many times, storytellers were from different areas, and they may have pronounced or said names differently. It is also possible that one person may have made a mistake in the way they wrote down the names. In any case, the translators should keep the same names and differences between the two lists. As in any list of names, there will always be differences between different people who write the names down.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: It is important to note the differences between this list of mighty men here and the list of David's mighty men in 2 Samuel. Discuss with your translation team how you will handle these differences. Pause this audio here.

We do not know what all the descriptions of the men mean. Sometimes, the description about a man may refer to the name of the man's family clan, or it may refer to the city or region from where they came. Sometimes it refers to both!

Stop here and, as a group, discuss how you will describe each man when you are not sure if they are from a certain place or a certain family group. Pause the audio here.

It is important to remember that in the 2 Samuel passage, we do not hear about the last 16 men the storyteller names in this story.

It is important to note that many of these men were from places outside of Israel. David most likely added to his group of mighty men when he was running away from Saul before David became king.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Many cultures use songs, poetry, or art to remember long lists of information. Other times, it can be helpful to group certain names together based on where those people were from or who they were related to. Talk to your group about how you will organize, sing, or draw the list of names to best remember them. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:26–47 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has one scene.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller
- And the 47 mighty men

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Act out how the storyteller stands and recites the names of David's mighty men. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing one of the mighty men, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am honored to serve King David; or
- I would do anything for David because he is a man who walks closely with Yahweh; or
- I am proud to be a member of David's mighty men. These are all great men! or
- I would protect David with my life.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 11:26–47 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The storyteller lists the names of David's **mighty men**. These were men whom the king specially chose, trained, and to whom he gave direct orders. Be sure to use the same word or phrase for mighty men as you used in previous passages.

Elhanan was the **son** of a man named Dodo, who was from the town of Bethlehem. Here, son does not just mean descendant, but it means Dodo was Elhanan's father. Be sure to use the same word for son as you used in previous passages. Son is in the Master Glossary.

The storyteller refers to Naharai as the **armor-bearer** of Joab. As you remember, Joab was the commander of the entire army of Israel. An armor-bearer was a servant who carried weapons and went into battle with their commander. People chose armor-bearers for their bravery, and these men were responsible for protecting the commanders they served. Be sure to use the same word or phrase for armor-bearer as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 11:26–47

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (732 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (1.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (945 KB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 12:1–7

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 12:1–7 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:1–7 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, the storyteller told us about the 30 mighty men who supported David and his kingdom, and about some of the brave and powerful things those men did in battle.

In this story, we will now learn specifically about the men who went with David to Ziklag. You will remember that David went to Ziklag before he went to Hebron and then finally to Jerusalem. This means that the information in this passage actually happened before the stories we just heard in the previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of Israel. Find Hebron and Jerusalem on the map. Pause this audio here.

This story begins when it says that this is a list of the fighting men who came to David at Ziklag. We know from 1 Samuel 27:7 that David went to Ziklag because King Saul, the son of Kish, chased David away. You will remember that Ziklag was a Philistine city, and that Achish, the king of Gath, gave Ziklag to David as a place of safety from Saul.

Ziklag was about 17.5 kilometers southeast of Gaza. David lived in Ziklag for one year and four months before he went to Hebron after Saul died. These men who came to David at Ziklag were brave soldiers who helped David fight in battle.

Stop here as a group and find the city of Ziklag on the map of Israel. Pause this audio here.

These soldiers could shoot arrows very well from a bow. The bow was an important weapon because soldiers could use it to shoot an arrow at an enemy from a long distance away.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a bow and arrow. Pause this audio here.

A sling was a very deadly weapon that helped soldiers to throw stones very hard and fast at an enemy. You will remember that David used a sling to kill Goliath with a stone when David was a very young man.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a sling. Pause this audio here.

These men were Benjamites. This means the men were from the tribe of Benjamin, which is the same tribe that King Saul came from. It is very surprising that men from Saul's own tribe went to Ziklag to support David instead of supporting King Saul!

Where the storyteller says these men were Benjamites, we are not sure if this means only the men in the list in this passage, or if this means all of the men in the other stories in this chapter. Most likely, the storyteller is talking only about the list of men in this passage.

Most Israelites at this time were right-handed, which means they used their right hand to do most tasks rather than their left hand. Many people knew that there were many left-handed people in the tribe of Benjamin, which

1 Chronicles 12:1–7

was very unusual. However, the storyteller says that these particular Benjamite soldiers could shoot using either their left or their right hand, which would have been extremely unusual even for a Benjamite.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, which tasks do people usually do with their right hand, and which tasks do they do with their left hand? Which hand is easier for you to use for difficult tasks? Who do you know who can use either hand equally well for any task? Pause this audio.

Now the storyteller begins to list each man's name. The first man is Ahiezer, who is the chief leader of the soldiers. Ahiezer and the next man on the list, Joash, are the sons of Shemaah the Gibeathite. This means these men were brothers. It is not clear whether Joash was also a leader, or if only Ahiezer was a leader. A Gibeathite was a way to talk about a person from Gibeah. You will remember that the city of Gibeah was just a short distance north of Jerusalem.

Stop here as a group and find the town of Gibeah on the map of Israel. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a list of people in your community and include where each person comes from. Pay attention to how you describe each person. Do you call the person by the name of the place they come from? Or do you give the person's name first and then tell the name of the place they come from? Pause this audio here.

Jeziel and Pelet appear next on the list. These men were the sons of Azmaveth.

Next are Beracah, Jehu the Anathothite, and Ishmaiah the Gibeonite. Today we know that Anathoth was located about 5 kilometers northeast of Jerusalem, and Gibeon was about 8.5 kilometers north of Jerusalem.

Stop here as a group and find Anathoth and Gibeon on the map of Israel. Pause this audio here.

Ishmaiah was a mighty warrior among David's 30 mighty men. The storyteller says Ishmaiah was a leader of "The Thirty," which may mean he led the 30 mighty men for a period of time.

Next are Jeremiah, Jahaziel, Johanan, Jozabad the Gederathite, Eluzai, Jerimoth, Bealiah, Shemariah, and Shephatiah the Haruphite. The storyteller does not give any details about these men except to mention the hometowns of Jozabad and Shephatiah. We know that a Gederathite was a person from a town in southern Judah, and Haruphite may refer to someone from the Calebite clan of Hareph. We are not sure why these men came from cities outside of the land of Benjamin, since most scholars agree that this is a list of Benjamite leaders. It may be that these were Benjamites, or descendants of Benjamin, who just lived in other cities outside of their family lands.

Stop here as a group and find the region of southern Judah on the map of Israel. Pause this audio here.

Next are Elkanah, Isshiah, Azarel, Joezer, and Jashobeam. These men were all Korahites, which means men from the clan of Korah. However, since this is a list of leaders of the tribe of Benjamin, this is not the clan of Korah from the tribe of Levi—it is a different clan from the tribe of Benjamin.

The last men to appear in this list are Joelah and Zebadiah, the sons of Jeroham from a city called Gedor. Gedor was a city in Judah.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: We learn that this is a list of men who came to David when David was staying at Ziklag because Saul, the son of Kish, chased David away. These men were warriors who helped David fight in battle.

In the second scene: We learn more details about these men. These men could shoot arrows with a bow very well. The men could also shoot arrows or sling stones with either their right or their left hand. These men were from the tribe of Benjamin.

1 Chronicles 12:1–7

In the third scene: The storyteller gives the name of each man. The storyteller also tells the names of some of the towns where these men came from.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Saul, the son of Kish
- Ahiezer and Joash, the sons of Shemaah the Gibeathite
- Jeziel and Pelet, the sons of Azmaveth
- Beracah, Jehu the Anathothite, and Ishmaiah the Gibeonite
- Jeremiah, Jahaziel, Johanon, Jozabad the Gederathite, Eluzai, Jerimoth, Bealiah, Shemariah, and Shephatiah the Haruphite
- The men from the clan of Korah, the Korahites: Elkanah, Isshiah, Azarel, Joezer, and Jashobeam
- And Joelah and Zebadiah, the sons of Jeroham from Gedor

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller says that these are the men who came to David at Ziklag when David could not move around in the area much because Saul, the son of Kish, chased David away. In the original language, the storyteller emphasizes Saul's actions and how that made it impossible for David to travel around freely during this time.

In the second scene, before the storyteller tells us the names of the men, the storyteller gives some important details about all of these men.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story where you first tell your audience what the story will be about, but then you give some background information before you actually begin to tell your story. Pay attention to the words you use to help people understand that you are giving background information first, before you tell the story. Pause this audio here.

First, all of these men had bows as weapons, and the men could shoot arrows from their bows with great skill. You will remember that a bow is a long, narrow piece of wood. People tie a strong string tightly to either end of this piece of wood so that the wood bends into a curved shape. Arrows are long, thin sticks with a pointed tip on one end. People often tie bird feathers onto the other end to help the arrow fly straight through the air. A person can shoot an arrow from the bow by pulling back the string and then letting go of the string quickly so that it pushes the arrow forward and makes it fly through the air very fast and far to hit an enemy.

Stop here as a group and look again at a picture of a bow and arrow, if needed. Pause this audio here.

These men could use either their right hand or their left hand to shoot arrows or to sling stones. You will remember that people could throw stones very hard and fast when they used a sling. People attached leather strings or straps to both sides of a wider leather band or pocket to make a sling. A soldier would take a stone and put it into the leather pocket. Then the soldier would hold both straps tightly and swing the stone in the pocket above his head very quickly. When the soldier let go of one strap, the stone would fly out of the sling at speeds of up to 160 kilometers per hour.

Stop here as a group and look again at a picture of a sling, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Most people are either right-handed or left-handed. This means that the person either prefers to use their right hand or their left hand for tasks that require extra skill or accuracy, like to throw a ball, work with a tool, or write a letter. Although it is extremely unusual, sometimes a person can do even the most difficult tasks equally well with either hand. So the storyteller is saying that all of these men were like this—able to shoot arrows from their bows or throw rocks with their slings using either hand.

All of these men were Benjamites. This probably means that just the men that the storyteller lists in this passage are Benjamites. You will remember that King Saul also came from the tribe of Benjamin.

In the third scene, the storyteller now begins to list each man's name. We do not find the names of these men anywhere else in the Bible.

1 Chronicles 12:1–7

Next, the storyteller begins to say the names of each of the men. The storyteller does this in a special way. First, the storyteller says the names of some men, and then he includes certain details about those men before he says the names of more men.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: As you listen to the list of names in this passage and how the storyteller includes extra information about the men, what is the most natural way for you to list these names and information in your translation? Pause this audio here.

First in this list is Ahiezer, who was the chief, or leader, of these men. Joash was one of these men, too. Ahiezer and Joash were the sons of Shemaah the Gibeathite. A Gibeathite was a person from Gibeah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your community, when you want to talk about how a person came from one town or another, how do you say it? Now, talk about how you will show which towns these men came from in your translation. Will it make more sense to call the men by the name of the town, or will it be more natural to say their name and then say where they are from? For example, would it be better to say, “Shemaah the Gibeathite,” or “Shemaah who was from the town of Gibeah”? Pause this audio here.

The second group of men in the list is Jeziel and Pelet, the sons of Azmaveth.

The third group of men in the list is Beracah, Jehu the Anathothite, and Ishmaiah the Gibeonite. An Anathothite was a person from the town of Anathoth, and a Gibeonite was a person from the town of Gibeon. The storyteller also mentions that Ishmaiah was a strong warrior who was among “The Thirty” and who was a leader of “The Thirty.” This probably means Ishmaiah led David’s 30 mighty men for a period of time. We are not sure why the list of the 30 men in the last passage did not include Ishmaiah, but perhaps Ishmaiah had already died by the time the storyteller put together the previous list.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about an important and powerful person, like a military or political leader. Tell how that person led for a period of time, but then how someone else became the new leader after that person died. Pay attention to how you talk differently about a current leader than you do about someone who was the leader in the past. Pause this audio here.

The fourth group of men in the list is Jeremiah, Jahaziel, Johanan, Jozabad the Gederathite, Eluzai, Jerimoth, Bealiah, Shemariah, and Shephatiah the Haruphite. A Gederathite was a person from the town of Gederah, and a Haruphite may refer to someone from Hareph, although we do not know if this was the name of a town.

The fifth group of men in the list is Elkanah, Isshiah, Azarel, Joezer, and Jashobeam, who were all Korahites. However, we know this is not the Levite clan of Korah but a Benjamite clan of Korah, because all of the men in this list are from the tribe of Benjamin.

The final group of men in this list is Joelah and Zebadiah. These men are the sons of Jeroham from a town called Gedor.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Saul, the son of Kish
- Ahiezer and Joash, the sons of Shemaah the Gibeathite
- Jeziel and Pelet, the sons of Azmaveth
- Beracah, Jehu the Anathothite, and Ishmaiah the Gibeonite
- Jeremiah, Jahaziel, Johanon, Jozabad the Gederathite, Eluzai, Jerimoth, Bealiah, Shemariah, and Shephatiah the Haruphite

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- The men from the clan of Korah, the Korahites: Elkanah, Isshiah, Azarel, Joezer, and Jashobeam
- And Joelah and Zebadiah, the sons of Jeroham from Gedor

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller says something like, "When David went to the town called Ziklag, he could not move around the area much because of Saul, the son of Kish. Many men came to David there. These men were among the brave soldiers who helped David fight in battle." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I felt very sad and discouraged when King Saul chased me away, but I was very grateful that these men came to support me! or
- These men were some of Israel's very best warriors. I hope people will understand how strong and brave these men were.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, the storyteller says something like, "These men could shoot arrows very well using their bows. These men could shoot arrows and use slings to throw stones with either their right or their left hand. These men were from the same tribe as Saul, the Benjamin tribe." Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the warriors, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- Most people do not understand how difficult it is to learn how to shoot arrows and sling stones accurately. It takes a lot of skill and practice! or
- Loyalty is very important in our culture. People expected us to support King Saul and our own tribe, but we chose to support David instead, because we believed in him!

Continue the drama. In the third scene, the storyteller lists each of the men, saying something like:

- "Their leader Ahiezer and his brother Joash, the sons of Shemaah from Gibeah.
- "Jeziel and Pelet, the sons of Azmaveth.
- "Beracah, Jehu from Anathoth town, and Ishmaiah from Gibeon town. Ishmaiah belonged to the special group of 30 brave soldiers, and he was a leader of that group.
- "Jeremiah, Jahaziel, Johanan, and Jozabad. Jozabad was from Gederah.
- "Eluzai, Jerimoth, Bealiah, Shemariah, and Shephatiah, who was from Hariph.
- "Elkanah, Isaiah, Azarel, Joezer, and Jashobeam, who all descended from a man named Korah.
- "And, Joelah and Zebadiah, who were the sons of Jeroham from the town called Gedor."

Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the men in the list, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We feel honored to have our names and our tribe remembered like this; or
- People may not remember much about our individual families, but they remember how we fought together for David and Yahweh, and that is what is important; or
- The story of Yahweh and the powerful things he does are what matter most. We feel honored to be a part of that story!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

1 Chronicles 12:1–7

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The men in this passage came to David at Ziklag when David was shut up or restricted because of Saul, the son of Kish. To be shut up or restricted means that David could not travel around freely, but had to stay near Ziklag during this time.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **shut up** or **restricted**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The people had armed these men, or equipped them with **bows**, which they used to shoot arrows, and with slings, which they used to throw stones. When someone "arms" someone, they give that person weapons to fight with. Use the same word for bow as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use to describe that someone **arms** the men with **slings**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

These men were Saul's **kinsmen**, family members, or male relatives. Use the same word for relatives or family members as you have used in previous passages.

Ahiezer was the **chief** or leader of this group of men. To be chief means to be the top leader or head person in charge of a group. Use the same word or phrase for chief or leader as you used in previous passages.

The storyteller describes some of these men as **sons** of other men. In this passage, a son refers to the male child of his parents. Use the same word for sons when it means male children as you have used previously. Sons is in the Master Glossary.

Ishmaiah was a **mighty man** among **The Thirty**. A mighty man means a strong warrior, and here, "The Thirty" refers to David's 30 mighty warriors that the storyteller listed in the last passage. Use the same words or phrases for "mighty men" and "The Thirty" as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 12:1–7

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (5.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Chronicles 12:8–15

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 12:8–15 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:8–15 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:8–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, we learned about the mighty warriors from the Israelite tribe of Benjamin who lived with David in Ziklag and fought alongside David while Saul was still king of Israel. In this story, we will now learn about the warriors from the Israelite tribe of Gad who came to support David even earlier, while David was hiding from Saul in the wilderness, before David went to Ziklag.

This story begins when the storyteller says that some men from the tribe of Gad went over to David at David's stronghold, or protected place, in the wilderness. These were probably some of King Saul's soldiers who became frustrated with Saul and chose to support David instead.

This stronghold was probably somewhere in the wilderness of Judah, or perhaps on the east side of the Jordan River in Moab, but we are not sure where. We know from other stories in the Bible that David had strongholds in several different places in the wilderness.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find the regions of Judah and Moab. Pause this audio here.

The wilderness was a dry, rocky place where people usually did not live because there was no water or good soil to grow food. David's stronghold was probably a place high on top of a mountain, among large rocks—a place where the men would be protected from enemies who might want to attack them.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a place on a high mountain in the wilderness that people may have used for a stronghold. Pause this audio here.

Just like the men of Benjamin in the last story, these men from Gad were also mighty warriors with a lot of experience fighting in battles. These men knew how to fight very well using shields and spears.

Stop here and look at a picture of a shield and a picture of a spear as a group. Pause this audio here.

The men's faces were like the faces of lions. A lion was the strongest and most dangerous of all wild animals in Israel, so this is special language that probably means the men's faces looked fierce and that they were very strong warriors.

Stop here and look at a picture of a lion as a group. Then discuss this question: Where you live, what kind of animals are the most powerful and dangerous? How do people talk about these animals? Also, how do you talk about people who show strength or fierceness like these animals? Pause this audio here.

The men were also as swift, or able to move fast, as gazelles. Gazelles are a type of antelope that can run fast over the rocks, and these warriors could run fast too.

Stop here and look at a picture of a gazelle as a group. Pause this audio here.

There were 11 of these warriors from Gad. The storyteller now lists these men in order of their level of responsibility: Ezer was first as their chief, or leader. Obadiah was second. Eliab was third. Mishmannah was fourth. Jeremiah was fifth. Attai was sixth. Eliel was seventh. Johanan was eighth. Elzabad was ninth. Another Jeremiah was tenth. And Macbannai was eleventh.

All of these men from the tribe of Gad were officers, or leaders, of the military men. Even the weakest of these men could fight against 100, and the strongest of these men could fight against 1,000.

It was these men who once bravely crossed over the Jordan River during the first month of the year, which is the time when the river overflows its banks, or is very deep and wide because of all the water. It would have been very dangerous to cross the river during this time. Then these men fought the people in the valleys there, and those people had to run away. Those people ran to the east and to the west.

Stop here and look at a picture of a river when it is very full of water and overflows its banks.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:8–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: We learn about the mighty men from Gad who joined David at his stronghold in the wilderness before David went to Ziklag. These fierce warriors were experts at fighting with shields and spears, and each man could run very fast. The storyteller gives the name of each of these warriors.

In the second scene: We learn that even the weakest of these warriors could fight 100 enemy soldiers, and the strongest could fight 1,000. Then the storyteller tells about a time when these men crossed over the Jordan River when the water was very high. These men attacked the people who lived in the valley there so that the people ran away to the east and to the west to escape.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Gadite warriors named Ezer, Obadiah, Eliab, Mishmannah, Jeremiah, Attai, Eliel, Johanan, Elzabad, another Jeremiah, and Macbannai
- And the people in the valley on the other side of the Jordan River who ran away from these Gadite warriors

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, we learn about the Gadites, or men from the tribe of Gad, who went to David at David's stronghold in the wilderness. In the original language, "wilderness stronghold" means the top of a mountain where there were caves and large rocks that would protect people from enemies. This would be a place where it would be very difficult for David's enemies to come up and attack David and his men. It is also likely that David and his men could find protection behind rocks if they did have to fight.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Where you live, what do soldiers use for strongholds, or places to protect them from enemies? What natural places do soldiers use for protection, like rocks or mountains, or what types of structures do they build for protection? How do you talk about these places and the way they help to protect the soldiers? Pause this audio here.

These Gadite men were experienced warriors who could fight very well with shields and spears. A shield is a large, flat object that soldiers would carry to protect themselves from their enemies. People usually made shields with a wooden frame and stretched leather over the frame. A soldier would hold this shield in front of him as he went into battle to help protect against arrows, stones, spears, and other enemy attacks.

Stop here and look at a picture of a shield as a group. Pause this audio here.

A spear is a weapon that people made by attaching a sharp blade to the end of a long stick. Soldiers could use a spear to fight up close by thrusting the spear at their enemy. Or soldiers could also throw a spear at an enemy farther away.

Stop here and look at a picture of a spear as a group. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says the faces of these men were like the faces of lions. This is special language that probably means the men could make their faces look very fierce, and that the men were very strong and dangerous fighters, just like a lion is dangerous to its enemies. In ancient Israel, people feared lions more than any other wild animal because lions were such powerful and dangerous animals.

Stop here and look at a picture of a lion again as a group, if needed. Then discuss this question: How will you talk about these men in your translation so that people will understand how the men were fierce-looking and strong like lions? If needed, think about your discussion in step two about people who are fierce and strong like strong animals. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller also says the men were as swift as gazelles on the mountains. This means the men could run extremely fast, even over very rocky ground. Gazelles are a type of antelope that are about a meter long and 60 centimeters tall. These animals can run extremely fast over the rocks in the mountains of the wilderness, so the storyteller says these warriors could do the same thing.

Stop here and again look at a picture of a gazelle as a group, if needed. Then discuss this question: In your translation, how will you talk about these men to show how they could run very fast over the rocky mountain tops like gazelles can run? Pause this audio here.

Next, the storyteller lists the names of each one of these warriors. The list includes 11 Gadite men altogether. The Bible does not talk about these particular men anywhere else in the Old Testament, although some of these men have the same name as some other people in the Bible.

Ezer was the first warrior. Ezer was their chief, or the head man who led the rest of these men. Then the storyteller lists the men in order of their rank. Obadiah was second in command. Eliab was third. Mishmannah was fourth. Jeremiah was fifth. Attai was sixth. Eliel was seventh. Johanan was eighth. Elzabad was ninth. Another Jeremiah was tenth. And Macbannai was eleventh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is a good way to list these names in your translation? Think about the way the storyteller says not just the men's names, but also their order of responsibility. Here are some examples of how you might do this:

- Ezer was their leader. Obadiah was second. Eliab was third; or
- First was Ezer, and he was their leader. Next was Obadiah, and he was second in command. Then came Eliab, who was third; or
- Ezer the first, Obadiah the second, Eliab the third.

Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that all of these Gadite men were officers, or leaders, of the soldiers. We are not certain what the original language means when the storyteller says, "the lesser over a hundred and the greater over a thousand." Some people think this means that the most important of these men led 1,000 Israelite soldiers, while the least important led 100 soldiers. However, most scholars think this means that the most powerful of

these men could fight against 1,000 enemies, while even the weakest of these men could fight against 100. In other words, all of these men were very strong! So it is best to follow this interpretation in your translation too.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this part to show that the strongest men in this group can fight 1,000 enemies, and even the weakest of these men can fight 100? Pause this audio here.

Finally, we hear a short story about a particular battle that these men fought in the past. The storyteller says the men crossed the Jordan River in the first month. The Israelites counted the first month of the year as the time we call March or April. This was the time of year when snow that had fallen on Mount Herman during the winter months began to melt, and also when it rained more often. You will remember that a river is a body of water that flows downhill, usually from a mountain or lake, or perhaps a sea. Usually, over time, the water cuts a deep path into the ground, which we call a "river bed," so that it leaves the higher ground on either side of the river dry. This higher ground on each side of the river we call a "river bank." However, sometimes when a large amount of extra water suddenly flows into the riverbed, like when it rains heavily, or when a lot of snow melts in the mountains very quickly, all of the extra water cannot fit down into the riverbed at once, so the water spills out onto the ground on either side. This makes the river much wider and deeper. This is what the storyteller means when he says that the Jordan River overflowed its banks. And so people usually could not cross the Jordan River at this time of year, because it was too dangerous. However, the storyteller says the men did cross the Jordan. Then the men attacked the people who lived in the valleys, or the lowlands between the hills near the riverbanks.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What happens when there is a lot of water where you live, either from rain or from snow that melts? Where does all the water go, and how does this affect where people can travel? How do you talk about this time of year? Pause this audio here.

We are not certain what the original language means when the storyteller says that the men "put to flight all those in the valleys, to the east and to the west." Most scholars think this means that the Gadite warriors attacked the people who lived in the valleys, and so these people ran away in different directions on both sides of the Jordan River. However, some people instead believe this means that the men attacked at the same time that the river flooded these valleys, and so the floodwaters from the river forced the people to run away to the east and to the west at the same time these men attacked. It is probably best in your translation to follow what most scholars think, so that the men attacked the people who lived in the valleys, and so that the people ran away on both sides of the Jordan River. You will remember that "east" is the direction that the sun rises, and "west" is the direction that the sun sets. The Jordan River flows north to south, so either side of the river is east and west.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:8–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Gadite warriors named Ezer, Obadiah, Eliab, Mishmannah, Jeremiah, Attai, Eliel, Johanan, Elzabad, another Jeremiah, and Macbannai
- And the people in the valley on the other side of the Jordan River who ran away from these Gadite warriors

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller says something like, "Some soldiers from Gad's tribe went to join David's army at David's strong place in the desert. These men were brave warriors who knew how to fight very well using shields and spears. These men could fight like strong, fierce lions. These men could also run very fast like a deer that runs across the mountains. The first man was Ezer, their leader. The second in command was Obadiah. Eliab was third. Mishmannah was fourth. Jeremiah was fifth. Attai was sixth. Eliel was seventh. Johanan was eighth. Elzabad was ninth. Another Jeremiah was tenth. And Macbannai was eleventh." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel so grateful that these strong warriors came to support me when Saul turned against me; or
- These men are some of the toughest warriors I know. I had to fight lions when I was a shepherd, so I know that these men truly are as fierce and strong as those lions! or
- These men would have been more comfortable living with King Saul in the city. I am very grateful that these men were willing to give that up to come fight with me.

Ask the men playing the warriors from the tribe of Gad, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We did not want to dishonor King Saul, but we wanted to support David because we believed that Yahweh was with David; or
- It was difficult to live in the wilderness, but we were strong warriors and knew how to survive and fight very well there; or
- David's stronghold in the rocks was not comfortable, but it was very strong and easy to defend from our enemies. David chose a wise place to stay.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, the storyteller says something like, "These men from the tribe of Gad were leaders in the army. Even the weakest of these men was as powerful as 100 normal soldiers, and the strongest of the men could fight against 1,000 men. It was these men who went across the Jordan River at the first of the year when the river filled so full of water that it overflowed. And these men fought the people who lived in the valleys so that the people ran away to both sides of the river." Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the warriors from Gad, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We were some of the very best warriors in Israel. We were not afraid of anything! or
- Most people could not cross the river when it was flooded. But that is why it was such a good time for us to attack, because no one expected it!

Ask the people who are playing the people in the valleys, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We were startled and terrified! We had no idea where this army of warriors had come from so suddenly; or
- Normally, we did not cross the river at this time of year, because we were afraid we might drown. But we were so afraid of these warriors that some of us did not hesitate but ran and crossed the river to get away.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:8–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, we learn about the **Gadites** who went to David at David's stronghold in the wilderness. You will remember that Gadites are the tribe of people who descended from Gad, one of Jacob's 12 sons. Use the same word or phrase for Gadites as you used in previous passages.

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A **stronghold** is a fortified, secure place that soldiers use for refuge or as a center of defense during battle. A stronghold might be something people build, like a high, strong wall. But here, David's stronghold was probably a natural place in the rocks, on a high mountain, where people could not easily crawl up, but where the men could fight back from behind the protection of the large rocks. Use the same word or phrase for a natural stronghold as you used in previous passages. For more information on stronghold, refer to the Master Glossary.

Wilderness is a dry, barren place without water and usually with very few bushes or trees. The wilderness around Israel is very rocky and mountainous in some places, and this was the kind of place where David had his stronghold. Use the same word or phrase for wilderness as you used in previous passages. For more information on wilderness, refer to the Master Glossary.

The men could handle a **shield** and a **spear**. Use the same words or phrases for shield and spear as you have used previously.

The storyteller says that these men's faces were like the faces of **lions**. This is special language that probably means these men looked very fierce and were very strong, so that other people would be afraid to fight these men. A lion is a very large, wild cat. Lions were one of the strongest animals in ancient Israel, and people were more afraid of lions than any other animal. Lions would often attack and eat other large animals, like sheep. Most people were afraid of lions. Use the same word or phrase for lion as you used in previous passages.

The storyteller also says that these men were as **swift** as gazelles upon the mountains. To be swift means to move very quickly or to run very, very fast. A gazelle is a type of antelope that lived in ancient Israel and could run and jump across the rocks on the mountains very quickly without losing its footing. People who can run fast on flat ground usually cannot move fast over the rocks in these mountains, but the storyteller says that these men could, just like the gazelles that live in this place.

Stop here as a group and again look at a picture of a gazelle, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **gazelle**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that Ezer was the **chief** of these 11 men. To be chief means to be the top leader or head person in charge of a group. However, the storyteller uses the same word to say that all of these Gadite men were chiefs, or leaders, of the army. So this means that Ezer was in charge of the other 10 men in this list, but all 11 of the men were also in charge of other soldiers. Use the same words or phrases for chief or military leader that you used in previous passages.

It was this group of men who crossed over the Jordan River when the river was overflowing its banks. Remember that a river that overflows its banks becomes much wider and deeper than normal.

Stop here as a group and again look at a picture of a river overflowing its banks, if needed. Then discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**overflowing its banks**." If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

These Gadite warriors **put to flight** all the people in the valleys. To put people to flight means to chase those people or to make them run away. Use the same word or phrase for "put to flight" or chase as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 12:8–15

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.1 MB)
- Setting the Stage (3.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (8.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 12:16–18

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 12:16–18 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:16–18 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:16–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, we learned about the warriors from the tribe of Gad who joined David at his stronghold in the wilderness. Now, in this story, we will learn about men from the tribes of Benjamin and Judah who also came to David during this time. We do not know if this story happened before or after the last story about the men of Gad. But we do know that it happened when David was still at his wilderness stronghold, before David went to Ziklag. You will remember from the previous passage that this stronghold was a place in the mountains with many large rocks where David and his men could protect themselves from their enemies. You will also remember that the wilderness is a very dry place without water and with very few plants or trees. Because of this, people usually do not live in the wilderness.

Stop here as a group and look again at a picture of a place on a high mountain in the wilderness that people may have used for a stronghold. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller of Chronicles would have known that the tribes of Judah and Benjamin stayed together even when the nation of Israel later split into two kingdoms. That may be why the storyteller talks about these two tribes together throughout the book of Chronicles. Most Israelites of the time thought of the tribes of Judah and Benjamin together, so it would have made sense that these men came to David together at the same time.

Stop here as a group and look at a map that shows where the tribes of Judah and Benjamin lived. Pause this audio here.

When these men arrived at David's stronghold, David came out of the stronghold to meet the men and speak to them. David told the men that if they had come as friends to help David, then David welcomed the men to stay. But if the men had come to help David's enemies kill David, even though David had done nothing wrong, then David prayed that God would punish these men.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Act out a story about a time when someone came from far away to visit your community. Show how, at first, you were not sure if you could trust this person as a friend, or if the person might be an enemy. Act out how you talked to this person. How did you greet this person in a polite but cautious way? Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller mentions that Amasai, "chief of The Thirty," spoke to David. We do not hear the name Amasai anywhere else in the Bible, so we are not certain who Amasai was. Some scholars believe this is a different name for Abigail's son, whom Absalom made captain in Joab's place earlier in the book of 1 Chronicles. Others think Amasai might be another name for the son of Zeruiah, who we also heard about earlier in 1 Chronicles, but this seems unlikely. Whoever Amasai was, the storyteller shows that Amasai later became an important leader of David's 30 mighty men. You will remember from a previous story how we learned about the 30 men who fought for David. In that story, the storyteller said that a different man named Abishai was chief of those 30 men. So, while Amasai was not the leader of these men at the time of this story, it seems Amasai became their leader at a later time.

The storyteller says that God's Spirit came upon Amasai, or took control of Amasai, and gave him power and words from God to speak. Amasai said that he and the men would serve David, Jesse's son, because they had come to help David. Then Amasai asked God to bless David, because Amasai knew that God was with David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time in your community when God or a spirit took control of a person. What did the person do or say? How did other people respond? Pause this audio here.

Then David accepted these men as his friends and made them officers in David's army.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:16–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Some men from the tribes of Benjamin and Judah come to David's stronghold in the wilderness. David goes out to meet the men. David tells the men that if they have come as friends, the men are welcome to stay. But if the men have come to help David's enemies, even though David has done nothing wrong, then David prays that God will punish these men.

In the second scene: God's spirit takes control of Amasai, who later became the leader of David's 30 warriors. Amasai says that he and the other men will serve David, the son of Jesse, because they have come to help David. Amasai also asks God to bless David, because Amasai and these men know that God is with David.

In the third scene: David accepts these men as his friends, and David makes the men leaders in his army of soldiers.

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The characters in this passage are:

- Men from the tribes of Benjamin and Judah
- David
- God
- God's Spirit
- And Amasai

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller starts with a word in the original language that some people translate as "one time." We do not know exactly when this time was, but we do know that it was while David was still staying at his stronghold in the wilderness.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a real thing that happened in the past without saying exactly when it happened. As you tell the story, pay attention to the words you use to talk about time in a general way rather than using specific times. Pause this audio here.

As the story begins, some descendants of Benjamin and Judah come to David's stronghold. You will remember that King Saul was from the tribe of Benjamin. You will also remember that Saul wanted to kill David. So it is very surprising that these men would come to help David. However, the storyteller does not mention that the men were disloyal to King Saul.

You will also remember from a previous story how warriors from the tribe of Benjamin came to David when David was at Ziklag. Although those men were also Benjamites, that story happened after the time this story happened. We know this because this story happens when David is still in the wilderness, before David goes to Ziklag.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think of two different stories that are connected in some way. For example, maybe these two stories are about the same person, or maybe they happened in the same place. Now tell the two stories, but tell them in the opposite order of how they happened. As you tell the stories, pay attention to how you talk about when the stories happened. For example, when you tell the second story, how do you show that it happened before the first story happened? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that David now goes out to face these men. This means that David comes close to the men and stands so that when the men look right in front of them, they see David, who stands there and looks at their faces. David says, "If you have come in peace to help me, I am ready for you to join me." To come in peace means to be friends with a person and not harm that person.

David continues, "But if you come to betray me to my enemies, when my hands are free from violence, then may the God of our ancestors see it and judge you." The phrase "my hands are free from violence" is special language that means that David has not hurt anyone physically. You will remember in previous stories how David chose not to kill King Saul, even when David could have done so very easily. So David is reminding these men of this.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Act out a story about a group of people who get angry and accuse someone of doing a bad thing even though that person has not done that thing. Have the person talk to the angry group and explain how they are not guilty. Pay attention to what words the person uses to describe how they are innocent. Pause this audio here.

When David talks about "the God of our ancestors," David means the one true God, Yahweh, whom all of the Israelites follow. So David is reminding the men that if the men pretend to be friends, but then they hurt David, the one true God will see not only that David is innocent, but also that these men have harmed David, and God will punish the men for it. In other words, David wants the men to be afraid to harm David because they fear God, even if they are not afraid of David himself.

As David stops speaking, God's spirit suddenly "clothes" Amasai, or comes on Amasai. This is special language that means that God literally took control of Amasai's whole body and made Amasai speak. Since this is the first time the storyteller has mentioned Amasai's name, he says here that this is the Amasai who later became the chief leader of The Thirty, or the special group of warriors who led all of David's soldiers.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your translation, how will you talk about how God took control of Amasai and made Amasai speak these words? If needed, look back at the conversation you had in step two to see how you talked about this. Pause this audio here.

Amasai says, “We are yours, David! We are with you, son of Jesse!” Where Amasai says “we,” Amasai means all of the men of Benjamin and Judah who had come to David. You will remember that David’s father is Jesse. In ancient Israel, people used the father’s name to show which family a person came from, much like many people use surnames today.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you name people so that you know what family or tribe they belong to? What will be the best way to translate “David, son of Jesse” in your language so that people will understand what it means? Pause this audio here.

Amasai continues, “Peace, peace to you, and peace to your helpers!” In the original language, the word peace means more than just the absence of war. Peace means that people will live well and be prosperous. So Amasai asks God to make David and David’s men successful.

Finally, Amasai says, “For your God helps you.” In the original language, the words Amasai uses here show that Amasai knows that God has helped David in the past and also that God continues to help David.

Finally, David receives these men as his friends, and David makes the men officers, or leaders, of his fighting men.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:16–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Men from the tribes of Benjamin and Judah
- David
- God
- God’s Spirit
- And Amasai

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller says something like, “One time, other men from the tribes of Benjamin and Judah also came to David at the stronghold. David went out to meet these men, and David said, ‘If you have come here to help me, we can be friends. But if you have come to tell my enemies where I am hiding, even though I have not done anything wrong, I pray that God will punish you.’” Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I hope these men want to be my friends, because I need strong warriors to fight with me; or

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- I am not sure if I can trust these men. I thought Saul was my friend, but then Saul tried to kill me even though I fought to protect Saul and his kingdom. So maybe these men want to kill me too; or
- I know that these men could lie to me, but God will know if they are lying. So I will ask God to protect me.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, the storyteller says something like, "Amasai, who later became the leader of the 30 warriors, was one of these men who came to David. God's Spirit took control of Amasai, and he said, 'We will serve you, David, Jesse's son. We have come to help you! May God bless you and give you success, and may God bless those who help you!'" Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Amasai, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- That was amazing! I did not know what I was going to say to David, but suddenly I felt this power come over me, and it gave me just the right words to say! or
- I was afraid David might think I was lying if I said we were his friends. But I think David could tell that God was speaking through me and that God sent us to help David.

Ask the people playing the men from Benjamin and Judah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We were not sure what to say to David, but what Amasai said was perfect! or
- We came to David because we believed that God was with David. And now that we have seen how God gave Amasai these words to say, we feel even more confident that God is blessing David.

Continue the drama. Finally, David accepts these men as his friends, and David makes the men leaders in his army of soldiers. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Amasai and the rest of the men from Benjamin and Judah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We feel so happy that David decided to trust us and to let us stay and fight in his army; or
- We feel honored that David chose us to be leaders over his men. We will be brave and strong leaders, and because God is on David's side, we know we will be successful.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:16–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, we learn about men, or the "**sons**" of Benjamin and of Judah, who come to David's stronghold. You will remember that Benjamin and Judah were two of Jacob's 12 sons. Sons of Benjamin means **descendants** of Jacob's son Benjamin, and sons of Judah means descendants of Jacob's son Judah. Use the same word or phrase for "sons" when it means "descendants" that you used in previous passages. For more information, look up descendants in the Master Glossary.

A **stronghold** is a fortified, secure place that soldiers use for refuge or as a center of defense during battle. In this case, the stronghold is natural, probably in caves and rocks in the hills. Use the same word or phrase for natural stronghold as you used in previous passages. For more information on stronghold, refer to the Master Glossary.

David says that if the men came peacefully or to be friends with David, then David's heart will be united with the men. In the Bible, the heart is special language for the place inside a person where that person's thoughts, feelings, and decisions happen. To unite means to join or to come together as one. Remember that the idea of peace is more than just the absence of war. When someone has peace with someone else, they live in harmony, as friends, and are content with each other, with God, and with things around them.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **peace** and "**heart would be united**." Look up heart and peace in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David also talks about what will happen if the men betray David to his adversaries. To betray someone means to be disloyal to them or act unfaithfully. For example, you might betray someone if you tell that person's secret

1 Chronicles 12:16–18

to other people or you act in a way that harms or deceives that person. In the original language, the word for adversaries here means the kind of enemies who oppress David and cause him great emotional stress or anguish.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **betray** and **adversaries**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David says that if these men try to hurt David, then David asks the God of their **fathers** to rebuke the men. Here, fathers refers not to their literal fathers, but to the ancestors of David and these men who came many generations before them. Use the same word or phrase for fathers, when fathers means ancestors, as you used in previous passages.

In the original language, the idea of rebuke means both to decide and to punish or condemn, much like a judge must first decide if a person is guilty of a crime, and then the judge must decide what punishment to give the person for their crime.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **rebuke**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says the Spirit clothed Amasai, the **chief** or **leader** of **The Thirty**. Translate "chief or leader," and "The Thirty," the same way you have in previous passages. "The Thirty" refers to the 30 mighty men who fought for David. Spirit means the spirit of God. The Bible often used special language to describe God's Spirit as like a wind or breath of air that blows over a person. The word clothed is also special language. It means to dress or to cover like clothes cover a person's body. The way the storyteller uses these two words together is similar to other passages in the Bible that describe how God's Spirit took control of a person so that the person prophesied, or spoke words from God. The New Testament describes God's Spirit as the Holy Spirit, which God gives to all believers in Jesus for all time. But in the Old Testament, God's Spirit only came on a few people, and only for a certain period of time. People do not translate "Spirit" in the Old Testament the same way they translate "Holy Spirit" in the New Testament. However, you can refer to Holy Spirit in the Master Glossary to learn more about the work of God's Spirit in the Old Testament.

Stop here and discuss as a group what phrase you will use for "**the Spirit clothed Amasai**." If you have already translated this idea in another book of the Old Testament, use the same phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The passage ends when the storyteller says that David received the men and made them **leaders**, or **officers** of David's raiding bands. The word for leaders here is the same word as that for chiefs previously, but these kinds of chiefs are leaders in charge of other fighting men. Use the same word or phrase for officers or leaders as you used in previous passages. Raiding bands are fighting men who attack to steal what they want, like food and weapons, and to create fear and chaos among the people they attack.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **raiding bands**. If you have already translated this idea in another book of the Old Testament, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 12:16–18

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (3.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 12:19–22

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 12:19–22 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:19–22 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:19–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, we learned about men from the tribes of Benjamin and Judah who came to David at his stronghold in the wilderness. There, David and Amasai spoke to each other. Amasai blessed David and said that Amasai and the men with Amasai would serve David. The story ended when the storyteller said that David made these men leaders over David's raiding bands.

In this story, we will now hear how men from the tribe of Manasseh also joined David when David lived at Ziklag. David went to live in Ziklag after the events in the last story.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of Israel. Find the city of Ziklag again, if needed. Pause this audio here.

This story begins when some men from the tribe of Manasseh left Saul's army and went over to join David's army instead. This happened at the time when David went with the Philistines to the battle against Saul. We know from 1 Samuel 29, which also tells this story, that David went to this battle with King Achish, a king of the

1 Chronicles 12:19–22

Philistines. You will remember that David and his men first hid from Saul at a stronghold in the wilderness, but then later David found protection with King Achish, who gave David the city of Ziklag to live in. Because of this, King Achish probably expected David to help him fight in this battle.

However, David and his men did not help the Philistines fight this battle after all. When David and his men arrived at the battlefield, the other leaders of the Philistines said to each other that if they allowed David to fight alongside them, David might switch loyalties and begin to fight for Saul against the Philistines as a way to make Saul happy with David again. If David did this, then Saul and David together would be able to win the battle and kill the Philistines. So King Achish sent David and David's men back home to Ziklag.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Tell a story about a game where two teams of people compete, like soccer or another physical sport. At first, both teams have the same number of skilled players, so neither team is able to easily win. Then tell how some players from one team suddenly switch to the other team so that the bigger and stronger team quickly wins the game. Pause this audio here.

It was while David and his men returned to Ziklag that these men from Manasseh left Saul's army and came to join David and his men. The names of the leaders of these men from the tribe of Manasseh were Adnah, Jozabad, Jediael, Michael, another Jozabad, Elihu, and Zillethai. Each one of these men was the leader of 1,000 soldiers.

In the original language, we are not sure what the next part of the story means. The storyteller may say that these soldiers of Manasseh helped fight a group of raiders. This would most likely refer to the story in 1 Samuel 30, which tells how the Amalekites burned Ziklag while David and his men were away. Or the storyteller may say that these soldiers from Manasseh helped David when they became leaders over David's own raiders, or troops. Either way, the storyteller says that these men were brave warriors and that eventually they became commanders in David's army.

Finally, the storyteller says that day after day, more and more men came to help David until David had a very great army, like the army of God. This does not mean that David's army had more men than Saul's. Instead, it means that David's army was very powerful because God was with them.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:19–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: We learn about men from the tribe of Manasseh who left Saul and joined David's army. This happened when David went with the Philistines to fight in the battle against Saul. But David and his men did not fight in this battle. Instead, when David arrived, the Philistine leaders said, "David may turn against us and instead fight for Saul. And if he does, they will kill us all!" So they sent David back home to Ziklag.

In the second scene: We learn the names of the men of Manasseh who left Saul and joined David while David returned to Ziklag. These men helped David and his soldiers. These men were brave warriors and became leaders in David's army.

In the third scene: The storyteller says that each day after this story happened, again and again, more men came to help David. So David had a large and powerful army that God made.

The characters in this passage are:

- Men from the tribe of Manasseh
- David
- The Philistines
- Saul
- The leaders of the Philistines
- The leaders of the men from Manasseh named Adnah, Jozabad, Jediael, Michael, another Jozabad, Elihu, and Zillethai

- And God

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller says that some men from the tribe of Manasseh defected to David. In the original language, this literally means that the men "fell to" David. Although the storyteller does not specifically mention Saul's name here, we know that this means the men deserted Saul, or stopped being loyal to Saul, and instead left and became loyal to David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you talk about someone who leaves the group of people they are a part of and instead becomes loyal to an enemy group? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says these men defected to David at the time when David went with the Philistines to fight against Saul in battle. That story, which we hear about in 1 Samuel chapters 27 through 29, happened at an earlier time when David and his men lived at Ziklag. "But," the storyteller adds, "David and his men did not help the Philistines." This is because the rulers of the Philistines talked together and decided it was too dangerous to allow David to fight with them. In the original language, the Philistine rulers literally said to one another, "For our heads, he will fall away to his master Saul." This means that to try to make Saul happy with David, during the battle, David might make his men turn and fight against the Philistines instead of against Saul. Then Saul might easily win the battle and kill the Philistines. People often cut off the heads of their enemies to show they had won a battle, just like David once cut off Goliath's head. This is probably why the Philistine rulers said David might do this "for our heads."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you talk about something that might happen, but you are not sure if it will? How do you talk about the consequences if that thing does happen? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, as David and his men return to Ziklag, the men who defect and come to join David are Adnah, Jozabad, Jediael, Michael, another man with the same name Jozabad, Elihu, and Zillethai. We do not hear these men's names anywhere else in the Bible, so we do not know anything more about these men except that they each command 1,000 soldiers from the tribe of Manasseh. Since there are two men with the same name, Jozabad, in this story, you may wish to say that in your translation.

The storyteller says these men from the tribe of Manasseh helped David. We are not sure if the original language says the men helped David "against" the raiding bands, or "over" the raiding bands. If the word means "against," this may refer to how these men helped David and his men fight the Amalekites who raided Ziklag, which we hear about in a story in 1 Samuel 30. But if it means "over," this may refer to how these men helped David by later serving as leaders over David's soldiers, who often raided other towns themselves.

In the third scene, the storyteller has finished his story about the men of Manasseh. But the storyteller wants to say one more important thing about all of the stories he has told in this chapter about the men who have come to David. The storyteller says that day after day, men continued to come to help David. This does not mean that the same men came again and again, but rather that new men continued to come each day so that David's army grew bigger and bigger.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you say this in your translation so it will be clear that different men came each day and not the same men over and over again? Pause this audio here.

Finally, the storyteller says that David's army became very great, "like an army of God." In the original language, these words show not only that David had many soldiers, but more importantly, that God was the one who brought these men together and that the men were strong because God gave them God's power.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this part of the story to make it clear that it was God who made David's army strong? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:19–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

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In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Men from the tribe of Manasseh
- David
- The Philistines
- Saul
- The leaders of the Philistines
- The leaders of the men from Manasseh named Adnah, Jozabad, Jediael, Michael, another Jozabad, Elihu, and Zillethai
- And God

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller says, "Some men from Manasseh's tribe also joined David's army. These men came to David when David went with the Philistines to fight against Saul. But David and his men actually did not help the Philistines fight Saul. Instead, the Philistine leaders discussed it and decided to send David away. The leaders did this because they were afraid David might betray them during the battle and help Saul fight and kill the Philistines instead." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I do not want to fight against Saul, but I feel obligated to go with King Achish to the battle because he was kind to me and gave me Ziklag to live in; or
- I was always loyal to Saul, but Saul has put me in a difficult situation here! or
- I know God does not want me to kill King Saul. Maybe God will make a way so that my men and I do not have to fight in the battle.

Ask the people playing the Philistine leaders, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- David seemed very loyal to Saul before Saul chased David away. How can we be sure David does not still want to help Saul? or
- David's army is not very big, but they are very strong. We are afraid of what David's army could do if they turned against us; or
- We still remember when David's God helped David kill Goliath. We are not sure we can trust David and his God.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, the storyteller says, "So David returned to Ziklag, and these men from Manasseh went with David. The men were Adnah, Jozabad, Jediael, Michael, another man whose name was also Jozabad, Elihu, and Zillethai. Each of these men was the leader of 1,000 soldiers, and all of those soldiers belonged to the tribe called Manasseh. They helped David fight against bad men who went around the country stealing things from people. All of these men were brave soldiers, and they became officers in David's army." Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the men from the tribe of Manasseh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We do not want to be disloyal to Saul, but we see that God is with David, and we want to be on God's side; or

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- David follows God's laws, but Saul is trying to murder David. If we must fight, we must fight for what is right.

Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am grateful to God for sending these brave and strong men to help me! or
- I can see that these men are very experienced in battle. Maybe one day I will make these men leaders over the rest of my soldiers.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, the storyteller says, "Every day, more men came to help David until his army became large and powerful, like an army of God." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- For a time, I felt like God had abandoned me. But now I can see that God is taking care of everything; or
- We may not have as many men as Saul, but God sent me some of the best and bravest soldiers in Israel.

Ask the person playing Saul, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I tried to kill David because I felt threatened by David's power. But now my men are leaving me and going to David, so things are even worse than before!

Ask the person playing God, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am pleased with David for trying to do the right thing even when Saul tried to murder David; or
- I will send more men to support David so that David will know I am with him; or
- I will give David's soldiers my power and protection, and I will help them succeed in their battles, because I am pleased with David.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:19–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The story begins when the storyteller says that some men from the tribe of Manasseh defected, or deserted, to David. In the original language, this word literally means the men "fell to" David. Although the storyteller does not specifically mention Saul's name here, the idea is that these men quit their loyalty to Saul in order to go help David and his army instead.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **defected**, or **deserted**. Pause this audio here.

The Philistine **rulers** took counsel or consulted together about David. You will remember that a ruler means a lord, or someone who has authority over other people. Use the same word or phrase for ruler as you used in previous passages. In the Bible, when people took counsel, it meant that they came close together and discussed or debated something before they made a final decision about it.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **took counsel**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The Philistine rulers were afraid that David would fight for his lord, or master, Saul. A lord is a person who is a master over someone else and has authority over them. People often call their kings or gods "lord."

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **lord**. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about lord. Pause this audio here.

The men from the tribe of Manasseh helped David fight against a **raiding band**. You will remember that a raiding band is a group of people who attack without good reason in order to steal things or capture people. These people often attack suddenly and violently when people are not expecting an enemy, and then they move on very quickly before people can organize and fight back. Use the same word or phrase for "raiding band" as you used in previous passages.

These men fought very well because they were **mighty men of valor**. This means they were very strong and brave. Use the same word or phrase for “strong and brave men” as you used in previous passages.

David eventually made these men **commanders** in his army. Commanders are the same thing as chiefs, or leaders over groups of soldiers. Use the same word or phrase for military commanders or leaders as you used in previous passages.

Day after day, men continued to come help David until there was a great army, like an **army of God**. Here, “army of God” means it was not only a large army, but also that God made this army and gave the men their strength.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 12:19–22

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.1 MB)
- Setting the Stage (3.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Chronicles 12:23–40

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 12:23–40 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:23–40 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:23–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, we learned about men from the tribe of Manasseh who left Saul and joined David's army. That story happened while David and his men were away from Ziklag during the battle between Saul and the Philistines. The storyteller also completed the last several stories by saying that day after day, new people continued to come to help David until David had a very great army.

In this story, we now hear a complete list of the armies that came to David at Hebron. You will remember that David went to Hebron after he lived in Ziklag, so this story happened after the last story. The storyteller begins when he says that these are the numbers of the soldiers who came to join David's army at Hebron. These soldiers came prepared to fight because they wanted to make David the new king after Saul. The storyteller reminds us that Yahweh had promised these things would happen.

Now we hear the list of soldiers, in groups, of each tribe of Israel. The storyteller gives these in order of where the tribes live, going from the south of Israel to the north.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find the area where each tribe lived. Also find the city of Hebron. Pause this audio here.

From the tribe of Judah, 6,800 soldiers came to David at Hebron. These soldiers carried shields and spears.

From the tribe of Simeon, 7,100 men came to Hebron. The storyteller calls these men brave warriors.

From the tribe of Levi, 4,600 men came to Hebron. This group of men included Jehoiada, a prince or leader of Aaron's clan who led 3,700 men. The group also included Zadok, a brave young warrior who came with 22 military commanders from his family group.

From the tribe of Benjamin, 3,000 men came to Hebron. Here, the storyteller reminds us that the tribe of Benjamin was the tribe Saul came from, and most of this tribe had stayed loyal to Saul until this time.

From the tribe of Ephraim, 20,800 men came to Hebron. The storyteller calls these men brave warriors and says that people from these men's clans respected these men very much.

From the half-tribe of Manasseh, 18,000 men came to Hebron. The storyteller mentions that the clans that these men came from specifically chose these men to go and help make David king. Also, you will remember that the tribe of Manasseh was divided into two parts, or "half-tribes." This half of Manasseh was the part that lived on the west side of the Jordan River.

Stop here as a group and again look at a map of Israel that shows the areas where each tribe lived. Find the west side of the Jordan River where this half of the tribe of Manasseh lived. Pause this audio here.

From the tribe of Issachar, 200 chiefs, or military leaders, came with all of their men. The storyteller does not give the entire number of soldiers in this group. However, the storyteller does say that these were wise men who understood the times and knew what Israel should do. We are not sure exactly what the storyteller means by this, but he probably means that these 200 men were wise political leaders and that other people listened to these men and followed what they said.

From the tribe of Zebulun, 50,000 men came to Hebron. These men had a lot of experience fighting in battle, and they came armed with all sorts of weapons. These men came to help David and to obey him completely.

From the tribe of Naphtali, 1,000 military commanders came with 37,000 men who carried shields and spears.

From the tribe of Dan, 28,600 men to Hebron.

From the tribe of Asher, 40,000 men came to Hebron. The storyteller calls these men experienced soldiers prepared for battle.

Finally, the storyteller tells us that 120,000 soldiers came from the east side of the Jordan River to Hebron. These men were from the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the other half-tribe of Manasseh. These men came armed with every type of weapon. This shows that the men were a very powerful army.

Stop here as a group and find where the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and this half of the tribe of Manasseh lived on the east side of the Jordan River. Pause this audio here.

All of the men in this list were soldiers ready to fight in battle. All of these men came to Hebron because they wanted to make David king over all Israel. And all of the people of Israel agreed that David should become king.

All of the men spent three days there in Hebron with David, where they ate and drank during a celebration feast. The storyteller says that these men's brothers prepared all of the food for them. Their "brothers" were probably the people from the tribe of Judah who lived in Hebron. But it was people from all of the tribes of Israel who brought all of this food. People even came from as far as away as the tribes of Issachar, Zebulun, and Naphtali. The storyteller probably mentions these specific tribes because they lived in the far north of Israel and had to come the farthest. This shows just how much people wanted David to be king.

Stop here and look again at a map of Israel as a group. Find where Issachar, Zebulun, and Naphtali lived and how far away that was from Hebron. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about an event or celebration in your community where people came from other places to attend. Now tell a story about an event that was so unusual and special that people from very far away came to this event even though they did not come to other events because of the great distance. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says how all of these people brought all of the food on donkeys, camels, mules, and oxen, which are all large, four-legged animals that people used to carry heavy burdens. People brought all kinds of food that included flour, cakes of figs, clusters of raisins, wine and oil, and oxen and sheep for meat. Again, the storyteller shows us just how much people wanted to support David and his men.

Finally, the storyteller says that the people did all of these things because the people in Israel felt very joyful.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:23–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: We learn about the groups of soldiers from each of the tribes of Israel who came to Hebron to help David fight and to make him king of Israel.

In the second scene: We learn more about how much these men and all the people of Israel wanted David to become king. We also learn how all of these men celebrated a feast with David for three days, and how people from all of the tribes of Israel brought food for these men to eat.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Saul
- Yahweh
- Soldiers who came to Hebron from all the tribes of Israel, including Judah, Simeon, Levi, Benjamin, Ephraim, the half-tribe of Manasseh from west of the Jordan River, Issachar, Zebulun, Naphtali, Dan, Asher, Reuben, Gad, and the other half-tribe of Manasseh from the east side of the Jordan River

- Jehoiada, the leader of the family of Aaron, which was part of the tribe of Levi
- Zadok and the 22 military commanders who were also from the tribe of Levi
- The 200 chiefs of Issachar
- And all of the people of Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller begins when he says that these are the numbers of the troops, or men armed for battle, who came to David at Hebron. The reason these men came to Hebron was to turn Saul's kingdom over to David. This means that the men wanted to take control of the kingdom away from Saul's family and make David king instead. Although the storyteller does not say it here, we know that Saul had died in battle. However, a king's son or another close family member of the king would often become the new king. So the men in this story came ready to go to battle, if needed, to make David king instead. The storyteller says that this was according to the word of Yahweh, which means this is what Yahweh had already said would happen.

The storyteller will now begin to list each of the tribes of Israel and some details about each group.

Stop here and discuss: How will you structure the information about each tribe in this story? For example, will you say the name of the tribe or the number of people first? Will you use longer sentences like a story, or will you use shorter sentences like a list? Here are some examples of ways you might say it:

- Six thousand eight hundred men from the tribe of Judah came armed for battle. These men carried shields and spears. Seven thousand one hundred men came from the tribe of Simeon. These men were brave soldiers ready for war...; or
- Judah: 6,800 men armed with shields and spears. Simeon: 7,100 well-trained men....

Pause this audio here.

From Judah's tribe, 6,800 men came to David at Hebron. These men carried shields and spears. These men knew how to fight very well. You will remember that a shield is a large, flat object that soldiers would carry to protect themselves from their enemies, and a spear is a weapon that people made when they attached a sharp blade to the end of a long stick.

Stop here as a group and look again at a picture of a shield and a spear, if needed. Pause this audio here.

From Simeon's tribe, 7,100 men came. The storyteller calls these men "mighty men of valor," which means these men were very brave and knew how to fight very well.

From Levi's tribe, 4,600 men came. Jehoiada, who was a prince or leader of Aaron's clan, came with 3,700 men, and Zadok, who was a brave young soldier, came with 22 military commanders. We know that these men were part of the Levite tribe, but it is not clear in the original language if the 3,700 men and 22 officers were part of the 4,600 Levites or if they were in addition to those men. However, most scholars agree that these men were part of the 4,600.

Stop here and discuss how you will translate this part of the story so people will understand that the men with Jehoiada and Zadok are part of the 4,600 Levites. For example, one way you might say this is, "From Levi's tribe, 4,600 men came. Jehoiada was one of these men. He was a prince or leader of Aaron's clan, and he commanded 3,700 soldiers. Zadok was also in that group of Levites. Zadok was a brave young soldier, and he came with 22 military commanders from his clan." Pause this audio here.

From Benjamin's tribe, 3,000 men came. The storyteller calls these men the relatives, or brothers, of Saul. This is because these men all descended from the same ancestor, Benjamin. The storyteller says that until this story happened, the majority had served Saul faithfully. In the original language, it is not clear if this means the majority of all the people from the tribe of Benjamin, or if it just means the majority of these 3,000 soldiers.

From Ephraim's tribe, 20,800 men came. These men were brave soldiers, and the people in their clans respected these men very much.

From the half-tribe of Manasseh, 18,000 men came. The leaders of the clans these men came from chose these men by name to come and help David become king. To call "by name" means that they chose each man carefully

and individually out of all of the men in this tribe. You will remember that this half of the tribe of Manasseh lived on the west side of the Jordan River.

Stop here and discuss: Bible translations talk about the two half-tribes of Manasseh in different ways. For example, one translation says “West Manasseh” and “East Manasseh.” Another translation says, “from the half-tribe of Manasseh west of the Jordan.” As a group, stop now and discuss how you will talk about this in your translation so that it will be easy for everyone to understand. Pause this audio here.

From the tribe of Issachar came 200 chiefs and all of the men from their tribe who obeyed the chiefs’ commands. The storyteller says that these officers “understood the times to know what Israel ought to do.” Some people think this means the men were astrologers, or people who watch where the stars move in the night sky as a sign for what people should do. But most scholars agree that this probably just means that these were very wise men who understood what Israel needed to do at this time.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you talk about people who are very wise and can help people know what they should do in different situations? Pause this audio here.

From the tribe of Zebulun, 50,000 men came. These men were brave warriors who came ready to fight in battle with different types of weapons. These men were completely faithful to David.

From Naphtali, 1,000 military commanders came with 37,000 men who carried shields and spears.

From Dan, 28,600 men came. All of these men came ready to fight in battle.

From Asher, 40,000 men came. These men were all trained soldiers who were also ready to fight in battle.

Finally, from the east side of the Jordan River, 120,000 men came. These soldiers belonged to the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the other half of the tribe of Manasseh. These men came armed with many different kinds of weapons.

The storyteller says that all of these men came “arrayed in battle order” to Hebron. To be arrayed in battle order means to come together in a battle line. Soldiers would often stand together in a long line, side by side, before marching forward together toward the enemy in battle, so this probably means these men marched to Hebron in a similar way.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your translation, how will you describe the way the soldiers came together in a battle line? Pause this audio here.

All of these men were soldiers who were ready for battle. And these men came to Hebron with a “whole heart” to make David king. The storyteller also says that the rest of the people in Israel were of a “single mind.” The Bible often talks about the heart as the center of a person where that person’s thoughts, feelings, and decisions live. But in a similar way, the Bible also talks about the mind as the place where people think and make decisions. So here, these two phrases have a very similar meaning. “Whole heart” means that these men had the very same desire or purpose when they came to David, and “single mind” means that everyone had the same idea and agreed that they too wanted David to be king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When people agree about something they want to happen, and those people come together to make it happen, how do you talk about this? Pause this audio here.

All of these men spent three days there with David, eating and drinking, because their brothers prepared it for them. This means the men had a feast or celebration together, and their brothers cooked or prepared all of this food. “Their brothers” probably means the people from the tribe of Judah who lived in Hebron. And also their neighbors from as far away as Issachar, Zebulun, and Naphtali came and brought food on donkeys, camels, mules, and oxen. You will remember that all four of these are large, four-legged animals that people used to carry people and heavy burdens on a journey.

Stop here and look at pictures of a donkey, a camel, a mule, and oxen as a group. Pause this audio here.

The people brought abundant provisions, which means a very large amount of food, to feed the men. These provisions included flour to make bread, cakes of figs, clusters of raisins, wine, oil, and oxen and sheep for meat.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of flour and bread, cakes of figs, clusters of raisins, wine, oil, oxen, and sheep. Pause his audio here.

Finally, the storyteller says that the people brought all of this food because there was joy in Israel. In the Bible, people often use the word joy to mean a special sort of happiness that people feel because of what God does. People often held special festivals or celebrations to show the joy they felt and to worship God. So here, the storyteller is saying that the people celebrated because they were very happy to make David king.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:23–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Saul
- Yahweh
- Soldiers who came to Hebron from all the tribes of Israel, including Judah, Simeon, Levi, Benjamin, Ephraim, the half-tribe of Manasseh from west of the Jordan River, Issachar, Zebulun, Naphtali, Dan, Asher, Reuben, Gad, and the other half-tribe of Manasseh from the east side of the Jordan River
- Jehoiada, the leader of the family of Aaron, which was part of the tribe of Levi
- Zadok and the 22 military commanders who were also from the tribe of Levi
- The 200 chiefs of Issachar
- And all of the people of Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller says something like, “These are the numbers of the soldiers who came to join David’s army at Hebron. These men wanted to make sure David would become the new king after Saul. These men were ready to fight to make this happen, just as Yahweh said would happen.

“From Judah’s tribe, 6,800 men came who carried shields and spears. These men knew how to fight very well.

“From Simeon’s tribe, 7,100 strong men came who knew how to fight well.

“From Levi’s tribe, 4,600 men came. One of these men was Jehoiada, a leader of Aaron’s clan. Jehoiada commanded 3,700 men. Zadok was also in that group. Zadok was a brave young soldier. Zadok came with 22 military commanders from his clan.

“From Benjamin’s tribe, the tribe that Saul belonged to, 3,000 men came. Most of those men served Saul faithfully until that time.

“From Ephraim’s tribe, 20,800 men came. The people respected these men very much.

“From the half of the tribe of Manasseh that lived on the west side of the Jordan River, 18,000 soldiers came. The clans of these men chose the men by name to come and help David become king.

"The tribe of Issachar sent 200 wise men who understood the right thing for Israel to do at the right time. These men came with their brothers, or the other men in their tribe, who obeyed what these men commanded them to do.

"From the tribe of Zebulun, 50,000 brave warriors came ready to fight. These men knew how to use many different kinds of weapons. These men were completely faithful to David.

"From Naphtali's tribe, 1,000 military commanders came. These men had 37,000 soldiers with them who carried shields and spears.

"From Dan's tribe, 28,600 men came ready to fight.

"From Asher's tribe, 40,000 trained soldiers came ready to fight.

"And from the east side of the Jordan River, 120,000 men came from the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the other half of the tribe of Manasseh. These soldiers came with all kinds of weapons, ready for battle." Pause the drama. Ask the people playing all of the soldiers who came from each of these tribes, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- David is a brave soldier and a very good leader. David won many battles for Saul. In fact, we think David is a much better leader than Saul was! or
- David was the only one who had the courage to fight Goliath, and David has bravely led many other battles. David is the kind of person we need as our next king; or
- Yahweh has protected David many times, so we know Yahweh is with David. We want a king whom Yahweh will make successful.

Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I was very discouraged when Saul tried to kill me, and I had to run away. But now I feel hopeful because Yahweh has sent all these men to support me; or
- I knew that I could not kill Saul, even to defend myself, because Yahweh had made Saul king. But now that Saul is dead, it seems like Yahweh does want me to be the next king.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, the storyteller says something like, "All these men were trained soldiers, and they came to Hebron ready for war. These men wanted to make David king of Israel, and they were willing to fight for David. All of the other people of Israel agreed with these men.

"The men stayed there with David for three days. During this time, the men ate and drank because their relatives had prepared food for them. Other Israelites also came from as far away as where the tribes of Issachar, Zebulun, and Naphtali lived. These people brought food on donkeys, camels, mules, and oxen. So they had plenty of flour to make bread, and lots of figs, raisins, wine, olive oil, cows, and sheep. All the Israelites had a very happy party!" Pause the drama. Ask the people playing all of the soldiers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We came ready to fight to make David king, if needed, but now we will celebrate with David! or
- We feel confident that Yahweh is with David, and we are very happy that everyone in Israel seems to agree with us that David should be king.

Ask the people playing the people of Hebron who prepared the food, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We love David, so we are very grateful that all of these men have come to fight for David. We want to help all of these men celebrate David as the new king; or
- We prepared a lot of food, but we did not expect this many men to come. We need more food!

Ask the people playing all the Israelites who bring food from different places in Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- It is a long journey to come here to Hebron, but we want to show David and all of his men our support; or
- Wow, this is a large group of men! We are glad we brought a lot of food, but we hope it is enough!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 12:23–40 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The storyteller says that these are the numbers of the divisions of the armed troops. A division is a group of soldiers who fight together under the same leader. “Armed troops” means soldiers who have their weapons with them and are ready to fight.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **divisions** and **armed troops**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

These men came to turn Saul’s **kingdom** over to David according to the **word of Yahweh**. A kingdom is the territory or the people that a king rules, and “word of Yahweh” means the things Yahweh tells people. Use the same word or phrase for “word of Yahweh” as you used in previous passages. Look up “Yahweh,” “Word of God,” and “kingdom” in the Master Glossary for more information.

The storyteller calls the Simeonites, Zadok, and the Ephraimites men of **valor**. Valor means brave or strong. Use the same word or phrase for valor as you used in previous passages.

Jehoiada is the **prince** of the house, or clan, of Aaron. Here, the word prince means a high or most important leader. Use the same word or phrase for prince or “most important leader” as you used in previous passages.

Zadok came with 22 **military commanders** from his **father’s house**. Use the same word or phrase for “military commanders” as you have in previous passages. In this story, the storyteller uses the term “house” or “father’s house” throughout this passage to mean a clan, or large family group. This means that these men were Zadok’s relatives, or that they were all part of the same large family. However, it probably did not mean they lived in the same house. You can use any phrases that mean a larger “household,” “relatives,” or “clan.” For more information, refer to household in the Master Glossary.

The Benjamites were the **brothers**, or relatives, of Saul. In this case, “brothers” refers to relatives, and not necessarily to brothers from the same mother. Instead, it means people who all come from the same ancestor. If this ancestor lived a long time ago, this group of related people could be very large. Use the same word or phrase for brothers, when it means relatives, as you used in previous passages.

The half tribe of Manasseh came to make David **king**. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory. For more information, look up king in the Master Glossary.

Two hundred **chiefs**, or clan leaders, came from the tribe of Issachar. Use the same word for chiefs, or leaders, as you have used in previous passages.

Like Zadok, Naphtali came with 1,000 **military commanders**. Use the same word for military commander here as you did for the 22 military commanders that Zadok brought.

All of these men came to Hebron with a whole **heart** to make David king. And all of the rest of the people in Israel were of a single **mind**. Remember your conversation about this in step three. You may also look up heart and mind in the Master Glossary for more information, if needed. Use the same words or phrases for heart and mind as you used in previous passages.

People from all over Israel brought food to Hebron on **donkeys**, **camels**, mules, and oxen. A donkey is a large mammal with hooves. A donkey is related to the horse, but with longer ears, a short mane, and a smaller but strong body. A camel is also a large mammal with hooves. Camels tend to be quite large, with longer legs and neck. Camels also have one or two large humps on their backs. Mules are another type of large mammal. Mules come from breeding a male donkey with a female horse. The law of Moses did not allow the Israelites to breed two different animals together, so we are not sure where these mules came from, but the Israelites might have taken them from their enemies when they won a battle. Finally, oxen are a type of large, strong cattle. The Israelites often used oxen to pull a plow in their fields or to pull carts that carried heavy items. Use the same

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words or phrases for donkeys and camels as you used in previous passages. For more information on donkey, see the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **mules** and **oxen**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The people brought lots of food, including flour, cakes of figs, clusters of raisins, **wine** and **oil**, and oxen and sheep. People made bread by grinding grain into flour and then mixing it with water and cooking it over a fire. Figs are a type of fruit, and people would press multiple figs together to make larger fig "cakes." People make raisins from grapes, which are a type of fruit that grows on a vine. People set grapes out in the sunlight until they dry and shrivel up to become raisins. Wine is an alcoholic drink that people make from grapes. Oil is a thick liquid that can come from many things, but in Israel, people usually made oil from olives, which are a type of fruit that grows on olive trees. Finally, oxen and sheep are both large four-legged animals that the Israelites could kill and cook to eat meat. Use the same words or phrases for wine and oil as you used in previous passages. For more information on wine, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **flour**, **cakes of figs**, **clusters of raisins**, and **sheep**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Finally, the storyteller says people did all these things because there was joy in Israel. This means that people felt very happy and celebrated what God had done.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**there was joy in Israel**." If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 12:23–40

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (9.3 MB)

- Filling the Gaps (5.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Chronicles 13:1–14

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 13:1–14 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 13:1–14 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 13:1–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, the storyteller described the many soldiers from different tribes who started to follow David as the new king of the Israelites. These men spent three days celebrating and feasting with David in the city of Hebron.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and find Hebron as a group. Pause this audio here.

This true story happens sometime after many Israelites feasted with David in Hebron. We do not know for sure where this story happens, but most likely it is Jerusalem. In this story, David talks and plans with David's most important military officers. David says, "If you all agree, and if Yahweh our God wants this to happen, then let us send a message to the rest of our people in the other Israelite regions." David is suggesting that the men choose a few people who will travel to these other regions and deliver the message for them.

David says the messengers should share the message with the priests and Levites who live in those regions with the other Israelites. In those days, priests and Levites were the ones who did important work to take care of the tabernacle and help Israel worship Yahweh.

David wants to bring the ark of "our God," or the ark of Yahweh, back to the people of Israel.

Stop here and look at a picture of the ark of God as a group. Discuss this question as a group: Tell of something or someone in your community that is a sign of God's presence, or perhaps the presence of spirits or gods. How do you think this is the same or different from the ark of God? Pause this audio here.

David talks about bringing the ark of Yahweh to where David and the Israelites are. Although the storyteller does not say the name of the city, we know that David is talking about moving the ark of Yahweh to the city of Jerusalem. Jerusalem is where David lives as the king of Israel at the time of this story.

Stop here and look at a map that includes Jerusalem as a group. Pause this audio here.

When David says, "We did not seek it during Saul's time," David is saying that the Israelites did not ask Yahweh what to do about the ark of Yahweh while Saul was king. Then all the Israelites agree to do what David suggests because the Israelites think this idea sounds good.

So, David assembles all the Israelites in Kiriath Jearim. Kiriath Jearim is on the border between the territories of Judah and Benjamin, about a half-day's walk northwest of Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a map that includes Kiriath Jearim as a group. Pause this audio here.

So, David and all the Israelites with David go up to Baalah, which means to Kiriath Jearim. The storyteller then says that Kiriath Jearim is in the region of Judah. David and the Israelites go there to get the ark of God, which people knew by the name, “Yahweh who sits above the cherubim.” The Israelites had carved cherubim on top of the ark. Cherubim are angels, or creatures with wings. The Israelites believed that Yahweh literally lived in the space directly above the ark. So, people called the ark by Yahweh’s name because the ark symbolized Yahweh’s presence.

Then the Israelites put the ark of Yahweh on a new cart to move it from Abinadab’s house. The storyteller does not tell us who Abinadab is, but we know from 1 Samuel 7 that Abinadab had taken care of the ark of Yahweh at his house for a long time. “A new cart” refers to a cart that people have never used before. Two men, Uzzah and Ahio, are guiding the cart. The storyteller does not mention this, but we know from another story that these men are walking and steering the cart while oxen pull the cart. Yahweh had given a command many years before that people must carry the ark on poles. So when people carry the ark on a cart, the people are disobeying Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of oxen pulling a cart as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Describe a holy object in your culture. What rules do you have for how people can interact with the object? What would happen if someone did not follow these rules? Pause this audio here.

While the men guide the cart, David and all the Israelites with David celebrate near the ark. Because the ark represents Yahweh’s presence, the Israelites would say that they are celebrating “before Yahweh.” The Israelites dance joyfully and play music to celebrate.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when many people in your culture celebrated something together. What kinds of things did people do to celebrate? What types of dances did people dance? What types of songs or music did people play? What types of musical instruments did people use? Pause this audio here.

The Israelites play lyres, harps, timbrels, cymbals, and trumpets as they walk along with the ark.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of musical instruments do people play to celebrate something good? Pause this audio here.

The first type of instrument the Israelites play is a lyre. Lyres are stringed instruments similar to a very small harp.

Stop here and look at a picture of a lyre as a group. Pause this audio here.

The second type of instrument is a harp. Harps are stringed instruments, similar to lyres but larger and with more strings.

Stop here and look at a picture of what this kind of harp may have looked like as a group. Pause this audio here.

The third type of instrument is timbrels. Timbrels are small, handheld drums similar to a tambourine but without rattles.

Stop here and look at a picture of what a timbrel may have looked like as a group. Pause this audio here.

The fourth type of instrument is cymbals. Musicians hold two cymbals and strike them together to make a high-pitched sound.

Stop here and look at a picture of cymbals as a group. Pause this audio here.

The fifth type of instrument is a trumpet. In those days, people made a trumpet by hammering metal, either silver or bronze, into a tube. The tube had a narrow opening on one end and a wide opening on the other end. A person blew into the narrow part of the trumpet and made their lips vibrate to force air through the other end of the tube. This made a loud, clear sound that people could hear from far away. The trumpet player could only play low notes, medium notes, and high notes. The trumpet player could make short sounds by blowing the trumpet quickly with just a little bit of breath. The trumpet player could make long sounds by blowing the trumpet slowly with a long breath.

Stop here and look at a picture of a metal trumpet. Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 13:1–14

David and the Israelites continue to move the ark and celebrate. The group arrives at a threshing floor, a type of flat farm area where farmers process grain. People called this specific threshing floor "the threshing floor of Kidon." We do not know for sure what "Kidon" means. "Kidon" could be the name of the place where the threshing floor was or, more likely, the name of the man who owns the threshing floor.

At this threshing floor, Uzzah reaches out his hand to hold the ark because, when the oxen stumble, the box starts to fall off the cart.

Right away, Yahweh feels very angry at Uzzah and kills Uzzah because Uzzah touched the ark. We know that Uzzah dies there before God.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of consequences do people experience if they do not obey God, gods, or spirits? Pause this audio here.

David feels distressed because Yahweh has killed Uzzah. So, David names the place where Uzzah died, "Perez Uzzah," which means that Yahweh has punished Uzzah in this place. The storyteller mentions that the Israelites continue to call the place Perez Uzzah even at the time when the storyteller writes down this story.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a time when someone was angry at God, gods, or the spirits. Pause this audio here.

David feels afraid of God because God has killed Uzzah. So, David says, "How can I bring the ark of God to me?" David does not think that David should continue to take the ark with David to Jerusalem, so David does not take the ark with him. The storyteller mentions the "City of David," which refers to Jerusalem, since this is where David lives at this time. Instead, David takes the ark to the house of Obed-Edom, a Gittite man. Obed-Edom keeps the ark in his house for three months, and Yahweh blesses Obed-Edom and all the people in Obed-Edom's household.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of good things happen to people when God, gods, or spirits bless them?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 13:1–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: David discusses with David's officers David's desire to gather all the other Israelites and bring the ark of Yahweh to Jerusalem. David then shares this with all the other Israelites there. These Israelites agree with David.

In the second scene: David assembles the Israelites from all regions to the city, Kiriath Jearim. David and the Israelites start to move the ark of Yahweh on a new cart, which oxen pull. David and the Israelites celebrate and play musical instruments. Uzzah and Ahio steer the cart.

In scene three: At a threshing floor, the oxen stumble, and Uzzah reaches out to hold the ark. Yahweh feels very angry and kills Uzzah right there. David feels angry at God. David decides not to bring the ark to David's city. Instead, David takes the ark to Obed-Edom's house.

In scene four: Obed-Edom keeps the ark at his house for three months. During that time, Yahweh blesses Obed-Edom and everyone in Obed-Edom's house.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- David's officers
- All the Israelites who live near David
- All the Israelites in other regions
- Uzzah and Ahio

- The oxen
- Yahweh
- And Obed-Edom, along with the people who live in Obed-Edom's house

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller introduces the story with a word that means that this story happens sometime after the last story.

In scene one, David consults with David's officers, the "princes of thousands and of hundreds, with every leader." These "princes" are David's most important military officers who lead different sizes of military groups. Some officers are the military commanders of 1,000 men. Other officers are the military commanders of 100 men.

The storyteller then uses a word to show that David did something next. The storyteller says that "David says to all the assembly of Israel…." "All the assembly of Israel" may refer to all the military leaders that the storyteller mentioned earlier. More likely, this refers to all the Israelites who live near David at this time.

Then David suggests an idea of something for the Israelites to do. David also makes it clear that David only makes this suggestion if the Israelites and Yahweh agree with David's idea.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what are some ways you can say that one thing will happen only if everyone agrees to it? Pause this audio here.

David suggests that David and the Israelites with David send a message to ask all the other Israelites, including priests and Levites, who live in different regions to come to where David is. David says these other people are "our brothers who remain in all the land of Israel." "Our brothers" refers to all the other Israelites who live in different regions other than Jerusalem.

David also mentions the priests and Levites who live in the areas that surround the Israelites' cities. Levites came from the family of Jacob's son, Levi. Levites did important work to help people worship Yahweh. Priests came from the tribe of Levi. The storyteller mentions priests separately because they did the most important work for worshipping Yahweh. In previous stories, we know that God had instructed Moses to give the Levites pasturelands outside the Israelite cities. In these pasturelands, the Levites could raise grazing farm animals. The Levites continued to do this during the time of David. In this story, David asks these other Israelites to come to the place where David and the Israelites who are with David are now.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about a bigger city or village that you know about. Describe the area around the city or village. How do you think this is similar or different from where the priests and Levites raised grazing animals in pasturelands outside of the Israelite cities? Pause this audio here.

David explains that he wants to send this message so that all of these Israelites can "bring the ark of our God to us." David is saying that David wants the Israelites to go get the ark and bring it to Jerusalem. "The ark of our God" refers to the ark of Yahweh. David continues to explain that the Israelites did not "seek" or "inquire of" the ark of God when Saul was king. The ark of God represents Yahweh. So, when David says that the Israelites did not "seek" or "inquire of" the ark, it means that the Israelites did not ask Yahweh what Yahweh wanted to do.

All the assembly, which means all the Israelites who have gathered or assembled to listen to David, say that they will do what David said because this is "right in their eyes." In those days, if someone said something was right in someone's eyes, it meant that that person agreed and thought this was a good idea. The Israelites agree that David's idea is a good idea.

In scene two, the storyteller uses a word that shows that the Israelites agree to follow David's suggestion. David gathers "all Israel," which means all the Israelites who live from the southern border of Israel, which is Shihor of Egypt, to the northern border of Israel, which is Lebo Hamath. All the Israelites prepare to get the ark of God from Kiriath Jearim. We do not know the exact meaning of "Lebo Hamath." It may refer to the entrance to the city of Hamath, a mountain pass to the south of Hamath, or "Lebo Hamath," a city located in the modern country of Syria. The name "Kiriath Jearim" means "city of woods." Kiriath Jearim is in the territory of the tribe of Judah, on the border between the territories of Judah and Benjamin, about a half-day's walk northwest of Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel. Find Shihor, Lebo Hamath, and Kiriath Jearim as a group. Pause this audio here.

David and all Israel go to Baalah in the territory of the tribe of Judah. “Baalah” is the old name for Kiriath Jearim. The Israelites are going to “bring up” or get from there the ark of Yahweh. Then the storyteller gives a title for the ark. Scholars are not certain what the original language means, but it probably means, “Yahweh enthroned upon the cherubim which is called a Name,” because the Israelites believed that Yahweh literally lived above the ark. “Cherubim” are winged creatures, like angels, that someone carved on top of the ark. So, people called the ark by Yahweh’s name because the ark symbolized Yahweh’s presence.

Stop and discuss: How might you describe “Yahweh enthroned upon the cherubim which is called a Name?” Stop the recording here.

The Israelites start to transport the ark of Yahweh on a new cart that people have never used before. The Israelites start moving the ark on the cart at Abinadab’s house. The storyteller does not mention this yet, but we know that some oxen pulled the cart. Uzzah and Ahio are guiding the cart. This means that Uzzah and Ahio are helping to direct the oxen that are pulling the cart.

And David and all Israel, meaning the Israelites with David, celebrate “before Yahweh” with all their strength. “Before Yahweh” means that the Israelites are doing this in front of the ark of Yahweh, since the ark represents Yahweh’s presence. “All their strength” means that the Israelites are celebrating with full devotion, enthusiasm, and energy. The Israelites are also playing music on lyres, harps, timbrels, cymbals, and trumpets.

Stop and discuss: How might you describe how the Israelites celebrate before Yahweh with all their strength? Pause the audio here.

In scene three, the storyteller uses a word to show that something else is happening at the same time as David and the other Israelites celebrate. The group arrives on a threshing floor, or a place where people thresh grain. In those days, threshing floors were usually a high, hard, and flat area. Farmers used this area to hit and separate the part of the grain plant that people can eat from the part of the grain plant that people use for animal beds. In this story, people call this specific threshing floor “the threshing floor of Kidon.” We do not know for sure what “Kidon” refers to. “Kidon” could be the name of a place or the name of the man who owns the threshing floor.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of someone threshing grain. Then discuss what word or phrase you will use to describe this place where people thresh grain. Pause this audio here.

It is here at the threshing floor that Uzzah reaches out to hold the ark. Uzzah does this because the oxen stumble. The phrase “the oxen stumbled” implies that when the oxen stumbled, the ark of Yahweh must have started to fall off the cart. In other words, Uzzah reaches out his hand to keep the ark of God from falling off the cart when the oxen stumble. The storyteller uses a special word to show that Yahweh immediately feels very angry that Uzzah touched the ark.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are some different ways in your culture to say that someone is extremely angry? What are some ways to say that God, or local spirits or gods, are angry at someone? Practice using these phrases to say that Yahweh felt extremely angry at Uzzah. Discuss which phrases you think are most like how Yahweh felt. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller then uses a word to show that what happens next is a direct result of Uzzah’s mistake. Yahweh instantly kills Uzzah because Uzzah put his hand on the ark. The storyteller adds that Uzzah died right there, facing God. By “facing God,” the storyteller is saying that Uzzah died in front of the ark, which represents Yahweh. The passage does not describe how Yahweh kills Uzzah. The Israelites could not see Yahweh, but the Israelites could see Uzzah’s dead body next to the ark of God.

Stop here as a group and talk about a time when someone died suddenly because of their own bad choice. Discuss what words or phrases you will use to describe how Uzzah died. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller then uses a word to show that David feels emotionally troubled because Yahweh killed Uzzah. David likely feels several kinds of negative emotions at this time. David names the place where Uzzah died “Perez Uzzah” or “the breach of Uzzah.” A breach is like when people break through an enemy’s city wall in battle. This place name means that Yahweh was so angry with Uzzah in this place that Yahweh killed Uzzah as punishment. The storyteller mentions that the Israelites continue to call the place Perez Uzzah even at the time when the storyteller writes this story.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are some ways to describe how David felt here? Discuss which ones you think are the most like how David felt. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that David is afraid of Yahweh that day, which means the day when Uzzah died. David says, "How can I bring the ark of Yahweh home to me?" David did not expect anyone to answer this question. David was saying that David could not and did not want to take the ark to Jerusalem after what had happened.

So, David does not take the ark into David's city, Jerusalem. Instead, David takes the ark to the house of Obed-Edom, a Gittite. A Gittite is someone from a city that people called "Gath." We do not know for sure what people group Obed-Edom comes from.

In scene four, the storyteller says that Obed-Edom keeps the ark of Yahweh in Obed-Edom's house for three months. Yahweh blesses Obed-Edom's household and everything that belongs to Obed-Edom, including family members and, possibly, servants. We do not know how Yahweh blesses Obed-Edom, but Yahweh does good things for the household.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 13:1–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- David's officers
- All the Israelites who live near David
- All the Israelites in other regions
- Uzzah and Ahio
- The oxen
- Yahweh
- And Obed-Edom, along with the people who live in Obed-Edom's house

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

David discusses with David's military officers and then talks with all the Israelites. David suggests that, if the Israelites and Yahweh agree, David will send messengers to gather all the Israelites from other regions. This includes the priests and Levites in the areas that surround those other regions. All the Israelites together can then go get the ark of "our" God. David also explains that the Israelites did not seek the ark during Saul's time as king. All of the Israelites who are there with David agree to David's suggestion because they think it is a good idea. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites with David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This is a great idea! We need to have Yahweh's presence with us again! or

- We are so excited to get the ark back again after so long; or
- David is wise to suggest this idea; or
- We like that we have a king who involves us when he makes decisions.

Continue the drama. So David gathers all the Israelites from the Shihor River area in Egypt to Lebo Hamath. The Israelites all go to the region of Judah to a town that people originally called Baalah. People later called this town Kiriath Jearim. This town is where the ark of God is. People call the ark, "Yahweh, who sits above the cherubim, which is called by the Name." The Israelites move the ark from the house of a man named Abinadab. The way the Israelites move the ark is by placing the ark on a new cart. Uzzah and Ahio steer the cart, and the oxen pull the cart. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I clearly told the Israelites that only Israelite priests could carry the ark on poles. David and the other Israelites are disobeying me when they put the ark on a cart; or
- The Israelites are dishonoring me.

Continue the drama. David and all the Israelites celebrate with all their strength before God. The Israelites play songs with lyres, harps, timbrels, cymbals, and metal trumpets. Pause the drama. Ask the person or people playing David and the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I, David, am starting my time as king. I can do a great thing by getting the ark back for the Israelites; or
- We are so excited and happy that we have the ark of God after we lost access to it for three generations; or
- We want to celebrate because we are finally in Yahweh's presence again; or
- We want to praise Yahweh for the return of the ark of God to the Israelites.

Continue the drama. The Israelites continue to celebrate and come to the threshing floor of Kidon. Here, at the threshing floor, Uzzah reaches out to stop the ark from falling when the oxen stumble. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Uzzah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The ark of God is special and should not touch the ground; or
- I know that I am not supposed to touch the ark, but I do not want the ark to fall.

Continue the drama. Yahweh feels very angry at Uzzah for Uzzah's error of touching the ark. So, Yahweh takes Uzzah's life right away. Uzzah dies right next to the ark. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The Israelites already disobeyed me when they put the ark on a cart instead of the Israelite priests carrying it. Now, Uzzah has done a terrible thing when he touches the ark; or
- No person is supposed to directly touch the ark because they are not completely good like I am; or
- Uzzah's consequence for his own bad choice is death.

Continue the drama. David feels distressed because Yahweh has killed Uzzah. Because of this, David thinks that David cannot continue to take the ark of Yahweh to David's city. Instead, David takes the ark of Yahweh to Obed-Edom's house. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am not good like Yahweh. I do not deserve to bring the ark to my city; or
- I am terrified of Yahweh because of Yahweh's power; or
- I took part in the disobedience to Yahweh that led to Uzzah's death; or
- I do not want to die or be responsible for anyone else dying because of the ark of Yahweh.

Continue the drama. Yahweh blesses everyone in Obed-Edom's house the whole three months that Obed-Edom keeps the ark there. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Obed-Edom is taking good care of my ark. I want to bless Obed-Edom; or
- When people spend time in my presence, I will bless those people.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 13:1–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

David talked with his **most important military officers**, who were **military commanders** in David's army. Use the same words or phrases for "most important military officers" and "military commanders" as you used in previous passages.

At the beginning of the story, David talks with "all the assembly of **Israel**." Israel refers to the Israelites or people who are descendants of Jacob. These people lived in the country called Israel. To assemble means to come together for a special purpose, so "all the assembly" means all the Israelites who live near David and have come to hear David speak. Later in the story, David gathers "all of Israel," which means the Israelites from every region. This means that many Israelites traveled from far away. For more information on Israel and Israelites, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word that you used for Israel, or Israelites, in previous passages.

David also calls together the **priests** and **Levites**. These men come from the **cities** and **pasturelands** across Israel. For more information on priests and Levites, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for priests and Levites as you used in previous passages. Use the same word or phrase for cities and pasturelands as you used in previous passages.

This story tells us how King David and the Israelite army moved the ark of God to Jerusalem. The ark was a special rectangular box covered in gold. Yahweh had told Moses to put sacred objects in the ark. This included the tablets that Yahweh had written Yahweh's law on. The Israelites believed that Yahweh literally lived in the space directly above the ark, so the ark represented Yahweh's presence. Yahweh used the ark to remind the Israelites that Yahweh had promised to be with the Israelites.

Stop here and, if needed, look at a drawing of the ark of God as a group again. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the general term for **God**, and for the **ark of God**. Look up God and the ark of the covenant in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

People called the ark of God by the name of "Yahweh who lives above the cherubim, which people call by the Name." Yahweh is God's personal name. The Israelites said the ark belonged to Yahweh, and the Israelites also worshipped or prayed to Yahweh at the ark. A cherub is an intelligent, powerful angelic being. Cherubim is the word that means more than one cherub. Cherubim are guardians of sacred places. Cherubim have a body like a lion, wings like a bird, and a face like a human. The ark of God has two cherubim on the top of it. Yahweh's presence is on top of the ark, like how a king sits on a throne. Since the cherubim are on the top of the ark, the Israelites say that Yahweh lives above the cherubim. The Israelites call the ark by Yahweh's Name.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **cherubim**. Look up cherubim in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss what words or phrases you will use for "**Yahweh who lives above the cherubim, which people call by the Name**." If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same phrase that you have used there. Look up Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

As the Israelites moved the ark of God, they played several instruments: lyres, harps, timbrels, cymbals, and trumpets. Here is a little more detail about these instruments.

The first kind of instrument the Israelites played was the lyre. Lyres are stringed instruments similar to a very small harp. People in those days often played lyres and sang at the same time. People played the lyre strings with one or both hands by plucking or strumming. In those days, people made lyres with 3 to 10 strings. People sometimes call this a "kinnor harp." The Israelites likely made the strings for lyres out of the dried large intestines of sheep. People in those days likely made lyres by carving wood into curved shapes and then stretching strings across the wooden frame from bottom to top. Lyres have a larger base at the bottom of the instrument and a smaller bar at the top of the instrument. The lyre usually has two arms, or bars, on the sides so the musician can hold the instrument. Lyre strings usually have different thicknesses and lengths. The person who plays the

lyre plucks or strums the strings so the strings vibrate and make a sound. When a musician plucks a longer and thicker string, the lyre makes a lower sound. When a musician plucks a shorter and thinner string, the lyre makes a higher sound. The person who plays the lyre would often pluck or strum with one of their hands and use their other hand to stop one or more of the strings from vibrating to block the sound from those strings.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word you will use for **lyre**. If necessary, look at a photo of a lyre. Pause this audio here.

The second kind of instrument the Israelites play is the harp, which is like a large lyre with more strings. In those days, the kind of harps that people played looked and sounded different from harps today. This type of harp probably had around 12 strings. The harps in those days had a wider and thicker bottom end of the instrument to help make the sound louder. This made the instrument look similar to a wineskin container that has a larger bottom. So, people called this kind of harp by the same name as a wineskin container, a “nabal” harp.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word you will use for **harp**. If necessary, look at a photo of a harp. Pause this audio here.

The third kind of instrument the Israelites play is the timbrel. A musician held this small, handheld drum in one hand and hit the drum with their other hand. To make these instruments, people would first make a round, shallow frame. Then the people would dry an animal skin and stretch it across the frame so that it was very tight. The shallow frame meant that the drum did not make a very loud sound. People may also have attached many tiny pieces of thin metal to the frame so that it would rattle when the musician hit or shook the instrument. People call this kind of drum a “tambourine” when it also has metal rattles on it.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word you will use for **timbrel**. If necessary, look at a photo of a timbrel. Pause this audio here.

The fourth kind of instrument the Israelites play is the cymbal, which people make like a thin, round metal plate. A set of cymbals has two identical pieces that musicians hit together to make a higher-pitched, crashing or ringing sound. Musicians either hold one cymbal in each hand or tie two cymbals with some kind of string to different fingers on the same hand to hit together. Smaller cymbals make quieter sounds, and larger cymbals make louder sounds.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word you will use for **cymbals**. If necessary, look at a photo of cymbals. Pause this audio here.

The fifth kind of instrument the Israelites play is the trumpet. We know from previous stories that Yahweh had told the Israelites to play on metal trumpets during days of celebration. Skilled Israelite workers made these trumpets by beating bronze or silver into a long tube. The tube had a small opening on one end where the musician could use their mouth to blow air into the instrument. The other end of the tube had a wider opening. A musician would play a trumpet by closing their lips tightly against the small opening of the trumpet. Then the musicians would blow the air in a way that made their lips vibrate. This vibrating sound increased as the air moved through the widened part of the tube. A trumpet player could only play low notes, medium notes, and high notes. The trumpet player could make short sounds by blowing the trumpet quickly with just a little bit of breath. The trumpet player could make long sounds by blowing the trumpet slowly with a long breath. People could hear the loud, clear sounds of trumpets from far away.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word you will use for **metal trumpets**. If necessary, look at a photo of metal trumpets. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh **blessed** all of Obed-Edom’s **household** because Obed-Edom kept the ark of Yahweh. Here, household refers to all the people who lived with Obed-Edom in his house. For more information on bless and household, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word that you used for bless and household in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 13:1–14

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.1 MB)
- Setting the Stage (8.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (10.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (7.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Chronicles 14:1–7

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 14:1–7 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 14:1–7 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 14:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The story in this passage does not follow on from the story about the ark in the previous passage. The storyteller stops the main story about the ark's journey to tell us about Yahweh's blessings to David because David was obedient and faithful. The storyteller uses this passage to talk about Yahweh's blessings to David during David's reign over Israel.

1 Chronicles 14:1–7

The storyteller reminds us of stories from 2 Samuel 5 to show how Yahweh blesses David.

Stop here and listen to your translation of the passage 2 Samuel 5:11–16, if possible. Pause this audio here.

The passages in 2 Samuel and 1 Chronicles are very similar.

When David was king of all Israel, Hiram, the king of Tyre, a city in Phoenicia, sent special messengers to David to talk about trade and to show friendship to Israel. Tyre was a rich and powerful city.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel that shows the city of Jerusalem in Israel and the city of Tyre in Phoenicia. Pause this audio here.

Hiram sent gifts to David to show that Hiram wanted the nations of Tyre and Israel to be friends. Hiram also sent logs of cedar wood, which were good for building houses. Cedars were large trees with straight trunks that people used for building houses. A log is a section of the tree trunk or a main branch of the tree from which a person removes the side branches.

Stop here and look at a picture of a cedar tree. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a picture of cedar wood logs. Pause this audio here.

Hiram also sent stonemasons, people who shaped stone with tools and built with stone, and carpenters, people who used wood to build houses and furniture. The stonemasons and carpenters helped the Israelites to build David's palace, his special house in the city of David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your community or country, how is your king's or most important leader's house different from other people's houses? Did people make the house for your king or leader, or did people make it for someone else and then give it to your king or leader? Pause this audio here.

Hiram, king of Tyre, treated David as a rich and powerful king, someone equal in power to Hiram. This helped David to know that Yahweh made David more powerful and influential during the time David was king. The storyteller talks about David's success but makes it clear to us that Yahweh was responsible for Israel's success and David's success as king. Yahweh established David's reign, which means that he made it secure over time. Yahweh highly exalted David's kingdom, or made David's kingdom very successful, so that this time was very good for the Israelites, Yahweh's people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a good and happy time for your people or nation. What made it a good time for your people? Pause this audio here.

When David was in Jerusalem, Yahweh showed that he blessed David by giving David more children. David married more women and brought these women into David's household. A wife was a woman who had the full rank and benefits of a married woman in the man's home. In this passage, this storyteller does not mention that David added concubines to his household. David fathered more children when he was in Jerusalem, in addition to the children that David already had when David was in Hebron. The storyteller tells us the names of David's sons who were born while David lived in Jerusalem and was King of Israel. The Israelites thought sons were more important than daughters. These sons of David were called Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon, Ibhar, Elishua, Elpelet, Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia, Elishama, Beeliada, and Eliphelet. David based some of the names of his sons on the northern or Canaanite name for God, which was Elohim or Baal. This was different from the names of David's earlier sons, which he based on the name of Yahweh. In 2 Samuel, the storyteller gives the name Eliada to Beeliada. The name Beeliada is based on Baal. After David was king, the Israelites thought it was wrong to use the Canaanite name for God, which was Baal, in names. Sometimes the storytellers changed people's names with Baal in them in stories to something different. Even though the storyteller tells this story many years later than the story in 2 Samuel, the storyteller in 1 Chronicles uses Beeliada's original name.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your community, how have names changed over time? What names can people not use because the names are offensive to your people? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller names two more sons than the storyteller in 2 Samuel. The two additional sons were called Elpelet and Nogah. We do not know why there is a difference between the two stories. The storyteller does not give the names of David's daughters.

1 Chronicles 14:1–7

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 14:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: During David's reign, Hiram, king of Tyre, sent messengers, wood to build things, and men to build with stone and wood to help build a palace for David. These events helped David know that Yahweh wanted David to be king and wanted to give David a successful kingdom.

In the second scene: When David was king in Jerusalem, David married more wives and had more children. The storyteller tells us the names of 13 of David's sons born in Jerusalem.

The characters in this passage are:

- Hiram, king of Tyre
- Messengers, stonemasons, and carpenters from Tyre
- David
- Yahweh
- David's wives
- And David's sons who were born in Jerusalem: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon, Ibhar, Elishua, Elpelet, Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia, Elishama, Beeliada, and Eliphelet

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The story in this passage does not follow on from the previous passage about how David moved the ark of the covenant. The storyteller starts a new part of his story to show that, because David acted in a faithful way, good things happened to David while David was king of Israel. The events in this passage probably happened later in David's reign. Hiram became king of Tyre many years after David became king of Israel. When Hiram and David were both kings, Hiram sent messengers and gifts so that there would be a good relationship between Tyre and Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call people who travel to other people groups or nations to talk about how they can trade or work together as two nations? Pause this audio here.

Hiram's gifts helped the Israelites to build a special house, a palace for David. You may notice that in 2 Samuel, the storyteller says carpenters and then stonemasons, but in 1 Chronicles, the storyteller says stonemasons and then carpenters.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call a special building that people make for the leader of your people to live in? Pause this audio here.

After being king for many years, David knew that Yahweh had made David an established king of Israel, a secure and successful king. David knew that Yahweh made David's kingdom very successful in order to bless Yahweh's people, the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Why do you think Yahweh made David's kingdom successful? How will you make it clear that Yahweh made David's kingdom successful in order to bless Yahweh's people? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller then tells us another way that Yahweh blessed David for being faithful. During David's reign in Jerusalem, David married more women as wives and had more children. The storyteller tells us the names of David's sons born in Jerusalem while David was king in Israel. David's sons were called Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon, Ibhar, Elishua, Elpelet, Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia, Elishama, Beeliada, and Eliphelet.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

1 Chronicles 14:1–7

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 14:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Hiram, king of Tyre
- Messengers, stonemasons, and carpenters from Tyre
- David
- Yahweh
- David's wives
- And David's sons who were born in Jerusalem: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon, Ibhar, Elishua, Elpelet, Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia, Elishama, Beeliada, and Eliphelet

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

During David's reign, Hiram, king of Tyre, sent messengers, wood to build things, and men to build with stone and wood to help build a palace for David. These events helped David know that Yahweh wanted David to be king and wanted to give David a successful kingdom. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Hiram, king of Tyre, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Israel is more powerful now that David is king; or
- I want to work and trade with Israel; or
- Israel is a good country for Tyre to work and trade with.

Ask the person playing the messengers, stonemasons, and carpenters, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel honoured to represent my king; or
- I must do a good job for my king, Hiram; or
- Israel is so big and powerful. We want King David to be our friend, not our enemy.

Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Tyre sees that Israel is powerful and strong; or
- I am pleased that Hiram sent wood and people to help build my palace; or
- Yahweh is blessing me and Israel.

Continue the drama. When David was king in Jerusalem, David married more wives and had more children. The storyteller tells us the names of 13 of David's sons born in Jerusalem. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Now that I am king of all Israel, I need to have more wives from Jerusalem and the other tribes; or
- More wives will give me more sons to help lead Israel and be king after me; or
- I can have as many wives as I want now that I am king of Israel.

1 Chronicles 14:1–7

Ask the person playing David's wives, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are honoured to be part of David's household; or
- We hope that we give David more sons; or
- There are many of us now, and David has lots of sons.

Ask the person playing David's sons born in Jerusalem, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We hope that David will like us as much as his children born before us; or
- There are lots of us, and we all want David to like us the most; or
- Which one of us will be king next?

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 14:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Hiram, **king** of Tyre, sent messengers to David to give David a message from King Hiram. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. For more information, refer to king in the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **messengers**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Hiram sent logs of cedar wood. Logs are sections of a tree trunk or the main branch of a tree. Cedar trees are big trees with straight trunks, which are good for building.

Stop here and look at a picture of cedar wood logs, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **logs**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **cedar**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Hiram sent stonemasons, people who made things from stone, to Jerusalem.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **stonemasons**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Hiram sent carpenters, people who made things from wood, to Jerusalem.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **carpenters**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The stonemasons and carpenters built a special house, a palace, for David. In the original language, the word is "house," but the people built a special house for a king.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for a **special house** or **palace**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David knew that Yahweh had made David king of **Israel** and had established David's **kingdom**. **Yahweh** is God's personal name. In this passage, the storyteller calls God "Yahweh." Be sure to translate Yahweh, kingdom, and Israel in the same way as you have in previous passages, and remember that Yahweh, kingdom, and Israel are in the Master Glossary.

David married more wives in Jerusalem and had more children.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 14:1–7

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (928 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 14:8–17

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 14:8–17 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 14:8–17 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 14:8–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller continues to tell us about Yahweh's blessings to David because David was obedient and faithful. In this passage, the storyteller gives two examples of David's power over David's enemies when David did what Yahweh told David to do. We can also find these stories in 2 Samuel 5:17–25, but with some differences.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: If you have already translated 2 Samuel 5:17–25, listen to your translation of that passage. Pause this audio here.

People brought news from Judah to Philistia to tell the Philistines that David was king over all of Israel. You will remember that the Philistines are the people who live in the country of Philistia to the west of Israel. The Philistines probably heard quite quickly from people that the Israelites had anointed David as king. The storyteller says that David is king of all of Israel because the storyteller wants to remind us that David was a great king who united Israel. When David became king of Israel, the Philistines knew that David was no longer a friend of the Philistines. Israel and Philistia were enemies. Therefore, David became an enemy of the Philistines. Israel was more dangerous to the Philistines because all of Israel was now united under King David.

The Philistines went to search for David after the Israelites anointed David as king. We do not know if the Philistines looked for David before or after David conquered Jerusalem. The Philistines sent all their fighting men, their full force of men, to look for David. David was somewhere in Israel. The Philistines wanted to capture David to reduce the power of the Israelites. When David heard from his people that the Philistines were looking for him, David left where he was to get ready to fight the Philistines.

The Philistines went into Israel and raided through the Rephaim Valley. The Philistines moved across the valley to different places to attack and steal from the people in the valley. The Rephaim Valley was a wide and long valley about 5 kilometers from Jerusalem. The Israelites who lived in the valley grew food for the people of Israel.

Stop here and look at a map of southern Israel and eastern Philistia and find the Rephaim Valley, Jerusalem, and the possible location of Baal Perazim as a group. Pause this audio here.

David asked God what David should do. In this passage, the storyteller sometimes uses the name God, the creator God, instead of Yahweh. In this passage, God and Yahweh are the same person. David probably did not talk directly to God but probably used a Levite priest, possibly Abiathar, to ask questions of God. David asked if he, David, should go up against or attack the Philistines. David also asked if God would give the Philistines into David's hand. In other words, David asked God if God will give David the victory over the Philistines. Yahweh told David to go up against, to attack, the Philistines. Yahweh told David that Yahweh would give the Philistines into David's hand.

David and his men went to attack the Philistines because Yahweh told them to go. David and his men went up to Baal Perazim, in the hills near the Rephaim Valley. David defeated the Philistines there. David said that God broke out or burst through his enemies using David and his men. David gave the place a name that described what Yahweh did to defeat the Philistines. You will remember that the Canaanite people used the word "Baal" for God, or lord. In David's language, Baal Perazim means that God bursts or breaks through. David and his men, with the help of Yahweh, quickly moved through the Philistines and defeated them. The Israelites moved through the Philistines quickly, like water bursts through something and makes a flood.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when someone won a battle quickly. Pause this audio here.

The Philistines left their gods behind when David and his men defeated them. The gods were special images or objects that represented their gods. The people also called these objects idols. The Philistines believed that the idols would bring help from the Philistine gods and give the Philistines the victory. David told his men to burn and destroy the Philistines' gods with fire. David did this to be obedient to Yahweh's instructions to Moses in Deuteronomy 7:5 and 25, which said to destroy foreign idols.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Listen to Deuteronomy 7:5 and verse 25, if needed. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller then tells us about another time that the Philistines attacked the Israelites. The Philistines probably attacked the Rephaim Valley again. We do not know how much time passed between the first attack and the second attack. The second attack may have happened before or after David conquered Jerusalem. The

storyteller tells us that David went to God again to ask what to do. This time, God told David not to attack the Philistines from the front but to move around the Philistines and attack from the back.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What different battle strategies have you seen, used, or heard of? Pause this audio here.

God told David to move to a place behind the Philistines, opposite a group of trees. Different translations of the passage name the trees as poplar, balsam, or mulberry trees. We do not know what type of trees they were, but in the original language, the storyteller calls them baka trees.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What trees, if any, do you notice more than others because the leaves make more noise when the wind blows through them? Talk about the noise the leaves make. Pause this audio here.

God told David to attack quickly after God made the tops of the trees make a noise like the noise when people march. Tops of trees move with the wind, and leaves of trees make a noise when the wind moves through the leaves. God made the tops of the trees sound like when people march with their feet, or walk with a strong, regular rhythm. It is common for fighting people to march or walk together so that each person takes a step at the same time. The rhythmic sound was different from the normal sound of wind when it moves through the trees.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do marching feet sound like? How might marching feet sound when leaves at the tops of trees make the sound? Pause this audio here.

David attacked the Philistines in the way that God told David to do. David did not go on his own but went with his men to fight the Philistines. God helped David and David's fighting men to defeat the Philistines. David and his men fought and chased the Philistines from Gibeon in Israel to Gezer, close to Philistia. It was about 19 kilometers from Gibeon to Gezer.

Stop here and look at the map and find Gibeon and Gezer as a group. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller ends the story by telling us that these victories over the Philistines helped to make David's name famous in every country.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Who is famous in your country? What stories have you heard about them, and what do these stories tell you about the person or people? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh made all the countries be afraid of David and respect David.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 14:8–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has nine scenes.

In the first scene: The Philistines heard from people that the Israelites had anointed David king of all Israel, and the Philistines went to Israel to find David.

In the second scene: David heard from people that the Philistines were looking for David and moved to get ready to fight the Philistines.

In the third scene: The Philistine fighters raided the Rephaim Valley.

In the fourth scene: David asked God what David should do. Yahweh replied that David should go to attack the Philistines, as Yahweh would make sure David won the battle.

In the fifth scene: David attacked the Philistines at Baal Perazim. The Philistines left behind their statues of their gods, and David and his men burned the statues.

In the sixth scene: The Philistines attacked Israel in the valley.

1 Chronicles 14:8–17

In the seventh scene: David asked God what David should do. God replied that David should attack the back of the Philistines in front of the trees. David should attack when David heard a marching sound in the tops of the trees. Then David would know that God had gone in front of David's army to attack the Philistines.

In the eighth scene: David followed God's instructions, and David and his men attacked and chased the Philistines from Gibeon to Gezer.

In the ninth scene: The storyteller tells us that everyone in the nations nearby knew David's name, and Yahweh made all the nations be afraid of David.

The characters in this passage are:

- Philistines
- David, king of Israel
- Philistine fighters
- God, or Yahweh
- And David's fighters

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller re-tells the stories in 2 Samuel 5:17–25 to show that David was faithful and obedient to Yahweh and a great king of a united Israel.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: If you have already translated 2 Samuel 5:17–25, listen to your translation of that passage. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller tells us about two separate times that the Philistines invaded Israel and moved across Israel. We do not know exactly when the attacks happened, but they were after the people anointed David as king of Israel. The two attacks might have happened at a similar time, or they might have happened many years apart. This passage does not follow on directly after the previous passage.

In the first attack, the Philistines went "up" to search for David after the Philistines heard from people that the Israelites had anointed David king of Israel. The Philistines went from the coast inland to the land of Israel, so the storyteller says that they went "up." The Philistines sent many fighting people to find David. When David heard that the Philistines were looking for him, David moved out from where he was to get ready to fight the Philistines. Later, David moves "up" to meet the Philistines.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Talk about times you have travelled around your country, particularly from low to high or high to low areas. How will you translate how people go up and go down in David's country? Pause this audio here.

At the time David moved to fight the Philistines, the Philistines raided the Rephaim Valley. The Philistines moved across the Rephaim Valley to steal people's belongings and attack the Israelites in the valley.

David asked God what God wanted David to do. David wanted to know if God wanted David to go to attack the Philistines and if God would give the Philistines into the hands of the Israelites. You will remember from earlier passages that David uses the word "hand" to symbolise power. David asks Yahweh if Yahweh will give David power over the Philistines. The storyteller uses both names for Yahweh—"Yahweh" and "God"—in this story.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What different names do you use for Yahweh? When do you use the different names, and do those names have different meanings? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh replied to David and told David to go. Yahweh wanted David to attack the Philistines. Yahweh promised to give David victory over the Philistines.

David went up to Baal Perazim near the Rephaim Valley and defeated the Philistines. David knew Yahweh helped the Israelites win the battle by giving the Israelites the power to break through the Philistines. David saw Yahweh's power break through the Philistines just as water can break or burst through a barrier.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have two or more people stand close together. Have another person or a few people quickly push through the people who stand together, from one side of the group to the other. How

would you describe water that bursts or breaks through a barrier like these people broke through the group of people? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time you saw water quickly start to flow out of somewhere or overflow something. What happened to everything that the water went over? Pause this audio here.

David named the place Baal Perazim to remind the people that it was the place where Yahweh used David to break through the Philistines. When the Israelites defeated the Philistines, the Philistines abandoned their statues, or idols, of their gods. When a person abandons something, the person leaves that thing behind, even though it was important and the person should care for that thing.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Baal Perazim means that the lord, or master, breaks through. How will you translate the name Baal Perazim? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words or phrases do you use to describe something that is precious but that people left behind because they could not carry it or take it with them? Pause this audio here.

After the Philistines left, David ordered his fighting men to burn the statues of their gods.

Sometime after the first attack, the Philistines raided the valley again. David responded to the attack by going to ask God again what to do. God replied to David with a different way to defeat the Philistines. God wanted David to go and fight the Philistines, but God did not want David to attack the Philistines from in front of the Philistines. God told David to move his fighting men around the Philistines until the Israelites were behind the Philistines.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have one or two people stand together to represent the Philistine fighters. Now have one or more people stand to one side to represent the Israelite fighters. Move the Israelite fighters around the Philistine fighters so that they are behind the Philistine fighters, and then touch the Philistine fighters on their backs. Pause this audio here.

God wanted David to attack the Philistines in front of some trees at a special time. God told David that God would signal the Israelites to move by making the trees make an unusual noise, the sound of people marching. The sound told David that God was in front of the Israelites, attacking the Philistines. David followed God's instructions and struck down the Philistines. In other words, David hit, killed, and injured the Philistines all the way from Gibeon, north of Jerusalem and the Rephaim Valley, to Gezer, near Philistia. David and his men chased the Philistines out of Israel.

Stop here and look at a map of southern Israel and eastern Philistia, and find the Rephaim Valley and Gezer as a group, if needed. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller adds his own comment to the end of the two stories. The storyteller tells us that David's success at defeating the Philistines made David famous everywhere. Also, Yahweh made every nation or country be afraid of David so that the people would respect David. This was a feeling of awe or fear because David was more powerful than they were.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 14:8–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has nine scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Philistines
- David, King of Israel
- Philistine fighters
- God, or Yahweh
- And David's fighters

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The Philistines heard from people that the Israelites had anointed David king of all Israel, and the Philistines went to Israel to find David. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Philistines, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are angry! This man is supposed to serve us, not be the king of Israel; or
- David is a powerful fighter and he will be a powerful king; or
- We need to capture David so that the Israelites lose their power.

Continue the drama. David heard from people that the Philistines were looking for David, and David moved to get ready to fight the Philistines. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know the Philistines are angry at me; or
- I am worried about my people; or
- What should I do? I need Yahweh to help me.

Continue the drama. The Philistine fighters raided the Rephaim Valley. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Philistines fighters, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We will take everything we can from these farmers; or
- Where is David? Will he come to defend his people? or
- We are happy to hurt our enemies.

Continue the drama. David asked God what David should do. Yahweh replied that David should go to attack the Philistines, as Yahweh would make sure David won the battle. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I must do what Yahweh wants me to do; or
- I want to attack the Philistines. The Philistines are hurting my people; or
- Will we win against the Philistines?

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that David is asking me what to do; or
- I want David to help rescue my people and defeat the Philistines; or
- I will make sure that David wins the battle.

Continue the drama. David attacked the Philistines at Baal Perazim. The Philistines left behind their statues of their gods, and David and his men burned the statues. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh is with us! We are breaking through the Philistine army! or
- I am so happy! I will name this place to remind our people of Yahweh's help; or
- We must burn the Philistines' gods to be obedient to Yahweh's instructions to us.

Ask the person playing Philistine fighters, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are defeated! The Israelites are too strong for us; or
- Our gods are not strong enough. The Israelites' God is stronger than our gods; or
- We need to run away before the Israelites kill us all.

Ask the person playing the David's fighters, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We won! Yahweh helped us to break through all the Philistine fighters; or
- We are so happy to see the Philistines run away; or
- I am so afraid of these statues! We will burn all the statues of their gods.

Continue the drama. The Philistines attacked Israel in the valley. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Philistine fighters, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We can take the food from our Israelite enemies; or
- We hate the Israelites; or
- Maybe this time we will win.

Continue the drama. David asked God what David should do. God replied that David should attack the back of the Philistines in front of the trees. David should attack when David heard a marching sound in the tops of the trees and God had gone in front of David's army to attack the Philistines. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We must follow God's instructions for us; or
- God knows the best way to attack the Philistines; or
- I am happy that God will be in front of us at the battle.

Ask the person playing God, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know the best way to defeat the Philistines; or
- I am happy that David trusts me; or
- We will defeat the Philistines together.

Continue the drama. David followed God's instructions and David and his men attacked and chased the Philistines from Gibeon to Gezer. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I can hear the marching noise in the trees! Let's attack the Philistines; or
- We are winning because God is with us; or
- Let's chase and fight the Philistines all the way back to their land.

Ask the person playing David's fighters, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The Philistines are running away; or
- We are strong with God with us.

Ask the person playing the Philistine fighters, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are surprised! The Israelites are attacking from behind us! or
- We cannot win because the Israelites are too strong; or
- We need to get back to Philistia, but the Israelites are still attacking us.

Continue the drama. The storyteller tells us that everyone everywhere knew David's name, and Yahweh made all the nations be afraid of David and respect David. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Everyone has heard the stories of how David defeated the Philistines; or
- I want everyone to know how strong and powerful David is.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 14:8–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

1 Chronicles 14:8–17

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The **Philistines** heard that the Israelites had **anointed** David **king** of all of **Israel**. Use the same words or phrases for Philistines, anointed, king, and Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information about anoint, king, and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

David went out against the Philistines. David left where he was and went to take action against the Philistines.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **went out**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The Philistines **raided** the Rephaim Valley. The Philistines moved across the valley to steal and destroy people's belongings. Use the same word or phrase for raid as you used in previous passages.

David asked **God** what David should do. Use the same word for God as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

David asked if God would give the Philistines **into David's hands** or into David's power. Use the same word or phrase for "into his hands" as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh replied to David. Yahweh is God's personal name. In this passage, God is also called Yahweh. Be sure to translate Yahweh in the same way as you have in previous passages, and remember that Yahweh is in the Master Glossary.

God broke out against David's enemies. God pushed through the Philistines like a flood of water.

The Philistines abandoned their **gods**, statues, or special images, also known as idols, which represented the Philistines' gods. Use the same word or phrase for gods as you have in previous passages. For more information on gods and idols, refer to the Master Glossary.

Another time, the Philistines came to the Rephaim Valley. David asked Yahweh what to do. Yahweh told David to attack the Philistines in front of the poplar, balsam, or mulberry trees.

Stop here and look at a picture of poplar, balsam, and mulberry trees. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **poplar**, **balsam**, or **mulberry trees**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David **struck down** the Philistines from Gibeon to Gezer. David hit and killed the Philistines as they ran away. Use the same word or phrase for struck down as you have in previous passages.

David's fame spread everywhere. In other words, everybody knew David's name and his reputation.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **fame**. Pause this audio here.

All the nations feared David. People "feared" David in a similar way to the way people feared, or greatly respected, God.

Stop here and discuss as a group what phrase you will use for "**the nations feared David**." For more information on nations, or countries, refer to the Master Glossary. Although the people in the nations feared David instead of God, you can still refer to the Master Glossary for "fear of God" to get ideas about how to translate that the people of the nations feared David.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 14:8–17

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (972 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.0 MB)

1 Chronicles 15:1–24

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 15:1–24 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 15:1–24 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 15:1–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, David defeated the Philistine army. In this story, David prepares to transport the ark of Yahweh from Obed-Edom's house to Jerusalem.

David builds a house and other buildings for himself in David's city, which is Jerusalem. David also prepares a tent for the ark of Yahweh. This tent is different from the tent that the Israelites used for the ark when Moses lived. Once again, David probably tells his servants to set up this tent. A tent is a temporary, movable shelter, and in those days, people made tents out of dried animal skins. David plans for this specific tent to be a portable place for the Israelite people to worship Yahweh.

David says that only the Levites may carry the ark of Yahweh because Yahweh chose the Levites to always do this task.

David tells all the Israelites to gather in Jerusalem so they can bring the ark of Yahweh to the place David has prepared for the ark of Yahweh.

David gathers the priests who are descendants of Aaron. David also gathers descendants from several other Levite family groups. A different man leads each of these Levite family groups. Uriel, a descendant of Kohath, leads 120 other descendants of Kohath. Asaiah, a descendant of Merari, leads 220 other descendants of Merari. Joel, a descendant of Gershon, leads 130 other descendants of Gershon. Shemaiah, a descendant of Elizaphan, leads 200 other descendants of Elizaphan. Eliel, a descendant of Hebron, leads 80 other descendants of Hebron. Amminadab, a descendant of Uzziel, leads 112 other descendants of Uzziel.

Then David talks to the priests Zadok and Abiathar, along with the leaders of the Levite groups: Uriel, Asaiah, Joel, Shemaiah, Eliel, and Amminadab. David tells these men that, since they are the leaders of their family groups, they must prepare themselves and the men they lead to bring the ark of Yahweh, the God of Israel, to the place that David had prepared for the ark. Here, David is commanding the men to prepare themselves for religious duties. David probably means that the men must perform a ritual where they clean their bodies and clothes, and temporarily do not have sexual relations with their wives.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kinds of actions do people, especially religious leaders, have to do to prepare for worship? Pause this audio here.

David tells the Levites that the reason that "Yahweh our God" punished the Israelites the first time they tried to move the ark of Yahweh is that the Levites did not carry the ark in the way Yahweh wanted. Here, David means the Levites tried to use a cart to move the ark to Jerusalem instead of carrying the ark the way Yahweh had told Moses the Levites must do.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of rules do leaders need to follow when they lead a religious ceremony? What are the consequences if these leaders do not follow these rules? Pause this audio here.

So, the priests and the Levites ritually clean themselves so that "Yahweh, the God of Israel," will accept them as worthy to move the ark to Jerusalem. The Levites use poles to carry the ark of Yahweh on their shoulders. This is how Yahweh, through Moses, had told the Israelites to carry the ark from the beginning. The ark of Yahweh had rings through which the Levites could place long wooden poles to carry the ark without any person touching it.

Stop here and, as a group, look at an image of Levites using poles to carry the ark of Yahweh. Discuss ways that people in your culture can carry a sacred object. Who can carry the object? Pause this audio here.

David also tells the Levite leaders to appoint other Levites who will joyfully sing and play musical instruments while the Israelites move the ark. These instruments are lyres, harps, and cymbals.

Stop here and look at images of lyres, harps, and cymbals as a group. Discuss as a group: What kinds of instruments do people in your culture play to celebrate something as part of worship? Pause this audio here.

So, the Levite leaders appoint several Levite men in three groups or choirs, according to the instruments that these men will play. Probably certain families of Levites all played one type of instrument, and other families played another type of instrument. Heman, Asaph, and Ethan will play the cymbals. We learn that Heman is Joel's son. Heman's relative, Asaph, is Berekiah's son. And Ethan is Kushaiah's son, a descendant of Merari.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, who plays different instruments? Who do the skilled musicians train to be the next generation of people to play these instruments? What rules do you have in your culture about who can and cannot play these instruments? Pause this audio here.

The leaders also choose a second group of Levites, who are lower in status, to play the harps. This group includes Zechariah, Jaaziel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Unni, Eliab, Maaseiah, and Benaiah. These men are supposed to play the harps in a certain way.

The leaders choose the following Levites to play the lyres: Mattithiah, Eliphelehu, Mikneiah, Azaziah, and the guards, Obed-Edom and Jeiel. These men are supposed to play the lyres in a certain way.

The Levite leaders also choose the skillful Kenaniah to lead all the Levites to bring the ark to Jerusalem.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of people lead the religious ceremonies? What kind of skill do these people have? Pause this audio here.

The leaders also choose Berekiah and Elkanah, along with Obed-Edom and Jehiah, as guards for the ark. The leaders also choose the priests, Shebaniah, Joshaphat, Nethanel, Amasai, Zechariah, Benaiah, and Eliezer to blow metal trumpets in front of the ark of God.

Stop here and look at an image of a metal trumpet as a group.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 15:1–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: In Jerusalem, David builds houses for himself. David also prepares a tent as a special place where David will put the ark of Yahweh. David says only Levites can carry the ark.

In the second scene: David gathers all the Israelites, including the priests and Levites, in Jerusalem so that they can bring the ark to Jerusalem. Then, the storyteller describes how many people David gathers from the different Israelite family groups.

In the third scene: David talks to the leaders of the priests and the leaders of the Levites. David tells these men to ritually prepare themselves and the men they lead so they can transport the ark of Yahweh. David also says that the reason Yahweh punished the Israelites the first time the Israelites tried to move the ark is that the Israelites did not follow what Yahweh said to do.

In the fourth scene: The priests and the Levites ritually prepare themselves. The Levites start to carry the ark on their shoulders as Yahweh told the Israelites to do since the time of Moses.

In the fifth scene: David also tells the leaders of the Levites to choose Levite men who will joyfully sing and play harps, lyres, and cymbals as they move the ark to Jerusalem. The Levites do this. Then the storyteller describes which Levites will play each type of instrument. Some of the Levites will act as guards for the ark. Some priests will play metal trumpets.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- All the people of Israel
- The priests
- The Levites
- The leaders of the priests, Zadok and Abiathar
- And the leaders of the Levites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In scene one, David builds a house and other buildings for himself in the "City of David." Here, "City of David" refers to Jerusalem since that is where David lives as the king. David also spreads out the tent for the ark of Yahweh. This means that David sets up the tent. Since David is the king, David most likely tells his servants to do the actual work rather than building the buildings and setting up the tent himself. After this, David says that

only the Levites may carry the ark of God because Yahweh chose the Levites to always serve as the ones to do this task.

In scene two, David tells all the Israelites to gather in Jerusalem so they can bring the ark of Yahweh to the place David has prepared for the ark of Yahweh. David also specifically gathers the "sons" or descendants of Aaron and the Levites. Then we learn the names of the Levite leaders that David gathers. We also learn which Levite tribe each leader comes from and how many "brothers" or relatives from that tribe serve under each leader.

The storyteller describes the six Levite tribes and the six men who lead their male relatives from those tribes. From the descendants of Kohath, Uriel leads 120 of his relatives. For the descendants of Merari, Asaiah leads 220 of his relatives. For the descendants of Gershon, Joel leads 130 of his relatives. For the descendants of Elizaphan, Shemaiah leads 200 of his relatives. For the descendants of Hebron, Eliel leads 80 of his relatives. For the descendants of Uzziel, Amminadab leads 112 of his relatives.

In scene three, David calls the leaders of the priests, Zadok and Abiathar, and the leaders of the Levites, Uriel, Asaiah, Joel, Shemaiah, Eliel, and Amminadab, to come talk with David. David says these men are the "heads" or leaders of their ancestors', or fathers', houses. This means these men lead the family groups that all come from the same ancestor.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your culture, how do you describe the descendants of a person or family group? What do you call the relatives within that group? How do you describe the leaders of a family or group? Pause this audio here.

David tells these leaders that they, along with their relatives in each of their tribes, must consecrate themselves so that they can bring the ark of Yahweh, the God of Israel, to the place David had prepared for the ark. In other words, all of the Levites must ritually prepare themselves for the upcoming religious task. This means that the men probably perform a ritual where they clean their bodies and clothes, and temporarily do not have sexual relations with their wives.

Stop here and discuss, as a group, some possible ways you can describe how the priests and Levites ritually prepare themselves for their upcoming religious duty. Pause this audio here.

David explains that the reason Yahweh had "broken out in anger" and punished the Israelites the first time the Israelites tried to move the ark was because the Levites did not carry the ark the way Yahweh commanded. Also, David says that the Israelites did not ask Yahweh what to do in the ritual.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about the reason Yahweh punished the Israelites when they tried to move the ark before. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about how Yahweh had "broken out in anger" at the Israelites. Pause this audio here.

In scene four, all of the priests and Levites ritually prepare themselves so that they can bring the ark of Yahweh, the God of Israel, to Jerusalem. The Levites carry the ark of God with poles on their shoulders. This way to carry the ark is the way that Yahweh, through Moses, had told the Levites to do many years ago.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, who can communicate a message from God, spirits, or local gods? Discuss some possible ways you can explain how Moses had previously given Yahweh's instructions to the Levites. Pause this audio here.

In scene five, David tells the Levite leaders to assign some of their fellow Levites to joyfully play musical instruments. These instruments include harps, lyres, and cymbals. First, the storyteller mentions the names of all of the men that the Levite leaders choose to play the instruments. The storyteller mentions the names of the first and highest-ranking group of musicians. Each man represents his own "brothers" or relatives from his family group. This includes Heman, the "son" or descendant of Joel. The second man the Levite leaders choose is Asaph, the descendant of Berekiah from among Asaph's family group. The third man the Levite leaders choose is Ethan, Kushaiah's son, from the Merarite family group.

Then the storyteller mentions the next, lower-ranking, group of musicians. The men in this group include Zechariah, Jaaziel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Unni, Eliab, Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattithiah, Eliphelehu, Mikneiah, Obed-Edom, and Jeiel. Some of these men are also guards for the ark.

Now, the storyteller repeats the names of the men by group and says what kind of instrument each group of men will play. In other words, the Levite leaders organize all of the men into groups so that each group of men plays the same type of instrument. Heman, Asaph, and Ethan will play the bronze cymbals. Zechariah, Jaaziel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Unni, Eliab, Maaseiah, and Benaiah will play the harps. The storyteller adds that these men will play the harps according to "alamoth." We do not know what the word "alamoth" means, but it is probably some kind of musical word. Mattithiah, Eliphelehu, Mikneiah, Obed-Edom, Jeiel, and Azaziah will play the lyres. The storyteller adds that these men will play the lyres according to "sheminith." In the original language, the word sheminith literally means "the eighth." We are not sure exactly what this means, but this, too, is probably some kind of musical word.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about "alamoth" and "sheminith" in your language. Pause this audio here.

Kenaniah, the head Levite, will lead since he is skillful. We do not know for sure how Kenaniah will lead or what Kenaniah is skillful at doing. The storyteller may mean that Kenaniah is in charge of transporting the ark, or perhaps of the singing, because he is skilled in this. Berekiah and Elkanah will be guards for the ark. Shebaniah, Joshaphat, Nethanel, Amasai, Zechariah, Benaiah, and Eliezer the priests will blow metal trumpets at the "face" or in front of the ark of God. Obed-Edom and Jehiah will also act as guards for the ark.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 15:1–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- All the people of Israel
- The priests
- The Levites
- The leaders of the priests, Zadok and Abiathar
- And the leaders of the Levites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

David builds buildings for himself in Jerusalem. After that, David prepares a special tent in which to later put the ark of God. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I have a house and many other buildings, but there is no special place for the ark of Yahweh in Jerusalem; or
- I am only a human king. Yahweh is our God. I must make a special place for Yahweh; or

- Last time we disobeyed Yahweh and moved the ark in our own way. This time, I will obey Yahweh and make sure that I and the other Israelites follow Yahweh's way to move the ark.

Continue the drama. David tells the Israelites that only Levites may carry the ark of God. This is because Yahweh is the one who decided the Levites should always be the only ones to carry the ark of God. David gathers all the Israelites to Jerusalem so they can, together, bring the ark of Yahweh to the special place David prepared for the ark. David also gathers the descendants of Aaron and the Levites to Jerusalem. The storyteller tells us who all the Levite descendants are and who leads each family group. Uriel, a descendant of Kohath, leads 120 other descendants of Kohath. Asaiah, a descendant of Merari, leads 220 other descendants of Merari. Joel, a descendant of Gershon, leads 130 other descendants of Gershon. Shemaiah, a descendant of Elizaphan, leads 200 other descendants of Elizaphan. Eliel, a descendant of Hebron, leads 80 other descendants of Hebron. Amminadab, a descendant of Uzziel, leads 112 other descendants of Uzziel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- King David is doing a wonderful thing; or
- King David is serious this time about moving the ark in the way Yahweh wants. King David is carefully making sure we do things right this time; or
- Yahweh will be pleased that we are obeying Yahweh!

Continue the drama. Then David talks just to Zadok and Abiathar, the priests, as well as Uriel, Asaiah, Joel, Shemaiah, Eliel, and Amminadab, the leaders of the Levites. David tells these men to ritually prepare themselves and the other Levites to bring the ark of the Lord, the God of Israel, to the place David prepared for it in Jerusalem. David explains that the reason Yahweh punished the Israelites who tried to move the ark before is that the Levites did not carry the ark. David also says that David and the Israelites did not follow Yahweh's way to move the ark. So the priests and Levites consecrate, or ritually prepare, themselves and then carry the ark of God with the poles on their shoulders, according to Yahweh's former command to the Israelites through Moses. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priests and Levites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We need to prepare ourselves properly to show respect to Yahweh; or
- We want to follow the right way to carry the ark so people do not die; or
- There are many rules to remember so that we follow Yahweh correctly.

Continue the drama. David tells the leaders of the Levites to choose musicians to joyfully play harps, lyres, and cymbals. The Levite leaders choose groups of men to do this. Each group plays different instruments in specific ways. Heman, Asaph, and Ethan will play the cymbals. We learn that Heman is Joel's son. Asaph is Berekiah's son. And Ethan is Kushaiah's son, a descendant of Merari. The leaders also choose a second, lower-status group of Levites to play the lyres. This group includes Zechariah, Jaaziel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Unni, Eliab, Maaseiah, and Benaiah. The leaders choose the following Levites to play the harps: Mattithiah, Eliphelehu, Mikneiah, Azaziah, and the guards, Obed-Edom and Jeiel. The Levite leaders also choose the skillful Kenaniah to lead and some other men to guard the ark. The guards are Berekiah, Elkanah, Obed-Edom, and Jehiah. The leaders also choose priests, Shebaniah, Joshaphat, Nethanel, Amasai, Zechariah, Benaiah, and Eliezer to blow metal trumpets in front of the ark. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priests and Levites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are people, and we do not deserve to stay in Yahweh's presence. We must sanctify ourselves and ritually prepare ourselves to do this special task. By doing this, we can show Yahweh that we want to faithfully obey Yahweh; or
- We have an important responsibility to take care of the ark of Yahweh in a way that honors Yahweh; or
- We are so excited and happy to have Yahweh's presence among our people again! or
- We are so thankful to Yahweh for forgiving our people, the Israelites, for our past mistake when we did not carry the ark the way Yahweh wanted us to do.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 15:1–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

This story tells us about how King David and the Israelite army moved the **ark of God**, or the **ark of Yahweh**, to Jerusalem. The ark was a special rectangular box that people covered in gold. Yahweh is the personal name for God. Use the same words for "ark of God," or "ark of Yahweh," that you have used in previous passages and remember that Yahweh and ark of God are in the Master Glossary.

David had prepared a tent to place the ark of God in Jerusalem. A **tent** was a temporary shelter that people usually made with soft material such as dried animal skins. A tent could be moved easily, but provided less shelter than a house made of wood or stone. Use the same word for tent that you have used in previous passages.

David called together all of **Israel**, which means all the people of Israel. Here, Israel refers to the Israelites or people who are descendants of Jacob, whom Yahweh called Israel. For more information on Israel and Israelites, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word that you used for Israel in previous passages.

David specifically called together the priests, who were the sons or **descendants** of Aaron, and the Levites, so that David could talk to these men. In this case, these priests were descendants of Aaron, but not direct sons of Aaron. Use the same word for sons when it means descendants as you have used in previous passages. Descendants is in the Master Glossary.

Priests were responsible to offer sacrifices to God on behalf of the people. These men took care of the tabernacle and taught the people how to worship God. **Levites** were the descendants of Levi, one of Jacob's 12 sons. For more information on priests and Levites, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for priests and Levites as you used in previous passages.

David called the **leaders** of the priests and the leaders of the Levites to come talk with David. Use the same word for clan leaders as you have used in previous passages.

David said these men were the leaders of their **father's houses**. This means that each of these men led a family group, or clan, of people who all came from the same ancestor. Use the same word for family group, clan, or household as you have used in previous passages. See household in the Master Glossary for more information.

The people in these family groups were all **brothers**, or relatives. Use the same word for "brothers" when it means relatives that you have used in previous passages.

David told these leaders that they, along with their relatives in each of their tribes, must consecrate themselves so that they could bring the ark of Yahweh, the God of Israel, to the place David had prepared for the ark. In other words, all of the Levites had to ritually purify themselves so they would be set apart, or holy, for this religious task. If needed, look up consecrate in the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about these men **consecrating** themselves. Pause this audio here.

David said that Yahweh was angry with the Israelites the first time they tried to bring the ark of Yahweh to Jerusalem because they did not bring it according to the ordinance that Yahweh gave them. An ordinance is a specific instruction that Yahweh gives his people about what the priests should do.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **ordinance**. Pause this audio here.

David told the Levites to choose musicians to play harps, lyres, and cymbals. Here is some more information about these instruments.

In those days, the kind of **harps** that people played looked and sounded different from harps today. The harps in those days had a wider and thicker bottom end of the instrument to help make the sound louder. People thought the shape of this harp looked similar to a wineskin container that has a larger bottom. So, people called this kind of harp by the same name as a wineskin container. This type of harp probably had around 12 strings. Use the same word you have used previously for harp.

Lyres are smaller stringed instruments, similar to a very small harp. People in those days often played lyres and sang at the same time. People played the lyre strings with one or both hands by plucking or strumming. In those days, people made lyres with 3 to 10 strings. Musicians would pluck and strum these instruments. The Israelites likely made the strings for lyres out of the dried large intestines of sheep. People in those days likely made lyres

by carving wood into curved shapes and then stretching strings across the wooden frame from bottom to top. Lyres have a larger base at the bottom of the instrument and a smaller bar at the top of the instrument. The lyre usually has two arms, or bars, on the sides so the musician can hold the instrument. Lyre strings usually have different thicknesses and lengths. The person who plays the lyre plucks or strums the strings so the strings vibrate and make a sound. Use the same word you have used previously for lyre.

A **cymbal** is like a thin, round metal plate. A set of cymbals has two identical pieces that musicians hit together to make a higher-pitched, crashing or ringing sound. Musicians either hold one cymbal in each hand or tie two cymbals with some kind of string to different fingers on the same hand to hit together. Smaller cymbals make quieter sounds and larger cymbals make louder sounds. Use the same word you have used previously for cymbals.

The priests blew metal **trumpets**. Use the same word you have used previously for metal trumpets.

Obed-Edom and Jehiah were guards, or gatekeepers, for the ark. These men made sure that no one touched the ark, and that everyone did the correct things around the ark.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you talk about the guards, or gatekeepers, for the ark?

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 15:1–24

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (919 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 15:25–16:7

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 15:25–16:7 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 15:25–16:7 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 15:25–16:7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In a previous story, King David failed to move the ark of the covenant of Yahweh to Jerusalem because David and the other Israelites disobeyed Yahweh. So, David put the ark in Obed-Edom's house. Now, in this story, David and the other Israelites try again to move the ark of Yahweh from Obed-Edom's house to the tent David has set up specifically for the ark in Jerusalem.

David, the Israelite elders, and the military commanders all joyfully go to Obed-Edom's house together so they can bring the ark of Yahweh to Jerusalem. An elder is a person with authority in the community. In those days, an elder was usually the head of a large family or a group of families. The military commanders each lead a unit or group of 1,000 soldiers.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

God helps the Levites who carry the ark. The Levites sacrifice seven bulls, which are male cattle, and seven rams, which are male sheep. The Levites are the ones who offer the sacrifices.

David wears a fine linen robe. All the Levites who carry the ark, the musicians, and Kenaniah, who is in charge of the men who sing, also wear the same kind of linen robe. Linen refers to a thin, white cloth material that people make from plant fibers.

Stop here and look at an image of a linen robe. Pause this audio here.

David also wears a linen ephod. We know that an ephod is a garment a priest usually wears. We do not know for sure what a linen ephod looks like, but a person who wears an ephod probably ties it around their waist, and the fabric probably goes from the waist down to the knee, and does not fully cover the person's body in that area.

Stop here and look at an image of a linen ephod. Discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what types of clothing do people wear to celebrate before God or local spirits or gods? Pause this audio here.

All the Israelites move the ark of the covenant of Yahweh to Jerusalem. The Israelites joyfully shout and play music with ram's horn trumpets, metal trumpets, cymbals, lyres, and harps.

Stop here and, if needed, look at images of a ram's horn trumpet, a metal trumpet, cymbals, a lyre, and a harp. Also, discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of musical instruments, music, and songs do people use to celebrate before God or local spirits or gods? How is what people do in your culture the same or different from what the Israelites do to celebrate Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

King David and the other Israelites bring the ark of the covenant of Yahweh to Jerusalem. Michal, daughter of former King Saul, watches from a window. The passage does not mention this, but we know from other stories that Michal is one of David's wives.

Michal sees King David dancing and celebrating. Michal feels such strong disgust for David's action that Michal strongly dislikes David.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about someone who disliked or hated another person because of the other person's actions. Pause this audio here.

The Levites bring the ark of Yahweh inside the tent that David has set up specifically for the ark. Then King David and the people present burnt offerings and peace offerings, or fellowship offerings, before Yahweh. This means that David tells the priests to give specific gifts to Yahweh in front of the ark of Yahweh. In those days, Israelite priests made a burnt offering by burning all of an animal that the priests sacrificed. The Israelites make this kind of offering to show Yahweh that the Israelites are completely devoted to Yahweh. Also in those days, Israelite priests made peace offerings by burning certain parts of the animal the priests sacrificed. Then the people who worshipped Yahweh would prepare and eat the other parts of the animal. The Israelites make this kind of offering to show Yahweh that they want to dedicate themselves to Yahweh and restore the Israelites' relationship with Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of offering do people make to please God or the local gods they worship? Pause this audio here.

After offering the burnt offerings and peace offerings, David asks Yahweh to bless the people of Israel. Then, David gives out a few kinds of food to all the men and women Israelites who are there. David, likely through David's servants, gives each person a piece of bread. In those days, people ate bread as their main food each day. In this story, David also gives another kind of food to the people. We do not know the exact meaning of the second thing that David gives to each of the Israelite people to eat or drink. David also gives each of the Israelite people a cake of raisins, meaning someone pressed a lot of raisins together into a clump. Then, the Israelite people go back to their homes.

Stop here and look at pictures of bread and a cake of raisins as a group. Pause this audio here.

David also appoints some of the Levites to lead others in worship before the ark of Yahweh. These people worship Yahweh by name and thank and praise Yahweh, the God of Israel. David appoints Asaph as the leader of the Levites. Asaph will also play the cymbals. Zechariah is second in rank after Asaph. The other Levites David appoints to play the lyres and harps are: Jeiel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Mattithiah, Eliab, Benaiah, Obed-Edom, and Jeiel. The priests, Benaiah and Jahaziel, regularly blow the trumpets in worship in front of the ark of the covenant of God. It is on this same day that David appoints Asaph and Asaph's relatives to give thanks to Yahweh in a certain way. Yahweh will explain how to do this in the next story.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 15:25–16:7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: King David, the Israelite elders, and the military commanders go with the Levites to move the ark of Yahweh from Obed-Edom's house to Jerusalem. The Levites sacrifice animals. David and the people with David all celebrate that the Israelites have the ark. David and the Levites wear fine linen robes. David also wears a linen ephod.

In the second scene: The Levites bring the ark into Jerusalem. The former King Saul's daughter, Michal, sees David dancing and celebrating. Michal feels a strong dislike towards David.

In the third scene: The Levites place the ark in the tent and give two types of offerings to Yahweh. Then David gives food to all the Israelites.

In the fourth scene: David appoints some Levites to lead people in worship, to play different musical instruments, and to give thanks to Yahweh.

The characters in this passage are:

- King David
- The Israelite elders
- The Israelite military commanders
- The Levites who carry the ark of Yahweh
- The Levite musicians who sing and play instruments
- Israelite men and women who celebrate when David brings the ark into Jerusalem
- Michal, daughter of Saul, the former king
- And the Levites whom David appoints to serve and worship in the tent

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller uses special language to show that this story starts after the previous story.

In scene one, we hear about David, the elders of Israel, and the Israelite military commanders. Each of the military commanders oversees a unit of 1,000 soldiers. David, the elders, and the commanders go with the Levites to joyfully bring the ark of the covenant of Yahweh from Obed-Edom's house to Jerusalem. A covenant is a strong promise. Yahweh had promised to stay with the Israelites and protect them as long as the Israelites obeyed Yahweh's laws. The ark of the covenant was a large, special box that symbolized Yahweh's presence with the Israelites. Many years ago, Yahweh had written Yahweh's laws on tablets, or flat pieces of stone. Yahweh had told Moses to put these tablets inside the ark. So, "the ark of the covenant of Yahweh" means that the ark both represents and holds the record of the covenant relationship between Yahweh and the people of Israel.

Then the storyteller says that God helps the Levites who carry the ark of the covenant of Yahweh. The Levites sacrifice seven bulls and seven rams. Bulls are male cattle, and rams are male sheep. That God helps the Levites might mean that the Levites sacrifice the bulls and rams to God before the Levites carry the ark, so that God will help the Levites. Or this might mean that the Levites can carry the ark because God helps the Levites. Or this might mean that the Levites sacrifice the bulls and rams to God after they carry the ark because God helped the Levites. We do not know exactly how God helps the Levites. In your translation, you may describe this help in a vague way so that the people who hear the story can interpret the meaning in several ways.

Stop and act out that God helps the Levites, and the Levites make a sacrifice. Then take turns in your group practicing how you can say this in your language. Pause this audio here.

David, the Levites who carry the ark, the musicians, and Kenaniah all wear fine linen robes. People make linen from the fibers of a flax plant.

We do not know for sure what Kenaniah's job is. Kenaniah might be in charge of transport or in charge of singing. Think about how you described Kenaniah's job in the previous story and use the same meaning here.

As all the people of Israel bring the ark of the covenant of Yahweh, the people shout with joy, make loud sounds with rams' horns and trumpets, and play cymbals, lyres, and harps.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What does it sound like when people make shouts of joy? Think of something very happy, and try to make shouts of joy about that thing as a group! How will you talk about these sounds in your language? Pause this audio here.

In scene two, the Israelites bring the ark of the covenant of Yahweh into the City of David. Since David lived in Jerusalem at this time, "City of David" refers to Jerusalem. Michal, Saul's daughter, watches this from a window. Michal strongly dislikes King David when she sees David dancing, or skipping around and laughing joyfully in celebration. Michal probably has not shared her feelings with others, but Michal has thought about these feelings.

Stop and discuss as a group how you might describe how Michal is feeling towards David. Think about the words you used when you told the story about someone who strongly dislikes someone else in step two. Pause this audio here.

In scene three, the Levites place the ark of Yahweh inside the tent that David set up for it. David had set up the tent sometime earlier. Most likely, this means that David told other people to set up the tent before David went

to get the ark of Yahweh to bring the ark back to Jerusalem. So, we know that this is a special place just for the ark of Yahweh.

The Levites make burnt offerings and peace offerings to God in this tent. In those days, Israelite priests made a burnt offering by burning all of an animal that the priests sacrificed. The Israelites make this kind of offering to show Yahweh that they are completely devoted to Yahweh. Also in those days, Israelite priests made peace offerings by burning certain parts of the animal that the priests sacrificed. Then the people who worshipped Yahweh would prepare and eat the other parts of the animal. The Israelites make this kind of offering to show Yahweh that they want to dedicate themselves to Yahweh and restore the Israelites' relationship with Yahweh. The Israelites do this "before God," which means in God's presence, at Yahweh's ark.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the idea that the priests made these sacrifices "before God"? Pause this audio here.

Then David asks Yahweh to bless the people. David blesses the Israelite people "in the name of Yahweh." In other words, David is asking Yahweh to use Yahweh's power to bless the Israelites.

Then David gives a loaf of bread, some other food, and a cake of raisins to each Israelite man and woman who is there. We do not know the exact meaning of the second thing that David gives to each of the Israelite people to eat or drink. Some possible meanings could be "a piece of roasted meat," "some wine," or "a cake of dates." David also gives each of the Israelite people a cake of raisins, which means someone pressed a lot of raisins together into a clump.

Stop and discuss as a group how you will describe what David gives to the Israelites. Look at translations available in major languages in your area. What word or phrase will you use here? Pause this audio here.

In scene four, David appoints some of the Levites to minister to, or serve, Yahweh by leading others in worship before the ark of Yahweh. These Levites will regularly remind other Israelites about the great thing Yahweh has done, and thank and praise Yahweh, the God of Israel. These actions are all part of the daily worship or special worship that the Levites will do on behalf of individual people or the Israelites as a whole.

Asaph is the leader of these Levites, and next to Asaph in rank is Zechariah. Then, Jeiel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Mattithiah, Eliab, Benaiah, Obed-Edom, and Jeiel will play the lyres and harps. Asaph will play the cymbals, and Benaiah and Jahaziel, the priests, will blow the trumpets in worship regularly, or every day at the appropriate time, before the ark of the covenant of Yahweh.

That same day, David, for the first time, appoints Asaph and Asaph's brothers to give thanks to Yahweh in a certain way. We do not know what kind of instructions David gave Asaph and Asaph's brothers. One possible meaning could be that David appointed Asaph and Asaph's relatives to give thanks to Yahweh by singing the song we will hear about at the beginning of the next story.

Stop and discuss: How will you talk in your language about the certain way that David tells Asaph and Asaph's relatives to thank Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 15:25–16:7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King David
- The Israelite elders
- The Israelite military commanders
- The Levites who carry the ark of Yahweh
- The Levite musicians who sing and play instruments

- Israelite men and women who celebrate when David brings the ark into Jerusalem
- Michal, daughter of Saul, the former king
- And the Levites whom David appoints to serve and worship in the tent

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

David, the Israelite elders, and the military commanders joyfully go to Obed-Edom's house together so they can bring the ark of Yahweh to Jerusalem. God helps the Levites who carry Yahweh's covenant ark. These Levites sacrifice seven bulls and seven rams to God. David, the Levites who carry the ark, the musicians, and Kenaniah all wear linen ephods. David and all the Israelites, with David, start to move Yahweh's covenant ark to Jerusalem. While these men move the ark, the men shout for joy and play music on ram's horns, metal trumpets, cymbals, lyres, and harps. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David and the other Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Last time, we did not follow what Yahweh said to do when we tried to move the ark. We must sacrifice to Yahweh to show our devotion and desire to do what Yahweh says to do this time; or
- We are so grateful to Yahweh for Yahweh's mercy and this new opportunity to bring the ark to Jerusalem; or
- We are so excited that Yahweh will live with us again—we must celebrate!

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy that my people, the Israelites, are following what I say to do; or
- I will help the Israelites to do what I want them to do; or
- I feel pleased that the Israelites are showing me proper respect.

Continue the drama. Michal, Saul's daughter, sees David dancing and celebrating. Michal strongly dislikes David because of this.

Ask the person playing Michal, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I think David is not acting how a king should act. If King Saul, my father, were still alive, my father would not act like this; or
- I feel ashamed of David. I am David's wife, but I do not feel love for David because David dances like this; or
- I am King Saul's daughter. I do not want people to associate me with David.

- I feel bitter towards David because David took the kingdom away from my father's family.

[!end] Continue the drama.

David and the other Israelite men with David bring the ark of God into Jerusalem and place it in the tent David had previously prepared for the ark. David tells the priests to give burnt offerings and fellowship offerings to God in front of the ark. David then asks Yahweh to bless all the Israelite people in Jerusalem. David also gives food to every man and woman there. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites in Jerusalem, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel so grateful that Yahweh has accepted and forgiven our people; or
- I am excited to live in Yahweh's presence and fellowship again; or
- I feel thankful to David for bringing the ark back to our people.

Continue the drama. David appoints Levites to serve at Yahweh's ark. David tells these Levites to regularly remind other Israelites about the great thing Yahweh has done and to thank and praise Yahweh, the God of Israel. Asaph leads this group of Levites. The next level of leaders under Asaph are: Zechariah, Jeiel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Mattithiah, Eliab, Benaiah, Obed-Edom, and Jeiel. Asaph will play the cymbals. The priests, Benaiah and Jahaziel, will blow the trumpets regularly in front of God's covenant ark. That day, David told Asaph and Asaph's relatives to praise Yahweh in a certain way. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Asaph and the other Levites who serve at Yahweh's ark, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We have a great responsibility and privilege to serve at Yahweh's ark; or
- We are so excited to praise Yahweh as our regular job.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 15:25–16:7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

David and other Israelites bring the **ark of the covenant of Yahweh** into David's city. Here, David's city refers to Jerusalem. **Yahweh** is God's personal name. Yahweh used the ark to remind the Israelites that Yahweh had promised to be with the Israelites. If needed, look up Yahweh and the ark of the covenant in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same words for "Yahweh" and "ark of the covenant of Yahweh" that you have used in previous passages.

Israel refers to the **Israelites** or people who are descendants of Jacob. The Israelites lived in the country that people called Israel. Use the same word or phrase for Israel or Israelites as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel and Israelites, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word that you used for Israel in previous passages.

The other Israelites with David include the **elders** and the military **commanders**. Use the same words or phrases for elders and military commanders that you have used in previous passages. For more information on elders, refer to the Master Glossary.

God helped the **Levites** who carried the ark. Use the same words for God and Levites as you have used in previous passages, and see the Master Glossary for more information about God and Levites.

David, the Levites who carry the ark, the musicians, and Kenaniah all wear linen robes. People make linen from the fibers of a flax plant. In those days, Israelite priests usually wore linen clothes as part of their official religious service.

Stop here and look at an image of a flax plant and of a linen robe. Refer to the Master Glossary for a description of a robe. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "linen robe." Pause this audio here.

Later in the story, we also learn that David wears a fine linen ephod. An ephod is a special type of clothing that priests usually wore for important events. Linen is a soft, lightweight fabric. A priest usually wore an ephod on top of other clothes by tying the straps of the ephod over his shoulders and waist. However, another type of ephod is a garment that priests and others wore under their clothes. We are not sure what kind of ephod this was. Ephods did not cover the whole body.

Stop here and, if necessary, look at an image of a linen ephod. Discuss as a group what words you will use to describe the ephod. Pause this audio here.

The Levites **sacrifice** seven bulls, which are male cattle, and seven rams, which are male sheep. A sacrifice is a gift to God. People would give this kind of gift to God for different reasons. People often did this to worship God and to thank God. Another reason people gave this kind of gift to God was when people had done something wrong and wanted to ask God for forgiveness. For more information on sacrifice, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for bulls, rams, and sacrifice as you used in previous passages.

1 Chronicles 15:25–16:7

Michal looks out from a window and sees David dancing and celebrating. Michal "despises David in her **heart**" or strongly dislikes David for doing this. The heart refers to the person's thoughts, feelings, and will. In this passage, the storyteller uses the word "heart" to show how strongly Michal feels. If you use the word for heart in this passage, use the same word for heart as you used in previous passages. For more information on heart, refer to the Master Glossary.

David tells the Levites to make **burnt offerings** and **peace offerings**, or **fellowship offerings**, to Yahweh. A burnt offering is a kind of sacrifice that people bring to God. When a person brings God a burnt offering, that person kills an animal and burns this animal completely on an altar, which is a special place people build where they bring gifts to God. For more information on burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary, and use the same word or phrase for burnt offering as you have used in previous passages. A peace or fellowship offering is an offering that people brought to God to restore their peace with God.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **peace offering** or **fellowship offering**. Use the same word or phrase for peace offering or fellowship offering, and for burnt offering as you used in previous books of the Bible. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about peace offerings or fellowship offerings. Pause this audio here.

David **blesses** all the Israelites who are in Jerusalem. David is asking Yahweh to do good to the Israelites. Use the same word for bless that you have used in previous passages. Refer to the Master Glossary for a full definition of bless.

In those days, the Israelites usually shared **cakes of bread** with each other at each meal. The Israelites ground up and roasted grain to make flour. Then the Israelites made bread by combining flour with oil to make a dough. The Israelites would bake this dough, which means to slowly heat food at a high temperature to make it ready to eat. The Israelites made some kinds of bread with yeast. Yeast made the bread grow bigger when people baked the bread. Israelites would make this kind of bread as loaves, or big chunks of bread that they could cut or tear apart for smaller pieces later. The process to make bread dough with yeast took a few days.

If necessary, stop here and look at a picture of bread as a group. Pause this audio here.

David also gives a second kind of food or drink to the people. We do not know the exact meaning of the second thing that David gives to each of the Israelite people to eat or drink, but most people think it may have been a cake of dates. Dates are a type of fruit, and people would press multiple dried dates together to make larger date "cakes." Some other possible meanings could be "a piece of roasted meat" or "some wine."

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use to describe this second item that David gave to the Israelites. Pause this audio here.

People in those days would take grapes, a fruit that makes wine, dry the grapes in the sun, and then squeeze the grapes together to form a clump. We call dried grapes "raisins." The Israelites called the clump of raisins a "**cake of raisins**." People who traveled or soldiers who went to battle often took cakes of raisins for food, since the cakes stayed good for a while, and people did not need to cook the cakes. Sometimes, the people would soak the raisins in water and mix the raisins with grain to eat.

If necessary, stop here and look at a picture of raisins and a cake of raisins as a group. Pause this audio here.

The Levites serve Yahweh at the ark by leading others in worship before the ark of Yahweh. These Levites will regularly remind other Israelites about the great thing Yahweh has done, and thank and praise Yahweh, the God of Israel. When someone praises Yahweh, they speak out loud the good things that Yahweh has done and recognize that Yahweh deserves honor.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **praise**. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about praise. Pause this audio here.

Israel brings Yahweh's covenant ark into Jerusalem. The Israelites shout with joy and play ram's horn trumpets, metal trumpets, cymbals, lyres, and harps. Here is some more information about these instruments:

In those days, the Israelite people made trumpets out of a ram's horn. The person who played the **ram's horn** would blow through the hole on the narrow end of the horn to make a long, loud sound. Ram's horn trumpets

can make only a few notes. Use the same word as you have used previously for ram's horn trumpets. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about a ram's horn trumpet.

We know from previous stories that Yahweh had told the Israelites to play on metal **trumpets** during days of celebration. People can hear the loud, clear sounds of metal trumpets from far away. Use the same word you have used previously for metal trumpets.

A set of **cymbals** has two identical pieces that musicians hit together to make a higher-pitched, crashing or ringing sound. Use the same word you have used previously for cymbals.

Lyres are smaller stringed instruments, with 3 to 10 strings. Use the same word as you have used previously for lyre.

In those days, the kind of **harps** that people played probably had around 12 strings. Use the same word you have used previously for harp.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 15:25–16:7

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (984 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (6.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 16:8–13

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 16:8–13 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:8–13 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:8–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Stop here and review as a group: We recommend that your team complete the "Introduction to Poetry Modules 2 & 3" before you continue with "Step 3: Defining the Scenes." Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The singer sings that the Israelites should praise Yahweh and tell others who Yahweh is and what Yahweh has done.

In the second scene: The singer reminds the Israelites that they are the people Yahweh chose, so the Israelites should remember what Yahweh has done.

The characters in this passage are:

- The singer, who may be a Levite like Asaph, along with a group of Levites, who may be playing instruments and singing too
- The Israelites who are listening to this song
- Yahweh
- Other people groups
- And Jacob, whose name is also Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the last passage, David chose Asaph and the Levites to praise Yahweh. Then the storyteller includes this song. This could mean that David wrote this song so Asaph and perhaps some other Levites could sing the song, but it is not clear exactly who wrote the song. It is also not clear how many people are singing at this time. It is possible that there is at least one singer who may be leading other Levites to sing or play music with him. The singer and other Levites will probably continue to sing this song and songs like it to praise Yahweh. This song is also in the book of Psalms in three parts. Those versions of the song are slightly different, as people probably changed the words of their songs to sing to Yahweh at different times. When this singer and the Levites sing these songs, they also teach the Israelites how to praise Yahweh. Throughout this song, the singer will tell the Israelites who the Israelites are and who they should worship, as well as how and why the Israelites should worship.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, when are some times when you would use a song or a poem to teach something? If you know some songs like this, you can sing them now! Why do you think people sing these teachings instead of just saying them? Pause this audio here.

Just like in many other Hebrew songs, this song has many companion phrases. In a companion phrase, a poet will say one thing in one line and then, in the next line or lines, add to what they said. Sometimes the poet will repeat what he just said. Sometimes the poet will add more information or say something opposite. Throughout

this song, the singer will often sing something in one line. Then, in the next line, the singer will repeat what he has just said in a different way and add a little more information.

Poets group several lines and companion phrases together to create larger sections. The lines in the section usually have a similar idea or part of the story. The entire song has eight sections, but some translations divide the song into different numbers of sections. This passage has two sections of the song, and each section has three or four sets of companion phrases.

Stop here and review as a group: If your team has completed the introduction to poetry, remind one another of the special ways that poets use language. What are the most common ways that poets use language in Hebrew poems? Pause this audio here.

In the first section of the song, the singer urges the Israelites to do several actions. Each action is slightly different, but they are all ways to worship Yahweh. The singer urges the Israelites to thank Yahweh, tell what Yahweh has done, sing praises to Yahweh, boast or rejoice in Yahweh, seek Yahweh, and remember what Yahweh has done. Throughout this song, the singer often uses many words that mean similar or the same things to emphasize something. Here, the singer is emphasizing that the Israelites really should praise Yahweh in many ways!

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: The Israelites would often repeat an important idea in a song several times in order to emphasize it. How do you emphasize an important idea in your language? Pause this audio here.

The first companion phrase is the first two lines of the first section. The singer sings that the Israelites should praise, call Yahweh's name out loud, and make known what Yahweh has done. The singer is saying three times, in three slightly different ways, that the Israelites praise Yahweh by proclaiming what Yahweh has done. The singer specifically says people should call on or proclaim Yahweh's name. In this time, someone's name is their reputation or their character. In the second line of the companion phrase, the singer explains whom the Israelites should tell. The Israelites should tell other nations, because everyone should hear about the amazing things Yahweh has done.

In the next companion phrase, the singer describes another way that the Israelites should praise Yahweh. The Israelites do not just speak about Yahweh. The Israelites should also sing! In the original language, when people sang praises, they often did so with musical instruments, which may be what the singer is encouraging the Israelites to do here. The singer explains in the second line what the Israelites will sing about. The Israelites should sing about what Yahweh has done.

The singer sings in the next companion phrase that the Israelites should glory and rejoice, which means similar things. Specifically, the Israelites should boast or glory in Yahweh's holy name or reputation. The Israelites should celebrate who Yahweh is! The singer clarifies that he is speaking to the Israelites who seek Yahweh. Those are the people whose hearts will rejoice, or the people who will rejoice. Notice how the next companion line goes with what the singer just said. The singer wants all of the Israelites to seek Yahweh. The Israelites should seek or look to Yahweh and Yahweh's strength to help them. The Israelites should seek Yahweh's face or presence continually. People go to be in Yahweh's presence to speak to Yahweh, worship Yahweh, learn about Yahweh, and hear from Yahweh. People do this to have a good relationship with Yahweh! People who have a good relationship with Yahweh rejoice because of that good relationship!

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think of a friend whose face you see often. You are often in that person's presence when you do activities with them and talk to them. Describe how well you know that person and what your relationship with that person is like. Now think of a friend whom you have not seen in many years. How is your relationship with this second friend different than your relationship with the first friend? Pause this audio here.

Discuss whether you ever use a phrase like "a heart rejoicing" or "seeking someone's face" in your language. Discuss how you want to translate the times when the singer sings about a part of a person doing something. Since these parts represent the person as a whole, you could also choose to say "Let the people who seek Yahweh rejoice," or "Seek Yahweh." Pause this audio here.

In the second section and scene, the singer reminds the Israelites who they are. Notice how the singer uses similar words in the first and second lines of this companion phrase. The singer calls the Israelites descendants of Israel in the first line and then children of Jacob in the second line. Jacob and Israel are two names for the same man. Children is another way to say descendants. The singer sings that the Israelites were Yahweh's servants and that Yahweh chooses people to be his servants.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what words do you have for a person's descendants? Discuss how you want to translate the different words for a person's descendants here. Pause this audio here.

The singer tells the Israelites what they should do because they are Jacob's descendants and Yahweh's servants. The Israelites should remember or remind themselves and each other of the wonders and miracles that Yahweh has done. Some of these amazing things Yahweh did were judgments on other nations, when Yahweh chose to do amazing things to save the Israelites and punish other nations.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In the original language, the singer tells the Israelites what to do, then calls them by several names. Some translations switch the order of these two verses to make it clearer. Discuss how you want to translate this into your language. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:8–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The singer, who may be a Levite like Asaph, along with a group of Levites, who may be playing instruments and singing too
- The Israelites who are listening to this song
- Yahweh
- Other people groups
- And Jacob, whose name is also Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The Levites sing,

"Thank Yahweh. Worship him!

Proclaim to other nations what Yahweh has done.

Sing to Yahweh, sing songs of praise to him

Announce to people all Yahweh's marvelous deeds.

Be proud of what the holy God has done

May the people who are looking to Yahweh rejoice.

Seek Yahweh and the strength that he gives.

Seek Yahweh continually.“ Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the singer, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am excited that we are celebrating Yahweh as we should! Yahweh is worth celebrating; or
- I am honored to sing this song in front of the Israelites. I know many people will hear or repeat this song, and I want everyone to know that we should praise and worship Yahweh; or
- I hope that the Israelites remember who Yahweh is and why we should praise him when they hear this song. I hope the Israelites also continue to remember to praise Yahweh when they go home after this celebration.

Continue the drama. “Remind yourselves of the wonderful things Yahweh has done.

Remember Yahweh’s miracles and how he judged our enemies

Listen, Yahweh’s servants, the descendants of Israel!

Listen, you children of Jacob, the people that God chose!“ Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- This song is beautiful, and I feel joyful when I hear this song. I want to sing beautiful songs to God, too! or
- Yahweh really has done so many things for us. I am thankful to Yahweh for how he has treated us; or
- When I think about what Yahweh has done, I feel excited and want to tell people about our God!

Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I have done these wonderful things for the Israelites because I am their God, and I have said that I will protect the Israelites. I always do what I say I will do; or
- I love my people and want to speak to them and spend time with them. I am pleased when my people sing songs to me and seek me; or
- I do not hide who I am or what I do from the Israelites. I have chosen the Israelites to be my people, and I have shown them who I am so that they can trust and rely on me.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:8–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The singer urges the people to thank **Yahweh**. The name Yahweh was a very personal name for God that showed the close relationship that God had with the people of Israel. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

The singer urges the Israelites to thank Yahweh in order to praise Yahweh. So some versions say “give thanks,” while others say “**praise**.” When you praise God, you speak out loud good things about God and to God, because you recognize that God is good and awesome and that God deserves great honor. For more information on praise, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for praise as you used in previous passages.

The Israelites should tell the nations or peoples what Yahweh has done. These people are all the people and people groups that live on the Earth.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **peoples**. Look up nation in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites should boast or glory in Yahweh’s holy name. When people glory in or boast about God, they praise God, admire him, and say good things about God. The Israelites are proud of their God!

1 Chronicles 16:8–13

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the way people **boast** or **glory** in Yahweh's name. Look up glory in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh's name is holy, which means that Yahweh is holy. This means Yahweh is completely good, completely pure, powerful, and majestic. It means that Yahweh is whole, complete, and unchangeable. But most of all, it means Yahweh is God!

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **holy**. Look up holy in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The singer sings, "May the **hearts** of the people who seek Yahweh rejoice!" The heart is a muscle inside our body that keeps our blood flowing, but in the Bible, people use the word heart for the place where a person's thoughts, feelings, and decisions happen. People use their hearts to rejoice or feel joy! For more information on heart, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for heart as you used in previous passages.

To seek Yahweh means to make an effort to know and serve Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the way people **seek** Yahweh. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites should remember the wonders, miracles, and judgments that Yahweh has done. A wonder is something wonderful that Yahweh has done. A miracle, which people sometimes also call a wonder, is something that happens that is very unusual and surprising and seems impossible. Yahweh often performed a miracle when people prayed for help. Sometimes people would call what Yahweh does "wonders" to show how amazing Yahweh's actions were. Sometimes Yahweh performed a miracle to punish people, and people would often call these miracles "judgments." Yahweh performs miracles to teach people something, to show the people that Yahweh is powerful and that they can trust him.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **wonders**, **miracles**, and **judgments**. What different words do you have in your language to talk about the different kinds of amazing things God does? Look up miracle in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites are Yahweh's **servants**. A servant is a person who does work for someone else. A servant is often a low position. For more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for servant as you used in previous passages.

The Israelites are the offspring or **descendants** of Jacob. Some translations also say "seed," which is another way to talk about a person's descendants. A person's descendants are his children, grandchildren, and all future generations from the same family line. The Israelites are descendants of Jacob, Abraham's grandson. Jacob's name is also Israel. Sometimes people refer to the Israelites as Israel. For more information on descendant or seed, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for descendant as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 16:8–13

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (812 KB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 16:14–22

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 16:14–22 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:14–22 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:14–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This song is a Hebrew poem. We recommend that your team complete the “Introduction to Poetry Module 1” before you continue with “Step 2: Setting the Stage.”

Stop here, if needed, and review the translation decisions your team has made regarding the translation of poetry. Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, the Levites started to sing to celebrate how the ark was now in Jerusalem. The singer sang that the Israelites should remember the wonderful things Yahweh has done. This passage is the second part of the song. The singer reminds the Israelites of how Yahweh made a promise to the Israelites’ ancestors and then protected their ancestors.

At the beginning of this passage, the singer reminds the Israelites to whom they sing: Yahweh, the Israelites’ God. The Israelites know who Yahweh is. Yahweh has been their people’s God since the time of Jacob, many,

many years ago! And their God is important. Yahweh's judgments or commands are for people all over the world because Yahweh rules the whole world. This is the God the Israelites serve and should worship!

Then the singer sings that the Israelites should always remember and think about Yahweh's covenant. This covenant or special promise is the one that Yahweh made with Abraham, the Israelites' ancestor. Some translations say that Yahweh remembers this covenant forever, which is true. But here, the singer is probably urging the Israelites to remember the covenant.

The singer reminds the Israelites how Yahweh kept this promise with each of Abraham's descendants. Yahweh swore an oath or solemnly promised this covenant again to Isaac, Abraham's son. Yahweh confirmed the covenant to Jacob, Isaac's son. Yahweh confirmed the covenant as a statute or promise, which is an announcement that a ruler makes. Yahweh gave this everlasting covenant, or promise that lasts forever, to Israel. While Israel is another name for Jacob, people also used this name to refer to Jacob's descendants, the Israelites. So here, the singer could be referring to both Jacob and the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When a leader makes a solemn promise with a group of people, how does the leader show that they will keep the promise? When a new leader begins to lead, how does the new leader show that they will still keep this special promise? Pause this audio here.

Then the singer sings about what Yahweh promised. Yahweh said he would give the land of Canaan to Abraham and Abraham's descendants. The land is a portion, or an area that Yahweh has measured out for the Israelites to inherit. Normally, a person inherits something after someone else dies. That person now has the right to own that thing. In this case, Yahweh does not have to die in order for the Israelites to inherit the land of Canaan. As the ruler over all the earth, Yahweh has the authority to give the land of Canaan to the Israelites.

Yahweh protected Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, and their families while they were waiting for Yahweh to fulfil his promise and give them the land of Canaan. Throughout their lives, Abraham and his sons did not live in one place but wandered from place to place. Each man and his family were sojourners or temporary residents. They lived for short times in the nations or kingdoms of other people groups, so Abraham and his family were like strangers in the land. While Abraham's family did grow, they were not a huge people group like the Israelites are in this passage.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are some people groups in your area or in your history who do not live in one place? When those people groups are in other nations' lands, how safe are those people groups? How do other governments or people groups treat the people groups who wander? Pause this audio here.

Though other people groups and rulers could have hurt Abraham and his family as they traveled, Yahweh protected them. Yahweh did not allow anyone to oppress Abraham and his family. Yahweh even rebuked or strongly criticized foreign kings in order to defend Abraham's family. Yahweh told those kings not to touch or harm Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, whom Yahweh calls his anointed ones and prophets. "Anointed ones" are people that Yahweh has chosen for a special purpose. Here, the word prophets means, in a general way, people to whom Yahweh speaks. Some people think "my anointed ones" and "my prophets" also refer to the people of Israel, because the Israelites speak God's words to the world. The singer is reminding the Israelites of how Yahweh protected Abraham and his descendants in the past to remind the Israelites that their God protects his people.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:14–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Stop here and review as a group: We recommend that your team complete the "Introduction to Poetry Modules 2 & 3" before you continue with "Step 3: Defining the Scenes." Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

1 Chronicles 16:14–22

In the first scene: The singer reminds the Israelites that Yahweh is their God, who rules over the whole Earth. So the Israelites should remember the covenant that Yahweh made with the Israelites' ancestors. Yahweh promised to give Abraham and his descendants the land where the Israelites live now.

In the second scene: The singer sings about how Yahweh protected Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, and their families when they wandered through other nations.

The characters in this passage are:

- The singer, who may be a Levite like Asaph, along with a group of Levites
- The Israelites who are listening
- The Israelites' ancestors: Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, and their families
- Yahweh
- And kings

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember, while it is not clear exactly who wrote or sang this song, the singer is probably a Levite like Asaph, who is perhaps singing with a group of Levites. This part of the song has two sections, and each section has a different subject. In the first section, the singer sings about who Yahweh is and the promise Yahweh made to the Israelites' ancestors. Then in the second section, the singer sings about how Yahweh protected the Israelites' ancestors. The singer also continues to sing using companion phrases, where he says something in one line, then in the next line or couple of lines, he develops or adds to the idea in some way.

In the first section and scene, the singer sings about who Yahweh is. Yahweh is the Israelites' God. Yahweh's judgements are for the whole earth, so he has authority over Israel and every other nation. Remember that in the last section, the singer urged the Israelites to remember the wonderful things Yahweh does. So next, the singer sings about one of the wonderful things that the Israelites should remember. Yahweh made a special promise to Abraham and his descendants. In the first line of a companion phrase, the singer sings that the Israelites should remember this promise forever. The singer then sings in the next line that the Israelites should remember for a thousand generations. A generation refers to a group of people who are living at the same time. A thousand generations would be a thousand times longer than a person lives! This is another way to say "forever."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what are some ways that you emphasize how someone should do something forever? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh keeps this same promise through each new generation of Abraham's descendants. The singer sings about three ancestors that the Israelites respected: Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, whose name is also "Israel." In two pairs of companion phrases, the singer emphasizes the way that Yahweh kept this covenant as he repeats that Yahweh confirmed it to each man's son. Yahweh confirms it with an oath to Isaac and as a statute or promise to Jacob. The singer then sings that Yahweh made this promise forever with Israel. Remember in the last section that the singer called the Israelites Jacob's descendants, so this promise is for them too. So here, the singer is probably referring both to the man named Israel as well as the people of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people swear oaths or make solemn promises? What do people say or do to show that this is a very serious promise? Pause this audio here.

In the last companion phrase of this section, the singer reveals part of the covenant that Yahweh made. Yahweh promised that he would give the land of Canaan to Abraham and his descendants. The singer explains in the second line that this is Abraham and his descendants' portion of an inheritance, or something that legally and rightfully belongs to them. The singer is showing how faithful Yahweh is because Canaan now belongs to the Israelites.

In the second scene and section, the singer sings about a small group that wanders from nation to nation. The singer has just sung about Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, so we know that he is singing about those men and their families. The singer is reminding the Israelites of how Yahweh protected the Israelites' ancestors. The singer does this to comfort and remind the Israelites that Yahweh will continue to protect them. Yahweh has done this several times, such as when the Israelites traveled through the wilderness. Sometimes, when leaders remind the Israelites about what God has done for their ancestors, the leaders will say, "This is what God has done for you,"

instead of “This is what God has done for your ancestors.” So some translations say “when you were a small group” instead of “when they were a small group.” The leaders are reminding the Israelites that God has treated the Israelites who live at that time, and their ancestors who lived long ago, in the same way.

Stop here and discuss how you want to translate the way the singer talks about the Israelites’ ancestors. As an activity, pretend you are giving a speech to your people group. Talk about the good things that have happened to your people group throughout your history. How do you show that the people you are talking to are connected to the other members of the group, even the people who lived a long time ago? Pause this audio here.

In a companion phrase, the singer repeats that the Israelites’ ancestors were a small group. The singer sings “Yes, they really were few people!” The singer calls them strangers or temporary residents in Canaan. In the next companion phrase, the singer says twice that the small group was wandering in different people’s lands. The singer says in the second line that they were wandering through kingdoms, or places where kings ruled. The singer is emphasizing the danger the small group of Israelite ancestors were in. Because they lived in other nations’ lands, Abraham and his family did not have any rights or a king who would protect them. Large people groups or nations could have hurt the small group!

The singer contrasts their dangerous situation with the way Yahweh protected them in the next two companion phrases. Yahweh did not allow anyone to oppress the Israelites. In fact, as the singer sings in the next phrase, Yahweh even rebuked kings! Then the singer sings Yahweh’s words. These may have been exact words that Yahweh spoke or the kind of things Yahweh would say to the kings. Both statements mean the same thing, to emphasize how serious Yahweh’s command to these kings was. Those kings should not harm the Israelites or even touch them! Yahweh calls Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob two names: “my anointed ones” and “prophets.” Yahweh is showing how special Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob are when he calls them these names.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what are some ways that you rebuke or warn someone not to hurt someone else? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do you call people whom God or gods speak to? When people choose a certain person for a special task, what do you call the person they choose? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:14–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The singer, who may be a Levite like Asaph, along with a group of Levites
- The Israelites who are listening
- The Israelites’ ancestors: Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, and their families
- Yahweh
- And kings

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

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Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The Levites continue to sing:

"He, Yahweh, is our God.

His judgments are for all the world.

Remember Yahweh's covenant forever

Remember the promise he made that will last forever.

Yahweh made that agreement with Abraham.

It is the oath that he swore to Isaac.

God renewed this covenant with Jacob as a law.

God made a covenant with Israel that would last forever.

God said, "I will give the land of Canaan to you

as the part you will inherit." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know people become worried or scared when they are waiting for something. I will confirm this promise many times to reassure Abraham's descendants; or
- I also know the Israelites will face many difficult things, even in the new land I have given them. I want the Israelites to remember how I keep my promises so that they can trust that I will continue to be their God and protect them; or
- I rule over the whole earth, and I give land to all peoples, not just the Israelites.

Ask the person playing the singer, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- When I serve in Yahweh's presence, there are many things to remind me of what Yahweh is like. However, some of the Israelites live far away and do not get to see what I see every day. I want these Israelites to tell each other stories about their people's history to remind each other of what Yahweh is like; or
- When I remember what Yahweh is like and what he has done, it is easier for me to trust Yahweh to take care of us. I want the Israelites to feel this too; or
- I am amazed at how Yahweh has cared for our ancestors and our people for hundreds of years!

Continue the drama. "When our ancestors were only a few people,

When they were just a small group of nomads

Our ancestors moved around from one country to another

They went from one kingdom to another

But Yahweh did not let anyone mistreat them

He warned kings in order to defend our ancestors

God said, 'Do not harm these people I have chosen.

Do not harm my prophets.'" Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We have been in lands where the kings do not respect or like our people. Sometimes, I feel worried about my family and if they will be safe. But every time, Yahweh has protected us; or
- Sometimes God told us to move, or sometimes we would move to find better feeding places for our animals. It was difficult sometimes, not knowing where we would live next; or
- Sometimes our families were in danger because we made mistakes. But Yahweh was still kind and saved us and our families. I am so thankful for what Yahweh has done for us.

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Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:14–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh is the Israelites' **God**. The name Yahweh was a very personal name for God that showed the close relationship that God had with the people of Israel. The word for God is a general word for God. For more information on Yahweh and God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and God as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh's **judgments** are for all the people of the world. Judgement can refer to the way Yahweh rules and the decisions Yahweh makes. Sometimes, Yahweh performed a miracle to punish people, and people would often call these miracles "judgments." A miracle, which people sometimes call a wonder, is something that happens that is very unusual and surprising and seems impossible. For more information on "judgments," refer to miracle in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for judgment as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh made a covenant with Abraham. When people make a covenant, they make a solemn promise to each other that they cannot break. Yahweh promised to give Abraham a land and many descendants. Later, Yahweh confirmed this covenant with Abraham's descendants several times.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **covenant**. For more information on covenant, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for covenant as you used in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also remembers his **word**, or everything that he says. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh's word as you have used in previous passages, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information about "word."

The Israelites should remember this covenant for a thousand **generations**. A generation refers to a group of people who live at the same time and belong to about the same age group. For more information on generation, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for generation as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh promised the covenant to Isaac with an oath. When people make a promise to each other, they can swear an oath to make the promise more serious. When someone swears an oath, they say, "I will absolutely keep my promise. If I do not, God may punish me." When God made a promise to people, God often made an oath as well. There is no one higher than God who can punish God if he breaks an oath, so God made these oaths in his own name, which means that God would punish himself if he broke his promise.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **oath**. Look up oath in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also confirmed the covenant to Jacob as a statute. The songwriter actually says that this covenant is like a decision, or formal announcement to Jacob, that God will always be with Jacob.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **statute**. Look up statute in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The land of Canaan is the portion that the Israelites inherit. When you inherit, you receive a thing or a right from someone else. So here, this means that the Israelites receive the land as their own.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **inherit**. Refer to heir in the Master Glossary for more information about inherit. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The land of **Canaan** is an area of land between the Jordan River in the east and the Mediterranean Sea in the west. People called this land Canaan because the descendants of the man named Canaan lived there. This is the land God promised to give to the Israelites. For more information on Canaan, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Canaan as you used in previous passages.

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The Israelites' ancestors were like strangers or foreigners in Canaan. A person is a foreigner in a country when they are in a country that is not where they were born. Strangers or sojourners are people who are foreigners in a country and temporarily live there, even though it is not where those people were born.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **foreigner**. Look up foreigner in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites' ancestors wandered from **kingdom** to kingdom and from **nation** to nation. A kingdom is the territory or the people that a king rules. A nation is a group of people who belong together, live in the same country, and have the same ruler. For more information on kingdom and nation, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for kingdom and nation as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh tells **kings** not to harm the Israelites. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory, like a region or a country. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh calls the Israelite ancestors his anointed ones or anointed people. To anoint someone means to pour sweet-smelling oil over someone to show that God has chosen that person for a special role. People used the word anointed, or anointed one, for people whom God had chosen, even if no one had done a ritual where they poured oil on that person's head.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **anointed ones**. Look up anoint in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also calls the Israelite ancestors his prophets. A prophet is a person whom God speaks to, so that the person can give messages from God to the people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **prophet**. Look up prophet in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (790 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 16:23–33

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 16:23–33 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:23–33 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:23–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This song is a Hebrew poem. We recommend that your team complete the “Introduction to Poetry Module 1” before you continue with “Step 2: Setting the Stage.”

Stop here, if needed, and review the translation decisions your team has made regarding the translation of poetry. Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, the Levites urged the Israelites to remember the way Yahweh protected the Israelites’ ancestors. Because of what Yahweh has done, the singer now urges all people to sing to Yahweh, who is the only real God. Everything and everyone in the world should rejoice and worship Yahweh. Yahweh created everything in the past, rules over everything now, and will come to rule in the future.

To begin this part of the song, the singer sings that all the earth or all the people in the world should sing to Yahweh to respond to the amazing things Yahweh does. People should proclaim or publicly announce Yahweh’s salvation. Yahweh’s salvation is the way Yahweh saves people. The Israelites should declare Yahweh’s glory, or how beautiful, powerful, and majestic Yahweh is. The Israelites should tell all people groups about the wonderful things Yahweh has done!

Everyone should know and praise Yahweh because Yahweh is great. Yahweh is worthy of or deserves everyone’s praise. Everyone should fear Yahweh, or treat him with deep respect and honor. Everyone should fear Yahweh above or more than all other gods. These gods are spirit beings that other nations worship as if those gods have power. Sometimes people use wood or metal to make idols, which are statues or pillars to represent their gods. These other gods are just idols, nothing more powerful than a statue or pillar. In fact, in the original language, the word for idols means worthless or nothing. These gods are worthless!

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, or in the cultures around you, what do people make to represent their gods? How would you talk about gods that you do not worship or believe to be real gods? Pause this audio here.

Other people groups claim that their gods have power over the heavens. Sometimes, the heavens can mean the sky or the place where God lives. But Yahweh is the one who actually created both the sky and the place where God lives! Unlike those worthless idols, Yahweh is powerful and created everything. And unlike those idols, Yahweh is great, honorable, and majestic, because he is a king. Anyone who is before Yahweh or near him can see this. In the place where Yahweh lives, are strength and joy, because Yahweh is strong and causes people to feel joy. The singer may be singing about the place where Yahweh lives, in heaven, but the singer may also be talking about the place where Yahweh's presence is. This is the tent with the ark of God, which is where Yahweh meets with the Israelites. Yahweh told the Israelites to put special things, like the ark, in this place to remind them what Yahweh is like. When people see these majestic and beautiful things, people should remember to worship their powerful and majestic God!

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What should a king or great leader be like? What do people know about the leader when they are near the leader? How do people feel when they are near a really good leader? Pause this audio here.

Again, the singer sings that everyone should praise Yahweh! The singer sings to the families of all the people on the earth. All people should ascribe glory and strength to Yahweh. To ascribe means to give or declare that something is true. Yahweh is strong and is glorious, and everyone should humbly declare that! People should give Yahweh the glory that Yahweh's name deserves. Remember, someone's name is their reputation or their character, so Yahweh's name represents Yahweh. When people give glory to Yahweh, they declare how beautiful, powerful, and majestic Yahweh is. Because Yahweh rules over all people, not just the Israelites, Yahweh deserves for all people to praise him!

The singer also urges people to bring an offering to Yahweh and come before him. An offering is a gift or sacrifice that people give to God. People do this in God's presence, which is wherever God has chosen to meet with his people. At this time, this is at the tent with the ark of God. When people praise and worship Yahweh, it is as if people are giving Yahweh a gift or offering. So this offering can mean either a physical gift like an animal, or this offering can also simply be the way that people praise Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kinds of gifts or offerings do people bring to gods or kings? Why do people do this? Pause this audio here.

People should bow down and worship Yahweh, to show that they respect and honor Yahweh. People should worship Yahweh in holy splendor. This could mean that people should come in special, beautiful clothes to worship Yahweh. This could also mean that they should worship Yahweh because his holiness is beautiful. In other words, Yahweh is so special in good ways that everything about Yahweh is beautiful. The beautiful things in Yahweh's holy place of worship, like the ark of God, remind people of how holy and set apart Yahweh is.

The singer tells the earth or the people of the earth to tremble in Yahweh's presence. This describes the way that people humble themselves in a fearful or respectful way before a powerful ruler or before God. People should be humble and respectful because Yahweh created the world and put it firmly in its place. If the world is so strong that nothing can move it, then the God who made the world must be even stronger and more powerful! People should tremble and bow down as they recognize how holy, beautiful, and powerful Yahweh is.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how should people act when they are in front of a very powerful king or leader? What do people do to show their deep respect and fear? Pause this audio here.

Then, the singer sings that the world and everything in it should praise Yahweh! The singer talks about the world like it were a person that can sing and celebrate. Yahweh created everything on the earth. The beautiful, powerful, amazing things on earth all show us what a good creator Yahweh is. It is like the world is praising Yahweh or saying out loud, "Look how well God made us! God really is an amazing creator!"

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think of a friend who makes beautiful and amazing things, such as very beautiful clothing or drawings. When you see one of their creations, how do you know who has made it?

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What do you learn or know about your friend when you look at their creations? How would you describe the way that the creation makes you think about the person who made it? Pause this audio here.

The singer sings that everything Yahweh has created should celebrate Yahweh. The heavens and the earth should rejoice and be glad like a person does. Again, the heavens could be both the sky and the place where God lives. The Israelites should say to the people of other nations that Yahweh is king. The sea and everything in it should resound or shout praise to Yahweh. The fields and everything in them should exult or show their joy. Each tree in a forest should sing for joy in front of Yahweh. Everything on earth should rejoice because Yahweh comes to judge or rule over the earth. Yahweh is a good king who cares for every person and every thing. So everyone and everything should look forward to the way Yahweh rules.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:23–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Stop here and review as a group: We recommend that your team complete the "Introduction to Poetry Modules 2 & 3" before you continue with "Step 3: Defining the Scenes." Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Everyone should sing to Yahweh and tell others about the wonderful things Yahweh has done! Yahweh is real and powerful, unlike the gods that other nations worship.

In the second scene: The singer sings that all people should give praise and worship Yahweh because Yahweh created the world.

In the third scene: The whole world, even things like the water and the trees, should celebrate that Yahweh is coming to rule over the earth.

The characters in this passage are:

- The singer, who may be a Levite like Asaph, along with a group of Levites
- Yahweh
- All the people of the world
- And the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This passage is part of the same song as last time. This part of the song is also in Psalm 96. Remember, while it is not clear exactly who wrote or sang this song, the singer is probably a Levite like Asaph, who is perhaps singing with a group of Levites. As the singer praises Yahweh, the singer is showing the Israelites how they can worship God and announce to all people that God rules over everything and everyone. This part of the song is in three sections. Throughout this passage, the singer uses a lot of words that mean similar things to emphasize certain instructions and help the Israelites remember the important ideas he is singing about.

Remember, the singer is singing in front of a group of Israelites. In this song, the singer also sings to all the people of the earth. Though all the other people groups are not in front of the singer right now, the Levites and the Israelites are supposed to repeat this song and tell everyone about Yahweh. When people hear about Yahweh, they should praise Yahweh, too! The singer also sings about things like the sky and the seas as if they are people too. The singer does not actually expect the ground or the sky to listen to him and sing as a person does. The singer is reminding the Israelites of the way that everything shows the amazing way Yahweh has created and cares for them. In the same way, the people Yahweh has created should show and tell about the amazing things Yahweh has done to create and care for them.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When you are singing songs, when are some times when you would sing to both people who are with you and people who are not with you right now? Pause this audio here.

In the first scene and section, the singer sings that all people should praise Yahweh because of these wonderful things Yahweh has done. And the people should not just quietly appreciate or think about Yahweh. Instead, the singer uses lots of similar words in companion phrases to show that people should talk loudly about Yahweh! People should sing, proclaim, and declare out loud in front of people and nations! These people and nations are all the people in the world who are not Israelites. Yahweh's salvation, his glory, and his marvelous works are all the wonderful ways that Yahweh helps, saves, and cares for people. Yahweh is so wonderful and does such wonderful things that people should proclaim what Yahweh does day to day or every day!

In a companion phrase, the singer explains why all people, not just the Israelites, should praise Yahweh. Yahweh is great and deserves for everyone to praise and fear him because Yahweh is real and powerful. Everyone should fear Yahweh more than all other gods. This does not mean that people should fear those gods as well as Yahweh. Yahweh is above or greater than those gods, so people should fear Yahweh instead. The singer compares Yahweh to the other gods that people worship. While those gods are worthless idols, Yahweh created the heavens! Yahweh created everything, including the sky, so everything belongs to him. Yahweh deserves to rule, and he does. Anyone who is before Yahweh or in Yahweh's presence can see how great and like a king he is. Yahweh is strong and causes joy, and anyone in Yahweh's dwelling place can see this. This dwelling place may be the place where Yahweh lives or the place where people go to worship Yahweh. Yahweh has shown that he is God, so everyone should praise and fear him.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you talk about the way that kings are impressive and great? As an activity, think of a great king or leader in your history. Pretend you were in the grand and beautiful place where that king meets with people, and the king is in front of you. Describe what you would see and feel about the king when you see him in this beautiful place. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the singer repeats three times that all people should ascribe or give praise to Yahweh. In this time, people would often repeat something three times to show that it is important. Notice that in each companion phrase of this section, the singer gradually gives more information as he repeats the instruction to give praise to Yahweh. First, the singer sings about who should praise Yahweh: all people of the world. Then he sings how the people should do this: they should tell Yahweh how glorious and strong Yahweh is. Then the singer sings why the people should do this: because Yahweh deserves it. The singer completes the whole idea in the final phrase and tells the Israelites what they should do. The Israelites should bring an offering and come before Yahweh.

The singer explains where the people should do this: in Yahweh's presence, or at the place where Yahweh has chosen to meet with people. This is the tent that David has just set up for the ark of God. When people come to this tent, they should bring an offering or a gift, and the best offering is their praise! And when people do come and see how holy and beautiful Yahweh is, they should act in a deeply respectful way. The singer uses companion phrases to talk about the respectful ways to worship Yahweh. The word for worship can mean to bow down. People should worship, bow down, or tremble, which are all very respectful and appropriate ways to treat someone who rules and has power. The people worship Yahweh in holy splendor, which can refer to special clothes people wear to honor Yahweh, or Yahweh's holy majesty—Yahweh's greatness. Yahweh's actions always show Yahweh's holy splendor. Yahweh always deserves praise for what Yahweh does, so here the singer is probably singing about Yahweh's holy splendor or greatness.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss how you want to translate when the singer sings to "Worship Yahweh in holy splendor." Some translations state this line so that it can mean either option, while others pick one option to make it clear. Both are acceptable translations. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh has shown that he is powerful and deserves to rule the world because he created or established the world. Nothing else can move the world or change what Yahweh has done. The singer emphasizes this when he says, "Yes! Yahweh has really established the earth!"

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you emphasize that something really happened? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene and section, the singer sings that everything on earth should celebrate Yahweh. This includes the Israelites, who can and should say out loud that Yahweh rules over everything. The singer mentions the heavens, the sea, the fields, and the forest, as well as everything in them, to refer to everything Yahweh has

created. The singer also says that everything Yahweh has created should be glad, rejoice, shout, and exult. The singer is saying the same thing with different words. The singer is saying that everything Yahweh has created should celebrate, just like the Israelites do when they announce that their good God, Yahweh, rules. The Israelites should celebrate how Yahweh rules now and how everything looks forward to how Yahweh will continue to rule in the future.

Stop here and discuss whether in your language you would ever talk about the sky or the animals like they were a person. As an activity, describe the way that an animal you take care of greets you and listens to you. Describe the way that an animal would respond to someone who hurts or scares them. Even though this animal is not a person, how does the animal show how good or wonderful you are when they greet you? Discuss how you want to translate the way that the singer says that the earth and sky are glad. You can compare the earth and sky to a person and say, “Earth and sky be glad like people are glad.” Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:23–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The singer, who may be a Levite like Asaph, along with a group of Levites
- Yahweh
- All the people of the world
- And the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The Levites continued to sing,

“All you people of the world, sing to Yahweh!

Every day, announce the good news that Yahweh saves

Declare among the nations how great God’s deeds are

Proclaim his miraculous deeds among all peoples

For Yahweh is great and deserves our greatest praise

People should fear Yahweh more than all the false gods

For all the false gods that other nations worship are only worthless idols

But Yahweh is not worthless. He created the heavens!

Yahweh is glorious and majestic like a king is

Strength and joy are in the place where Yahweh is.“ Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel encouraged when I hear this song. Even though our people have faced many difficult things, our God has always protected us because he is greater than any other people or their gods; or
- I was surprised when I heard that all people should sing to Yahweh. Usually, people worship the god of their people. I guess Yahweh is the God of all people; or
- I feel excited when I remember the wonderful things Yahweh has done and when we celebrate and sing together like this. I want to tell people about how I feel and what I remember about Yahweh. I even want to tell people I do not know!

Continue the drama. “All you peoples on earth, give praise to Yahweh.

Praise him, tell him how great and powerful he is.

Give the honor to Yahweh that he deserves

Bring an offering and come into his presence.

Bow down to worship Yahweh because he is very holy.

All you people who live on earth, humble yourselves in fear in Yahweh’s presence!

Indeed, Yahweh has put the world firmly in its place, and nothing can move it.“ Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the singer, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Right now, as we are all gathered here in front of the tent with the ark of God, it is easy to get excited and want to celebrate Yahweh. However, the Israelites should remember to worship Yahweh even on normal days. I hope this song reminds the Israelites of the way they should continue to act; or
- Yahweh is so great that all people should worship him! I wonder what it would be like if all people worshiped Yahweh as they should. It would be an amazing celebration; or
- I am amazed at how powerful Yahweh is. When we see the amazing things Yahweh does, we should also treat Yahweh with great respect and fear.

Continue the drama. “May the heavens rejoice, may the earth be glad

Let people say among nations, ‘Yahweh rules as king!’

May the sea and all the creatures that are in the sea shout with praise to Yahweh

May the fields and everything that is in them celebrate

May the trees in the forest shout for joy in Yahweh’s presence

because he comes to rule over the whole world.“ Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I remember how the land looks when the plants are growing and the sky is beautiful. It is almost like the world has put on beautiful clothes to celebrate something. Now I see that the world is celebrating Yahweh. Everything Yahweh creates shows how amazing Yahweh is; or
- I suppose if the world is celebrating Yahweh even though it cannot speak, I should celebrate Yahweh too. And I have lots of ways to sing and say how amazing Yahweh is!

Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I carefully made all things to be beautiful and good, and I care about all of it. I am happy when I see the things and people I made living as they should; or
- I am a just and fair ruler. I want to help and care for everything I have created; or
- I am glad when my people celebrate me. I love the beautiful songs they sing to me. I love them and want to help them.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:23–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The singer urges people to sing to **Yahweh**. The name Yahweh was a very personal name for God that showed the close relationship that God had with the people of Israel. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

People should proclaim Yahweh's salvation. Salvation is the way that someone rescues another person from a difficult or dangerous situation.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **salvation** or the way that Yahweh saves people. Look up salvation in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

People should also declare Yahweh's **glory** or how glorious Yahweh is. Glory is the fame and admiration that you gain by doing something impressive. When Yahweh shows his glory, people can see how beautiful, powerful, and majestic Yahweh is. For more information on glory, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for glory as you used in previous passages.

The people should declare Yahweh's glory among the **nations**. A nation is a group of people who belong together, live in the same country, and have the same ruler. For more information on nations, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for nations as you used in the previous passage.

People should declare the **wonders** or wonderful things Yahweh has done. Use the same word for wonder, or "wonderful thing that Yahweh has done," as you have used earlier in this song.

Yahweh is worthy of **praise**, or deserves for everyone to praise him. When you praise Yahweh, you speak out loud good things about Yahweh and to Yahweh because you recognize that Yahweh is good and awesome and that Yahweh deserves great honor. For more information on praise, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for praise as you used in previous passages.

People should **fear Yahweh** more than they fear any god. To fear Yahweh means to have reverence, honor, and respect for Yahweh. People show this fear by obeying Yahweh because of the respect they have for Yahweh, not because they are afraid of cruelty from Yahweh. For more information on fearing Yahweh, refer to "fear of God" in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for "fear of Yahweh" as you used in previous passages.

The other gods are false **gods**. For more information on gods, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for gods as you used in previous passages.

These gods are just **idols**. An idol is an object that people make in order to worship a god.

In the original language, the word for idols means worthless or nothing. For more information on idols, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for idol as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh made the heavens. The word heaven sometimes means the visible sky: the place where birds fly, where we can see clouds, and where we can see stars at night. Heaven also refers to the place where God lives. Sometimes it is not clear if, in a certain passage, the word "heaven" means the visible sky or the place where God lives. Sometimes, both meanings can be true at the same time. Since Yahweh created everything, Yahweh certainly made both the skies and the place where Yahweh lives!

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **heavens**. Look up heavens in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Splendor and majesty are in Yahweh's presence, and strength and joy are in his place or dwelling. These are words that describe a powerful and good king. Anyone who is near Yahweh or his presence can see how great, majestic, and strong Yahweh is, and they feel joy because of that.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about the good things people can see and feel about Yahweh. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 16:23–33

Yahweh's place or dwelling can mean either heaven, where God lives, or the place on earth where God lives among his people. Although God does not need to live in a house, God told the Israelites that he would live among them and meet with them in the special portable place the Israelites prepared for him. At the time when the singer sang this song, this was the tent that David set up for the ark of God.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for Yahweh's **place** or **dwelling**. Look up "house of God" and "heaven" in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

People should ascribe glory and strength to Yahweh. To ascribe means to give or say that something belongs to someone. To ascribe glory to Yahweh means to see or understand the glory that Yahweh already has and declare how beautiful, powerful, and majestic Yahweh is.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **ascribe** or **give**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

People should bring an **offering** to Yahweh. An offering is a gift or sacrifice that people offer in a ritual to God. An offering can be an object, like an animal, or it can be the way that people worship and praise Yahweh. For more information on offering, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for offering as you used in previous passages.

The people should bow down or worship Yahweh. When people worship Yahweh, they give honor to Yahweh. People in the Bible often showed their worship to God by bowing down to him. In this time, people worshiped God together at special places of worship, like the tent David set up for the ark of God. People worshiped God through their songs, prayers, and sacrifices.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **worship** or **bow down**. Look up worship in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The people worship because Yahweh is very **holy**. This means Yahweh is completely good, completely pure, powerful, and majestic. It means that Yahweh is whole, complete, and unchangeable. But most of all, it means Yahweh is God! For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh comes to **judge** the earth. When a person judges, they decide if what another person does is right or wrong, and therefore if the other person is guilty or innocent of breaking a law. A judge will punish the person if the judge decides that the person is guilty of doing wrong. For more information on judge, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for judge as you used in the previous passage.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 16:23–33

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (852 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (6.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 16:34–36

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 16:34–36 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:34–36 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:34–36 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Remember that in the last passage, the singer sang that everything and everyone in the world should rejoice and worship Yahweh. So now, in this final part of the song, the singer urges the Israelites to give thanks to Yahweh because of the way Yahweh loves. The singer then ends this song of praise with a prayer for God to save his people so that God's people can praise and thank God.

The singer sings that people should thank Yahweh because Yahweh is good and faithfully loves forever. Yahweh shows this love as he keeps his special promise to the Israelites to be their God always and to protect and take care of them.

The singer then teaches the Israelites how to pray to Yahweh when they need help. The singer reminds the people that God saves them, so the Israelites can ask God to save them. The Israelites can pray this when the Israelites are lost, in danger, or when other people have captured the Israelites and taken them to other lands. The Israelites should trust and ask Yahweh to gather and save them from other nations. Then the Israelites can thank Yahweh's holy name, or Yahweh who is holy. The Israelites will "glory" or will be proud to sing praises to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Pretend someone who has never prayed before asks you how to pray. How would you teach that person to pray? Think of some things that you often say to God, or certain ways that you often pray to God. Why do you often say these same things? Who taught you to pray in this way? Pause this audio here.

But the Israelites do not need to wait until the next time Yahweh saves them to praise Yahweh! The singer urges the Israelites to praise Yahweh now! Some translations say to bless Yahweh, which means a similar thing. When people praise or bless Yahweh, they worship Yahweh and thank Yahweh for his goodness and his blessings. Yahweh is the Israelites' God, and Yahweh deserves for the Israelites to praise him from everlasting to everlasting, or forever! The singer is reminding the Israelites how the Israelites should respond to Yahweh and what Yahweh does. The Israelites should praise and thank Yahweh!

When the singer finishes singing, the Israelites respond to the song. The Israelites say "Yes, we agree!" and then they praise Yahweh as they should.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:34–36 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The singer urges the Israelites to thank Yahweh because of the way Yahweh loves.

In the second scene: The singer teaches the people how to pray to Yahweh and reminds them to praise Yahweh, both now and when Yahweh saves them.

In the third scene: The Israelites respond to the song and praise Yahweh.

The characters in this passage are:

- The singer, who may be a Levite like Asaph, along with a group of Levites
- Yahweh
- And the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This part of the song is also in Psalm 106. In the last section, the singer urged everything and everyone to celebrate how Yahweh rules now and look forward to how Yahweh will continue to rule in the future. Because of this, the singer sings in the first section that people should thank Yahweh, because when Yahweh rules, he continues to love in the faithful way he has already shown to the people. The way the singer urges the people to thank Yahweh because of his love is a common reminder that people often use in the Old Testament. The singer is reminding the Israelites how Yahweh described himself to Moses and the Israelite people.

Remember that as the singer praises Yahweh, the singer is showing the Israelites how they can worship God and announce to all people that God rules over everything and everyone. Now, the singer shows the people how to pray to God for help. In the second section of this part of the song, the singer tells the people to cry out to Yahweh or to pray these words to Yahweh. The Israelites should pray that God will save, gather, and deliver them. In response, the Israelites should promise and remind themselves to thank, praise, and rejoice in Yahweh. This is the end of the prayer that the singer teaches to the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Pretend you are teaching the other people in a group how to speak respectfully to an important leader. In the middle of your teaching, tell your listeners something specific that they should say. Pay attention to the way that you show that you have finished telling them what to say and are now going to talk about something else they should do. Discuss how you want to translate the way the singer teaches the prayer in order to show where the prayer ends. Pause this audio here.

Then the singer finishes his song by urging the Israelites one more time to praise Yahweh. Since Yahweh has done great things for the Israelites, the Israelites should praise Yahweh right now! The Israelites should praise Yahweh from everlasting to everlasting, which means they should never give up praising Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how would you tell someone that they should continue to do something forever, such as continue to eat meals or sleep? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller describes what the Israelites do after they hear this song. The Israelites say "Amen," which is a word people say to strongly approve and agree with something they have just heard. Because the Israelites agree, they do what the singer instructed them to do and praise Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what do people say when they strongly agree with something? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:34–36 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The singer, who may be a Levite like Asaph, along with a group of Levites
- Yahweh
- And the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The Levites sing,

"Give thanks to Yahweh, for he is good. He faithfully loves us forever.

Say to Yahweh, 'O God our Savior, save us!

Gather us together and rescue us from other nations

so that we may thank you who are holy

and we will be proud to sing your praises.'

Praise Yahweh, the God of Israel

Praise him forever and ever."

Then all the people said loudly, "May it be so." And the people praised Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want my people to pray to me for help because I want to help my people. I am powerful and stronger than any problem my people face; or
- I love the Israelites, even when they are not faithful to me. I punish and correct the Israelites because I love them, just like a father does. I also love to give the Israelites good things and a good relationship with me.

Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel honored when I remember that Yahweh will never stop loving us, even though we do not always love Yahweh well. I want to thank Yahweh for how faithful he is; or
- It is hard to praise Yahweh when I am in trouble. All I can think about are the dangerous or bad things around me. I want to pray like the singer has taught us, since I do want Yahweh to help and save me when I am trouble; or
- Everything the singer has sung is very good and right! We should praise Yahweh, and we will start right now; or
- People are singing beautifully and making beautiful music on their instruments. I love to gather with people to celebrate Yahweh!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:34–36 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The Israelites should give thanks to **Yahweh**. The name Yahweh was a very personal name for God that showed the close relationship that God had with the people of Israel. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh shows **steadfast love** forever. This is the loyal love of God. Some translations call this unfailing or faithful love.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the way Yahweh **loves**. Look up steadfast love in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The people should pray to **God**, their savior. This word for God is a general word for God. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages.

God is the Israelites' "Savior" or salvation. A savior is someone who rescues people from a difficult or dangerous situation. Some translations say God is the Israelites' salvation, which is the way that someone rescues someone else.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Savior**. Look up savior and salvation in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites should pray that Yahweh would save them from the other **nations**. A nation is a group of people who belong together, live in the same country, and have the same ruler. For more information on nations, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for nations as you used in previous passages.

When God saves them, the Israelites should give thanks to Yahweh, who is **holy**. This means Yahweh is completely good, completely pure, powerful, and majestic. It means that Yahweh is whole, complete, and unchangeable. But most of all, it means Yahweh is God! For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages.

The Israelites will also boast or **glory** in singing praise to God. This means to proudly sing praise to Yahweh. For more information, refer to glory in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for boast or glory as you have used in previous passages.

The singer urges anyone who listens to his song to **bless** or **praise** Yahweh. To bless Yahweh means to worship Yahweh and thank him for his goodness and his blessings. Many translations say to praise Yahweh, since it means a similar thing. When you praise Yahweh, you speak out loud good things about Yahweh and to Yahweh, because

you recognize that Yahweh is good and awesome and that Yahweh deserves great honor. For more information on praise or bless, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for praise or bless as you used in previous passages.

When the singer finishes his song, the Israelites say, “Amen!” Amen can mean something like, “I accept this,” “May it be true,” “Indeed,” or “Truly.” Here, the Israelites are agreeing to what the singer has sung and agreeing to praise Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **amen**. Look up amen in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 16:34–36

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (864 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 16:37–43

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 16:37–43 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:37–43 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:37–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, the Israelites praised Yahweh as they celebrated that the ark of God was now in Jerusalem. This passage is about the men David chose to serve Yahweh at the places of worship. The Israelites now have two places of worship, one in Gibeon and one in Jerusalem.

Before the song in the last passage, David chose men to serve Yahweh. To begin this passage, the storyteller reminds us that David chose men to serve Yahweh at the place of worship in Jerusalem. David chooses Asaph and some other Levites to serve at the tent with the ark of the covenant of Yahweh, which is another name for the ark of God. The ark of God reminded the Israelites of Yahweh's covenant or special promise that the Israelites would be Yahweh's people. Asaph and the other Levites would regularly serve at the tent with the ark, doing what needed to be done each day. This probably means that Asaph and the Levites would sing the songs that were appropriate for each day and for various festivals. These men may also take care of the tent and help with any sacrifices or offerings.

Stop here and look at a picture of the ark of Yahweh's covenant as a group as needed. Pause this audio here.

David also instructs Obed-Edom and 68 relatives or other Levites to serve along with Asaph. Obed-Edom is the son of Jeduthun, and Obed-Edom and Hosah work together as gatekeepers, the men who guard the gate or entrance to the tent area. Men would guard the entrance to keep any unclean or improper people or animals away from the special area. Yahweh commanded the Israelites to keep any unclean people or animals from entering Yahweh's places of worship to show that these places were holy or different from normal areas.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are some holy or special places in your area? How do people show that these are holy or special places? Who can enter these places? What do people have to do to enter these places? Pause this audio here.

David tells Zadok the priest and the other priests to serve at the tabernacle. The tabernacle is a special tent where the Israelites would worship God. The ark of God used to be in the tabernacle. The ark was then in a town called Kiriath Jearim for a while before David and the Levites brought the ark to the new tent in Jerusalem. The tabernacle is at the high place, or place of worship, in Gibeon, which is about 10 kilometers northwest of Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a picture of the tabernacle tent as a group. Look at a map of Israel and find the cities of Gibeon and Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

The priests present the burnt offerings at the tabernacle. People would give burnt offerings to Yahweh to show how dedicated those people were to Yahweh. For a burnt offering, the priests would cut up an entire animal and burn it on a special altar, which is the altar for burnt offerings. The priests did this every morning and evening, according to the Law of Yahweh, which Yahweh had commanded the Israelites to do.

Stop here and look at a picture of the altar of burnt offerings as a group. Pause this audio here.

Heman and Jeduthan also serve at the tabernacle with Zadok and the priests. Heman and Jeduthan, along with the other men David has chosen, give thanks to Yahweh because Yahweh faithfully loves forever. Heman and Jeduthan are responsible for, or are in charge of, the trumpets and cymbals. Cymbals are a musical instrument with two metal discs that people strike together in order to make a shrill, clashing sound. Trumpets are long,

straight instruments that people make from hammered metal, either silver or bronze. People blow air into trumpets to make a small range of notes.

Stop here and look at a picture of cymbals and a trumpet as a group. What kind of similar instruments do you have in your culture? Pause this audio here.

Heman and Jeduthun are also in charge of the other men who play the other musical instruments for the sacred songs or the songs of praise to God. Jeduthun's sons guard the gate or the entrance to the tabernacle. In this time, people sometimes say the word "sons" to mean relatives. So here, the sons of Jeduthun can mean both Jeduthun's actual sons as well as some members of Jeduthun's clan. This Jeduthan and his sons and relatives are probably different than Obed-Edom's father, Jeduthan.

Then all the people who had gathered to celebrate that the ark of God was in Jerusalem return to their homes. David also returns home to bless his household, which is everyone who lives in his house. Someone's household includes any wives, children, unmarried daughters, and any married sons and their wives and children. A person's household might also include other relatives and servants who live with them as well. In Old Testament times, a blessing was often a kind of greeting, so here, David may be going to his home to greet members of his family who live in his house.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, which family members live together in the same house or close area? Who leads the family? When that family leader returns home from a trip or special event, how does the leader greet or bless the other members of the family?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:37–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: David chooses people to serve Yahweh at the tent in Jerusalem.

In the second scene: David chooses people to serve Yahweh at the tabernacle in Gibeon.

In the third scene: The people and David return to their homes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Asaph
- The Levites who will work with Asaph
- Yahweh
- Obed-Edom, son of Jeduthun
- The 68 Levites who will work with Obed-Edom
- Hosah
- Zadok, the priest
- The priests who will work with Zadok
- Heman
- Jeduthun
- The men whom David chose to give thanks to Yahweh
- The musicians at the tabernacle
- The sons of Jeduthun
- The Israelites
- And David's house, or the people who live in his house

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This was an unusual time for the Israelites. Normally, the Israelites worshiped Yahweh at one place, but at this time, there were two locations, one in Gibeon and one in Jerusalem. This passage explains which Levites serve at each location. In the original language, the storyteller does not say who chose each of these men, but we know that in previous passages, David chose certain Levites to serve Yahweh in various ways. So in this passage, David assigns these men to serve at these places.

At the beginning of this passage, David and all of the men in this chapter gather together in Jerusalem to celebrate. The storyteller says that David left certain men to serve at either the tent in Jerusalem or at the tabernacle. When David leaves men to serve at the tabernacle, the storyteller probably does not mean that David and some of the men traveled from Jerusalem to Gibeon, and then David left Gibeon while the men stayed. Although David does leave the tent in Jerusalem at the end of the story, the storyteller probably means that David chooses or assigns these men. David chooses men to serve, sing, and guard at both places.

Stop here and discuss how you want to translate the way that David leaves or chooses men to serve at both of these places. Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, David leaves or chooses Asaph and his brothers to serve before or at the ark, which means at the tent where the ark is located. In this time, people would sometimes use the word “brothers” to mean “relatives.” So these men who serve with Asaph are not all children of Asaph’s parents, but rather relatives or other Levites. Asaph and these men will serve there continually, which is another way to say regularly. David chose Asaph and his relatives to sing and serve during the celebration, and these people will continue to work at the tent and do everything that needs to be done each day.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what are some words you would use for relatives who are men? Discuss how you want to translate Asaph’s brothers or relatives. Pause this audio here.

David also leaves or chooses Obed-Edom, Hosah, and Obed-Edom’s 68 relatives, who are other Levites, to serve at the ark. Since the storyteller mentions their names, Obed-Edom and Hosah were most likely the leaders of this group of Levites. The storyteller explains that Obed-Edom is the son of Jeduthun and that Obed-Edom guards the entrance to the tent with Hosah. The storyteller decides to mention Obed-Edom’s father for the first time here rather than several passages ago when we first heard about Obed-Edom. If needed, you can move the name of Obed-Edom’s father to the first time the storyteller talks about Obed-Edom. These men would probably stand at the entrance to let people enter or to stop people from entering the tent. Jeduthun, the father of Obed-Edom, is probably different from the chief musician Jeduthun who serves at the tabernacle.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what do you call men who protect the entrance to a place? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller explains who serves at the tabernacle tent in Gibeon. When the priest Zadok and the other priests leave Jerusalem, they will return to the tabernacle to continue to serve there. The tabernacle is at a high place. In this time, people often worshiped gods at high places, which were places of worship, sometimes on top of a hill. The storyteller is clear that this is Yahweh’s tabernacle, not a place of worship to another god.

Zadok and the other priests will present burnt offerings to Yahweh every morning and evening. These men will do everything exactly as Yahweh commanded the priests to act when Yahweh gave his Law to the Israelites. Heman, Jeduthan, and the other singers will also serve at the tabernacle. Remember that earlier, the Levites had chosen some people to sing and make music to Yahweh, including Heman and Asaph. Whoever does not stay in Jerusalem with Asaph goes to the tabernacle in Gibeon with Heman.

These people will give thanks to Yahweh because Yahweh faithfully loves forever. Remember that in the last passage, the singer sang, “Give thanks to Yahweh because Yahweh faithfully loves forever.” People would often sing that line, so the storyteller may be quoting from one of the songs that the Levites would sing at the tabernacle.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how would you show that you are quoting from a common song that people would know? Pause this audio here.

Heman and Jeduthan will play the cymbals and trumpets, perhaps while they sing or while other people sing. Heman and Jeduthan are also in charge of the other people who would play instruments to make music for the sacred songs or songs of praise to God. Jeduthun's sons, who may be Jeduthun's actual sons or his relatives, guard the entrance to the tabernacle.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what do you call songs that people sing to praise God? Pause this audio here.

In the last scene, the people all go home. People had gathered from all over Israel, including Jerusalem, for this celebration. David also returns to his home, which was in Jerusalem. When he arrives home, David blesses his family, who may have gathered together to greet David.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:37–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Asaph
- The Levites who will work with Asaph
- Yahweh
- Obed-Edom, son of Jeduthun
- The 68 Levites who will work with Obed-Edom
- Hosah
- Zadok
- The priests who will work with Zadok
- Heman
- Jeduthun
- The men whom David chose to give thanks to Yahweh
- The musicians at the tabernacle
- The sons of Jeduthun
- The Israelites
- And David's house, or the people who live in his house

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Afterward, David left Asaph and Asaph's fellow Levites to serve at the ark of Yahweh's covenant. These men were to serve there regularly and do everything that needed to be done each day. David also assigned Obed-Edom and 68 other Levites to serve with Asaph and his fellow Levites. Hosah and Obed-Edom, son of Jeduthun, were

in charge of guarding the gates. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the men who would serve at the ark of Yahweh's covenant, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Our tribe, the Levites, has an important responsibility to serve Yahweh. I am honored that David chose me to serve at this new place where we honor Yahweh! or
- Since Jerusalem is an important city, many people come here, both Israelites and people from other nations. Since our tent is in Jerusalem, I hope everyone will see the way we praise Yahweh and want to know more about Yahweh; or
- Since the ark of God is now near where David lives and rules, I hope that David will see the tent and remember to ask God about how David should rule.

Continue the drama. David also had Zadok the priest and the other priests serve at the tabernacle of Yahweh. The tabernacle was at the place of worship in Gibeon. The priests were to regularly offer burnt offerings to Yahweh on the altar for burnt offerings. The priests were to burn these sacrifices every morning and every evening. The priests were to follow everything that Yahweh said in his Law. Yahweh had commanded the people of Israel to follow this Law. With Zadok and the other priests were Heman, Jeduthun, and other Levites whom David had chosen by name to give thanks to Yahweh, because Yahweh's steadfast love endures forever. Heman and Jeduthun were in charge of the music. These men were responsible for the music of the trumpets and cymbals. These men were also in charge of the people who played the other musical instruments for the songs of praise to God. The relatives of Jeduthun watched the entrance to the gate. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the men who would serve at the tabernacle, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- When I sacrifice the burnt offerings, I remember the things Yahweh has told us. I want the Israelites to remember, too, when they see these burnt offerings; or
- I want to show the way I respect Yahweh as I serve Yahweh carefully in the exact way he has told us to; or
- I am excited to sing beautiful songs about Yahweh, who loves us so faithfully. I want the Israelites to hear us sing and to want to praise Yahweh, too!

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I have told the Israelites the best way to live, which will cause them to live in peace with each other and have a good relationship with me; or
- I care about the Israelites and want them to come to these places of worship to speak to me and ask me for help. I want to hear about the good things in the Israelites' lives as they celebrate and worship at these places; or
- I will continue to faithfully love the Israelites, even when they mess up. I will not break my promises to the Israelites, and I will remind them of this.

Continue the drama. After that, all the people of Israel left and returned to their homes. And David returned home to bless his household. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am amazed at all the things I heard about Yahweh at this celebration! I am going to talk about this to everyone for a long time! or
- I saw how carefully David and the Levites chose people to serve Yahweh in order to honor Yahweh. I should follow their example and do what Yahweh says so I can honor Yahweh too; or
- I look forward to when I can return again to these places of worship at festivals and sing to Yahweh with the other Israelites.

Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am thankful that this celebration went well and that the Levites are ready to serve Yahweh. I am thankful that Yahweh chose this tribe to lead, teach, and remind us how to worship and praise Yahweh; or
- I am glad that we all celebrated Yahweh together. I know that Yahweh is pleased when we honor him in this way, and I want to honor Yahweh, because he has taken care of us; or
- I want to see my family and tell them about the good things Yahweh has done, both during this celebration and during Israel's history. I will ask Yahweh to bless my family, because I love my family.

1 Chronicles 16:37–43

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 16:37–43 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

David chooses men to serve at the **ark** of **Yahweh's covenant**. This is another name for the ark of God, which is the rectangular chest that Yahweh asked Moses to make out of acacia wood. Yahweh was a very personal name for God that showed the close relationship that God had with the people of Israel. A covenant is a solemn promise. Yahweh made a covenant with the Israelites that they would be his people. The ark of God reminds the Israelites of this promise, so sometimes people called it the "ark of Yahweh's covenant." For more information on covenant, ark of the covenant, and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for covenant, ark of the covenant, and Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

David chose different **men to guard the gates** or to be **gatekeepers** at each tent. Gatekeepers guarded the entrance to keep out any people or animals who should not be in the holy area. Use the same word or phrase for gatekeeper or men who guard the gates as you used in previous passages.

Zadok was a **priest** who served at the tabernacle with other priests. Priests were responsible to offer sacrifices to God on behalf of the people. These men took care of the tabernacle and taught the people how to worship God. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for priest as you used in previous passages.

The **tabernacle** was a tent where the Israelites worshiped Yahweh. Another name for the tabernacle is "tent of meeting," because this tent was the place where the Israelites could meet Yahweh. This is a different tent than the tent David set up in Jerusalem for the ark of God. For more information on tabernacle, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for tabernacle as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of the tabernacle again as a group as needed. Pause this audio here.

The tabernacle was at a high place. A high place was a general term for a place of worship, sacrifice, and prayer. People would often make these high places on a hill or elevated area. This high place was an official or good place for worshiping Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **high place**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The priests will offer **burnt offerings** to Yahweh. A burnt offering is a sacrifice or gift that people bring to God. For a burnt offering, the priest kills an animal and burns this animal completely on an altar. For more information on burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for burnt offering as you used in previous passages.

The priests offer the burnt offerings on the **altar of burnt offerings**. An altar is a place where people make offerings or sacrifices to God. Refer to altar in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same word or phrase for "altar of burnt offering" as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of the altar of burnt offerings again as a group, as needed. Pause this audio here.

The priests will do everything in the Law of Yahweh. A law is a rule, or a set of rules that people have to keep. When in the Bible people talk about the Law, they mean the set of instructions that Yahweh has given the people of Israel. Yahweh gave the people his laws through a man named Moses, who wrote down the Law. Yahweh told the people through Moses that if people would keep Yahweh's Law, Yahweh would bless the people. But if people would break Yahweh's law, Yahweh would punish the people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Yahweh's Law**. Look up law in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

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The storyteller says the Levites will thank Yahweh because Yahweh shows **steadfast love** forever. This is the loyal love of God. Some translations call this “unfailing” or “faithful love.” For more information on steadfast love, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for steadfast love as you used in previous passages.

Heman and Jeduthun are in charge of the **trumpets**. Trumpets were long, straight instruments that people made from metal like silver or bronze. People would blow air into a trumpet to make a limited range of notes. People used trumpets in times of war, but also to produce music in times of celebration. Use the same word or phrase for trumpet as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a trumpet again as a group, as needed. Pause this audio here.

Heman and Jeduthun are also in charge of the **cymbals**. Cymbals were two metal discs that people would strike together in order to make a shrill, clashing sound. Use the same word or phrase for cymbals as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of cymbals again as a group, as needed. Pause this audio here.

Heman and Jeduthun used these instruments when they sang sacred songs or songs to praise God. This is the more general word for God.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **songs to praise God**. Look up hymn and God in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David returns home to **bless** his house. When someone blesses another person, they pray that Yahweh will do good things for this other person. In this time, a blessing was often a kind of greeting, so here, this may mean that David went to his home to greet members of David’s family. For more information on bless, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for bless as you used in previous passages.

In the Bible, a **house**, or a household means all the people who live together in one house. The household included a father, his wife, children, unmarried daughters, and any married sons and their wives and children. Other relatives might live with these family members as well. If the family had servants or slaves, then those people were included in the household as well. For more information on house, refer to “household” in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for house or household as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 16:37–43

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (852 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 17:1–15

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 17:1–15 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 17:1–15 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 17:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This story happened sometime after David and the Levites had carried the ark of Yahweh to Jerusalem. This story is about how David wants to build a permanent building or “house” for the ark of Yahweh, and then Yahweh’s response to David through Nathan, the prophet.

Nathan already knows that David lives in a cedar palace and Yahweh’s ark is only in a tent. David tells Nathan about this because David does not like the situation and wants to make a change. David wants to hear a response from Nathan since Nathan is a prophet for Yahweh.

David says to Nathan the prophet that David lives in a house that people made from cedar wood, while the ark of the covenant of Yahweh is in a tent. You will remember that people often used cedar wood to build buildings.

Stop here and look at an image of cedar wood. Pause this audio here.

The ark of the covenant of Yahweh refers to the rectangular chest that Yahweh asked Moses to make of acacia wood. The Israelites believe that Yahweh literally lives in the space directly above the ark, so the ark represents Yahweh’s presence. Remember that Yahweh had instructed Moses to build the ark. Also, remember that Yahweh’s presence went with the Israelites in the wilderness and that Yahweh brought the Israelites into the Promised Land.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of shelter do you need to have for special items that represent God or your cultural gods? Pause this audio here.

Nathan replies to David and tells David to do whatever David plans to do because God is with David. The story does not say this, but Nathan likely goes back to Nathan’s home after he speaks to David. But later that same night, Yahweh tells Nathan the following message for Nathan to say to David.

1 Chronicles 17:1–15

David is not the one to build Yahweh a house to live in. Since the time Yahweh saved the Israelites from slavery in Egypt until now, Yahweh has not lived in a house. Instead, Yahweh has moved from one tent site to another. Yahweh had told the Israelites' leaders to care for Yahweh's people like shepherds. Shepherds move from place to place while they take care of sheep. Yahweh has also moved with all the Israelites.

Yahweh also reminds David that Yahweh never asked the Israelite leaders why they did not build Yahweh a cedar house. Yahweh Almighty is the one who took David from looking after sheep in the fields and appointed David as the ruler over Yahweh's people, the Israelites.

Yahweh has been with David wherever David has gone. Yahweh has defeated or destroyed all of David's enemies right in front of David.

Then Yahweh either says that Yahweh has or that Yahweh will make David famous like other people who are famous throughout the world. Yahweh either says that Yahweh has or that Yahweh will provide a place for Yahweh's people, the Israelites, to live. This is so that the Israelites will have a home of their own and no longer feel afraid of their enemies. Bad or evil people will not hurt the Israelites anymore. Since Yahweh chose leaders for Yahweh's people, the Israelites, Yahweh has started to defeat all of Israel's enemies.

Although Yahweh will not let David build Yahweh a house, Yahweh firmly says that Yahweh will build a house for David. This means that Yahweh will give descendants to David who will continue to lead Yahweh's people for a long time.

One day, when David dies, Yahweh will make one of David's sons replace David to lead Yahweh's people as the king. Yahweh will make David's son's rule secure. Later, Yahweh says that David's son's kingdom is Yahweh's own kingdom.

David's son will be the one who will build a house for Yahweh, and Yahweh will establish David's son's reign forever. This means that David's son will be the one who will build the temple for Yahweh, and Yahweh will make David's son's descendants kings forever.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of person can build a building for God, a local god, or the spirits? What do people say about this person? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will be David's son's father, and David's son will be Yahweh's son. Yahweh is promising to establish and make stable the line of kings through David's descendants. In those days, Yahweh's promise to David's son was the kind of promise a powerful king would make to a smaller king who followed the powerful king's rules. The more powerful king makes the rules, and the smaller king agrees to loyally listen and obey. The more powerful king takes care of the smaller king like a father takes care of his child.

Yahweh will never take Yahweh's steadfast love away from David's descendants. Yahweh had taken Yahweh's steadfast love away from King Saul, who was king of the Israelites before David became king. Yahweh will make sure that David's descendants will rule over Yahweh's house and Yahweh's kingdom forever. Yahweh will make David's offspring rule forever.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Yahweh's words about making David's descendants rule Yahweh's kingdom forever are extremely important for the Israelites. In your language, how can you show that this is important? Pause this audio here.

Shortly after Yahweh tells Nathan this message, Nathan tells all of Yahweh's message to David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does someone in your culture give a message to someone in authority?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 17:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

1 Chronicles 17:1–15

In the first scene: In Jerusalem, David tells Nathan, the prophet, that David lives in a cedar palace, but Yahweh lives in a tent. Nathan tells David to do what David wants to do.

In the second scene: At night, Yahweh tells Nathan to give a message to David. Sometime shortly after Yahweh tells Nathan the message, Nathan goes back to David to tell Yahweh's message to David.

The characters in this passage are:

- King David
- Nathan, the prophet
- Yahweh
- And David's son

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This story happens sometime after David and the other Israelites moved Yahweh's ark to Jerusalem.

In scene one, David has already been living comfortably in his house in Jerusalem for a while. Here, "house" refers to David's palace, where David lives as the king. Sometime later, David tells Nathan, the prophet, that David is living in a house that people made from cedar wood, while the ark of the covenant of Yahweh is under a tent. When people make a covenant, they make a strong promise to each other that they cannot break. People who make covenants with each other want to have a good relationship with each other and, so, sometimes call each other "brother," "father," or "son." A covenant is supposed to last forever.

You will remember that Nathan already knows that David lives in a cedar palace and Yahweh's ark is only in a tent. David tells Nathan about this because David does not like the situation and wants to make a change. David wants to hear a response from Nathan since Nathan is a prophet for Yahweh.

Nathan replies and tells David to do whatever David wants to do because God is with David. By saying, "God is with you," Nathan means that Nathan believes that Yahweh will support David's plan.

In scene two, the storyteller uses special language to show that what happens next is in contrast with what happened earlier: "That night, God's word came to Nathan." We know that God speaks to Nathan through a vision because the storyteller tells us that this is a vision at the end of the passage. A vision is like a dream, but visions happen while people are still awake. When someone has a vision, that person sees or hears something from God that other people do not see or hear. In the vision, God tells Nathan to go back to David and to tell a message to "my servant, David." Usually, a servant is a person who works closely for another person, the master. Servants have a low status in the community and must obey the master. Here, Yahweh calls David "Yahweh's servant" to show a close relationship. David, even though he is the king of Israel, still follows his more powerful King, Yahweh himself.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: Yahweh refers to David as "my servant" here. How will you talk about David as Yahweh's servant, even though David is still the king of Israel? Pause this audio here.

Stop and discuss as a group: Yahweh continues to tell Nathan the message that Nathan will tell to David later. However, Yahweh speaks as though Yahweh is speaking directly to David. How will you make it clear that Yahweh's message to Nathan is different from Yahweh's message to David? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that David is not the person who will build a house for Yahweh to live in because Yahweh has not lived in a house. From the time that Yahweh saved the Israelites from slavery in Egypt until now, Yahweh has moved from one place to another in a tent.

Yahweh asks David if Yahweh ever told any of Israel's leaders—whom Yahweh chose to care for Yahweh's people like shepherds—to build Yahweh a house made of cedar wood while Yahweh was with the Israelites wherever they went. A shepherd is a person who takes care of sheep and goats. A shepherd protects his sheep, and a shepherd is in charge of his sheep. Because shepherds were so common in Israel, storytellers in the Bible often use the word shepherd as special language for a protector or a ruler.

Yahweh asks David the previous question, but Yahweh does not expect David to answer. Yahweh's question is a way to say that Yahweh never expected or wanted the Israelites to build a house for Yahweh. In other words, Yahweh also does not expect or want David to build a house for Yahweh.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: Yahweh did not expect David to answer this question. Instead, Yahweh uses this kind of question to show that Yahweh does not expect or want David to build a house for Yahweh. Take turns in your group practicing how you can say what Yahweh says to David. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh then speaks to Nathan directly again. Yahweh tells Nathan to tell something to Yahweh's servant, David. Then Yahweh speaks again as though Yahweh is talking directly to David. Yahweh calls himself "Yahweh of hosts." Yahweh says that Yahweh is the one who took David from the pasture, from looking after sheep, and appointed David to be ruler over Yahweh's people, Israel. Here, Yahweh calls David "ruler" and not "king." This word for ruler means a person whom Yahweh has chosen to rule over people. Yahweh is saying that Yahweh chose David to rule. We do not know the exact meaning of "hosts," but "Yahweh of hosts" is a title that describes Yahweh as an all-powerful ruler. Yahweh is the true king of Israel.

Stop and discuss as a group: Yahweh tells Nathan what to tell David later. Then Yahweh again speaks as though Yahweh is speaking directly to David. Discuss how you will say this in your language. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that Yahweh has been with David wherever David has gone, and Yahweh has defeated or destroyed all David's enemies right in front of David.

We are not sure if Yahweh says that Yahweh has already made David famous or if Yahweh is saying that Yahweh will make David famous. In either case, David is or will be famous just like those people whom people all around the world know about. Yahweh either says that Yahweh has or that Yahweh will provide a place for Yahweh's people, the Israelites, to live. This is so that the Israelites will have a home of their own and no longer feel afraid of their enemies. Bad or evil people will no longer hurt the Israelites. Since Yahweh chose leaders for Yahweh's people, the Israelites, Yahweh has started to defeat all of Israel's enemies.

Yahweh also tells David that Yahweh will build a house for David. This means that Yahweh will give descendants to David who will lead Yahweh's people.

When David's life comes to its end, and David dies, Yahweh will appoint David's offspring, or one of David's own sons, to succeed David. Yahweh will establish David's son's kingdom.

David's son, or offspring, will be the one who will build a house for Yahweh, and Yahweh will establish David's son's throne forever. This means that David's son will be the one who will build the temple for Yahweh, and Yahweh will make David's son's dynasty permanent. Here, the royal throne, or the king's special chair, symbolizes David's son's reign.

Stop and discuss: How will you describe David's offspring's reign here? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will be David's son's father, and David's son will be Yahweh's son. Yahweh will never take Yahweh's steadfast love or loyal love away from David's son, as Yahweh took that love away from David's predecessor, King Saul.

Yahweh will make David's son rule over Yahweh's house and Yahweh's kingdom forever. Yahweh will establish David's son's throne, which means that David's descendants will rule forever. In this context, Yahweh's house probably refers to the future temple, and Yahweh's kingdom probably refers to the Israelite nation. In other words, Yahweh will make David's son ruler over Yahweh's people forever. The storyteller talks about David's son as if he were one person. So, in one sense, the storyteller is only talking about Solomon. But Yahweh will make sure that one of Solomon's descendants will always rule over the nation of Israel.

So, Nathan goes to tell David everything Yahweh said in the message during Nathan's vision.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 17:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King David
- Nathan, the prophet
- Yahweh
- And David's son

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

David says to Nathan the prophet that David lives in a house made from cedar wood, while the ark of the covenant of Yahweh is in a tent. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I have a beautiful and comfortable palace, but Yahweh only has a temporary tent. Yahweh is God and far more important than I am. I want to make a permanent, wonderful place for Yahweh's ark; or
- I want to build a house for Yahweh's ark, but I want advice from someone I trust who is close to Yahweh. I will ask Nathan the prophet to listen to my idea and give feedback.

Continue the drama. Nathan replies to David and tells David to do whatever David plans to do because God is with David. Then Nathan goes home. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Nathan, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- David tries to follow Yahweh and wants to do something good for Yahweh. I believe Yahweh will be very pleased with David's plan; or
- Yahweh deserves a wonderful place to live, so I think David has a good idea.

Continue the drama. That night, Yahweh gives Nathan a message to tell David that is different than what Nathan had said to David.

Yahweh says that David is not the one to build Yahweh a house to live in. Since the time when Yahweh saved the Israelites from slavery in Egypt until now, Yahweh has not lived in a house. Instead, Yahweh has moved from one tent site to another. Yahweh had told the Israelites' leaders to care for Yahweh's people like shepherds. Shepherds move from place to place while they take care of sheep. Yahweh also moved with all the Israelites.

Yahweh also reminds David that Yahweh never asked the Israelite leaders why they did not build Yahweh a cedar house. Yahweh Almighty is the one who took David from looking after sheep in the fields and appointed David as the ruler over Yahweh's people, the Israelites.

Yahweh has been with David wherever David has gone. Yahweh has defeated or destroyed all of David's enemies right in front of David. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am like a shepherd for the Israelites. I move with the Israelites from place to place. I make sure the Israelites have what they need to live. I protect the Israelites; or
- I wanted the previous leaders of the Israelites to act as shepherds and take care of the Israelites just like I did; or
- David was an actual shepherd for sheep. I made David the leader of the Israelites. I want David to lead the Israelites just like shepherds lead sheep; or

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- I do not need a fancy cedar house. I could make a house for myself if I wanted one, but I do not need it. I am more powerful than that.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh either says that Yahweh has or that Yahweh will make David famous like people who are well known by others throughout the world. Yahweh either says that Yahweh has or that Yahweh will provide a place to live for Yahweh's people, the Israelites. This is so that the Israelites will have a home of their own and no longer feel afraid of their enemies. Bad or evil people will no longer hurt the Israelites. Since Yahweh chose leaders for Yahweh's people, the Israelites, Yahweh has started to defeat all of Israel's enemies.

Yahweh firmly says that Yahweh will build a house for David. This means that Yahweh will give descendants to David who will continue to lead Yahweh's people for a long time. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh has already taken me from the low job of shepherd to the important job as the king. I feel amazed that Yahweh will make my descendants lead Yahweh's people for a long time; or
- Yahweh is so good. I do not deserve any of these blessings. I feel humbled; or
- I also feel thankful to Yahweh.

Continue the drama. One day, when David dies, Yahweh will make David's son take over and lead Yahweh's people as the king. Yahweh will make David's son's sovereignty secure. Later, Yahweh says that David's son's kingdom is Yahweh's own kingdom.

David's son will be the one who will build a house for Yahweh, and Yahweh will establish David's son's reign forever. This means that David's son will be the one who will build the temple for Yahweh, and Yahweh will make David's son's dynasty permanent.

Yahweh will be David's son's father, and David's son will be Yahweh's son. Yahweh is promising the stability of the line of kings through David's descendants. In those days, this was like a promise between a powerful king and a smaller king who followed his rules. The more powerful king makes the rules, and the smaller king agrees to loyally listen and obey. The more powerful king takes care of the smaller king like a father takes care of his child. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David's son, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh has honored me so that I am the one to build a house for Yahweh; or
- I have a great responsibility to lead Yahweh's people; or
- Yahweh has greatly blessed me not only as a person, but also as Yahweh's son; or
- Yahweh loves me and Yahweh's people so much that he makes our household the same forever.

Continue the drama. Yahweh will never take Yahweh's steadfast love away from David's offspring, as Yahweh took it away from David's predecessor, King Saul. Yahweh will make sure that David's offspring will rule over Yahweh's house and Yahweh's kingdom forever. Yahweh will make David's offspring rule forever. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am the most powerful, true God. I am not like the false gods that other people groups follow. I do not need a fancy place to live, but I will honor David's desire by letting one of David's offspring build this house for me; or
- I will do something much better than letting David construct a building for me. I will make David's offspring rulers over my people forever.

Continue the drama. Shortly after Yahweh tells Nathan this message, Nathan goes back to David and tells Yahweh's message to David. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Nathan, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- David's desire to build a house for Yahweh is honorable, but not what Yahweh wants. I did not ask Yahweh what Yahweh wanted when I agreed with David. Now I must tell David what Yahweh says Yahweh wants; or
- Yahweh is more powerful and knows better than King David. Yahweh will do something even better for David than what David planned to do for Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 17:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

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Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

At the beginning of the story, David talks about living in a **house** that people made from cedar wood. Here, the house specifically refers to the palace where David lives as the king of Israel. Some translations use a special word for a king's house. Later, David says he wants to build a house for Yahweh, or a place for Yahweh to live.

Stop here and discuss what word or words you will use to describe David's house, and then the house that David wants to build for Yahweh. Use the same words for David's house, or palace, as you have used previously. Pause this audio here.

Cedar trees are a kind of tree that has thin, green leaves throughout the year. People call the leaves of cedar trees "needles," similar to the shape of a needle people use to sew clothes. Instead of flat and wide leaves like the leaves on most trees, cedar tree needles are long and thin, and they grow in bunches. This helps the tree leaves stay green all year, even in cold weather. Many people think cedar trees are beautiful because of the green color. Cedar trees have light brown-colored wood with a pretty pattern. The natural oil in cedar wood keeps insects away, prevents rot, and makes the wood smell very nice. People like to use cedar wood to build buildings or furniture since it often tends to last longer than many other kinds of wood.

Stop here and discuss what word or words you will use to describe **cedar trees** and **cedar wood**. Pause this audio here.

David tells Nathan, the **prophet**, that the **ark of the covenant** of **Yahweh** is in a tent. A prophet is someone who speaks God's message to other people. Use the same words or phrases you used previously for prophet, the ark of the covenant, and Yahweh. Look up prophet, the ark of the covenant, and Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information.

After Nathan tells David to do what David wants to do for Yahweh, Nathan leaves David's palace. That night, Yahweh says the "word of God" to Nathan. Here, the "word of God" means a message from God. We know from later in the story that Yahweh gives this message to Nathan through a vision. A vision is when someone who is awake sees or hears a message from God that other people do not see or hear.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **word**, **God**, and **vision**. Look up word, God, and vision in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

God tells Nathan to go back to David and to tell a message to "my **servant**, David." Usually, a servant is a person who works closely for another person, the master. Servants have a low status in the community and must obey the master. Here, Yahweh calls David Yahweh's servant to show a close relationship. David, even though he is the king of Israel, still follows the more powerful Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase you used previously for servant. Look up servant in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh calls himself "**Yahweh of hosts**," or "Yahweh Almighty." Yahweh is God's personal name. The Israelites said the ark belonged to Yahweh and also that they worshipped or prayed to Yahweh at the ark. The word "hosts" could refer to the armies of Israel or armies of spiritual beings in heaven or heavenly bodies, such as stars. This title emphasizes that Yahweh is the ruler who has all power. Yahweh is not only the ruler over a certain region, but of everything on earth and in heaven. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about Yahweh of hosts.

Stop here and refer to your translation of this title for Yahweh from 1 Chronicles 11:9. Translate this title for Yahweh in the same way that you translated it there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh talks about **Israel**, which means the Israelites. Yahweh tells David that Yahweh did not even ask the Israelite **judges** to build a house for Yahweh. Judges were the leaders that Yahweh chose to care for, guide, and protect the Israelites before the Israelites had kings. Yahweh describes how the Israelite leaders take care of the Israelites like **shepherds** take care of sheep. A shepherd takes care of, guides, and protects his sheep. Yahweh says that the people who lead the Israelites are like shepherds. Use the same words for Israelites, judges, and shepherds as you have used in previous passages. Refer to the Master Glossary for the full definitions of Israelite, judges, and shepherds.

Yahweh says that Yahweh appointed David as **ruler**. This kind of ruler is a ruler that God chose.

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Stop here and review what word or phrase you used for this type of ruler in 1 Chronicles 5:2 and 1 Chronicles 11:2. Use the same word or phrase for this type of ruler that you used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh talks about destroying David's **enemies** and making David's "name," meaning David, famous. Yahweh also says that Yahweh will stop **unrighteous** or evil people from hurting the Israelites. Righteousness refers to a good relationship between God and people. Yahweh views people as righteous when they have a good relationship with Yahweh. Remember that people can never be righteous on their own or by doing enough good things. Only Yahweh makes someone righteous. So, your term or phrase for righteousness should not focus on doing good works. Unrighteous people are the opposite of righteous people. Unrighteous people are not right with Yahweh and do not have a relationship with Yahweh. In this story, the "unrighteous" refers to the people, or enemies, who intentionally hurt the Israelites. Use the same words or phrases you used previously for enemies and unrighteous. Look up righteousness in the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for the **unrighteous** people Yahweh talks about here. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that he will build a "house" for David. Yahweh uses the word house to refer to David's household, which here includes David's descendants. Yahweh says that David's son's descendants will rule over Yahweh's people forever. Yahweh also says that Yahweh will be like a father to David's son.

Stop here and discuss as a group the best way to talk about Yahweh building a "**house**," a dynasty of kings, or a stable household for David. For more information about "house of David**,"** refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that, someday in the future, David will go to be with David's **ancestors**. An ancestor is anyone from your same family who lived before you, such as a great-grandparent. David's ancestors are dead. So, Yahweh talks about something that will happen after David dies. Yahweh says that Yahweh will give one of David's **seed**, or **descendants**, a throne forever. Sometimes Bible storytellers use the word for a plant's seed to talk about a person's children or descendants. Use the same word for seed or descendants that you have used previously, and refer to the Master Glossary for seed and for descendants as you decide which word to use here.

A **throne** is a ruler's special chair where the ruler makes official decisions for the people they rule over. So, thrones represent the way a person rules like a king. Yahweh will make David's descendants rule forever in a **kingdom** that Yahweh gives them.

Stop here and look at an image of a throne. Also, discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use to describe how David's descendants will rule Yahweh's people. See the Master Glossary for more information about kingdom. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also promises to always give Yahweh's **steadfast love** to David's descendants. Loving kindness describes a kind of love that shows kindness and mercy and never fails. Yahweh loves David's descendants so much that even if they become unfaithful in their relationship with Yahweh, Yahweh will keep Yahweh's promise to them. Yahweh's loving kindness is an important idea throughout the Old Testament. Yahweh always shows this love to Yahweh's people. Yahweh also expects this kind of love from his people. Translate steadfast love in the same way you have translated it before. Look up steadfast love in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (915 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 17:16–27

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 17:16–27 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 17:16–27 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 17:16–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The events in this story happen after Nathan, the prophet, has told King David that Yahweh will make people from David's family rulers over Israel forever.

King David goes into the tent where the ark of Yahweh is. This tent is the one David had previously set up for the ark of Yahweh in Jerusalem. David puts his body into a respectful position so that David can talk to Yahweh humbly.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how does someone show humility and respect with the position of their body when they pray to God, the most powerful local gods, or spirits? Pause this audio here.

David says that David and David's house, which means David's descendants, are not worthy for Yahweh God to do these good things for David. David used to just be a humble shepherd. People did not consider shepherds to

have a high status. But Yahweh took David as a humble shepherd and made David the first king in a long line of rulers that would come from David's family.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when someone surprised people and gave someone else a position that they did not deserve. Pause this audio here.

David continues to pray to Yahweh. David says that what Yahweh did for David and David's family is a "small thing" to Yahweh. In other words, David knows Yahweh is very powerful and wants to do even more amazing things than bless David's family. Starting from this point and many times in this story, David often humbly refers to himself as Yahweh's servant to show respect to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when someone talked to God, local gods, or spirits, and showed great respect and humility. Pause this audio here.

David says that Yahweh treats David as if David were the most important person in the world.

David says that David cannot ask Yahweh for a higher honor. David also says that Yahweh knows that David is grateful, even though David cannot figure out how to fully say how grateful David is to Yahweh. David says that Yahweh wants to do this wonderful thing. David knows that Yahweh told David about it both to make David happy and for Yahweh to tell about his plan.

David says that, according to all that David and the Israelites have experienced, there is no other god like Yahweh, and Yahweh is the only true God.

David says that Yahweh's people, the Israelites, are the only people group on earth that Yahweh has rescued. Yahweh did this so that people in the world will know that the Israelites are Yahweh's special people and that Yahweh has power and deserves praise. Yahweh rescued the Israelites from slavery in Egypt and made them Yahweh's own people. And Yahweh made a name for himself. David says that people should respect Yahweh because Yahweh did these great and wonderful miracles to rescue the Israelites from slavery to the people in Egypt. Yahweh made Yahweh's people, the Israelites, Yahweh's own people forever. Yahweh has become the only God for the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a good leader who did many good things for his or her people. Then tell another story about a really great leader. What makes the really great leader better than the good leader? Pause this audio here.

David now asks Yahweh to make sure that Yahweh's promise to David and David's family will come true. David wants this so that people will highly praise Yahweh forever. David has the courage to pray boldly to Yahweh because Yahweh already made this great promise to David that Yahweh would make David's descendants leaders of Israel and would bless David's descendants forever. When David prays, David shows that he understands that this blessing is not just about David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how does God, the local gods, or spirits bless a person?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 17:16–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: David goes into the tent where the ark of Yahweh is and starts a long prayer to Yahweh. David begins by saying thank you for Yahweh's blessing to David's family.

In the second scene: David praises Yahweh God as the one faithful, true God who has guided the Israelites.

In the third scene: David asks Yahweh to continue to show this faithfulness by keeping Yahweh's promise to bless David's family.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Yahweh
- The people of Israel
- And other nations

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller begins this story with language that shows that this story happens shortly after the previous story. This story is David's response to how Yahweh had said that Yahweh will make David's descendants rulers over Yahweh's people forever.

In scene one, King David goes into the tent where the ark of Yahweh is. The Israelites believed that Yahweh lived above the ark, so it is like David goes in to sit in front of Yahweh. David humbly positions himself by the ark of Yahweh and talks to Yahweh. David puts his body into a respectful position directly in front of the ark so that David can talk to Yahweh humbly. In other words, David is preparing to spend a long time talking with Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you describe David's body position here? Pause this audio here.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: David is about to say a very long prayer to Yahweh. David speaks to Yahweh with a lot of respect and humility. Take turns acting out how you think David might be sitting before the ark of Yahweh. Then discuss what word or phrase you will use to describe this. Pause this audio here.

David asks Yahweh a question that David does not expect Yahweh to answer. David says to Yahweh, "Who am I, Yahweh God, and what is my house, that you have brought me this far?" By "house," David means David's family or David's descendants. David means that David and his family do not deserve the good things that Yahweh has done for them. David means that Yahweh has done many things to this point in David's life. Not only did Yahweh make David the king, but Yahweh also promised that Yahweh would make David's descendants rulers forever.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: David asks Yahweh many questions during this prayer. David does not expect Yahweh to answer these questions. Instead, David uses these questions to show what David deeply believes and thinks is important. Take turns in the group telling stories about something very important to you. Pay attention to the different ways each person shows something is important. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: David uses the word "house" to refer to David's descendants. What word or phrase will you use to make sure this meaning is clear? Pause this audio here.

Stop and discuss as a group some possible ways you can describe what Yahweh did for David. Pause this audio here.

David continues to say, "This was a small thing in your eyes, God." By "this," David is referring to what Yahweh has already done for David and David's family. "In God's eyes" means the way that Yahweh thinks and feels about that thing. By "a small thing," David means that what Yahweh has done for David until now is a small thing compared with what Yahweh just promised to do for David.

David says that, in addition to what Yahweh already did, Yahweh also talked about the future of David's house, or David's descendants. So, David talks about what Yahweh said would happen with David's family for a long time in the future. David calls himself Yahweh's "servant." Usually, a servant is a man or woman who works for another person, the master. Servants have a low status in the community and must obey the master. Here, David humbly calls himself Yahweh's servant to show respect to Yahweh. David says that Yahweh treats David like the most important person in the world.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: David refers to himself as "your servant" here and many other times in this prayer. David means that David is Yahweh's servant. In other words, David is talking about himself when David says, "your servant." Think about how you will talk about David so that people who hear the story will know that David talks about himself and not about someone else. Pause this audio here.

David asks another question that David does not expect Yahweh to answer. David says, "What else can I say to you for honoring your servant?" David does this to say that David believes Yahweh has given the highest honor

to David. David uses this question to say that David could not ask Yahweh for anything better than what Yahweh has already promised. Then David says the reason why David believes this: “For, You know your servant, Yahweh!” David probably means that Yahweh understands that David is thankful to Yahweh, even though David cannot figure out how to fully say how grateful David is to Yahweh.

David again calls himself Yahweh’s servant. David says, “For the sake of Yahweh’s servant and according to Yahweh’s own heart, Yahweh has done all these great things and let David know these things before these things happen.” The heart represents Yahweh’s will or emotions. This means that Yahweh promises these things because Yahweh plans to do these things for David.

In scene two, David says that there is no one like Yahweh and there is no God but Yahweh, according to all that David and the Israelites have “heard with their ears.” In other words, everything David and the Israelites have experienced proves that Yahweh is the one true God.

David asks Yahweh a long question. David does not expect Yahweh to answer this question. The first part of what David says is, “Who is like your people, Israel, the only nation on earth whose God saved his people for himself?” David is saying that no other nation of people on earth is like Yahweh’s people, the Israelites. Yahweh rescued the Israelites so they could be Yahweh’s people. David also says that Yahweh “made a name for himself,” which means that people know about Yahweh and think good things about Yahweh, because of something great that Yahweh did. David says that people know and think these things about Yahweh because, “You did a great and awesome thing by freeing your people from the Egyptians.” In other words, many people know the great thing Yahweh did when Yahweh freed the Israelites from slavery in Egypt. Because of this, people respect Yahweh.

David says, “And now, Yahweh, confirm the word which you have spoken about your servant and concerning establishing his house forever so that Yahweh’s name will be great forever.” Once again, David refers to himself as “your servant” to show respect to Yahweh. David is referring to Yahweh’s word, or promise, to make David and his descendants rulers over Israel forever. David does not doubt that Yahweh will keep Yahweh’s promise. David wants Yahweh to keep this promise forever.

David says that people will praise Yahweh’s name forever. The people will say, “Yahweh Almighty, the God of Israel is Israel’s God.” When someone praises someone’s name, that person praises or recognizes that all of that person is very important, or great. In this case, the people will call Yahweh “Almighty,” or “Yahweh of hosts,” or “Yahweh of heaven’s armies.” David is saying that many, many people will know and respect Yahweh. “God of Israel” means the “God who rules Israel” or “God who guides the people of Israel.” David says that, when this praise happens, Yahweh will make David’s house strong and secure. Yahweh’s main purpose in making David’s descendants rule forever is so that everyone will praise Yahweh.

In scene three, David humbly asks God for something. David says that Yahweh, my God, uncovered, or revealed, to “your servant” that Yahweh will build a house, or long line of kings, for David. David says that, because of what Yahweh said, David found courage to ask Yahweh something. David says, “You, Yahweh, are God! You have promised these good things to your servant. Please keep this house, or reign, secure forever so that my descendants continue as future leaders in your sight. You have chosen to bless my descendants, so please keep on blessing them forever.”

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 17:16–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Yahweh
- The people of Israel

- And other nations

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In scene one, King David goes into the tent where the ark of Yahweh is and starts to pray a long prayer in Yahweh's presence. David says to Yahweh God that David and David's family do not deserve what Yahweh has done for them. Yahweh not only brought David from a low position to become King of Israel, but Yahweh also did a bigger thing when he promised David that David's family would rule forever. Yahweh God treated David like the most important man in the world. Yahweh gave David the highest honor. David thanks Yahweh for this, even though David cannot find the right words to show gratitude to Yahweh.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh is the true God. I do not deserve anything from Yahweh, but Yahweh has chosen to bless me and my family to be rulers for many generations; or
- I know Yahweh always keeps his promises and that Yahweh is powerful. If Yahweh says he will do something, I know Yahweh will do it; or
- Wow! I feel so humble and grateful to Yahweh!

[!end] Continue the drama.

In scene two, David continues his prayer to Yahweh. David praises Yahweh as the only true God. Everything that David and the Israelites have heard confirms that Yahweh really is the only true God. Then David gives an example of Yahweh's greatness. David says that no other nation of people on earth is like Yahweh's people, the Israelites, because Yahweh saved the Israelites so they could be Yahweh's people. Pause the drama. Ask the person or group playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We remember how Yahweh sent the plagues so Pharaoh would let us leave Egypt; or
- We remember how Yahweh opened the sea so we could escape; or
- We remember how Yahweh kept us alive in the wilderness for 40 years; or
- We remember how Yahweh helped us chase the people out of Canaan to give us the land Yahweh had promised us.

Continue the drama. David says that Yahweh gained a great reputation because many people know that Yahweh freed the Israelites from slavery in Egypt. Because of this, people respect Yahweh. David describes how Yahweh made a relationship with the people of Israel, who then recognized Yahweh as their God. Pause the drama. Ask the person or group playing other nations, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The Israelites really love their God; or
- The God of the Israelites is more powerful than the Egyptian king and gods. This God freed the Israelites from slavery in Egypt! or
- We are afraid of the God of the Israelites. Because of this God, the Israelites often win in battle.

Continue the drama. In scene three, David makes a humble request of Yahweh. David asks Yahweh to make sure that Yahweh will keep his promise that David's descendants will rule forever. Because of Yahweh's promise, David says that people will respect Yahweh as the all-powerful God of the people of Israel. David asks Yahweh to keep David's family's rule secure so that David's descendants continue as leaders.

David says that Yahweh has caused David to know that Yahweh will make David's descendants rulers forever. David says that Yahweh's promise made David feel brave enough to pray this prayer to Yahweh. David says that Yahweh promised David a good thing. Finally, David says, "You, Yahweh, have blessed the house of your servant to continue forever in your presence. You, Yahweh, have made this promise and blessing. So, please bless my descendants forever." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I trust Yahweh's promise to give peace to the Israelites and make my descendants rulers over Israel. I want to ask Yahweh to keep this promise forever; or
- I know that my family cannot follow Yahweh if they follow their own ways. I know that we need Yahweh's help so that we lead in Yahweh's ways; or
- I know that Yahweh's blessing is not just for me. Yahweh wants to bless all people through my descendants so that all people will know about and worship Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 17:16–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

At the start of the story, David goes into the tent where the ark of Yahweh is. David positions his body in a humble way in front of the ark "before **Yahweh**." Yahweh is God's proper name, the Israelites' personal name for God. David calls Yahweh, "Yahweh **God**," at the beginning of David's prayer. Use the same words for Yahweh and God as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and God, refer to the Master Glossary.

David talks about his **house** often in this story. David means David's household or family, including David's descendants who will come in the years to come. These descendants make up a family line of kings, a kingdom. Yahweh says that he will make this "house," or this line of kings, strong. Look up "house of David" in the Master Glossary for more information, and use the same phrase for house of David that you have used in previous passages.

David often refers to himself as "Yahweh's **servant**" in this story. Usually, a servant is a man or woman who works for another person, the master. Servants have a low status in the community and must obey the master. David humbly calls himself Yahweh's servant to show respect to Yahweh. Look up servant in the Master Glossary for more information, and use the same word for servant as you have used in previous passages.

David said that no other nation of people on earth is like Yahweh's people, Israel. Here, "nation" refers to a group of people who belong together, live in the same area, and follow the same ruler.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **nation**. Look up nation in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

"**Israel**" refers to the Israelites or people who are descendants of Abraham. The Israelites lived in the country called Israel. Use the same word or phrase for Israel or Israelites as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israelites and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word that you used for Israel in previous passages.

David talks about how Yahweh rescued or redeemed the Israelites from **Egypt**. Here, Egypt refers to the country and to the Egyptian people who lived in that country. Yahweh frees his people and releases them from slavery.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **redeem** or **rescue**. See the Master Glossary for more information about redeem. Pause this audio here.

David uses the word "**heart**" a couple of times in the story. The first time, David is talking about Yahweh's desire and plan to make David's descendants rulers forever. In this example, the heart refers to Yahweh's thoughts, feelings, and will. Use the same word for heart here as you used in previous passages. The second way David uses the word "heart" also represents David's emotions, as David found courage or felt brave enough to pray this prayer to Yahweh. For more information on heart, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group: You may want to use the same word for heart here as you used in previous passages, or you may want to use a more specific word to describe the exact feeling David had. Take turns acting out how David felt. Then discuss how you will describe the emotion that David is talking about here. Pause this audio here.

David calls Yahweh the **Yahweh of hosts**, or **Yahweh of heaven's army**. This is a way to say that Yahweh is the ruler who has all power. Some people translate this title as Yahweh Almighty, or all-powerful. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about "Yahweh of hosts," and use the same title here for Yahweh as you have used in the previous passage.

Yahweh **blesses** the house of his servant David. Use the same word for bless as you have used in previous passages, and see bless in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 17:16–27

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (929 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 18:1–13

1 Chronicles 18:1–13

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 18:1–13 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 18:1–13 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 18:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, David responded to Yahweh's message from Nathan the prophet by praying to Yahweh in the tent in front of the ark of Yahweh. At this time, the ark of Yahweh is in Jerusalem, where David lives.

Stop here and look at the map and find Jerusalem as a group. Pause this audio here.

This true story happens sometime after David prayed to Yahweh in the tent. In this story, the storyteller talks about how David wins against the Israelites' nearby enemies. Now we get to see part of how Yahweh fulfills Yahweh's promises to David.

In this story, the storyteller tells us that David attacks and takes control of the Philistines who live on the west side of the nation of Israel. You may remember from previous stories that the Philistines do not follow Yahweh, and the Philistines are the Israelites' enemies.

Stop here and look at a map of the Philistine area to the west of Israel as a group. Pause this audio here.

David takes control of Gath from the Philistines. Gath is one of the five main Philistine cities in the flat land along the sea to the west of Judah and southwest of Jerusalem. David also takes control of the villages near Gath.

Then David attacks Moab. Moabites are the people who live in the country named Moab. The Moabites lived on a very high, flat hill to the east of the Dead Sea.

Stop here and look at a map of the kingdom of Moab as a group. Pause this audio here.

The Moabites become servants to David and start to bring gifts to David to make David happy with them. These "servants," or Moabites, now follow David as their ruler. We do not know for sure what kind of gifts the Moabites bring to David, but we do know that these Moabites give these gifts regularly, not just one time.

David also attacks Hadadezer, the king of Zobah. The storyteller says that David and David's men attack while "he" is on the way to gain power again among the people who live near the Euphrates River. In this case, we do not know for sure who the storyteller says seeks to regain power among the people near the Euphrates River. The storyteller is either talking about David or, perhaps more likely, Hadadezer. Hadadezer is the leader or king of a powerful city called Zobah in Aram. Today, people call the area of Aram, "Syria." Zobah is on the northern side of Israel in the Beqaa Valley.

Stop here and look at a map of the Euphrates River as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a map of Zobah and Aram during David's time as a group. Pause this audio here.

David captures 1,000 of Hadadezer's chariots and 7,000 of Hadadezer's horsemen. A chariot is a special type of cart that soldiers used while fighting in battle. Horsemen are soldiers who fight while riding horses or chariots.

David also takes 20,000 of Hadadezer's foot soldiers. Foot soldiers are soldiers who walk in order to fight. Also, David hurts the chariot horses so that Hadadezer's soldiers could not use the horses in battle anymore. David leaves only enough horses for David to use for 100 chariots.

Stop here and look at a drawing of a horse pulling a chariot as a group. Pause this audio here.

Other Arameans from Damascus come to help Hadadezer fight against David's army. Here, Damascus refers to a region of Aram. These other Arameans come because Zobah is one of the Aramean groups, and the Arameans want to help each other. David's army kills 22,000 of these Aramean soldiers.

Stop here and look at a map of the region of Damascus during David's time as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group how people groups in your culture come to help each other during times of attack. Pause this audio here.

Then David sets up defenses and a way to control the Arameans in Damascus. The Arameans become David's servants and start to bring gifts to David. Here, "servants" means that the Arameans now follow David as their ruler. We do not know for sure what kind of gifts the Arameans bring to David, but we do know that these Arameans give these gifts regularly, not just one time. Yahweh gives David victory wherever David fights in battle.

David takes the gold shields that the servants of Hadadezer carried in battle, and David brings these shields to Jerusalem. Gold is a shiny, yellow-colored metal. Gold is expensive because it is hard to find and because it does not rust or turn brown when it gets old. David himself probably did not carry the shields. David most likely told his soldiers to do the work.

Stop here and look at a photo of a piece of gold metal as a group. Pause this audio here.

And David takes a lot of bronze from the cities of Tebah and Cun that belonged to Hadadezer. Bronze is a strong, red-brown metal that people make by combining copper and tin. The bronze items David took probably included various items. Then the storyteller tells us about something that will happen sometime after this story.

Stop here and look at a photo of a piece of bronze metal as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a map of Tebah and Cun as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what people might find valuable to take from an enemy after they defeat that enemy. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells the listener that Solomon used these bronze items to make the bronze sea, the pillars, and other various bronze items. The listener knows these items well since the storyteller told this story about David sometime after Solomon built a house for Yahweh. The bronze sea is a huge bronze basin that priests use for religious cleansing ceremonies in Yahweh's house, the temple. The bronze sea is shaped like a very, very large bowl, and 12 bull statues support the bowl. The pillars are two bronze columns at the entrance to Yahweh's house. The other various bronze items refer to the many kinds of bronze tools that priests use in Yahweh's house.

Stop here and look at an image of what the bronze sea and pillars may have looked like. Pause this audio here.

Then someone tells Tou, king of Hamath, that David has defeated Hadadezer's whole army. In those days, it would take around 11 days to walk from Jerusalem to Hamath. Hamath was far west of the Euphrates River. After Tou hears that David has defeated Hadadezer, Tou sends his son, Hadoram, to greet King David. Hadoram blesses David for fighting against and defeating Hadadezer. Tou and Hadadezer had been at war with each other, and now Tou sees his chance to become friends with David to stay safe from David potentially attacking Tou.

Stop here and look at a map of Hamath as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What kind of person might a king or leader send as his ambassador or representative to another king or leader? What characteristics make a good ambassador? Pause this audio here.

Hadoram brings many kinds of gold, silver, and bronze items to David. King David dedicates these objects to Yahweh along with all the other man-made silver items and gold items that David has taken from other nations that David now controls. These include the things David took when he defeated the Edomites, the Moabites, the Ammonites, the Philistines, and the Amalekites.

Stop here and look at a photo of a piece of silver metal as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what are the things people usually dedicate to God, or to local gods or spirits? This can be something people dedicate at any time, not just wartime. What do people use these items for after they dedicate the items to God? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a map of the areas where the Edomites, Ammonites, Philistines, and Amalekites lived during David's time. Pause this audio here.

Abishai, Zeruiah's son, defeats 18,000 Edomites. Abishai is one of David's soldiers. So, Abishai won the victory on David's behalf. The valley where the Edomites live is called the "Valley of Salt." We do not know the exact location of the Valley of Salt. However, we do know that this refers to a valley with a lot of salt in the dirt, probably south or southwest of the Dead Sea. A valley is a big, wide opening between two hills.

David puts military buildings in Edom, probably like a "garrison," for soldiers. This means that David sets up a way to control the Edomites there. All the Edomites become David's servants. We can see from David's victories that Yahweh gives David victory everywhere that David goes!

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 18:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: David and David's men defeat and take control over the Philistines.

In the second scene: David and his men defeat the Moabite soldiers. The Moabites become David's servants and start to bring tribute to David.

In the third scene: David and his men defeat Hadadezer, king of Zobah. Other Arameans from the region of Damascus come to help their fellow Aramean, King Hadadezer. David and David's men kill thousands of these Arameans. Then David takes control of Damascus. These Arameans become David's servants and start to bring tribute. Yahweh gives victory to David wherever David goes. David and David's men take all the gold and bronze items they won from Hadadezer to Jerusalem. We learn that Solomon later uses these metal items as part of the house Solomon builds for Yahweh.

In the fourth scene: King Tou of Hamath sends his son Hadoram to thank and give gifts to King David for defeating Tou's enemy, Hadadezer. David dedicates these gold, silver, and bronze items to Yahweh, along with the silver and gold from all the nations that David had taken control of.

In the fifth scene: Abishai, one of David's soldiers, kills thousands of Edomites in the Valley of Salt. David sets up control throughout all of Edom, and all the Edomites become David's servants. Yahweh gives victory to David wherever David goes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David and David's men
- the Philistines
- the Moabites
- Hadadezer and Hadadezer's men
- Arameans from the region of Damascus
- Yahweh
- Solomon
- Tou, king of Hamath
- Hadoram, Tou's son
- the Edomites
- the Ammonites

- the Amalekites
- And Abishai

In scene one, the storyteller uses a word that shows that this story happens sometime after David prayed to Yahweh in the tent. The storyteller uses this word to introduce something new that David is about to do. The storyteller says that David "strikes," which means "attacks" the Philistines in battle. David is successful when he attacks the Philistines, and so David takes control of the Philistines in this area. When the storyteller says that David did this, the storyteller means that David and the soldiers in David's army did this together. David and David's men also take control of Gath from the Philistines. Gath is a major Philistine city or area. David also takes control of the "daughter" villages, or the villages that surround Gath that Gath likely had control over.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use to describe the areas that surround Gath. Pause this audio here.

In scene two, David and David's men "strike" or "attack" Moabite soldiers in battle. This means that David and David's men defeat the Moabite soldiers. The Moabites become servants to David and start to bring regular gifts to David so that David will not attack them.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use to describe how the Moabites bring regular gifts to David. Pause this audio here.

In scene three, David and his men "strike" or attack Hadadezer, king of Zobah. The men attack when "he" goes to regain power at "the River." We do not know for sure if the storyteller is saying that David or Hadadezer goes to get power at the River. In those days, the people knew the Euphrates River so well that they simply called it "the River." So, "the River" means the Euphrates River. Either David or Hadadezer wants to regain control over the area around the river.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that "he went to regain power at the Euphrates River." Pause this audio here.

David takes 1,000 of Hadadezer's chariots, 7,000 of Hadadezer's horsemen, and 20,000 of Hadadezer's foot soldiers. This means that David captured these soldiers. And David cuts the thigh muscles of Hadadezer's chariot horses so that the horses cannot run in battle anymore during their lifetime. However, before doing this, David keeps enough horses that can still run for David to use with 100 chariots.

Then, other Arameans in the region of Damascus come to fight against David and David's men in order to help Hadadezer, king of Zobah. Although Zobah is an important city in Aram, the people from Zobah are part of a bigger group of Arameans who all help each other. That is why the other Arameans come to help King Hadadezer.

David and David's men "strike" 22,000 Aramean soldiers. Here, "strike" means "kill." Then David puts military defenses across the Aramean territory of Damascus to control the people there. The Arameans who remain become David's servants and start to bring regular gifts to David. The storyteller says that Yahweh "saves" David wherever David goes. Here, "saves" means that Yahweh gives David victory. In other words, Yahweh causes David to have victory over David's enemies everywhere that David goes.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will describe what Yahweh did for David. Pause this audio here.

David and David's men take away the gold shields from Hadadezer's servants who carry the shields. David and David's men then bring these shields to Jerusalem. David also takes a lot of bronze items from Hadadezer's cities, Tebah and Cun. Though the storyteller does not say this directly, David also brings the bronze items to Jerusalem.

The storyteller now mentions something that will happen in the future, sometime after David's victories in this story, but before the Israelites first hear this story. Solomon will use these metal items to make special parts of Yahweh's house or temple. These items include the bronze sea, the pillars, and other tools.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use to describe the bronze sea, the pillars, and other tools. If needed, look at images of the bronze sea and the pillars. Pause this audio here.

In scene four, Tou, king of Hamath, learns that David has "struck down" or "defeated" the whole army of Hadadezer. So, Tou sends his son, Hadoram, to "ask peace" from and "bless" King David. Hadoram also gives gifts from King Tou to King David because David had defeated Tou's enemy, Hadadezer. Tou and Hadoram do

this because David fought against Hadadezer and "struck down" or defeated Hadadezer. In those days, people often said "peace" as a greeting. Hadoram blesses or praises David because David defeated Tou's enemy. In other words, Hadoram is greeting and thanking David. The storyteller adds the information that Hadadezer had often fought battles against Tou. This means that Hadadezer and Hadadezer's army often attacked Tou and Tou's people.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will describe what Hadoram did when Hadoram greeted David, praised David, and gave gifts to David. Pause this audio here.

King Tou's son, Hadoram, brings many kinds of "vessels," which means man-made items of gold, silver, and bronze, as a gift to King David. King David dedicates these items to Yahweh. Here, "dedicates" means that David gives the items to Yahweh to show that Yahweh is important. David also dedicates to Yahweh all the silver and gold from all the different people groups David took control of. These nations include the Edomites, the Moabites, the Ammonites, the Philistines, and the Amalekites. When the storyteller talks about the Ammonites, the storyteller says, "the sons, or descendants, of Ammon." David also brings items that David "plundered" or "took away in battle" from Hadadezer, king of Zobah. When someone dedicates something to Yahweh, that person is using the item for the purpose of worshipping or serving Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will describe David dedicating these items to Yahweh. Pause this audio here.

In scene five, Abishai, the son of a woman named Zeruiah, strikes down 18,000 Edomites in the Valley of Salt. Abishai is one of David's soldiers, so Abishai defeats the Edomites on David's behalf. David makes garrisons, or military stations, in Edom to control the people. All the Edomites become David's servants. Once again, the storyteller says that Yahweh saves David, or gives David victory over David's enemies.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 18:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has 5 scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David and David's men
- the Philistines
- the Moabites
- Hadadezer and Hadadezer's men
- Arameans from the region of Damascus
- Yahweh
- Solomon
- Tou, king of Hamath
- Hadoram, Tou's son
- the Edomites
- the Ammonites
- the Amalekites
- And Abishai

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

David attacks and takes control of the Philistines. Also, David takes control of Gath and the surrounding areas from the Philistines.

Then David attacks and defeats the Moabites. The Moabites who remain become David’s servants and start to bring regular gifts to David. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the remaining Moabites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We feel very afraid of David, and we also feel grateful that David kept some of us alive; or
- We have to keep David happy by doing what David says and giving gifts to David often so that he will not kill more of us.

Continue the drama. David and David’s men also attack King Hadadezer. This happens while “he” is on the way to gain power again among the people who live near the Euphrates River. David captures 1,000 of Hadadezer’s chariots, 7,000 of Hadadezer’s horsemen, and 20,000 of Hadadezer’s foot soldiers. David keeps enough horses to pull 100 chariots for David. David hurts all the other chariot horses so that Hadadezer’s soldiers cannot use the horses in battle anymore.

Then Arameans from the region of Damascus come to help Hadadezer, king of Zobah, to fight against David’s army. David’s army kills 22,000 Aramean soldiers. Then David sets up stations to control the Arameans there. The Arameans become David’s servants and start to bring gifts to David. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Arameans from Damascus, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We must help King Hadadezer, since we are all Aramean; or
- David killed many of our people and has control of our area with many soldiers. We have to do what David says and give gifts to David.

Continue the drama. The storyteller says that Yahweh enables David to defeat and control other armies wherever David goes. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I told David before that I would give peace to Israel by stopping enemies from harming Israel. I am keeping my promise; or
- I love David and will help David.

Continue the drama. David and David’s men take the gold shields, which the servants of Hadadezer carry and bring these shields to Jerusalem. David also takes a lot of bronze from the cities of Tebah and Cun. The storyteller tells us that, later, Solomon uses these metal items to make the bronze sea, the pillars, and various bronze tools for Yahweh’s house. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh gave victory to my father, David. So, these precious metal items belong to Yahweh; or
- Yahweh told my father, King David, that one of David’s descendants would build a house for Yahweh. I feel honored that I could build Yahweh’s house in Jerusalem. I want to use the best materials, like these precious metals.

Continue the drama. Tou, king of Hamath, learns that David has defeated Hadadezer’s whole army. So, Tou sends his son, Hadoram, to greet King David. Hadoram blesses David for fighting against and defeating Hadadezer. Then the storyteller tells us that Hadadezer had been at war with Tou. Hadoram brings silver, gold, and bronze items to David. Pause the drama. Ask the person or people playing Tou or Hadoram, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am so grateful that David killed my enemies; or

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- I am also afraid of David because David's army is very powerful. I want to make sure David does not treat me like David's enemy; or
- I want to thank David for what David has done.

Continue the drama. King David dedicates the silver, gold, and bronze items from Tou to Yahweh. David also dedicates all the silver and gold items that David took from all the other nations that David has taken control of. The people groups David took control of are: the Edomites, the Moabites, the Ammonites, the Philistines, and the Amalekites. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh has done so much for me and for the other Israelites. I am so grateful to Yahweh. I want to give these things back to Yahweh as a way to thank and praise Yahweh; or
- I know that Yahweh caused me to win all these battles. Yahweh deserves all these things.

Continue the drama. Then the storyteller tells us that Abishai, Zeruiah's son, kills 18,000 Edomites in the Valley of Salt.

David puts military stations throughout the Edomite area to control the people there. All the Edomites become David's servants. Yahweh gives victory to David wherever David goes.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 18:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

David defeated the Philistines. David took the **city** of Gath and its surrounding **villages**. Remember that cities are larger settlements with walls around them. Villages usually surround a city, and they usually do not have walls. David defeated both the bigger city of Gath and the smaller villages that surrounded Gath. Use the same words for city and villages that you have used in previous passages.

In the story, the Moabites and other people groups became David's **servants**. Usually, a servant is a man or woman who works for another person, the master. Servants have a low status in the community and must obey the master. The Moabites and other people groups now had to do what David told them to do and had to give regular gifts to David. Later in the story, David takes the gold shields that Hadadezer's servants had carried in battle. In the original language, this is the same word for "servant" as when the Moabites became David's servants. But here, Hadadezer's servants may refer to Hadadezer's military officers or guards. Look up servant in the Master Glossary for more information, and use the same word for servant as you have used in previous passages.

David orders his men to hurt or hamstring Hadadezer's **chariot** horses. When people hamstring, they cut the thigh muscles in the back legs of an enemy's horse so the horse can no longer run or pull a chariot in battle. Use the same word for chariot as you have used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **hamstring**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David used bronze to make the bronze "sea" and the pillars.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate bronze sea and pillars. See the photos again if needed. Pause this audio here.

Two times in the story, the storyteller tells us that **Yahweh** "gives victory to" David everywhere David goes. To give victory means to save or rescue someone from an enemy. Yahweh is God's proper name, the Israelites' personal name for God. Use the same general word for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **victory**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David builds garrisons, or military buildings, in different places. Soldiers live in these buildings so they can protect the people and the area around them.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **garrison** or military buildings.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (909 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 18:14–17

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 18:14–17 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 18:14–17 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.

6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 18:14–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This story is about how King David ruled the nation of Israel, and about King David's officials and the responsibilities of King David's officials. The events in this story happened some time after King David and King David's army had defeated the armies of neighboring nations, and the neighboring nations had begun to serve King David. The officials in this story are the ones who served King David in the land of Israel.

David reigns over all Israel, and David does what is just and right for all his people.

"All Israel" refers to the nation of Israel and probably includes many or most of the territories David and his men conquered. David does what is just and right, which means that David treats people fairly. The terms "justice" and "righteousness" do not refer to two completely different things. Here, the storyteller is likely using these two words together to describe the way a person acts in the right way towards all people and not just the people they like. However, David probably ruled only the Israelites with justice and righteousness. David probably did not rule the people he had conquered justly and rightly.

Stop and discuss: Tell a story about a leader from your culture who did what is just and right for his people. What type of action shows that the leader is just and righteous? Stop the recording here.

Joab, who is the son of a woman called Zeruiah, is the leader of the army. Zeruiah is the woman who is Joab's mother. Zeruiah is David's sister or step-sister. We do not know who Zeruiah's husband is. This means that Joab is David's nephew. Joab commands the army, which is a powerful position.

Jehoshaphat, the son of Ahilud, is recorder. We do not know exactly the meaning of "recorder." A recorder may be a person who was in charge of public records, or important information and laws that all people in the nation needed to know. The recorder may also have been the king's spokesman or a person who reported to the king and told the people what the king's decisions were.

Zadok, the son of Ahitub, is one of the priests. Ahimelech, the son of Abiathar, is also one of the priests. Priests were people who worked in the tabernacle of Yahweh. The tabernacle was the tent that the Israelite people used to worship Yahweh before Solomon built the temple. Priests were responsible for offering sacrifices to Yahweh on behalf of the people. Priests took care of the tabernacle and taught the people how to worship God. We do not know for sure if Ahimelech is the son of Abiathar, or if Abiathar is the son of Ahimelech. At the time of King David, there were many priests. However, according to this storyteller, it is clear that both Zadok and Ahimelech were high priests, or the most important priests.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, who is responsible for offering things to God, gods, or spirits on behalf of the people? What do they usually do? Pause this audio here.

Shavsha is "secretary." We are not sure what a secretary did during the time of King David. A secretary may have been the person who wrote things down for the king. It is certain that during David's time, a secretary's duties were very important so that people would have a record of the king's actions and decisions.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Describe someone in your culture who does a similar role. Pause this audio here.

Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada, leads the Kerethites and the Pelethites. We know from later stories that Benaiah is a mighty warrior. Benaiah is an Israelite, but the Kerethites and the Pelethites are most likely non-Israelites from the Aegean Sea area. The Kerethites and the Pelethites are the bodyguards, or special royal guards, responsible for protecting King David. The Kerethites and the Pelethites remained loyal to King David in all three revolts against King David. King David trusted the Kerethites and the Pelethites as his bodyguards because they were always loyal to King David.

Stop here and look at a map of the Aegean Sea area during the time of King David as a group. Pause this audio here.

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We are not sure what David's sons do in his kingdom. Perhaps they are all David's high-ranking officials in the government. Or perhaps, the oldest sons of David are the ones near King David, who help him. In that time and culture, a king often had many wives and many sons. The king's oldest sons from the different wives would help the king in the government.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of things do a son or sons of a leader do to support the leader?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 18:14–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: David reigns over the nation of Israel, and David does what is just and right for all his people.

In the second scene: The storyteller talks about David's officials and their roles.

The characters in this passage are:

- King David
- All the Israelites who are under David's rule
- Joab, who is the son of a woman called Zeruiah
- Jehoshaphat, the recorder, son of Ahilud
- Zadok, the priest, son of Ahitub
- Ahimelech, the priest, son of Abiathar
- Shavsha, the secretary
- Benaiah, the leader of David's bodyguard, son of Jehoiada
- the bodyguards, or men of the Kerethites and the Pelethites
- And David's sons

If you have already translated 2 Samuel 8:15–18, you may want to listen to that passage to hear how you translated the names of the people and their job titles. Pause this audio here.

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller makes it clear at the beginning of this passage that he is starting a new story with a new subject.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you change subjects and start to tell a new story, or the next part of a big story? Pause this audio here.

In scene one, David reigns over, or controls, the nation of Israel, and David does what is just and right for all his people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about the story you told in step two about a leader who does what is just and right. What words did you use to describe what that leader did? Pause this audio here.

In scene two, Joab, who is the son of a woman called Zeruiah, is the leader of the army, and Jehoshaphat, the son of Ahilud, is recorder.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: The storyteller tells the name of the father or mother for most of the people in this story. In your language, what is the most natural way to include information about the father or mother? Pause this audio here.

A "recorder" may refer to a person who was in charge of public records. The recorder may also have been the king's spokesman or a person who reported to the king and told the people the king's decisions.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In step two, how did you describe the recorder? What words or phrases did you use for "recorder"? Pause this audio here.

Zadok, the son of Ahitub, is one of the priests. Ahimelech, the son of Abiathar, is also one of the priests. And Shavsha is "secretary."

We are not sure if Ahimelech is the son of Abiathar, or Abiathar is the son of Ahimelech. At the time of King David, there were many priests. However, according to this storyteller, it is clear that the two priests are Zadok and Ahimelech.

We are not sure what a secretary did during the time of King David. A secretary may have been the person who wrote things down for the king. However, it is certain that during David's time, a secretary's duties involved more than just writing things down for the king. It is certain that during David's time, a secretary's duties were very important so that people would have a record of the king's actions and decisions.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about the story you told in step two. What name or phrase did you use for "secretary"? Pause this audio here.

Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada, is the leader of the Kerethites and the Pelethites who are King David's bodyguards.

David's sons are the chief officials in the service of the king. We are not sure what David's sons do in his kingdom. Perhaps the sons are all David's high-ranking officials in the government. Or perhaps, the oldest sons of David are the ones near King David, who help him. In that time and culture, a king often had many wives and many sons. The king's oldest sons from the different wives would help him in the government.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your translation, how would you describe David's sons? Why would you describe the sons in that way? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 18:14–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- King David
- All the Israelites who are under David's rule
- Joab, who is the son of a woman called Zeruiah
- Jehoshaphat, the recorder, son of Ahilud
- Zadok, the priest, son of Ahitub
- Ahimelech, the priest, son of Abiathar
- Shavsha, the secretary
- Benaiah, the leader of David's bodyguard, son of Jehoiada
- the bodyguards, or men of the Kerethites and the Pelethites
- And David's sons.

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In scene one, David reigns over, or controls, the nation of Israel, and David does what is just and right for all his people. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am very proud of myself; or
- I am very thankful to God; or
- I love my people, and I will do my best for them.

Continue the drama.Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Israelites under King David’s rule, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am very thankful to God for this king who treats people with justice and righteousness; or
- I want just treatment when people treat me unjustly; or
- I do not want the king to treat me justly when I have treated others badly! That means the king will punish me!

Continue the drama. In scene two, Joab, who is the son of a woman called Zeruiah, is the leader of the army, and Jehoshaphat, the son of Ahilud, is recorder. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Joab, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel like a very powerful man; or
- I am very proud to be the leader of the army of Israel; or
- I love to serve the king who does what is just and right for the people.

Ask the person playing Jehoshaphat, the recorder, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am very honored to serve the king who loves God; or
- I am stressed as I am one of King David’s important officials; or
- I want to be very careful whenever I say or write something because I have a great responsibility.

Continue the drama. Zadok, the son of Ahitub, is one of the priests. Ahimelech, the son of Abiathar, is also one of the priests. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Zadok, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am thankful to God as I can represent people to offer things to God; or
- I am afraid that I might sometimes sin against God intentionally or unintentionally; or
- I am very proud to be one of the religious leaders for the people.

Continue the drama. And Shavsha is secretary. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Shavsha, the secretary, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel stressed as I am one of King David’s important officials; or
- I am thankful to God for what I can do to support King David; or
- I am proud to be one of King David’s important officials.

Continue the drama. Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada, is the leader of the Kerethites and the Pelethites, who are King David’s bodyguards. And David’s sons are the chief officials in the service of the king. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Benaiah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I want to stop anyone who might try to kill the king; or
- I feel that I am the toughest guy in the room wherever I go; or
- I am thankful to God as I am able to serve King David with my fighting skills and leadership skills.

Ask the person playing David’s sons, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am thankful to my father, King David, for this position; or
- Every day, I am excited to learn different things from my father’s important officials; or
- I want to learn how to be a king from my father, King David.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 18:14–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

"All **Israel**" refers to the nation of Israel and probably includes many or most of the territories David and his men conquered. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages.

The terms "**justice**" and "**righteousness**" do not refer to two completely different things. Here, the storyteller is very likely using the two words to mean "true justice" or the way someone "treats everyone fairly in the same way." For more information on justice and righteousness, refer to the Master Glossary. If you have translated these words in another part of the Bible, use the same words as you have used there.

In the original language, the precise meaning of the word for "recorder" is not clear. A recorder may be a person in charge of public records. The recorder may also have been the king's spokesman or a person who reported to the king and told the people the king's decisions.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **recorder**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Zadok, the son of Ahitub, is one of the **priest**s. Ahimelech, the son of Abiathar, is also one of the priests. Priests were people who worked in the tabernacle of Yahweh. The tabernacle was the tent that the Israelite people used to worship Yahweh before Solomon built the temple. Priests were responsible for offering sacrifices to Yahweh on behalf of the people. Priests took care of the tabernacle and taught the people how to worship God. Use the same word or phrase for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Shavsha is "secretary." We are not sure what a secretary did during the time of King David. A secretary may have been the person who wrote things down for the king. It is certain that during David's time, a secretary's duties involved more than those of a modern-day secretary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **secretary**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Most likely, both the Kerethites and the Pelethites were groups of non-Israelites who probably came from the Aegean Sea area.

King David's sons worked with David as **officials**. Use the same word or phrase for government officials as you used in previous passages.

For more information on **king**, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 18:14–17

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (629 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 19:1–9

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 19:1–9 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 19:1–9 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 19:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, we talked about how David ruled the nation of Israel and about the names and the responsibilities of David's officials. This story is about the conflict between King David and the Ammonites, and how the Ammonites and the Syrians, or Arameans, prepared to fight against the army of King David. The events in this story happened in the land of the Ammonites and in the land of Israel. The conflict in this story happened because Hanun, King of the Ammonites, insulted King David's representatives.

Some time after the events in the previous story, King Nahash of the Ammonites dies, and Hanun, his son, becomes the king of the Ammonites. David says that he will show steadfast love or loyalty to Hanun, son of Nahash, because Hanun's father, Nahash, showed steadfast love or loyalty to David. So David sends messengers to show sympathy to Hanun because Hanun's father, Nahash, had died. These messengers are officials in David's kingdom.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do leaders of other ethnic groups usually do to show sympathy to a leader who lost his father? Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 19:1–9

We do not know for sure how Nahash showed steadfast love or loyalty to David. We just know that Nahash treated David well. Eventually, David must have told his people what David wanted to do for Hanun.

David's messengers go to the city of Rabbah to show sympathy to Hanun. But the Ammonite military leaders do not trust David's men. The leaders convince King Hanun that David sent messengers to explore and spy on the country so that King David could conquer it.

So Hanun takes David's messengers, shaves off their beards, cuts off their garments in the middle, at the buttocks, and sends them away.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people usually do to humiliate someone? Pause this audio here.

During the time of David, people sometimes shaved their beards as a sign of mourning. Here, Hanun shaved David's messengers' beards in order to humiliate or dishonor them. Hanun also shamed David's men when he cut off their robes because now everyone could see the men's private parts of their bodies.

When some people come and tell David about the messengers, David sends people to meet the messengers, because the messengers are very ashamed. King David tells the messengers to stay in the city of Jericho till their beards have grown, and then come back to the city of Jerusalem.

The city of Jericho was on the return route from the city of Rabbah to the city of Jerusalem. By the time David's messengers had reached Jericho, they had already made most of the return trip home.

Stop here and look at a map of the route from Rabbah to Jericho and Jerusalem during the time of King David as a group. Pause this audio here.

The Ammonites know that they have offended David very much, much like a very bad smell offends people. The Ammonites send a thousand talents of silver to hire chariots and horsemen for themselves from the kingdoms of Aram Naharaim, Aram Maacah, and Zobah, which are in Syria.

Stop here and look at a map of Aram Naharaim, Aram Maacah, and Zobah during the time of King David as a group. Pause this audio here.

A "talent" was about 34 kilograms. A thousand talents of silver is about 30 tons or 34,000 kilograms of silver. However, the weight of a talent changed over time and in different places, so it is not possible to be certain of the exact amount of a thousand talents of silver. The silver the Ammonites spent was clearly a very large amount of silver and represented a great deal of money.

Chariots from Syria at that time were light vehicles with two wheels and six or eight spokes on each wheel. The body of the chariot had a front and two sides that came to about mid-thigh level and had an open back. People used iron to strengthen the rims of the wheels. During the earliest time, two horses pulled chariots, but later teams of three or four horses pulled the chariots. These chariots usually had two men: the driver and an archer. Sometimes there was also a shield-bearer.

Stop here and look at a picture of a chariot and chariot drivers during the time of King David as a group. Pause this audio here.

In the original language, the meaning of the word for "horsemen" is not clear. The word may refer to either men who ride in the chariot, or troops who fight on horses. However, it is very likely that "horsemen" refers to "men who rode in the chariots."

The Ammonites hire for themselves 32,000 chariots, as well as the king of Maacah with his army, who comes and camps near the town of Medeba, while the Ammonites gather from their cities and come for the battle.

Medeba was a town about 20 kilometers east of the north end of the Dead Sea in the territory of Reuben in Moab.

Stop here and look at a map of Medeba in relation to Rabbah during the time of King David as a group. Pause this audio here.

When David hears the news about the Syrians and the Ammonites, David sends Joab, the leader of Israel's army, out with the entire army of Israel. The Ammonite troops come out of the city of Rabbah and arrange themselves

1 Chronicles 19:1–9

in their battle positions at the entrance to their city, Rabbah. Meanwhile, the Syrian kings and their armies, who have come to help the Ammonites, are by themselves in the open country with no trees nearby.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 19:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has eight scenes.

In the first scene: King Nahash of the Ammonites dies, and his son, Hanun, rules in his father's place.

In the second scene: David says that he will show steadfast love or loyalty to Hanun because Hanun's father showed steadfast love or loyalty to David. Then, David sends messengers to show sympathy to Hanun.

In the third scene: When David's messengers come to Hanun in the land of the Ammonites to show sympathy to him, the Ammonite leaders convince Hanun that David is not sincere. The leaders say that David sends his messengers to Hanun only to explore, spy out, and overthrow the country. So Hanun takes David's messengers, humiliates them, and sends them away.

In the fourth scene: When some people come and tell David about the messengers, David sends people to tell the messengers to stay in the city of Jericho till their beards have grown, and then come back to the city of Jerusalem.

In the fifth scene: When the Ammonites realize that they have angered King David, the Ammonites send a large amount of silver to hire chariots and chariot riders for themselves from Aram Naharaim, Aram Maacah, and Zobah.

In the sixth scene: The 32,000 chariots, as well as the king of Maacah with his army, come and camp near the city of Medeba, while the Ammonites gather from their cities and come for the battle.

In the seventh scene: When David hears the news about the Syrians and the Ammonites, David sends Joab out to their city, Rabbah, with the entire army of Israel.

In the eighth scene: The Ammonite troops come out of the city of Rabbah, while the Syrian kings and their armies, who have come to help the Ammonites, are by themselves in the open country.

The characters in this passage are:

- Nahash, King of the Ammonites
- Hanun, Nahash's son
- David
- Someone who tells David about Nahash's death
- The messengers David sends to Hanun
- The Ammonite leaders who believe that David is not sincere
- Hanun's people who humiliate David's messengers
- Some people who tell David about what Hanun does to David's messengers
- People whom David sends to tell his messengers to stay in the city of Jericho
- Syrian kings and their armies from the kingdoms of Aram Naharaim, Aram Maacah, and Zobah
- Someone who tells David about the armies of the Ammonites and the Syrians
- Joab
- The army of Israel
- And the Ammonite army

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This story is very similar to the first part of the story in 2 Samuel 10:1–19.

1 Chronicles 19:1–9

Stop here and listen to your translation of 2 Samuel 10:1–19, if you have already translated this passage. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us that this story happened some time after the previous story. We do not know how much time passed between each story.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What word or phrase do you want to use in your translation to introduce this story? Pause this audio here.

In scene one, in the capital city of the Ammonites, called Rabbah, Nahash, king of the Ammonites, dies, and Hanun, Nahash's son, rules in his father's place. The storyteller implies that someone told David that Nahash died, and Hanun became the king of the Ammonites.

In scene two, in the city of Jerusalem, David says that he will show steadfast love or loyalty to Hanun, son of Nahash, because Hanun's father showed steadfast love or loyalty to David. We do not know who David speaks to here. David might say this to himself or to one of his officials.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Describe a person in your community who shows the kind of love to someone else that David showed to Hanun. What kind of person is he or she, and what does he or she do? Pay attention to the words you use to describe the kind of love this person shows. Pause this audio here.

David really wants to show love to Hanun, so David sends messengers to show sympathy to Hanun because Hanun's father, Nahash, died. The storyteller sometimes calls these messengers "David's servants," and sometimes "David's messengers." These men give David's messages to people on behalf of David. These men are also David's servants, because they do whatever David asks them to do.

In scene three, David's messengers come to Hanun in the land of the Ammonites to show sympathy to Hanun. But the Ammonite military leaders ask Hanun, "Do you think David is honoring your father by sending messengers to you to show sympathy? Have not his messengers really come to you to explore and spy out the country and conquer it?" The Ammonite commanders do not want Hanun to answer their questions. Instead, these men want to cause Hanun to distrust David. These men want Hanun to think that David is lying to Hanun and that David actually wants to conquer Hanun's kingdom.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how would you show that the Ammonite leaders do not trust David? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller shows surprise that the Ammonite leaders would try to make Hanun mistrust David's men.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What word or phrase do you want to use to introduce the action of the Ammonite leaders that the listeners might not expect? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller makes it clear that what Hanun did next is the logical result of what the Ammonite leaders said. Hanun takes David's messengers, shaves off their beards, cuts off their garments in the middle, at the buttocks, and sends them away. It is more likely that Hanun's commanders or servants were the ones who actually shaved the beards of David's messengers, cut off their garments in the middle, at the buttocks, and sent them away forcefully.

In scene four, in Jerusalem, when some people come to tell David about what Hanun did to the messengers, David sends people to meet the messengers. David does this because the messengers are very ashamed. King David tells the men to stay in the city of Jericho till their beards have grown, and then come back to the city of Jerusalem.

In scene five, the Ammonites realize that they have offended David very badly, much like a very bad smell offends people. So the Ammonites send 1,000 talents of silver, or 34,000 kilograms of silver, to hire chariots and horsemen for themselves from the kingdoms of Aram Naharaim, Aram Maacah, and Zobah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how will you say that the Ammonites have offended David? Pause this audio here.

In scene six, the Ammonites hire for themselves 32,000 chariots, as well as the king of Maacah with his army, who comes and camps near the city of Medeba, while the Ammonites gather from their cities and come for the battle.

1 Chronicles 19:1–9

In scene seven, in Jerusalem, when David hears the news about the Syrians and the Ammonites, David sends Joab out with the entire army of Israel. Joab is the leader of the army of Israel.

In scene eight, the Ammonite troops come out of the city of Rabbah and arrange themselves in their battle positions at the entrance to their city, Rabbah. This means that the Ammonites prepare to fight the Israelites by putting their soldiers in rows. Meanwhile, the Syrian kings and their armies, who have come to help the Ammonites, are by themselves in the open country. The storyteller does not say the name of the city of Rabbah in this passage, but we know from a later story that they are in Rabbah.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 19:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has eight scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Nahash, King of the Ammonites
- Hanun, Nahash's son
- David
- Someone who tells David about Nahash's death
- The messengers David sends to Hanun
- The Ammonite leaders who believe that David is not sincere
- Hanun's people who humiliate David's messengers
- Some people who tell David about what Hanun does to David's messengers
- People whom David sends to tell his messengers to stay in the city of Jericho
- Syrian kings and their armies from the kingdoms of Aram Naharaim, Aram Maacah, and Zobah
- Someone who tells David about the armies of the Ammonites and the Syrians
- Joab
- And the Ammonite army

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In scene one, in the capital city of the Ammonites, called Rabbah, Nahash, king of the Ammonites, dies, and Hanun, Nahash's son, rules in his father's place. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Hanun, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad because my father died. At the same time, I am happy because I am now the king of the Ammonites; or
- I am stressed to bear the responsibilities of being a king; or
- I am excited to enjoy all the pleasures a king can have.

Continue the drama. In scene two, in the city of Jerusalem, David says that he will show steadfast love or loyalty to Hanun, son of Nahash, because Hanun's father showed steadfast love or loyalty to David. So David sends

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messengers to express sympathy to Hanun because Hanun's father, Nahash, died. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sorry for Hanun's loss; or
- I am excited to build a new relationship with the new king, Hanun; or
- I am grateful for the way Nahash treated me.

Continue the drama. In scene three, David's messengers come to Hanun in the land of the Ammonites to show sympathy to Hanun. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David's messengers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am excited to be in a new kingdom and see a new place; or
- I am proud to be one of the messengers for King David; or
- I am excited to build a good relationship with the new king.

Continue the drama. But the Ammonite leaders ask Hanun if he really thinks that David is honoring his father, Nahash, by sending messengers to Hanun to show sympathy. The Ammonite leaders tell Hanun that they believe that David's messengers came to Hanun only to explore, spy out, and overthrow the country. So Hanun takes David's messengers, shaves off their beards, cuts off their garments in the middle, at the buttocks, and sends them away. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Hanun, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am afraid of David and his army; or
- I want to humiliate David for his evil plan; or
- I want to make David angry as a punishment for his actions.

Continue the drama. In scene four, in Jerusalem, when some people come and tell David about the messengers, David sends people to meet the messengers, because they are very ashamed. King David tells the messengers to stay in the city of Jericho till their beards have grown, and then come back to the city of Jerusalem. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David's messengers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I will never go back to the city of Rabbah again; or
- I am very angry with Hanun; or
- I do not want to go out to see other people because I am embarrassed by my appearance.

Continue the drama. In scene five, when the Ammonites realize that they have angered David, they send 1,000 talents of silver to hire chariots and horsemen for themselves from Aram Naharaim, Aram Maacah, and Zobah.

In scene six, the Ammonites hire for themselves 32,000 chariots, as well as the king of Maacah with his army, who comes and camps near the city of Medeba, while the Ammonites gather from their cities and come for the battle.

In scene seven, in Jerusalem, when David hears the news about the Syrians and the Ammonites, David sends Joab out with the entire army of Israel. Joab is the leader of the army of Israel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing one of the soldiers from the army of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am afraid I might not see my family; or
- I am angry with the Ammonites because they humiliated our messengers; or
- I am very proud to follow King David's and Joab's orders.

Continue the drama. In scene eight, the Ammonite troops come out of the city of Rabbah and arrange themselves in their battle positions at the entrance to their city, Rabbah, while the Syrian kings and their armies, who have come to help the Ammonites, are by themselves in the open country. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing one of the soldiers from the Syrian armies, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I will joyfully destroy the Israelite soldiers; or
- Why me? I am afraid to die; or
- Is this fight worth fighting for?

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Ask the person playing one of the soldiers from the Ammonite army, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Why do our leaders want to fight wars? I just want to stay with my family; or
- We will win this war because our army is strong and the Syrian armies are also strong; or
- I am afraid to die.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 19:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

King Nahash of the Ammonites died. A king is someone who rules over a city or territory, like a region or a country. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

David wanted to show **steadfast love** to Hanun. Steadfast love or loyalty means the kindness or help a person gives to another person. Look up “steadfast love” in the Master Glossary for more information, and translate this in the same way as you have in previous passages.

David’s servants, or messengers, are officials in David’s kingdom. Sometimes the storyteller calls these men servants, and sometimes he calls them messengers. For more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will describe these men. What words will you use for **messengers**, and what words will you use for **servants**? Pause this audio here.

Hanun’s **military commanders**, or leaders, convince Hanun that David wants to spy out his land and conquer them. Use the same word or phrase for military commanders that you have used in previous passages.

The storyteller calls the “Ammonites” the “sons or children of Ammon.” These are people who descended from a man named Ammon. Use the same word or phrase for Ammonites as you used in previous passages.

Use the same word or phrase for chariot and horsemen as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 19:1–9

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (686 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 19:10–19

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 19:10–19 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 19:10–19 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 19:10–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, Hanun, the new king of the Ammonites, humiliated David's representatives and hired Syrian, or Aramean, armies to fight against David and David's army. Then the Ammonites came out of their city, Rabbah, to fight against David's army while the Syrians were in the open country.

This story is about how Joab and his brother, Abishai, led the army of Israel to fight against the Syrians and the Ammonites, and how the Israelites won the battle. We also hear how David and David's army fought against the Syrians again, and about the result of David's victory.

The Syrians fought against the army of Israel because the Ammonites hired the Syrians for the first battle. As for the second battle, the Syrians gathered the Syrians from other regions to fight against the army of Israel again because they had lost the first battle against the army of Israel.

The events in this story happened very soon after the army of Ammonites came out of their city to fight against the army of Israel. During that time, the Syrians prepared to fight the army of Israel on a different front. The first battle in this story happened near the Ammonite city of Rabbah, and the second battle happened on the east side of the river Jordan.

Joab realizes that he would have to fight at the front and behind at the same time because the Ammonite army is at the entrance to their city of Rabbah, and the Syrian army is in the open country around the city. So, Joab selects the best fighters of the army of Israel and arranges them in battle positions to fight against Aram. You will remember that Aram refers to the Syrians, who are the people from the place called Syria.

Joab puts the rest of the men under the command of Abishai, his brother, and Joab arranges them in battle positions to fight against the Ammonites.

Joab tells Abishai that if the Syrians are too strong for Joab, then Abishai will rescue Joab. But if the Ammonites are too strong for Abishai, then Joab will rescue Abishai.

Joab tells Abishai to be strong and to be courageous for their people, the Israelites, and the cities of their God. "The cities of our God" probably refers to cities to the south on the east side of the Jordan River, where the Israelites worshiped Yahweh. It is possible, but less likely, that "the cities of our God" refers to Israelite cities in general.

Joab also says that he is willing to accept whatever turns out to be the will of Yahweh.

Then, Joab and the troops with Joab move forward to fight the Syrians, and the Syrians run away from Joab.

When the Ammonites see that the Syrians are running away from Joab and Joab's soldiers, the Ammonites also run away from Joab's brother, Abishai, and go back inside the city. Then Joab comes back to Jerusalem.

But when the Syrians realize that the Israelites have defeated them, the Syrians send messengers to get other Syrians to come from beyond the Euphrates River, with Shophach, the commander of Hadadezer's army, as their leader. Hadadezer was the king of the city called Zobah. You will remember that Zobah was one of the independent cities in Syria.

We may be surprised by these actions of the Syrians. We may have expected that after the Israelite army had defeated the Syrians and the Ammonites, the Syrians would surrender.

When someone tells David what the Syrians are doing, David himself comes and gathers the army of Israel and crosses the Jordan River.

Stop here and look at a map of the Jordan River and the Euphrates River as a group. Pause this audio here.

David comes to the Syrians and arranges his soldiers in battle positions against the Syrians. When David arranges his soldiers in battle positions against the Syrians, the Syrians fight against David.

But the Syrians run away from the army of Israel, and David's army kills 7,000 of their chariots and 40,000 of their foot soldiers. David also kills Shophach, the commander of the Syrian army.

We do not know the meaning of "7,000 chariots" for sure. It may refer to "7,000 chariot drivers" or "7,000 men from chariot teams." Chariots of Syria at that time were light vehicles with two wheels and six or eight spokes on each wheel. The body of the chariot had a front and two sides that came to about mid-thigh level and had an open back. People used iron to strengthen the rims of the wheels. During the earliest time, two horses pulled the chariots, but later teams of three or four horses pulled the chariots. These chariots usually had two men: the driver and an archer with bows and arrows. Sometimes there was also a shield-bearer.

When the servants or supporters of Hadadezer realize that the Israelites have defeated the Syrians, they make peace with David and become servants to David. In other words, the servants of Hadadezer live under the authority of David and his kingdom. So the Syrians are not willing to help the Ammonites again.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about your country's history and tell a story about a time when neighboring countries chose not to fight against your country because they saw that your country had won a battle against someone else. Pause this audio here.

When the servants of Hadadezer made peace with David, they accepted the terms of peace that David demanded and agreed to be under David's rule and serve David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your country, what are the things people have to do or choose to do for the winner after they lose a battle against the winner?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 19:10–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Joab realizes that he has to fight the battle at the front and behind at the same time. So, Joab prepares to fight the Syrians and puts the rest of the soldiers under his brother's command to fight the Ammonites. Then, Joab encourages his brother, and Joab starts to fight the Syrians. The Syrians run away from Joab and Joab's troops, and the Ammonites also run away from Abishai and Abishai's troops. Then, Joab returns to Jerusalem.

In the second scene: The Syrians send messengers to get other Syrians in order to fight against David and David's army.

In the third scene: David learns about what the Syrians are doing. So, David gathers all of David's fighting men of Israel to come and fight against the Syrians. The Syrians run away from David and David's army. David's army kills many chariot drivers and foot soldiers of the Syrian army.

In the fourth scene: When the servants of Hadadezer learn that the Israelites have defeated the Syrians, they make peace with David and become David's servants.

The characters in this passage are:

- Joab
- Troops who fight with Joab
- Abishai
- Troops who fight with Abishai
- The Syrian army
- The Ammonite army
- Someone who tells David what the Syrians are doing
- David
- Syrian messengers who call Hadadezer's army to fight
- Shophach, the commander of Hadadezer's army
- The Syrian army under Shophach
- And servants of Hadadezer

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This story is very similar to the story in 2 Samuel 10:1–19.

Stop here and listen to your translation of 2 Samuel 10:1–19, if you have already translated this passage. Pause this audio here.

In scene one, Joab realizes that he would have to fight at the front and behind at the same time, because the Ammonites are in front of their city, and the Arameans, or Syrians, are out in the open fields around the city. So, Joab selects the best fighters of the army of Israel and arranges them in battle positions to fight against the Syrians. Joab puts the rest of the men under the command of Abishai, his brother, and Joab arranges them in battle positions to fight against the Ammonites. Joab tells Abishai that if the Syrians are too strong for Joab, then Abishai shall help Joab, but if the Ammonites are too strong for Abishai, then Joab shall help Abishai. Joab tells Abishai to be strong and to be courageous for the Israelites and the cities of their God. Joab also says, "May Yahweh do what is good in Yahweh's eyes." Joab is saying that he is willing to accept whatever turns out to be the will of Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your translation, how will you translate Joab's words, "May Yahweh do what is good in Yahweh's eyes?" Pause this audio here.

Now, the storyteller tells what Joab did next right after Joab talked to Abishai. Joab and the troops with Joab move forward to fight the Syrians, and the Syrians run away before Joab.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your translation, what word or phrase will you use to introduce what Joab did immediately after he talked to Abishai? Pause this audio here.

Even though the storyteller mentioned only Joab's name, both Joab and Joab's army fought against the Syrians, and the Syrians ran away from them. When the Ammonites see that the Syrians are running away from Joab and Joab's soldiers, the Ammonites also run away from Joab's brother, Abishai, and go back inside their city. Then Joab comes back to Jerusalem.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your translation, what word or phrase will you use to show the transition from the battle scene to Joab's return to Jerusalem? Pause this audio here.

In scene two, when the Syrians realize that the Israelites have defeated them, the Syrians send messengers to get other Syrians from beyond the Euphrates River. Shophach, the commander of Hadadezer's army, comes with Hadadezer's army.

We may not expect the Syrians to want to continue fighting. Usually, an army would surrender when another army defeats that army.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your translation, how would you introduce the actions of the Syrians if their actions are different from what the listener expects? What word or phrase would you use to introduce the actions of the Syrians? Pause this audio here.

"Beyond the Euphrates River" refers to the east side of the Euphrates River from the point of view of a person located in Israel.

In scene three, when someone tells David what the Syrians are doing, David gathers all the fighting troops of Israel, and they cross the Jordan. David comes to the Syrians and arranges his soldiers in battle positions against the Syrians. Then the Syrians fight against David. Even though the storyteller mentions only David's name here and in the rest of the story many times, we know that both David and David's army fought against the Syrians.

But the Syrians run away from the army of Israel, and David kills 7,000 of their chariots and 40,000 of their foot soldiers. Here, the storyteller is saying that even though the Syrians attacked first, the Syrians ran away from David's army.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your translation, what word or phrase would you use to describe the fact that even though the Syrians attacked first, the Syrians ran away from David's army? Pause this audio here.

We do not know the meaning of "7,000 chariots" for sure. It may refer to "7,000 chariot drivers" or "7,000 men from chariot teams." Both interpretations are possible.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What translation do you want to use for "7,000 chariots"? Pause this audio here.

David also kills Shophach, the commander of the Syrian army.

In scene four, when the servants or supporters of Hadadezer realize that the Israelites have defeated the Syrians, they make peace with David and become David's servants. So the Syrians are not willing to help the Ammonites again. "Make peace" means that the servants or supporters of Hadadezer accepted the terms for peace that David's army demanded.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture or history, what did weak nations do in order to be able to live in peace with a strong or a victorious nation that just won a great battle? How would you describe what the weak nations did? Pause this audio here.

"Servants of Hadadezer" are of high status, and they are not like household servants. You can also call these people "followers" or "supporters" of Hadadezer.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when a group of people became servants of another group. What word or phrase did you use to describe these servants? Pause this audio here.

At the end of scene four, the storyteller says that the Syrians are not willing to help the Ammonites again.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your translation, how will you describe the storyteller's final statement about how the Syrians are unwilling to help the Ammonites again? What word or phrase would you

use to describe the transition from the actions of Hadadezer's servants to the storyteller's final statement? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text
Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 19:10–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Joab
- Troops who fight with Joab
- Abishai
- Troops who fight with Abishai
- The Syrian army
- The Ammonite army
- Someone who tells David what the Syrians are doing
- David
- Syrian messengers who call Hadadezer's army to fight
- Shophach, the commander of Hadadezer's army
- The Syrian army under Shophach
- And servants of Hadadezer

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In scene one, Joab realizes that he would have to fight in the front and behind at the same time. So, Joab selects the best fighters of the army of Israel and arranges them in battle positions to fight against Aram, the Syrians. Joab puts the rest of the men under the command of Abishai, his brother, and Joab arranges them in battle positions to fight against the Ammonites. Joab tells Abishai that if the Arameans or Syrians are too strong for Joab, then Abishai shall help Joab, but if the Ammonites are too strong for Abishai, then Joab shall help Abishai. Joab tells Abishai to be strong and courageous for the Israelites and the cities of their God. Joab also says, "May Yahweh do what is good in Yahweh's sight." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Joab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am concerned for my soldiers; or
- I am very nervous as unexpected things can happen during a battle; or
- I will fight with the best of my ability to be a good example for my soldiers.

Ask the person playing Abishai, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We cannot lose. We are the only ones who can stop the Syrian army from destroying the nation of Israel; or
- I will trust Yahweh to make us win this battle; or

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- I am very nervous as the enemies are on both sides of the army of Israel.

Continue the drama. Then, Joab and the troops with Joab move forward to fight the Syrians, and the Syrians flee before Joab. When the Ammonites see that the Syrians are running away from Joab and Joab's soldiers, the Ammonites also run away from Joab's brother, Abishai, and go back inside the city. Then Joab comes back to Jerusalem. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Joab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad for the soldiers who died during the battle, but I am happy that we won the battle; or
- I am thankful to Yahweh that he let me go home safely to my family; or
- I am very proud of the army I lead.

Ask the person playing Abishai, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am very proud to fight with my brother, Joab; or
- I am very happy to go home; or
- I thank Yahweh a lot for this victory.

Continue the drama. In scene two, when the Syrians realize that the Israelites have defeated them, the Syrians send messengers to get other Syrians from beyond the Euphrates River, with Shophach, the commander of Hadadezer's army, as their leader.

In scene three, when someone tells David what the Syrians are doing, David gathers all the fighting troops of Israel and crosses the Jordan. David comes to the Syrians and arranges his soldiers in battle positions against the Syrians. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am determined to defend the nation of Israel; or
- I feel stressed as I am responsible to lead the army of Israel; or
- I will need to figure out ways to defeat the Syrians together with my military leaders.

Continue the drama. When David arranges his soldiers in battle positions against the Syrians, the Syrians fight against David. But the Syrians run away before the army of Israel, and David kills 7,000 of their chariot drivers and 40,000 of their foot soldiers. David also kills Shophach, the commander of the Syrian army.

In scene four, when the servants of Hadadezer realize that the Israelites have defeated the Syrians, they make peace with David and become David's servants. So the Syrians are not willing to help the Ammonites again. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing one of the servants of Hadadezer, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I will do everything in my power to protect my family and country; or
- I am afraid to fight against David and David's army; or
- I want to have King David's protection.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 19:10–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Arameans are people from Syria who people also call **Syrians**. Use the same word or phrase for "Arameans" or "Syrians" as you used in previous passages.

Use the same word or phrase for **God** and **Yahweh** as you used in previous passages. For more information on God and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

A **city** is a large town with a wall around it. Use the same word for city as you have used in previous passages.

Chariots in Syria at that time were light vehicles with two wheels and six or eight spokes on each wheel. Use the same word or phrase for chariot as you used in previous passages.

Shophach is the **military commander** of Hadadezer's army. Use the same word for a military commander as you have used in previous passages.

In this story, the **servants** of Hadadezer were more like supporters of the king Hadadezer. For more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary. Because these people were not household servants, you may need to call these people Hadadezer's followers or supporters.

In this story, "make **peace**" means that the servants or supporters of Hadadezer surrendered and stopped fighting David's army. These people became David's servants. For more information on peace, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 19:10–19

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (751 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 20:1–3

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 20:1–3 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 20:1–3 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1 Chronicles 20:1–3

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 20:1–3 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, King David's army defeated the Aramean, or Syrian, army, so that the Syrian army could no longer help the Ammonites. In this story, Joab leads the Israelite army to attack the Ammonites. Joab besieges Rabbah and defeats the city. King David comes and takes the crown of Ammon and makes the Ammonite people become David's slaves. Then David returns to Jerusalem with his army.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and Ammon as a group. Pay close attention to the location of Jerusalem and Rabbah. Pause this audio here.

Joab was David's top military commander. In a previous story, David sent Joab to lead the army in a battle against the Ammonites. In this story, Joab is in charge of the same task again while David stays in Jerusalem. This happens in the spring of the year, a time when kings normally go to war. In Israel, spring is the time of year after the rainy season has ended. During the rainy season, the ground would become muddy, and the soldiers would have a difficult time traveling, so most kings would wait until the rains were over before they would send an army out to fight.

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: Name some activities that, in your country, you only do during a specific season of the year. What are the reasons why you only do those activities during that time of year? Name some other activities that most people would never do during a particular season of the year. What are the reasons why you would never do those activities during that time of year? Pause this audio here.

Joab leads a siege of Rabbah, the capital city of Ammon. This means that the Israelite army surrounded the city of Rabbah and prevented the people inside from coming out. The people inside Rabbah could not get outside the city to get food, and once their food supplies ran out, they would starve to death. Joab only needed to wait outside the city to attack any Ammonite soldiers who tried to get out, or for the people inside the city to give up.

Stop here and tell a story about a military battle. If you know a story about an army that is surrounded or trapped in a place where they cannot escape and cannot get food, that would be the best story to tell. Pause this audio here.

After some time, Joab was able to get his army inside the walls of Rabbah and overthrow the city. Then King David left Jerusalem and came to Rabbah. David took the crown of the king of the Ammonites. In most societies with a king, the king wears special clothes and special jewelry to show that he is the king. A crown is a special piece of jewelry. The king wore a crown on top of his head, like a hat. Only the king can wear the crown. People used expensive materials like gold and precious stones to make crowns. The size and value of the crown showed that the person who wore the crown was a wealthy and powerful person. A crown is also a symbol of authority. King Saul had a crown, and a messenger brought this crown to David after Saul died.

Stop here and look at a picture of a crown. Pause this audio here.

The Ammonites had made their king's crown with gold and precious stones. This crown weighed 34 kilograms, which means it was unusually large. The storyteller tells us that David put this crown on his head, which symbolized that David now had power over the Ammonites and over their land.

Stop here and discuss this question: In your culture, how do the leaders show that they are leaders? How do those in power show that they have power? If one person takes power away from another person, does that person do anything to show they now have power? Pause this audio here.

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David brings two things out of the city of Rabbah: plunder and people. Plunder refers to material goods that once belonged to the people who lived in Rabbah. These things probably included food, clothing, animals, and materials like wood or stone. King David took these things in order to make his own people richer and also to make the Ammonites too weak to fight back.

David also brought out the Ammonite people from inside the city of Rabbah and made them do hard physical work. It was a common practice at that time for people who won a battle to make the people they had conquered become their slaves. David probably made the Ammonites do work like sawing wood, digging in the ground, and cutting stone. The storyteller says that David did this to all of the Ammonite people, not just the people who lived in Rabbah. Bible scholars believe that after the war with Ammon, David needed laborers to rebuild the damaged and destroyed structures throughout the country. David probably used the Ammonite people to do this rebuilding. Finally, David and his army returned to Jerusalem.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 20:1–3 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Joab leads the Israelite army and attacks the Ammonites while David stays in Jerusalem. Joab fights against the Ammonites and attacks their capital city, Rabbah.

In the second scene: David comes to Rabbah and takes the crown of the Ammonites. David takes plunder, or material goods, out of Rabbah and makes the Ammonite people into slaves. Then David returns to Jerusalem with his army.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Joab
- Israelite soldiers
- Ammonite soldiers
- And the Ammonite people

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Joab and the Israelite army march out to fight against the Ammonites. This part of the story is also in the beginning of 2 Samuel chapter 11. If you have already translated 2 Samuel, it would be helpful to go back and listen to the very beginning of chapter 11 to remind yourselves how you translated it.

Stop here and listen to the first part of the story in 2 Samuel chapter 11. Listen for any ways that the story in 2 Samuel is a little different from the story in 1 Chronicles. Pause this audio here.

Joab leads the Israelite army to Ammon in "the spring of the year," which refers to March or April according to the modern calendar. This time of year is also shortly after the new year or the first month of the year, according to the Hebrew calendar. This time of year comes after the cold season, when temperatures begin to warm again. The storyteller says that "the spring of the year" is the time that kings normally go off to war. In the Middle East, most of the rain falls from November to February. During this time, the land becomes muddy, and it is difficult to travel. This is not a good time for the army to go out and fight, so a king or military leader usually waited until after the rains ended to send the army into battle.

Stop here and discuss how your team will translate this phrase for this time of year. Pause the audio here.

But this time, when it is time to go fight, Joab leads the Israelite army to fight the Ammonites, while King David stays in Jerusalem. Joab and the army ravage the country, which means they cause a great deal of damage and destruction. Joab and the army probably cause severe damage or even completely destroy villages, farms, roadways, bridges, waterways, or other structures that you might find in the land.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will describe what Joab did to the country of the Ammonites. Pause this audio here.

It is only after this that Joab and the army attack the capital city, Rabbah. When the Israelite army besieges Rabbah, it means that after the Israelite army fights against the Ammonites, the Ammonite survivors go inside the walls of Rabbah and close all the entrances to prevent the Israelite army from entering the city. Then the Israelite army surrounds Rabbah and waits for the people inside to begin to starve. The Israelite army hopes that the Ammonites will give up, or that the defenders of the city will become so weak from lack of food that the Israelites can defeat the Ammonites easily.

Stop here and discuss how you will describe the siege of Rabbah. Pause the audio here.

Joab succeeds and conquers Rabbah. The king of the Ammonites is probably inside Rabbah, so when the Israelites conquer the city, it means the Israelites conquer all the Ammonite people.

In the second scene, King David leaves Jerusalem and comes to Rabbah. You can listen to this part of the story at the end of 2 Samuel chapter 12. If you have already translated 2 Samuel, it would be helpful to go back and listen to the last part of chapter 12 to remind you of how you translated it.

Stop here and listen to the end of 2 Samuel chapter 12. Listen for any ways that the story in 2 Samuel is a little different from the story in 1 Chronicles. Pause this audio here.

When King David comes to Rabbah, David takes a crown from the Ammonites. Bible scholars disagree as to whether this crown belonged to the King of Ammon or if it was a decoration on the head of an idol that represented the Ammonite god Molech. The reason for this disagreement is that the name “Molech” and the word “king” are very similar in the Hebrew language. Although the king is usually the one who wears the crown, this crown weighed 34 kilograms. This crown was probably too heavy for a person to wear on his head. It would make more sense if the crown were on the head of an idol.

Stop here and find an object that weighs around 34 kilograms. See if someone can lift that object and transfer its weight to the head of a person. Be careful not to hurt that person! After you complete this activity, do you think David was able to put the 34-kilogram crown on his head? Pause this audio here.

Regardless of who the crown originally belonged to, the symbolism was the same. When David puts the crown on his head, it shows that David has defeated the Ammonites.

Stop here and discuss whether you will translate this phrase to mean that David took the crown from the King of Ammon or that David took the crown from Molech. Pause the audio here.

It is also not clear whether David puts the entire Ammonite crown on his head, or whether David takes a jewel out of the crown and puts the jewel into David’s own crown. Since the entire crown weighs 34 kilograms, it would be difficult, or maybe even dangerous, for David to put the crown on his head. Many Bible scholars think that it makes more sense for David to take the jewel out of the Ammonite crown and put it in David’s own crown.

Stop here and discuss whether you will translate this sentence to mean that David put the entire Ammonite crown on his head, or that David took a jewel out of the Ammonite crown and put it in his own crown. Pause this audio here.

David takes plunder out of Rabbah. This means that after David conquers the city, David and the Israelite army take many valuable goods with them. This was common practice after a military leader conquered a city or settlement. As the soldiers went through the city, they would take any items they considered valuable out of homes or shops. This does not necessarily mean that David personally goes through the city and takes all the valuable goods for himself. It is more likely that David tells his military commanders to go through the city and bring valuable goods back to Israel.

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: In your language, how do you talk about a situation where a leader gives an order and then his followers do what he says? Who gets the credit or blame for that situation? Pause this audio here.

David not only makes the people of Rabbah slaves, but David also made slaves of all the people who live in all the other Ammonite towns. David makes the people do hard physical labor using different kinds of tools. The tools

the storyteller mentions here are probably different kinds of tools that people use for cutting wood, digging in the ground, or shaping stone for use in buildings, walls, and other structures. The storyteller names three kinds of tools that the Ammonite people used during their hard labor.

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: Talk about the tools that you use to cut wood, to chisel stone, and to dig. Think of as many different words as you can in your language for these kinds of tools. Pause this audio here.

Finally, David goes back to Jerusalem. When it says that "all the people" went with David, this does not mean that every single Israelite and every single Ammonite went with him. David probably took most of his army, but left a few soldiers behind to oversee the slaves that worked in Ammon. It is possible that David might have taken some Ammonite people with him back to Israel, but David also needed those Ammonite slaves to stay in Ammon and to do physical labor and produce goods for David. So when the storyteller says that "all the people" went with David, this is just a quick way to say that the war was over and most of the Israelite army left Ammon.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 20:1–3 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Joab
- Israelite soldiers
- Ammonite soldiers
- And the Ammonite people

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Joab led the Israelite army to Ammon and attacked the Ammonites, while King David remained in Jerusalem. Joab destroyed the country and besieged Rabbah. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Joab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I cannot wait to finally defeat the Ammonites; or
- I hope that this time we will finally be successful; or
- I really want to show King David that he can count on me to win battles for him.

Ask the people playing the Israelite soldiers "What are you feeling or thinking?" They might answer things like:

- I hope we can end this war quickly; or
- I am angry at the Ammonites and want to attack them; or
- I hope that I do not die in this war!

Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I trust Joab and know he will get the job done; or
- I am so mad at the King of Ammon for how he treated my messengers! or
- It will be very good for our country to get the resources that the Ammonites have.

Ask the people playing the Ammonite soldiers, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I do not know if we can win this battle by ourselves; or
- I am afraid because we are probably going to lose this war; or
- I am angry that we have to fight against David’s army because our king was disrespectful to David.

Continue the drama. Joab defeated Rabbah, and King David came to the city. David took the crown of the Ammonites and wore it himself. David took valuable goods out of the city of Rabbah and made the Ammonite people do hard physical labor. Then David and the army went back to Jerusalem. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Joab, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am very pleased that we had such a successful campaign! or
- I am glad the war is over, and that I can go back home; or
- I am excited that we got so many valuable things from Rabbah.

Ask the people playing the Israelite soldiers, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I am so happy we won! or
- I am excited to take all this plunder back to Israel; or
- I am glad that our king now controls the territory of the Ammonites; or
- I am relieved that I can finally go home and see my family.

Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am pleased that Joab and our army did such a good job; or
- I can relax now that I have avenged the wrong that the King of Ammon did to me; or
- I am happy that we got so much good plunder from Rabbah; or
- Now we have to figure out how to keep this territory under control.

Ask the people playing the Ammonite people, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I am depressed because many of my people are dead, and now I am a slave; or
- I am angry that the Israelites have taken over my country; or
- I am afraid of what may happen to my children and my country. Will things ever go back to the way they were?

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 20:1–3 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Before you begin this step, remember that you can listen to part of this story at the beginning of 2 Samuel chapter 11. If you have already translated 2 Samuel, it would be helpful to go back and listen to the very beginning of chapter 11 to remind you of how you translated it.

Stop here and listen to the first few sentences of 2 Samuel chapter 11. Pay attention to how you translated any key terms. Pause this audio here.

This story begins in the spring, a time when **kings** normally go out to battle. Use the same word for king as you have used in previous passages, and remember that king is in the Master Glossary.

When Joab came to the capital city, Rabbah, he besieged it. A siege happens when an army surrounds a city and traps all the people inside so that they cannot come out and get food, water, or other supplies.

1 Chronicles 20:1–3

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the word "**siege**." See the word siege in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have used this word before in other books of the Bible, be sure to translate it in the same way that you did there. Pause this audio here.

Joab overthrew Rabbah, and then King David came to the city. You can listen to this part of the story in 2 Samuel at the end of chapter 12. If you have already translated 2 Samuel, it would be helpful to go back and listen again to this part of the story in chapter 12.

Stop here and listen to the end of 2 Samuel chapter 12. Pay attention to how you translated any key terms. Pause this audio here.

David symbolized his victory over the Ammonites by taking their crown and wearing it himself. A crown is a valuable piece of jewelry that the king wears on his head. People made crowns of gold and valuable stones, and a crown showed that the person who wore it was rich and powerful.

Stop here and look at a picture of a crown. Decide how you will translate the word **crown**. If you have translated this word in another book of the Bible, be sure to translate it the same way here. Pause this audio here.

David brought out a large amount of plunder from the city of Rabbah. Plunder is valuable goods that an army that conquers takes from the people it has conquered. This might include food, clothes, livestock, or materials like wood or stone.

Stop here and discuss what word you will use for **plunder**. If you have translated this word in another book of the Bible, make sure to translate it the same way here as you did there. Pause this audio here.

David gathered the Ammonites who survived and made them work as slaves. David made the people work with three different kinds of tools: saws, iron picks, and iron axes. People use saws to cut wood. People made saws out of metal. Saws have sharp points on them to help cut through the wood. One person could operate a smaller saw, but a larger saw might require two people to use it. The tool mentioned here could also be used to cut stone.

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the word "**saw**." Pause this audio here.

"Iron picks" means an iron tool that was sharp and could cut other things. We do not know if this was a large tool or a small tool. People could use a tool like an iron pick to work with stone. "Iron axes" refers to an iron tool that could cut wood or other things. Bible scholars are not sure what the difference is between an "iron pick" and an "iron axe." The most important details are that people made these tools out of iron and used them to cut other things.

Stop here and discuss how you will translate "**iron picks**" and "**iron axes**."

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 20:1–3

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (833 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Chronicles 20:4–8

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 20:4–8 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 20:4–8 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 20:4–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, King David's army defeated and captured the people of the town of Rabbah. This story is about several battles that King David's army fights against the Philistines. Three of David's men defeat strong, tall Philistines, and the Israelite army defeats the Philistine army.

Some time after the previous story, the Philistines and Israelites fight a battle at the town of Gezer. Gezer is a Philistine town about 32 kilometers away from the Israelites' capital city of Jerusalem. The city of Gezer is in an area of low hills where the Israelites and Philistines would often fight. During this battle, one of David's strong warriors fights a strong Philistine. This warrior who fights for David is Sibbecai. Sibbecai is a Hushathite. Descendants of a man named Hushah live in a town called Hushah in Judah. So this could mean that Sibbecai is from the Hushathite clan or from the Hushathite town "Hushah." Sibbecai is one of the mighty men of David's army.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and Philistia as a group. Find the cities of Jerusalem and Gezer. Pause this audio here.

Sibbecai kills Sippai, a Philistine. Sippai is a descendant of the Rephaites. The Rephaites were descendants of Rapha. The Rephaites were very tall and strong, so some people called them giants. Sometimes, people would call any tall person a Rephaite or a giant. When the Israelites first came to the land of Canaan, the Israelites

killed most of the Rephaites. The only Rephaites who remained lived in the Philistine cities of Gaza, Gath, and Ashdod.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are some common features that people groups in your area have? Perhaps the people from one group are often tall, or people from another group are very good farmers. If you heard someone was from one of those people groups, what would you assume about that person? Pause this audio here.

The Israelites defeat the Philistines in this battle. Some translations say that the Israelites make the Philistines serve the Israelites as slaves.

Later, during another battle with the Philistines, another of David's strong warriors kills another giant or tall Philistine. This warrior who fights for David is Elhanan, Jair's son. Elhanan kills a Philistine named Lahmi. Lahmi is the brother of Goliath. Goliath was the giant that David killed before David became king. Both Lahmi and Goliath are Gittites, which means these men lived in the Philistine city of Gath.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and Philistia as a group. Find the city of Gath. Pause this audio here.

Lahmi had a very impressive spear. A spear is a long, straight rod with a sharp end. Soldiers would thrust this weapon at an enemy. Normally, the rod would be large enough for a man to hold comfortably in his grip. The storyteller says the rod of this spear was like a weaver's rod.

A weaver is a person who makes cloth on a loom. In this time, a loom had two long posts in the ground with a beam or rod across them. The storyteller could mean that the spear was very thick, like this beam, because Lahmi's hands were so large and Lahmi would need a larger rod to hold comfortably in his hand. But this could also mean that there was a loop of cord at the end of the spear to help Lahmi throw the spear. This looked like the rod with a loop of cord that weavers would use to lift threads on a loom. Either way, this is an unusual and impressive weapon.

Stop here and look at a picture of a spear as a group. What weapons do you have in your culture that look like this spear? What would be a very impressive weapon in your culture? Pause this audio here.

Later, the Israelites fight another battle with the Philistines near the Philistine city of Gath.

Another tall Philistine challenges and insults the Israelites. The storyteller does not include what the Philistine says, but the Philistine probably says that the God of Israel could not protect the Israelites. This Philistine was an unusual man who had six fingers on each hand and six toes on each foot. This Philistine is also a descendant of Rapha. This time, David's nephew Jonathan kills this Philistine. Jonathan is the son of David's brother Shimea.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people think about a person whose body looks different than other people's bodies, such as someone with an extra finger, or someone who is much taller than most people? Pause this audio here.

David and his army defeat and kill these three Philistines from Gath. Remember that a few passages ago, the storyteller said that Yahweh caused David to win wherever David went. The storyteller does not specifically mention God, but these stories show how God helped David and David's people win.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 20:4–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The Israelites fight against the Philistines. During a battle, the Israelite warrior Sibbecai kills the Philistine Sippai. The Israelites defeat the Philistines.

In the second scene: During another battle with the Philistines, the Israelite warrior Elhanan kills the Philistine Lahmi.

In the third scene: During another battle with the Philistines, the Israelite warrior Jonathan kills the Philistine man with six fingers on each hand.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller summarizes the story when he says that David and the Israelites defeat these giant men from Gath.

The characters in this passage are:

- The Philistine army
- The Israelite army
- Sibbecai the Hushathite
- Sippai the Philistine
- The Rephaites or giant people
- Elhanan, son of Jair
- Lahmi the Gittite, whose brother is Goliath
- The Philistine with six fingers on each hand
- Jonathan, son of David's brother Shimea
- And David

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This section gives brief summaries of battles the Israelites fight with the Philistines. This part of the story is also at the end of 2 Samuel 21:18–22. If you have already translated 2 Samuel, you can go back and listen to the end of chapter 21 to remember how you translated it. Some of the names here sound a little different than in the 2 Samuel story.

Stop here and listen to the last part of the story in 2 Samuel 21:18–22. Listen for any ways that the story in 2 Samuel is a little different from the story in 1 Chronicles. Pause this audio here.

This story has three battles. In each battle, a different Israelite warrior fights and kills a Philistine warrior. The story is about the warriors, so the storyteller does not include a lot of other information about the battles. The storyteller does not even mention who wins two of the battles. Instead, the storyteller focuses on how Israelite warriors defeat three Philistines who were descendants of Rephaites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about something that happened three times in your people's history. Briefly tell the others in the group about these three events. Discuss how you chose to focus on the event that happened three times. Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, the Israelite army fights a battle against the Philistine army. The two armies fight at the town of Gezer. During this battle, one of David's warriors, Sibbecai, kills the tall and strong Sippai. The Israelites win this battle against the Philistines. The Israelite army may return home after this battle.

The second scene happens some time after the first battle. Again, the Israelites fight a battle against the Philistines. It is not clear where this battle happened. During this battle, one of the Israelites, Elhanan, kills the tall Philistine Lahmi. Lahmi is Goliath's brother. Lahmi has a big spear. Though the storyteller does not mention it, the Israelites probably win this battle too.

The third scene again happens some time after the second battle. Again, the Israelites fight a battle against the Philistines, this time near the city of Gath. During this battle, one of the Philistines taunts or insults the Israelites. This Philistine has six fingers on each hand and six toes on each foot. The storyteller does not tell us this Philistine's name. David's nephew, Jonathan, kills this tall and strong Philistine. Again, though the storyteller does not mention it, the Israelites probably win this battle.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you talk about warriors and how they defeated their enemies? What information do you include about the warriors? Pause this audio here.

The last scene is a summary of how David's warriors killed the Philistines. All three of these Philistine warriors are tall and strong men who are descendants of the Rephaites. These three Philistines are all from the Philistine city of Gath. The storyteller says the Philistines fall at the hands of David and David's men. This means that David and his men kill these Philistines.

We are not sure if David actually led his warriors into these battles. The storyteller probably says that "David and his men" defeat the Philistines because David is the king and is responsible for what his army does.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: List some things that your leaders or leaders in your area have done or decisions those leaders have made. Discuss whether the leader was able to do those things by themselves or if they had other people help them. How do you talk about things that the leader and his people do while the leader rules, even if the leader does not directly do the action himself? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 20:4–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The Philistine army
- The Israelite army
- Sibbecai the Hushathite
- Sippai the Philistine
- The Rephaites or giant people
- Elhanan, son of Jair
- Lahmi the Gittite, whose brother is Goliath
- The Philistine with six fingers on each hand
- Jonathan, son of David's brother Shimea
- And David

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Some time later, the Israelites fought a battle against the Philistines at Gezer. In this battle, Sibbecai the Hushathite killed a giant named Sippai. Sippai was a descendant of a giant called Rapha. The Israelites won against the Philistines. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am amazed that we defeated the Philistines even though the Philistines had such a tall and strong warrior with them! or
- I am so glad that we defeated the Philistines! We can keep our people safe! or
- I saw how Sibbecai killed that huge Philistine. I am glad that Sibbecai is in our army!

Continue the drama. During another battle with the Philistines, Jair's son Elhanan killed Lahmi. Lahmi was the brother of Goliath from Gath. Lahmi had a spear that was very thick and heavy. The spear's handle was as large as the piece of wood that people use to make cloth. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Elhanan, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I could see that Lahmi was a strong warrior with a dangerous weapon. I knew it would be a hard fight, but I also knew that Yahweh would help me win; or
- This man I killed was the brother of Goliath. I am proud that I killed a giant like our king David did; or
- I want to protect my people, so I will fight even dangerous enemies like Lahmi.

Continue the drama. In yet another battle at Gath, the Israelites fought against a very large Philistine. This Philistine had six fingers on each hand and six toes on each foot, so he had 12 fingers and 12 toes. He, too, was a descendant of Rapha. This Philistine shouted insults at the Israelites. So Jonathan killed this Philistine. Jonathan was the son of David's brother Shimea. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Philistine with six fingers on each hand, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so big and strong that no one can defeat me; or
- I do not care about the Israelites or their god. I am better than any Israelite warrior; or
- I will taunt the Israelites and make them nervous before we fight. Perhaps that will help us win.

Ask the person playing Jonathan, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I felt a little nervous when I saw how large this man was, but I would not let him continue to say these insults about us; or
- I was angry when I heard what this Philistine said; or
- I was not worried about the way this Philistine spoke. I knew with Yahweh's help we would be able to defeat this man and his fellow Philistines.

Continue the drama. These Philistine men were sons of the giants from the town of Gath. David and his warriors killed these Philistines. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Philistines, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am amazed that the Israelites continue to defeat us, even though we have such tall and strong warriors! or
- Surely the Israelites' God helps them win these battles; or
- I feel discouraged that we have lost so many battles.

Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so thankful that Yahweh has caused the Israelites to win so many battles! I know we could not have done this without Yahweh's help; or
- I am honored that such strong warriors chose to defend me and the other Israelites; or
- Even if the Philistines chose to attack again, I am not worried. Yahweh will help us win.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 20:4–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

These Philistine warriors are **descendants** of the Rephaites. A person's descendants are his children, grandchildren, and all future generations from the same family line. The Rephaites were tall people, or giants. For more information on descendants, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for descendants as you used in previous passages.

Lahmi the Philistine has a very impressive **spear**. A spear is a long, straight rod with a sharp end. People normally made spears out of wood with a metal tip. A spear was usually as long as a man was tall, and a man could wrap his hand around the rod of a spear. Usually, people thrust a spear at an enemy, but occasionally they would throw a spear. Use the same word or phrase for spear as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a spear again as a group as needed. Pause this audio here.

This spear was like a weaver's rod. A weaver is someone who crosses threads over and under each other on a loom to make cloth. The weaver's rod could be a thick beam on their loom or a piece of wood with a loop of cord at the end.

Stop here and look at a picture of a weaver's rod as a group. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **weaver's rod**. Use the same word or phrase you used for weaver's rod in 1 Chronicles 11:23. Pause this audio here.

The Philistine with six fingers challenged and insulted **Israel**, which means that he mocked the people of Israel. Use the same word for Israel as you have used previously, and see the Master Glossary for more information about Israel.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 20:4–8

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (861 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

1 Chronicles 21:1–6

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 21:1–6 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:1–6 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 21:1–6

3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:1–6 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, David was at war with the Philistines. The storyteller listed the different victories that David's soldiers won over very strong enemies. Now, the storyteller begins to tell about a new event that happened during David's reign as king. This is a similar story to 2 Samuel 24:1–9, but this story has some differences.

Stop here and listen to your story in 2 Samuel 24:1–9, if you have already translated it. Notice the differences between the way the storyteller tells the story in 2 Samuel and the way he tells it here. Pause this audio here.

In this story, the storyteller says it was Yahweh who caused David to take the census. The storyteller says that Satan rose up against, or brought trouble to, David and caused him to take a census of the people. The name Satan means adversary, and it is the name for the devil, the leader of all evil spirits. Satan tempts people to disobey Yahweh. It is likely that Yahweh permitted Satan to influence David to act in a way that displeased Yahweh. As a result, Yahweh is angry with his people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, when someone does something wrong, who or what do they usually blame? Talk about a time, in your culture, when someone blamed a spiritual being for influencing them to do something bad. Pause this audio here.

David orders Joab, the commander of Israel's army, and the other army commanders who were under Joab's authority, to take a census of the people of Israel. We know from 2 Samuel that this was a military census. Therefore, they only counted the number of fighting men in Israel. It is unclear why it was wrong in Yahweh's eyes to count the number of fighting men in the kingdom. Many scholars have suggested that the real sin was that David wanted recognition for being a successful king, and David did not trust that Yahweh would provide enough people.

David orders the men to go from Beersheba to Dan and count all of the fighting men in Israel. This means Joab would only count men who were physically able to serve in the military. From Beersheba to Dan was another way to say "go through all of Israel from one end to the other," since Dan was in the far north and Beersheba was in the far south of Israel. Once the commanders have counted the fighting men in Israel, David wants Joab to return and report the number to David.

Stop here and look as a group at a map of Dan and Beersheba in the territory of Israel. Pause this audio here.

Joab replies respectfully to King David, though he does not agree with David. Joab tells David that he, too, desires Yahweh, David's God, to increase David's army a hundred times over, or to largely increase the number of men. But Joab respectfully asks David, "Are the people not your servants already?" to imply that the people were already loyal and served David as their king. Joab does not approve of David's decision. Joab implies that to take the census will make Israel guilty in Yahweh's eyes because David is showing that he does not trust Yahweh.

But King David's word overruled Joab, which means that David did not change his mind and continued to firmly command that Joab take the census. So, Joab and his commanders left the king and followed David's order to begin to count the fighting men of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do government authorities respond when people question their decisions? Pause this audio here.

Joab traveled throughout all the land of Israel and counted the fighting men in each place that he visited. We do not know the exact route Joab took to count the Israelites. But at the end of his journey, Joab returned to Jerusalem to report the census numbers to David.

In total, Joab counted 1,100,000 fighting men, or men who drew the sword, in all of Israel, and 470,000 fighting men in Judah. We do not know if Judah is included in the total for all of Israel or if the 470,000 men are in addition

to the 1,100,000 fighting men. As you remember, the nation of Israel had two main territories. The southern part was called Judah, while the northern part was called Israel and included the territories of all the other tribes.

Stop here and look as a group at the map of Israel that shows Judah within the nation of Israel. Pause this audio here.

It is unclear why these numbers do not match the numbers the storyteller gave in 2 Samuel, but it is best to translate the numbers as the storyteller gives them in each story.

The storyteller says Joab did not count men from the tribes of Levi or Benjamin. Joab did not include the Levites because Yahweh told the Levites they did not have to fight in the army since they were devoted to caring for the tabernacle. Most likely, Joab did not count the men in Benjamin because at this time, the tabernacle was located in the territory of Benjamin at Gibeon. Joab did not count these tribes because Joab was deeply offended that David asked him to take the census. Joab knew that Yahweh would not be happy with the census.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Joab did not count the tribes of Levi and Benjamin because Joab was deeply offended that David had asked him to do something that Joab considered wrong. In your culture, what things would cause people to feel deeply offended if someone asked them to do those things?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:1–6 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Satan causes David to take a census of the people of Israel.

In the second scene: David calls in Joab and his military commanders. David orders these men to take a census, or count all the fighting men in Israel, from Beersheba to Dan. Joab respectfully disagrees with David. Joab says this thing will cause Israel to be guilty.

In the third scene: David insists on the census. Joab and the military commanders leave David and go to take the census. Joab travels throughout the land of Israel and Judah, but he does not count the fighting men in the tribes of Levi or Benjamin because Joab is deeply offended by the census.

In the fourth scene: Joab returns to Jerusalem to report the numbers of the census to David: there are 1,100,000 fighting men in Israel and 470,000 fighting men in Judah.

The characters in this passage are:

- Satan
- David
- Joab
- The military commanders
- And the people of Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Satan rose up against David. This does not mean Satan was sitting down and then stood up, but rather it is another way to say that Satan caused trouble for David. Satan does this by causing David to take a census of the people of Israel.

David calls for Joab and his army commanders and orders them to count all of Israel, "from Beersheba to Dan." It is important to note that "from Beersheba to Dan" was another way to say "all of the kingdom." This is because Dan was located in the far north, and Beersheba was located in the far south.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you translate "from Beersheba to Dan" in a way that means Joab counted the fighting men in the whole land? Be sure to use the same word or phrase you used in 2 Samuel 24:2 for the idea of the entire land of Israel from Beersheba to Dan. Pause this audio here.

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Because Joab was the commander of Israel's army, we know that this was a military census, so Joab was only to count the number of fighting men in Israel. Once Joab finishes counting, David wants Joab to return and report the numbers to David.

Joab respectfully disagrees with King David. Joab calls David "my lord, the king" as a way to show respect to David as a higher authority.

Joab says he hopes Yahweh will multiply David's army a hundred times over. Joab asks, "Are all the people not my lord's servants?" as a way to imply that all of the people were already loyal to David as their king and served David. Joab politely disagrees with David's decision by asking David why David wants to do this thing. Joab implies that David is doing wrong when Joab says the census will bring guilt to Israel. Joab most likely means the people of Israel would be guilty of not trusting Yahweh, but rather trusting that their army is strong.

The king's word, or decision, overruled Joab, which means that David did not change his mind. Joab leaves to take the census of Israel.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story of a time when someone in authority insisted on doing something in his way. Pay attention to what phrases and words you use to describe how the person in authority insists on doing things his way. Pause this audio here.

It is important to remember that, as Joab travels throughout the land, Joab does not count the fighting men in the tribes of Levi or Benjamin.

After a long time traveling, Joab returns to Jerusalem and reports the numbers of the census to David: 1,100,000 fighting men in Israel and 470,000 fighting men in Judah. We are not sure if the number 1,100,000 includes all of the fighting men in Israel and Judah, or if the 470,000 men from Judah were in addition to that number. Remember, these men were "able to handle a sword," which means the men were physically able to fight.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How do you say very large numbers like one million, one hundred thousand people? How will you talk about these numbers in this passage? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us that Joab found David's command to take the census to be repulsive. This means that Joab had very strong emotions of disapproval and even disgust.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Think about something that you find repulsive and describe how it makes you feel. How will you describe this strong feeling of disapproval and disgust in your language? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:1–6 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Satan
- David
- Joab
- The commanders of the fighting men
- And the people of Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

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The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Act out how Satan persuades David to take a census of the people of Israel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We have had many victories lately. I must have thousands of soldiers by now. I want to know exactly how many people are at my command; or
- Things have changed since I was a shepherd boy. I am proud of the king I have become; or
- I want to know how many soldiers I have to know how powerful I have truly become.

Continue the drama. Act out how David orders Joab and the other army commanders to go through all of Israel, from Beersheba to Dan, to count the fighting men. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Joab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This does not sound right. Is this something Yahweh wants for Israel, or is it just what David wants? or
- How do I speak against David without offending him? or
- I must say something to get David to change his mind.

Continue the drama. Act out how Joab respectfully disagrees with David. Joab says he hopes Yahweh, his God, will multiply David's army, but asks David why he would want to do such a thing. Joab asks if the people are not already David's servants. Act out how David refuses to change his mind. David insists that the men go out and take the census.

Act out how Joab and the commanders leave David and, after some time, leave Jerusalem to take the census. Joab travels throughout the land but he does not count the fighting men in the tribes of Levi and Benjamin because Joab is deeply offended by the census.

Act out how Joab reports the census numbers to David. Joab tells David there are 1,100,000 fighting men in Israel and 470,000 fighting men in Judah. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Joab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel upset. It is wrong for us to count the fighting men. Yahweh is the one who gives us victory! or
- I cannot count Levi or Benjamin in the census. I do not want to involve the tribe dedicated to the tabernacle or the tribe where the tabernacle is located in such a sin; or
- I feel angry. David is going to make Yahweh angry with us all.

Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel proud. Israel has really grown during my reign as king; or
- I feel secure. With this number of people, we can defeat anyone! or
- I feel satisfied. I knew we had strength in numbers.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:1–6 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Satan rises up against Israel and causes David to take a census. The name Satan means the adversary, and it is the name for the devil, the leader of all evil spirits. Satan tempts people to disobey Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Satan**. Look up Satan in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

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Here, **Israel** refers to God's chosen people, the Israelites, or the descendants of Abraham. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel and Israelites, refer to the Master Glossary.

David wants to take a census, or to count, the people of Israel. In this case, David wants to count the number of men who are able to go to war.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **census**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Joab is with the **military commanders** of the fighting men, or army, when David commands Joab to take the census. The commanders were leaders of the Israelite army, and they were under the authority of Joab. Be sure to use the same word or phrase for military commanders as you have used in previous passages.

Joab says, "May **Yahweh** add to his people a hundred times as many as they are!" Yahweh is the personal name of the one true God of the Israelites. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Joab refers to David as my **Lord**, the **king**. The title "my Lord" refers to someone who is a master and has full authority over other people. "King" refers to someone who rules over a country. Joab uses these two titles to show great respect to David, even though Joab disagreed with David's decision. Use the same word or phrase for Lord and king as you used in previous passages. For more information on Lord or king, refer to the Master Glossary.

Joab asks David, "Are they not all of them my lord's **servants**?" Joab asks this to imply that the people are already David's servants. A servant is someone who is under the authority of their master. A servant does not have the freedom to leave their master when they want to. In this case, Joab is saying the people already obey David as their king. Use the same word or phrase for servant as you used in previous passages. For more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Joab asks David why he would want to bring guilt on all of Israel by taking the census. Guilt is when someone is responsible for doing something wrong. Joab is implying that Yahweh will see all of Israel as responsible for the sin instead of only seeing David as responsible for the sin.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **guilt**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Joab reported the number of men who could handle a **sword**, or who could fight well. Use the same word for sword as you have used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (730 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 21:7–17

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 21:7–17 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:7–17 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:7–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Yahweh allowed Satan to tempt King David to take a census in Israel and Judah. David sent his army commander, Joab, throughout the land to count all of the fighting men. After Joab counted all of the tribes except for Levi and Benjamin, Joab returned and reported the census numbers to David.

The storyteller tells us that not only was Joab displeased because he had to take the census, but Yahweh was also displeased and saw the census as evil, or the opposite of good. So Yahweh punishes the people for David's evil action of ordering the census.

After counting the people, David prays to Yahweh. David feels strong guilt and is sad because he ordered Joab to count the people. David tells Yahweh that David has sinned greatly, or done something very wrong, by counting the people. David calls himself Yahweh's servant and asks Yahweh to take away his guilt, or to forgive David for the wrong he has done. David admits that he has acted very foolishly.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story of a time when a leader or someone in authority felt deep sadness over a decision they made that affected the whole community. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh responds to David's prayer and speaks to Gad. Gad was David's seer, or the prophet who stayed in David's palace. Yahweh used prophets to speak on Yahweh's behalf to his people. Yahweh tells Gad to go to David and to give David a message about how Yahweh will punish David. We only hear a part of Yahweh's message when Yahweh speaks to Gad. We will hear the rest of the message when Gad gives the full message to David later.

Gad finds David and repeats Yahweh's message. Gad tells David he must choose from three different forms of punishment. One possible punishment is three years of famine, or lack of food in the land. Another possible punishment is that David's enemies will chase David for three months. The final option Yahweh gives David is three days of horrible disease in the land that an angel with a sword makes happen. Gad tells David to think about these options and then make a decision so that Gad can give David's answer to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Discuss the different punishments that Yahweh offered to David. Which punishment would you choose and why? Pause this audio here.

David tells Gad he is deeply distressed. In other words, David was in a very difficult position, and it was hard for David to decide. David tells Gad he wants Yahweh to choose what will happen, because David knows Yahweh is full of mercy. When Yahweh is merciful, Yahweh pities people, helps them, and forgives them. David does not want to fall into the hands of people or to let other people have power over David, because David knows people are not as merciful as Yahweh is.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story of a time when someone showed mercy to another person or group of people. Pause this audio here.

So Yahweh chooses to send the plague, or the horrible disease, on the people of Israel. During this time, 70,000 people died in Israel.

Yahweh uses the angel to destroy the people with a plague. Angels are supernatural beings who are messengers of Yahweh and carry out Yahweh's instructions. Yahweh orders the angel to destroy Jerusalem. But when the angel is about to destroy the city, Yahweh decides to stop punishing the people. Yahweh commands the angel to "withdraw his hand" or to stop using his power to harm the people because enough people had already died.

When the angel stops his destruction, the angel is by the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite, just outside the city of Jerusalem. As you remember, a threshing floor was a hard, level surface located outside a town, where blowing winds could separate the grain seeds from the husks. Jebusites were a group of non-Israelite people who lived in Jerusalem.

Stop here and look at a picture of people working on a threshing floor. Pause this audio here.

When David looks up and sees the angel in the sky with his sword pointed toward Jerusalem and ready to destroy the people, David bows to the ground and prays to Yahweh. David was with the elders, or other leaders of Israel, and all these men were dressed in sackcloth to show that they were very sad. Sackcloth is a rough cloth that people made out of goats' hair. Because sackcloth was so uncomfortable, people wore it to show they were really upset.

Stop here and look as a group at an image of a person wearing sackcloth. What do people in your culture wear to show they are very sad? Pause this audio here.

David tells Yahweh that it was David's idea to count the fighting men. David wants to emphasize that it is David himself whom Yahweh should punish because David did wrong. David says that the punishment is a result of David's sin. David says the Israelites are as innocent as sheep. Since sheep follow the shepherd, David is saying that the Israelites only followed David like sheep follow a shepherd.

Stop here and look at a picture of sheep with a shepherd. As a leader, David compared himself to a shepherd. Discuss how your leaders describe themselves to the people they lead. Pause this audio here.

David asks, "What have they done?" to emphasize that the people are not responsible for the wrongdoing. David does not think it is fair that the Israelites have to experience punishment for David's actions. So David asks Yahweh to only show Yahweh's anger toward David and David's family. David asks Yahweh to take the plague away from the people.

In the next passage, we will see Yahweh's response to David.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:7–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: David feels very sad that David ordered the census. David prays to Yahweh and says, “I have sinned greatly in what I have done.... Now I beg of you, take away the guilt of your servant. I have done a very foolish thing.”

In the second scene: Yahweh gives a message to Gad for David. Yahweh tells Gad that Yahweh is giving David the choice between three punishments.

In the third scene: Gad goes to David and gives David Yahweh’s message. Gad says David must choose between three different forms of punishment. Gad asks if David would rather have three years of famine in the land, three months of David’s enemies chasing David, or three days of plague in the land. David is deeply distressed. David asks Yahweh to choose the punishment because David knows Yahweh is full of mercy. David says he does not want to fall into human hands.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh chooses to punish David with a horrible disease. Yahweh sends an angel with a sword to use his power to kill the people of Israel with the disease. Seventy thousand people die from the disease throughout the land. Yahweh then sends the angel to destroy Jerusalem.

In the fifth scene: When the angel is at the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite, Yahweh tells the angel to stop the destruction because enough people have already died. At the same time, David and the elders are all wearing sackcloth clothes. When David sees the angel above Jerusalem, David and the elders bow to the ground. David prays to Yahweh to stop the destruction because the people are as innocent as sheep. David asks Yahweh to only punish David and his household.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Gad
- David
- The elders
- The angel
- The people of Israel
- And Araunah the Jebusite

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage’s setting:

This story is also in 2 Samuel 24:10–17. If you have already translated this passage in 2 Samuel, stop here and listen to your translation. This story has some differences. Pause this audio here.

It is important to remember that David has just ordered a census and received a report from Joab of all the fighting men in Israel. Joab did not approve of the census, but David ordered it anyway.

The storyteller tells us that David’s command to take the census was evil in Yahweh’s sight. Evil is the opposite of good, so Yahweh sees that David has disobeyed, or sinned. The consequence of David’s disobedience is that Yahweh will punish the people of Israel.

David feels great sadness and prays to Yahweh. David says he has sinned greatly and acted foolishly. When a person is foolish, that person does not use good judgment but makes decisions and acts in a way that is unwise.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story of a leader who acted foolishly. What did that person do? Pay attention to the words you use to describe this leader. Pause this audio here.

David begs Yahweh to “take away the guilt of your servant.” Here, David is referring to himself as a servant of Yahweh since Yahweh is David’s master. David wants Yahweh to take away his guilt, or his punishment, for counting the people.

Yahweh responds to David’s prayer by giving a message to Gad, David’s seer. Gad was a prophet who lived in David’s palace. Yahweh wants Gad to give his message to David.

Gad goes to David and tells David Yahweh's message. Gad says David must choose between three different punishments from Yahweh. Gad asks if David would rather have three years of famine or lack of food in the land, three months of being swept away by David's enemies with their swords, or three days when the sword of Yahweh spreads plague in the land.

When people sweep away their enemies, they attack their enemies, and their enemies run away from them. In this case, Yahweh is suggesting that enemies come to attack the Israelites and make the Israelites run away for three months.

Yahweh compares "the sword of Yahweh" with a destroying angel that Yahweh would send. This angel will hold a sword and will cause a horrible disease to spread.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you translate Yahweh using "the sword of Yahweh" to refer to the destroying angel that Yahweh will send? Pause this audio here.

Gad says David must think about his answer and let Gad know what David has chosen so that Gad can tell "the one" who sent Gad. Gad is referring to Yahweh as the one who sent Gad.

David is deeply distressed. In other words, David has a very hard decision to make and is worried about what to choose. David is worried because he cannot decide which punishment is worse and will bring greater shame.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story of someone who was deeply distressed over a decision they had to make. Discuss how you will describe this feeling in your language. Pause this audio here.

David asks Gad to let David and Israel fall into the hands of Yahweh and not into the hands of man. It is important to remember that "into the hands" of someone is special language. "Into the hands of" is another way to say that David wants Yahweh to choose what will happen, because David knows Yahweh is full of mercy. If someone or something is in the hands of someone else, it means that the other person has power or control over the person or situation.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story of someone or something who had power or control over someone else. Discuss how you will describe "into the hands of" in your language. Pause this audio here.

David says he wants to fall into the hands of Yahweh, or the power of Yahweh, because David knows Yahweh is full of mercy. This is another way to say that people know Yahweh is compassionate and forgiving.

As a result of David and Gad's conversation, Yahweh chooses to send a plague or horrible disease on the people. We know from the story in 2 Samuel 24 that Yahweh does this by sending an angel with a sword to Israel to spread the disease and kill people. An angel is a supernatural being who is a messenger of Yahweh. Angels live in heaven with Yahweh, so this angel would have come from heaven to Israel.

The disease begins to spread the same morning Gad talks to David. During this time, 70,000 people die throughout Israel.

Yahweh sends the angel to destroy Jerusalem. But as the angel begins to destroy Jerusalem, Yahweh decides to stop the punishment because Yahweh is sad when Yahweh sees the people suffer.

Yahweh tells the angel, "Enough! Withdraw your hand," which is special language that means that Yahweh wants the angel to stop using his power to destroy the people. This happens when the angel is at the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite. This threshing floor was located just outside the city of Jerusalem.

Stop here and discuss with your group: Imagine the angel is just about to kill more people in Jerusalem. The angel starts to stretch out his hand to kill them, but Yahweh stops the angel. How will you describe this scene? Be sure to use the same language as you used in 2 Samuel 24. Pause this audio here.

David sees the angel with a sword in his hand between heaven and earth, or in the sky. When the angel stretches the sword toward Jerusalem to destroy the people there, David and the elders with him all fall to their faces. These men do not actually fall down, but bow down with their faces to the ground to show respect to Yahweh. David and his elders, or the wise men who help David lead, have already been dressed in sackcloth before this moment to show their deep mourning. The men wear this uncomfortable fabric to outwardly show how sad and upset the men are.

David prays to Yahweh. David asks, “Was it not I who ordered the fighting men to be counted?” David wants to emphasize that David alone is responsible for this wrongdoing and not the people. David says he is the one who has sinned and done wrong. “Sinned” and “done wrong” mean the same thing, but David uses repetition to emphasize that he is the only person to blame.

David compares the people to sheep and says they are innocent and not responsible for the punishment. This is another way to say that David is like a shepherd, and that David led the people into wrongdoing. David asks, “What have they done?” not because David wants an answer, but to emphasize that the people are blameless. David asks for all of Yahweh’s anger to fall on David and his household, or immediate family, and no one else. David asks Yahweh to take the plague away from the people.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story of someone who was very angry with someone else and how they showed their anger. In this story, the storyteller says that David wants Yahweh’s anger to fall on David. How do you talk about someone who shows their anger in this way in your language? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:7–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Gad
- David
- The elders
- The angel
- The people of Israel
- And Araunah the Jebusite

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Act out how David feels very sad because he ordered the census. David prays to Yahweh and says, “I have sinned greatly in what I have done.... Now I beg of you, take away the guilt of your servant. I have done a very foolish thing.” Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel deep sadness. I should have listened to Joab’s advice; or
- I am worried about how my sin will affect the people around me; or
- I am hopeful that Yahweh will forgive me for what I have done.

Continue the drama. Act out how Yahweh gives a message to Gad for David. Yahweh tells Gad that Yahweh is giving David a choice between three forms of punishment.

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Act out how Gad goes to David and gives him Yahweh's message. Gad says David must choose between three different forms of punishment. Gad asks if David would rather have three years of famine in the land, three months of David's enemies chasing David, or three days of plague in the land. David is deeply distressed. David asks Yahweh to choose David's punishment because David knows Yahweh is full of mercy. David says he does not want to fall into human hands. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Gad, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad David has brought Yahweh's punishment on the people; or
- I respect David for letting Yahweh choose his punishment; or
- I can see that David truly does care for the people, and David is worried about how the people will suffer.

Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am overwhelmed! This decision is too hard for me; or
- I am worried. I do not want to be shamed by my enemies defeating me; or
- I feel sad. I can only hope that Yahweh will show me mercy.

Continue the drama. Act out how Yahweh chooses to punish David with a horrible disease. Yahweh sends an angel with a sword to use his power to kill the people of Israel with the disease. Seventy thousand people die from the disease throughout the land. Yahweh sends the angel to destroy Jerusalem. When the angel is at the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite, Yahweh tells the angel to stop destroying people because enough people have already died.

At the same time, act out how David and the elders wear sackcloth together. When David sees the angel above Jerusalem, David and the elders bow to the ground. David prays to Yahweh to stop destroying people because the people are as innocent as sheep. David asks Yahweh to only punish David and his household. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- David has turned back to me and is truly sorry for what he has done. I will end David's punishment; or
- I am sad because of the consequences David has brought on my people; or
- I know my people are like sheep. I will send their true shepherd soon.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:7–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh found David's command to take the census to be evil. Evil is the opposite of good. When people stop obeying God, people start to do evil things. God hates evil. When God establishes his kingdom forever, God will destroy evil forever. Until that time, God still allows evil to happen.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **evil**. Look up evil in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The census was evil in the sight of **God**. Here, God refers to the most powerful spiritual being, the God who created everything. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

As a result of David's disobedience, Yahweh decided to punish the people of **Israel**. Israel refers to the territory where the Israelites lived. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

David feels sorry for what he has done and prays to Yahweh. David says he has **sinned** greatly. When someone sins, they disobey God or act in rebellion toward God. David also asks Yahweh to take away his **guilt**. Use the same words or phrases for sin and guilt as you used in previous passages. For more information on sin or guilt, refer to the Master Glossary.

1 Chronicles 21:7–17

David calls himself Yahweh's **servant**. David shows that Yahweh has authority over David and that David serves Yahweh as his master. Use the same word or phrase for servant as you used in previous passages. For more information on servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh responds to David by giving a message to Gad for David. Yahweh is the personal name for God that shows the close relationship between God and Israel. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Gad was David's **seer** or the **prophet** who lived in David's palace. A prophet is someone who gives messages from Yahweh to the people. Use the same word or phrase for prophet or seer as you used in previous passages. For more information on prophet, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh gives David three options for punishment. One of the options for David's punishment is **famine** in the land for three years. Famine refers to a severe lack of food in the land, usually due to no rain. Use the same word for famine that you used in previous passages.

Another option for David's punishment is that the sword of Yahweh, or a destroying angel, will cause three days of plague in the land. In this context, a plague is a horrible disease.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **plague**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

An **angel** is a supernatural being who gives messages and performs tasks on behalf of Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for angel as you used in previous passages. For more information on angel, refer to the Master Glossary.

When David hears the options for Yahweh's punishment, David does not choose. Instead, David says, "Let us fall **into the hands of** Yahweh and not into the hands of man." If someone or something is in the hands of someone else, then it means the other person has power or control over that person or circumstance. Use the same word or phrase for "into the hands of" as you used in previous passages.

David describes Yahweh as being full of mercy. When someone shows mercy, they show goodness, kindness, and compassion. When Yahweh is merciful, he shows pity, helps, and forgives.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **mercy**. Use the same word or phrase for mercy as you used in previous passages. For more information on mercy, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The angel comes to the **threshing floor** of Araunah the **Jebusite**. Jebusites are the people group that used to live around Jerusalem before David conquered the city. Threshing floors were outdoor workplaces located just outside of cities where people worked to gather grain. These were flat, hard areas where people used the blowing winds to separate wheat grains from the husk. Be sure to use the same words or phrases for threshing floor and Jebusite that you have used in previous passages.

David sees the angel standing between heaven and earth. Here, heaven refers to the sky, so David had to look up to see the angel above Jerusalem. Use the same word or phrase for heaven, meaning sky, as you used in previous passages. For more information on **heaven**, refer to the Master Glossary.

David is with the **elders** of Israel, and these men are wearing sackcloth to show that they are in mourning. An elder is a person with authority in the community. Use the same word or phrase for elder as you used in previous passages. For more information on elder, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 21:7–17

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (714 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.0 MB)

1 Chronicles 21:18–22:1

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 21:18–22:1 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:18–22:1 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:18–22:1 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, Yahweh sent an angel to bring a plague, or a horrible disease, to Israel. This disease killed 70,000 people. Yahweh used the disease to punish David for counting all of the fighting men in Israel. Yahweh told the angel to stop the punishment just as the angel reached the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite.

The angel of Yahweh, who speaks to people on Yahweh's behalf, orders Gad to speak to David. As you remember, Gad was the prophet who lived in David's palace. Gad tells David that Yahweh wants David to build an altar to Yahweh on the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite. An altar was a place where people made sacrifices to

Yahweh. An altar was like a table or a platform that people made using earth or large stones. People placed gifts such as animals, food items, or sweet-smelling spices on the table, then burned them as an offering to Yahweh.

Stop here and look as a group at a picture of an altar. Pause this audio here.

The threshing floor was the same place where Yahweh had compassion on the people and ordered the angel to stop the punishment. Gad spoke in the name of Yahweh, or on Yahweh's behalf. When David followed Gad's instructions, David was obeying Yahweh.

As you remember, the angel was in the sky above the threshing floor when Yahweh ordered the angel to stop destroying the people. Araunah and his four sons are threshing wheat in the field when Araunah sees the angel. When Araunah's sons see the angel, they hide, most likely because they are afraid.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Imagine you are working in a field when you see an angel suddenly appear over you. How would you react and why? Pause this audio here.

At that moment, Araunah sees David coming up the hill toward the threshing floor. Araunah recognizes David and immediately goes out from the threshing floor to show David respect by bowing down to David. David asks Araunah to sell his threshing floor for the full price so that David can build an altar to honor Yahweh and stop the plague or horrible disease.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story of a time when someone was willing to pay any amount of money to resolve a problem. Pause this audio here.

Araunah tells David that David can have the threshing floor and make whatever offerings David wants to Yahweh. David does not have to pay for it. Araunah even offers to provide oxen for the burnt offering, threshing boards for wood, and wheat for grain offerings. At this time, people used oxen, or male cows, to thresh wheat, or separate the husks from the grain. The oxen pulled heavy wooden boards, called threshing sledges, over the grain that people had spread out.

Stop here and look as a group at a picture of oxen pulling threshing sledges. Pause this audio here.

Araunah offers the oxen to David as animals that David can burn on the altar as a burnt sacrifice to Yahweh. Araunah also offers the threshing sledges as wood for the fire. Araunah offers wheat for grain offerings. People offered grain offerings to Yahweh when they mixed grain with sweet-smelling spices and olive oil. According to the law of Moses, the Israelites had to offer a grain offering with every burnt offering.

Stop here and look as a group at a picture of wheat grains. Pause this audio here.

Araunah speaks to David and calls David "My Lord, the King" to show great respect. Araunah says he will give all of these things to David. But David says he will not accept Araunah's offer. Instead, David wants to pay Araunah for everything. David does not want to offer a burnt offering to Yahweh that costs David nothing. David wants to pay Araunah for the threshing floor and everything that came with it. In David's culture, David had to pay for the land, even though Araunah offered it to him. Otherwise, David would have then been in debt to Araunah, and it would not have been a true sacrifice for David.

So David buys the threshing floor and oxen for 600 shekels of gold. Since a shekel is a unit of measurement that weighs around 11.4 grams, this means David paid 6,840 grams of gold for the threshing floor. This was a very large amount of money at this time.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss why you think David would pay such a high price for something that someone offered to David for free. Tell a story of someone who paid more for something than its price because they knew the true value of the item. Pause this audio here.

David then builds an altar to honor Yahweh. David offers burnt offerings, or animals that David completely burns on the altar, as a gift to Yahweh. David also offers peace offerings on the altar. A peace offering is when someone kills an animal as an offering to Yahweh, then eats the meat as part of a meal that celebrates a good relationship with Yahweh. The storyteller tells us that David prays to Yahweh, and Yahweh answers David by sending fire from heaven to consume the burnt offerings on the altar. You may remember that Yahweh confirmed that he approved of the tabernacle when the Israelites first built it by sending fire from heaven to consume their offerings. Yahweh once again uses fire from heaven to show that he approves of David's sacrifices on the threshing floor. It is most

likely that David took this sign of approval from Yahweh to mean that it should be the new building site for the future temple.

After David makes his offerings on the altar, Yahweh tells the angel to put his sword away in its sheath. A sheath was a case about the size and shape of a sword that people used to cover and carry the sword. By putting its sword away, the angel shows that it will no longer cause the horrible disease to spread among the people.

Stop here and look as a group at a picture of a sword and its sheath. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller then gives a summary of what David did and why he did it. According to the law of Moses, the Israelites made their sacrifices to Yahweh on the altar of burnt offerings at the tabernacle, or the portable tent where Yahweh's presence lived. At that time, the tabernacle was located on a high place in Gibeon. But David could not travel that far to make his sacrifices.

Stop here and look as a group at a map of where Jerusalem is located in relation to Gibeon, as well as a picture of the tabernacle. Pause this audio here.

Instead, the presence of the angel and his sword causes David to be afraid. David decides to offer sacrifices at the place that Yahweh chose for the future temple. David says they will build the "house of Yahweh," or the temple, on the threshing floor. David says they will also build the altar where the people of Israel would offer burnt offerings to Yahweh on the threshing floor.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:18–22:1 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The angel of Yahweh gives Gad a message for David. Gad comes to David and says Yahweh wants David to build an altar on the threshing floor of Araunah. David obeys.

In the second scene: Araunah is working on his threshing floor with his four sons when he sees the angel. Araunah's sons hide when they see the angel. At that moment, Araunah sees David approaching. Araunah goes out to meet David and bows down to David. David says he wants to buy the threshing floor to build an altar to Yahweh. David wants the horrible disease in the land to stop. David wants to buy the threshing floor at the full price.

In the third scene: Araunah offers to give David the threshing floor, his oxen, the threshing sledges, and the wheat so that David can make an offering to Yahweh. But David refuses. David says he does not want to give Yahweh an offering that David did not pay for. David pays Araunah 600 shekels of gold.

In the fourth scene: David builds the altar on the threshing floor and makes burnt offerings and peace offerings. David prays to Yahweh, and Yahweh answers by sending fire from heaven to consume the burnt offerings on the altar. Yahweh tells the angel to put his sword away. David says they will build the temple and the altar of burnt offerings for all of Israel on the threshing floor.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Gad
- The angel of Yahweh
- King David
- Araunah
- Araunah's four sons
- And oxen

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

It is important to remember that David has just asked Yahweh to forgive David and to stop punishing the people for David's disobedience. David asks Yahweh to only punish David.

It is important to remember that the angel of Yahweh was still in the sky above the threshing floor of Araunah when Yahweh commanded the angel to stop spreading the plague or horrible disease.

The angel of Yahweh orders Gad to give a message to David. The angel speaks to Gad in the name of Yahweh, or on Yahweh's behalf. As you remember, Gad was a prophet who specifically served as Yahweh's messenger to King David.

Gad goes to David and gives him the message from Yahweh. Yahweh tells David to raise, or build, an altar on the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite. It is important to remember that an altar is a rock table where people make sacrifices or offerings to Yahweh. As you remember, the threshing floor of Araunah is where Yahweh stopped the angel from destroying Jerusalem.

David obeys Gad's instructions and goes to the threshing floor according to the word that Gad spoke in the name of Yahweh. To speak in the name of Yahweh means that Gad represented Yahweh before David. David obeyed Yahweh's command by following Gad's instructions.

The threshing floor is located just outside the city of Jerusalem, and the angel is still in the sky above the threshing floor. Araunah and his four sons are most likely using oxen to thresh wheat when they see the angel. Araunah's sons immediately stop working and hide when they see the angel, but Araunah stays on the threshing floor.

At the same time, David walks uphill toward the threshing floor. When Araunah sees David coming, Araunah leaves the threshing floor to meet David and bows at David's feet. By bowing, Araunah shows respect for David as an authority. It is important to remember that Araunah was not an Israelite, but he still recognized who King David was.

David says he has come to buy the threshing floor and to build an altar so that the horrible disease in the land will stop. David refers to Yahweh as the one who will bring an end to the disease. David says he wants to pay the full price for the threshing floor.

Araunah tells David to take whatever David wants and to do whatever seems good. Araunah refers to David as "my Lord, the king" to emphasize his respect for and submission to David.

Here, Araunah uses special language and says David should do what is "good in his eyes" or what is pleasing to David. Again, Araunah is showing respect to David as Araunah's authority.

Stop here and discuss with your group: How might someone in your culture talk to a person who has power and authority? What phrases does that person use to show respect? How will you talk about David doing something that is "good in his eyes"? Pause this audio here.

Araunah says David can use the oxen as a burnt offering and the wood from the threshing sledges for the fire. Araunah also says David can use the wheat as grain offerings.

But King David does not accept the gifts. Instead, David says he will buy Araunah's threshing floor and oxen for the full price. David says he will not offer to Yahweh something that belongs to Araunah. David did not want to offer a sacrifice to Yahweh that did not cost David anything. So David pays Araunah 600 shekels of gold for the threshing floor and oxen. You may remember that in the similar story in 2 Samuel 24, David only pays 50 silver shekels for the threshing floor. It is unclear why there is a difference. In any case, David paid a lot of money.

David builds an altar on the threshing floor and then kills the oxen as burnt offerings. David also makes a peace offering, or fellowship offering, which would have included a peace offering meal. Yahweh shows his acceptance by sending fire from heaven to consume the burnt offerings on the altar.

Stop here and discuss with your group: The storyteller says the fire comes down from heaven and "eats up" the burnt offerings like people quickly eat food. How will you translate the way the fire acted in your language? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh orders the angel to put his sword away in its sheath, and the angel obeys.

The storyteller then shifts to give us a summary of what David did and why he did it. David could not offer sacrifices at the tabernacle in Gibeon because David was afraid of the angel. As you remember, the angel was holding a sword and had the power to cause people to die from a horrible disease. Instead, David obeyed Yahweh's earlier command and offered sacrifices on the threshing floor, the place Yahweh chose for the future temple.

David says his people will build the "house of Yahweh" with the altar where the people of Israel would offer burnt offerings on the threshing floor. It is important to note that David is talking about the future temple, which will be the more permanent house of God. David is not saying the Israelites will build another tent like the tabernacle.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:18–22:1 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Gad
- The angel of Yahweh
- King David
- Araunah
- Araunah's four sons
- And oxen

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Act out how the angel of Yahweh gives Gad a message for David. Gad comes to David and says Yahweh wants David to build an altar on the threshing floor of Araunah. David obeys.

Act out how Araunah works on his threshing floor with his four sons. When they see the angel, Araunah's sons hide. At that moment, Araunah sees David approaching. Araunah goes out to meet David and bows down to David. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Araunah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I understand why my sons ran! I have never seen anything as frightening as that angel; or
- I feel confused. Why is the angel just staying there with his sword? What is the angel going to do to us? or
- The Israelite king is here! I will give the king whatever he wants to see if he can get the angel to leave.

Continue the drama. Act out how David says he wants to buy the threshing floor and build an altar to Yahweh to stop the horrible disease in the land. David says he wants to buy the threshing floor for the full price.

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Act out how Araunah offers to give David the threshing floor, his oxen, the threshing sledges, and the wheat so that David can make an offering to Yahweh. David refuses. David says he does not want to give Yahweh an offering he did not pay for. David pays Araunah 600 shekels of gold for the threshing floor. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am determined. This is the place Yahweh chose. There is no price too high to pay; or
- I will not make a sacrifice to Yahweh that costs me nothing. Yahweh deserves everything I can offer Yahweh, and more; or
- I feel fearful. I hope Yahweh accepts my offerings.

Continue the drama. Act out how David builds the altar on the threshing floor and uses the oxen to make burnt offerings and peace offerings. David prays to Yahweh, and Yahweh answers by sending fire from heaven to eat up the burnt offerings on the altar.

Act out how Yahweh tells the angel to put his sword away. David says he will build the house of Yahweh and the altar of burnt offerings for all of Israel on the threshing floor. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel relief. Yahweh forgave me and accepted my offerings; or
- I feel joyful. All of our people will remember this place as the place where Yahweh showed us mercy; or
- I will make sure my son builds the house of Yahweh here.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 21:18–22:1 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The **angel of Yahweh** gives Gad a message for David. An angel is a supernatural being who gives messages and performs tasks on behalf of Yahweh. An angel of Yahweh is a special angel who speaks with so much authority that it is as if God himself is speaking. Yahweh is the personal name of God that shows the close relationship between God and Israel. Use the same word or phrase for "angel of Yahweh" as you used in previous passages. For more information on "angel of Yahweh" and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Gad tells David that Yahweh wants David to build an **altar** on the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite. An altar is a place where people make sacrifices to Yahweh. It is like a table or a platform that people make of earth or large stones. People would place gifts such as animals, food items, or sweet-smelling spices on the table and then burn those things as an offering to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for altar as you used in previous passages. For more information on altar, refer to the Master Glossary.

David must build the altar on the **threshing floor** of Araunah the Jebusite. Threshing floors were flat, hard areas where people used the blowing wind to separate the wheat grains from the husk. Be sure to use the same word or phrase for "threshing floor" that you have used in previous passages.

Jebusite means that Araunah was not an Israelite but someone who lived in the Jerusalem area before the Israelites conquered it. Be sure to use the same word or phrase for Jebusite that you have used in previous passages.

David went up to the threshing floor because he obeyed Yahweh's **word** that Gad had spoken in Yahweh's name. Use the same word or phrase for word, and "in someone's name" as you have used in previous passages. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about "word."

After seeing the angel, Araunah looks down and sees David coming. David wants to buy the threshing floor and make an offering to bring an end to the **plague**, or horrible disease. Use the same word or phrase for plague as you used in previous passages.

Araunah bows down to David. Araunah calls David "my lord, the king."

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**bow down**." Refer to bow in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

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The title "my **Lord**" refers to someone who is a master and has full authority over other people. A **king** is someone who rules over a country. In this case, David ruled over Israel. Araunah recognized that David had authority over Araunah. Use the same words or phrases for Lord and king as you used in previous passages. For more information on Lord and king, refer to the Master Glossary.

Araunah says David can have his threshing floor and oxen as **burnt offerings**. When a person brings God a burnt offering, he kills an animal and burns this animal completely on an altar, which is a special place meant for bringing gifts to God. Use the same word or phrase for burnt offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

David also offers a grain offering on the altar. People offered grain offerings to Yahweh when they mixed grain with sweet-smelling spices and olive oil. The Israelites had to offer a grain offering with every burnt offering.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **grain offering**. Look up grain offering in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David pays 600 shekels of gold for the threshing floor. A shekel is a unit of measurement that weighs around 11.4 grams.

Stop here and decide as a group what word or phrase you will use for **shekel**. Use the same word or phrase for shekel as you used in previous passages. For more information on shekel, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

After paying for the threshing floor, David builds an altar and offers burnt offerings and **peace or fellowship offerings** on the altar. A peace or fellowship offering is when someone kills an animal as an offering to Yahweh and then eats the meat as part of a meal that celebrates a good relationship with Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for peace, or fellowship, offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on "peace or fellowship offering," refer to the Master Glossary.

The storyteller tells us Yahweh responded to David by sending fire from **heaven** to eat the burnt offerings on the altar. Here, heaven refers to the sky. Use the same word or phrase for heaven, meaning sky, as you used in previous passages. For more information on heaven, refer to the Master Glossary.

David offered sacrifices on the threshing floor because David was so afraid of the angel that he could not travel to the **tabernacle** in Gibeon. The tabernacle was a portable temple that the Israelites carried with them. This was the place where the Israelites kept the ark of the covenant and where they worshiped Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for tabernacle as you used in previous passages. For more information on tabernacle, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelites built the tabernacle with Moses in the desert or **wilderness**. A wilderness is a dry, rocky place without water where few people live. Use the same word or phrase for wilderness as you used in previous passages. For more information on wilderness, refer to the Master Glossary.

David says that he will build **the house of Yahweh God** on the threshing floor. The house of God is a way to talk about the place on earth where Yahweh lived among his people. Although Yahweh does not need to live in a house, Yahweh told the Israelites that he would live among them and meet with them in the special portable tent they prepared for Yahweh. The Israelites called this tent the tabernacle. But here, David is referring to the temple, which is the more permanent house that the Israelites would build for Yahweh in the future. People sometimes called both the tabernacle and the temple the "house of God." David calls this the house of Yahweh God. Yahweh God is a title that the Israelites sometimes used for Yahweh, their God. For more information on the house of God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 21:18–22:1

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (676 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1020 KB)

1 Chronicles 22:2–19

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 22:2–19 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 22:2–19 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 22:2–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

You will remember that in the previous story, David identified the place where people would build the temple. David had displeased Yahweh when he counted the people of Israel, and Yahweh sent a plague on the Israelites. But then David saw an angel with a sword at the threshing floor of Ornan. David built an altar there and offered

sacrifices. Yahweh ended the plague, and then David declared this spot would be the house of Yahweh and the place for Israel's altar.

In this story, the storyteller talks about how David prepares for the building of the temple. David cannot build the temple himself, but David wants to help his son Solomon succeed in this important task. This part of Chronicles is a story about a special moment in Israel's history. We do not hear about how David passes on the work to his son Solomon in any other parts of the Bible.

The storyteller calls the temple the "house of Yahweh" in this story. David orders workers to cut and prepare stones for building the temple. These workers are foreigners who live in Israel. These foreigners may have been descendants of the people who lived in the land before the Israelites. Many stone quarries existed near Jerusalem where workers could get limestone.

David provides lots of iron that people can use to make nails and hinges for the gate doors. David also gives more bronze than anyone can weigh for the other decorative work in the temple. In early times, iron was very valuable. David got these metals from the enemies David defeated in battles. The people of Tyre and Sidon bring many cedar logs to David. Cedar from Lebanon was famous, and people used cedar in many countries to build important buildings like temples and palaces.

Stop here and look at pictures of cedar trees and wood as a group. What materials do people in your community use to build important buildings? Pause this audio here.

The temple needs to be a beautiful building that brings fame and glory to Yahweh. David decides to make preparations before he dies because David's son Solomon, who will build the temple, is still young. From this moment, David links himself and Solomon together as a team to build the sanctuary. David prepares almost everything for the temple ahead of time. David knows that a young person, even an intelligent one, will need help with such a big job.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do older people in your community help younger people learn important skills? Pause this audio here.

David tells Solomon that David wants to build a temple for Yahweh. But Yahweh had told David before that David could not build the temple because David had fought in many wars and killed many people. The blood from battles made David unclean for this holy task. The person who built Yahweh's house needed to be a man of peace. Yahweh does not condemn David because David fought. The wars David fought actually helped create the peace that Solomon would enjoy. David tells Solomon that Yahweh had told David that Solomon would be born, and Solomon's name means peace. During Solomon's time as king, Yahweh will give Israel peace and quiet. Yahweh will keep Israel safe from their enemies.

Solomon will build a temple for Yahweh's name. Solomon will be like a son to Yahweh, and Yahweh will be like a father to Solomon. Yahweh will make Solomon's kingdom strong forever. This is part of Yahweh's special promise to David's family.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do leaders in your community decide who will do important jobs? Pause this audio here.

David prays that Yahweh will give Solomon wisdom and understanding. The gift of wisdom will help Solomon build the temple. David wants Solomon to obey Yahweh's law and follow Yahweh's instructions for how to build the temple. If Solomon obeys Yahweh's commands, Solomon will succeed. This prayer is like the instruction that Moses gave to Joshua when he told Joshua to obey Yahweh's commands.

Stop here and tell a story of a time when an older person encouraged a younger person who was about to do a difficult job. How did the younger person feel? How did the older person help the younger person? Pause this audio here.

David has worked hard to prepare materials for the temple. David has collected huge amounts of gold, silver, bronze, iron, wood, and stone. The amounts are so large that they show how important the temple is. David says he collected 100,000 talents of gold. A talent weighs about 34 kilograms, so this equals about 3,750 tons of gold. David also collected 1,000,000 talents of silver, about 37,500 tons. Solomon can add more to what David has

prepared. David also mentions the many skilled workers who work with these materials. These workers include stonecutters, carpenters, and all kinds of craftsmen who work with gold, silver, bronze, and iron.

Stop here and tell a story about a time when people in your community worked together on a big project, perhaps to build a large building. What kind of skilled workers helped? Pause this audio here.

David also commands all the leaders of Israel to help Solomon. David reminds the leaders that Yahweh has caused them to have peace, so no enemies attack. David knows that if the leaders are faithful to Yahweh, they will be faithful to Solomon. The land is now under the control of Yahweh and his people. David tells the leaders to seek Yahweh their God. In Chronicles, when someone seeks Yahweh, they do more than just ask Yahweh to guide them. A person who seeks Yahweh obeys Yahweh. The leaders can seek Yahweh by helping build the temple. The leaders should build the sanctuary so they can bring the ark of the covenant and the sacred vessels into the temple they will build to honor Yahweh's name. These sacred vessels are all the items that people dedicated to Yahweh so the priests and Levites could use them in worship.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What sacred objects do people in your community have? How do people treat these objects? Pause this audio here.

For the people who first heard Chronicles, this story reminded them how important the temple and the worship that people did in the temple were for their community. The temple was at the center of their relationship with Yahweh.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 22:2–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: David tells the foreigners who live in Israel to come together. David gives the people work to do. David gathers materials for people to build the temple. These include stones, iron, bronze, and cedar logs. David collects so many supplies that no one can weigh or count them because the temple must look amazing. David prepares because Solomon is young and has never built anything like this before.

In the second scene: David talks privately with his son Solomon. David tells Solomon that David wanted to build a temple for Yahweh. But Yahweh told David he could not build this temple because David had fought too many wars and killed too many people. Yahweh picked Solomon to build the temple instead. David tells Solomon how to build the temple. David reminds Solomon to obey Yahweh's laws. David shows Solomon all the building supplies he has gathered. David also tells Solomon about the workers who will help with the building.

In the third scene: David orders all the leaders of Israel to help Solomon. David reminds them that Yahweh has stopped their enemies from attacking them. The land now belongs to Yahweh and his people. David tells the leaders to follow Yahweh with their whole heart. David asks the leaders to help build the holy place. This place will hold the ark of the covenant and other holy items.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Solomon
- The foreigners who live in Israel
- The leaders of Israel
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This story happens near the end of David's life. Yahweh has already told David where to build the temple. David has been a successful warrior king who defeated many enemies. Now Israel has peace. David knows he will die soon, so David makes preparations for the temple that Solomon will build.

David has gathered a huge amount of building materials. David mentions gold, silver, bronze, iron, wood, and stone. The amount is so large that people cannot count or weigh some of the materials. Later, David talks about the millions of talents of gold and silver that David has gathered. David may be exaggerating to emphasize how magnificent the temple will be. This kind of exaggeration was common in ancient times. The round numbers suggest that David expected people to understand that David was not talking about exact amounts.

David has organized many kinds of skilled workers. There are stonecutters and masons who cut and carve stone. There are carpenters who cut wood, and skilled craftsmen who work with gold, silver, bronze, and iron. The craftsmen will use the iron to make nails for the doors in the gateways as well as for the clamps. We are not sure what the clamps are exactly, but clamps may be another part of the door, such as the hinges or strips of metal that strengthen the door.

The people from Sidon and Tyre had brought cedar logs to David, so David has a lot of cedar. Sidon and Tyre were cities on the coast of the Mediterranean Sea, north of Israel. The leader of these cities had peace with the Israelites and traded with the Israelites.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel and the Mediterranean Sea as a group. Find the cities of Sidon and Tyre. Pause this audio here.

David speaks directly to Solomon and calls him “my son.” Solomon is young and inexperienced. David speaks to Solomon with authority and gives Solomon commands and advice. David had it in his heart to build the temple. People would talk about someone’s heart when they wanted to talk about the place where a person feels and thinks. David means that David wanted to build the temple. David tells Solomon that Yahweh has promised that Solomon will have a peaceful reign. Solomon’s name is related to the Hebrew word for peace. Yahweh has promised to establish Solomon’s kingdom forever if Solomon is faithful.

David also speaks to the leaders of Israel with authority. David reminds the leaders that Yahweh has given them victory over their enemies. The leaders have a responsibility to help Solomon and to seek Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people in your culture show respect when they speak to Yahweh? How will you translate the way David speaks of Solomon as the one Yahweh chose? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, David emphasizes that the temple will be for “the name of Yahweh.” This phrase appears several times. Remember that a person’s name represents their character, so this temple will bring glory to Yahweh. And the temple is not just a building. The temple is a holy place where Yahweh’s presence will dwell among his people. David calls it a “sanctuary,” which is a holy place. The temple will contain the ark of the covenant and holy articles that the priests will use to worship Yahweh.

Yahweh will establish the throne of Solomon’s kingdom over Israel forever. Yahweh means that Yahweh will cause Solomon’s descendants to continue to rule as king over Israel. Kings would sit on the throne, or a special seat for a king, so sometimes people used a king’s throne to represent the way that a king rules.

David speaks of “seeking Yahweh” as an important duty. David tells both Solomon and the leaders to devote themselves to seeking Yahweh. This involves obeying Yahweh’s laws and being committed to serving Yahweh.

David asks Yahweh to give Solomon discretion and understanding. A person who has discretion is wise and knows the right way to act. A person who has understanding can understand the world because that person pays attention and listens. David encourages Solomon with phrases like “be strong and courageous” and “do not be afraid or discouraged.” These are similar to words that Moses spoke to Joshua before Joshua led Israel into the Promised Land. David also assures Solomon that “Yahweh will be with you.”

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people in your culture encourage someone who has a difficult task ahead? How will you translate these phrases of encouragement in a way that sounds natural? Pause this audio here.

David says that a word from Yahweh came to David. This means that Yahweh gave a message to David. When David speaks about how Yahweh prevented David from building the temple, David accepts Yahweh’s decision without complaint. David focuses instead on what he can do to help Solomon succeed in the task. Even though

David cannot build the temple himself, David takes pains, or works very hard, to prepare everything Solomon will need.

When David talks to the leaders, David asks them two questions that David does not expect the leaders to answer. David asks if Yahweh is really with the Israelites and if Yahweh has given the Israelites rest on every side. David does not wonder if Yahweh has done these things. David wants to emphasize that Yahweh really is with the Israelites. David also wants the leaders to remember that Yahweh has given the Israelites rest, or has stopped enemies from attacking the Israelites from any direction. David also says that Yahweh has given the people who live in the land "into David's hands," which means that Yahweh has caused David to have power over these people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you emphasize that something is really true? Discuss how you will translate the way that David asks the two questions. Pause this audio here.

David tells the leaders to devote their heart and soul to seek Yahweh. A soul is the invisible part of a person that may live on after a person dies. When someone talks about doing something with their heart and soul, they mean to do it earnestly, with all of their attention and focus. David wants the leaders to devote their whole selves to seek, or to serve and worship, Yahweh.

Stop here and tell a story about a person who was completely focused on doing one thing, like raising their children, so that they constantly thought about, worked for, and cared for that thing. How would you describe the way the person completely devoted themselves to that thing? Discuss how you want to translate the way that David tells the leaders to devote their heart and soul to seek Yahweh. Pause this audio here.

At the end of the passage, David speaks of the temple as a place "built for the name of Yahweh." The temple will bring honor to Yahweh. The temple's purpose is to provide a permanent place for the ark of the covenant and the sacred articles.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people prepare for important projects that will continue after they die? How will you translate the idea that David is preparing for something he will not live to see completed? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it. As you do this, you might want to use drawings, objects, or even people to represent David gathering materials, foreign workers cutting stones, and the large piles of gold, silver, bronze, iron, wood, and stone. Consider showing how David talks with Solomon and passes on Yahweh's message that David cannot build the temple, but Solomon will. You could also show how David speaks to the leaders of Israel and how everyone works together to prepare for the temple that will honor Yahweh and hold the ark of the covenant.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 22:2–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three parts.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Solomon
- The foreigners who live in Israel
- The leaders of Israel
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

David tells the foreigners who live in Israel to come together. David gives these people work to do. David selects stonecutters to prepare stones to build God’s temple. David provides large amounts of iron to make nails for the doors and fittings. David provides more bronze than anyone can weigh. David also provides many cedar logs, which the Sidonians and Tyrians brought to David. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I want to make sure Solomon has everything he needs to build the temple; or
- I am excited to prepare for God’s house even though I cannot build it myself; or
- I feel responsible to gather the best materials from everywhere for God’s temple.

Ask the person playing one of the foreign workers, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am working hard to shape these stones perfectly for God’s house; or
- I wonder why King David is collecting so many materials.

Continue the drama. David says, “My son Solomon is young. Solomon has never done anything like this before. But Yahweh’s house must be so great and beautiful that people throughout the world know about it! I will gather supplies for this building.” That is why David gathers many supplies before he dies. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I want the temple to honor God and show his greatness to all nations; or
- I worry that Solomon is too young for such a big project; or
- I need to use my last days to prepare as much as possible for the temple.

Continue the drama. David calls for Solomon and tells him to build a house for Yahweh, the God of Israel. David says to Solomon, “My son, I wanted to build a house to worship Yahweh more than anything. But then Yahweh spoke to me. Yahweh said, ‘You have killed many people and fought in many battles. You cannot build a house to worship me because I have seen all the blood of the people you have killed. But you will have a son, and he will rule peacefully. His name will be Solomon. I will make sure that none of Solomon’s enemies attack Solomon. While Solomon rules as king, the people of Israel will be able to live peacefully. Solomon will build a house for me. Solomon will become my son, and I will become his father. I will make Solomon’s kingdom strong, and will make sure that someone from Solomon’s family will rule Israel forever!‘“ Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I accept that God chose Solomon instead of me to build the temple; or
- I am thankful that God promises to bless my son; or
- I feel both disappointed and honored by God’s decision.

Ask the person playing Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel overwhelmed by this responsibility to build God’s temple; or
- I am honored that God chose me for this special task; or
- I wonder if I can live up to my father’s expectations.

Continue the drama. David says, “Now, my son, I pray that Yahweh will help you. I pray that you will be successful when you build the temple of Yahweh, your God, just as Yahweh said you would. I pray that Yahweh will cause you to be wise, so that you will understand things. You will need to be wise when Yahweh makes you king of Israel, so that you may obey the law of Yahweh, your God. You will be successful if you carefully obey Yahweh’s commands and rules, which Yahweh gave to Moses for Israel. Be strong and brave. Do not be afraid or discouraged.” Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I want Solomon to know his success depends on following God's laws; or
- I hope my encouragement will help Solomon be brave in this big task; or
- I pray that God will give my son the wisdom he needs.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I need God's help to complete this task; or
- I want to make my father proud and follow God's commands; or
- I feel strengthened by my father's confidence in me.

Continue the drama. David says, "I have worked hard to provide for Yahweh's temple. I have provided 100,000 talents of gold, 1,000,000 talents of silver, and more bronze and iron than anyone can weigh. I have also provided wood and stone. You may add to them. You have many workers with special skills. Some workers know how to cut stone. Other workers know how to build with stones or with wood. Some workers can use gold, silver, bronze, and iron to make things. There are more workers than you can count. So begin the work! I pray Yahweh will help you." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hope Solomon realizes how much preparation I have done; or
- I want to assure Solomon he has everything he needs to succeed; or
- I feel satisfied that I have done everything possible to help with the temple.

Continue the drama. David orders all the leaders of Israel to help his son Solomon. David says to the leaders, "Yahweh, your God, is certainly with you! Yahweh keeps you safe from all your enemies. Yahweh has caused me to rule over the people who live in this land. Now this land belongs to Yahweh and his people. So you must obey and serve Yahweh completely. Begin to build the holy place for Yahweh, your God. Then you can place the ark of the covenant of Yahweh as well as the other holy things in the temple. The building will bring honor to Yahweh." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want to make sure everyone supports Solomon in this important work; or
- I remind the leaders that God has blessed us, so we should honor God; or
- I hope the leaders understand their responsibility to help build God's house.

Ask the person playing one of the leaders of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I see that David wants all of us to support his son; or
- I recognize how important this temple project is to David and to God; or
- I want to help Solomon succeed in building the temple.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 22:2–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

David orders **foreigners** to help prepare for the temple. Foreigners were non-Israelite people who lived in Israel. These people had fewer rights than the Israelites, but were protected by laws. David assigned these foreigners to cut stones and prepare building materials. For more information on foreigners, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for foreigners as you used in previous passages.

David prepares many materials to build the **house of Yahweh**. Another name for the house of Yahweh is the "house of God" or the temple. The temple is the place where the Israelites worshiped Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for "house of Yahweh" as you have used in previous passages. Look up "house of God" in the Master Glossary for more information.

David gathers together stonecutters, who are people who cut large blocks of stone, which people use to build buildings. Later, David says he has gathered masons and carpenters. Masons build things with stones, and carpenters build things with wood.

1 Chronicles 22:2–19

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **stonecutter**, **mason**, and **carpenter**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David has gathered a lot of **bronze**. Bronze is a metal that people make out of copper and tin. For more information on bronze, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for bronze as you used in previous passages.

This house will be for **Yahweh**. Yahweh is the personal name of God in the Bible. This name appears many times throughout this passage. David often refers to Yahweh as the God of Israel when David explains why his son will build the temple instead of David. For more information on Yahweh and God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and God as you used in previous passages.

David had it in his heart to build a house for Yahweh. People use the word "heart" to represent the place where people think, feel, and make decisions. David means that he really wanted to build a house for Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the phrase "**had it in his heart**." Look up heart in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

The **word** of Yahweh came to David. This means that Yahweh gave a message to David. For more information on the "word of Yahweh," refer to "word" in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for the "word of Yahweh" as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh told David that David had shed much **blood**, or killed many people. For more information on blood, refer to blood in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for blood as you used in previous passages.

David calls Solomon a "man of peace." This means someone who brings or experiences peace rather than war. David contrasts his own life of war with Solomon's future peaceful reign. This peaceful condition was needed before people could build the temple.

Peace refers to a state of safety and calm without war or conflict. David explains that Solomon's name is connected to peace. God promises to give Israel peace during Solomon's reign. This peace is necessary for building the temple. For more information on peace, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for peace as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **man of peace**. What words in your language describe someone who brings or lives in peace? Pause this audio here.

David mentions the **kingdom** of Israel that Solomon will rule. Kingdom refers to the land and people under the authority of a king. God promises that Solomon's kingdom will last forever. For more information on kingdom, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for kingdom as you used in previous passages.

Solomon will have success if he keeps Yahweh's laws, statutes, and ordinances. When people in the Bible talk about Yahweh's laws, statutes, and ordinances all together, they mean the set of instructions that God has given the people of Israel.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **laws**, **statutes**, and **ordinances**. Look up "law," "statute," and "ordinance" in the Master Glossary for more information. If necessary, you can simply say that Solomon will have success if he keeps the set of instructions that God has given the people of Israel. Pause this audio here.

David says that he has provided 100,000 **talents** of gold and 1,000,000 talents of silver. A talent is a unit of measurement that weighs about 34 kilograms. Use the same word or phrase for talent as you used in previous passages. Talent is in the Master Glossary.

David speaks to the officials or **leaders** of the people of **Israel**. Some translations call these men "princes." Use the same word or phrase for Israel and leaders as you used in previous passages. Israel is in the Master Glossary.

David tells the leaders to devote their hearts and souls to seek Yahweh. A person's soul is the total invisible, inner part of a person. This part of a person may live on even after their body dies. David means that the leaders should devote their whole selves to serve and obey Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate the phrase "**devote your hearts and souls**." Look up "heart" and "soul" in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David mentions the rest that God gives to Israel. Rest means safety from enemies and peace in the land. God gave Israel rest by defeating their enemies. This rest created the right conditions for people to build the temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **rest**. What words in your language describe a time of safety and peace after conflict? Pause this audio here.

David calls the temple a **sanctuary**. A sanctuary is a holy place set apart for the worship of God. The sanctuary will house the ark of the covenant and other sacred objects that people used in worship. For more information on sanctuary, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sanctuary as you used in previous passages.

David describes the **holy** articles that people will place in the temple. These articles are holy or set apart for God. These were special objects that people used in worship and that belonged to God. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages.

The **ark of the covenant** was a special box that represented God's presence with Israel. The ark contained the stone tablets with the Ten Commandments. People would place the ark in the temple that Solomon would build. For more information on the ark of the covenant, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase "ark of the covenant" as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 22:2–19

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (871 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (6.0 MB)

- Filling the Gaps (5.8 MB)

1 Chronicles 23:1–6

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 23:1–6 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:1–6 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:1–6 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, David prepared materials for people to use to build the temple. David told Solomon and the leaders of Israel to help with this important task. Now the story continues as David makes plans for those who will serve in the temple.

When David became very old, David made his son Solomon the king of Israel. This marks an important transition of power. David helped Solomon establish his rule even before David died. This arrangement helped create stability in the kingdom.

David gathered all the leaders of Israel, along with the priests and Levites. David wanted to organize these people before he died because David knew the work the Levites would do at the temple was very important. This gathering was an informal meeting. The leaders, priests, and Levites were mostly there to witness what David planned to do.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do leaders in your community prepare for the future? Pause this audio here.

David counted the Levites who were 30 years old or older. There were 38,000 Levite men in total. Yahweh instructed Moses long ago that the Levites who are 30 to 50 years old will serve Yahweh. In later stories, we will learn that David lowered the age to 20. David made this change because the duties of the Levites were changing. The Levites no longer needed to be as physically strong since they would not have to carry the ark from place to place.

David assigned different roles to these Levites. David put 24,000 Levites in charge of the work in Yahweh's temple. David appointed 6,000 Levites to be officials and judges. These officials kept records and helped govern the people. The judges settled arguments among the people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people in your community divide up important work? Pause this audio here.

David assigned 4,000 Levites to be gatekeepers. Gatekeepers guarded the entrances to the temple. Gatekeepers made sure that only the right people entered the sacred spaces.

David also appointed 4,000 Levites to praise Yahweh with musical instruments. David had people specially make these instruments for worship. Music became one of the main duties of the Levites after people built the temple. These Levites played instruments like lyres, harps, and cymbals.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you use music in your community's worship? Pause this audio here.

David organized the Levites into working groups based on the three sons of Levi. These sons were Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Each son's family formed a division with specific responsibilities. This organization helped prepare for the temple that Solomon would build. David could not build the temple himself, but David did everything he could to help his son succeed.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In what ways do older people in your community help prepare younger people for important responsibilities?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:1–6 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: David is very old. David makes his son Solomon king over Israel. This marks the beginning of the transfer of power from David to Solomon. David is preparing to hand over both the kingdom and the responsibility for building the temple to his son.

In the second scene: David gathers all the leaders of Israel along with the priests and Levites. David counts the Levites who are 30 years old or older. There are 38,000 Levites in total. David begins to organize the large group of Levites for their future service in the temple.

In the third scene: David assigns specific duties to the Levites. David puts 24,000 in charge of the work in Yahweh's temple. David makes 6,000 officials and judges. David assigns 4,000 to be gatekeepers. David designates 4,000 to praise Yahweh with musical instruments that David provided for worship. David then organizes the Levites into working groups based on the three sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Solomon
- The leaders of Israel
- The priests
- The Levites
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This story happens near the end of David's life. David is "old and full of days," which means that David has lived a long and complete life. David knows he will die soon, so David is making preparations for the future of the kingdom of Israel and for the temple that Solomon will build.

David makes Solomon king over Israel. This happens while David is still alive. This means both David and Solomon rule together for a time. David prepares Solomon to take over as king.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What words in your language describe the son of a king who becomes king while his father is still alive? Pause this audio here.

David's preparations include organizing the people who will serve in the temple. First, David focuses on the Levites, who are from the tribe of Levi. The Levites have special responsibilities in worship. David counts the Levites and assigns them specific duties. Some will supervise the work in the temple. Others will serve as officials and judges. Some will be gatekeepers. And some will lead worship with musical instruments.

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David speaks with authority to the leaders, priests, and Levites. As king, David has the power to organize the people and assign their duties. David provides musical instruments for the Levites to use to praise Yahweh. David shows that he is very committed to establish proper worship practices.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people in your culture prepare for important leadership transitions? How will you translate the idea that David is preparing for the future when he will no longer be king? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, David divides the Levites into groups based on the Levite clan they come from. The three sons of Levi were Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Each Levite belongs to one of these family lines. To organize people by family groups was important in Israelite society. People's roles and responsibilities often depended on which family they belonged to.

The temple is a central focus in this passage. Even though people have not built the temple yet, David is already organizing the people who will serve there. The temple will be Yahweh's house, a place where God's presence lives among his people. David assigns such a large number of Levites to serve in the temple because he wants to make sure that the Israelites properly worship Yahweh.

David assigns 4,000 Levites to praise Yahweh with musical instruments. Music is an important part of worship. The instruments that people mention elsewhere in the Bible include lyres, harps, and cymbals. The Levites who lead music have the special task of helping the people show their praise to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember what you discussed about music and musical instruments in worship in the last step. How will you translate the idea that Levites praise Yahweh with instruments? Pause this audio here.

At this time in Israel's history, the people are no longer wandering in the wilderness. The people have settled in the Promised Land. The permanent temple in Jerusalem will replace the portable tabernacle. This change affects the duties of the Levites. In the past, the Levites carried the tabernacle from place to place. Now the Levites will have new responsibilities in the temple.

David shows wisdom when he prepares for this transition before his death. David does not wait until the last minute to organize the temple service. Instead, David carefully plans for the worship that will continue after he is gone. David wants to make sure that proper worship of Yahweh will continue into the next generation.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how important is it to prepare for things that will happen after you die? How will you translate the idea that David is organizing worship that he will not live to see fully established? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:1–6 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three parts.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Solomon
- The leaders of Israel
- The priests
- The Levites
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

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First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

David is very old and full of days. David makes his son Solomon king over Israel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know my time is coming to an end, and I must prepare for the future of Israel; or
- I am proud to see my son take the throne while I am still alive; or
- I feel relief knowing the kingdom will continue under Solomon's leadership.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel the weight of responsibility that my father places on my shoulders; or
- I am honored that my father trusts me to lead Israel; or
- I hope I can be as good a king as my father has been.

Continue the drama. David gathers all the leaders of Israel together with the priests and Levites. David orders people to count the Levites who are 30 years old or older. There are 38,000 Levites in total. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am amazed at how many Levites God has provided for service; or
- I need to organize these Levites properly before I die; or
- I want to make sure the temple worship is well-established for generations to come.

Ask the person playing one of the Levites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wonder what task people will give me to do in the service of Yahweh; or
- I feel honored to be counted among those who will serve in the temple; or
- I am curious why King David is counting all of us at this time.

Continue the drama. David assigns duties to the Levites. David puts 24,000 in charge of the work in Yahweh's temple. David assigns 6,000 to be officials and judges. David designates 4,000 to be gatekeepers. David appoints 4,000 to praise Yahweh with musical instruments that David provided. David organizes the Levites into divisions based on the three sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want to make sure everything is in order for proper worship when the temple is built; or
- I am fulfilling my responsibility to organize God's people for service; or
- I feel satisfaction when I complete this important task before I die.

Ask the person playing a Levite who David assigned to temple work, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am honored that David chose me to work in Yahweh's temple; or
- I will do my best to serve faithfully in this important role; or
- I am glad to be part of such a large group that serves Yahweh together.

Ask the person playing a Levite assigned to be a musician, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am excited to praise Yahweh with the instruments King David provided; or

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- I will use my musical talents to honor God with all my heart; or
- I feel blessed to be able to lead others in worship through music.

Ask the person playing a leader of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I see how important proper worship is to King David; or
- I am impressed by David's careful organization of the Levites; or
- I will support these arrangements for temple service under Solomon's reign.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:1–6 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

David is the **king** of **Israel**, and David is now old. David makes his son Solomon the new king. For more information on David, king, and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for David, king, and Israel as you used in previous passages.

David gathers together the **political** or **military leaders**, **priests**, and the **Levites**. Both the priests and the Levites are descendants of Levi. Priests are the descendants of Aaron who serve in the temple. Other Levites who were not descendants of Aaron helped the priests in their duties. For more information on priests and Levites, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for political or military leaders, priests, and Levites as you used in previous passages.

David assigns 24,000 Levites to supervise the work in the **temple**. The temple is the house of God, which people will build in Jerusalem. For more information on temple, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for temple as you used in previous passages.

The Levites will serve in **Yahweh**'s temple. Yahweh is the personal name of God in the Bible. Some Levites will offer praises to Yahweh with instruments. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

David assigns 6,000 Levites to be officials and judges. Officials are Levites who serve as leaders in the community. These officials help govern the people. In the time of Moses, officials helped lead the people. Officials worked with judges to apply God's laws. Officials helped organize the tribes and maintain order in the community.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **officials**. What words in your language describe people who help govern and lead a community? Pause this audio here.

Judges are Levites who make decisions about disputes among the people. David assigns these Levites to work with officials. For more information on judges, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for judges as you used in previous passages.

David assigns 4,000 Levites to be **gatekeepers**. Gatekeepers are Levites who guard the entrances to the temple. Gatekeepers had an important role in the tabernacle before people built the temple. Gatekeepers protected the sacred areas and treasures. In the time of Moses, the Levites camped around the tabernacle to guard it. Later, gatekeepers became more organized under King David and Solomon. Use the same word or phrase for gatekeepers as you have used in previous passages.

Four thousand Levites will **praise** Yahweh with musical instruments. For more information on the word for praise, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for praise as you used in previous passages.

David organized the Levites into their family groups that were the descendants of the three **sons** of Levi. In this case, sons refers to the male children of Levi. For more information on the word for sons, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sons as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 23:1–6

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (802 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 23:7–11

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 23:7–11 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:7–11 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:7–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

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In the previous story, David organized the Levites into divisions, or working groups, based on the three sons of Levi. These sons were Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Now we learn more about the families that came from Gershon.

Gershon was the oldest son of Levi. In the time of Moses, the Gershonites had very important duties. The Gershonites took care of the curtains, coverings, and hangings of the tabernacle. The Gershonites carried these items when the Israelites moved from place to place in the wilderness. Yahweh assigned the Gershonites to camp on the west side of the tabernacle. The Gershonites received two carts and four oxen to help with their work.

Gershon had two sons named Ladan and Shimei. These two sons started the main family lines of the Gershonites. In other parts of the Bible, people call Ladan by the name Libni.

Ladan had three sons. The oldest son was Jehiel. The other sons were Zetham and Joel. These three men led all the clans of Ladan.

Shimei also had sons. These sons were Shelomoth, Haziel, and Haran. These three sons led important families.

It is unclear, but Shimei probably had four more sons. These sons were Jahath, Ziza, Jeush, and Beriah. Jahath was the oldest, and Ziza was second. Jeush and Beriah did not have many descendants. Because their families were small, David counted Jeush and Beriah's families as one clan and assigned them one job together.

David helped prepare for the temple that Solomon would build by organizing the workers. Each family line had specific responsibilities. David was making sure everything was ready for worship in the temple.

In the early days, the Gershonites needed to be strong. The Gershonites had to carry the tabernacle materials when Israel traveled in the wilderness. Now that the ark would have a permanent home in the temple, the Gershonites would have different duties. The Gershonites would no longer need to carry heavy items from place to place. We learn later in this story that this is why David changed the starting age for service from 30 to 20.

Later in Israel's history, some Gershonites became musicians in the temple. Some of the Gershonites joined a group called the Asaphites. They helped with music during worship. Others served as officials and judges for the people.

The family organization also created a sense of connection across generations. Sons would serve in the same roles as their fathers. This helped people pass down knowledge and traditions from one generation to the next.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you divide families to do certain tasks in your community?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:7–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller introduces the two sons of Gershon: Ladan and Shimei. Gershon was one of the three sons of Levi that the storyteller mentioned at the end of the previous passage. The passage begins by showing how David organized the Levites by their family groups.

In the second scene: The storyteller names the sons of Ladan. These sons were Jehiel the first, then Zetham, and then Joel. There were three sons in total. The storyteller also mentions three sons of Shimei: Shelomoth, Haziel, and Haran.

In the third scene: The storyteller describes four more sons of Shimei: Jahath, Ziza, Jeush, and Beriah. Jahath was the oldest, and Ziza was the second. Jeush and Beriah did not have many sons. Because they had few descendants, David counted Jeush and Beriah's families as one family group and gave them one assignment.

The characters in this passage are:

- David

- Gershon
- Ladan
- Shimei
- Jehiel
- Zetham
- Joel
- Shelomoth
- Haziel
- Haran
- Jahath
- Ziza
- Jeush
- And Beriah

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This passage continues from the previous passage. David is still organizing the Levites for their future service in the temple. Now David is organizing the Levites according to their family groups. This passage focuses on the descendants of Gershon, who was one of the three sons of Levi.

This passage shows the importance of family relationships in Israelite society. People's roles and duties often depended on which family they belonged to. David organizes the Levites by their family lines, starting with the descendants of Gershon.

In this passage, David continues to organize the Levites for temple service. This organization is very detailed. David is making sure that every Levite knows his place and role in the temple service. David's careful organization shows how important proper worship was to him. David wanted to make sure that the temple service would continue smoothly after his death. Each person needed to know their duties.

The passage records not just the main family heads but also smaller details like which son was first or second, and which families had fewer members. David will say, "This is the oldest son," and then, after David says all the sons' names, David says how many sons there were in all.

Stop here and, as an activity, tell the others in the group about a family that has many children. Tell the group all the children's names. Pay attention to when you choose to say how many children there are and how you talk about who the oldest is. Then discuss how you want to translate the way that David talks about who the oldest sons are and how many sons are in the family. Pause this audio here.

David talks about the families of Gershon's two sons, Ladan and Shimei. Later, David talks about the sons of Shimei, then says that these sons are the leaders of the family clan of Ladan. Then David talks about more sons of Shimei. This part of the passage is not clear. It is possible that there is more than one Shimei in the Gershonite tribe. It is possible that Ladan has a descendant whose name is Shimei, and then David talks about the sons of Levi's son Shimei. Or David could talk about only one man whose name was Shimei in this passage. We are not sure of the exact family lines in this passage, but you should translate this part the way it is in the text.

David mentions that two of Shimei's sons, Jeush and Beriah, did not have many descendants. Because of this, David combines these sons' families and counts them as one group for temple service. This shows that the organization of the family groups was practical. When a family line had few members, this family line could join with another small family for their duties.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do family connections affect roles and responsibilities in your culture? How will you translate the idea that David combined small families for practical purposes? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the concept that David organizes people by family groups so they can do their work duties? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it. As you do this, you might want to use drawings, objects, or even people to represent the family tree of Gershon. Show

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Gershon with his two sons, Ladan and Shimei. Then show Ladan with his three sons: Jehiel, Zetham, and Joel. Show Shimei with his first three sons: Shelomoth, Haziel, and Haran. Also show Shimei's four other sons: Jahath, Ziza, Jeush, and Beriah. You could show Jeush and Beriah standing together because they had few sons. This will help you understand how David organized the Levites by their family groups.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:7–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Gershon
- Ladan
- Shimei
- Jehiel
- Zetham
- Joel
- Shelomoth
- Haziel
- Haran
- Jahath
- Ziza
- Jeush
- And Beriah

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

David organizes the Levites by their family groups. Gershon is one of the three sons of Levi. Gershon has two sons: Ladan and Shimei. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want to make sure every Levite family knows their assignment for the temple; or
- It is important to keep good records of all the Levite families; or
- I need to organize the Levites carefully so that worship in the temple will run smoothly when Solomon builds it.

Ask the person playing Gershon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am proud that my family will serve Yahweh in the temple; or
- I hope my sons and grandsons will do their duties well; or
- I feel honored to be one of the three main Levite families.

1 Chronicles 23:7–11

Continue the drama. Ladan has three sons: Jehiel the first, Zetham, and Joel. Shimei also has three sons: Shelomoth, Haziel, and Haran. These were the leaders of the families of Ladan. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ladan, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am thankful for my three sons who will continue our family line; or
- I hope Jehiel leads his brothers well, as my oldest son; or
- I want my family to serve Yahweh faithfully in the temple.

Ask the person playing Shimei, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am thankful that Yahweh caused me to have several sons; or
- I want my sons to be good leaders for the families of Ladan; or
- I feel a great responsibility to prepare my sons for leadership.

Ask the person playing Shelomoth, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I will do my best to lead the family group I am responsible for; or
- I want to honor my father Shimei by being a good leader; or
- I must work closely with my cousins to make sure the temple service runs smoothly.

Continue the drama. Shimei has four more sons: Jahath, Ziza, Jeush, and Beriah. Jahath is the oldest, and Ziza is the second. Jeush and Beriah do not have many sons. Because they have few descendants, David counts Jeush and Beriah as one family group and gives them one assignment. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jahath, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- As the oldest of these four brothers, I feel responsible for them; or
- I want to make sure my family serves well in the temple; or
- I am thankful that my father has so many sons to serve Yahweh.

Ask the person playing Jeush or Beriah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I understand why King David counts our families as one, since we have fewer sons; or
- Even though our family is smaller, our service to Yahweh is still important; or
- I am glad we still have a place in the organization, even with fewer descendants.

Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Every Levite family needs a clear assignment, even the smaller ones; or
- I want to be fair and practical when I organize the Levites; or
- This organization will help the temple worship continue for generations.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:7–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Gershon is one of the three sons of Levi. The other sons are Kohath and Merari. Gershon's family line is called the Gershonites. The Gershonites are part of the Levites who serve in the temple.

Ladan is one of the sons of Gershon. Some people call Ladan "Libni" in other parts of the Bible. Ladan's family becomes an important group within the Gershonites. Some of Ladan's descendants become **heads** of their father's **households** or large family groups. For more information on household, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for the leader or head of their father's household as you used in previous passages.

Son is a male child of a parent. In the Bible, sons are very important. Sons carry on the family name. Sons inherit family property. Sons continue family traditions. In this passage, we learn about the sons of Gershon, who was a son of Levi. For more information on son when the storyteller uses the word to refer to a male child of a parent, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for son as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 23:7–11

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (802 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.0 MB)

1 Chronicles 23:12–20

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 23:12–20 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:12–20 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:12–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

You will remember that in the previous passage, David organized the Levites into working groups based on the three sons of Levi. These sons were Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Now the storyteller gives details about the descendants of Kohath.

Kohath had four sons. These sons' names were Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. Each of these sons became the head of a family group within the Kohath family group.

Amram was the father of Aaron and Moses. God chose Aaron and his descendants for a special purpose. God set these people apart to prepare the holy things for the temple service. The descendants of Aaron offered sacrifices, or burned incense, to Yahweh. They served Yahweh in the temple. They also blessed the people in Yahweh's name. This was the duty that Aaron's descendants always had.

Stop here and tell a story about a particular family group that has a special task that only they can do. Pause this audio here.

People called Moses "the man of God." Moses and his sons were a part of the tribe of Levi. Unlike Aaron's descendants, Moses' descendants did not have a special status. These descendants were ordinary Levites.

Moses had two sons named Gershom and Eliezer. Gershom's first son was Shubael. Eliezer had only one son named Rehabiah. Rehabiah was the family leader. Rehabiah had many descendants.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about family groups in your culture who have more or better status than others. Why is this? Pause this audio here.

Kohath's second son, Izhar, had a son named Shelomith. Shelomith was the head of his clan.

Hebron, who was Kohath's third son, had four sons. Jeriah was the first son and the leader. Amariah was the second son. Jahaziel was the third son. Jekameam was the fourth son.

Uzziel, who was Kohath's youngest son, had two sons. Micah was the first son and the leader. Isshiah was the second son.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Why is it important to know your family relationships? Pause this audio here.

This detailed list shows how David organized the Levites. Each person had a specific place in the temple service. This organization helped prepare for worship in the temple that Solomon would build.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does good organization help people get important work done in your community?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:12–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller introduces the four sons of Kohath. Kohath was one of the three sons of Levi that the storyteller mentioned at the end of a previous passage. The storyteller continues to show how David organized the Levites by their family groups. Kohath's sons were Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel.

In the second scene: The storyteller then tells about the sons of Amram, who were Aaron and Moses. Yahweh set Aaron and his descendants apart for special service. Yahweh chose these people to prepare the holy things in the temple. Yahweh also chose them to offer sacrifices to Yahweh and to proclaim blessings in his name forever.

In the third scene: The storyteller names the sons and descendants of Moses, and the other sons of Kohath. Moses had two sons named Gershom and Eliezer. Gershom's son was Shubael, who was the family leader. Eliezer had only one son named Rehabiah, but Rehabiah had many descendants. Then the storyteller lists the

descendants of Kohath's other sons. Izhar's son was Shelomith. Hebron had four sons: Jeriah was first, Amariah was second, Jahaziel was third, and Jekameam was fourth. Uzziel had two sons: Micah was first, and Isshiah was second.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Kohath
- Amram
- Izhar
- Hebron
- Uzziel
- Aaron
- Moses
- Gershom
- Eliezer
- Shubael
- Rehabiah
- Shelomith
- Jeriah
- Amariah
- Jahaziel
- Jekameam
- Micah
- And Isshiah

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This passage continues from the previous passage. David is still organizing the Levites for their future service in the temple. Now David is organizing the Levites according to their family groups. The storyteller now focuses on the descendants of Kohath, who was one of the three sons of Levi.

In this passage, the storyteller shows the special place of Aaron's family in Israelite worship. Aaron and his descendants were set apart to be priests. These people had special duties that other Levites did not have. These people prepared the holy things, burned incense, and blessed the people in Yahweh's name.

The passage also shows that even though Moses was an important leader, Moses' family did not receive special status. Moses' sons were regular Levites. This shows that people received roles in temple service by family line, not by personal achievement or status.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people assign important roles in your culture? How will you translate the idea that Aaron's family had special duties that others did not have? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, David continues to organize the Levites in a very detailed way. David makes sure that every Levite knows his place and role in the temple service. The passage records not just the main family heads but also details about which son was first, second, third, or fourth. This shows that each person had their place in the system.

The storyteller also notes when a family had few descendants, like Jeush and Beriah in the previous passage, or many descendants, like Rehabiah in this passage. This shows that David paid attention to things like family size.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the idea that some families had many descendants, and some families had just a few descendants? Pause this audio here.

The organization of the Levites by family groups helped ensure that temple worship would continue properly. Each family group had specific responsibilities. This system would continue from generation to generation.

The family organization also created continuity over time. Sons would serve in similar roles as their fathers. This helped traditions continue and made sure that people passed down important knowledge. The storyteller also says, "this is the first son" or "second son," which shows how important the birth order was in families.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate the way that the storyteller tells us which son was born first, second, third, or fourth? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it. As you do this, you might want to use drawings, objects, or even people to represent the family tree of Kohath. Show Kohath with his four sons: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. Then show Amram with his two sons: Aaron and Moses. Show that God set Aaron's family apart for priestly duties. Show Moses with his two sons: Gershom and Eliezer. Then show the sons of each of Kohath's other sons. This will help you understand how the storyteller tells us the names of the Levites by their family groups.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:12–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has 3 scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Kohath
- Amram
- Izhar
- Hebron
- Uzziel
- Aaron
- Moses
- Gershom
- Eliezer
- Shubael
- Rehabiah
- Shelomith
- Jeriah
- Amariah
- Jahaziel
- Jekameam
- Micah
- And Isshiah

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

David is organizing the Levites by their family groups. Kohath is one of the three sons of Levi. Kohath has four sons: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I need to organize all the Levite families carefully for the temple service; or
- I want to make sure the worship of Yahweh continues properly after I am gone; or
- It is important to keep good records of all the Levite families and their duties.

Ask the person playing Kohath, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am proud that my family will have important duties in Yahweh's temple; or
- I hope my four sons will lead their families well in service to Yahweh; or
- I feel honored to be one of the three main Levite families.

Continue the drama. Amram has two sons: Aaron and Moses. Aaron and his descendants are set apart for special service. These people prepare the holy things, offer sacrifices to Yahweh, and pronounce blessings in Yahweh's name. Yahweh calls Moses "the man of God," but counts his sons as regular Levites. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Amram, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am blessed to have two such important sons as Aaron and Moses; or
- I am proud that Aaron's family will serve as priests in Yahweh's temple; or
- I am thankful that both my sons have important roles in service to Yahweh and his people.

Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- It is a serious responsibility to take care of the holy things in Yahweh's temple. Yahweh has honored me with this job and I know I must pay close attention to what I do; or
- I want to make sure my sons understand the importance of their priestly duties; or
- I am honored that Yahweh chose my family to serve him as priests forever.

Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am content that my sons will serve as regular Levites in the temple; or
- Even though I led Israel, my sons do not have special status; or
- I am called "the man of God" because I followed Yahweh faithfully, not because of my family position.

Continue the drama. Moses has two sons: Gershom and Eliezer. Gershom's son is Shubael, who is the family leader. Eliezer has only one son, Rehabiah, but Rehabiah has many descendants. Izhar's son is Shelomith. Hebron has four sons: Jeriah, Amariah, Jahaziel, and Jekameam. Uzziel has two sons: Micah and Isshiah. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Gershom, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am proud that my son Shubael is a family leader among the Levites; or
- Even though we are not priests, our service to Yahweh is still important; or
- I want my family to serve faithfully in the duties we are given.

Ask the person playing Eliezer, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am thankful that my one son, Rehabiah, has many descendants; or
- Our family line will continue strongly through Rehabiah's many children; or
- I am grateful that our family will continue to serve in Yahweh's temple.

Ask the person playing Hebron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am blessed to have four sons who will lead their families well; or
- I hope Jeriah will guide his brothers wisely as the oldest; or
- I want all my sons to work together to serve Yahweh properly.

Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This detailed organization will help the temple service run smoothly; or
- Every Levite family has their place and purpose in Yahweh's service; or
- I am making sure that people will continue to worship Yahweh properly in future generations.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:12–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The storyteller talks about the **sons** of **Levi**. Sometimes in this passage, the word "son" means the male child of his parents and sometimes son means "**descendant**." A person's descendants are his children, grandchildren, and all future generations from the same family line. Aaron's descendants are the priests. Moses' descendants are counted as Levites. For more information on Levi, son, and descendant, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for Levi, son, and descendant as you used in previous passages.

Aaron and his sons **consecrate** the **holy** things. To **c**onsecrate means to make something or someone holy for a special purpose. Holy means set apart for God. The things in the temple are holy. For more information on consecrate and holy, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for consecrate and holy as you used in previous passages.

Aaron and his sons minister before Yahweh. To minister means to serve God in the temple. This is part of the priests' special job.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **minister**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Aaron and his sons ask God to **bless** the people. When you bless people, you ask God to give good things to people. For more information on bless, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for bless as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 23:12–20

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (751 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.5 MB)

- Speaking the Word (1.0 MB)

1 Chronicles 23:21–32

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 23:21–32 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:21–32 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:21–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The storyteller continues the list of Levi's descendants in this passage. Now the storyteller focuses on the family of Merari, who was one of Levi's sons along with Gershon and Kohath. All together, these families formed the tribe of Levi.

Merari had two sons named Mahli and Mushi. Mahli's sons were Eleazar and Kish. Eleazar died without having any sons. Eleazar only had daughters. These daughters married their cousins, who were the sons of Kish. This marriage helped to keep property within the tribe, as the Law of Moses required. Mushi had three sons named Mahli, Eder, and Jerimoth.

This passage shows how David organized the Levites for temple service. David counts the Levites who are 20 years old or older. In earlier times, Levites started their work for the temple at the age of 30. David counted the Levites just before the end of his life. This was one of David's last official acts as king.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do leaders in your community prepare for the future before the next leader begins to lead? Pause this audio here.

David said that Yahweh had given peace to his people, Israel. David also said that Yahweh had chosen to make Jerusalem the permanent place for Yahweh's presence among his people. Yahweh's special presence would be in the temple in Jerusalem. Because of this, the Levites no longer needed to carry the tabernacle or its equipment from place to place. The tabernacle was the portable tent with the ark of the covenant, where people worshiped before people built the temple. The ark represented Yahweh's presence among his people. Because the men no longer needed to be strong enough to carry the equipment, David could start to count the men from the age of 20 years old.

Stop here and tell a story about a time when a leader changed the rules about something. Why did that leader change the rules? How did that leader say that they had changed the rules? Pause this audio here.

Just like the Levites served at the tabernacle, now the Levites would soon serve at the temple. While the place of worship changed, the Levites still focused on honoring Yahweh. The Levites' job was still to help Aaron's descendants, the priests, in the temple service. Now, instead of carrying the tabernacle tent, the Levites took care of the temple courtyards and rooms. The Levites made sure all the holy things that the priests used in worship stayed pure, or ritually clean. The Levites helped with many other tasks in Yahweh's temple.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How have worship practices changed in your community over time? Pause this audio here.

The Levites were responsible for preparing the “bread of the presence” that sat on the table in the holy place. The Levites arranged this bread in two rows of six loaves. The Levites kept the flour for grain offerings. The Levites made the flat bread, which they made without yeast. The Levites mixed and baked the bread for offerings. The Levites also made sure all measurements were correct.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What jobs do people in your community do to help with worship? Pause this audio here.

Every morning and evening, the Levites stood in their places to thank and praise Yahweh. The Levites also helped when the priests presented burnt offerings to Yahweh. These offerings happened on Sabbath days, at New Moon festivals, and on other special days or festivals. Sabbaths were weekly days to rest and worship Yahweh. New Moon festivals happened on the first day of the month, when people could only see the thin edge of the moon. During the New Moon festivals, people would sacrifice or offer gifts to Yahweh. The correct number of Levites had to be present at these times. The Levites followed the rules for worship.

The Levites watched over the Tent of Meeting and the sanctuary, or the Holy Place. The “Tent of Meeting” was another name for the tabernacle. The Holy Place could refer to the inside of the tabernacle or to the temple. The Levites helped their relatives, Aaron’s descendants, with serving and working in Yahweh’s temple. The storyteller wanted to show that the priests and the Levites cooperated very well together.

Stop here and tell a story about a time when different groups worked together but had different specific roles. Why is it important for people to have specific roles when they work together? Pause this audio here.

For the people who first heard this story, these details reminded them how important it was for people to worship in the temple so that they could have a good relationship with Yahweh. The temple was the special place where Yahweh chose to make his presence known among his people. The temple was the center of the Israelites’ community life. The way the Levites faithfully performed their duties set an example for the community.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:21–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: We learn about the descendants of Merari. Merari has two sons named Mahli and Mushi. Mahli’s sons are Eleazar and Kish. Eleazar dies without having any sons. Eleazar only has daughters. These daughters marry their cousins, the sons of Kish. Mushi has three sons named Mahli, Eder, and Jerimoth.

In the second scene: David explains why the Levites no longer need to carry the tabernacle. Yahweh has given peace to his people. Yahweh now lives in Jerusalem forever. The Levites will not need to carry the tabernacle or any of its equipment anymore. Now, David counts all the Levites who are 20 years old or older. These Levites will serve in the temple.

In the third scene: David describes the new duties of the Levites. The Levites help Aaron’s descendants with temple service. The Levites take care of the courtyards and rooms. The Levites make sure the holy things stay pure. The Levites prepare the sacred bread, flour for offerings, and special cakes. The Levites stand every morning and evening to thank and praise Yahweh. The Levites help with sacrifices on Sabbaths, New Moon festivals, and other special days. The Levites follow all the proper procedures for serving Yahweh.

The characters in this passage are:

- Merari
- Mahli
- Mushi
- Eleazar
- Kish
- The daughters of Eleazar

- The sons of Kish
- Mahli
- Eder
- Jerimoth
- David
- Aaron's descendants
- The other Levites
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This story happens at the end of David's life. David has organized the Levites into groups to help the priests in the temple that Solomon will build. The storyteller shows how the role of the Levites changes when the temple replaces the tabernacle as the center of worship. The Levites will no longer need to transport the ark and sacred items from place to place. Instead, the Levites will serve in the permanent temple in Jerusalem.

David explains that Yahweh has given his people peace. The land now belongs to Yahweh and his people. The Levites' new duties focus on helping the priests by maintaining the temple and its surroundings. The Levites take care of the courtyards and rooms. The Levites prepare the holy bread and offerings. The Levites lead morning and evening praises to Yahweh. The Levites assist with ceremonies on holy days.

The Levites work alongside the priests but have specific tasks that are different from priestly duties. Only descendants of Aaron can serve as priests. The other Levites support the priests in their work. The Levites now serve from age 20 instead of 30. This change helps provide enough workers for all the temple duties.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people in your culture prepare buildings for worship? What words or phrases would you use to translate the duties of the Levites to maintain the temple? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, David speaks of specific tasks the Levites must do. The Levites must keep the temple courtyards and rooms clean. The courtyards are the open areas that surround the temple. The Levites must make sure all holy objects remain pure. The Levites prepare different kinds of bread and cakes for offerings. The Levites weigh and measure ingredients to ensure everything follows Yahweh's instructions. The Levites stand each morning and evening to thank and praise Yahweh through music and singing.

David talks about the special bread for the temple table. This bread sits on a gold table in the Holy Place. The priests place 12 fresh loaves there each Sabbath day, and they call it the "bread of the presence," which means the bread that sits in the presence of Yahweh, or near where Yahweh lives. The Levites also prepare fine flour for grain offerings. The Levites make thin wafers without yeast. The Levites prepare cakes that they cook with oil. The Levites make sure all these things follow the exact amounts that Yahweh's law requires.

The storyteller mentions special times when the Levites assist with sacrifices. These times include Sabbath days, New Moon festivals, and celebrations that happen each year. The Levites follow exact procedures during these special times. The Levites make sure the right number of offerings occurs at the right times.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people prepare special food for religious ceremonies? What words or phrases would you use to translate the different kinds of bread and offerings that the storyteller mentions in this passage? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller also describes how the Levites help maintain proper worship. The Levites work under the direction of the priests. The Levites guard and take care of the holy places and objects. The Levites' work ensures that worship continues properly. Even though their duties change, the Levites remain important to Israel's worship of Yahweh.

David organizes the Levites because he knows he will not live to see when people finish the temple. David prepares everything Solomon will need to build and maintain the temple. This shows David's commitment to proper worship of Yahweh, even if David cannot participate in it himself.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it. As you do this, you might want to use drawings, objects, or even people to represent the family tree of Merari's descendants.

Consider showing how David counts the Levites who are 20 years old or older. You could also show how the Levites clean the temple courtyards, prepare bread offerings, stand to sing praises to Yahweh, and help the priests during special festivals.

Embodying the Text
Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:21–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three parts.

The characters in this passage are:

- Merari
- Mahli
- Mushi
- Eleazar
- Kish
- The daughters of Eleazar
- The sons of Kish
- Mahli
- Eder
- Jerimoth
- David
- Aaron's descendants
- The other Levites
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The passage begins with a list of Merari's descendants. Merari has two sons, Mahli and Mushi. Mahli's sons are Eleazar and Kish. Eleazar dies without having any sons. Eleazar only has daughters. These daughters marry their cousins, the sons of Kish. Mushi has three sons named Mahli, Eder, and Jerimoth. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Eleazar's daughter, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am concerned about continuing our family line since my father has no sons; or
- I am glad that I can marry my cousin and keep our inheritance within our family; or
- I feel responsible to preserve my father's place in the tribe of Levi.

Ask the person playing one of Kish's sons, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am honored to marry my cousin and help continue Eleazar's family line; or
- I understand the importance of keeping our inheritance within our family.

Continue the drama. David explains that the Levites no longer need to carry the tabernacle. David says, "Yahweh, the God of Israel, has given his people rest. Yahweh will now live in Jerusalem forever. The Levites will not need

to carry the tabernacle or any of its equipment anymore." David counts all the Levites who are 20 years old or older. These Levites will serve in the temple. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am pleased that Yahweh has given us peace and a permanent place to worship him; or
- I want to make sure the Levites have clear duties now that they will not have to carry the tabernacle; or
- I am planning ahead for the temple worship even though I will not see it completed.

Ask the person playing one of the Levites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wonder what my duties will be now that we will not have to carry the tabernacle; or
- I am excited to serve in the permanent temple instead of moving from place to place; or
- I feel honored to be counted among those who will serve in the temple.

Continue the drama. David describes the duties of the Levites. David says, "The Levites will help Aaron's descendants with temple service. The Levites will take care of the courtyards and rooms. The Levites will make sure the holy things stay pure. The Levites will prepare the sacred bread, flour for offerings, and special cakes. The Levites will stand every morning and evening to thank and praise Yahweh. The Levites will help with sacrifices on Sabbaths, New Moon festivals, and other special days. The Levites will follow all the proper procedures for serving Yahweh." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want to ensure proper worship continues after I am gone; or
- I am establishing clear duties so no one will be confused about the Levites' responsibilities; or
- I want the Levites to know how important their service is to Yahweh and to all Israel.

Ask the person playing one of Aaron's descendants, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I appreciate that the Levites will help us with our duties in the temple; or
- I understand that the priests and Levites must work together for proper worship; or
- I am thankful that David has organized the temple service so carefully.

Ask the person playing one of the Levites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel proud that my duties include preparing offerings and helping with temple worship; or
- I am honored to stand and praise Yahweh every morning and evening; or
- I want to learn all the proper procedures so I can serve Yahweh correctly.

Continue the drama. The passage concludes with a summary of the Levites' responsibilities. The Levites watch over the Tent of Meeting and the Holy Place. The Levites help their relatives, the descendants of Aaron, with the service of Yahweh's temple. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing one of the Levites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I understand that my role is to support the priests in their service to Yahweh; or
- I feel privileged to care for the holy places where we worship Yahweh; or
- I am committed to serve faithfully according to the duties David has assigned to us.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 23:21–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The storyteller talks about the **Levites** by their family groups. The Levites are people from the tribe of Levi. The Levites have special duties in the worship of Yahweh. David organized the Levites into three main family lines: the Gershonites, the Kohathites, and the Merarites. For more information on Levites, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Levites as you used in previous passages.

The storyteller talks about the **sons** of Levi. At the beginning of this passage, the storyteller lists the sons of Merari and their sons. In this case, the word "son" means the male child of his parents. Then the storyteller talks about the "**descendants**" of Levi by their family, and the descendants of Aaron. A person's descendants are his children, grandchildren, and all future generations from the same family line. For more information, refer to son and descendant in the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for sons and descendants as you used in previous passages.

Use the same word or phrase for **heads** or **leaders** of families that you have used in previous passages.

David says **Yahweh** will dwell in **Jerusalem** forever. Jerusalem is the city where David ruled and where Solomon would build the temple. Yahweh chose Jerusalem as the place where people would honor Yahweh's name, or worship Yahweh. Yahweh is God's personal name. For more information on Jerusalem and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for Jerusalem and Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

David mentions that Yahweh, the **God** of Israel, has given **rest** to **Israel**. Israel refers to the people that Yahweh has chosen. Rest refers to safety from enemies and peace in the land. For more information on God and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for God, Israel, and rest as you used in previous passages.

David says the Levites no longer need to carry the **tabernacle** because God will now live permanently in Jerusalem. The tabernacle, or Tent of Meeting, was the portable worship place where people worshiped Yahweh before people built the temple. For more information on tabernacle, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for tabernacle as you used in previous passages.

The Levites will **serve** in the **house of Yahweh** instead of carrying the tabernacle. This kind of serving is actual physical work that the Levites will do in the temple. The "house of Yahweh" is another name for the **temple**. The temple is the permanent building for worship that Solomon will build in Jerusalem. For more information on the temple and "house of Yahweh," refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for temple or house of Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

The Levites **purify** the **holy** things in the temple. When you purify something, you make that thing ritually clean for worship. For more information on holy and on purify, or purification, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for holy and purify or purification as you used in previous passages.

The Levites take care of the **Holy Place**. The Holy Place, or sanctuary, is the sacred area inside the temple. For more information on Holy Place, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Holy Place as you used in previous passages.

The courtyards are the areas around the tabernacle or temple, where the people gather together.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **courtyards**. Pause this audio here.

The Levites make the bread of the Presence. The "bread of the Presence" is the special bread that the priests put on a table in the Holy Place of the temple.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **bread of the Presence**. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about "bread of the Presence." Pause this audio here.

The Levites also **praise** Yahweh in the temple. Use the same word or phrase for praise as you have used previously. Praise is in the Master Glossary.

The Levites help the priests present **burnt offerings** to Yahweh on special days. Burnt offerings are animal sacrifices that the priests completely burn on the altar. For more information on burnt offerings, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for burnt offerings as you used in previous passages.

The **Sabbath** was one of those special days. The Sabbath is the seventh day of the week for the Israelites. The Sabbath is a day for people to rest and worship God. For more information on Sabbath, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Sabbath as you used in previous passages.

The **New Moon Festival** was another one of those special days. In Old Testament times, the people of Israel celebrated this festival at the beginning of each month, when the people could see the new moon rise in the sky. During this festival, the Israelites stopped their work, offered special sacrifices, and blew trumpets to celebrate.

Stop here and discuss as a group what phrase you will use for the **New Moon festival**. Look up “Festival of the New Moon” in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

These Levites helped their **brothers**, or relatives, who were the descendants of Aaron and who were priests in the temple. Use the same word or phrase for brothers when it means relatives as you have used previously.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 23:21–32

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (794 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1011 KB)

1 Chronicles 24:1–19

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 24:1–19 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 24:1–19 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.

4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 24:1–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passages, when King David grew old, David made his son Solomon the new king of Israel. Then David counted all of the men of the tribe of Levi and organized the men so that the men would be ready to serve in the new temple that Solomon would build for Yahweh to replace the tabernacle.

In this passage, we will now learn how David and the leaders counted the men who descended from the first high priest, Aaron, who was also a Levite. We will also learn how David and the leaders organized these men into groups to serve in the new temple. You will remember that it was the Levites who descended from Aaron who served as the priests.

The storyteller begins when he says that he will now tell us how they divided the descendants of Aaron into groups. But first, the storyteller will provide some short background information about the descendants of Aaron.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story in your language. As you begin the story, first tell some background information that happened long before the time of the story, but that people need to know to understand what happens in the story. Then tell the rest of your story. Pause this audio here.

Aaron had four sons, whose names were Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar. But Nadab and Abihu died while their father, Aaron, was still alive. The storyteller does not retell this sinful part of the story here because his goal is to focus on how God was with David in the kingdom. But we know from Leviticus chapter 10 and also Numbers chapter three that Nadab and Abihu disobeyed Yahweh and burned the wrong kind of fire as an offering. So Yahweh punished Nadab and Abihu when Yahweh put them to death with fire.

The storyteller reminds us that Nadab and Abihu did not have any sons to take their place as priests, and so Nadab and Abihu's younger brothers, Eleazar and Ithamar, became the next priests. However, by the time of this story, Eleazar and Ithamar had grown old and died. So instead, Zadok, one of Eleazar's descendants, and Ahimelech, one of Ithamar's descendants, helped David count all of Aaron's descendants who would serve as priests in the temple. This may mean that David told Eleazar and Ahimelech what to do, and then Eleazar and Ahimelech helped to organize the men into the right groups according to the kind of work each man would do in the temple.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when people in your culture organized a group of people to do an important task. Pause this audio here.

Eleazar's descendants had more men who knew how to lead than Ithamar's descendants did. So David, Zadok, and Ahimelech organized the priests so that Eleazar's descendants had 16 groups with their leaders, and Ithamar's descendants had eight groups with their leaders. This means they had a total of 24 groups of men.

The storyteller explains that Eleazar's clan and Ithamar's clan included both consecrated officers and officers of God. So to make it fair for everyone, David, Zadok, and Ahimelech used lots to decide how to divide the groups of men. We are not sure how the men did this, but you will remember that to cast lots was a way people asked Yahweh's will. To do this, the men probably used a number of objects, like stones or sticks, which they may have marked in some way to represent a particular group or family. Then the men would have thrown or "cast" these lots onto the ground. The way each stone or stick landed showed how Yahweh wanted them to organize the men by the jobs each priest would do in the temple.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you make decisions in a fair way when you organize groups of people? For example, maybe you are about to play a team sport, and you need to pick which people will play on which team. Or maybe you will work together to build a house, and you need to give each person a different part of the job to do. What do you use to help make these decisions? Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 24:1–19

One of the Levite men was named Shemaiah. Shemaiah was the son of Nethanel. Shemaiah was a scribe. A scribe is a person whose job is to write down and keep important histories and other information. You will remember that at this time, most people did not know how to write, but Shemaiah wrote down the names of each of the priests while David and the other leaders watched. The storyteller says these leaders included Zadok, Ahimelech, and the heads of the fathers' houses of the priests and the Levites.

As David and the men threw the lots, they chose one family from Eleazar's descendants, then one from Ithamar's descendants. These are the names of each man they chose by lot, in the order that they chose them:

- First was Jehoiarib.
- Second was Jedaiah.
- Third was Harim.
- Fourth was Seorim.
- Fifth was Malkijah.
- Sixth was Mijamin.
- Seventh was Hakkoz.
- Eighth was Abijah.
- Ninth was Jeshua.
- Tenth was Shecaniah.
- Eleventh was Eliashib.
- Twelfth was Jakim.
- Thirteenth was Huppah.
- Fourteenth was Jeshebeab.
- Fifteenth was Bilgah.
- Sixteenth was Immer.
- Seventeenth was Hezir.
- Eighteenth was Happizzez.
- Nineteenth was Pethahiah.
- Twentieth was Jehezkel.
- Twenty-first was Jakin.
- Twenty-second was Gamul.
- Twenty-third was Delaiah.
- And twenty-fourth was Maaziah.

Each of these groups worked in the temple in this order. And each group obeyed the rules that their ancestor Aaron had given for how to serve in the temple. It was Yahweh, the God of Israel, who had given these rules to Aaron for all of the priests to obey.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 24:1–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller says he will tell how they divided up the descendants of Aaron to serve in the temple. But first, the storyteller reminds us that Aaron had four sons. Aaron's first two sons died early, and so Aaron's two younger sons, Eleazer and Ithamar, became the priests. Now it is Zadok, a descendant of Eleazar, and Ahimelech, a descendant of Ithamar, who help David with this task to divide up all of the descendants of Aaron.

In the second scene: We learn that there were 16 leaders among the descendants of Eleazar and eight leaders among the descendants of Ithamar. Both of these family groups included consecrated officials and officials of God. So to make sure it was fair, David, Zadok, and Ahimelech cast lots to determine how to divide up the men.

In the third scene: The storyteller says that Shemaiah the scribe wrote down the men's names while David and the other leaders watched. As they cast lots to pick the men, they went back and forth between picking from Eleazar's family and Ithamar's family. Then the storyteller lists each man in the order in which they chose them.

In the fourth scene: We hear that these groups worked in the temple in this order, and each group obeyed the rules that Yahweh had given Aaron for how to serve in the temple.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Aaron, the first high priest
- Aaron's four sons: Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar
- Eleazar's descendant Zadok, and Ithamar's descendant Ahimalech
- The heads of the families of the Levites and priests
- Shemaiah the scribe, and his father, Nethanel
- The leaders of each of the 24 groups of priests: Jehoiarib, Jedaiah, Harim, Seorim, Malkijah, Mijamin, Hakkoz, Abijah, Jeshua, Shecaniah, Eliashib, Jakim, Huppah, Jeshebeab, Bilgah, Immer, Hezir, Happizzez, Pethahiah, Jehezkel, Jakin, Gamul, Delaiah, and Maaziah
- All of the priests
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller says that this was how they divided up all of the priests from Aaron's family who would serve at the temple. However, the storyteller does not list all of these groups immediately. First, the storyteller will remind us of the history of Aaron's family when Aaron was still alive.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When you want to tell a story, but first you need to explain some important information from long ago to help your audience understand the story, how do you do this? What words or actions do you use to help people understand when each thing happened? If needed, look back at the story you told in step two to see how you did this. Pause this audio here.

Aaron had four sons named Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar. But Nadab and Abihu died before Aaron died, and Nadab and Abihu did not have any children. So Eleazar and Ithamar became the next priests after Aaron.

Now that the storyteller has given that background information, the storyteller returns to the time of this story when he says that it was with the help of Zadok, who was a descendant of Eleazar, and Ahimelech, who was a descendant of Ithamar, that David organized the men the storyteller is about to list.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about an important leader who did a task with the help of lesser leaders who took orders from that important leader. For example, maybe a king leads an army by giving commands to his generals, who then tell all of the soldiers what to do. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller now explains that there were more chief men, or leaders, among the descendants of Eleazar than among the descendants of Ithamar. This does not necessarily mean that there were twice as many overall descendants of Eleazar, but there were twice as many men among them who were qualified to serve as leaders. Because of this, they organized the men so that there were 16 leaders from Eleazar's family and eight leaders from Ithamar's family.

David and the leaders divided all of the men by casting lots, and they did this because there were consecrated officers and officers of God among both the sons, or descendants, of Eleazar and of Ithamar. We do not know exactly what the storyteller means by "consecrated officers and officers of God." However, it seems that although the men had different skills or jobs to do, it was very important to treat all of the men equally and in a fair way.

A scribe named Shemaiah, who was the son of a Levite man named Nethanel, wrote down the names of each man in this list. Shemaiah wrote these down in the presence of the king and the officials. These officials included Zadok the priest, Ahimelech son of Abiathar, and the heads or leaders of the priests and the Levites. We are not sure why the storyteller says that Ahimelech was the son of Abiathar. In the book of 1 Samuel, it says that Ahimelech was the son of Ahitub and the father of Abiathar, not Abiathar's son. Some scholars think this is an error, but others think that the Ahimelech in this story was the son of Abiathar and the grandson of the Ahimelech

mentioned in 1 Samuel. Either way, you should translate the passage as it is written so that it says, “Ahimelech son of Abiathar.”

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your community, do people ever give children the same first name as their parents or grandparents? If so, when you talk about these people, how do you say a person’s name so other people know exactly which person you mean—the child, the parent, or the grandparent? In your translation, how will you say Ahimelech’s name so people will understand this is the Ahimelech who was Abiathar’s son? Pause this audio here.

In the original language, it is not clear what the storyteller says next. He seems to say that as David and the leaders cast the lots, they first cast for Eleazar’s clan, then for Ithamar’s clan, and so on back and forth until they had organized all of the groups. However, we know that Eleazar’s clan had twice as many heads of family groups. We are not sure how they did this, but it may be that they cast the lots two times for Eleazar’s family every time they cast the lots once for Ithamar’s family.

Now the storyteller lists the names of each group leader. The first lot fell to Jehoiarib, the second to Jedaiah, the third to Harim, the fourth to Seorim, the fifth to Malkijah, the sixth to Mijamin, the seventh to Hakkoz, the eighth to Abijah, the ninth to Jeshua, the tenth to Shecaniah, the eleventh to Eliashib, the twelfth to Jakim, the thirteenth to Huppah, the fourteenth to Jeshebeab, the fifteenth to Bilgah, the sixteenth to Immer, the seventeenth to Hezir, the eighteenth to Happizzez, the nineteenth to Pethahiah, the twentieth to Jehezkel, the twenty-first to Jakin, the twenty-second to Gamul, the twenty-third to Delaiah, and the twenty-fourth to Maaziah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you organize this list of names in your translation? Will you list the number along with each man’s name, or how will you show the order? Pause this audio here.

Finally, the storyteller says that each of these groups worked in the temple in this order. And each group obeyed the rules that their ancestor Aaron had given for how to serve in the temple. The storyteller also reminds us that it was Yahweh, the God of Israel, who gave these rules to Aaron for all of the priests to obey.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 24:1–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- David
- Aaron, the first high priest
- Aaron’s four sons: Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar
- Eleazar’s descendant Zadok, and Ithamar’s descendant Ahimalek
- The heads of the families of the Levites and priests
- Shemaiah the scribe, and his father, Nethanel
- The leaders of each of the 24 groups of priests: Jehoiarib, Jedaiah, Harim, Seorim, Malkijah, Mijamin, Hakkoz, Abijah, Jeshua, Shecaniah, Eliashib, Jakim, Huppah, Jeshebeab, Bilgah, Immer, Hezir, Happizzez, Pethahiah, Jehezkel, Jakin, Gamul, Delaiah, and Maaziah
- All of the priests
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

1 Chronicles 24:1–19

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, the storyteller says something like, "This is how they divided the descendants of Aaron into groups for service. Aaron had been the father of four sons named Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar. But Aaron's two oldest sons, Nadab and Abihu, died without sons, while their father was still alive. So Nadab and Abihu's younger brothers, Eleazar and Ithamar, became the priests after Aaron. And it was with the help of Zadok, a descendant of Eleazar, and Ahimelech, a descendant of Ithamar, that David organized the priests into groups according to their duties." Pause the drama. Ask the person who plays Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I felt sad when my sons Nadab and Abihu disobeyed, and Yahweh put them to death. But I was glad that Eleazar and Ithamar served Yahweh well; or
- I am amazed at how many people have descended from my family. Look at all of these priests!

Ask the person who plays David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want to make sure all of the priests are organized and ready to serve in the temple that my son Solomon will build for Yahweh after I die; or

Ask the people who play Eleazar and Ithamar, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We feel honored to help David organize all of the men in our families; or
- We are excited that we will soon have a permanent temple to serve in. Until now, we have only had the tabernacle tent!

Continue the drama. In the second scene, the storyteller says something like, "Eleazar's clan had more qualified leaders than Ithamar's clan. So David, Zadok, and Ahimelech organized the priests according to the number of the leaders in each family. Eleazar's family had 16 leaders, while Ithamar's family had eight leaders. Both Eleazar's clan and Ithamar's clan had temple officials and spiritual leaders, so to make the process fair for everyone, they assigned each group by casting or throwing lots." Pause the drama. Ask the people who play David, Zadok, and Ahimelech, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The priests will need strong leaders to keep them all organized; or
- I want to be fair when we give people different jobs and responsibilities. We should cast lots so Yahweh can make those decisions.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, the storyteller says something like, "A Levite named Shemaiah was a scribe, and he wrote down the names of the priests in front of the king and the officials. Zadok the priest was there, and so was Abiathar's son Ahimelech and the leaders of the priests' clans and of the Levites' clans. When they threw the lots, they chose one family from Eleazar's descendants, then one from Ithamar's descendants. Each group of priests went by the name of its family leader, and they were assigned their duties in this order: The first lot fell to Jehoiarib, the second to Jedaiah, the third to Harim, the fourth to Seorim, the fifth to Malkijah, the sixth to Mijamin, the seventh to Hakkoz, the eighth to Abijah, the ninth to Jeshua, the tenth to Shecaniah, the eleventh to Eliashib, the twelfth to Jakim, the thirteenth to Huppah, the fourteenth to Jeshebeab, the fifteenth to Bilgah, the sixteenth to Immer, the seventeenth to Hezir, the eighteenth to Happizzez, the nineteenth to Pethahiah, the twentieth to Jehezkel, the twenty-first to Jakin, the twenty-second to Gamul, the twenty-third to Delaiah, and the twenty-fourth to Maaziah." Pause the drama. Ask the person who plays Shemaiah, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel honored to help with this important task by writing these names down for David; or
- There are a lot of leaders in this list, but it will take a lot of leaders for so many priests!

Ask the people who play Zadok, Ahimelech, and the leaders of the clans, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- We must be important if David ordered a scribe to write all of our names down like this.

Continue the drama. In the fourth scene, the storyteller says something like, “This was the order in which each group was to serve when they entered Yahweh’s temple. They had to obey the rules that their ancestor Aaron had given. Yahweh, the God of Israel, had given those rules to Aaron.” Pause the drama. Ask the people who play all of the priests, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We are excited about how we will serve in our new jobs in the temple! or
- We must remember all of Yahweh’s rules and follow them. We remember how Aaron’s sons Nadab and Abihu died when they did not follow Yahweh’s rules, and we do not want to be like them!

Ask the person who plays Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am pleased that so many men will dedicate their lives to serve me in my temple; or
- It is very important that people obey my commands.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 24:1–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The storyteller says that these were the divisions of Aaron’s sons. In this case, Aaron’s sons refers to all of Aaron’s **descendants**, including the children and grandchildren of Aaron’s sons. Use the same words or phrases for “sons” when it means descendants as you used in previous passages. For more information on descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

These divisions were separate groups of men who would work together to do their tasks in the temple. Divisions are usually groups of an equal number of people who have specific work to do.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **divisions** of Aaron’s sons. Pause this audio here.

Aaron’s sons were Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar. After Nadab and Abihu died, Eleazar and Ithamar became the next **priests**. You will remember that Moses, through whom God gave the people his law, was a **Levite**. And Moses’s brother Aaron was also a Levite. Those Levites who were descendants of Aaron became priests. Although priests were also Levites, they were more important than the other Levites. Priests were people who worked in the tabernacle and later in the temple, once people finished building it. Priests were responsible for offering sacrifices to God on behalf of the people. Priests took care of the temple and taught the people how to worship God. Use the same words or phrases for Aaron and for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information, look up Levite and priest in the Master Glossary.

Zadok was of the “**sons**” or **descendants** of Eleazar, and Ahimelech was of the “sons” or descendants of Ithamar. This does not mean they were literally the direct sons of Eleazar and Ithamar, but rather that they were descendants of these men, such as a grandson, great-grandson, or great-great-grandson. Just as previously in this passage, use the same words or phrases for “sons” when it means descendants as you used in previous passages. For more information, look up “descendants” in the Master Glossary.

David and the men organized all of the priests under the **heads** or leaders of **fathers’ houses**. The word “heads” here means top leaders or chiefs. Sometimes in the Bible, a “father’s house” refers to the family members who lived in one man’s house, also known as a household. However, at other times, it could refer to larger family groups who were related by a common ancestor but who lived in separate households. In this story, the term “heads of father’s houses” refers to the way they divided the very large families of Eleazar and Ithamar into smaller family groups with a top leader over each group. Use the same words or phrases for heads and for fathers’ houses as you used in previous passages. For more information, look up household in the Master Glossary.

All of these men had an appointed duty or assignment for **service** in the temple. This means that the leaders gave each man a physical job to do in the temple to serve Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for service as you used in previous passages.

1 Chronicles 24:1–19

David, Zadok, and Ahimelech divided the men into groups **by lot**. This means they cast lots, which was a way people asked what Yahweh wanted to do in a situation, or who Yahweh wanted to choose for a task. We do not know exactly how they did this, but people may have taken some objects like different colored stones or sticks and thrown them on the ground. Depending on how these items landed, it would then show which answer Yahweh gave. Use the same words or phrases for "by lots" that you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about drawing or throwing lots. You have already talked about lots in 1 Chronicles 6:54, so use the same word or phrase here. Pause this audio here.

There were **consecrated**, or **holy officers** and **officers of God** among the descendants of both Eleazar and Ithamar. The word consecrated means holy or set apart for God, and the word officers can also mean officials or princes. We are not sure exactly what the storyteller meant by these words, but the important thing to show in your translation is that all of the priests did holy and important work for God. Use the same words for consecrated or holy and for officers or officials that you have used in previous passages. Also, if you wish, you may choose to make this a single phrase, such as "sacred officers, even officers of God." For more information, look up holy or consecrated in the Master Glossary.

The **scribe** Shemaiah recorded the men's names. Scribes were highly educated people who wrote down and kept important information, such as laws, historical records, and copies of the Scriptures. To record meant to write down and keep this information so that people could look back and remember what they had decided. Use the same word or phrase for scribe as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for "**recorded**." Look up scribe in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The scribe Shemaiah recorded the names in the presence of the **king** and of his officials. Use the same word or phrase for king as you have used previously, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information about king.

This list was the priests' appointed order for how they would serve in the **house of God** or the **temple**. The "appointed order" means the structure or organization that God gave them to follow. Here, the word temple is literally "house of God," but we know from context that David is preparing the priests for the time when they will serve in the temple that Solomon builds. Use the same word or phrase for temple, or your general phrase for "house of Yahweh," as you used in previous passages. For more information on temple, or "house of Yahweh," refer to the Master Glossary. Translate this word in the same way you have throughout 1 Chronicles.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for "**appointed order**." If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

All of the priests would serve in the temple according to the **ordinance** that Aaron gave them from **Yahweh**. Ordinance means "the prescribed way," or in exactly the way Yahweh said to do each thing. You will remember that Yahweh gave many specific instructions for the priests in the book of Leviticus and other Old Testament books. The word ordinance means the instructions or laws themselves, as well as Yahweh's command to follow those laws. "Yahweh, God of Israel" is a normal title to show that Yahweh was special to Israel. Use the same words or phrases for ordinance and Yahweh that you have used in previous passages. If needed, refer to Yahweh, God, and Israel in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 24:1–19

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (677 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1004 KB)

1 Chronicles 24:20–31

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 24:20–31 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 24:20–31 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 24:20–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

You will remember that in previous passages, the storyteller talked about how King David organized the families of the Levites to serve in the temple that David's son Solomon would build to replace the tabernacle after David died. First, the storyteller listed the Gershonites, the Kohathites, and the Merarites. These were the family groups of the Levites who were not priests, but who each had different tasks to serve Yahweh in the temple. Then, in the previous passage, David organized all of the male descendants of the first high priest, Aaron, so that these men would be prepared to serve in the new temple as the priests.

Now, in this passage, the storyteller will again list leaders of the Levite family groups. While this list includes many of the same names we heard in 1 Chronicles chapter 23, the storyteller now provides the names of an additional generation of Levites. The names in this list are not in quite the same order as chapter 23. Also, this time, the storyteller does not include the family of the Gershonites. We are not sure why the storyteller does this, but it may be because the Levites in this list had different duties in the temple in Jerusalem.

Stop here and remind each other of the decisions you made for how to translate the names of the Levite family leaders in chapter 23. Do you still like the decisions you made? Why or why not? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller will first provide a list of leaders from the Kohathites and then a list from the Merarites. Finally, we will hear how they assigned each group their duties and how David and the other leaders chose and organized these men.

The storyteller begins when he says that this is the list of the leaders of the other Levite families. You will remember that inside the very large Levite tribe were several clans, and then inside each clan were these leaders over different family groups.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how important is it for people to know what families their leaders come from? What can you learn about a person when you know that person's family? Pause this audio here.

Shubael descended from Amram, and Jehdeiah descended from Shubael. Although the passage does not say it here, you will remember from 1 Chronicles chapter 23 that Amram was the descendant of Kohath. Amram was also the father of Moses and Aaron, and Shubael descended from Moses's son Gershom. Now, Shubael's son Jehdeiah was the chief, or leader, of this family group.

Next, Isshiah was the oldest son who descended from Rehabiah. You will remember that Rehabiah was another descendant of Moses through Eliezer. Isshiah was the chief, or leader, of this family group.

Next, from the descendants of Izhar came Shelomoth, and from the descendants of Shelomoth came Jahath, who became the leader of his family group.

Hebron had four sons or descendants: the first was Jeriah, the second was Amariah, the third was Jahaziel, and the fourth was Jekameam.

Micah was the son or descendant of Uzziel, and Micah was also the father or ancestor of Shamir. Micah's brother was Isshiah, and Isshiah's son was Zechariah.

Merari was the father or ancestor of Mahli and Mushi. This is the same information we hear in 1 Chronicles 23. However, this next information is not clear in the original language, and we do not see it in other passages in the Bible. It seems that Merari had another son, or descendant, named Jaaziah, and Jaaziah had a son or descendant named Beno. Then the storyteller says this another way when he says that Merari's son Jaaziah had four sons named Beno, Shoham, Zaccur, and Ibri.

Mahli's son Eleazar did not have any sons. Mahli's other son, Kish, was the father of Jerahmeel.

And finally, Mushi was the father of Mahli, Eder, and Jerimoth.

The storyteller finishes when he says that this is the list of the Levites and the leaders of each family. The people cast lots to choose their different jobs, just as their relatives, the descendants of Aaron, did in the last passage. The people cast the lots in front of King David, the priests Zadok and Ahimelech, whom David chose in the last story to help him with this process, and the leaders of the families of the priests and the Levites. Finally, the people chose work for the older brothers or family leaders in the same way that they did for the younger brothers.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What ways do you use to choose good leaders that everyone can trust? Also, what ways do you use to assign tasks to different people so that everyone feels that others treat them fairly and equally?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 24:20–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller gives a list of the leaders of the other Levite families from the Kohathite and Merarite clans.

In the second scene: The storyteller tells how the people cast lots in the same way that Aaron's descendants did, and how they treated the oldest brothers the same as the youngest.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller of the drama
- The people who listen as the storyteller recites
- Levi's descendants
- Amram, Shubael, and Jehdeih
- Rehabiah and Isshiah
- Izhar, Shelomath, and Jahath
- Hebron, Jeriah, Amariah, Jahaziel, and Jekameam
- Uzziel, Micah, and Shamir
- Isshiah and Zechariah
- Merari, Mahli, and Mushi
- Jaaziah, Beno, Shoham, Zaccur, and Ibri
- Mahli, Eleazar, Kish, and Jerahmeel
- Mushi, Mahli, Eder, and Jerimoth
- Aaron's descendants
- And King David, Zadok, and Ahimelech

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller begins when he says that this is the rest of the descendants of Levi. You will remember that in the last chapter—1 Chronicles 23—we already heard a list of the Levite family groups who would serve in the temple. However, although we see many of the same names here, you will notice that the storyteller only includes the Kohathite and Merarite clans in this list and not the Gershonites. You will also notice that the order of the families is different, and also that the storyteller gives more generations of names.

When you listen to this list, it is important to understand that in Bible times, people often used the word "son" to mean a descendant, and "father" to mean an ancestor. For example, when the storyteller says that Shubael was from the sons of Amram, we know from 1 Chronicles 23 that Amram was not Shubael's father but rather his great-grandfather.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what words do you use to describe the relationship between an ancestor and a descendant? If you want to say that a person descended from a particular ancestor, but you do not know or do not want to say exactly how many generations are between these people—like their son, grandson, great-grandson, or great-great-grandson—how would you say this? Pause this audio here.

You will also notice that from each family group, the people chose one male descendant to lead. However, in the original language, the storyteller does not always use the title "chief" or leader beside this person's name. Also, in the original language, the storyteller does not use exactly the same words or order of the names when he describes each family group and leader. However, some English translations choose to organize the names in a similar way throughout to make this clearer.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this list of families and leaders so that it is clear and easy for your audience to understand in your language? What would be the best way to structure the order of the names for each family group and leader? Do you need to use the word "leader" or "chief" every time to make it clear how they chose each person? What other translation choices would it help to discuss? Pause this audio here.

First in the list, the storyteller says, “Of the sons of Amram: Shubael; of the sons of Shubael: Jehdeiah.” This means that Jehdeih, who they chose to lead this family group, was a descendant of Shubael, and Shubael was a descendant of Amram. Although the storyteller does not say it here, you will remember that Amram was a descendant of Kohath, or a Kohathite.

Second, the storyteller says, “As for Rehabiah, from his sons: Isshiah the chief.” This means that Isshiah was a descendant of Rehabiah, and Isshiah became the leader of this family group. Again, you will remember from the previous list in chapter 23 that Rehabiah was also a descendant of Kohath.

Third, the storyteller says, “From the Izharites: Shelomoth; from the sons of Shelomoth: Jahath.” This means that Jahath was a descendant of Shelomoth, and Shelomoth was a descendant of Izhar. In 1 Chronicles 23, the storyteller says this name “Shelomith,” but we know that this is the same person as “Shelomoth” in this passage. Again, you will remember that Izhar was a descendant of Kohath, and so Jahath became the leader for this family group among the Kohathite clan.

In the original language, it is not clear what the storyteller says about the fourth family group. However, most translations say that of the sons or descendants of Hebron, Jeriah was the chief or first leader, Amariah was the second leader, Jahaziel was the third leader, and Jekameam was the fourth leader. Again, you will remember that Hebron was a descendant of Kohath, which means this family group was also part of the Kohathite clan.

Fifth, the storyteller says, “The son of Uzziel: Micah; from the sons of Micah: Shamir.” Then the storyteller continues, “The brother of Micah: Isshiah; from the sons of Isshiah: Zechariah.”

This means that Micah and Isshiah were sons of Uzziel, and the leaders chose Micah’s son Shamir and Isshiah’s son Zechariah. Again, you will remember from chapter 23 that Uzziel’s family descended from Kohath, which means they were part of the Kohathite clan.

Sixth, the storyteller says, “The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. The son of Jaaziah: Beno.” Then the storyteller continues, “The sons of Merari: from Jaaziah: Beno, Shoham, Zaccur, and Ibri.” Scholars disagree about how to translate these descendants of Merari. Part of what makes this difficult is that in the original language, it is unclear how Jaaziah relates to Merari. Some translations list Jaaziah as a third son of Merari, along with Mahli and Mushi, rather than simply a descendant of Merari. However, chapter 23 only mentions Mahli and Mushi, so we do not know if this is correct. Another thing that is uncertain is that while the word “Beno” could be the name of a son, it could also mean “his son.” Unfortunately, because Jaaziah, Beno, Shoham, Zaccur, and Ibri are not mentioned anywhere else in the Bible, we cannot know for sure what the storyteller meant. However, while we do not know the exact order of the generations, we can be sure that these men descended from Merari.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this part of the passage where we are uncertain exactly what the storyteller means? For example, here are some possible ways you could say it:

- The sons of Merari were Mahli, Mushi, and Jaaziah. Merari’s son Jaaziah had four sons. The names of these sons were Beno, Shoham, Zaccur, and Ibri; or
- From the descendants of Merari, the leaders were Mahli and Mushi. From the descendants of Merari through Jaaziah, the leaders were Beno, Shoham, Zaccur, and Ibri; or
- Mahli, Mushi, and Jaaziah were descendants of Merari. Jaaziah had three sons: Shoham, Zaccur, and Ibri.

Pause this audio here.

Seventh, the storyteller says, “From Mahli: Eleazar, who had no sons.” And then the storyteller continues, “From Kish, the son of Kish: Jerahmeel.” Again, we remember from 1 Chronicles 23 that both Eleazar and Kish were sons of Mahli. So it seems clear here that the storyteller means that Mahli had two sons, Eleazar and Kish, and that Eleazar had no sons, but Kish’s son Jerahmeel became the leader of this family group. Also, once again, we know from the previous chapter that Mahli was a descendant of Merari, which means this family group was from the Merarite clan.

Finally, the storyteller says, “And the sons of Mushi: Mahli, Eder, and Jerimoth.” Again, we remember that Mushi was also a descendant of Merari.

Now, the storyteller shows us he has finished this list when he says, “These were the Levites, according to their family groups.” Then the storyteller tells us some background information about how the people chose these

family group leaders. We hear that the “heads of each father’s house and their younger brothers alike” cast lots just like the clan of Aaron did in the last passage to choose the priests. You will remember that when people cast lots, they were asking Yahweh to tell them his will. So it seems important not only that Yahweh decided these leaders, but also that they were fair about the way they divided up the tasks among the family groups.

The storyteller says that they cast the lots in the presence of King David, Zadok, Ahimelech, and the heads of the fathers’ houses of the priests and the Levites. You will remember that “heads of fathers’ houses” means the leaders of each family group. And you will also remember that Zadok and Ahimelech were leaders over the priests who helped King David to assign the other leaders and tasks among the family groups of Aaron in the last passage.

Finally, the storyteller says that as they cast the lots in front of King David, Zadok, Ahimelech, and the other leaders, they chose work for the older brothers, or family leaders, in the same way that they did for their younger brothers.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 24:20–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller of the drama
- The people who listen as the storyteller recites
- Levi’s descendants
- Amram, Shubael, and Jehdeih
- Rehabiah and Isshiah
- Izhar, Shelomath, and Jahath
- Hebron, Jeriah, Amariah, Jahaziel, and Jekameam
- Uzziel, Micah, and Shamir
- Isshiah and Zechariah
- Merari, Mahli, and Mushi
- Jaaziah, Beno, Shoham, Zaccur, and Ibri
- Mahli, Eleazar, Kish, and Jerahmeel
- Mushi, Mahli, Eder, and Jerimoth
- Aaron’s descendants
- And King David, Zadok, and Ahimelech

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

For this step, choose one person to play the part of the author of Chronicles. This person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group in your language. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person who plays the author should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you can also play the audio recording out loud.

While you do this, imagine you are an ancient Israelite who listens to this list of descendants and the men who became leaders of these Levite family groups. Remember how important it was for the Israelites that Yahweh was their God, and also how important the Levites were because Yahweh chose them to serve him. Not just anyone could serve before Yahweh, so it was very important for people to know which families these men came from and also that Yahweh chose these men himself, as the people cast lots.

Pause this audio here and recite the passage.

The group should listen to this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person who plays the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person who plays the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The storyteller begins and says something like, "From Amram's descendants, Shubael was the leader, and from Shubael's descendants, Jehdeiah was the leader. From Rehabiah's descendants, Isshiah was the leader. From Izhar's descendants, Shelomoth was the leader, and from Shelomoth's descendants, Jahath was the leader. From Hebron's descendants, Jeriah was the leader, Amariah was second, Jahaziel was third, and Jekameam was fourth. From Uzziel's descendants, Micah was the leader, and from Micah's descendants, Shamir was the leader, along with Micah's brother, Isshiah. From the descendants of Isshiah, Zechariah was the leader. From Merari's descendants, Mahli and Mushi were the leaders. From Merari's descendants through Jaaziah, Beno, Shoham, Zakkur, and Ibri were the leaders. From Mahli's descendants, Eleazar was the leader, though he had no sons. From Mahli's descendants through Kish, Jerahmeel was the leader. And from Mushi's descendants, Mahli, Eder, and Jerimoth were the leaders." Pause the reciting. Ask the person who plays the author of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This is a long list of names to recite, but I want to make sure the Israelites know that the right men led these Levite family groups; or
- The tribe of Levi is the most important tribe in all of Israel, because Yahweh chose the Levites to serve him. So I know all of the Israelites will be very interested to know this information.

Ask the people who play the Israelites who listen as the author recites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- Family is very important in our Israelite culture. To know who a leader is, and whether we can trust that person, we must know what family they come from; or
- Other people may not recognize the names of these ancestors, but we remember stories that our parents and grandparents told about these people. So these names mean a lot to us!

Continue the reciting. The storyteller continues and says something like, "This was the list of the Levites, with the leaders of each family. Like their brothers, Aaron's descendants, these Levites also asked God to choose which jobs each man should do. So they threw lots in front of King David, Zadok, Ahimelech, and the leaders of the priests and the other Levite families. They chose work for the family leaders in the same way that they did for their younger brothers." Pause the reciting. Ask the person who plays the author of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- People need to know not only that Yahweh chose these men, but also that the people did everything while King David and the other leaders watched. This way, no one lied or cheated; or
- It is good that the people used the same process here to choose the leaders and assign work for these Levites as they did for the priests from Aaron's family. This shows that they did things in an orderly and careful way.

Ask the people who play the Israelites who listen as the author recites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- Only Yahweh can know for sure if a person will do good or bad things as a leader, so it is good to know that Yahweh himself chose these men; or
- We know that leaders have a lot of power and that sometimes leaders use that power to take advantage of other people. But we are glad to know that they chose the work for each man to do in a fair and equal way.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 24:20–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

1 Chronicles 24:20–31

In this passage, the storyteller tells us about the rest of the sons, or descendants, of **Levi**. You will remember that the Levites are people who belong to the tribe of Levi, one of the 12 tribes of Israel. Moses, through whom God gave the people his law, was a Levite. And Moses's brother Aaron was also a Levite. Those Levites who were descendants of Aaron became **priests**, and we heard about those priests in the previous passage. In this passage, we hear about the Levites who were not descendants of Aaron but who helped the priests in their duties. Use the same word or phrase for Levi as you used in previous passages. Look up Levite and priest in the Master Glossary for more information.

Throughout the passage, the storyteller talks about the **sons** of different men. You will remember that in the original language, this word could mean a man's literal son, but it could also mean a more distant **descendant**, like a grandson, a great-grandson, or even many generations apart. In fact, often "the sons of" an early ancestor like Levi could mean a group of related people that was very, very large—sometimes even many thousands of people! Use the same word or phrase for "sons of" as you used in previous passages when it means descendants, and use the same word or phrase throughout this passage. Look up descendant in the Master Glossary for more information.

The storyteller says that of the sons of Rehabiah, Ishiah was the **chief**, or **leader**. You will remember that chief means the leader of the family group. You will also remember that although the storyteller does not use the word chief to describe every leader in this passage, we understand that each man was a leader of that man's family group. Use the same word or phrase for chief or leader as you used in previous passages, and use the same word or phrase throughout this passage.

These were the leaders of the Levites according to their **fathers' houses**. You will remember that sometimes in the Bible, a father's house could refer to the family members who lived in one man's house, also known as a household, but other times it could refer to larger family groups who were related by a common ancestor but who lived in separate households. In this story, the term "leaders of fathers' houses" refers to the way they divided the very large families of the Levites into smaller family groups with a top leader over each group. Use the same words or phrases for "leaders of fathers' houses" as you used in previous passages. And for more information, look up household in the Master Glossary.

Just like the descendants of Aaron, their **relatives**, did in the last passage, here the people **cast lots** to choose these leaders of the Levite family groups. You will remember that to cast lots was the way people determined what Yahweh wanted to do or who Yahweh wanted to use in a certain situation. We do not know exactly how they did this, but people may have taken some objects, like different colored stones or sticks, and thrown them on the ground. Depending on how these items landed, it would then show the people which answer Yahweh gave. Use the same words or phrases for relatives and for "cast lots" that you used in previous passages. The storyteller calls these descendants the brothers of Aaron, but these could be anyone related to Aaron. Use the same word or phrase for relatives as you have used in previous passages.

In this story, the storyteller calls David "**King** David." Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. Look up king in the Master Glossary for more information.

The storyteller reassures us that the people chose work for the **oldest** brothers in the same way that they did for the youngest. In the original language, the word here for "oldest" means the same thing as the word for chief or leader that we see earlier in the passage. And the word "youngest" means insignificant, small, or even less privileged. So the emphasis here seems to be on each person's authority or power more so than their physical age, although often in this culture, the older people had more authority and were the leaders. Use the same word for oldest, head, or chief as you have in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **youngest**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 24:20–31

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (683 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1004 KB)

1 Chronicles 25:1–7

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 25:1–7 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 25:1–7 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 25:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, the storyteller listed the other leaders of the Levite family groups. We also heard how the people cast lots to choose the leaders of each family group, just as the priests from Aaron's clan did previously. Now, in this story, we will hear how the people organized the groups of temple musicians.

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As the story begins, we hear that David, with the help of the chiefs or leaders of the Levites, chose men from the families of Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun. David and the leaders gave these people the special job to proclaim God's message through music at the temple Solomon would build in Jerusalem. These people would sing songs about God and play musical instruments called harps, lyres, and cymbals. You will remember that harps and lyres were musical instruments with strings that people would pluck to make beautiful sounds, and cymbals were metal instruments that people would hit together to make a loud noise.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of a harp, a lyre, and cymbals. Pause this audio here.

These songs would help the Israelite people to understand God's truth and to obey God's commands.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are some songs that people sing in your culture to remind themselves or others of important truths? Sing some of these songs to the group now. Pause this audio here.

Now we hear a list of the men whom David and the leaders chose to do this work as musicians. From the sons or descendants of Asaph, they chose four men: Zaccur, Joseph, Nethaniah, and Asarelah. They put Asaph in charge of these men, and Asaph would sing the messages of God whenever the king told him to.

From the descendants of Jeduthun, they chose six men: Gedaliah, Zeri, Jeshaiah, Shimei, Hashabiah, and Mattithiah. Jeduthun was in charge of these men. Jeduthun sang God's message while either Jeduthun or his descendants played the lyre. Jeduthun also sang to thank Yahweh and to praise Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you use music to worship God, or how do you use music to communicate with the spirits or other gods? What are some of the things you say in this music? Pause this audio here.

From the descendants of Heman, they chose Bukkiah, Mattaniah, Uzziel, Shubael, Jerimoth, Hananiah, Hanani, Eliathah, Giddalti, Romamti-Ezer, Joshbekashah, Mallothi, Hothir, and Mahazioth. Heman was the king's prophet, and all of these men were his descendants. God had promised to make Heman strong, so God gave Heman many children. Heman had 14 sons and three daughters.

All of these Levite men sang and played cymbals, lyres, and harps at the temple in Jerusalem. The king told Asaph, Jeduthun, and Heman what to do, and Asaph, Jeduthun, and Heman told each of their sons what to do. All of these men and their relatives learned how to make music very well. Altogether, these Levites who played music numbered 288 people.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 25:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: We learn how David and the leaders chose Asaph, Heman, Jeduthun, and each of their sons to serve as musicians in the temple. These men would sing and play music on the harp, lyre, and cymbals to tell God's message to the people and also to worship Yahweh. Then the storyteller gives us a list of the names of each of these sons who served as musicians.

In the second scene: We learn how the king told Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthan what to do, and then how each of these men told their sons what to do. We also learn that all of their other family members learned how to sing and play music to Yahweh, and that the total number of men was 288.

The characters in this passage are:

- The author of Chronicles
- The people who listen as the author recites this passage
- David and the chiefs, or leaders
- Asaph and his sons Zaccur, Joseph, Nethaniah, and Asarelah
- Jeduthun and his sons Gedaliah, Zeri, Jeshaiah, Shimei, Hashabiah, and Mattithiah

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- And Heman and his sons Bukkiah, Mattaniah, Uzziel, Shubael, Jerimoth, Hananiah, Hanani, Eliathah, Giddalti, Romamti-Ezer, Joshbekashah, Mallothi, Hothir, and Mahazioth

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The story begins when the storyteller says that "David and the chiefs of the service set apart for the service some of the sons of Asaph, and of Heman, and of Jeduthun." Although the storyteller does not use the word "King" here, we know this is the same King David we heard about in the last passage. In the original language, we are not sure exactly what the "chiefs of the service" means. This could mean military, government, or religious leaders, or it could mean the leaders in charge of the Levite family groups.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What will you choose to call these leaders in your translation? Do you think they were military leaders, government leaders, or religious leaders? Do you think they were the leaders of the Levites or a different group of leaders? Pause this audio here.

We do know that together, David and these leaders chose Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun and their sons to serve as the leaders of all the Levites who would sing and play musical instruments in the temple in Jerusalem. The storyteller says that these men "prophesied" with lyres, with harps, and with cymbals. When someone prophesies, they give a message from God to the people. In the Old Testament, people who prophesied would give messages or instructions from God to the people and would warn people what would happen in the future if those people disobeyed God's commands. In this passage, we understand the word "prophesied" to mean that these men proclaimed, or preached, God's message through the music that they sang and played on these musical instruments. This would help the people understand God's message and know how to obey God's commands.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, if someone receives a message from God, or from local spirits or gods, how does that person tell the message to other people? How do you talk about this kind of message and the way a person shares the message with others? Pause this audio here.

Harps and lyres were similar types of musical instruments in Bible times. Both had strings that people stretched over a frame or box, and people would pluck the strings to produce beautiful, vibrating sounds. Cymbals were a different type of musical instrument. Cymbals were thin, round metal plates that people would hit together to make a loud crash or ringing sound.

Stop here as a group and look again at pictures of a harp, a lyre, and cymbals, if needed. Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller says he will tell a list of the men who did this work.

From Asaph's sons, they chose Zaccur, Joseph, Nethaniah, and Asarelah. These four men worked "under the hand of Asaph," which means Asaph directed the work of his sons and told them what to do. We also hear that Asaph "prophesied under the direction of the king." This means Asaph sang messages from God whenever the king told Asaph to sing. You will notice in the next passage that Asaph's son, who is named Asarelah here, is called "Jesharelah" there. To make your translation easier to understand, you may decide to use the same name in both places.

Stop here as a group and discuss if you will use the same name for Aserelah and for Jesharelah in both passages. If so, which name will you choose? Pause this audio here.

From Jeduthun's sons, they chose Gedaliah, Zeri, Jeshaiah, Shimei, Hashabiah, and Mattithiah. Their father Jeduthun had authority over these six men and their work. Jeduthun sang songs with messages from God while someone played the lyre. It is not clear in the original language if it was Jeduthun or his sons who played the lyre while Jeduthun sang.

Some of the ancient copies of this book do not include the name Shimei here, but we are not sure why this is. Without this name, there are only five names instead of six. Also, Shimei is in the list in the next passage, so most translations include it here. Most place the name Shimei after Jeshaiah, although some translations place it after Mattithiah.

From Heman's sons, they chose Bukkiah, Mattaniah, Uzziel, Shubael, Jerimoth, Hananiah, Hanani, Eliathah, Giddalti, Romamti-Ezer, Joshbekashah, Mallothi, Hothir, and Mahazioth. You will notice in the next passage that the son named "Uzziel" here is named "Azarel" there, and in some translations, the son named "Shubael" here

may be named “Shuba-el” there. Once again, to make your translation easier to understand, you may decide to use the same name in both places.

Stop here as a group and discuss if you will use the same name for Uzziel and for Shubael in both passages. If so, which names will you choose? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that all of these were the sons of Heman, the king’s seer. A seer means a prophet of God. In the original language, the word “seer” literally meant to see or to perceive. This may mean that God showed Heman things that would happen in the future through dreams or visions.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call a person who has dreams or visions from God about the future? How do you talk about the special messages or warnings these people give to others from God? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller also says that God had promised to give Heman many children who would give him honor. In the original language, this literally means, “By the words of God to lift up a horn.” This is difficult to understand in the original language. The word “horn” may refer to how Heman’s sons played trumpets as part of their work as musicians in the temple. You will remember that a trumpet was a very loud musical instrument that people made from a ram’s horn or hammered metal. The Israelites would often play trumpets to worship Yahweh and to call people together to hear an important message from God. So the work that Heman’s sons did in the temple not only brought honor to Heman, but it also brought honor to God and the king. The storyteller says that God gave Heman a total of 14 sons and three daughters.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about children who brought honor to their parents. Pay attention to the way you describe this. Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller summarizes everything he has said in this passage. “All of these men were under the direction of their father for the music of the temple of Yahweh, with cymbals, lyres, and harps, for the ministry at the house of God.” This seems to mean that Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun showed their sons how to do their work as musicians in the temple, where the sons played cymbals, lyres, and harps. And the storyteller also says that Asaph, Jeduthun, and Heman were under the order of the king. So it seems the king told Asaph, Jeduthun, and Heman what to do, and then Asaph, Jeduthun, and Heman told their sons what to do.

Finally, the storyteller says that, “The number of them along with their brothers, who were trained in singing to Yahweh, all who were skillful, was 288.” This means that although the storyteller only named Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun and each of their sons, these three family groups had other relatives who also sang as temple musicians. And altogether, there were 288 people. We will learn more about these other people in the next passage.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 25:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The author of Chronicles
- The people who listen as the author recites this passage
- David and the chiefs, or leaders
- Asaph and his sons Zaccur, Joseph, Nethaniah, and Asarelah
- Jeduthun and his sons Gedaliah, Zeri, Jeshaiah, Shimei, Hashabiah, and Mattithiah
- And Heman and his sons Bukkiah, Mattaniah, Uzziel, Shubael, Jerimoth, Hananiah, Hanani, Eliathah, Giddalti, Romamti-Ezer, Joshbekashah, Mallothi, Hothir, and Mahazioth

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

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For this step, choose one person to play the part of the storyteller. This person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group in your language. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person who plays the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you can also play the audio recording out loud.

While you do this, imagine you are an ancient Israelite who listens to this list of men and their families who served in the temple as musicians. Remember how important it was for the Israelites that Yahweh was their God, and that they had the Levites to help the rest of the Israelite people obey Yahweh. Not just anyone could serve before Yahweh, so it was very important for people to know which families these men came from.

Pause this audio here and recite the passage.

The group should listen to this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person who plays the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person who plays the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The storyteller begins and says something like, "King David and his officers chose men from the families of Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun to sing God's message to the people. These men would also play musical instruments called the harp, the lyre, and cymbals. King David and his officers chose this list of men to do this work: From Asaph's sons, they chose Zaccur, Joseph, Nethaniah, and Asarelah. Asaph was the leader of his sons, and Asaph would sing the messages of God whenever King David told him to do that. From the sons of Jeduthun, they chose six who were Gedaliah, Zeri, Jeshaiah, Shimei, Hashabiah, and Mattithiah. Their father Jeduthun was also their leader, and he sang God's message and played the harp to thank and praise Yahweh. From Heman's sons, they chose Bukkiah, Mattaniah, Uzziel, Shubael, Jerimoth, Hananiah, Hanani, Eliathah, Giddalti, Romamti-Ezer, Joshbekashah, Mallothi, Hothir, and Mahazioth. All those men were sons of Heman, the king's prophet. God had promised to make Heman strong. So Heman had many children. God gave Heman 14 sons and three daughters." Pause the drama. Ask the person who plays the author of Chronicles, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The musicians were very important to help the Israelites worship Yahweh and remember Yahweh; or
- We need prophets like Heman who listen carefully to God and help us hear what God says; or
- These men were very well-organized. These men served Yahweh and the king very well.

Ask the people who play the Israelites who listen to the author, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- These songs help us to understand God better and remember what God says; or
- When we travel near the temple and hear these men play music, it reminds us that Yahweh is with us and that we should live and think as Yahweh says.

Continue the drama. The storyteller says something like: "All these Levite men sang at Yahweh's temple under the direction of their fathers, Asaph, Jeduthun, and Heman. The men used instruments that they hit together and stringed instruments to make music to worship Yahweh in his temple. The men served God in this way in his house, and the king told Asaph, Jeduthun, and Heman how they should be leaders in this music. All those men had skills to make good music, as well as their relatives. Altogether, there were 288 musicians." Pause the drama. Ask the people who play Asaph, Jeduthun, Heman, and their sons, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- It is a great honor to serve Yahweh in the temple; or
- We love to make music for Yahweh! There is no job we would rather do than to be Yahweh's musicians.

Ask the person who plays King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

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- Music to worship Yahweh is very important. When I was a young man, I sang and played the harp for King Saul, and that music helped Saul to experience God's presence and peace; or
- I am grateful that we have so many musicians to help lead the people to follow Yahweh. When people follow Yahweh, it brings peace to our land!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 25:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The storyteller says that David and the chiefs of the service set apart for service some of the sons of Asaph, and of Heman, and of Jeduthun. You will remember that chiefs means officers or leaders. In the original language, this word for "service" could mean work in the military, government, or religion, so these men could be leaders in the military, the government, or religion.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**chiefs of the service**." If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that David and the chiefs of the service set apart these men for this **service**. To set apart means to especially choose. The word for "service" is different from the word the storyteller used for service before. This word for service means to work hard with their hands. Use the same word or phrase for service as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**set apart**." If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller talks about the **sons** of Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun, and also the **brothers** of all of these men. You will remember that in the original language, the word "sons" could mean a man's literal son, but it could also mean other relatives or family members from a common ancestor. In a similar way, "brothers" could mean men who came from the same literal father, or it could mean other family members who came from a common ancestor. In this passage, each of the men that the storyteller says are sons of Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun are these men's actual sons. But when the storyteller talks about these men's "brothers," it means people who came from the same larger family group who share a common ancestor. Use the same words or phrases for sons and brothers as you used in previous passages. Look up son in the Master Glossary for more information.

These men **prophesied** with **lyres**, and **harps**, and **cymbals**. You will remember that to prophesy means to give a message from God to the people. You will also remember that lyres and harps are musical instruments with strings that people pluck to make beautiful sounds, and cymbals are metal instruments that people hit together to make a loud sound. Use the same words or phrases for prophesied, lyre, harp, and cymbals as you used in previous passages. For more information on prophecy and what it means to prophesy, refer to the Master Glossary.

The storyteller says Jeduthun prophesied with the lyre in **thanksgiving** and **praise** to Yahweh. Thanksgiving literally means to thank someone for something they have done, and praise means to show great satisfaction or thankfulness for a person's good qualities, such as great beauty, wisdom, or goodness. Use the same words or phrases for thanksgiving and praise as you used in previous passages. Look up "praise" and also "worship" in the Master Glossary for more information.

The storyteller mentions both **God** and **Yahweh** in this passage. Yahweh is a personal name that God gives himself, and this name shows the close relationship that God has with the people of Israel. Use the same words for God and for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. Look up God and Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information.

Heman was the **king**'s **seer**. You will remember that a seer is a prophet. Use the same word or phrase for seer or prophet, and for king, as you used in previous passages. Look up king and prophet in the Master Glossary for more information.

The storyteller talks about the **temple** as "**the house of Yahweh**" or the "house of God." The temple is the place where the Israelites worship God and where God meets with the people. Here, you can either use the word for temple or a phrase for "the house of Yahweh." Look up temple and house of Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 25:1–7

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (668 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (996 KB)

1 Chronicles 25:8–31

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 25:8–31 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 25:8–31 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.

5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 25:8–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous story, we learned how King David and the leaders chose Asaph, Heman, Jeduthun, and each of their sons to serve as musicians in the temple that David's son Solomon built for Yahweh. The storyteller also gave a list of the names of each of these sons and said that all of these men and their relatives, who were also trained temple musicians, numbered 288 people. Now, the storyteller will show how the people chose each man and the order in which they chose them.

The storyteller begins when he says that the people cast or threw lots to choose the order in which the men would serve before Yahweh. Whether a person was young or old, and whether they had much experience as a musician or were just learning, the people treated each man in the same way. You will remember that this is very similar to how the storyteller talked about the way people chose the other descendants of Levi in a fair and equal way in a previous story. You will also remember that to cast lots was a way people asked Yahweh's will about a decision.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people in your culture make decisions fairly as a group? When is it good to treat people differently because of things like their age, status, or level of skill, and when is it important to treat everyone in exactly the same way? What ways do you use to do this fairly? Pause this audio here.

Now, the storyteller gives a list of each of the sons. The storyteller also tells how each son has his own sons and relatives with him, so that each son has a group of exactly 12 men. You will remember that the storyteller already told us there are 288 men altogether. Now, we see there are 24 sons, with 12 men in each son's group, which makes 288 men. The names of each of the 24 sons are: Joseph, Gedaliah, Zaccur, Izri, Nethaniah, Bukkiah, Jesarelah, Jeshaiah, Mattaniah, Shimei, Azarel, Hashabiah, Shubael, Mattithiah, Jerimoth, Hananiah, Joshbekashah, Hanani, Mallothi, Eliathah, Hothir, Giddalti, Mahazioth, and Romamti-Ezer.

Scholars are not certain if the people used the lots to determine the different types of tasks each group would do or if it was only to decide the order in which each group would serve. We remember that in a previous story, the storyteller listed exactly 24 divisions or family groups of Aaron's descendants, the priests. And here we learn there are also exactly 24 groups of musicians. So it seems that each family group of priests and musicians may have served at the temple together at different times of the year in rotating order.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are some tasks or responsibilities that people in your community share so that no one has to do the same task every day? For example, maybe people take turns cooking food, fetching water, hunting, watching for enemies, taking care of children, or maybe even teaching or leading worship at your church. Pause this audio here.

One thing we notice about this list is that the names of the sons are not in the same order as the storyteller gave in the last story. Before, we heard all of Asaph's sons, then all of Heman's sons, and then all of Jeduthan's sons. But in this story Asaph's sons come 1st, 3rd, 5th, and 7th; Jeduthun's sons come 2nd, 4th, 8th, 10th, 12th, and 14th; and Heman's sons come 6th, 9th, 11th, 13th, and 15th all the way through 24th. Although this may seem out of order to us, it makes sense when we remember that the storyteller said they treated all of the men the same and did not choose them in order of their age or experience. Instead, when the people cast the lots, they asked Yahweh to show them the order in which Yahweh chose the men.

Stop here and do this activity: Imagine you are getting ready to do an important job together as a group, such as to build a house or plant a garden. Each person will need to do a different task to complete the whole job together, but everyone enjoys certain tasks more than others. So you will need to find a fair way to decide who will do each task. First, organize your group so that the oldest or most experienced people in the group will do the tasks people enjoy most, and the youngest or least experienced people will do the tasks people enjoy least. After you have organized yourselves in this way, have each person in the group describe how they feel about this way of doing things. Next, find a way to randomly choose who gets to do each task. For example, you could

write each person's name on a piece of paper, fold the papers up so no one can see the names, put all of the papers in a bowl or cup, and then pull one piece of paper out at a time from first to last to decide who gets to do which task. Now, once again, have each person say how they feel about this new way to organize things. Pause this audio here.

Another thing we notice about this list of sons is that the storyteller wrote many of the names differently here than in the previous story. For example, the son whom the storyteller called Zeri in the last story appears as Izri in this list, and the son Asarelah is now Jesharelah. Scholars are not sure why many of these sons' names appear differently in this list, but we know that these are the same men.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about some people in your community who people call by more than one name. For example, maybe a person has the name their parents gave to them at birth, but people also call that person by another name to describe the way the person looks or something they did that people remember. Or maybe someone has their own name, but people also call the person by their family name or their father's name.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 25:8–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller says that the people cast lots to choose the order of the men's responsibilities. Whether a man was young or old, and whether that man had a lot of experience as a musician or was just learning, people treated every man in the same way.

In the second scene: The storyteller gives us a list of each man's name and the number of their family members who served with them. The storyteller lists 24 sons from the families of Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun. And each one of these sons and their relatives with them formed a group of 12 men.

The characters in this passage are:

- Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun, although the storyteller only mentions Asaph's name in this story
- Joseph, son of Asaph
- Gedaliah, son of Jeduthun
- Zaccur, son of Asaph
- Izri, son of Jeduthun
- Nethaniah, son of Asaph
- Bukkiah, son of Heman
- Jesarelah, son of Asaph
- Jeshaiah, son of Jeduthun
- Mattaniah, son of Heman
- Shimei, son of Jeduthun
- Azarel, son of Heman
- Hashabiah, son of Jeduthun
- Shubael, son of Heman
- Mattithiah, son of Jeduthun
- Jerimoth, son of Heman
- Hananiah, son of Heman
- Joshbekashah, son of Heman
- Hanani, son of Heman
- Mallothi, son of Heman
- Eliathah, son of Heman
- Hothir, son of Heman
- Giddalti, son of Heman

- Mahazioth, son of Heman
- Romamti-Ezer, son of Heman
- And all of the relatives they chose to serve with each of these sons of Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

You will remember that in the last story, the storyteller told how King David and the leaders chose Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun and their sons to serve as musicians in the temple. The storyteller listed each son's name and told how all of these men, along with their relatives who were also trained as musicians, totalled 288 people. Now, the storyteller will continue with his story and give more information about these men and how they divided up their responsibilities.

In the first scene, the storyteller says that these men cast lots for their duties. The storyteller may mean that the men cast the lots to decide which group would perform which task. But most scholars agree that it is more likely that this just means that they cast the lots to decide which order the men would serve in the temple, just like the other Levites did in a previous story.

The storyteller also emphasizes that all of the men alike cast lots for their duties, whether the men were young or old, a teacher or a student. In Israelite culture, people treated older people with more respect and authority, and also gave more authority to a person who was more skilled or experienced and could teach others. However, the storyteller seems to say that in this situation, they used the lots to decide who would go first, so that in some cases, younger or less-experienced people might have gone before older and more experienced people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you talk about people who are older or more important and also people who are younger or less important in the community? Also, how do you talk about people who are more skilled or experienced at something and people who have little experience or are just starting to learn that thing? What would be some good ways to talk about these ideas in your translation? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller tells the order in which the lots chose the men. The storyteller also tells how many sons and relatives served with that man.

Stop here as a group and listen again to 1 Chronicles 25:8–31. When you hear the storyteller give the list of these men, try to identify the pattern the storyteller uses to give that information. Pause this audio here.

You will notice that the storyteller talks about the first son on the list, Joseph, a little differently than the other sons. First, this is the only son where the storyteller mentions the father by name—Asaph. We are not sure why the storyteller does this, but you should do the same in your translation. Second, we notice that the first son, Joseph, is the only one in the list whom the storyteller does not mention other sons and relatives. However, we know that Joseph did have relatives with him to form a group of 12 men. We know this because in the last story, the storyteller told us there are a total of 288 men. There are 24 sons, and each of the other sons' relatives with him forms a group of 12 men. So each of the 24 groups of men would need to be 12 men to add up to 288 men altogether. Therefore, even though it is not in the original language, some translations add the phrase after Joseph's name to say that his sons and relatives, together with him, formed a group of 12 men.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you talk about Joseph? Will you add the information after his name to say that he and his relatives formed a group of 12 men? Or will you not say this information about Joseph and trust that people will understand this is true for Joseph just as it is true for all of the other sons in the list? Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you structure the information about each son's family members and the size of their group? In the original language, the storyteller repeats the same information about the family group after each man's name. However, if you prefer, you could instead choose to give that information one time at the beginning and then just say each son's name in order after that. For example, "The 288 men divided according to their families into 24 groups, with a total of 12 men in each group and one man in charge of each group. These are the names of the leaders of each group and the order in which the groups did their work: First was Joseph of the family of Asaph, second was Gedaliah, third was Zaccur…." Pause this audio here.

You will also notice that in this list, the storyteller says some of the names of the sons a little differently than in the previous story. The son Izri in this story is the same son as Zeri in the last story, the son Jesharelah is the same son as Asarelah, and the son Azarel is the same as Uzziel. Although the storyteller says or writes these names a little differently in each story, we know that each of these sons is the same person. So if you think it would make your translation clearer and easier to understand, you may wish to use the exact same name for each of these sons in both this story and the last story.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Will you translate these names differently in each story, as the storyteller did, or will you make the names the same in both stories? If you decide to use the same names, which ones will you use? If you already talked about this and made a decision when you translated the last story, make sure to follow the same decision here. Pause this audio here.

Stop here as a group and practice telling this list of sons and their family groups. As you do this, you may wish to sit in a circle as a group so that each person in your group tells about the next son on the list. Help each other remember all of the names on the list. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 25:8–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun, although the storyteller only mentions Asaph's name in this story
- Joseph, son of Asaph
- Gedaliah, son of Jeduthun
- Zaccur, son of Asaph
- Izri, son of Jeduthun
- Nethaniah, son of Asaph
- Bukkiah, son of Heman
- Jesarelah, son of Asaph
- Jeshaiah, son of Jeduthun
- Mattaniah, son of Heman
- Shimei, son of Jeduthun
- Azarel, son of Heman
- Hashabiah, son of Jeduthun
- Shubael, son of Heman
- Mattithiah, son of Jeduthun
- Jerimoth, son of Heman
- Hananiah, son of Heman
- Joshbekashah, son of Heman
- Hanani, son of Heman
- Mallothi, son of Heman
- Eliathah, son of Heman
- Hothir, son of Heman
- Giddalti, son of Heman
- Mahazioth, son of Heman
- Romamti-Ezer, son of Heman
- And all of the relatives they chose to serve with each of these sons of Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

For this step, choose one person to play the part of the storyteller. This person will read or recite this passage out loud to the rest of the group in your language. Everyone else in the group will play the role of an ancient Israelite who listens to the passage.

First, the person who plays the storyteller should read or recite the passage out loud without stopping. Pay attention to the flow and the focus of the passage. Help the reader if some of the names are difficult. If the passage is too hard to remember, you can also play the audio recording out loud.

While you do this, imagine you are an ancient Israelite who listens to this list of men and their families who served in the temple as musicians. Remember how important it was for the Israelites that Yahweh was their God, and that they had the Levites to help the rest of the Israelite people obey Yahweh. Not just anyone could serve before Yahweh, so it was very important for people to know which families these men came from.

Pause this audio here and recite the passage.

The group should listen to this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person who plays the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person who plays the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and read or recite the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The storyteller says, “The men cast lots to assign their work. All of them drew lots, whether they were young or old, experts or beginners.” Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the men who cast the lots, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- Those of us who are older and more experienced could probably go first if we wanted to, but we do not want people to complain that we were unfair; or
- We will give everyone an equal chance by casting lots to let Yahweh choose. That way, if someone does not like the order, they can blame Yahweh and not us!

Continue the drama. The storyteller continues: “The men divided themselves by family into groups, with a total of 12 men in each group and one man in charge of each group. These are the names of the men in charge of each group and the order in which the groups did their work: First, Joseph of the family of Asaph. Second, Gedaliah. Third, Zaccur. Fourth, Izri. Fifth, Nethaniah. Sixth, Bukkiah. Seventh, Jesarelah. Eighth, Jeshaiah. Ninth, Mattaniah. Tenth, Shimei. Eleventh, Azarel. Twelfth, Hashabiah. Thirteenth, Shubael. Fourteenth, Mattithiah. Fifteenth, Jerimoth. Sixteenth, Hananiah. Seventeenth, Joshbekashah. Eighteenth, Hanani. Nineteenth, Mallothi. Twentieth, Eliathah. Twenty-first, Hothir. Twenty-second, Giddalti. Twenty-third, Mahazioth. Twenty-fourth, Romamti-Ezer.” Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the men chosen first, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We are surprised that Yahweh would choose us first, since some of us are younger and have little experience; or
- We did not expect to be first, but we feel very honored that Yahweh chose us; or
- It is a big responsibility to go first. This is the first time anyone will serve in the new temple, and we want to do it well!

Ask the people playing the men chosen last, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We feel surprised and a little offended that Yahweh chose us last. Some of us have more experience than anyone else; or
- We are relieved that we do not have to go first. This way, we can watch how the other groups perform their music and learn from them before it is our turn to perform.

Ask the people who play the Israelites when they listen to the men play music in the temple, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- We can tell which men seem to know and love Yahweh the best, because we see it in how they talk and act towards other people; or

- The men who help us worship Yahweh the best are not always the most skilled at singing and playing instruments. We love to hear the beautiful sound of the music, but it is the words of the music and the way the men live their lives that teach us how to follow Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 25:8–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In the first scene, the storyteller says that the people **cast lots** for their duties. You will remember that we do not know exactly how people cast lots, but they may have taken some objects like stones or sticks and written one man's name on each object. Then the people may have thrown the objects on the ground so that the way the items landed showed the order Yahweh gave to each man and that man's relatives to serve in the temple. Use the same word or phrase for cast lots or throw lots as you used in previous passages.

The storyteller says that the lots determined the men's service or duties. In the original language, this word means a service someone must do very carefully to fulfill a covenant or law. All of the Levites who served in the temple, including these musicians, helped the Israelites to keep the covenant with Yahweh by following Yahweh's commands. In the original language, this special word can also mean to heed or give attention to. You will remember from the last story that the musicians did not just sing and play music for Yahweh to hear. Even more important, the words of the music helped the people to learn about Yahweh and remember to obey Yahweh's commands.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the men's **duties**. Pause this audio here.

All of the men cast lots in the same way for their duties, whether they were small or great, teacher or student. In the original language, "small" means young or not important, and "great" means older or more important. Also, "teacher" means a person who is very experienced and can teach other people with less experience, and a student is someone who is learning from other people with more experience.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **teacher**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Each one of the 24 men, with their **sons** and **brothers**, formed a group of 12 men. In this passage, the sons are the literal sons of their fathers. Also in this passage, the word "brothers" could either mean men who came from the same literal father, or it could mean other family members who came from a common ancestor. Use the same words or phrases for sons and for brothers, or relatives, as you have used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 25:8–31

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (682 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1002 KB)

1 Chronicles 26:1–19

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 26:1–19 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:1–19 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:1–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

King David is getting everything ready for the temple that his son Solomon will build. Even though people had not built the temple yet, David wanted the people to be well-organized and prepared. Only Levites, the descendants of Jacob's son Levi, could work in the temple. The Levites had three main jobs: some were priests, some were musicians, and some were gatekeepers or temple guards. In the previous passage, we heard about how King David organized the musicians. Now, we learn more about the gatekeepers.

The gatekeepers had a very important job. The gatekeepers had to guard and take care of the temple. The gatekeepers' main duty was to guard the gates or doors to make sure everything stayed in order and that only the right people came in. The gatekeepers also opened and closed the temple each day, protected it at night, took care of supplies, and helped to get everything ready for worship. Basically, the gatekeepers made sure the temple stayed clean, safe, and ready for worship every day.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, who watches over special or important places? Is it religious leaders? Guards? Family members? Pause this audio here.

The temple had gates on all four sides: north, south, west, and east.

Stop here and look at a picture of a temple gate as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look also at a picture or pictures of the temple as a group. See the four sides of the temple with gates or entrances on each side. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller describes how the Israelites divided the gatekeepers into groups. There were three main families of gatekeepers: the first was Meshelemiah and his sons, the second was Obed-Edom and his sons, and the third was Hosiah and his family members. Meshelemiah and Obed-Edom were part of the Korah family, also called the Korahites. Korah was from Kohath, one of the sons of Levi.

The storyteller gives us a list of leaders of the gatekeepers from each family.

First, the storyteller talks about Meshelemiah's family. Meshelemiah was the son of Kore, and Kore came from a man named Asaph.

Now, this is a little confusing. In a previous passage, we heard that Asaph was a temple musician, and from a different family line, the family of Gershon, not Kohath. The Asaph here is not the same person as the temple musician.

Meshelemiah had seven sons. In order of their age, oldest first, the sons are Zechariah, Jediael, Zebadiah, Jathniel, Elam, Jehohanan, and Eliehoenai.

Next, the storyteller talks about Obed-Edom's family. You might remember Obed-Edom from an earlier story. Obed-Edom looked after the ark of the covenant, the special box that showed God's presence, for three months. And during that time, God blessed or showed favour to Obed-Edom's family. Obed-Edom had eight sons. The oldest son was Shemaiah, then there were Jehozabad, Joah, Sacar, Nethanel, Ammiel, Issachar, and Peullethai. The storyteller says that God "richly" or greatly blessed or favoured Obed-Edom with many sons. In those days, if someone had many sons, people saw this as a sign of Yahweh's blessing.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what is a sign that God has blessed a person or some people? What do people think about a family that has many sons? What are other signs of blessing in your culture? Pause this audio here.

Now, the storyteller mentions Shemaiah, the oldest son of Obed-Edom. Shemaiah had sons, too. Shemaiah's sons were strong and capable men, and they were leaders in their "father's house." In other words, the sons were well-respected leaders within their families.

These sons' names were Othni, Rephael, Obed, and Elzabad. The storyteller also names two other people, Elihu and Semakiah, who were especially strong and capable men. We are not sure if these were Shemaiah's sons or maybe his cousins.

Altogether, Obed-Edom had 62 family members who served as gatekeepers. All the "sons" or descendants of Obed-Edom were very capable men and had the strength and power to do the work. The storyteller may have meant that these men were physically strong enough to work as guards of the temple, or the storyteller may have meant that these men were wise and able leaders.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are the signs in your culture that someone is strong, not just physically, but in character or spirit? Tell stories about a man who was an able and well-respected leader within your community. What did that man do that made him so great? Pause this audio here.

There were 18 men from Meshelemiah's family altogether. These men were also very strong and capable men.

Then we hear about Hosah, who was from a different family, the family of Merari, another son of Levi. Hosah had four sons: Shimri, Hilkiah, Tabaliah, and Zechariah. Usually, the oldest son became the leader. But here, Hosah chose Shimri, even though Shimri was not the oldest. The storyteller does not tell us why. Maybe the oldest had died or was not a good leader. Hosah's whole group had 13 people who served as gatekeepers. So while Hosah only had four sons who served as gatekeepers, there were another nine of Hosah's relatives who served as gatekeepers.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do different sons in the family do? What responsibilities does the oldest son usually have? Pause this audio here.

All the gatekeepers were Levites, and they all had duties in the temple, just as their “brothers,” or other Levites, also served in the “house of Yahweh,” or the temple, in other ways.

So how did the people decide who guarded which gate? The Levites used a method of casting sacred lots. This was a common way to let Yahweh make the decision. We do not know exactly what the Levites used, but the “lots” could be stones, sticks, or pieces of wood with names that people had written on them. The people might put the items in a container, and then pick one. The idea was simple: Yahweh would guide the result. This was a fair way to organise the work among the families of Levite gatekeepers. Everyone had an equal chance, “small and great alike,” so things like their age, status, or experience did not matter.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does your community decide who does what job? Is it by age, wisdom, family line, or does someone make the decision? How do you make these decisions fairly? Pause this audio here.

Now, let’s look at which jobs the Levites had.

The Levites cast lots to decide which gate each group would guard. The lot for the temple’s east gate “fell to” Meshelemiah and his group. In other words, the result of the lot showed that Yahweh had chosen Meshelemiah and his group to guard the east gate. The east gate was the most important gate because it was the main way into the temple. Here, the storyteller calls Meshelemiah “Shelemiah,” a short form of Meshelemiah.

The Levites also cast lots for Zechariah, the son of Meshelemiah, who was a wise counselor or advisor. The lot showed that Zechariah’s group was the one Yahweh chose to guard the north gate. So that became their job.

The lot showed that Yahweh had chosen Obed-Edom to guard the south gate. Obed-Edom’s sons got the lot to guard the storerooms or storehouses. We do not know exactly what these buildings were or what the Israelites used them for, but they were probably part of the temple treasury. So they were places where the Levites kept money, other valuable things and supplies.

Then we hear about Hosah and someone named Shuppim who had to guard the west gate. But there is a problem here. We have not heard of Shuppim before! Some Bible experts think this might be a mistake. The name “Shuppim” looks and sounds a lot like the word for “storehouses” in the original language. So it is possible that the storyteller meant to say that Hosah was supposed to guard the west gate and take care of the storehouses.

There is something else a bit tricky here. The storyteller says that the lot showed that Yahweh chose Hosah and Shuppim to guard “the gate of Shalleketh on the road that goes up.” It is not clear exactly what this means. The gate of Shalleketh could be another name for the west gate, or it could be a second gate on the west side.

The “road that goes up” was a steep road that people had to walk on to reach a place that was higher on the land. This road led “up” to some important place, maybe the king’s palace or the temple.

Stop here and look at the picture of the temple as a group again. Look at the four sides of the temple and remind yourselves who was the leader of each of the sides. Pause this audio here.

Next, the storyteller talks about how the guards worked together. We are not sure exactly how the gatekeepers organized themselves. They may have worked next to each other, or the groups may have taken turns one after another to guard the gates. So one group would finish their time, and the next group would begin. The important point in this part of the story is that King David carefully organized the gatekeepers. King David wanted everyone to do everything for the temple with order, care, and respect, even the way the guards worked together.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time people had to take turns to guard something important, like animals, crops, or someone’s house. How did the people do this in a careful way? Pause this audio here.

Here is how King David arranged the guard duty. Each day, six Levites stood at the east gate, four Levites watched the north gate, and four more Levites stood at the southern gate. There were also two pairs of Levite guards who watched over the storehouses, where all the valuable things were. On the west side of the temple, six Levites guarded the area. Four of those Levites on the west side were on the road that led up to the temple, and two stood near a special area near the west side of the temple, which may have been a big porch with pillars. A porch is an area with a roof at the front or side of a building, not inside and not fully outside. Sometimes a porch has

strong poles to hold up the roof. What is clear is that David cared about the porch. David made sure that the porch had guards.

Stop here and look at a picture of a porch with pillars as a group. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller ends this passage with a summary that these Levite families, descendants of Korah and Merari, were the gatekeepers of the temple.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:1–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller introduces the Levite families who served as gatekeepers. The storyteller names the Levite leaders and sons and tells us that all of these leaders were strong and capable men.

In the second scene: The leaders assign or give each group of gatekeepers their jobs. The leaders divide the men and place the men at different gates of the temple: north, south, east, and west. The gatekeepers also guard the storehouses and some other important places.

The characters in this passage are:

- Meshelemiah and his family. Meshelemiah's sons were:

1. Zechariah
2. Jediael
3. Zebadiah
4. Jathniel
5. Elam
6. Jehohanan
7. Eliehoenai

- Obed-Edom and his family. Obed-Edom's sons were:

1. Shemaiah. Shemaiah's sons were:

- Othni
- Rephael
- Obed
- Elzabad

Obed-Edom's next sons were:

1. Jehozabad
2. Joah
3. Sacar
4. Nethanel
5. **^ ^**Ammiel
6. Issachar
7. Peullethai

Obed-Edom also had two other family members:

- Elihu
- Semakiah
- Hosah and his family

1. Shimri, who was the leader among his brothers, although Shimri was not the oldest
2. Hilkiah
3. Tebaliah
4. Zechariah

- Some translations include Shuppim
- Other Levites who would have helped cast lots and assigned the gates
- And Yahweh. The storyteller does not mention Yahweh, but Yahweh is present because Yahweh chooses the outcome of the lots.

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

As background to the first scene, King David is preparing for the work in the temple. The action likely takes place in the area where people will build the temple, in Jerusalem. While the storyteller does not mention David in this part, we know that David specially chooses certain families to guard the temple gates or entrances as gatekeepers.

Stop here and discuss what words or phrases you will use to translate "gatekeepers." Pause this audio here.

These men are Levites or descendants of Levi. David has chosen these men because they are strong and capable. These men are well-respected and trustworthy men. We hear a list of the sons of the three main families—that is, Meshelemiah's family, Obed-Edom's family, and Hosah's family. Meshelemiah and Obed-Edom both descended from Levi's son Kohath, through Kore, the son of Ebiasaph, the son of Korah. Hosah descended from Levi's son Merari.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Listen to the passage again and then use items like small pebbles and sticks to represent and understand this family tree. Use pebbles to represent each person and sticks to show the family line or connection. Consider using a larger pebble for Levi, and then smaller pebbles for Levi's sons. Do the same for the other descendants until you get to the characters in this passage. Pause this audio here.

Meshelemiah has 18 men in his family who will work as gatekeepers and are all strong and capable.

Obed-Edom has 62 men altogether. Yahweh has blessed or favoured Obed-Edom with a large family. Obed-Edom has eight sons. Obed-Edom's oldest son, Shemiah, has four sons, who are all very able. They are also well-respected leaders within their father's "house," that is, within their family. The storyteller also mentions two other strong and capable men from Obed-Edom's family. All the men from Obed-Edom's family are very strong and capable. They are well-suited for this work.

Hosah has 13 men in his family who will work as gatekeepers.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember how, in the last script, you discussed and told stories about a man who was a strong leader in your community. What words or phrases did you use to describe that man? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Collect a bag of pebbles, beans, or other small objects. Place larger pebbles as the three men who are the leaders of their families: Meshelemiah, Obed-Edom, and Hosah. Place smaller pebbles beneath each of the three larger pebbles to represent the family members within each of the three families. Notice how much longer Obed-Edom's family is than the others. Pause this audio here.

The second scene also likely takes place in the area where people will build the temple. Now, the Levites are "casting lots" to decide in a fair way which family will guard which gate. Both the old and the young, the more experienced and the less experienced, all have the same possibility to guard each gate.

It is important to remember that this method does not use magic, luck, or chance. It is Yahweh who decides the outcome.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Choose an object to represent each of the different tasks that gatekeepers and their helpers would have done, like to guard each of the gates, let the right people in, keep others out, and so on. The objects should be similar, like different colored rocks or pieces of paper. Put all the objects into a container. Ask each person to take turns "casting lots" and take an object from the container. Then

ask each person which task their object represents, and talk about what that job was and why it was important. Notice how everyone, the youngest and the oldest, all got a fair chance to have each task. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about the way that someone chooses between people in a fair way, no matter how different the people are? Discuss how you want to translate the way that the storyteller says that the Levites cast lots in a fair way. Pause this audio here.

The result of this method shows which family will guard which gate. Through casting lots, Yahweh decides that Meshelemiah will guard the most important east gate. In the same way, Yahweh decides that Meshelemiah's oldest son Zechariah will guard the north gate. Yahweh decides that Obed-Edom will guard the south gate, and Obed-Edom's sons will guard the storehouses.

Yahweh decides that Hosah and someone called Shuppim will guard the west side of the temple and a special place called the "gate of Shalleketh," which may have been a place where people threw out rubbish. This gate is near a road or path that goes "up" towards a place higher on the land, maybe to the king's palace or up to the temple.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss how you are going to translate the "gate of Shalleketh." In your culture, do you have a way to talk about an area that people use for waste or rubbish? You can use this to help your discussion. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss how you will translate "the road that goes up." Also, discuss how you will talk about the east, west, north, and south sides of the temple. Remind each other of what you discussed earlier in the book when you talked about the four sides of the temple. Pause this audio here.

The guards work in teams in an organized way. The groups may take turns to guard their area, one after the other.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Lay out pebbles in a line to represent the guards. Use a stick to represent the gatekeeping duty. Show how one pebble, or guard, passes the stick to the next. This is how they worked, one group after the other, taking care of the temple gates. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Think of your discussion on the previous script about a time people had to take turns to guard something. What words or phrases did you use to talk about this? Pause this audio here.

King David arranges the structure of the work. Every day, there will be six Levites standing at the east gate, four at the north gate, and four at the south gate. There will also be two pairs of Levite guards to watch over the storehouses. On the west side of the temple, there will be six Levite guards. Four of the guards will be on the road that leads up to the temple, and two will stand near the special porch area.

Stop here and, as a group, look again at the picture of a porch with pillars. Do buildings have something similar to this in your culture? How will you translate "porch?" Pause this audio here.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Draw a simple square on the ground or on paper to represent the temple. Use objects such as stones or sticks to mark out the four different directions: north, south, east, and west. You can use two sticks with a leaf to represent the special porch area on the west side, and you can mark out a road or path that goes "up" to a higher point of land. Let volunteers stand as the leaders of the gatekeepers who guard the four sides of the temple. Pause this audio here.

Finally, the storyteller summarises that the families of Korah and Merari divide their gatekeepers in this way.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:1–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Meshelemiah and his family. Meshelemiah's sons were:

1. Zechariah
2. Jediael
3. Zebadiah
4. Jathniel
5. Elam
6. Jehohanan
7. Eliehoenai

- Obed-Edom and his family. Obed-Edom's sons were:

1. Shemaiah. Shemaiah's sons were:

- Othni
- Rephael
- Obed
- Elzabad
- Obed-Edom's next sons were:

1. Jehozabad
2. Joah
3. Sacar
4. Nethanel
5. Ammiel
6. Issachar
7. Peullethai

- Obed-Edom also had 2 other family members:
- Elihu
- Semakiah
- Hosah and his family

1. Shimri, who was the leader among his brothers, although Shimri was not the oldest
2. Hilkiah
3. Tebaliah
4. Zechariah

- Some translations include Shuppim
- Other Levites who would have helped cast lots and assigned the gates
- And Yahweh. The storyteller does not mention Yahweh, but Yahweh is present because Yahweh chooses the outcome of the lots.

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The storyteller introduces the three main families whom King David has chosen to be gatekeepers. First, we hear of Meshelemiah and his sons. Meshelemiah had seven sons. Next, we hear about Obed-Edom and his eight sons. The storyteller tells us that Yahweh had greatly blessed or favoured Obed-Edom with many sons. We now hear that Obed-Edom's oldest son Shemiah himself had four sons who were strong and capable men and who

were well-respected leaders within their families. There were also two other men within Obed-Edom's family who were very capable men. In total, Obed-Edom had 62 descendants, and all of them were very capable and well-suited for their work.

The storyteller adds that Meshelemiah had 18 sons and relatives, and that they also were very strong and capable men.

Both Meshelemiah and Obed-Edom descended from Levi's son Korah. Meshelemiah's father was Kore, and his grandfather was Ebiasaph.

Now, we hear about Hosah, who descended from another of Levi's sons, Merari. Hosah had 13 sons. The leader among Hosah's sons is called Shimri. Usually the oldest son is the leader, but in this case, Hosah had chosen Shimri as the leader, although Shimri was not the oldest.

As the other Levites served at the temple in other ways, these Levites had to serve as the gatekeepers or guards of the gates or entrances to the temple. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I must make sure that people protect the temple. I must choose strong, trustworthy men to guard it carefully; Or
- I must organize everything here properly before I die so that my son Solomon can take over and future generations can follow; or
- I feel hopeful that the temple will be a place where Yahweh's people can meet with Yahweh for generations to come; Or
- I feel pleased that Yahweh has brought me such excellent and trustworthy men to serve in Yahweh's temple.

Ask the person playing the gatekeepers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am greatly honoured that King David has chosen me and my family to be gatekeepers. It is such an important role, and I feel grateful and humble that the king has chosen me; or
- At the same time, this is a great responsibility! It is very important that we guard the gates of the temple well. I must be sure that my sons and grandsons do the job properly; or
- I feel proud of my family, of my strength, and my good reputation.

Continue the drama. The gatekeepers "cast lots" to decide which group would guard which gate. Everyone had an equal chance. In this way, Yahweh showed that Meshelemiah would guard the east gate, Meshelemiah's wise son Zechariah would guard the north gate, Obed-Edom would guard the south gate, and Hosah would guard the west gate. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We must be fair. When they cast lots for the gates, Yahweh must choose, not me*.* I want to be just; or
- I feel that I trust Yahweh completely. This decision is for Yahweh alone to make and I have complete trust in Yahweh to make the right choices.

Ask the person or people playing the gatekeepers "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like,

- This is a huge honour! King David is giving me a duty to guard the temple! I am feeling proud and excited about what part I will get; or

- I feel humbled. I realise that Yahweh did not choose me because of my skills, but by Yahweh's will. It is not about being the strongest or oldest, but about being willing; or
- I feel eager to serve Yahweh. I am ready to take on whatever responsibility the lot decides.

[!end] Continue the drama.

The groups of guards take turns in an organised way to guard the gates. King David planned that every day, six Levites would stand at the east gate, four at the north gate, and four at the south gate. There would also be two pairs of Levite guards to watch over the storehouses. On the west side of the temple, there would be six

Levite guards. Four of the guards would be on the road that leads up to the temple, and two would stand near the special porch area.

This is the way King David organised the temple gatekeepers, all of them descendants of Korah and Merari. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel pleased and joyful. I gave David the vision for the temple. It pleases me to see David and my people obediently preparing for it and honouring my instructions, which brings me joy; or
- I feel proud when I see these strong, capable, trustworthy men guarding my special temple; or
- I deeply care for my people. I want to protect the temple, but I also want to protect my people.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:1–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Gatekeepers will guard the **temple**, or **house of Yahweh**. For more information on the temple or "house of Yahweh," refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases you have used for gatekeeper and temple, or "house of Yahweh," in previous passages and use the same word or phrase throughout this passage.

The storyteller lists the names of the gatekeepers and their **sons**. In this passage, the storyteller usually uses this word to talk about a real son of someone. However, when the storyteller makes a summary statement about all the men from a family, he uses "sons" to mean a man's grandsons, **descendants**, or other relatives. The storyteller also talks about a man's "**brothers**," which can sometimes mean relatives. For more information on descendants and sons, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for sons or descendants, as well as brothers or relatives, as you used in previous passages.

Two of the **leaders** or **chiefs** of the gatekeepers were descended from Korah, Meshelemiah, and Obed-Edom. Meshelemiah has seven sons, and Obed Edom has eight sons. The storyteller says that **God** has **blessed** Obed-Edom greatly. For more information on God and blessed, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for leaders, God, and blessed as you used in previous passages.

Shemaiah's sons are leaders within their father's **house**, which is another way to say family. For more information on "house," refer to household in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for house as you used in previous passages.

This passage uses the personal name for God, **Yahweh**. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

The men in this passage are **Levites**, or descendants of Levi. For more information on Levites, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Levites as you used in previous passages.

People chose the different duties of the leaders of the gatekeepers by **casting lots**. Use the same word or phrase for casting lots as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 26:1–19

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (694 KB)
- Setting the Stage (7.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1000 KB)

1 Chronicles 26:20–28

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 26:20–28 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:20–28 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:20–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The previous story was about the gatekeepers who would guard the temple. Remember that David chooses these Levites to prepare for the temple, which David's son will one day build. Now this story is about the Levites who take care of the temple storerooms.

The Levites who are in charge of the storerooms in this story are relatives of the Levites from the last story. The storerooms or treasuries are rooms where people store useful and valuable things for God's house. The house of God can mean either the tabernacle or the temple, which are both places where people worship God. At this time, these Levites probably work in the tabernacle's storerooms, and one day will work in the temple's storerooms. The storerooms of the house of God probably have the vessels and utensils that priests use. These

rooms probably also have food items such as flour, oil, and wine. The storerooms for dedicated things probably have gold, silver, and other valuable items that people dedicate or set aside as a special gift to God.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kinds of gifts do people give or dedicate to God or to other gods? Why do people do this? Who takes care of these gifts? Where do people keep these gifts? Pause this audio here.

Two groups of Levites take care of the storerooms: one group from the family line of Gershon and the other group from the family line of Kohath. Both Gershon and Kohath were Levi's sons. Gershon had a descendant named Ladan, and leaders of Ladan's descendants are in charge of the storerooms of Yahweh. Jehieli is one of these leaders. Jehieli is the father of Zetham and Joel, who are also leaders. These descendants of Ladan are in charge of the storerooms in the house of Yahweh.

Then the storyteller introduces the Kohathite clans: the Amramites, Izharites, Hebronites, and Uzzielites. Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel were sons of Kohath. Members of the Amramite clan also work in the storerooms.

Shubael is from the Amram clan. Shubael is a descendant of Gershom, Moses's son. Shubael is also an official in charge of the storerooms. Shubael probably works with Ladan's descendants, as well as a man named Shelomith and Shelomith's relatives. Shelomith is a descendant of Eliezer, who is also from the Amram clan. Eliezer was the brother of Gershom, Shubael's ancestor. Eliezer was the father of Rehabiah, who was the father of Jeshaiah, who was the father of Joram. Joram was the father of Zikri, who was the father of Shelomith. So Shelomith and his relatives, Shubael, and leaders of Ladan's descendants take care of the storerooms.

In the storerooms are all the special gifts that people dedicate to God. King David and leaders of the Israelite families have dedicated gifts to God. These family leaders are also military leaders who are in charge of groups of soldiers, from 100 men to 1,000 men. Some family leaders are other kinds of military leaders.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, who leads family groups or clans? What are the armies or military groups like? Who is in charge of the soldiers? Pause this audio here.

Some of the gifts are plunder or things that people took from their enemies in war. People dedicate these things for the Levites to eventually use to take care of the temple.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people maintain or take care of places of worship? Who provides the resources or money to do this? Pause this audio here.

Shelomith and his relatives are also in charge of the gifts which the prophet Samuel, King Saul, Abner, and Joab brought. You will remember that Samuel was Yahweh's prophet and that Saul was king before David. Abner was Saul's army commander, and Joab is David's army commander. Samuel, Saul, Abner, and probably Joab all die before people build the temple. These men may have given these gifts for the tabernacle.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:20–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller explains which Levites are in charge of the storerooms. First, the storyteller talks about the descendants of Gershon.

In the second scene: The storyteller then talks about the descendants of Kohath who work in the storerooms.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Gershon's descendant Ladan
- Ladan's descendant Jehieli
- Zetham and Joel

- The Kohathite clans of Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel
- The men from the Amram clan, which includes Moses's sons Gershom and Eliezer; Gershom's descendant Shubael; Eliezer's descendants: Rehabiah, Jeshaiah, Joram, Zikri, and Shelomith; and Shelomith's relatives
- King David
- Leaders of the Israelite families, who are also military leaders
- The prophet Samuel
- King Saul, Kish's son
- Abner, Ner's son
- And Joab, Zeruiah's son

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the original language, we are not sure what the storyteller says at the beginning of the first scene. There are two main translations. Some translations begin this story with "Their Levite relatives are in charge of the storerooms." Other translations say that "Ahijah the Levite is in charge of the storerooms." We are not sure which of these the storyteller actually said because the word for brother or relative sounds very similar to the name Ahijah.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What version of this passage have you heard? What version would people in your area be familiar with or understand better? Discuss how you want to translate this portion. We suggest that you follow the accepted translation in your area. Pause this audio here.

These storerooms are for the house of God or "Yahweh's house," which is another name for the temple. Remember that people have not built the temple yet, but people have already begun to give and store things for the temple. The Levites may already use some of these things in the tabernacle, which is the place where people worship God.

Some of Gershon's descendants and some of Kohath's descendants will take care of the storerooms. First, the storyteller talks about Gershon's descendants. The wording in this part of the story is a bit difficult to understand. You may find that translations say it in different ways. Gershon had a descendant named Ladan. You may remember that in 1 Chronicles 6:17, some translations call this man "Libni." To make your translation easier to understand, you may decide to use the same name in both places.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Which version of this name have you heard? Discuss if you will use the same name for Ladan in both passages. If so, which name will you choose? Pause this audio here.

Some of Ladan's descendants are leaders of family groups. Jehieli is one of these leaders. You may remember that in 1 Chronicles 23:8, some translations call this man "Jehili." To make your translation easier to understand, you may decide to use the same name in both places.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Which version of this name have you heard? Discuss if you will use the same name for Jehieli in both passages. If so, which name will you choose? Pause this audio here.

Zetham and Joel are also leaders. Here, the storyteller calls Zetham and Joel "Jehieli's sons." Some translations call Zetham and Joel "Jehieli's brothers." These translations say this because in 1 Chronicles 23:8, the storyteller refers not only to Jehieli, but also to Zetham and Joel, as "sons" of Ladan. However, "sons" is another word for descendants, so Zetham and Joel are probably Jehieli's sons. Jehieli, Zetham, and Joel are some of the men in charge of the storerooms.

Then the storyteller talks about the men from the Kohathite clans who work with Jehieli, Zetham, and Joel. The storyteller lists four clans: the Amramites, Izharites, Hebronites, and Uzzielites. We know from other passages that these are Kohathite clans. The storyteller then begins to talk about Shubael. Though the storyteller does not say it here, we know from an earlier passage that Shubael is from the Kohathite clan of Amram. The storyteller talks about the clan of Amram in this passage and will talk about the other clans in later stories.

Shubael is a descendant of Gershom, Moses's son. Shubael works with Shelomith, a descendant of Eliezer, Moses's other son. So Shelomith is Shubael's relative through Eliezer. The storyteller includes Shelomith's family line, which is Shelomith's ancestors in order from father to son. First Eliezer, then Rehabiah, then Jeshaiah, then Joram, and then Zicri, who is Shelomith's father.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: As an activity, tell the others in the group the names of your ancestors from several generations. Start with one man, like your great-great-grandfather, and then tell this man's descendants until you reach your own name. Pay attention to the way you show how one man is the next man's father. Then discuss how you want to translate Shelomith's family line. Pause this audio here.

You may notice that in this passage and others, the storyteller sometimes calls Eliezer's descendant "Shelomoth" and sometimes "Shelomith." To make your translation easier to understand, you may decide to use the same name in both places.

Stop here as a group and discuss this question as a group: Which version of this name have you heard? Discuss if you will use the same name for Shelomith in both passages. If so, which name will you choose? Pause this audio here.

Shubael, Shelomith, and Shelomith's relatives are in charge of the storerooms, too. There may have been different rooms that each man was in charge of, or perhaps the men all worked together as a team to lead other Levites. Many people gave or dedicated gifts to Yahweh. The Levites keep these gifts in the storerooms until the Levites use the gifts to serve Yahweh. King David and leaders of clans or family groups gave some gifts. These family group leaders are also military leaders. Some of the gifts that the king and the leaders gave were plunder or things they took from the enemies they defeated.

Shelomith and his relatives are also in charge of the gifts that Samuel, Saul, Abner, and Joab gave. Samuel was a seer. A seer is a prophet of God. God would often tell Samuel about things that would happen in the future.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call a person who has dreams or visions from God about the future? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller includes Saul's father's name, Kish, to remind us that this Saul is the man who was king before David. The storyteller also includes Abner's father's name, Ner, and Joab's mother's name, Zeruiah.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:20–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Gershon's descendant Ladan
- Ladan's descendant Jehieli
- Zetham and Joel
- The Kohathite clans of Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel
- The men from the Amram clan, which includes Moses's sons Gershom and Eliezer; Gershom's descendant Shubael; Eliezer's descendants: Rehabiah, Jeshaiah, Joram, Zikri, and Shelomith; and Shelomith's relatives
- King David
- Leaders of the Israelite families, who are also military leaders
- The prophet Samuel
- King Saul, Kish's son
- Abner, Ner's son
- And Joab, Zeruiah's son

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Other men from the tribe of Levi were in charge of the temple storerooms. These men also supervised the storerooms for the valuable things that people gave as gifts to Yahweh.

Some of these Levites were heads of different families who all belonged to the one big family of Ladan. Ladan was from the clan of Gershon. Jehieli was the leader of one of Ladan’s family groups. Jehieli was the father of Zetham and Joel, who were also leaders. These descendants of Ladan were in charge of the storerooms in the temple of Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jehieli, Zetham, and Joel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We feel honored that we help look after the storerooms in the house of Yahweh; or
- This is a big responsibility. We are glad that other men help us with this job; or
- We like that we can work with our relatives!

Continue the drama. Members of the Kohathite clans of Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel had responsibilities, too.

Shubael, a descendant of Moses’ son Gershom, was the official in charge of the storehouses. A descendant of Moses’ son Eliezer also worked in the storehouses. This man’s name was Shelomoth. Eliezer’s son was Rehabiah. Rehabiah’s son was Jeshaiah. Jeshaiah’s son was Joram. Joram’s son was Zikri. Zikri’s son was Shelomith. Shelomith and his relatives were in charge of all the storerooms for the special gifts. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Shubael and Shelomith, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I want to honor Yahweh with the way I work! or
- I am amazed at the way that people honor Yahweh with all these beautiful gifts; or
- I am thankful that I have a good and important job.

Continue the drama. King David had dedicated gifts to Yahweh. The leaders of families also dedicated gifts. These leaders were commanders of troops of thousands or hundreds of fighting men, or were other army commanders. These leaders took things from their enemies in war and dedicated some of those things for people to use to repair the house of Yahweh.

Shelomith and his relatives were in charge of everything that people dedicated to Yahweh. This included the gifts which the prophet Samuel, Kish’s son King Saul, Ner’s son Abner, and Zeruiah’s son Joab brought. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing all the people who dedicated gifts to Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am thankful for all the things that Yahweh has done for me! I want to show everyone that I am thankful to Yahweh; or
- I love Yahweh and want to serve Yahweh. If I dedicate gifts, the priests can lead the people to worship Yahweh in the right way; or
- Yahweh is my God and is powerful. I want to honor Yahweh with these gifts.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am pleased that these people have dedicated gifts to me; or
- I love that the Levites work in a way that honors me; or
- I am happy that David and the Levites are organized and take care of the good supplies and gifts.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:20–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Some **Levites** take care of the storerooms. For more information on Levites, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Levites as you used in previous passages.

The **storerooms** or **treasuries** for the tabernacle, and later for the temple, are buildings or rooms where people store useful and valuable things for the tabernacle or the temple. Use the same word or phrase for storerooms or treasuries as you used in previous passages.

These are the storerooms of the **house of God** or the house of **Yahweh**. Remember that God is a more general name for God, while Yahweh is the personal name for God. The house of God is a way to talk about the place on earth where God lived among his people. People sometimes called both the tabernacle and the temple the "house of God." These storerooms were probably the tabernacle's storerooms at the time of the story. When people build the temple, these same Levites will work in the storerooms for the temple. So some translations say the "**temple** of Yahweh" instead of the house of Yahweh. For more information on house of God, refer to "house of God" and temple in the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for house of God or Yahweh, and for temple, as you used in previous passages.

In the storerooms are gifts that people dedicated or **consecrated**. People could consecrate an object to do a special task for God. These objects were now **holy** and belonged to God. People could not use these objects for ordinary use. For more information on consecrate and holy, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for consecrated as you used in previous passages.

Some of Ladan's **descendants** are in charge of the storerooms. A person's descendants are his children, grandchildren, and all future generations from the same family line. For more information on descendants, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for descendants as you used in previous passages.

Some of Ladan's descendants are **leaders of family groups** or **clans**. Use the same words or phrases for clans and leaders of family groups as you used in previous passages.

King David dedicated gifts for the temple. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages.

The leaders of the family groups are also **military commanders**. Some of these leaders are in charge of groups of hundreds or thousands of men. Some of the leaders are other kinds of military leaders. Use the same words or phrases for these kinds of military leaders as you used in previous passages.

King David and the military leaders dedicate some of their **plunder**. Plunder is anything that a winning army takes from the army they defeated after the battle. Use the same word or phrase for plunder as you used in previous passages.

Samuel was a **seer**. A seer is a **prophet**. A prophet is a person who gives messages from God to the people. For more information on seer, refer to prophet in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for seer as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 26:20–28

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (684 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1007 KB)

1 Chronicles 26:29–32

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 26:29–32 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:29–32 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:29–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The previous passage was about the Levites who worked in the storerooms. Those Levites were descendants of Gershon and of Kohath's son Amram. This passage is about the descendants of Kohath's other sons, Izhar and Hebron.

This passage begins with Kenaniah and his sons, who are from the Izhar clan. Kenaniah and his sons do not work at the temple or "house of God." Instead, Kenaniah and his sons work throughout Israel as officials and judges. It is not clear exactly what these men's duties are, but they probably help with legal problems.

Then there are two groups from the clan of Hebron who also work throughout Israel. Hashabiah and 1,700 Hebronites are in the first group. These Hebronites are skilled workers and are in charge of religious and government business throughout Israel on the west side of the Jordan River. The Hebronites might make sure

that people follow the king's laws and God's rules. The Hebronites might also collect taxes for both the king and the temple.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find the part of Israel that is on the west side of the Jordan River. Pause this audio here.

Jeriah leads the other group from the clan of Hebron. During David's 40th year as king, someone looked in the genealogical records, or the records of the Israelites' families. This person found that many of Hebron's descendants were strong and good leaders. There are 2,700 of these leaders who live in the town of Jazer in the region of Gilead. Gilead is on the east side of the Jordan River. Jeriah leads these 2,700 men. King David chooses Jeriah and these 2,700 other Hebronites to supervise the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and East Manasseh. The tribes of Reuben, Gad, and East Manasseh live on the east side of the Jordan River. So Jeriah and his fellow Hebronites are in charge of religious and government business throughout the part of Israel that is on the east side of the Jordan River. Jeriah and his fellow Hebronites do the same work that Hashabiah and his fellow Hebronites do.

Stop here and look at a map of Israel as a group. Find the territories of Ruben, Gad, and East Manasseh on the east side of the Jordan River. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What people are in charge of government business in different regions in your area? What people are in charge of religious business in different regions in your area? Who chooses these people?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:29–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller explains what a group of Levite men from the Izhar clan does.

In the second scene: The storyteller explains what one group of Levite men from the Hebron clan does. These men work throughout Israel on the west side of the Jordan River.

In the third scene: The storyteller explains what a second group of Levite men from the Hebron clan does. These men work throughout Israel on the east side of the Jordan River.

The characters in this passage are:

- Kenaniah and his sons
- Hashabiah and the 1,700 skilled workers
- Yahweh
- King David
- Jeriah and the 2,700 leaders from Jazer
- And the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and East Manasseh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in the last section, the storyteller introduced the four clans whose ancestors are the four sons of Kohath. Then the storyteller talked about men from the first clan, the Amramites. In this passage, the storyteller talks about men from the Izharite clan and the Hebron clan. The storyteller does not talk about the men from the last clan, the Uzzielite clan, here.

In the first scene, the storyteller talks about Kenaniah and his sons, who are from the Izharite clan. King David assigns Kenaniah and his sons to work outside or away from the temple. Kenaniah and his sons work as officers and judges. Here, officers can mean either military officers or government officers. And here, judges are people who make decisions on legal problems. Kenaniah and his sons work all over Israel.

In the second scene, the storyteller talks about a group of men from the Hebronite clan. Hashabiah and 1,700 other Hebronites are strong men. This phrase in the original language can mean men who are physically strong or are skilled and able to do many things. Hashabiah and his fellow Hebronites work in the portion of Israel that is west of the Jordan River. Hashabiah and his fellow Hebronites work for the king and Yahweh. This probably means that Hashabiah and his fellow Hebronites are in charge of both religious and government business.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how would you talk about the way that people take care of both religious and government matters? Discuss how you want to translate the way that Hashabiah and his fellow Hebronites work for the king and for Yahweh. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller talks about a second group of men from the Hebronite clan. Jeriah leads this group of men. It is possible that Jeriah leads all the Hebronites. The storyteller pauses his story to explain how King David and other people knew that Jeriah was the leader and why King David chose Jeriah and his men. During David's 40th year as king, someone searched through the genealogical records for the Israelite families. This person found that there are many capable Hebronites at the town of Jazer in Gilead. Jeriah and these 2,700 men are leaders of family groups and also able men. So King David puts Jeriah and these 2,700 men in charge of the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and East Manasseh, who live on the east side of the Jordan River. Like Hashabiah, Jeriah and his fellow Hebronites do the work for the king and Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: As an activity, tell a story about a time when you chose a group of people to work on something together. As you tell the story, explain how you learned that this group of people was the right group to do this kind of work. Pay attention to the way that you explain what you learned about the people and when you choose to tell it. Discuss how you want to translate the way the storyteller explains why David chose Jeriah and the other Hebronites. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:29–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Kenaniah and his sons
- Hashabiah and the 1,700 skilled workers
- Yahweh
- King David
- Jeriah and the 2,700 leaders from Jazer
- And the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and East Manasseh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The Izharites were another Kohathite clan. Kenaniah and his sons were from the Iszhar clan. Kenaniah and his sons did not work in the temple. These men worked across Israel as officers and judges over the people of Israel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Kenaniah and his sons, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am happy to have this good job. I like to help the Israelites when they have problems; or
- I understand that this is an important job and I will try to do it well; or
- I hope Yahweh helps me make wise decisions.

Continue the drama. The Hebronties were another Kohathite clan. Hashabiah and his relatives were from the clan of Hebron. There were 1,700 Hebronites who were skilled workers. These Hebronties were in charge of all religious and government business throughout Israel on the west side of the Jordan River. These men served both Yahweh and the king. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Hashabiah and his fellow Hebronites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- This is a big portion of Israel to look after! I am glad there is a large group of Hebronites who work with me; or
- I hope the Israelites listen to us! or
- I want to serve my king and Yahweh well!

Continue the drama. Jeriah was another of Hebron’s descendants. Jeriah was the leader of the Hebron clan. When King David had ruled for 40 years, people looked in the ancestral records of Israel. These people found many descendants of Hebron who were strong and capable leaders. These Hebronites lived in the town of Jazer in the region of Gilead. Jeriah had 2,700 men who were strong and experienced leaders in their clans. King David chose these Hebronite leaders to supervise the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and East Manasseh. These Hebronites served both Yahweh and the king. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I was glad to see that there were so many skilled Hebronites! or
- Since these Hebronites already live on the east side of the Jordan River, I will assign these Hebronites to work there; or
- I am thankful that we keep good records of our people, so we can know where the leaders of families live.

Ask the person playing Jeriah and his fellow Hebronites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that I do not have to move across the river to do my job; or
- I am thankful that I get to work with people I know; or
- I hope that I can lead the other Israelites well.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 26:29–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Kenaniah and his sons work “outside,” or away from the **house of God**. The storyteller just says that the men work outside, but we know that he means that the men work away from the tabernacle, which later becomes the **temple**. Some translations just say that they worked away from the temple, or house of God. Use the same word for temple or house of God in this passage as you used in previous passages. For more information on “temple” or “house of God,” refer to the Master Glossary.

Kenaniah and his sons work as **officials** and **judges**. For more information on “judge,” refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for officials and judges as you used in previous passages.

Kenaniah and his sons work all over **Israel**. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages.

Hashabiah and his fellow Hebronites work throughout the portion of Israel that is west of the **Jordan River**. The Jordan River is a long river that runs through Israel from north to south. For more information on the Jordan

1 Chronicles 26:29–32

River, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for the Jordan River as you used in previous passages.

Hashabiah and his fellow Hebronites serve both the **king** and **Yahweh**. For more information on king and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for king and Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

People check the genealogical records or the places where people keep track of people's **genealogies**. A genealogy is a list of names of people who belong to the same ancestor. A genealogy can begin with one person and then give a list of this person's descendants, or it can begin with one person and give a list of this person's ancestors. For more information on genealogy, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for genealogy as you used in previous passages.

The second group of Hebronites serve both **God** and the king. This is a more general term for God. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 26:29–32

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (683 KB)
- Setting the Stage (1.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1001 KB)

1 Chronicles 27:1–15

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 27:1–15 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:1–15 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

At the beginning of this passage, the storyteller says that he is writing a list of all the people who have served in King David's army. It is important to remember that everyone in the army was an Israelite, which means they were descendants of Israel. The storyteller includes both commanders and officials, because these are likely two different positions. The storyteller uses "commanders" to refer to the leaders of the army divisions or groups. The storyteller also uses the word "officials" to refer to the men who kept the records for the army and who assisted the commanders. The storyteller has listed each of these commanders in previous passages as part of lists of David's "Thirty" brave and special warriors.

The storyteller organizes the list in a specific way to show the many people who are commanders or leaders and the hundreds and thousands of people who are soldiers in the army. The commanders and soldiers take turns each month. King David may have chosen this system so that commanders and soldiers could rest. King David had a strong army each month because both the commanders and soldiers were ready for battle.

Throughout the list, you can see that the storyteller repeats a consistent pattern. In this pattern, each commander begins to lead at the start of each new month. Each commander has a group of 24,000 soldiers to take the place of tired or killed soldiers. The storyteller also shows that there are leaders for both "hundreds" and "thousands" of soldiers. When the storyteller lists a commander's name, it is likely that this person is in charge of the entire group. These commanders then lead several other leaders who lead smaller groups of soldiers within the 24,000 men.

As the storyteller lists the monthly groups, it is important to remember that the first month does not necessarily mean "January" or whatever month your culture sees first in a calendar or new year. It is likely that the first month is actually March or April. It is helpful to know this because it will help you visualize the months that the storyteller intended for this passage.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you talk about months? Do you have different names for months of the year, or do you tend to use weather or numbers to show how time passes? Pause this audio here.

This passage is a different version of the list that you heard in an earlier passage from 1 Chronicles. This passage is also very similar to a list in 2 Samuel. The storyteller probably includes this list to show the strength of King David's army. This list repeats the names of David's mighty men whom King David trusted. This passage is the beginning of a longer list where the storyteller shows how important King David is and how brave David's appointed workers are.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think of as many people as possible that you would trust to keep you safe. Discuss why you would trust these people the most. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller includes the following commanders and the months they served in the list:

1. Jashobeam, son of Zabdiel, served in the first month.
2. Dodai the Ahohite served in the second month.
3. Benaiah, son of Jehoiada the priest, served in the third month. The storyteller reminds us that Benaiah was one of the leaders of David's special fighting force of 30 brave warriors.
4. Asahel, brother of Joab, served in the fourth month.
5. Shamhuth the Izrahite served in the fifth month.
6. Ira, son of Ikkesh the Tekoite, served in the sixth month.
7. Helez the Pelonite, of the sons of Ephraim, served in the seventh month.
8. Sibbecai the Hushathite, of the Zerahites, served in the eighth month.
9. Abiezer of Anathoth, a Benjaminite, served in the ninth month.
10. Maharai of Netophah, of the Zerahites, served in the tenth month.
11. Benaiah of Pirathon, of the sons of Ephraim, served in the eleventh month.
12. Heldai the Netophathite, of Othniel, served in the twelfth month.

For each month, the storyteller changes the commander's name and where he is from. But, it is important to pay attention to the ways the storyteller keeps each month's description the same. Each month, the storyteller says that the commander is in charge of an army division of 24,000 soldiers. This means that King David had 288,000 men in his army in this list.

It is likely that this list represents the army structure during peacetime. This structure allowed soldiers to serve for a month and then return to their homes and jobs until they were needed again. This structure also likely saved a lot of money and resources because the commanders only needed to feed 24,000 soldiers at a time.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How would you support your family if you had to be away for a month? What responsibilities would you need to consider before you leave? Pause this audio here.

There are a few important people to note in this list. The storyteller lists Jashobeam as the first commander. This may mean that Jashobeam is the chief or top commander of all other commanders and the commander of King David's mighty men. This could also mean that Jashobeam is simply the first commander for the first month.

The storyteller lists two different times when a son takes the place of a father after the father dies. Ammizabad takes the commander position after his father, Benaiah, dies. Similarly, Zebadiah replaces Asahel after Asahel dies. These moments seem to show how important it is to the Israelites to honor each generation.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What expectations or traditions do you have in your culture that require you to continue doing a family member's job or responsibilities after the family member dies? Pause this audio here.

It is important to remember why the storyteller chooses to repeat this list of people. The storyteller likely wants to show how powerful and strong King David's army is and how prepared the army is for future battles. By keeping the army in rotation, each division commander trains and continues the military preparations for future battles. This also means that when war breaks out, each commander already has a group of soldiers to lead.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller introduces a list of King David's commanders for his peacetime military. Each commander served one month at a time.

In the second scene: The storyteller lists the 12 commanders, two replacements, and one additional leader, who take turns each month, for 12 months. Each commander leads 24,000 different men.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller of 1 Chronicles
- Jashobeam, son of Zabdiel
- Dodai the Ahohite
- Mikloth, a leader alongside Dodai
- Benaiah, son of Jehoiada
- Ammizabad, son of Benaiah
- Asahel, brother of Joab
- Zebadiah, son of Asahel
- Shamhuth the Izrahite. Shamhuth is either from the city or the family of Izrah.
- Ira, son of Ikkesh the Tekoite, from the city of Tekoa
- Helez the Pelonite, from the tribe of Ephraim, from the city or the family of Pelon
- Sibbecai from the city of Hushah, from the family of Zerah
- Abiezer from the city of Anathoth, from the tribe of Benjamin
- Maharai from the city of Netophah, from the family of Zerah
- Benaiah from the city of Pirathon, from the tribe of Ephraim
- Heldai from the city of Netophah, from the family of Othniel
- 288,000 men—24,000 in each of the 12 months

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

This passage is the beginning of a longer list of King David's military structure, commanders, workers, administrators, and most trusted leaders.

In the first scene, the storyteller begins this list with an introduction to the list of commanders, the fathers or families of the commanders, the month each commander is in charge, and the number of people the commander is assigned to lead. Each commander leads 24,000 men, and each commander has a specific month when that commander and his 24,000 men serve.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Think about a situation in your culture where certain groups of people are responsible for certain activities at certain times of the year. Describe these situations. Pay attention to the words and phrases you use to describe the activities, the number of people involved in the activities, and the times of year they do them. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the word "commander" most likely means the person in charge of the military men. Likewise, the word "officer" most likely means the person who keeps a record of the men and is the person the commander communicates with if King David calls the full military to serve. The "heads of fathers' houses" most likely means the leaders of the clans of the different tribes of Israel.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your culture, what words do you use to show the difference in the levels or types of leadership? Discuss how you can explain King David's levels of leadership clearly. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us that each month, 24,000 men are on military duty. Then, for each month, the storyteller repeats this information when the storyteller lists information about each commander. Some translations only give the information about the number of men once in the introduction and then list the commanders by month. 288,000 total men serve each 12-month period, because 24,000 men serve each month.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Discuss how you will keep the passage simple when you list the people and their responsibilities. In your culture and language, is it more helpful to restate information for each month, or is it more helpful to state the information once at the beginning of the passage? Discuss the most natural ways to tell this list as a group. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller lists the 12 commanders in order of the months the commanders served. If you have decided to include the number 24,000 for each commander for each month, it is important to make this clear as you form the list.

Each commander serves one month, and each commander has a new group of 24,000 men to lead. The storyteller lists the following leaders and the months the leaders serve:

1 Chronicles 27:1–15

First month: Jashobeam, son of Zabdiel.

Second month: Dodai the Ahohite. In other words, Dodai was from the family of Ahoah. Mekloth seems to have been Dodai's chief officer.

Third month: Benaiah, son of Jehoiada the priest. Ammizabad, the son of Benaiah, may have replaced or helped Benaiah.

Fourth month: Asahel, brother of Joab. Zebadiah, the son of Asahel, replaced Asahel.

Fifth month: Shamhuth the Izrahite. Shamhuth is either from the city or the family of Izrah.

Sixth month: Ira, son of Ikkesh the Tekoite, from the city of Tekoa.

Seventh month: Helez the Pelonite, from the tribe of Ephraim, from the city or the family of Pelon.

Eighth month: Sibbecai from the city of Hushah, from the family of Zerah.

Ninth month: Abiezer from the city of Anathoth, from the tribe of Benjamin.

Tenth month: Maharai from the city of Netophah, from the family of Zerah.

Eleventh month: Benaiah from the city of Pirathon, from the tribe of Ephraim.

Twelfth month: Heldai from the city of Netophah, from the family of Othniel.

Stop here and try an activity as a group: Find 12 objects that are the same type of object but that have small differences. For instance, you can use 12 crayons that are different colors. Or 12 rocks that are different colors or shapes. Also, collect three items that each share a color or similar shape with one of the 12 objects.

Each of the 12 objects will represent a month. The three extra items will represent the two men who took over for their fathers, and Mikloth, who helped lead. Make sure these three objects match the three that they are replacing or helping.

Use these objects to help represent the 12 commanders and the months that the commanders served. This will help you start to picture the division of groups. Take turns talking through the order and the details for each month. Pause this audio here.

It is important to remember that this list is in other passages, so you may have chosen specific names already for each person. You should take your time as you go through the list and refer to 2 Samuel 23:8–38 to make sure you use the same names consistently.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it. Use the suggestion above and find other ways to help you understand the passage.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has 2 scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller of 1 Chronicles
- Jashobeam, son of Zabdiel
- Dodai the Ahohite
- Mikloth, a leader alongside Dodai
- Benaiah, son of Jehoiada
- Ammizabad, son of Benaiah
- Asahel, brother of Joab
- Zebadiah, son of Asahel
- Shamhuth the Izrahite. Shamhuth is either from the city or the family of Izrah.

- Ira, son of Ikkesh the Tekoite, from the city of Tekoa
- Helez the Pelonite, from the tribe of Ephraim, from the city or the family of Pelon
- Sibbecai from the city of Hushah, from the family of Zerah
- Abiezer from the city of Anathoth, from the tribe of Benjamin
- Maharai from the city of Netophah, from the family of Zerah
- Benaiah from the city of Pirathon, from the tribe of Ephraim
- Heldai from the city of Netophah, from the family of Othniel
- 288,000 men—24,000 in each of the 12 months

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The following list shows a record of the number of people in Israel. The list shows how many men serve in King David’s military, the commanders for the army, the leaders of Israel’s tribes, and the number of people that each person leads. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the storyteller, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I hope I do not forget to include anything! or
- This is a big responsibility! or
- I hope King David approves!

Continue the drama. King David appointed 12 commanders to help lead his military during peacetime. King David assigned one commander per month, and 24,000 new men rotated into King David’s service each month. 288,000 total men served in a 12-month period. Twelve original commanders, plus two commanders who took over for their fathers, took turns serving for one month as well.

- In the first month, Jashobeam, son of Zabdiel, led the men. Jashobeam also served as the head of all the commanders.
- In the second month, Dodai the Ahohite led the men. Mikloth also helped lead.
- In the third month, Benaiah, son of Jehoiada, led the men. When Benaiah died, his son, Ammizabad, took his place and led the men.
- In the fourth month, Asahel, brother of Joab, led the men. When Asahel died, his son, Zebadiah, took his place and led the men.
- In the fifth month, Shamhuth the Izrahite led the men.
- In the sixth month, Ira, son of Ikkesh the Tekoite, led the men.
- In the seventh month, Helez the Pelonite, of the sons of Ephraim, led.
- In the eighth month, Sibbecai the Hushathite, of the Zerahites, led.
- In the ninth month, Abiezer of Anathoth, a Benjaminite, led.
- In the tenth month, Maharai of Netophah, of the Zerahites, led.
- In the eleventh month, Benaiah of Pirathon, of the sons of Ephraim, led.
- In the twelfth month, Heldai the Netophathite, of Othniel, led.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ammizabad or Zebadiah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that my dad died; or
- I must make the men respect me! or

- I wonder if King David will approve of me! or
- This is a big responsibility!

Ask the person playing Jashobeam, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am honored to serve King David! or
- I had better get this right! People are looking up to me for help! or
- I hope I do not disappoint King David!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:1–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The storyteller talks about **leaders of families**, or clans. Each army commander also has **officers** who help him. Use the same words for leaders of fathers’ houses, or clans, and officers, as you have used previously. For more information about fathers’ houses, refer to household in the Master Glossary.

The storyteller presents a list of King David’s army structure and describes how the army operates. King David divides the army into 12 separate divisions or groups. Each division has 24,000 soldiers. Each division also has a commander who is in charge of all other leaders and soldiers. For more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **division**, **army**, **soldiers**, and **commander**. If you have already translated these words in previous passages, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller lists 12 commanders and two replacement commanders. The two additional commanders took over for their fathers after their fathers died. The 12 original commanders are some of the men whom King David included in his list of “**mighty men**,” also known as “The 30,” who fought well for King David’s kingdom. Use the same word or phrase for King David’s “Mighty Men” or “The 30” as you used in previous passages, especially in 1 Chronicles 11:10–31.

It is important for you to review and discuss as a group the names to make sure you use the same names as you previously chose. Here is the list again to help you compare:

1. Jashobeam, son of Zabdiel.
2. Dodai the Ahohite.
3. Mikloth, a leader alongside Dodai.
4. Benaiah, son of Jehoiada.
5. Ammizabad, son of Benaiah.
6. Asahel, brother of Joab.
7. Zebadiah, son of Asahel.
8. Shamhuth the Izrahite. Shamhuth is either from the city or the family of Izrah.
9. Ira, son of Ikkesh the Tekoite, from the city of Tekoa.
10. Helez the Pelonite, from the tribe of Ephraim, from the city or the family of Pelon.
11. Sibbecai from the city of Hushah, from the family of Zerah.
12. Abiezer from the city of Anathoth, from the tribe of Benjamin.
13. Maharai from the city of Netophah, from the family of Zerah.
14. Benaiah from the city of Pirathon, from the tribe of Ephraim.
15. Heldai from the city of Netophah, from the family of Othniel.

Use the same names for the list of King David’s commanders as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 27:1–15

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (2.6 MB)
- Setting the Stage (4.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 27:16–24

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 27:16–24 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:16–24 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:16–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, the storyteller explained the system that King David used for his military during peacetime. The people of Israel needed army structures in place because the structures helped keep the military active and ready for future battles.

In this passage, the storyteller shows us that King David records each tribal leader. You will remember that when Moses counted the number of Israelites in the story in Numbers chapter 1, he appointed a tribal leader from each tribe to help him. In a similar way, King David appoints tribal leaders so that the leaders can help King David count the people in each leader's tribe. These tribal leaders may also have communicated with the king and with each military commander serving in each month of the year. The word for leader also meant a prince or ruler for the tribe.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How do you appoint leaders who help govern people on a regional level? How do these leaders share information with each other so that they can protect and govern the country well? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller lists the following chief officers and their tribe assignments:

- Eliezer, son of Zicri, came from the tribe of Reuben.
- Shephatiah, son of Maacah, came from the tribe of Simeon.
- Hashabiah, son of Kemuel, came from the tribe of Levi
- and Zadok came from the "tribe of Aaron" in the Levites.
- Elihu, King David's brother, came from the tribe of Judah.
- Omri, son of Michael, came from the tribe of Issachar.
- Ishmaiah, son of Obadiah, came from the tribe of Zebulun.
- Jerimoth, son of Azriel, came from the tribe of Naphtali.
- Hoshea, son of Azaziah, came from the tribe of Ephraim.
- Joel, son of Pedaiah, came from the half-tribe of Manasseh, who lived west of the Jordan River.
- Iddo, son of Zechariah, came from the half-tribe of Manasseh who lived east of the Jordan River.
- Jaasiel, son of Abner, came from the tribe of Benjamin.
- Azarel, son of Jeroham, came from the tribe of Dan.

Stop here and look at a map of the different locations of the tribes as a group. Make sure to pay attention to all of the tribes that the storyteller mentions. Pause this audio here.

The first thing you may notice about this list is that the storyteller does not list two tribes that are usually included. The storyteller leaves out the tribes of Gad and Asher, and there is no real explanation for why the storyteller does this. The storyteller also includes a few new parts to the list of tribes.

The storyteller includes Aaron in the list as a tribe name, even though no other storyteller does this anywhere else in the Old Testament. It is likely that the storyteller includes Aaron as a tribe to represent the priests, who are a smaller part of the Levi tribe, also known as the Levites. Yahweh does not allow the Levites to fight in the military, so the storyteller probably includes them in this list to show that King David also has non-military tasks he wants leaders to do. The storyteller also lists Zadok as the chief officer of "Aaron's tribe," and this makes sense because Zadok is the high priest. It is probably best for you to note that the storyteller likely does not mean to include "Aaron" as a tribe, but the storyteller probably wants to show that the priests form a smaller group in the tribe of Levi and that Zadok is in charge of the group.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Think about your culture and the rules you have for certain people. Describe anyone in your culture who leaders do not require to do tasks that most other people have to do. Discuss why this is the case and how the community responds to these rules. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller also does something surprising when he divides the tribe of Manasseh into two half tribes. The storyteller chooses to divide the tribe by showing a geographical divide of how the tribe of Manasseh lives on both sides of the Jordan River. King David assigns the part of the tribe of Manasseh that is west of the Jordan River to Joel. King David then assigns the part of the tribe of Manasseh that is east of the Jordan River to Iddo. Again, the storyteller does not give a clear reason for this, but it is important to remember this difference from previous lists.

Stop here and look at a map of the Jordan River and the territory of the two half-tribes of Manasseh as a group. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller seems to present this tribal list without explaining the reason for it. However, at the end of this passage, the storyteller gives us a possible reason for this list. King David asks Joab, son of Zeruiah, to count the

Israelite men. It is important to notice that Zeruiah is Joab's mother, because storytellers normally only mention fathers' names. Zeruiah is King David's sister, so it is possible that the storyteller wanted to show the strength of King David's family line, because Zeruiah's sons served as well in King David's military. A person counts the number of people in a specific place by completing a census. A census shows how many people live in a certain region.

Stop and discuss as a group: How do you keep a count of the people in your community, tribe, or town? Discuss the different ways, both formal and informal, that you use in order to know how many people are in your community. Pause this audio here.

Joab does not count anyone under the age of 20 years old. It is likely that King David is trying to find out how many people are available to help defend Israel. King David only wants to count the people who are old enough to serve in the military. In previous passages, the storyteller shows that King David's motives for counting the men are not good. Many years before, Yahweh had promised to make the Israelite people as many people as there were stars in the sky, and although King David only counts the men over 20 years old, he seems to forget this promise. King David likely wants to know the number of Israelite men so that David can feel he has control and is prepared.

Stop and discuss as a group: Perhaps David thinks he is not disobeying Yahweh when he only counts men over 20 years old. Think of a time when you tried to get what you wanted by only partly breaking the rules in your home or community. Share with the group what happened. Pause this audio here.

However, Joab does not want to count the people, and Joab does not finish counting. Joab does not count the tribes of Levi or Benjamin, because Joab does not agree with King David's request. Even though Joab does not complete the census, Yahweh is angry at King David's decision. The storyteller never includes the full number of fighting men in King David's official records, or the book of the history of King David.

Stop and discuss as a group: Think of a time when someone forced you to do something that you knew was wrong. It may be that your leader made you do this, or it could be that your friends pressured you into doing something. Describe what happened to the group and how you felt about it. Pause this audio here.

It is important to remember that the storyteller includes this list as part of a bigger list. Instead of only showing leaders in a military context, this list shows tribal leaders who have other responsibilities outside of the army. The storyteller presents this list to show that King David's government was large, organized, and strong.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:16–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller lists the tribes of Israel and lists the officers that King David appointed over each tribe.

In the second scene: King David commands Joab, son of Zeruiah, to complete a census or to count the people of Israel. Yahweh shows his anger because King David tries to take control instead of trusting Yahweh.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller
- Eliezer, son of Zicri: Tribe of Reuben
- Shephatiah, son of Maacah: Tribe of Simeon
- Hashabiah, son of Kemuel: Tribe of Levi
- Zadok: "tribe of Aaron" in the Levites
- Elihu, King David's brother: Tribe of Judah
- Omri, son of Michael: Tribe of Issachar
- Ishmaiah, son of Obadiah: Tribe of Zebulun

- Jerimoth, son of Azriel: Tribe of Naphtali
- Hoshea, son of Azaziah: Tribe of Ephraim
- Joel, son of Pedaiah: Half-tribe of Manasseh—west of the Jordan River
- Iddo, son of Zechariah: Half-tribe of Manasseh—east of the Jordan River
- Jaasiel, son of Abner: Tribe of Benjamin
- Azarel, son of Jeroham: Tribe of Dan
- Joab, son of Zeruiah
- King David
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this passage, the storyteller continues to list the people King David has appointed to key roles in his kingdom. In the previous passage, the storyteller lists the structure of the military during peacetime, each commander in charge, and the month of the year each commander serves. The storyteller continues the list with the tribes and the men in charge who look after the tribes. King David most likely appoints all his leaders to help take care of his kingdom, but King David also likely uses this system to help his leaders communicate with other important leaders.

In the first scene, the storyteller lists tribes that make up the people groups of Israel. Each tribe that the storyteller lists has a leader or officer who is in charge of the tribe. This likely means that the officer keeps account of the people in the tribe and also communicates with army commanders who serve each month of the year. The officers are probably a link between the commanders and the people in Israel's tribes.

Stop and discuss as a group: How can you tell the difference between different types of officers, government workers, and leaders in your culture? Think about how these people dress, their titles, where they live, and other differences. How will you show the differences between the army commanders from the previous passage and the tribal leaders in this passage? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller includes several differences in this list compared to previous lists of Israel's tribes. The storyteller does not include the tribes of Gad and Asher in this list. The storyteller does not give a reason.

Another difference is that the storyteller notes a smaller group of people in the tribe of Levi. The storyteller seems to call one of the tribes "Aaron," and this is the only time a storyteller mentions Aaron in this way in the Old Testament. It is highly likely that the storyteller makes this point because the priests are a smaller group of the larger tribe of Levi. The storyteller names Zadok as the person in charge, and the storyteller likely wants to show that tribes sometimes have smaller groups in charge of certain tasks in Israel and the tribes.

The storyteller highlights another difference when he divides the tribe of Manasseh into two half-tribes. The storyteller uses the Jordan River as a clear dividing line for the tribe. Half of the tribe of Manasseh lives to the east of the Jordan River. The other half of the tribe of Manasseh lives to the west of the Jordan River. Again, the storyteller does not give a reason for this in this passage, but it is good to be aware of this difference.

Stop and discuss as a group: In your culture, what words or phrases would you use to show smaller divisions of a group that still shares the same name? In the passage, the tribe of Manasseh has half-tribes, but the half-tribes are still a part of the larger tribe. Think about how you can describe this. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller lists the tribes like this:

- Over the tribe of Reuben: Eliezer, son of Zicri.
- Over the tribe of Simeon: Shephatiah, son of Maacah.
- Over the tribe of Levi: Hashabiah, son of Kemuel.
- Over the tribe of Aaron: Zadok, who is in the Levites.
- Over the tribe of Judah: Elihu, King David's brother.
- Over the tribe of Issachar: Omri, son of Michael.
- Over the tribe of Zebulun: Ishmaiah, son of Obadiah.
- Over the tribe of Naphtali: Jerimoth, son of Azriel.
- Over the tribe of Ephraim: Hoshea, son of Azaziah.
- Over the half-tribe of Manasseh that is west of the Jordan River: Joel, son of Pedaiah.

- Over the half-tribe of Manasseh that is east of the Jordan River: Iddo, son of Zechariah.
- Over the Tribe of Benjamin: Jaasiel, son of Abner.
- Over the Tribe of Dan: Azarel, son of Jeroham.

Stop and discuss as a group: In your language, how would you list people, and give their titles and family names? In what order would you give the information? How will you most naturally give the information about each Israelite tribal leader? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller talks about a census or a way to count the people of Israel. In the story, King David ordered Joab, son of Zeruiah, to count every male who was 20 years old or older. King David did not count anyone who could not serve in the military.

Stop and discuss as a group: How can you describe a census or a way to count people? How does your culture describe this action? Pause this audio here.

This story shows how David wants to control the success of his military and his kingdom. Joab does not want to count all of the people, because Joab remembers that Yahweh made a promise to make Israel so large that there would be no way for anyone to count all of the people. Yahweh told Abraham many years before that someday there would be more Israelites than there are stars in the sky. Yahweh wants King David to trust Yahweh, and King David is not doing this. Joab chooses not to finish the counting because Joab knows it is not the right thing to do.

Stop and discuss as a group: In your language, how will you translate the phrase “more than the stars in the sky”? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller continues and says that, even though Joab does not finish, King David still tries to do the wrong thing. King David’s decision angers Yahweh, and Yahweh shows his strong anger, or wrath, to Israel. The storyteller finishes this passage by saying that the book of the history of King David never includes the final number of Israel’s people.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:16–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller
- Eliezer, son of Zicri: Tribe of Reuben
- Shephatiah, son of Maacah: Tribe of Simeon
- Hashabiah, son of Kemuel: Tribe of Levi
- Zadok: “tribe of Aaron” in the Levites
- Elihu, King David’s brother: Tribe of Judah
- Omri, son of Michael: Tribe of Issachar
- Ishmaiah, son of Obadiah: Tribe of Zebulun
- Jerimoth, son of Azriel: Tribe of Naphtali
- Hoshea, son of Azaziah: Tribe of Ephraim
- Joel, son of Pedaiah: Half-Tribe of Manasseh—west of the Jordan River
- Iddo, son of Zechariah: Half-Tribe of Manasseh—east of the Jordan River
- Jaasiel, son of Abner: Tribe of Benjamin
- Azarel, son of Jeroham: Tribe of Dan
- Joab, son of Zeruiah
- King David
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The storyteller should recite the drama, and the team should act it out.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses:

In this story, King David appoints officers to lead the different tribes of Israel. Each officer takes charge of each tribe.

Here are the tribes the storyteller listed and the officers who helped to lead the tribes:

Eliezer, the son of Zicri, led the Tribe of Reuben. Shephatiah, the son of Maacah, led the tribe of Simeon. Hashabiah, the son of Kemuel, led the tribe of Levi, and Zadok the high priest led the “tribe of Aaron” in the Levites. Elihu, King David’s brother, led the tribe of Judah. Omri, the son of Michael, led the tribe of Issachar. Ishmaiah, the son of Obadiah, led the tribe of Zebulun. Jerimoth, the son of Azriel, led the tribe of Naphtali. Hoshea, the son of Azaziah, led the tribe of Ephraim. Joel, the son of Pedaiah, led the half-tribe of Manasseh located west of the Jordan River. Iddo, the son of Zechariah, led the half-tribe of Manasseh located east of the Jordan River. Jaasiel, the son of Abner, led the tribe of Benjamin. Azarel, the son of Jeroham, led the tribe of Dan.

As part of the tribe of Levi, Zadok is in charge of the priests who begin with Aaron. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Joel or Iddo, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am glad I do not have to lead an entire tribe alone! or
- Am I more in charge of the tribe, or is he?

Ask the person playing Hashabiah, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I hope Zadok and I can work together; or
- I wonder what kind of work I will do because I am not allowed to fight, since I am a Levite!

Ask the person playing the storyteller, “What are you thinking or feeling?” The person might answer things like:

- Why did Yahweh choose not to include the tribes of Gad and Asher? or
- I want this list to make King David look strong and powerful!
- I hope I remembered every detail correctly!

[!end] Continue the drama.

King David commands Joab, son of Zeruiah, to count all of the men in Israel who are 20 years of age or older so that King David can know how many people are in King David’s military. Joab does not want to do this because Joab believes that Yahweh does not want Joab to. Yahweh promised that Yahweh would make Israel’s population so large that no one would be able to count it. King David tries to take control and wants to know how strong his kingdom is. Joab does not finish counting all of the people, because Joab knows that Yahweh will not approve. Even though Joab stops counting, Yahweh is angry and shows his anger to all of Israel. No one records a final number of Israelites in any records. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Joab, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- What is King David thinking?! or
- Yahweh is going to be so angry with me! or

- Maybe I can convince King David not to do this!

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I must know how many people there are who can defend me! or
- If I do not include women or children, surely this will not offend Yahweh?! or
- What have I done?!

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am so sad that King David has disobeyed me and does not trust me! or
- I must punish Israel for King David’s disobedience!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:16–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, the storyteller lists people whom King David appointed to **lead tribes** within Israel. This list is a part of a larger passage that shows all of the people who work for King David and who help lead. Use the same words or phrases for tribes and chiefs, or leaders of tribes, as you used in previous passages.

The storyteller lists the following people and tribes:

- Eliezer, son of Zicri: Tribe of Reuben
- Shephatiah, son of Maacah: Tribe of Simeon
- Hashabiah, son of Kemuel: Tribe of Levi; and Zadok: “tribe of Aaron” in the Levites
- Elihu, King David’s brother: Tribe of Judah
- Omri, son of Michael: Tribe of Issachar
- Ishmaiah, son of Obadiah: Tribe of Zebulun
- Jerimoth, son of Azriel: Tribe of Naphtali
- Hoshea, son of Azaziah: Tribe of Ephraim
- Joel, son of Pedaiah: Half-tribe of Manasseh—west of the Jordan River
- Iddo, son of Zechariah: Half-tribe of Manasseh—east of the Jordan River
- Jaasiel, son of Abner: Tribe of Benjamin
- Azarel, son of Jeroham: Tribe of Dan

It is important to pay attention to each name and make sure you use the same names and spellings as you used in previous passages. Use the same word or phrase for **tribes** and **Levites** as you used in previous passages. Look up Levites in the Master Glossary for more information.

After the storyteller finishes the list, the storyteller talks about the census or counting of **Israel**. King David commands Joab, son of Zeruiah, to count all of the men who are 20 years old or older. Use the same word for Israel or Israelites as you used in previous passages, and see the Master Glossary for Israel and Israelites if needed.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **census** or counting a population. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Joab does not want to do this, so Joab does not finish counting the men. **Yahweh** does not want **King** David or his people to keep count of the Israelites, because Yahweh promised to make Israel so big that no one could count the people. When King David and Joab try to count the men, Yahweh shows his wrath. Look up king and Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information if needed.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wrath**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Look up wrath in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us that no one writes down the number of the Israelites in the special book about the Acts of King David. In those days, people wrote books on long pieces of animal skins or paper that they made from papyrus.

Stop here and look at a photo of a scroll. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate **scroll** or book. Use the same word for book or scroll as you have used previously.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 27:16–24

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (835 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

1 Chronicles 27:25–31

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 27:25–31 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:25–31 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 27:25–31

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:25–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller makes a transition to listing the people in charge of King David's property instead of people concerned with the kingdom as a whole. As the storyteller lists each person and their role, it is important to pay attention to locations as well. The storyteller likely includes the location names to show how much land and resources King David ruled over during this time.

The storyteller lists the 12 men David appointed in order as follows:

- Azmaveth, son of Adiel
- Jonathan, son of Uzziah
- Ezri, son of Kelub
- Shimei, the Ramathite, from the city of Ramah
- Zabdi, the Shiphmite, from the city of Shepham
- Baal-Hanan, the Gederite, from the city of Geder
- Joash
- Shitrai, the Sharonite, from the city of Sharon
- Shaphat, son of Adlai
- Obil, the Ishmaelite, the descendant of Ishmael
- Jehdeiah, the Meronothite, from the city of Meronoth
- Jaziz, from the Hagrite people group

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In the list above, the storyteller mentions family names and where people are from. In your culture, what special ways do people use to introduce themselves, their family line, or where they are from? Discuss how you introduce yourself and others when you first meet each other. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller includes each man on this list for a purpose. Each person has a specific task to do for King David's kingdom. Storytellers never mention many of the men in this list anywhere else in the Old Testament. But King David gives these men honor by appointing them to each role.

Azmaveth, son of Adiel, oversees King David's storehouse and livestock. Some translators use the word "treasury," but the word for treasury can also mean storehouses and cellars. It is possible that Azmaveth acts as the royal treasurer over financial tasks as well as the storehouses and livestock. Storehouses usually refer to places where people keep grain and other crops. In the temple, priests put the tithes, or 10 percent of income, in storehouses. Azamaveth looks after King David's property in Jerusalem and makes sure that he protects it.

Stop here and look at a picture of a storehouse that holds grain and other crops. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at different types of livestock like cows, sheep, and goats. Pause this audio here.

Jonathan, son of Uzziah, also looks after storehouses and livestock, but Jonathan oversees all of the storehouses in the country, cities, villages, and towers where people go to guard fields. This is a large responsibility!

Stop here and look at a tower that people might use to guard an area. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller continues the list by naming Ezri, son of Kelub, the person in charge of all farmers and field workers who work the land and grow crops. This is also a large responsibility, because crops provide food for King David's home and for everyone in the kingdom.

The storyteller lists Shimei, the Ramathite, and Zabdi, the Shiphmite, as overseers of the vineyards. It is likely that Shimei is from a city called Ramah and is specifically in charge of the vineyard workers. Vineyards are large fields where people grow grapes on vines for food and to make wine. Shimei is in charge of making sure the workers plant and tend to the vineyard crops. Zabdi is likely from a city called Shepham and is in charge of the grapes once they are ripe and ready for harvest. Zabdi likely oversees the workers who harvest the grapes. Zabdi also oversees the people who make the wine as well as the process of storing the wine.

Stop here and look at a vineyard with grapes on the vines. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a person squeezing grapes. Also, look at people making wine from grapes. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a map that shows where Shimei and Zabdi are from. Look at Jerusalem, where King David is, and see where Ramah and Shepham are in relation to Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller continues with Baal-Hanan, from a village called Geder, who oversees the olive trees and sycamore fig trees throughout the land. Olive trees grow slowly, but olive trees live for a long time. Olive trees grow olives, and olives make olive oil. Sycamore fig trees are trees that have leaves like a mulberry tree and fruit like a fig tree. Sycamore trees grow all year long, and a sycamore tree's wood is soft and durable. Baal-Hanan is in charge of everything that keeps these trees alive and thriving, including the workers. The trees grow in a place called "Shephelah," which is located in the foothills of Judah, west of the mountains and east of the Mediterranean Sea. Joash likely worked closely with Baal-Hanan. The storyteller lists Joash as the person who oversees the olive oil. This is likely a big task, as people use olive oil to cook and in the temple.

Stop here and look at a sycamore fig tree with leaves and figs on it. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at an olive tree, olives, and olive oil. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a map that shows Jerusalem, where King David is, and the locations where Baal-Hanan and Joash are from, specifically Geder and Shephelah. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller continues to talk about the land when he lists both Shitrai, the Sharonite, and Shaphat, son of Adlai, as the people who oversee the herds of cattle. In this instance, the storyteller defines "cattle" as cows, bulls, calves, and heifers. Shitrai is from the plain of Sharon, a fertile land by the Mediterranean coast, and cares for the cattle in his homeland. Shaphat is in charge of taking care of the cattle in all the valley regions of Israel except the plain of Sharon. Shitrai and Shaphat likely oversee the workers who care for the cattle.

Stop here and look at a map that includes the plain of Sharon and all other valleys of Israel. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at photos of cows, bulls, calves, and heifers. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller ends the list with three workers who care for various animals throughout the land. The first worker is Obil, the Ishmaelite. Obil oversees the camels and all workers who care for the camels. The name Obil means "camel driver," so it is likely that Obil grew up around camels and knew how to tend them. Obil is one of the few people the storyteller listed who do not belong to the tribes of Israel. Obil is a descendant of Ishmael, Abraham and Hagar's son. King David is not against including workers who have joined the people of Israel in worshipping Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of a camel. Pause this audio here.

The second person the storyteller lists is Jehdeiah, the Meronothite. Jehdeiah most likely comes from a town called Meronoth. Jehdeiah oversees the donkeys. The donkeys are specifically female donkeys, and the people would likely use the donkeys to breed more donkeys. The final person the storyteller lists is Jaziz, the Hagrite. Jaziz tends the flocks of sheep and goats. Like Obil, Jaziz is also not an Israelite. Jaziz is a part of the Hagrites, a pastoral tribe that lives in the region east of Gilead. Again, both Jehdeiah and Jaziz likely oversee the other workers who tend the cattle and flocks.

Stop here and look at a map that shows where Jehdeiah and Jaziz are originally from. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a photo of a donkey, a sheep, and a goat. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a map that shows King David's property, including Jerusalem and all of the places the storyteller lists in this passage. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller ends this passage by saying that each worker he listed is a steward or caretaker of King David's property. It is important to remember that property can mean possessions that people can move, or buildings or objects that people cannot move. It is highly likely that King David trusted the men listed above very much, because these men managed everything King David owned. These men likely felt honored to be a part of King David's workers.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:25–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has six scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller lists the two men that David appointed to oversee the treasury, storehouses, and livestock for Jerusalem and beyond.

In the second scene: The storyteller then lists the person responsible for overseeing the land, the farming, and all of the workers and farmers.

In the third scene: The storyteller lists the two men who are in charge of the vineyards.

I**n the fourth scene:** The storyteller continues by listing the two men who are responsible for the olive and sycamore fig trees, and also for the olive oil production.

In the fifth scene: The storyteller lists the two men who tend the cattle.

In the sixth scene: The storyteller finishes the list by listing three men who tend to various types of animals.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller or Chronicler
- Azmaveth, son of Adiel
- Jonathan, son of Uzziah
- Ezri, son of Kelub
- Shimei, the Ramathite, from the city of Ramah
- Zabdi, the Shiphmite, from the city of Shepham
- Baal-Hanan, the Gederite, from the city of Geder
- Joash
- Shitrai, the Sharonite, from the city of Sharon
- Shaphat, son of Adlai
- Obil, the Ishmaelite, the descendant of Ishmael
- Jehdeiah, the Meronothite, from the city of Meronoth
- Jaziz, from the Hagrite people group

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Throughout this passage, the storyteller describes each person in the same way. The storyteller lists the person's name, where the person is from, and what the person does for King David.

In the first scene, the storyteller lists two people who oversee the storehouses, treasury, and livestock. Azmaveth, son of Adiel, oversees King David's storehouses and treasury in Jerusalem, and Jonathan, son of Uzziah, oversees the rest of the storehouses and treasury in King David's kingdom. Both men likely look after the financial treasury and the storehouses that hold grain, crops, and other important items for the kingdom, like livestock. The storyteller uses the word "country" to refer to fields in a countryside instead of official areas of land with borders. The storyteller continues by using the word "cities" to refer to areas protected by walls or structures. The storyteller also uses the word "villages" to refer to small towns without walls of protection. Lastly, Jonathan

1 Chronicles 27:25–31

looks after “towers,” which means places where people might store equipment, or towers where people can watch over fields or land to protect them against invaders or other dangers.

Stop here and look at a picture of a storehouse that holds grain and other crops. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at different types of livestock like cows, sheep, and goats. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a map that shows King David’s property, including Jerusalem and all of the places listed in this passage. You may want to keep this map available so that you can refer back to it. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller lists the appointed man who oversees the workers who farm the land and plant the crops. Ezri, son of Kelub, ensures the land is ready for planting and produces good crops for food and storage.

In the third scene, the storyteller lists the two men in charge of tending the vineyards. Shimei, the Ramathite, is from Ramah and oversees the vineyards until harvest as well as the vineyard workers. Zabdi, the Shiphmite, is from Shepham and oversees the people who harvest the grapes and the people who make the wine. Shepham also looks after the workers.

Stop here and look at a vineyard with grapes on the vines. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at people squeezing grapes. Also, look at people making wine with grapes. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a map that shows where Shimei and Zabdi are from. Look at Jerusalem, where King David is, and see where Ramah and Shepham are in relation to Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller lists the two men who make sure people produce the olives well, from growth to harvest. Baal-Hanan, the Gederite, from the city of Geder, grows sycamore fig trees and olive trees. Joash makes sure people produce the olive oil well. Both men likely oversee the workers as well.

Stop here and look at a sycamore fig tree with leaves and figs on it. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at an olive tree, olives, and olive oil. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at the map that shows Jerusalem, where King David is, and the locations where Baal-Hanan and Joash are from, specifically Geder and Shephelah. Pause this audio here.

In the fifth scene, the storyteller lists the two men responsible for the cattle, such as cows, bulls, calves, and heifers, and the workers who tend the cattle. Shitrai, the Sharonite, from the city of Sharon, tends the cattle in the plain of Sharon. And Shaphat, the son of Adlai, tends the cattle in all other valleys of Israel apart from the plain of Sharon.

Stop here and look at a map of the plain of Sharon and all the other valleys of Israel. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at photos of cows, bulls, calves, and heifers. Pause this audio here.

In the sixth scene, the storyteller finishes the list with three men who tend different types of animals. Obil, the Ishmaelite, is a non-Israelite who tends the camels. Jehdeiah, the Meronothite from Meronoth, tends the female donkeys. Jaziz, the Hagrite, a non-Israelite from the region east of Gilead, tends the flocks of sheep and goats.

Stop here and look at a picture of a camel. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at the map that shows where Jehdeiah the Meronothite and Jaziz the Hagrite are originally from. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a photo of a donkey, a sheep, and a goat. Pause this audio here.

In this session, have the group storyboard or draw in order to visualize the story and the action in it. It may be helpful to find an object to represent each person listed. For example, you could use oil to represent “Joash” or grapes to represent “Zabdi.” This may help you remember each person and the role each person plays.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:25–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has six scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller or Chronicler
- Azmaveth, son of Adiel
- Jonathan, son of Uzziah
- Ezri, son of Kelub
- Shimei, the Ramathite, from the city of Ramah
- Zabdi, the Shiphmite, from the city of Shepham
- Baal-Hanan, the Gederite, from the city of Geder
- Joash
- Shitrai, the Sharonite, from the city of Sharon
- Shaphat, son of Adlai
- Obil, the Ishmaelite, the descendant of Ishmael
- Jehdeiah, the Meronothite, from the city of Meronoth
- Jaziz, from the Hagrite people group

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The person playing the storyteller or Chronicler should read the script. It may be helpful to find an object to represent each person listed. For example, you could use oil to represent “Joash” or grapes to represent “Zabdi.” This may help you remember each person and the role each person plays.

This is a story about a list of people who helped care for King David’s property and possessions.

Azmaveth, son of Adiel, is the first person in the list and is the person who oversees King David’s treasury, storehouses, and livestock in Jerusalem. Jonathan, son of Uzziah, oversees the rest of the storehouses, treasury, and livestock in the countryside, cities, villages, and towers outside of Jerusalem. Both men hold important jobs as they look after the money and the stored crops and important items in King David’s kingdom. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jonathan, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel so important when I do this job! or
- I am anxious because I have so many things to look after!

Continue the drama. The next person in the list is a man named Ezri, son of Kelub. Ezri ensures the land is ready for planting, that the food grows, and that people harvest the food. Ezri likely looks after the workers who dig up the ground, plant the crops, and harvest the crops. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Ezri, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I hope we get enough rain so the crops grow! or

- Should I help dig up the ground, or am I only supposed to oversee the workers? or
- I am afraid that the crops will not grow.

Continue the drama. The next two people on the list are two men responsible for tending the vineyards. First is Shimei, the Ramathite, a man from Ramah. Shimei ensures the vineyards produce grapes until harvest. Second is Zabdi, the Shiphmite, from Shepham. Zabdi manages the harvest of grapes. Zabdi makes sure that the workers make the wine correctly. Both men likely look after the workers who help them carry out their duties. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Shimei, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I must get this right so that there will be harvest and wine! or
- I am worried the grapes will not grow! or
- Can I really depend on my workers?

Ask the person playing Zabdi, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hope no animals eat the grapes! or
- The wine must be the best for King David! or
- I am worried that diseases will kill the grapes and that I will get in trouble!

Continue the drama. Two men oversee the olive production. Baal-Hanan, the Gederite, is a person from a village called Geder who grows the sycamore fig trees and olive trees. Baal-Hanan plants and grows the trees, ensuring the olives and figs develop properly. Joash is a man who oversees the workers who make the olive oil. Both men likely oversee the workers who help grow, harvest, and process the olives and figs. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Baal-Hanan, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- These trees take a long time to grow! or
- I hope the weather is good and that the trees stay safe!

Ask the person playing Joash, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hope the olives that Baal-Hanan grows are perfect for making olive oil! or
- I must hire the best workers so we can make the best olive oil for everyone!

Continue the drama. The list continues with two men who oversee the cattle, such as cows, bulls, calves, and heifers, and the workers who tend the cattle. Shitrai, the Sharonite, from the city of Sharon, tends the cattle in the fertile plain of Sharon, and Shaphat, the son of Adlai, tends the cattle in all other valleys of Israel apart from the plain of Sharon.

Ask the person playing Shitrai, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so lucky to work in the same place where I have always lived! or
- I know the best places to take the cattle for feeding!

Ask the person playing Shaphat, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hope the valleys where I am are as good for the cattle as the plain of Sharon! or
- I hope I can trust my workers to tend the cattle well.

Continue the drama. The list ends with three men who take care of different types of animals. Obil, the Ishmaelite, is a non-Israelite who tends the camels. Jehdeiah, the Meronothite, is the person from Meronoth who tends the female donkeys. Jaziz, the Hagrite, is a non-Israelite from the region east of Gilead who tends the flocks of sheep and goats.

Ask the people playing Obil and Jaziz, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- It feels strange to work in the land of the Israelites! or
- I wonder if people will accept me since I am not an Israelite!

Ask the person playing Jehdeiah, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The people might answer things like:

- I hope these female donkeys are able to birth more donkeys! or
- How do I make sure we get more donkeys?

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:25–31 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The storyteller of this passage lists men who are the **sons** of other men. These are probably the literal sons of their fathers. Use the same word for sons as you have used in previous passages, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information about sons.

The storyteller in this passage lists key people who work for **King** David and his kingdom. The storyteller begins by introducing Azmaveth, son of Adiel, and Jonathan, son of Uzziah, as keepers of the treasury. The treasury may refer to both money and storehouses. Storehouses are places where people store crops and resources. Translate king in the same way you have previously, and for more information on king, refer to the Master Glossary if needed.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **storehouses** or **treasury**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Jonathan was in charge of the treasuries in the districts, cities, villages, and towers. Use the same words or phrases for **cities** and **villages** as you have previously. Remember that cities are settlements with walls around them, and villages are smaller groupings of houses near cities. These towers were special places where people could store weapons. People could also use towers to watch over fields and areas to see when the enemy was attacking. Towers are well-protected, like a fortress.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **tower**. A tower is like a fortress, but it is also a place to store weapons. A tower was usually a tall place from where people watched for dangerous activity. Pause this audio here.

The next people the storyteller lists prepare the land for crops, as well as growing and harvesting the crops. Ezri and his workers dig up and prepare the ground for the crops. Both Shimei and Zabdi manage different parts of the vineyards. Shimei helps to make sure the vineyards grow the grapes. Zabdi harvests the grapes from the vineyards to make and store **wine** for King David. Use the same word for wine that you have used previously. For more information on wine, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **vineyards**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. For more information on vineyards, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller continues with more people who oversee the land. Baal-Hanan is responsible for ensuring the sycamore fig trees and the **olive trees** grow and produce fruit. Joash is responsible for harvesting the **olives** and making **olive oil**. Use the same word or phrase for olive trees, olives, and olive oil as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for a **sycamore fig tree**. This is different from a regular sycamore tree. Pause this audio here.

The next people the storyteller lists are Shitrai and Shaphat. Shitrai tends the cattle in the plain of Sharon. A plain is usually a flat and fertile section of land with natural resources like water and good soil. Shaphat tends the cattle in all other **valleys** apart from the plain of Sharon. Valleys are usually lowlands between mountains that have a stream or river and grassland. Use the same word or phrase for valleys as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for a **plain**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The last people the storyteller mentions are men responsible for various types of animals. Obil takes care of the **camels**. Jehdeiah tends the female **donkeys**. Jaziz cares for the **sheep** and **goats**. For more information on

camels and donkeys, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for camels, donkeys, sheep, and goats as you used in previous passages.

The storyteller ends the passage by saying that everyone he lists is a person who takes care of King David's property. When a person owns property, the property can be something that people can move, like furniture or a bicycle. Property can also be something that stays still, like a house. It is important to make sure you use the correct words to show this difference.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for a **property**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 27:25–31

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (951 KB)
- Setting the Stage (7.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 27:32–34

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 27:32–34 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:32–34 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:32–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause the audio here.

In previous passages, the storyteller or Chronicler listed Israel's military leaders and tribe leaders. The storyteller also listed people who were in charge of taking care of King David's property and possessions. In this passage, the storyteller finishes the list of King David's trusted workers by telling us King David's closest and most important people.

Stop here and think about the closest person or people that you trust to help you. Share with each other who you have chosen and why you trust your closest people. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller begins by listing Jonathan first. The storyteller says that Jonathan is King David's "uncle," but we do not know for sure who Jonathan is. Even though it is possible that Jonathan is either King David's uncle or nephew, it is true that Jonathan was close enough to King David to be a person whom King David trusts. The storyteller describes Jonathan as King David's counselor and scribe. The word "scribe" likely means that Jonathan gained a lot of knowledge through education and learning. Jonathan may have been someone who advised King David.

The storyteller also lists a man named Jehiel with Jonathan. It is likely that Jonathan and Jehiel were in charge of educating King David's sons. Both Jonathan and Jehiel were educated men. The storyteller says that Jehiel is Hacmoni's son. Even though it is not fully clear, it is probably true that Jehiel was a descendant of the Hacmoni family line. The name Hacmoni means "wise" or "skilled," so the Hacmoni line likely shared this skill in education.

Stop here and think about skills or jobs that your family does. What jobs, skills, or talents do you have in common with other members of your family? Think about your parents, grandparents, uncles, aunts, etc. Discuss why you think families often have these similarities. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller lists a man named Ahithophel as a counselor to the king. This means that King David likely had more than one counselor or advisor at any given time. In a different part of the story, King David's son, Absalom, wanted to become king instead of King David, and Ahithophel supported this and advised Absalom to attack King David. Absalom's desire to have power caused the kingdom to divide. However, Absalom did not listen to Ahithophel's advice and delayed attacking King David. When Ahithophel realised Absalom did not listen to him, Ahithophel killed himself by hanging himself.

Stop here and think about a time when a person gave you bad advice. Discuss with the group whether or not you listened to the advice and what happened. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller also lists a man named Hushai the Arkite as King David's friend, or someone David could trust and tell anything to without worry. It is not clear what or who "the Arkite" refers to, but it is possible that "Arkite" refers to the people group who lived in the land of Benjamin's tribe. Hushai proved his loyalty to King David when he pretended to help Absalom. Hushai became a spy and gave information to King David about Absalom's plans to try to become king instead of King David.

After Ahithophel died, two advisors took Ahithophel's place in King David's group of people whom King David trusted the most. Jehoiada, who was Benaiah's son, acted as an advisor for King David. Abiathar was a priest who also advised King David. Abiathar was the only priest who escaped from King Saul's reign, and King David later appointed Abiathar as the high priest. The storyteller lists Joab last. Joab was David's nephew and the commander of King David's army. Both Abiathar and Joab were loyal to David for many years until they both supported King David's son, Adonijah, in Adonijah's attempt to become king instead.

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King David's closest advisors were people he trusted. The storyteller makes this list of people seem perfect. When the storyteller leaves out certain information, it can seem like King David had the perfect people surrounding him. In this list, as well as the lists before this one, the storyteller tries to make King David's reign look perfect by only talking about the good things in King David's reign.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How do you learn lists of names like the storyteller has listed in this passage? What are helpful visual aids or ways to remember, especially with names that are difficult to pronounce?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:32–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: The Chronicler or storyteller begins to list the closest people to King David. The storyteller lists Jonathan and Jehiel first and describes them as the people who most likely educated King David's sons.

In the second scene: The storyteller continues the list with Ahithophel and Hushai as King David's counselors.

In the third scene: The storyteller lists Jehoiada and Abiathar as the two men who took Athiophel's place after Athiophel died.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller finishes by listing Joab as the commander in King David's army. Joab is the last name in the list of King David's inner group of people he can trust.

The characters in this passage are:

- Chronicler or storyteller
- Jonathan
- Jehiel
- David's sons
- Ahithophel
- Absalom
- Hushai
- Jehoiada
- Abiathar
- And Joab

In this session, have the group storyboard or draw in order to visualize the story and the action in it. It may be helpful to find an object to represent each person the storyteller lists. For example, you could use a book to represent Jonathan or Jehiel since they both helped educate David's sons. This may help you remember each person and the role each person plays.

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller introduces a man named Jonathan as both a counselor to King David and a scribe or educated person. The storyteller describes Jonathan as an "uncle," but Jonathan is most likely a relative of some sort on King David's side of the family. The storyteller says that Jonathan is a man of understanding, which means that Jonathan can understand the situation and the best way to handle the situation. The storyteller also introduces a man named Jehiel and says that both Jonathan and Jehiel educated King David's sons.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what word do you use for a person who is educated and teaches other people? Also, discuss how you would describe a "man of understanding" in your culture. Think about a person you know who fits the descriptions of an educated person and a person of understanding. Discuss the options for words that you could use. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller continues the list with a man named Ahithophel and a man named Hushai. Ahithophel was King David's counselor. Hushai was King David's closest and most trusted friend. The storyteller

uses the words “counselor” and “friend” to show King David is close to both men. Ahithophel gives King David advice and helps King David work through difficult decisions, but the storyteller describes Hushai as King David’s closest person. A friend is someone who is trustworthy and who will keep secrets and not share important information with other people.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture and language, how can you show the difference between a counselor and a close friend? Which words would you use to show the difference? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Jehoiada and Abiathar took Ahithophel’s place after he died. Jehoiada was the son of Benaiah, and Abiathar served as a priest and then as the high priest.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller finishes the list of people by introducing Joab. Joab served as the commander of King David’s army.

As before, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:32–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Chronicler or storyteller
- Jonathan
- Jehiel
- David’s sons
- Ahithophel
- Absalom
- Hushai
- Jehoiada
- Abiathar
- And Joab

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The person playing the storyteller or Chronicler should tell the story.

This is a story about King David’s most important people, including David’s closest advisors and trusted people. The list begins with Jonathan, who is likely David’s uncle. Jonathan is King David’s counselor and scribe. With Jonathan, a man named Jehiel is responsible for helping to educate King David’s sons. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Jonathan, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am so glad I get to help my family; or
- I feel really important because I am helping the king! or

- I hope I do not make a mistake!

Continue the drama. Ahithophel is King David's counselor, and Hushai the Arkite is David's closest friend and most trusted person.

After Ahithophel dies, Jehoiada and Abiathar become King David's counselors. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Hushai, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer with things like:

- I feel honored to be King David's closest friend; or
- I hope King David knows he can trust me.

Ask the person playing Abiathar, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer with things like:

- I must make sure everyone keeps God's laws! or
- Since I am a priest, I hope I am appointed high priest one day.

Continue the drama. The storyteller finishes the list with Joab as the commander of King David's army. Joab is the last name in King David's list of trusted people. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Joab, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer with things like:

- I must keep King David and his people safe! or
- This is a lot of pressure!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 27:32–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The storyteller of this passage continues on from the previous lists and introduces **King** David's most important people. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. Refer to king in the Master Glossary for more information.

The storyteller lists several roles throughout this passage. The storyteller describes both Jonathan and Ahithophel as King David's counselors. The storyteller says that Jonathan was a man of understanding, which means that Jonathan could understand a situation and the best way to handle the situation. This means that Ahithophel and Jonathan likely listened to King David and gave him ideas and answers to questions. The storyteller also calls Hushai the Arkite the king's friend. A friend is a person whom you can trust more than anyone else and who keeps your secrets without telling other people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **counselor** and **friend**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Both Jonathan and Jehiel educated King David's sons, but the storyteller specifically lists Jonathan as a **scribe**. A scribe would usually mean someone who is educated and teaches others. Use the same word or phrase for scribe as you used in previous passages. For more information on scribe, refer to the Master Glossary.

The storyteller lists Joab last as the **commander** of King David's **army**. Use the same words for army and commander as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 27:32–34

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (993 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 28:1–8

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 28:1–8 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 28:1–8 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 28:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

You will remember in 1 Chronicles 23 that King David had gathered all the leaders of Israel, including the priests and Levites, to Jerusalem. Then, in the most recent stories, the storyteller had interrupted the story to tell us the names of the leaders and those who were in charge of King David's property. The storyteller tells us that the other leaders were the leaders of the 12 tribes of Israel, the leaders of the army troops that served the king, the commanders or generals of the military units made of 1,000 soldiers and of 100 soldiers each, the leaders who

1 Chronicles 28:1–8

took care of the property and animals that belonged to the king and his sons, the leaders of those who served in the king's palace, and the powerful men and all the brave warriors.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss a kingdom or country that has one ruler. Talk about how that man organises the society of that kingdom or country. Name the groups of people that help the ruler to rule, and discuss the different levels of authority and power that the different groups of people have in the kingdom. Pause this audio here.

Now the storyteller returns to the gathering of leaders from 1 Chronicles 23. When all of these people had assembled together, probably in the palace, King David stood up and spoke to them. King David was an old man at this time, so it is likely that David had been sitting on his throne. David stood up to speak to the leaders because what he wanted to say was very important. King David told the people that he had had it in his heart, or greatly desired, to build a permanent house of rest for the ark of the covenant of Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of the ark of the covenant of Yahweh as a group. Pause this audio here.

From the day that Moses made the ark in the wilderness, the ark had moved from the wilderness to Gilgal, then to Shiloh, then to the cities of the Philistines, then to Beth Shemesh, then to Kiriath Jearim, and finally to Jerusalem. David is saying that he really wanted to build the temple where the people could permanently keep the ark of the covenant, just as Yahweh had instructed Moses. The Israelites believed that Yahweh's throne was the holy place between the cherubim above the ark of the covenant. Yahweh met and spoke to Moses from above the wings of the cherubim that were on the ark of the covenant. Therefore, the people believed that the ark or its cover was the place where Yahweh rested his feet. The place where people rest their feet is called a footstool. In that culture, someone would sit on a chair and place their feet on a small stool to relax.

King David told the elders that because of his great desire, David had started preparing to build the temple. King David probably means that he had begun to gather the material and skilled builders that the people would need.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss the places of worship in your community and neighbouring communities. Talk about the day that the people made each place of worship. Talk about all the preparation that you needed to do. Mention the materials you needed, the people who did the building, and the cost and time it took. Discuss also people whom you did not allow to be involved in this holy work, and the reason why you did not allow them to help. Pause this audio here.

King David told the leaders that he really wanted to build the temple and had made all the preparations, but that Yahweh told David that David could not be the one to build the temple. Yahweh had chosen King David to fight battles and to bring peace to Israel. David would have had a hard time building the temple before he had defeated all the enemies. David was a warrior who had killed many people, so David was unclean, or unfit to touch holy things or go into holy places. The temple would be very holy. Yahweh told the prophet Nathan to tell David that David's son would build the temple, and Yahweh promised to build David a kingdom instead. Yahweh promised David that his son Solomon would have rest from battle and be the king of peace. Solomon's name means "peaceful."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell stories of a king or chief who ruled in difficult times and fought many battles, and another king who ruled in peaceful times. Compare the kind of things they were both able to do in their times. Pause this audio here.

King David now reminds the leaders of the promises that Yahweh had made to David and his descendants. This way, King David shows the leaders his right to be king of Israel. King David tells the leaders that even though Yahweh did not allow David to build the temple, nevertheless, Yahweh, the God of Israel, had chosen David and his descendants out of all his father's sons to be kings of Israel forever. David explained to them that this was because Yahweh had chosen the tribe of Judah to be the leader of all the tribes of Israel. And from the tribe of Judah, Yahweh had chosen David's father Jesse's house. And among the sons of Jesse, David's brothers, Yahweh had chosen David and made him king. Then David says that from his many sons, Yahweh had chosen Solomon to sit on the throne, or to be king of the kingdom of Yahweh. Yahweh was the real ruler of Israel, and Yahweh chose the man who would represent Yahweh as king. Different nations had different ways of deciding which man would be the ruler. Some chose kings from one family, others chose the strongest or richest family, but in Israel, it was Yahweh who chose the king because Yahweh is the true king of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does your community choose its rulers? Discuss the part that God, the spirit, or the ancestors play in choosing your rulers. If this does not happen in your community, discuss how it happens in another community. Pause this audio here.

David told the leaders that Yahweh chose Solomon to be the next king after David died. Yahweh also said that it would be Solomon who would build Yahweh's house or temple and Yahweh's courtyards. The courtyards of the temple were important places where the people of Israel held their festivals and celebrated before Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of the temple and its courtyards as a group. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said that he had chosen Solomon to be his son, and Yahweh promised to be Solomon's father. In these days, if a great king gave someone a country in his kingdom to rule for him, the king made a covenant or agreement with that person and adopted him as his son and promised to be his father. This is how Yahweh promised to protect the kingdom of Israel for Solomon. Yahweh promised to establish Solomon's kingdom forever if Solomon continued to obey Yahweh's commands and ordinances, as he was already doing. It is also possible that Yahweh meant that David was the one obeying Yahweh's commands and ordinances.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does the ruler of your community relate with God, spirits, or the ancestors? Talk about the things that your ruler is supposed to do or not do to keep God, the spirits, or ancestors happy with him. Pause this audio here.

Then King David publicly encouraged and urged the leaders before all Israel, and in the presence of God, to be careful to do everything that Yahweh had commanded. David told the leaders that if they took care to study and obey the commands of Yahweh, they would continue to possess the good, fertile land that Yahweh had given them and also pass it down to their descendants. David himself had obeyed Yahweh and was now passing down his inheritance to his son Solomon.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell stories about when a ruler was nearing the end of his rule and spoke to children and his people about what they should do after he dies. What kind of things did the ruler talk about, and why do you think he spoke of those things?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 28:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: King David summoned or called together all the leaders of the people of Israel to gather in Jerusalem.

In the second scene: King David stood up and told the leaders about the plans that he had for building the temple. David told the leaders that although he had begun preparing to build the temple, Yahweh had stopped David and told him that Yahweh had chosen Solomon to build it.

In the third scene: King David therefore urged the leaders of the people of Israel to study and obey the commands and ordinances that Yahweh had given the people of Israel. David said that if they did, they would continue to possess the good land that Yahweh had given them and also pass it down to their children.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- King David
- The leaders of the people of Israel. They were the leaders of the tribes, the leaders of the divisions of soldiers that served the king, the commanders of the military units of thousands of soldiers and of the military units of hundreds of soldiers, the leaders of those who looked after the king's property and the livestock of the king and of his sons, the leaders of those who served in the palace, the powerful men, and all the brave warriors.
- Solomon

- The other sons of David, Solomon's brothers
- All the people of Israel and their descendants
- And David's father's family, David's brothers

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the action of the story returns to when David assembled or gathered all the leaders of Israel in Jerusalem. The storyteller had interrupted the flow of the story that he started in 1 Chronicles 23 to list the names of Levites and the other officials according to how King David organised them. Now the storyteller tells us what happened after David gathered the leaders in Jerusalem. It is likely that the leaders were all standing before King David in the palace or somewhere public in the city of Jerusalem. David gathered the chiefs of the tribes or tribal leaders. Every one of the 12 tribes usually had one wise man whom they had chosen to be their leader. The officers of the divisions or leaders of the military units that served the king were also there. King David had divided them into 12 divisions of 24,000 officers or soldiers, and they took turns month after month to serve the king. King David further divided these divisions of 24,000 into units of 1,000 or 100, each with its captain. These captains of the 1,000 and 100 soldiers each were also there. The managers of the property and livestock of the king and of his sons were also there. It is very likely that King David's sons were there because this meeting is about who would become king after David. The palace officials or the king's advisors and government administrators were also there. All the mighty or powerful men, together with all the brave warriors, were also there. The storyteller uses one word for leader and then specifies what leader he is referring to by mentioning the leader's role.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell stories of when there has been such a gathering in your community. What was the reason people gathered, and who called the gathering? When you discuss this question, try to use different and specific words for the different leaders. If you do not have specific words, use phrases like "the great chief" or name them according to their specific roles. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have one person list out to the rest of the group all the leaders that were in the previous discussion. The person should try different ways of listing the leaders until they find the best way. One way the person can do this is in groups. For example, they might say the leaders of the men and then list out each individual leader that falls into the category of men, such as the leader of the old men, the leader of the warriors, and the leader of the unmarried men. The group should listen and make suggestions. You should repeat this activity until you find a way of listing the leaders that you all like. Pause audio here.

In the second scene, King David stood up and spoke to the leaders who were gathered before him. At this time, King David had grown old and would have likely been sitting down on his throne, but David stood up to address the leaders of Israel. It is important to note that although the king was old, the storyteller does not show him as a weak old man. The storyteller records the words that King David spoke to the elders directly. King David spoke to the leaders of Israel very pleasantly. David called them his brothers and his people. They were David's people because he was their king, and they were David's brothers because they were all from the same ancestors.

Stop here and discuss how a king or a great man addresses or talks to people who are lower or less important than himself. How would he speak to the people to show them that he is one of them and that he loves them? Pause audio here.

King David told the people that he had had it in his heart, or greatly desired, to build a house of rest for the ark of the covenant of Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words, phrases, or special language do you use in your community to express a very strong desire? Pause this audio here.

The ark was a box which could not feel tired, but David speaks of building it a house of rest as if the ark was a living thing.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Give examples of ways in which you speak of non-living things as if they were alive in your language. Pause this audio here.

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David calls the ark of the covenant the footstool or place of rest for the feet of the God of Israel. The ark was the place where Yahweh met with the people of Israel. Yahweh spoke from above the lid of the ark. Therefore, the people of Israel called the ark “Yahweh’s footstool,” or the place where Yahweh rested his feet.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss the kind of special language that you use for a sacred place where God meets you. Explain what each phrase means. Suggest what special language you would use for a place where heaven and earth touch or where the presence of God from heaven touches the earth. Remember that the people of Israel believed that Yahweh both met them and rested his feet on the ark. Pause this audio here.

The temple is also called “a house for Yahweh’s name.” The Israelites would worship and honor Yahweh in the temple. Therefore, it is a house where people honor Yahweh’s name.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about the temple as a house for Yahweh’s name. Pause this audio here.

David told the leaders of Israel that although he had wanted to build the temple of Yahweh and was ready to begin, Yahweh had forbidden or stopped David. Yahweh told David that Yahweh would not allow David to build the house of Yahweh because David was a warrior and had shed much blood, which means that David had killed many people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a person who was a great warrior and had killed many people in battle. What kind of special language do you use to describe someone like this? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh did not reject the plan for the building of the temple. Yahweh rejected David as the man to do it. It is important to show the strong difference between the strong desire that David had to build the temple and how strongly Yahweh rejected David. The temple was to be the holy place where Yahweh’s people would worship and honor Yahweh. Yahweh said he rejected David because David had shed the blood of many people in battle. This would have made David’s hands unclean or unworthy to do the holy work of building the temple. It is important to note that this does not mean that David was evil. David told the leaders of Israel that, in spite of Yahweh rejecting David to build the temple, Yahweh had nevertheless chosen David and his descendants from all the sons of his father Jesse to be king over Israel. King David explained to the leaders that, formerly, Yahweh had chosen the tribe of Judah from the 12 tribes of Israel to be the leader. And from the tribe of Judah, Yahweh had chosen Jesse, David’s father’s house. And then from the sons of Jesse, David’s brothers, Yahweh chose David to be king over Israel. Then David told the leaders that, of all his many sons, Yahweh had chosen Solomon to sit on the throne of Israel. A throne is the seat of a king. A throne symbolises the king’s power and authority.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the symbol of a king’s power and authority in your culture? How will you translate the word throne in this passage? The way you translate this word needs to show that Solomon has the power and authority in Israel. Pause this audio here.

Israel was the Kingdom of Yahweh, and it was Yahweh who chose the person who would rule as his representative.

King David told the leaders of Israel that Yahweh had told David that it would be Solomon who would build the temple or house of Yahweh and its courtyards. The temple area included two large open spaces called courtyards. One courtyard was for the priests to do their work. The other courtyard is where the rest of the people of Israel celebrated the feast of Yahweh. It was a place of joy and celebration to be in the presence of Yahweh. Yahweh said that Yahweh had chosen Solomon to be his son and that Yahweh would be Solomon’s father. This is the language people used to make strong covenants or agreements. Yahweh was saying that his relationship with Solomon would last forever. But Yahweh said that he would only secure Solomon’s kingdom as long as Solomon continued to obey Yahweh’s commands and ordinances.

In the third scene, King David finishes his speech to the leaders of Israel by encouraging them to study and obey all the commands of Yahweh, the God of Israel. David says that he has spoken to the leaders in the sight or in the presence of all Israel, which is the assembly of Yahweh. An assembly is a formal gathering of people. It is another way of saying all Israel. It does not mean that every Israelite person was there, but that those who were there represented all of Israel.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when your people have had a gathering like that. Talk about why leaders called the assembly together and what happened. Pay attention to the words and phrases you use to refer to the group of people who had gathered together. Pause this audio here.

It is unlikely that all of the people of Israel were there—it was just their leaders. David also said that Yahweh had witnessed everything that David said to his people. David told the people that if they obeyed Yahweh, they would continue to own the good and fertile land that Yahweh had given them and also pass the land down to their descendants. David knew that he was dying when he spoke these last words to the people. Therefore, David charged the people of Israel to continue obeying and trusting Yahweh.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 28:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has 3 scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- King David
- The leaders of the people of Israel. They were the leaders of the tribes, the leaders of the divisions of soldiers that served the king, the commanders of the military units of thousands of soldiers and of the military units of hundreds of soldiers, the leaders of those who looked after the king's property and the livestock of the king and of his sons, the leaders of those who served in the palace, the powerful men, and all the brave warriors.
- Solomon
- The other sons of David, Solomon's brothers
- All the people of Israel and their descendants
- And David's father's family, David's brothers

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

King David summoned or called together all the leaders of the people of Israel to gather in Jerusalem. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing king David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This is an important day. I make my son Solomon king today. I am very happy; or
- All of Israel will know that Yahweh has chosen Solomon to be king after me; or
- I praise Yahweh who has been with me and pray that Yahweh will be with my son also. I want to make sure that the leaders of the people of Israel will obey Yahweh and support Solomon.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This is an amazing day. I am very happy; or
- Yahweh has loved me and blessed me; or

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- My father promised my mother that he would make me king after him and now he is fulfilling his promise.

Ask the person playing the leaders of the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Today is a very important day for our nation. Our king will tell us who will be the next king; or
- We have all come to Jerusalem. All the leaders are here. There is great excitement in the city; or
- The king is very wise. The king does not want the kingdom to be divided after he dies.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, King David stood up and told the leaders of Israel that he had greatly desired to build the temple of Yahweh, but that Yahweh had refused David and chosen his son Solomon instead. Yahweh had chosen Judah from the 12 tribes, and Jesse from the clans of Judah, and David from the sons of Jesse. And now, Yahweh had chosen Solomon from the many sons of David. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing king David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- With all my heart I wanted to be the one who built the temple for our God. Yahweh made my house great, and I love him and wanted to honor him by making a place where the ark of the covenant, Yahweh's footstool, would rest; or
- I even made the preparations needed to start this great work, but Yahweh did not allow me to be the one who had the honor of building his house. Yahweh chose my son Solomon instead. Yahweh is king over Israel, and he chooses whoever he desires. I praise Yahweh's name. I am very excited for my son; or
- I was sad at first but I am happy because although Yahweh rejected me, he also blessed me by honoring my son. And I want to make sure that Solomon has the support of the whole nation because this is a great task. I am sad that I will not be here to see the house of Yahweh.

Ask the person playing the leaders of the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel excited. I feel great joy and happiness. We have long desired to complete this work that Yahweh gave us; or
- Oh what a happy reign Solomon will have. Solomon will build the house of Yahweh. May Yahweh bless him; or
- Israel will love Solomon just as we have loved his father, David. David bravely fought our enemies and brought us peace. Now Solomon will bring the glory to Israel.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This is my will. David has obeyed me and I am happy; or
- I will give Solomon rest from the wars his father had to fight. Solomon will rule in peace and build my house without enemies disturbing him; or
- I am happy that the whole nation will know my will. All these leaders will take the message to them. I want them to support Solomon. Solomon is my chosen king.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel very small. This work is very important and I am not experienced; or
- I am happy that my father has made preparations for me; or
- I will need the support of these men who have served my father wisely and loyally.

Continue the drama. King David told the leaders that Yahweh said that he would be a father to Solomon and Solomon would be a son to Yahweh. Yahweh promised to secure Solomon's kingdom if Solomon obeyed the commands of Yahweh. Then King David charged the leaders of the people of Israel to obey Yahweh's commands so that Yahweh would keep them in the good land he gave them. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- If Solomon keeps my commands and ordinances as I have instructed then Solomon will have a long and happy rule; or
- The leaders of the people of Israel must also obey my commands and teach the people to do the same and I will bless them; or
- But if they do not and go after other gods and practice things that I have not commanded then I will throw them out of my land as I told Moses.

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Ask the person playing David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Obedience is very important. Yahweh will not bless disobedience; or
- Yahweh has disciplined me when I have disobeyed him, and I know that Yahweh will remain faithful to himself. Yahweh cannot change. Yahweh treats disobedience seriously; or
- I am sad that I will be leaving my people soon, but I hope that these leaders of the people of Israel will be obedient and make sure that they help Solomon to rule as Yahweh has commanded.

Ask the person playing Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am very happy. Yahweh has made great promises to me; or
- I must be careful to obey Yahweh. I want my kingdom to be secured; or
- My heart rejoices in Yahweh.

Ask the person playing the leaders of the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We have a great responsibility; or
- Yahweh’s blessings are great and many and we want them. We love this land and want to pass it down to our children, but we must obey; or
- We will be loyal to Solomon, and we pray that he is obedient and pleasing to Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 28:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

King David called together to **Jerusalem** all the **officials** of **Israel**. Use the same words or phrases for king, Jerusalem, and Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, Jerusalem, or Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. The officials of Israel is a general phrase for the leaders of specific areas. The storyteller uses the general word for leader and then specifies the specific role that each leader played.

These were the officials in their specific roles: the **officers** over the tribes or tribal **leaders** were responsible for their specific tribes, and the commanders of the **divisions** were in charge of one unit of 24,000 soldiers. The commanders of thousands worked under the commander of the division and were in charge of 1,000 soldiers, whilst the commander of hundreds was in charge of 100 soldiers. You will remember that “divisions” refers to the groups of soldiers or workers that David had divided into groups. Some officers were in charge of all the property and **livestock**, which is the cattle, sheep, and goats, that belonged to the king and his sons. Use the same words or phrases for divisions, livestock, and officers or leaders as you used in previous passages.

King David also called all the palace officials who specifically worked in the palace, the **mighty men**, and all the brave fighting men. The “mighty men” normally refers to great warriors, but here it likely refers to powerful, influential men in general, who did not occupy any special public or court office.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: What will you call these leaders? Pause this audio here.

King David stood up and said that he had had it in his **heart** to build a “house of rest” or temple for the **ark of the covenant** of Yahweh and for a footstool of God. Look up heart and ark of the covenant in the Master Glossary for more information, and translate heart and ark of the covenant in the same way you have in previous passages. “House of rest” is another way to say the temple. It is also called the “house of God.” It is the place where the people worshipped Yahweh. The temple is also the place where the people of Israel kept the ark of the covenant, which symbolized the presence of Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for “**house of rest**.” Look up **temple** in the Master Glossary for more information to help you decide how to translate house of rest. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites believed that Yahweh’s throne was the holy place between the cherubim above the ark of the covenant. Therefore, the ark was called his footstool or the place where Yahweh rested his feet.

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Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **footstool**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller sometimes refers to the God of Israel by his proper name, **Yahweh**, and sometimes by the more general term **God**. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and God as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh or God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Although Yahweh had refused for David to build the temple, Yahweh had nevertheless chosen David and his descendants from the house of **Judah** to be **king** over Israel and Solomon, out of David's many sons, to be king over the **kingdom** of Yahweh. The **house** of Judah refers to the family or tribe of Judah, or Judah's descendants. Use the same words or phrases for house or family, Judah, king, and kingdom as you used in previous passages. For more information on Judah, king, and kingdom, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh told David that it would be Solomon who would build Yahweh's house and its **courts**. The courts or courtyard of the temple were a very special place for the people of Israel. This is where those who were not from the tribe of priests celebrated the feasts of Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for courts as you did in 1 Chronicles 23:28.

Yahweh said that Solomon would be Yahweh's son and Yahweh would be Solomon's father. This is special language to say that Yahweh had made a covenant or agreement with Solomon. Yahweh said that he would establish the kingdom for Solomon if Solomon would keep Yahweh's **commands** and **ordinances**. Use the same words or phrases for commandments and ordinances as you used in previous passages. For more information on commandments and ordinances, refer to the Master Glossary.

David charged the leaders of Israel in the sight of all Israel or in the presence of the nation. David used this special language to call the people of Israel as witnesses. David also called all Israel, the **assembly** of Yahweh. The assembly of Yahweh means the gathering of Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for assembly as you used in 1 Chronicles 13:2.

David also said that he spoke to the leaders of Israel these instructions in the "hearing of God." David was saying that Yahweh was also a witness, and Yahweh heard everything they were saying.

David told the people that they should be careful to obey Yahweh so that they can keep owning the land and give it to their children as an **inheritance**. Use the same word or phrase for inheritance as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (971 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (8.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 28:9–21

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 28:9–21 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 28:9–21 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 28:9–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, King David gathered all the leaders of Israel in Jerusalem and told them Yahweh had chosen Solomon to build the temple. David strongly urged the leaders to obey Yahweh.

In this story, David turned to Solomon in front of the leaders and gave Solomon the same strong commands. David told Solomon to be committed to Yahweh, David's God. David told Solomon to know Yahweh personally and to serve Yahweh with all his heart and mind. When someone is fully committed to something, the people of Israel say that the person has given his whole heart. If a person is not fully committed, they say that person is distracted or has a divided heart.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when you were fully committed to do something. Pause the audio here.

David emphasized that Yahweh knows everyone's heart and intentions. David was telling Solomon that Solomon must not lie or hide his motives from Yahweh. If Solomon obeyed, Yahweh would accept Solomon, but if Solomon abandoned Yahweh, Yahweh would reject Solomon forever. Yahweh had made a covenant or strong promise that he would secure Solomon's kingdom if Solomon obeyed Yahweh's commandments. If Solomon did not build the temple, Yahweh would reject Solomon. David warned Solomon to take this seriously and get to work on building the temple, as Yahweh had instructed.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell stories of strong promises that you personally and also your community together have made with God, spirits, or your ancestors. What are the ways in which you personally

or your community could have broken those promises or failed to honor the agreement, and what would have happened to you or your community? Pause the audio here.

David then gave Solomon the plans for the temple. We do not know what the plans looked like. It is probable that these plans were instructions that someone wrote down for the skilled builders to follow.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What does the place of worship in your community look like? Describe it in as much detail as you can. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us all the instructions that were in the plans that David gave to Solomon. The plans included details for various sections of the temple, starting from the entrance of the main temple building to the Most Holy Place. The plans had instructions about how to build the portico or entrance of the temple. This was probably a long hallway without a roof that you had to pass through to enter the temple itself. The plan also had instructions about the temple buildings. This probably refers to buildings that surrounded the temple, but it could also refer to the two main rooms of the temple. The plans had instructions for the temple's storage rooms and the rooms on its roof, as well as instructions for the rooms inside the temple and the room for the mercy seat or place of atonement. This was the way that David referred to the ark of the covenant. People believed that the cover of the ark was a place where Yahweh lived. This is where the high priest asked Yahweh to forgive the sins of all the Israelites each year.

Stop here and look at a drawing of Solomon's temple as a group. See if you can find the different parts of the temple on the drawing. Pause the audio here.

David gave Solomon the plans that Yahweh's Spirit put in David's mind for the courts of Yahweh's temple. The temple had two courts, one for priests to sacrifice animals and another for people to gather and celebrate feasts.

Stop here and look at the drawing of Solomon's temple as a group again. Point out the two courts. Pause the audio here.

When the people of Israel left Egypt, Yahweh gave Moses detailed plans of how to build a tabernacle for Yahweh's honor. Moses instructed the Israelites to make the tabernacle of tents and move it from place to place. After David had defeated many enemies and brought peace to Israel, David desired to build a more permanent tabernacle or sanctuary to honor Yahweh. The plan for this more permanent sanctuary, also called a temple, was the same as those that Yahweh gave Moses for the tabernacle. However, there were also other things that David added to the temple. David says that the Spirit of Yahweh guided him when he was making the plans.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when someone has created something or come up with an idea with the help of God or the divine spirits in the community. Pause the audio here.

David also gave Solomon plans for the surrounding rooms, which were storerooms for temple items and treasures. They were a row of rooms, built one above the other on three floors or levels. It is likely that these rooms stored various vessels or utensils that people used in the temple service, as well as the food items such as flour, oil, and wine. The rooms were also the treasuries or storerooms of the things of gold, silver, and other valuable items that people had dedicated to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about the most special gifts someone can give to God, the spirits, or the ancestors in your community. Pause the audio here.

David instructed Solomon on how to organize the priests and Levites for their work in the temple. David also detailed the amount of gold and silver that Solomon would need to make various temple utensils. David specified the amounts for the gold and silver lampstands with their lamps. The amount of gold or silver for the lampstands with their lamps depended on how people used them.

Stop here and look at a picture of a lampstand as a group. Pause this audio here.

In the instructions, David also told Solomon the weight of gold that he would require to make each golden table on which the priests would place the loaves of bread they offered to Yahweh. People made this table of acacia wood and then covered it with gold. David also gave Solomon the weight of silver for making the tables that people covered with silver.

Stop here and look at a picture of the golden tables as a group. Pause this audio here.

David also gave Solomon instructions on how much pure or true gold he should use to make the forks or meat hooks that the priests would use to handle the meat people gave as a sacrifice.

Stop here and look at a picture of a fork as a group. Pause this audio here.

David also told Solomon how much pure gold he would need to make the basins that the priests would use to hold the blood of the sacrificed animal, which they would sprinkle on the altar.

Stop here and look at a picture of a basin as a group. Pause this audio here.

David told Solomon the amount of pure gold he needed to make the jugs that the priest would use in Yahweh's drink or wine offerings.

Stop here and look at a picture of the jugs as a group. Pause this audio here.

David also told Solomon the amount of gold for each gold and silver small bowl. People also used these bowls for the drink offerings.

Stop here and look at a picture of the gold and silver small bowls as a group. Pause this audio here.

David told Solomon the amount of pure gold that he would need to make the altar that the priests used to offer sweet-smelling incense to Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of the altar of incense as a group. Pause this audio here,

David also gave Solomon the plan for making the chariot, which is the golden cherubim that spread their wings and cover the ark of the covenant of Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of the cherubim with their wings spread over the ark of the covenant as a group. Pause this audio here.

King David told Solomon that he had written all those plans because Yahweh had guided him and made him understand them. Yahweh wanted to make sure that Solomon built the temple according to Yahweh's plans.

Finally, David encouraged Solomon to be strong and brave, and he assured Solomon that Yahweh would be with him and ensure the temple's completion. David mentioned that priests, Levites, and craftsmen were ready to help with the work.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about the biggest building project that you have done in your community. List all the people you needed for the project, and mention each person's role and how they felt about being involved in the great project.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 28:9–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: David turns from talking to the leaders of Israel and begins to talk to Solomon publicly. David urges Solomon to know Yahweh and to be completely committed to serving Yahweh. David tells Solomon to obey Yahweh and to build the temple. David warns Solomon that if Solomon rejects Yahweh then Yahweh will also reject Solomon.

In the second scene: David gives Solomon the plans he had prepared to build the temple and its buildings. David also tells Solomon the weight in gold and silver that he would need for making various utensils that the priests will use in their work. David tells Solomon how to organise the priests and Levites for their work.

In the third scene: David urges Solomon to be brave and to do the work that Yahweh has given him. David tells Solomon that the priests and Levites are ready to begin their work in the temple and that the skilled craftsmen

are ready and willing to help Solomon do the work of building the temple. David also tells Solomon that the leaders of the people of Israel will obey everything that he tells them.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- David
- Solomon
- Priests and Levites
- The leaders of Israel
- All the skilled craftsmen
- And all the people of Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The action of this story continues from the last story. David had been speaking to the elders of Israel and had just commanded them to obey Yahweh. In the first scene of this story David turns to his son Solomon, in the presence of the elders, and tells Solomon to obey Yahweh. The storyteller opens the scene by showing that David focused his words on Solomon even though there were many people there.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Imagine a great man is dying. Have the man speak his last words to all his children to encourage them about the future and remind them of the important things that he taught them. Then let the man choose one of his sons and give instructions about how to lead, support, and look after the rest of the family. Let the great man speak his words directly to the chosen son in front of the rest. Pay attention to the words and phrases you use to show that the great man has switched the focus of his words from all his sons to the chosen son. Pause this audio here.

David urges and encourages Solomon to know Yahweh, David's own God and the God of his ancestors. This does not mean that Solomon had a different god. David is telling Solomon to learn to know Yahweh personally.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story of how you became friends with another person. Talk of how you met that person and how you got to know them better and better. Pay attention to the words or phrases you use to talk about how your relationship with that person grew or developed as you learnt more about them. Pause this audio here.

David tells Solomon to serve or to be Yahweh's slave with his whole heart and a willing mind. David is telling Solomon to be fully committed to Yahweh and not to be distracted. The Israelites talk of being fully committed as being whole-hearted or having a heart that is not divided.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Which organs of the body do you think of as representing being completely committed to something? Consider how you will translate this special language about Solomon's commitment to Yahweh. Pause this audio here.

David explains why Solomon should be devoted to Yahweh by telling Solomon that Yahweh searches or examines everyone's heart and knows or understands everyone's plans and thoughts. This special language means that Yahweh knows the reasons for everyone's thoughts.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell of a time when someone did something to help another person but with bad reasons or intentions and wrong thoughts. Pay attention to the words and phrases you use to talk about the person's thoughts and motives. Pause this audio here.

David tells Solomon that if Solomon seeks or obeys Yahweh, Yahweh will accept Solomon. But if Solomon abandons or disobeys Yahweh, then Yahweh would reject Solomon forever. David tells Solomon that he must realize and never forget that Yahweh has chosen him to build a house or temple that would be Yahweh's sanctuary. A sanctuary is any holy place that people have set apart for the worship of Yahweh. People sometimes used sanctuary as another word for the temple of Yahweh. In that case, sanctuary can refer specifically to the Holy of Holies, the most important place in the temple. People use the word temple for the building as well as for the courtyards surrounding it, but people only use the word sanctuary for the building.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a very holy place or thing. Discuss who can enter the place or touch the thing and why. Tell of the reasons that make it holy. Pay attention to the words and phrases you use to describe its holiness. Pause this audio here.

David charged Solomon to therefore be strong or firm and do the work or build the temple.

In the second scene, after telling Solomon to do the work of building the house of Yahweh, David gives Solomon the building plans for the temple. It is not clear what these plans looked like. Usually, building plans are drawings, but it is more likely that David's plans were written instructions. The storyteller interrupts the flow of the action to tell us the instructions that were in the plans. The plans had instructions for various parts of the temple. The storyteller lists these parts beginning from the outside of the temple and going to the inside.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Imagine talking to someone who has never been to your village. Describe to him in detail what your village's place of worship looks like. Begin your description from the outside of the place of worship, going in. Describe it just as someone would see it when they approach it and then go inside. Pause this audio here.

The plans David gave to Solomon had instructions on how Solomon should build the entrance of the temple. David also gave Solomon instructions for how to build the temple houses. The plans also had instructions for how to build the temple's storage rooms. The plans had instructions for the rooms that they would build on the roof of the temple. The plans also described the inner rooms of the temple and the room for the mercy seat. The room for the mercy seat or atonement cover for the ark of the covenant was the most important room in the temple. This room was called the Holy of Holies because this is where the people kept the ark of the covenant. The priests asked Yahweh to forgive the people's sins in the Holy of Holies.

Stop here and look at the drawing of Solomon's temple as a group. Point to the room called the Holy of Holies. Pause the audio here.

King David gave Solomon all the plans that had come to his mind through the Spirit of Yahweh. The Spirit of Yahweh uses people to do what Yahweh wants. The Spirit of Yahweh can speak to people directly, but he can also direct them through their own thoughts and plans. It is likely that David means that the Spirit directed David's mind when he was making plans for the temple. The Spirit directed David on how to build the courts of Yahweh's temple and the rooms around the courts. The temple had two courts or large open spaces. One was for the priest to make sacrifices, and the other court was for the people of Israel. They built rooms on the wall of the temple that surrounded the courts. The Spirit also directed David on how to build the treasuries or storerooms of Yahweh's house. The priests probably used these rooms to store the vessels or utensils that they used in their work, as well as the food items such as flour, oil, and wine. The Spirit also directed David on how to build the treasuries for the dedicated things, such as gold, silver, and other valuable items that people had offered to Yahweh. King David gave Solomon instructions about how to divide the priests and the other descendants of Levi into groups. David told Solomon to organise the priests or descendants of Aaron and their helpers, the Levites, into groups so that they could do their work in the temple in shifts.

King David also gave Solomon instructions about the vessels or utensils that the priests and Levites were to use when they did their work in the temple. The priests would use many different utensils of gold or silver in their temple work. David told Solomon how much gold or silver he should use to make each thing. The priest would use gold and silver lamps in their work. David told Solomon the weight of gold for each golden lampstand with its lamps and the weight of silver for the silver lampstands and their lamps also.

Stop here and look at a picture of a gold and silver lampstand as a group. Pause this audio here.

The weight of each golden or silver lampstand with its lamps depended on how the priests would use each lampstand. David also told Solomon the amount of gold for each table on which they would place the bread of the Presence, and also for the silver tables.

Stop here and look at a picture of a gold table as a group. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh had instructed the priest to have 12 loaves of bread, one for each tribe, before him on a table that people made of acacia wood and covered with pure gold. These loaves were called the bread of the Presence of Yahweh.

We do not know how the priests used the silver tables. David also told Solomon the amount of pure or true gold that he would need to make the forks or meat hooks that the priests used to handle the meat of sacrifice.

Stop here and look at a picture of the forks as a group. Pause this audio here.

David told Solomon the amount of gold and silver he would need to make the basins that the priests would use to hold the blood of the animals that they had killed for sacrifices. The priests were to sprinkle the blood of the sacrifice on the altar. David told Solomon the amount of gold that he would need to use to make the jugs and small bowls that the priests would use to pour out liquid or drink offerings.

Stop here and look at a picture of the basins, jugs, and small bowls as a group. Pause this audio here.

David gave Solomon the weight of pure gold and instructions for how to make the altar of incense. Yahweh told the priests to burn sweet-smelling incense to Yahweh every day. David also gave Solomon instructions about the golden chariot, which is the golden cherubim that spread their wings to cover the covenant box of Yahweh. The people of Israel considered the cherubim to be a chariot or vehicle on which Yahweh rode.

Stop here and look at a picture of the cherubim on the ark as a group. Pause the audio here.

King David told Solomon that he had written all the instructions that Yahweh's hand had given David. This means that Yahweh had guided David and helped David to understand all the details of how to build the house of Yahweh. It is important to remember here that Yahweh had also given Moses exact instructions for how to build the tabernacle.

In the third scene, after listing the instructions that were in the plans, the storyteller continues the flow of the action of the story. David urged Solomon to be strong and brave, and to do the work that Yahweh had given him. David told Solomon not to be afraid or discouraged because Yahweh would help Solomon. David spoke to Solomon directly and said his God, Yahweh, would help Solomon. David assured Solomon that Yahweh would not fail him or forsake him, and that Yahweh would make sure that all the work related to the temple for Yahweh was finished correctly. David had warned Solomon that if Solomon did not obey, or if he abandoned Yahweh, Yahweh would reject Solomon forever. Then David told Solomon to look and see that all the priests and Levites in their groups were ready to start their work in the temple. It is likely that David was actually pointing to the priests and Levites or their leaders, who were probably there with the rest of the leaders of Israel. David also told Solomon that many craftsmen had volunteered to help Solomon in the work to build the temple. He also told Solomon that the leaders of the people of Israel were ready to obey everything that Solomon commanded them. David had strongly commanded these leaders in the last story.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 28:9–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- David
- Solomon
- Priests and Levites
- The leaders of Israel
- All the skilled craftsmen
- And all the people of Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, David urges Solomon to know Yahweh and to be completely committed to serving Yahweh. David tells Solomon to obey Yahweh and to build the temple. David warns Solomon that if Solomon rejects Yahweh then Yahweh will also reject Solomon. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel very serious. This is very important. I pray that my son listens and obeys my words. The future of the nation of Israel depends on it; or
- I love my son. I feel very proud of him. I think Solomon will be a good king, but only if he loves Yahweh and obeys. Yahweh is the real king of Israel. Solomon must know and understand this; or
- O Yahweh, my God, please help my son and bless the people of Israel.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am nervous and also excited; or
- I am happy to do the work that Yahweh has given me, but I am worried that I might make mistakes. My father has strongly warned me to be very careful to obey Yahweh; or
- I must be committed to Yahweh as my father was committed to Yahweh. I want Yahweh to be happy with me just as he has been happy with my father. I pray that when Yahweh looks at my heart and mind, Yahweh will be happy.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, David gives Solomon the plans he had prepared to build the temple and its buildings. David also tells Solomon the weight in gold and silver that he would need to make various utensils that the priests will use in their work, and how to organise the priests and Levites for their work. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel great joy. My heart praises Yahweh. He has shown me the plans for building the temple and has allowed me to deliver them into the hands of the man who will build it. I pray that Yahweh will give Solomon the strength to do it; or
- I have given Solomon all the plans that Yahweh gave me in front of all the leaders of Israel. Solomon must follow these plans carefully. This is a glorious day; or
- I feel very happy and proud that my son will build Yahweh a house. I only wish that I could have seen it with my eyes and worshipped Yahweh in his temple.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Wow! These plans are amazing. Look at the detail. My father has thought about everything; or
- Yahweh has given my father every direction for everything that will be needed. I am happy that Yahweh has done this; or
- This will be a magnificent temple. I will need many skilled men who can follow these plans.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy. I am pleased with David. David has listened to me and done everything I told him; or
- I will help David's son Solomon to finish the work of building the temple; or
- Solomon is listening well, and I can see that he is serious about building the temple.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, David urges Solomon to be brave and do the work that Yahweh has given him. David tells Solomon that the priest and Levites are ready to begin their work in the temple and that the skilled craftsmen are ready and willing to help him do the work to build the temple. David also tells Solomon that the leaders of the people of Israel will obey everything that he tells them. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Everything has been prepared for Solomon to start and finish the work I have given him. Solomon has no excuse to fail; or
- The priest and Levites, the skilled men, and the leaders of Israel will follow Solomon if he leads them; or
- And I will be with Solomon, just as I was with Moses when he built the tabernacle.

Ask the person playing priests and Levites, the skilled craftsmen, and the leaders of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are ready to do all that Yahweh has commanded; or
- Solomon is the new king and we will support him and obey him; or
- We cannot wait to begin the work.

Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I have delivered the kingdom and the responsibility of building the temple to Solomon in front of all Israel; or
- This is a day to rejoice; or
- I can now die in peace.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I have a lot of responsibility; or
- I am very young and inexperienced. I pray that I do not fail; or
- O Yahweh, help me lead these people that you have given me to do the work. Give me wisdom and strength, O Yahweh.

Ask the person playing the skilled craftsmen, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy and excited to begin work; or
- I feel joy.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 28:9–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Listen to your translations of Exodus 25 and Exodus 27. Pay attention to the way you translated lampstands, table of the bread of Presence, forks, basins, cups, and golden bowls in those passages and translate the same in this passage. Pause this audio here.

David tells Solomon to know the **God** of his father or David's God. David tells Solomon to be committed to the God of his father because **Yahweh** searches all **hearts** and understands every plan and thought. Use the same words or phrases for heart, Yahweh, and God as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and God, refer to the Master Glossary.

David reminded Solomon that Yahweh had chosen Solomon to build Yahweh a **house** for the **sanctuary** and urged him to not give up, but to do it. Use the same words or phrases for house and sanctuary as you used in previous passages. For more information on "house of God," temple, or sanctuary refer to the Master Glossary.

David said that **Yahweh's Spirit** had given David all the plans for the temple. David just calls Yahweh's spirit "the Spirit" here, but we know that this is God's Spirit. For more information about God's Spirit, see Holy Spirit in the Master Glossary, and use the same word for Spirit, when it refers to God's Spirit, as you have in previous passages in 1 Chronicles.

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Then David gave Solomon the plan or pattern for the entrance of the temple and of its houses, its treasuries, its upper rooms, its inner chambers, and the room with the mercy seat or atonement cover. The atonement cover or the mercy seat was where Yahweh removed the sins of the people of Israel and restored his relationship with his people, because this is where the high priest sprinkled the blood of the sacrifice.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **mercy seat**, or **atonement cover**. Look up "ark of the covenant" and atonement in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David gave Solomon the plans for dividing the **priests** and **Levites** into the groups that they would do their temple work in. Use the same words or phrases for priests and Levites as you used in previous passages. For more information on priests and Levites, refer to the Master Glossary.

David told Solomon the amount of gold and silver that he would need for all the objects that the priests would use in the temple service, including the lampstands and their lamps, and the tables where they placed the **bread of the Presence**. The priests offered bread of the Presence to Yahweh as a symbol that Yahweh was present in the Tent of Meeting. The priests placed 12 loaves on the golden table that was in the room called the Holy Place. The priests replaced it with fresh bread each Sabbath. You should translate lamps, lampstands, and bread of the Presence as you did in previous passages, and refer to the Master Glossary for "bread of the Presence."

David told Solomon the amount of pure gold and silver that he would need to make the forks, basins, jugs, and the gold and silver for the bowls. David also told Solomon the amount of pure gold he would need for the **altar of incense** and for the golden chariot, the cherubim, with their wings spread over the **ark of the covenant**. An altar is a place where people make offerings or sacrifices to God. The gift could be an animal, food items, or sweet-smelling spices. The altar of incense was a specific altar where people offered sweet-smelling spices to Yahweh. Use the same words or phrases for "ark of the covenant" and "altar of incense" as you have in previous passages, and refer to "altar" in the Master Glossary for more information.

A cherub is a type of angel, and people call more than one cherub "cherubim." Cherubim seem to especially guard sacred, or holy, places. Gold cherubim spread their wings over the top of the ark of the covenant and protected the throne where Yahweh met with his people from the top of the ark of the covenant. In the book of Ezekiel, Ezekiel sees a vision in which cherubim are carrying the throne of God. It is likely that the golden chariot is another way to refer to the cherubim that were on the ark.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **golden chariot** and **cherubim**. Look up cherubim in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there.

David reminded Solomon that Yahweh's **hand**, or power, had given David all the plans he needed for the temple. Translate the idea of Yahweh's hand, or power, in the same way you have in previous passages.

David said that Yahweh would be with Solomon until the work for the **service** of the temple was finished. The service of the temple is the work that the Levites and priests do to keep the work of the temple going. Skilled craftsmen would help Solomon complete the work. A craftsman in this context is someone who has wisdom in how to conduct worship to Yahweh well.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **skilled craftsmen**.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 28:9–21

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.1 MB)
- Setting the Stage (7.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (11.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

1 Chronicles 29:1–9

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 29:1–9 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:1–9 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Yahweh guided King David to make plans and instructions for how the Israelites should build the temple, and King David gave these plans and instructions to Solomon. King David told Solomon in the presence of all the leaders of Israel to obey and serve Yahweh.

In this story, after King David commanded Solomon to do the work to build the temple, King David turned and spoke to all the assembly, or all the Israelites gathered there. King David had called all the leaders of the people of Israel to Jerusalem. King David told the leaders that his son Solomon was the only one that God had chosen to build Yahweh's temple. King David had many sons who could have become king after their father, David. Yahweh, the true King of Israel, had chosen Solomon to rule Israel as Yahweh's representative. King David told the people of Israel that Yahweh had given Solomon, who was young and inexperienced, the great work to build a house

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for Yahweh. King David is saying that Solomon had not yet learned everything that he needed to know about life and about being a king. It is not clear how old Solomon was when he became king, but it is likely that Solomon was not fully grown up. Solomon may have been around 20 years old.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss the stages of life that a boy goes through in your community before people consider him a fully grown man. What are the things that he has to learn in the various stages, and at which stage would he be ready to be a leader in the community? Pause this audio here.

King David said that the palace that Solomon would build was not simply a great house for a king, but it was a house to worship Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Describe the kind of house that a king or the most important man in your community lives in. Then describe the house that your community builds for people to worship God. Talk about the differences between a great house for a great man to live in and a great house for people to worship God in. Pause this audio here.

Then King David told the people that because of the great work that Solomon had to do, and because Solomon was young and inexperienced, King David had done his best to help Solomon. King David said that he had provided Solomon with materials to build the temple. King David said that he had prepared gold, silver, bronze, iron, timber, precious stones and gems, stones for mosaics, and quantities of marble. The builders would need a lot of each of these materials.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell of a time when your leader successfully built a great building, especially a place of worship. Talk about the kind of building materials that they needed to complete the building and how much material they used. Discuss how the leader managed to get the people of the community involved in the work and the various ways that the people helped. For example, people could give money, land, building materials, and they could do the work. Pause this audio here.

King David also told the people that, in addition to preparing all these things for Solomon, King David had also given gold and silver from his own private wealth. King David said that he gave his own gold and silver because he was completely dedicated to the work of building the holy temple of Yahweh. King David gave 3,000 talents of gold from a place called Ophir. We are not sure where Ophir was, but it was famous for having the highest quality of pure gold. A talent of gold could weigh around 34 kilograms. So David likely gave about 100,000 kilograms of gold. David also gave 7,000 talents of refined or pure silver, which was around 230,000 kilograms. Refined silver is silver that people have made pure by heating it until they have removed all the impurities. King David said that he gave his gold and silver so that people could use it to decorate the walls of the temple houses and to make all the other objects that the skilled workers were to make. The people of Israel saw gold as a symbol of wealth, holiness, and Yahweh's glory.

King David then asked the leaders of the people of Israel which of them would follow his example and devote themselves to Yahweh by contributing to the work of the temple. When someone gave their possessions to Yahweh, they showed that they were dedicated to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about times you have given some of your possessions as a way to dedicate yourself spiritually. How did you feel when you gave? Talk about times when it was hard to give your things away, and you did not want to give your things away. Pause this audio here.

The leaders of the families of Israel, the leaders of the 12 tribes and the commanders of the units of 1,000 and 100 soldiers, together with the officials in charge of King David's business, all gave gold, silver, bronze, iron, and gems willingly. All together, they contributed to the work to build the temple, gold weighing 5,000 talents or 170,000 kilograms and 10,000 daric coins of gold. A daric was a coin that the kingdom of Persia used many years after the days of David and Solomon. It is unlikely that the people gave actual daric coins because the Persian Empire did not exist for another 420 years. It is likely that the storyteller uses the daric because he knows that the people who lived in the days that he wrote would understand the value of a daric.

Stop here and look at a picture of a daric coin as a group. Pause this audio here.

The leaders also gave 10,000 talents or 340,000 kilograms of silver, 18,000 talents or 612,000 kilograms of bronze, and 100,000 talents or 3,400,000 kilograms of iron. And those leaders who had gems or precious stones donated

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them to the treasury of the house of Yahweh. Those leaders gave the gems to a man called Jehiel, a Levite from the clan of Gershon. The descendants of Gershon were responsible for transporting the tabernacle's fabrics and covering. It is likely that David made Jehiel, their leader, responsible for the contributions that people gave for the temple.

The people of Israel rejoiced and celebrated because their leaders had contributed to the temple willingly. And King David was also very joyful because they had offered their valuable things to Yahweh willingly and with their whole heart.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell stories of a time when the leaders of your community contributed to a project willingly, and people responded with great joy.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: King David told the leaders of Israel that Yahweh had chosen his young and inexperienced son Solomon. King David told the leaders about the materials that he had prepared for Solomon to build the temple.

In the second scene: Because of how committed and dedicated King David was to the work to build the temple, David contributed more material from his own private wealth. King David gave his own gold and silver to cover the walls of the temple and to make the other objects that the skilled workers would need to make.

In the third scene: King David asked the leaders if they would follow his example and also make contributions to the work of the temple. The leaders of Israel followed King David's example and also contributed willingly from their own private wealth. The leaders gave gold, money, silver, bronze, iron, and precious stones to Jehiel, the man in charge of the contributions for the temple.

In the fourth scene: The people of Israel rejoiced because their leaders gave willingly to the work of the temple of Yahweh. King David also rejoiced greatly.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- King David
- Solomon
- All the leaders of the people of Israel: these were the leaders of the families, the leaders of the tribes, the military commanders of thousands of fighting men and hundreds of fighting men, and all the officials who were in charge of King David's business
- The skilled workers who will build the temple and make the things that go in it
- Jehiel the Gershonite
- And the assembly, or the people of Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the previous story, King David had been speaking to Solomon in front of the leaders. David gave Solomon the plans for the temple and encouraged Solomon to do the work. When King David finishes instructing Solomon, King David turns to the whole assembly or the gathered leaders and addresses them. The storyteller begins this scene with a word that connects the last story with this one. King David speaks to the leaders directly and tells them that his son, Solomon, is still soft and tender or young and inexperienced. This does not mean that Solomon is physically weak or emotionally childlike, but that Solomon has not yet learned all the things he needs to know.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a person who received a great responsibility at an early age. How do you talk about how hard it is to have a great responsibility at a young age? Pause audio here.

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King David said that although Solomon was young and inexperienced, God had chosen Solomon. In this story, King David refers to Yahweh by his personal name and also by the more general name, “God.” It is important to refer to David as King David because he is speaking as a king to the people he rules. King David told the leaders that the work that Yahweh had given Solomon was great. It is likely that King David means that the work is important as well as large and difficult.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to describe the kind of work that Yahweh gave to Solomon in your language? Remember that the work was great because it was large and difficult as well as spiritually important. Pause this audio here.

King David said that the work was great because the palace that Solomon was going to build is not a palace for a man to live in, but for Yahweh, the God of Israel, to live in. King David calls the temple a palace, castle, or fortress. This usually refers to an important building from which a ruler rules a town or area. This kind of building was usually very secure against attack and was also the home of the king or ruler. It is likely that King David talks about the temple as if it were a king’s palace because Yahweh is the real King of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Suggest various words that you use in your language to refer to a palace or a great house where a great man or ruler lives. This house would be protected against enemy attack. Pause this audio here.

King David told the assembly what he had done in order to help his young and inexperienced son Solomon. King David said that he did all that he was able to do to prepare materials for the building of the house of his God. King David did this to help his son Solomon, but the main reason he prepared the materials is that he loves his God, Yahweh. King David said he prepared gold, silver, bronze, iron, and wood for building. King Solomon would need all of these things to make various things for the temple. King David said that he had also provided precious stones for the work of decoration. King David provided onyx, a beautiful stone that people can find in many colors. David also provided blue-green stones called turquoise and other precious stones of different colors, as well as a large amount of marble. Marble is a beautiful type of stone that people used to make the beautiful floor of the temple.

Stop here and look at a picture of onyx, turquoise, and marble as a group. Name and describe the different types of stones that you have in your community. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, King David continued to talk to the elders. King David said that, in addition to the materials that he had already prepared, King David would now, or at that moment, contribute more from his own private wealth. King David said that he would do this because he was devoted to the house or temple of his God. David called the temple a holy temple or sanctuary. Any building becomes holy or a sanctuary when people dedicate it to honor Yahweh. A king has wealth from his position as king and also his own private wealth as a man. A king can do whatever he likes with his own private wealth, but the kingdom’s wealth goes to the person who becomes king after him. King David contributed 3,000 talents of gold from Ophir. We are not sure where Ophir was, but people knew that it produced the highest quality of pure gold. A talent is a weight measurement. One talent is equal to around 34 kilograms. So King David gave around 100,000 kilograms of high-quality gold from Ophir. King David also gave refined or pure silver that weighed 7,000 talents or 230,000 kilograms. King David said that he gave these so that people could use them to cover the walls of the houses of the temple and for any other work that the skilled workers would need gold and silver to do. Yahweh had instructed them to cover the inside of the entrance room of the temple, the main room, and the walls of the Most Holy Place with gold.

In the third scene, King David asked the leaders which of them would follow his example. King David asked them if they would show their devotion to Yahweh by contributing to the work of the temple freely. Yahweh never demands free will offerings, but Yahweh receives gifts that people give joyfully. The leaders of the families of Israel, the leaders of the 12 tribes of Israel, the commanders of the military units of 1,000 and 100 soldiers each, and the officials who were in charge of King David’s business, responded to King David. These people contributed freely to the work of the temple, without anyone forcing them. The leaders gave gold that weighed 5,000 talents or 165,000 kilograms, 10,000 coins of gold called darics, which is about 84 kilograms of gold, silver that weighed 10,000 talents or 330,000 kilograms, bronze that weighed 18,000 talents or 600,000 kilograms, and iron that weighed 100,000 talents or 3,300,000 kilograms. It is likely that these are the amounts of all their gifts added together. Also, those of them who had precious stones contributed them to the storehouse of the temple of

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Yahweh. Jehiel the Levite from the clan of Gershon was the one who was in charge of the storehouse of the temple of Yahweh.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Discuss the weight of the gifts that the leaders gave. Remember that a talent is around 34 kilograms, and a daric is a coin that people made of gold. How would you speak of these gifts in your own language using weights that you are familiar with? Pause audio here.

In the fourth scene, the people of Israel rejoiced because of the gifts that their leaders had given with their whole hearts to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about someone who gives generously and freely, as the leaders of Israel did? Take turns describing the leaders of your community who gave willingly to the project that you discussed in the last step. Pause this audio here.

And King David also rejoiced with great joy.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- King David
- Solomon
- All the leaders of the people of Israel: these were the leaders of the families, the leaders of the tribes, the military commanders of thousands of fighting men and hundreds of fighting men, and all the officials who were in charge of King David's business
- The skilled workers who will build the temple and make the things that go in it
- Jehiel the Gershonite
- And the assembly, or the people of Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

King David tells the leaders of Israel that Yahweh has chosen Solomon, who is young and inexperienced. King David tells the leaders about all the materials that he has prepared for Solomon to build the temple. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel passionate. I am very committed to the work of the temple. I want everything to go well and for it to be a success; or
- I feel worried because my son has no experience. I am really concerned that Solomon might fail; or

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- I have done everything to help Solomon. I have collected and provided all these materials that people will need. I am speaking to the leaders because I want them to be committed and help Solomon.

Ask the person playing the leaders of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We are very excited by King David's message and his strong spirit; or
- King David has done such a mighty work in providing all these materials. We love King David and will do everything that he tells us; or
- Solomon will need our help. Yahweh has chosen Solomon. We will support Solomon.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel amazed. My father is very passionate and determined. My father's words give my heart courage; or
- I am very nervous about the work. It is a big responsibility, and I am afraid of failing; or
- I feel happy that my father has provided so much material for me to begin the work. I love my father, King David.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, King David tells the leaders of Israel about how committed and dedicated he is to the work of building the temple. King David therefore contributes from his own private wealth, gold, and silver to cover the walls of the temple and to make the other objects that the skilled workers will need to make. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel very happy and excited; or
- I love Yahweh, and I am eager for Yahweh's house to be built; or
- I am ready to give generously from my wealth, which Yahweh has given me, to the work of the temple.

Ask the person playing the skilled workers, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Praise Yahweh. This is a very great contribution from King David; or
- This is the best gold and silver in the world. We are very excited to begin the work; or
- What an amazing and beautiful temple it will be.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, King David asks the leaders if they will follow his example and also make contributions to the work of the temple. The leaders of Israel follow King David's example and also contribute willingly from their own private wealth. The leaders gave gold, money, silver, bronze, iron, and precious stones to Jehiel, the man in charge of the contributions for the temple. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel very happy. King David loves me, and the leaders of Israel also love me. They have all given generously and willingly. I know that they are devoted to me; or
- I love the unity these men have all shown, and David, my servant, for leading them well; or
- I am pleased with these men's hearts and minds.

Ask the person playing the leaders of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy and blessed. What a day this is; or
- We will gladly give with much joy in our hearts. We are eager to build the temple; or
- We love King David and his son Solomon, and we love Yahweh our God and King.

Ask the person playing Jehiel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am very happy. Everyone gives generously, and I, too, give what I have; or
- People have given 165,000 kilos of gold, 330,000 kilos of silver, 600,000 kilos of bronze, 3,300,000 kilos of iron, and many gems and precious stones. I must keep very good records and store them well; or
- I am honored to be involved in the work of the temple. What a great blessing.

Continue the drama. In the fourth scene, the people of Israel rejoiced because of their leaders' gifts that they, the leaders, had given freely to Yahweh. And King David also rejoiced with great joy. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

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- This is amazing. We are very happy. Our hearts are full; or
- What a great day in Israel. What great leaders we have. They have proved their love for Yahweh and Israel; or
- We love our leaders and praise Yahweh.

Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This is the happiest day. I trust that the people will complete the temple; or
- The leaders are devoted. The leaders will help Solomon and build Yahweh's house; or
- Let's eat and drink and be merry. There is great joy in Israel today.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel hopeful. I am very encouraged by the devotion of the leaders; or
- All the people of Israel are happy and excited about the temple. I must not fail; or
- My father has been very loyal to Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

King David told all the **assembly** of Israel that his son Solomon, the same one that **God** had chosen, was young and inexperienced. An assembly of people is a special gathering of people who meet for a purpose. King David told the assembly that the task is great because the palace is not for man, but for **Yahweh**. Use the same words or phrases for assembly, King, God, and Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on king, God, and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

A palace is a large and beautiful home for a ruler or king. A palace is also where the king rules his kingdom from. King David likely calls the temple of Yahweh a palace because Yahweh is the true king of Israel.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **palace**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

King David said that the palace is for **Yahweh God**. David uses these two titles for the God of Israel to show that Yahweh is the God of Israel. There is no other god for Israel. You should use both titles—Yahweh and God—here in your translation.

King David told the leaders that he had done all that he could to provide gold, silver, bronze, iron, timber, precious stones, and gems for decorations, and a large amount of marble for the work of the **temple**, or the **house of God**. Use the same word or phrase for temple or "house of God" as you used in previous passages. For more information on the temple and "house of God," refer to the Master Glossary.

King David said that because he was dedicated to the work of the **holy** temple or holy house of God, he also gave gold and silver from his private wealth. We call a place that is dedicated to God "holy." The temple is holy because it is set apart for Yahweh's honor. Translate holy in the same way you have previously, and refer to holy in the Master Glossary for more information.

King David said that he was providing materials for the skilled craftsmen to use when they make the things that go inside the temple. These skilled craftsmen are men who make the things that go inside the temple, like the gold and silver bowls, jugs, utensils, tables, altars, and basins.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the skilled craftsmen who will make the objects that go inside the temple. Pause this audio here.

King David contributed gold and silver for people to decorate the walls of the temple and asked the leaders if they too would **consecrate** themselves by following his example and contributing freely to the work. In this story, consecrate means to dedicate yourself to Yahweh, or make yourself holy. The leaders did this by giving their wealth freely to the work of the temple. Use the same word or phrase for consecrate as you used in previous passages. Look up consecrate in the Master Glossary for more information.

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The **leaders**, **chiefs**, or heads of the families or clans, and of the **tribes** of Israel, the **commanders** of thousands and of hundreds of soldiers, and the officials in charge of the king's work, gave willingly. Use the same words or phrases for the leaders, the chiefs of families or fathers' houses, the leaders of tribes, and the military commanders as you used in previous passages.

These people gave many **talents** of gold, silver, bronze, and iron. A talent is a measurement of weight. One talent is around 34 kilograms. You can calculate the weights into kilograms and use kilograms instead of talents if the word talent would cause confusion. Use the same word or phrase for talent as you have used previously, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information about talent. The people also gave 10,000 **darics**. You may say 10,000 gold coins if the word daric would cause confusion.

Stop here and discuss again how you will translate the weight of the gold, silver, bronze, and iron that David and the leaders gave. Pause this audio here.

The leaders who had precious stones gave them to Jehiel the Gershonite. Jehiel was in charge of the **treasury** of the house of Yahweh. A treasury is a storeroom for valuable things. Use the same word or phrase for treasury as you used in previous passages in 1 Chronicles.

The people of Israel rejoiced because of the gifts that their leaders had given with their "whole heart" to Yahweh.

Stop here and decide as a group how you will translate that the leaders gave with their **whole heart** to Yahweh. If you use the word heart in your translation, use the same word or phrase as you have used previously, and refer to heart in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (5.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (8.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (7.0 MB)

- Filling the Gaps (4.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.5 MB)

1 Chronicles 29:10–20

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 29:10–20 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:10–20 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:10–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, King David and the leaders of the people of Israel rejoiced greatly because they had given generously to the work of the temple.

In this story, King David prayed. In his prayer, David praised and gave thanks to Yahweh because the leaders of the people of Israel had given willingly. King David felt that Yahweh had caused the leaders to give generously to the work of the temple. King David spoke to Yahweh directly in the presence of all the leaders of Israel. King David blessed or gave thanks and praise to Yahweh. Usually, it is Yahweh who blesses or does good things to people because Yahweh is greater than people. When people bless Yahweh, they are praising or worshipping Yahweh. David called Yahweh the God of Israel, or the God of Jacob. Jacob, whom Yahweh renamed Israel, was the ancestor of the people of Israel. King David said that all the praise, from eternity to eternity, belongs to Yahweh. King David said “eternity to eternity” because Yahweh has no beginning or end. Yahweh was there before creation and will be there when creation ends.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell stories of a time when a leader of your community has spoken to God to say thank you or to worship and praise God. How did the leader speak, and what was the reason that led him to do this? Pause this audio here.

King David praised Yahweh by saying that all the greatness and power belonged to Yahweh. David was saying that there is no one who is greater or more powerful than Yahweh. King David also said that Yahweh is glorious or beautiful, victorious and majestic. King David was speaking about how powerful Yahweh is. People honor Yahweh as king, and Yahweh has the highest status. King David said that everything in heaven and on earth belongs to Yahweh because Yahweh rules over everything. Yahweh is the ruler of everything because Yahweh created everything in heaven and on earth. The kingdom of Israel belongs to Yahweh. Yahweh created it and was its true King. The Israelites worship one God, Yahweh, who is in charge of everything.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about the greatest God, spirit, or important person in the history of your culture. Describe what makes them better than all the rest and how no one can compare them to any other thing. Pause this audio here.

King David thanked Yahweh, the ruler of all things, because Yahweh gives wealth and honor. King David is likely thinking about the wealth that the people have given for the temple and the honor of being the people that Yahweh chose to build Yahweh a house on earth. David also said that Yahweh has strength and power and is able to give people a higher status and to give people strength. It was Yahweh who had lifted the people of Israel

from a few men to a large nation and from being slaves to being free. Yahweh had also lifted David from being a shepherd boy to become the King of Israel. King David said that they, the people of Israel, were thankful to Yahweh their God, and that they praised Yahweh's glorious or beautiful name. In Israel, people's names reflected their character. So to praise Yahweh's glorious name is the same as to praise Yahweh for who Yahweh is.

King David praised Yahweh for being great and then compared that greatness to how small David and Israel were. King David asked who he and his people, Israel, were that they were able to give generously to the work of the temple. Yahweh owns everything and does not need anything from anyone. King David and the people had brought their gifts and had given generously. But David and the people had only given back what Yahweh had given them.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell stories of how you or a person you know gave to someone else in need, and later on, the one who was in need came back and helped the very person who had helped him or her. Pause this audio here.

King David said that they were sojourners and strangers in the sight or in the presence of Yahweh, just as their ancestors had been. Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, the ancestors of Israel, lived in the land and moved from place to place while they lived in tents. These people lived as if they did not own anything and had no security in the land. The land of Israel, as well as the world, belongs to Yahweh. Yahweh had given the children of Israel the right to live in the land of Israel and to enjoy its benefits, but the land really belonged to Yahweh. Yahweh told these people to live their lives as pilgrims or people on a journey. King David said that the days of the people of Israel are like a shadow, without hope. David was saying that people's days on the earth end quickly, just like the amount of time a traveller spends in a single place.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a place that you visited for a short time. Describe some of the things that you enjoyed at that place, such as the food or the weather. Talk about how long you were able to enjoy them and how you felt when you had to leave. Pause this audio here.

King David praised Yahweh for all the things that they had been able to give in large quantities because it all belonged to Yahweh.

King David said that he knew that Yahweh tests or sees every person's heart and that Yahweh is happy when people do what is right with a sincere heart. King David told Yahweh that he had given all his offerings willingly and with an honest heart or purpose. David said that he had also joyfully watched as the leaders of Israel contributed willingly. King David asked Yahweh, the God of the ancestors of Israel, to keep the people of Israel's hearts honest and sincere. King David is likely asking that Yahweh would help the people of Israel to serve Yahweh with sincerity or to obey Yahweh as they build the temple and also after they finish building the temple. Yahweh is interested in people's hearts. If the people build the temple but disobey Yahweh's commandments, Yahweh would not be pleased. King David also asked Yahweh to give Solomon a heart that is dedicated to obeying Yahweh's rules and instructions. King David asked Yahweh to enable Solomon to build the palace for Yahweh, or temple, that King David had prepared materials for.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss when a great leader has come to the end of their life or term before they have completed a great work. Who did that leader leave the work to and how did he tell others what he wanted them to do to continue the work that he started? Pause this audio here.

Then King David told all the people gathered there to praise Yahweh their God. So all the people gathered there praised or worshiped Yahweh by bowing their heads in respect and laying down with their faces to the floor to honor Yahweh and King David.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss the actions you do to show deep respect, admiration, and worship in your culture.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:10–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: First King David publicly praised Yahweh for who Yahweh is.

In the second scene: King David praised and gave thanks to Yahweh because Yahweh helped the people to give generously. King David also told Yahweh how small and unimportant King David was compared to Yahweh. Then King David asked Yahweh to help the people and Solomon to be obedient and to build the temple.

In the third scene: King David told all the people gathered there to praise Yahweh their God. So all the people gathered there praised or worshiped Yahweh by bowing their heads in respect and lying down with their faces to the floor to honor Yahweh and King David.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- King David
- Solomon
- The assembly, or the people of Israel
- And, the fathers of the people of Israel: Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the previous story, the leaders of the people of Israel had given generously to the work of the temple. In this story, King David responds to their generous giving by giving praise to Yahweh. The first scene begins with a word that shows that David blessed Yahweh as a result of the leader's willingness to give. By blessing Yahweh, David is declaring that Yahweh is the source of all the generous gifts that David and the leaders of Israel have given. David blessed Yahweh in the eyes of all the assembly. This is special language to say that David prayed publicly or in front of all the people gathered there.

David's prayer is special, formal language that he uses when he prays publicly in celebrations. David praises Yahweh and talks about Yahweh's greatness and power.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about how your religious leaders or other leaders pray publicly. How is their prayer different from just praying at home alone or in a small group? What kinds of special language do you use in your culture when you pray publicly on formal occasions? Pause this audio here.

David spoke directly to Yahweh and said, "We praise you, Yahweh, God of our father Israel, from forever to forever." Israel is another name for Jacob, the ancestor of the Israelites. David told Yahweh that everything belonged to Yahweh. David says that Yahweh is the greatest and most powerful being. No one can match Yahweh's glory, majesty, and beauty. David also says Yahweh is a strong and victorious king with everlasting honor.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Choose a person to speak publicly as if he were addressing Yahweh. Let the person speak the words of David out loud while the rest of the group listens. The person may address Yahweh in direct speech. For example, he might say, "You, Yahweh, are powerful." Or, he might use indirect speech. For example, he might say, "To Yahweh belongs power." The rest of the people in the group should listen and decide the best way to communicate David's prayer. If they have other ways to communicate what David is saying, they should suggest those ways. Try out all suggestions until you have agreed on the best one. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, David praises Yahweh for helping the people to give generously. King David begins by asking Yahweh a question that he does not expect anyone to answer. David asks Yahweh who David and the people of Israel are that they were able to give so generously. Because everything in heaven and on earth belongs to Yahweh, David is saying that he and the people of Israel are not worthy to give to Yahweh. David said that the kingdom also belongs to Yahweh and that Yahweh is ruler over everything. It is likely that the kingdom that David is talking about is the kingdom of Israel. If so, David means that Yahweh is the true king and ruler of Israel. David continued praying and said that Yahweh gives riches and honor or respect to anyone whom Yahweh chooses because Yahweh is the ruler of everything. Yahweh had lifted David from being a shepherd boy to being King of Israel and had given David and the leaders of Israel their wealth. David says Yahweh is strong and powerful. David talks of strength and power as being in Yahweh's hand because it is Yahweh who lifts people up and makes them strong. David has been saying that the praise belongs to Yahweh because Yahweh is unique and no one compares to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss one or two great things that have happened to your community in its history. Who did the people think caused the great things to happen? How did the people credit the thing that had happened to them? Focus on events where the people felt that a spiritual being like God caused the events, and explain how people recognised that the spiritual being was responsible. Pause this audio here.

David then gives thanks to Yahweh and says that all the people there thank Yahweh and praise Yahweh's glorious or awesome name. David speaks for all the people of Israel. David gives the reason to thank Yahweh. David says that they, David and the people of Israel, are small and not special. David says that they, David and the leaders, were only able to give so generously because Yahweh, who owns everything, had first given them their wealth. David says that all the people of Israel are sojourners and strangers in Yahweh's sight or presence. Sojourners are people who are foreigners in a country and temporarily live there, even though it is not where they were born. A person is a stranger in a country when they are in a country that is not where they were born. David is saying that the people of Israel are just like their ancestors, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Yahweh owned the land, and the people lived in it and enjoyed it because Yahweh allowed them to do so.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about other communities that pass through your territory and stay only for a short time, such as communities that follow their animals around the country. Talk about those communities' relationship to your territory. Pay attention to the words and phrases you use to refer to these communities' way of life. Pause this audio here.

David says that the days of the people of Israel on the earth are like a shadow. David means that their time on earth is short and passes away quickly, so that the people have no real hope of continuing in the land.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Get a torch or light and shine it above an object to make a shadow. Draw a small area on the ground below the object to represent the land of Israel. Then have the person who holds the torch move it as if it were the sun. Watch how the shadow passes through the land. Discuss the length of a person's life. Pay attention to the words, phrases, and special language you use to refer to how short it is. Pause this audio here.

For this reason, David tells Yahweh that all the wealth that they, David and the leaders, have provided to build the temple, came from Yahweh and belongs to Yahweh. David says that the temple is for Yahweh's holy name. The fact that Yahweh's name is holy refers to Yahweh's character. Yahweh is completely good, pure, powerful, and majestic. Yahweh is whole, complete, and unchangeable. But most of all, it means that Yahweh is Yahweh.

Then David prays for the people of Israel and for Solomon. David tells Yahweh that he knows that Yahweh tests or examines people's hearts and that Yahweh is happy when people are honest. Yahweh cares about what we do and why we do it. Yahweh knows everything, even our thoughts and feelings. David tells Yahweh that he has given to the temple with an honest heart and is happy to see the people of Israel giving willingly too. David asks Yahweh to keep this desire in the Israelites' hearts forever. David wants the Israelites to obey Yahweh in everything, not just in building the temple. David prays for the people of Israel to stay loyal to Yahweh. David calls Yahweh the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, the Israelites' ancestors. David also prays for his son Solomon and asks Yahweh to give Solomon a committed heart to follow Yahweh's rules. David wants Yahweh to help Solomon build the beautiful temple. David prays for the hearts of the people and Solomon because the temple would mean nothing if they did not honor Yahweh with honesty and sincerity. The people of Israel believed that the heart was the place where people's intentions come from. Doing something with a pure heart, therefore, meant doing it with pure intentions.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell stories of people who have done great things for your community, especially things that cost them greatly. Talk about the intentions of the people's hearts and minds and the reasons why they were willing to pay a high price for your community. Pay attention to the words and phrases you use to describe their desires and willingness. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, David turned to all the people gathered there and told them to praise Yahweh their God. So the people did so. The people praised Yahweh, the God of their ancestors. The people bowed low and lay down with their faces on the ground to honor Yahweh and David, the king.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have a person play a great king. The rest of the people should honor that person by bowing low to him and lying down with their faces on the ground before him. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text
Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:10–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- King David
- Solomon
- The assembly, or the people of Israel
- And, the fathers of the people of Israel: Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, King David praised Yahweh publicly because of who Yahweh is. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy. My heart is very glad. I rejoice because Yahweh has caused all of this great generosity; or
- I want to sing and dance and praise our great God, Yahweh. I love Yahweh; or
- No one compares to Yahweh. Yahweh is awesome, full of power and glory. Yahweh has made this day happen, and we are all happier than we have ever been.

Ask the person playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We are very joyful. Our hearts are full of happiness. Yahweh has blessed us greatly; or
- Our king is happy, and we are happy with him. Truly, David is right. Yahweh owns everything; or
- We feel very honored to be the people Yahweh has chosen to build the temple.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Pleased with my people. My people honor me; or
- The people are right to praise me. Their praise is a pleasing offering to me; or
- I alone am God, and my people recognise this.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, King David praised Yahweh by giving thanks to Yahweh for helping the people to give generously. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing King David, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel very thankful. I want the whole world to hear me thanking Yahweh, my God; or

- It is Yahweh who has given us all these gifts that we have given to the work of the temple. There is great joy in Israel today; or
- What a blessed people we are. Yahweh loves us. My heart is full of praise for Yahweh.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel respected and honored; or
- David pleases me because he recognises that without me, he is nothing; or
- My name is glorified, and I am happy.

Continue the drama. King David prayed for the people and Solomon to be obedient and to build the temple. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so happy. What a wonderful and glorious day this is; or
- I feel humbled by the work ahead of me and by the greatness of my father, David; or
- I feel like David loves me very much. David prays good things for me, and I pray that Yahweh will help me and give me a heart like David's so that I may serve Yahweh as David has.

Ask the person playing the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Amen! Amen! O Yahweh, hear our king's prayer; or
- We love Yahweh and want to love Yahweh forever; or
- May Yahweh bless Solomon so that we may live in happy days like today.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, King David told all the people gathered there to praise Yahweh their God. So all the people gathered there praised or worshiped Yahweh by bowing their heads in respect and lying down with their faces to the floor to honor Yahweh and King David. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Our hearts are full of songs of honor to Yahweh. We feel very blessed and favored to be here today; or
- We are dancing and rejoicing because of all that has taken place. We thank Yahweh; or
- We are very excited about the future. We worship and praise Yahweh. We also respect David for being a great king and leader.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel great joy and happiness; or
- I want to serve Yahweh forever and do all that Yahweh asks; or
- I love Yahweh, and I love my father David and all the people of Israel.

Ask the person playing King David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that I have seen this day. My heart is at rest because I know that I have done all I could to prepare my son and the people of Israel to build the temple and to serve Yahweh; or
- I feel peace and joy. I am full of hope for Solomon's reign; or
- Yahweh has loved me and blessed me.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel loved and honoured; or
- The people worship me, and they raise their voices in adoration to me. I am happy; or
- I will bless the people and help them because I love them.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:10–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

David **blessed Yahweh** in the presence of the whole **assembly**, or the people gathered there. Usually, it is Yahweh who blesses people. When people bless Yahweh, it means they are worshiping Yahweh and thanking Yahweh for his goodness and his blessings. To bless is another way of saying to praise. Use the same word or phrase for bless, Yahweh, and assembly as you used in previous passages. For more information on bless and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

David called Yahweh the "**God** of our father **Israel**." Yahweh changed the name of the father of the 12 tribes from Jacob to Israel. Use the same word or phrase for God and Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on God or Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

David said that the **glory** belonged to Yahweh because everything in **heaven** and earth belonged to Yahweh. David said that the **kingdom** belonged to Yahweh and Yahweh was head or ruler of all. Use the same words or phrases for glory, heaven, and kingdom as you used in previous passages. For more information on glory, heaven, or kingdom, refer to the Master Glossary.

David gives God thanks, and David **praises** God. Use the same word or phrase for praise as you have in previous passages, and remember that praise is in the Master Glossary.

David thanked Yahweh and said that all the abundant gifts that David had given for building a **temple**, or house, for Yahweh's **holy** name came from Yahweh. David uses the word for "house" and the word for "palace" when he talks about the temple in this passage. You may just use the word for temple throughout if you would like, or the word for palace that you used in the previous passage. If you use the word for temple, use the same words or phrases for temple and holy as you used in previous passages. For more information on temple or holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

David said that the people of Israel were sojourners and strangers before Yahweh. These two words have a similar meaning. A person is a sojourner in a country when they temporarily live in a country where they were not born, and perhaps move from place to place. Strangers are people who are foreigners in a country where they were not born.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **sojourners** and **strangers**. Look up sojourner in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David said that Yahweh is pleased with the integrity or uprightness of people's hearts. Integrity refers to how a person behaves and their motives or intentions. A person with integrity behaves in a way that honours Yahweh. That person obeys Yahweh's commandments. That person is complete or the same person with his actions, his thoughts, and his emotions. That person is sincere, strong, and honest. Integrity is also called "uprightness of heart."

Stop here and discuss what word or phrase you will use for **integrity**. If you use the word for heart in your description of integrity, then use the same word for heart as you have previously, and remember that heart is in the Master Glossary. If you have already translated integrity, or heart, in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David prayed that Yahweh would help Solomon to be committed to keep Yahweh's **commands**, **testimony**, and **statutes wholeheartedly**. Use the same words or phrases for wholeheartedly, commandments, and statutes as you used in previous passages. For more information on commandments and statutes, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh gave Moses the 10 commandments that he wrote on stone tablets. The people called these stone tablets the testimony. Therefore, "testimony of Yahweh" is another way to say the law of Yahweh. This law proved that God and the people of Israel had a covenant, or a special relationship.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **testimony**. Look up testimony in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

David told the people of Israel to praise Yahweh their God, and they **bowed** and lay on the ground to honor Yahweh and the **king**. Use the same word or phrase for king as you used in previous passages. For more information on

king, refer to the Master Glossary. When a person bows down before someone else, they lower their head or the whole top of their body forward. The person does this to show respect and humility. A person can also bow down by kneeling in front of a person and putting their head to the ground. Sometimes people even stretched themselves out flat on the ground in front of a person. This is called making yourself fall at someone's feet. Use the same word or phrase for bow down as you have used in previous passages, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information about bow.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 29:10–20

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (6.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (8.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (5.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.4 MB)

1 Chronicles 29:21–25

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 29:21–25 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:21–25 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.

3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:21–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, King David prayed and praised Yahweh for the generous gifts that the leaders of Israel had willingly given to the work of the temple.

This story takes place the day after that. The next day, the people of Israel offered sacrifices to Yahweh. The people offered burnt sacrifices and peace or fellowship sacrifices. In a burnt sacrifice, they killed, cut up, and then burned the whole animal completely on the altar. A person would offer a burnt offering to dedicate himself to Yahweh completely. In a fellowship or peace offering, the priests burned some parts of the animal on the altar and took some for themselves to eat. The priest also gave the person who offered the sacrifice the rest of the meat. The peace or fellowship offering represented sharing a meal with Yahweh, and so it showed that the person who offered the offering was in a good relationship with Yahweh. The people of Israel altogether offered 1,000 bulls or male cows, 1,000 rams or male sheep, and 1,000 male lambs. A lamb is a young sheep, less than one year old, whereas a ram is a sheep above one year old. The Israelites offered these animals with their specific drink offerings. Yahweh had instructed the Israelites in the days of Moses that they had to offer specific amounts of wine together with their animal offerings. The amount of wine the people should offer was related to the size of the animal they offered as well as to the importance of the type of offering. The drink offering showed that the person who offered it was completely surrendering and committing himself to serve Yahweh, just like the priest completely poured out to Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of a bull, a ram, and a lamb as a group. Discuss this question as a group: What kind of animal and drink sacrifices do your people make or used to make, and what does each sacrifice represent? Describe the amount or quality of the sacrifice for different types of sacrifice. Make sure you identify the relationship between the sacrifice and the life of the person who offered it. Pause this audio here.

Although the storyteller does not tell us, it is likely that the priests are the ones who actually burnt the sacrifices on the altar. The number of peace sacrifices that they offered was enough to feed all the people of Israel who were there. On that day, the people of Israel ate and drank in the presence of Yahweh with great joy. It is likely that the people made the offerings on Mount Moriah, on the land David had bought and where David had already built an altar to Yahweh. This is where Solomon would later build the temple. This great feast in the presence of Yahweh showed the Israelites' commitment, togetherness, and fellowship with Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What sacrifices or rituals do your people celebrate together in the presence of God, spirits, or ancestors? Talk about a time you shared a meal with God, the spirits or the ancestors. Explain why and how you did this. Pause audio here.

You will remember that David had already made Solomon king privately. The people of Israel confirmed or proclaimed David's son, Solomon, king a second time on that day. The people of Israel publicly anointed or poured oil on Solomon's head to show that he was their king. The people anointed Solomon as king in the presence of Yahweh or before Yahweh. The people also anointed Zadok as Yahweh's priest. Before this, Zadok and Abiathar had been important priests together. Zadok was from the family line of Phinehas, and Abiathar was from the family line of Eli. Yahweh had previously promised to choose Phinehas' descendants as high priest and to reject Eli's descendants. Therefore, it is likely that the Israelites anointed Zadok as the high priest or the most important priest. When people anointed a person, they showed that Yahweh's spirit was coming on the person because Yahweh had chosen the person for a special task. People anointed other people, objects, and buildings that were set apart for Yahweh with oil.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss how you dedicate people to serve God or spirits in your community. Tell a story of a time when your community anointed, recognised, proclaimed, or crowned a great leader. Pause this audio here.

1 Chronicles 29:21–25

So Solomon became King in his father David's place. David probably saw Solomon become king before David died. The storyteller says that Solomon sat on the throne of Yahweh. The throne of the king of Israel is called the throne of Yahweh because Yahweh was the true king of Israel. Solomon ruled as Yahweh's representative. The people of Israel obeyed Solomon, their king, and Solomon became successful. All the leaders of Israel and the mighty men, as well as the rest of David's sons, who were all of Solomon's brothers, promised to obey Solomon. The storyteller says that the leaders gave their hand or power to Solomon. It is likely that the storyteller is telling us that the leaders of Israel served Solomon, and no one challenged Solomon for the right to be king. Solomon's brothers would be the people most likely to challenge Solomon to become king of Israel, so it was very important that they all promised to obey Solomon.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell two stories from your community's history. Tell one story of a great, successful leader that everybody obeyed. Tell also of another leader who some people challenged for the right to be their leader. Suggest the reasons why this happened to them. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh exalted or made Solomon great in the eyes of all Israel. The people of Israel all saw how Yahweh blessed Solomon and made him a great king. Yahweh gave Solomon great wealth, honor, or reputation and power, more than any other king of Israel had before Solomon.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:21–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: The day after King David praised Yahweh and prayed for Solomon, the people of Israel offered sacrifices to Yahweh. The people offered burnt offerings and other offerings together with all their drink offerings. The people ate and drank with great joy in the presence of Yahweh.

In the second scene: The people of Israel anointed Solomon as king a second time. The people also anointed Zadok as high priest. All the mighty men and leaders, as well as King David's other sons, promised to be loyal to King Solomon.

In the third scene: The storyteller tells us that Yahweh made Solomon great before all the people of Israel. Yahweh gave Solomon more wealth, honor or reputation, and power than Yahweh had given any other king of Israel before Solomon.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- King David, Solomon's father
- Solomon, King David's son
- Zadok
- The officers of the king
- The mighty men
- King David's other sons
- The people of Israel
- And, although the storyteller does not mention them, the priests who offered the sacrifices that the people of Israel brought were probably there as well

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the previous story, the people of Israel praised and worshipped Yahweh after King David had praised Yahweh and prayed for them and for Solomon.

This story takes place the following day. The storyteller says that "they," or the same people who had praised Yahweh in the previous story, offered sacrifices to Yahweh. These are the people of Israel who had gathered in Jerusalem. In the previous story, the people of Israel had worshipped Yahweh with their voices. In this story,

the people continue to worship Yahweh by offering animal sacrifices. The people of Israel had several different kinds of sacrifices that they usually offered to Yahweh. In this story, the people brought more than one type of sacrifice. This great event in the history of Israel, when the people anointed King Solomon, took place over two days. This event would have involved a lot of work and preparation.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell of a great spiritual event that people celebrated to honor your community's spiritual being or beings. Discuss how long the event was, including the planning and the people involved. Pause this audio here.

Although King David was very old and was going to die soon, it is very likely that David was present at this event for Solomon as well.

The people of Israel offered or brought to Yahweh 1,000 bulls or male cows, 1,000 rams or male sheep, and 1,000 lambs or young male sheep as burnt offerings. Although the storyteller does not mention the priests, it is likely that the people brought the sacrifices to the priest because the priests were the only ones who Yahweh allowed to do the work of offering sacrifices to Yahweh. The people of Israel brought all their animal offerings with their specific drink or wine offerings. You will remember that Yahweh had commanded the people of Israel to bring a specific drink offering with each animal sacrifice. The people offered burnt offerings and drink offerings to show that they were dedicated to Yahweh completely. The people did not eat any of the meat of the burnt offering. It is likely that the people were dedicating themselves to the work of building the temple.

Stop here and look again at the pictures of the bull, the ram and the lamb as a group. Pause this audio here.

The people of Israel also brought a great number of other sacrifices. It is likely that these other sacrifices were fellowship or peace offerings because the priests did not completely burn these other offerings on the altar. The priests gave some of the meat to the people to eat. Unlike with the burnt offerings, we do not know the number of peace offerings that the people brought. We are only told that the number of these sacrifices was enough to feed all the people of Israel who were there. The people of Israel ate and drank with great joy in the presence of Yahweh that day. The people of Israel celebrated the anointing of their new king, Solomon, by eating and drinking together with Yahweh. Yahweh was not there in person. The storyteller likely means that they ate and drank near Yahweh's altar or that, although they could not see Yahweh, Yahweh was fellowshipping with the people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell of a time when your people have fellowshipped with God or spirits. Explain how people did this. Pay attention to the words you use to indicate that God or the spirits were present. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the people of Israel anointed Solomon as king. The people of Israel also anointed Zadok as priest. People poured sweet-smelling oil over someone's head to anoint them. This ritual showed that Yahweh had chosen this person for a special purpose and gave that person special authority.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk of a great celebration in the history of your people when the people acknowledged a leader before the spiritual being of your community. Explain the ritual that the people used to do this. Pay attention to the words that you use to describe the ritual that declared the person a leader. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that the people anointed Solomon king a second time. David had declared Solomon king before this day but that was probably in private. People had anointed both King Saul and King David twice, once in private and another time in public. It is not clear why the people anointed Zadok together with Solomon, because Zadok had already been serving as a priest. It is likely that the people anointed Zadok to serve as high priest on this day. Yahweh had given Solomon a holy task: to build the temple. It might be that Zadok, the chief priest, is included in the anointing to remind us of the holy nature of Solomon's kingship. Solomon would build the temple where Zadok would lead the people of Israel in worshipping Yahweh. The people anointed Solomon and Zadok before Yahweh. This means that Yahweh was a witness.

Therefore, Solomon ruled on the throne of Yahweh after his father, David, died. Yahweh was the true king of Israel, so King Solomon ruled as Yahweh's representative. King Solomon was successful, and all the people of Israel obeyed Solomon. The storyteller is likely summarising the entire reign of Solomon here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Return to the previous discussion. Have someone retell the events of the day that the people acknowledged the leader publicly. The person should then summarise the successes of that leader's life and rule after they tell of the events of the day that the people chose that leader. Pause this audio here.

All the leaders of Israel and the mighty men, as well as the rest of King David's sons, who were Solomon's brothers, promised that they would be loyal to Solomon. The mighty men might have been military leaders, or just important and influential men or leading citizens. The storyteller says that the men "put their hand under" Solomon. This is special language to tell us that the men accepted the authority of Solomon. The men may also have literally put their hands under Solomon, but the important thing is that they promised not to challenge Solomon's rule.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have a person swear his loyalty to another person from the group. If possible, the person should act out the ritual or ceremony that you would do in your culture on such occasions. Whilst this is happening, another person should narrate out loud what is happening. The narrator should use the special language that you have in your language for this ritual or ceremony. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller summarises what Yahweh did for King Solomon in all the years that he ruled. Yahweh exalted or made Solomon great in the eyes of all the people of Israel. This means that all the people of Israel saw how Yahweh made King Solomon great. Yahweh gave Solomon more kingly glory than all the kings that had ruled Israel before Solomon. It is likely that this mainly refers to Solomon's wealth and honor.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about the leader from your community to whom God gave the most blessings of any other leader. What did this leader have that people could see and know that he was the leader whom God had most blessed? Pay attention to the words and phrases to describe how God blessed the leader. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:21–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- King David, Solomon's father
- Solomon, King David's son
- Zadok
- The officers of the king
- The mighty men
- King David's other sons
- The people of Israel
- And, although the storyteller does not mention them, the priests who offered the sacrifices that the people of Israel brought were probably there as well

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The people of Israel made sacrifices to Yahweh. The people offered burnt sacrifices and other sacrifices, together with all their drink offerings, and ate and drank with great joy in the presence of Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We feel great joy and happiness. This is a wonderful day of celebration and dedication; or
- All of Israel sings and dances as we praise Yahweh for giving us a new king; or
- We feel generous. Solomon will build the temple. We bring to Yahweh all the best of our animals to honor and praise Yahweh. The people of Israel rejoice and fellowship with Yahweh.

Ask the person playing the priests, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We feel joy and wonder at the goodness of Yahweh. We love Yahweh and King Solomon; or
- We are blessed to offer these sacrifices to Yahweh for the people; or
- We feel tired but happy. We are excited for people to build the temple.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy and well pleased; or
- I am satisfied and pleased with the sacrifices of my people; or
- I love being in my people’s presence.

Continue the drama. The people of Israel anointed Solomon as king a second time. The people also anointed Zadok as high priest. All the mighty men and leaders, as well as King David’s other sons, promised to be loyal to King Solomon. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Solomon, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel very happy, honoured, and blessed by Yahweh; or
- People feel great joy in Israel, and people have huge expectations of me. I am nervous; or
- I am now king of Israel. The responsibility is heavy on me.

Ask the person playing Zadok, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Praise be to Yahweh for this day; or
- I have the job of standing before Yahweh on behalf of the people in the temple; or
- I will support Solomon in his task of building the temple. I am happy that Yahweh will have a house in the midst of Yahweh’s people

Ask the person playing the officers, mighty men, and King David’s other sons, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy, honored, and full of excitement. Solomon is king. We will obey Solomon; or
- Yahweh has chosen Solomon, and we will listen to Solomon and support him in every way. Solomon is the king of Israel; or
- The people have made our brother Solomon king publicly. We must show our support and promise to obey Solomon. But some of us are not happy. Several of us would be much better kings than Solomon. Why has our father chosen Solomon?

Continue the drama. Yahweh made Solomon great before all the people of Israel. Yahweh gave Solomon more wealth, honor or reputation, and power than Yahweh had given any other king of Israel before Solomon. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- We feel amazed. Solomon is the wealthiest man who has ever lived; or

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- Solomon is the most glorious king we have ever seen. Yahweh has blessed Solomon even more than David. Yahweh must love Solomon very much, and we love him too; or
- We feel very happy to live under such a successful king as King Solomon.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy and generous; or
- I love Solomon. Solomon loves me and obeys me. Solomon will build my house as I asked; or
- I will also rejoice to bless Solomon and make him very great.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:21–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The next day, the people of **Israel** made **sacrifices** to **Yahweh**. The people brought many male bulls, rams, and lambs as **burnt offerings** together with their **drink offerings**. Use the same words or phrases for the people of Israel, sacrifices, Yahweh, burnt offerings, and drink offerings as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israel, sacrifices, Yahweh, burnt offerings, and drink offerings, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same words or phrases for **bulls**, **rams**, and male **lambs** as you used in previous passages.

The people **anointed** Solomon as **king** and Zadok as **priest** in the presence of Yahweh that day. Use the same words or phrases for anointed, king, and priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on anoint, king, and priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Solomon sat as king on the **throne** of Yahweh after his father, David, died. All the **officers** or leaders and **mighty men** or important men, as well as all of King David's sons, promised to obey King Solomon. Use the same words or phrases for throne, officers, and mighty men as you used in previous passages. Remember that a throne symbolizes the authority and rule of a king.

Yahweh made Solomon great in the presence of all Israel and gave Solomon more **glory** than any other king of Israel before him. Use the same word or phrase for glory as you used in previous passages. For more information on glory, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 29:21–25

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.1 MB)
- Setting the Stage (5.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.4 MB)

1 Chronicles 29:26–30

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear 1 Chronicles 29:26–30 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:26–30 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:26–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller finishes telling the story of David. In the previous passage, the storyteller told us about the end of David's reign and how Solomon became king after David. Now, the storyteller gives us a summary of David's reign. The storyteller uses earlier stories told by other storytellers in Deuteronomy and Kings to help form this story.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: If possible, listen to your translation of 1 Kings 2:10–12, where the storyteller of 1 Kings gives a summary of David's reign. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller reminds us that David was the son of Jesse. Jesse, David's father, was from the tribe of Judah, but Jesse was not a king. David was the king of all of Israel. The storyteller highlights that the kingdom of Israel was united when David reigned over Israel. The storyteller tells us that David reigned for 40 years in total. David reigned for seven years in Hebron. You may remember that in 2 Samuel, the storyteller of that book tells us that David reigned in Hebron for seven years and six months. We do not know why this storyteller in 1 Chronicles tells us seven years. This storyteller does not say that David's reign in Hebron was only over Judah because the storyteller does not want to remind people that Israel was divided into two kingdoms at the beginning of David's reign. David reigned over all of Israel for 33 years. When David was king over all of Israel, David lived in Jerusalem. David reigned over the kingdom of Israel from Jerusalem.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Have somebody tell a story of a well-known leader of your country or people. Include how long that person was a leader for and where they lived while they were the leader. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller of 1 Chronicles probably used the book of 2 Samuel to help write the book of 1 Chronicles. The storyteller of this passage probably took the length of David's reign over Israel from the book of 2 Samuel. You

may remember that at the time of the storyteller of 2 Samuel, the Israelites thought that 40 years represented the time it took for a complete generation of people to happen. We do not know if the storyteller of 2 Samuel gave us the actual time that David ruled Judah and Israel, or if the storyteller used the ideal numbers to make David seem better to the people who heard the story.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What things do you say about great leaders? When you describe your leaders, what kinds of details about the leaders' lives do you tell people? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us that David died at a good old age. David lived a long life and was old when he died. David died after enjoying his long life, wealth, and honor, or the respect that people gave to David. All of these good things came from Yahweh and were Yahweh's blessing on David because David was faithful to Yahweh and kept the covenant that David swore to the people of Israel. The storyteller tells us that David's son Solomon succeeded David as king. Solomon was the next king of Israel after David. David was still alive when Solomon became king of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time in your country when the most important leader in your country stopped leading, even though he was still alive, and a new person became the most important leader. Why did the most important leader stop leading your people? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller ends the passage by telling us that other people wrote in other books all the events or things that happened to David during King David's reign. The storyteller points us to the records, chronicles, or stories of Samuel the seer, Nathan the prophet, and Gad the seer. All of these men were alive during David's life. Samuel heard from Yahweh and told the people of Israel that David should be the king of Israel. Nathan and Gad prophesied to David during David's reign. You will remember from earlier passages that a seer and a prophet are very similar to each other. A seer and a prophet both receive a message from God and see something about God that other people cannot see. A prophet speaks on behalf of God. Storytellers completed the records of Samuel, Nathan, and Gad many years before this storyteller told this story in 1 Chronicles. We do not know if the stories from Samuel, Nathan, and Gad are all part of the Bible. It is possible that the stories are the books of 1 and 2 Samuel and 1 and 2 Kings, or they might be stories that people lost after the storyteller told this story.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What records or stories of the history of your nation do you have? What do you call these records or stories, and what are they named after? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us that other information about David is in the stories by Samuel, Nathan, and Gad. The stories from these men contain details about David's reign over Israel and David's power or strength as a ruler. The stories from Samuel, Nathan, and Gad also tell people about events that happened to David and to Israel and all the other kingdoms. The storyteller does not mean every kingdom in the whole world. The storyteller means the nations in the region around the country of Israel. These nations were Egypt, Syria, Philistia, Moab, Edom, Tyre, and Amon. You will remember that David defeated some of these nations. The kings of all of these nations respected David as king.

Stop here and look at a map that shows Israel and the surrounding nations. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What other countries or groups of people surround your country or people group? Include all the countries or groups of people that are next to or near your country or people.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:26–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: The storyteller reminds us that David was the king of all Israel. David ruled for a long time, and Yahweh blessed David. Solomon became king after David was king.

In the second scene: The storyteller tells us that the records of Samuel the seer, Nathan the prophet, and Gad the seer all include the events and details of David's reign and everything that happened to David and the surrounding kingdoms.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller
- David
- Solomon
- And Samuel the seer, Nathan the prophet, and Gad the seer

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The storyteller ends the story of 1 Chronicles by giving a summary of David's reign over Israel. The storyteller reminds us that David was king over all of Israel. The storyteller tells us the total number of years that David was king and then tells us how many years David was a king while David lived in Hebron, and then how many years David was a king while David lived in Jerusalem.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Have someone tell a story that is based on another story. What parts of the story are the same? What parts of the story are different? Did the person leave out any parts of the original story? Pause this audio here.

David was very old when he died. During David's long life, David enjoyed many blessings from Yahweh. Yahweh blessed David with a long life or a life full of days.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How would you describe someone who was old when they died and had a good life? Pause this audio here.

David enjoyed many riches or wealth. David had lots of belongings, money, and valuable items. During David's life, David enjoyed honor. People respected David, and David had a good reputation among his people.

Solomon was king of all Israel after David. David was still alive when Solomon became king.

The storyteller then uses a word to introduce something new into the story and to draw our attention to it.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What word or phrase do you use to draw someone's attention to a new part of a story or get someone's attention? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller tells us that all the important events about David's reign over Israel are in three different records or stories. People named these records after three people who heard from God and shared messages from God with David and the people of Israel. The three people were Samuel the seer, Nathan the prophet, and Gad the seer. Samuel, Nathan, and Gad were alive at the same time as David. Storytellers wrote the records of Samuel, Nathan, and Gad many years before the storyteller told the story of 1 Chronicles. The records contained details, or facts and information, about David's reign over Israel, David's power or strength as a king, and David's activities in Israel and with the surrounding kingdoms.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:26–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller
- David
- Solomon
- And Samuel the seer, Nathan the prophet, and Gad the seer

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The storyteller reminds us that David was the king of all Israel. David ruled for a long time, and Yahweh blessed David. Solomon became king after David was king. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the storyteller, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- David was a really good king. David united Israel; or
- Yahweh blessed David because David was faithful to his covenant with Israel; or
- Israel was such a good place at the time of David.

Ask the person playing David, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I had a good life; or
- Yahweh blessed me while I was king; or
- I kept my promises to my people and to Yahweh.

Ask the person playing Solomon, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- David anointed me king of Israel; or
- I am honored to be king of Israel after my father, David.

Continue the drama. The storyteller tells us that all the events and details of David's reign and everything that happened to David and the surrounding kingdoms are in Samuel the seer, Nathan the prophet, and Gad the seer's records. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the storyteller, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- There are so many ways for people to hear about King David; or
- It is important for my people to see that Israel was strong when Israel was united and David was king; or
- The other countries near Israel respected and feared David.

Ask the person playing Samuel the seer, Nathan the prophet, and Gad the seer, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We wrote down events from David's reign over Israel; or
- We told the stories of King David because we wanted everyone to remember those stories.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of 1 Chronicles 29:26–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

David, **son** of Jesse, was **king** of all **Israel**. Use the same words or phrases for son, king, and Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on son, king, and Israel, refer to the Master Glossary.

David **ruled**, or was king of, Israel for 40 years. Use the same word or phrase for ruled as you used in previous passages.

David died an old man after David lived a long time and enjoyed **wealth** and **honor**, or a good reputation among people. Use the same words and phrases for wealth and honor as you used in previous passages.

David's son Solomon followed David as king. Solomon was the next person to be king after David.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about Solomon following David as the next king. Pause this audio here.

Someone wrote the events of King David's reign in the records or history of Samuel the seer, Nathan the prophet, and Gad the seer. People probably wrote these events on long scrolls or rolled-up pieces of parchment. The word in the original language for records is literally "the words of Samuel the seer."

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **records**, or a **history** that someone writes down. Pause this audio here.

Use the same words for **seer** and **prophet** as you have used in previous passages. Remember that seer and prophet mean almost the same thing, and prophet is in the Master Glossary.

The storytellers wrote down the events in Israel and the surrounding **kingdoms**. In this case, kingdoms are territories that kings rule over. Use the same word or phrase for kingdom as you used in previous passages, and remember that the storyteller is talking about several kingdoms in this story. Kingdom is in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

1 Chronicles 29:26–30

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (923 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)